

Cohort A

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Business AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The Business AAS mission statement has not been changed. The mission statement is still aligned with the college's mission statement. The department continues to work with industry leaders to give students necessary skills to translate into the business community.

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	"Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution? The Business AAS degree gives students the knowledge and skills needed for attractive careers in fields such as accounting, banking and finance, hospitality, human resources, logistics management, marketing, supply, sales, and supply chain management. The Business AAS program and certificates all for partnership and relationship with local businesses and communities.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes

2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The learning outcomes have been assessed in the BUSN 2395 course. Students are assessed using a final exam. There is no change in the outcomes and the way students are being assessed.

Learn outcomes have not changed. These outcomes are assessed in the BUSN 2395 capstone course. Students are still assessed prior to graduation.

PLO 1 and PLO 5 are assessed in the Accounting 1010 course during the Fall and Spring semesters. The current assessment, which began to be used in Fall of 2021, was selected because it is assigned in all ACCT 1010 classes, regardless of modality, and supports all three of the course learning objectives as well as mapping very well to the AAS Business PLOs 1 and 5. The assignment requires students to interpret and evaluate transaction data presented, and then to apply Generally Accepted Accounting Principles in recording those transactions. The assessment has seven elements that parallel the complete accounting cycle that all businesses go through in a single project.

PLO 1, 2, 3, 4, are assessed in the BUS 1305 Introduction to Business Courses during the Fall and Spring. Questions have come up since 2020 on how to better meet these PLOs. In 2021 the Business plan was removed from the course as a way to address the PLOs.

The concern was that students at this point did not fully understand the different parts of a business plan. The understanding of financial statements in the class were not substantial enough to successfully apply to PLOs. Business faculty are currently reviewing other course materials and ideas on how to better prepare students to complete these PLOs.

Faculty are tasked to complete an overhaul of the course by Spring of 2025. In Fall of 2019 all exit exams for the course were removed as they did not directly address or apply to these PLOs.

PLO 1-5 are all assessed in the BUSN 2395 BUSN Applications or Capstone Course. In 2020 program faculty overhauled the course to better align with these PLOs. The course is also better aligned with the course catalogue. The new Capstone course is required for students graduating as early as Fall 2021 (if they entered in Fall 2020 and continued as full-time students for four consecutive semesters through Fall 2021). The new Capstone course include new assessments of program-level student learning outcomes. Objective assessments at the end of the course are currently being used to track student success in meeting these PLOs. Data will continue to be tracked for student success. Program faculty continue to meet and create ideas on how to better meet all five PLOs in this

course. Prior to Spring 2020 the exam was outdated and did not align with program SLOs or courses required for all students in the program and therefore did not accurately measure program learning outcomes. The exam was added in Spring 2020 and addresses new program PLO measures being embedded into the design of a new capstone course.

Evidence:

- Business, AAS Assessment Tool (1)

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

There is no change in the data that was reported in 2023. Students are still being assessed. The course is offered in Spring 2025

Data is still being collected for the 2024 and 2025 AY. The last time data was provided was at the beginning of the APR.

OUTCOME	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met) Average%
PLO 1			75.49	24.51%	69.85%	30.15%	Met Met Not
PLO 2			73.15%	26.85%	72.79%	27.21%	Met Met Not
PLO 3			73.15%	26.85%	86.76%	13.24%	Met Met Not
PLO 4			73.15%	26.85%	68.33%	31.67%	Met Met Not
PLO 5			85.94%	14.06%	92.73%	7.27%	Met Met Not
Course Learning Outcome #1 ACCT1010			90.71%	9.29%	92.91%	7.09%	Met Not Met
Course Learning Outcome #2 ACCT1010			90.71%	9.29%	92.91%	7.09%	Met No Met
Course Learning			90.71%	9.29%	92.91%	7.09%	Met Not Met

Outcome #3 ACCT1010							
Course Learning Outcomes	ACCT1010.1 Principles	ACCT 1010.2 Cycle	ACCT 1010.3				
Methods & Procedures							

1. Analysis of trends

Although 75 to 90% of students met PLOs 1-5 in 2022 and 2023, overall the three year outcome results were not met. More data will need to be collected in 2023 to 2025 to determine overall student success rates.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning. Tremendous contributions from a strong team of adjunct faculty that not only taught courses well but even developed numerous, high quality model courses and supported department service and support requirements when we had no other resources to do so. Adjunct faculty have taught 50% or more of all BUS sections for the last three years and helped us provide our students the access and learning modalities they needed to succeed.

Unfortunately, the story of this program and our performance is not entirely pretty. The combination of inadequate full-time faculty strength levels, instability/turnover in the dean's position, and the double-edged blessing and challenge of soaring enrollments have contributed to and exposed some program deficiencies and a challenge to meet objectives with overall PLOs.

- BUS AAS programs see enrollments continue to grow, spurred in part by soaring numbers of high school students enrolling in online, dual enrollment BUS A.A.S. courses
- Business faculty begin utilizing new Team Room spaces to enable more team-based, in-class, problems-/case study-based assignments
- Department rolls out robust tutoring program for Accounting 1010 and 1020 courses

Evidence:

- ACCT1010 CLOs AY20-23
- BUS AAS PLO AY21-23 Ground all other & Online
- BUSN2395 Rubric Report 02-07-2024 081547
- Business AAS Gender PLOs AY21-23
- Business AAS PLOs Pell_First Gen AY21-23
- Business AAS PLOs Race_Ethnicity AY21-23
- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Here is an update on initiatives established by the division.

- Hired new Faculty in accounting and Business in 2023
- Classes in Hospitality Management will start summer 2025 for the embedded certificate.
- Continues to focus on collaboration and teamwork with full-time advisors and developing advising tools and templates to help students develop good, achievable degree plans regardless of the pace at which they progress (full-time or part-time).
- Improved outreach efforts to improve alignment and teamwork with feeder school systems, TCATs, job centers, and employers in our service area.
- Department offers more significant and impactful career transition support enabled by new faculty hires and driven by increasing completion rates and booming regional economies
- Hosted advising clinics at the beginning of each semester to allow faculty and department members to better meet individual student needs.
- Improved relationships and improved services and enrollment at all of the regional campuses.

Here is an update on initiatives established by the division.

- Hired new Faculty in accounting and Business in 2023
- Classes in Hospitality Management will start summer 2025 for the embedded certificate.
- Continues to focus on collaboration and teamwork with full-time advisors and developing advising tools and templates to help students develop good, achievable degree plans regardless of the pace at which they progress (full-time or part-time).
- Improved outreach efforts to improve alignment and teamwork with feeder school systems, TCATs, job centers, and employers in our service area.
- Department offers more significant and impactful career transition support enabled by new faculty hires and driven by increasing completion rates and booming regional economies
- Hosted advising clinics at the beginning of each semester to allow faculty and department members to better meet individual student needs.
- Improved relationships and improved services and enrollment at all of the regional campuses.

The BUS department and BUS AAS programs have been succeeding at a high rate and showing significant gains in most performance measures in recent years despite woeful full-time faculty strength levels. Building renovations and continuous course rewrites during Spring 2025 should help in meeting the PLOs and overall student success rates. At this point, program faculty are displaced throughout different buildings on campus. This creates a challenge to collaborate with other program faculty. Unfortunately, the story of this program and our performance is not entirely pretty. The combination of inadequate full-time faculty strength levels, instability/turnover in the different positions key campus positions, and the double-edged blessing and challenge of soaring enrollments have contributed to and exposed some program deficiencies. Tremendous contributions from a strong team of adjunct faculty that not only taught courses well but even developed numerous, high quality model courses and supported department service and support requirements when we had no other resources to do so. Adjunct faculty have taught 50% or more of all BUS sections for the last three years and helped us provide our students the access and learning modalities they needed to succeed.

Despite being woefully under-resourced, Business enrollment growth has far outpaced overall college enrollment growth over the last five years (by more than 700%). The department is now moving in the right direction with slow but steady movements toward the faculty levels needed to achieve the excellence and outcomes that students, faculty members, and supported communities deserve. In part inspired by its resource challenges, the department has recently implemented numerous improvements that are sure to make BUS AAS programs even more successful and impactful and drive enrollments, retention rates, and completion rates ever higher.

Actions currently being implemented that are sure to boost positive momentum include:

- Hiring a Full-Time faculty member to teach BUS courses in Cookeville – started Spring 2021
- Creating a, new Embedded Technical Certificates effective Fall 2024 in Hospitality Management.
- Hiring two additional full-time faculty members
- Continuing to focus on collaboration and teamwork with full-time advisors and developing advising tools and templates to help students develop good, achievable degree plans regardless of the pace at which they progress (full-time or part-time).
- Initiating new outreach efforts to improve alignment and teamwork with feeder school systems, TCATs, job centers, and employers in our service area.
- Department offers more significant and impactful career transition support enabled by new faculty hires and driven by increasing completion rates and booming regional economies
- Hosting advising clinics at the beginning of each semester to allow faculty and department members to better meet individual student needs.
- Better relationships and improved services and enrollment at all of the regional campuses.

Evidence:

- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1
- Business- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

Students completing end-of-course surveys have generally reported strong satisfaction with BUS AAS courses. Overall student satisfaction survey data continues to match student retention and satisfaction with the program and staff. Student engagement office tracks employment satisfaction as well as student satisfaction survey data.

There are no changes to PLO from the initial APR.

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline**	Baseline Data
1	Apply Business and Management Knowledge through employability of skills	Increase employer hiring satisfaction survey rate of BUS AAS graduates	Programs Faculty BUS AAS Department	36% of employers are responding to surveys as of 2019	2025 to 2026	Increase response rate to 50% or higher by 2026
2	Demonstrate a basic understanding of the American Free Enterprise System	Increase Student survey responses on application of BUS AAS courses to program and jobs in the industry	Program faculty	Student survey response rate is at 30 to 40% of those enrolled in classes	2025 to 2026	Increase student survey rates to 60% of those enrolled in courses.
3	Implement a Tutoring Program through Tutor.com for students taking accounting classes. PLO 5 (SL)	Improve Student Success Rate in the Accounting 1010 and 1020 classes and improve exam scores	Program Faculty Tutor.com	Increase in student usage of Tutor.com for accounting.	2025-2026	

4	Implement Team Room Space Activities through in class and online classroom modalities PLO 1 (SL)	Improve student team based, problem/case study based skills in BUS 1305 and BUS1330 revisions/development	Program Faculty www.persusail.com	Rubrics will be created for BUS 1330 and BUS 1305 Team Room activity	2025-2026	
---	--	---	--	--	-----------	--

Students completing end-of-course surveys have generally reported strong satisfaction with BUS AAS courses. However, there was some decline in satisfaction with some BUS AAS courses after the college shifted rapidly to fully online learning in Spring 2020 and taught online again in Fall 2020. Declines were most significant with courses for which we did not have a model course already developed and with sections taught by faculty members who were less experienced in online learning and less familiar with the college's learning management system.

The BUS AAS program is prioritizing efforts to develop model courses for all courses required for a Business AAS degree. As of Summer 2020, 60% of Distributed Education's AY 2020-2021 budget was obligated for Business and Technology Division courses. The pace of these development efforts is constrained by the limited number of Full-Time faculty authorizations but the department and division are prioritizing this work, highly.

The Department is also working to make course design and development efforts more collaborative so more faculty will use the model courses as the foundation of what they teach – *particularly* for courses taught online.

Although 75-90% of students met PLOs annually, the three-year outcome for PLO 5 was not met, indicating a need for stronger, sustained support in applying accounting concepts. Implementing a Tutor.com tutoring program for accounting courses (ACCT 1010/1020) directly targets gaps in interpreting accounting data and applying it to business problems, strengthens foundational skills across delivery modalities (including high-enrollment and dual enrollment sections), and is expected to improve consistency and long-term PLO achievement.

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

There is no new budget initiatives as of Spring 2025

Much of the division budget concerns were met with revocation of building and hiring of new faculty members. I am not aware of any new budget concerns.

Department and College wide turnover will continue to hurt in meeting PLOs and overall student success. Positions in the BUS AAS programs are funded and are going through the hiring processes. Salary rates don't match industry rates at this point, and create a challenge in getting qualified faculty to either locate or relocate to the area. Several positions in the Department have gone vacant for around two years. An analysis of salaries throughout the campus is also underway.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

The mission of the program is aligned with the educational items in the institutional mission. This last sentence "The Business AAS program and certificates all for partnership and relationship with local businesses and communities" seems to have missing parts.

The PLO's seem to align with the division's mission, but they are not stated in the document, so I am not able to provide feedback on them.

From the presentation given in the committee meeting, the rational for the recommended changes seem appropriate and responsive to recognized deficiencies in the program.

There are several encouraging initiatives here. There is one repeated paragraph from Section 2. These initiatives seem appropriate for the division.

Mission- The Business AAS program and certificates all for partnership and relationship with local-**Does this sentence need to be adjusted?**

Under PLO1-5 an EXAM is discussed - **What is the exam and what topics does it cover that address your PLOs? Is this an updated exam versus the exam discussed in the prior sentence?**

Section 2B- **How do these bullet points speak to the manner in which you are using the data in table 2 to improve student learning outcomes?_**

- BUS AAS programs see enrollments continue to grow, spurred in part by soaring numbers of high school students enrolling in online, dual enrollment BUS A.A.S. courses
- Business faculty begin utilizing new Team Room spaces to enable more team-based, in-class, problems-/case study-based assignments.
- Department rolls out robust tutoring program for Accounting 1010 and 1020 courses

Section 3-

- succeeding at a high rate and showing- **What constitutes "succeeding at high rates and showing significant gains"? Tie this statement back to data that supports it.**
- Unfortunately, the story of this program and our performance is not entirely pretty. The combination of inadequate full-time faculty strength levels, instability/turnover in the different positions key campus positions, and the double-edged blessing and challenge of soaring enrollments have contributed to and exposed some program deficiencies.
Tremendous contributions from a strong team of adjunct faculty that not only taught courses well but even developed numerous, high quality model courses and supported department service and support requirements when we had no other resources to do so. Adjunct faculty have taught 50% or more of all BUS sections for the last three years and helped us provide our students the access and- **You have these statements listed in 2B. Do you mean to have the same content in two different places?**
- Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1- **What data came from your course evals?**

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The faculty appear to be engaged in reviewing this academic program. Outcomes data has been provided.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell.	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%	YES

	online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate prepares students to succeed in entry-level administrative support positions in practically any sector of the economy. Students will complete courses that align with popular industry certifications from Microsoft. Graduates also will develop the knowledge and confidence to adapt to workplace requirements of the future. Knowledge and skills gained in the program also provide students a strong foundation for further studies toward an Associate's degree.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The mission of the Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate aligns with the institution's mission by preparing students for successful careers and meaningful civic	

participation in a global society.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

To ensure students are fulfilling the objective of ADMN 1311, they are required to complete a project utilizing various components of Word. Students are assessed on a rubric.

To ensure students are fulfilling the objective of BUSN 1302, they are required to complete a project assessing students on their typing capabilities. Students are assessed on a rubric.

BUSN 1302 Keyboarding with Word Processing
BUSN 1305 Introduction to Business
INFS 1010 Computer Applications

These three courses provide the framework for further study in the business technology. Keyboarding with word processing provides basic knowledge to enhance success in computer applications, necessary for additional study in business. Introduction to Business provides an overall look at the fundamentals of the business world. These three courses provide the foundation for future coursework.

ADMN 1311 Word Processing I
BUSN 1310 Business Communications
BUSN 1370 Spreadsheet Applications

The remaining nine hours toward the certificate provides deeper knowledge in coursework. For instance, ADMN 1311 provides advanced knowledge in word processing. BUSN 1310 Business Communication allows students to develop an understanding of proper verbal and written communication including resume completion and preparing for interviews. These skills assist in preparation for entering the job market. Finally, BUSN 1370 provides an overview of Microsoft Excel.

Evidence:

- ADMN 1311 Sam Capstone Project Rubric Detail 01-30-2024 102542
- ADMN, CERT. Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

1 The Administrative Professional Technology Technical Certificate is a newer certificate. Rubrics were created over the last year. Therefore, PLO data is not currently available. We will be collecting the data using Watermark through ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. Data will be reviewed yearly to look at outcome trends. The next review cycle will include current and a deeper dive into the PLO outcome data.

Technology is here to stay. It is necessary to learn the current technology used in the office environment. Students will learn these technologies in this program. They will also learn to prepare documents found in the office environment such as emails, interoffice communication, Microsoft Office, instant messaging, virtual team meetings, slack, and more.

Students will learn Microsoft office and dive deeper into Word and Excel during this program. They will also become exposed to the most common components of a business such as marketing, accounting, finance, management, and human resources. Once students earn the certificate, they will be better equipped to use their skills in software applications, perform electronic and routine administrative office procedures, prepare documents found in an office environment, and have the ability make decisions and solve problems.

2.To improve student learning, course assignments/projects should include the most up to date technologies used in the business environment.
Assignments will also focus on application to real world problems.

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The programs strengths can be measured by the course evaluations which are positive with a mean of 4.54 and 4.63.

The headcount for fall 2021 was 12 and fall 2022 was 20. This number could be increased by educating students on their ability to complete this certificate while pursuing their degree.

The skills obtained in the required coursework meet the needs of today's workforce.

Individuals with this certificate may be selected for a job over those who do not have the certificate. It also could lead to a promotion in the workplace.

A survey of students in this problem needs to be conducted to determine the increase in enrollment. To continue the programs growth, students need to be made aware of the existence of the certificate and its value. Faculty should promote the certificate in each of their classes.

Microsoft Office is used in this program which is widely used in the workplace.

Evidence:

- Administrative Professional Technology- Fact Sheet FA23
- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Demonstrate the use of effective office communication. PLO 3 & PLO 1 (SL)	Provide relevant instruction to support their completion of the coursework.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025 Students completed the Capstone Project Spring 2024	80% meet the outcome of a passing grade of 70%
2	Learning to adapt to changing technologies. PLO 1 (SL)	Provide relevant instruction in the areas of current and changing technologies in the workforce.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025	
3	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of workplace strategies. PLO 4 (SL)		Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025 Students completed the Capstone Project Spring 2024	80% meet the outcome of a passing grade of 70%

4	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of technology updates. (SL)	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025 Students will complete the new assignment Spring 2026
---	---	--------------------	---	--

Summary

1. Because the program is new and PLO data are not yet available, the initiative directly responds to the identified data outcome, the need to collect meaningful baseline assessment data using newly developed rubrics in Watermark. By embedding effective office communication using current technologies into course assignments (ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302), the initiative ensures students actively demonstrate required software and communication skills, producing measurable evidence for future PLO trend analysis and continuous improvement while strengthening applied, job-ready learning.

2. Because PLO data are not yet available due to the program's newness and recently developed rubrics, this initiative responds directly to the data outcome by intentionally building adaptive technology skills into ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. Focusing on learning to adapt to changing technologies ensures students repeatedly engage with updated tools and platforms, generating measurable assessment evidence in Watermark while strengthening students' ability to transfer skills to evolving workplace technologies.

3. Given that PLO data are not yet available due to the program's newness and recently developed rubrics, this initiative directly supports the data outcome by creating a structured, assessable assignment in ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. Requiring students to illustrate their knowledge of workplace strategies provides measurable evidence in Watermark, supports baseline data collection, and strengthens students' applied decision-making and problem-solving skills in realistic workplace contexts.

4. Because the program is new and PLO data are not yet available, this initiative directly addresses the data outcome by creating an assessable assignment focused on current technology updates in ADMN 1311 and BUSN 1302. The assignment generates baseline evidence in Watermark while strengthening students' awareness of evolving office technologies and their ability to apply updated software tools in real-world workplace settings.

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

N/A

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Feedback:

The student success initiative for student learning outcome 1 is a little vague. I don't know that the term "workplace strategies" is clear enough to connect to the learning outcome about effective office communication. \

Demonstrate the use of effective office communication.	Provide relevant instruction to support their completion of the coursework.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025	
2	Learning to adapt to changing technologies.	Provide relevant instruction in the areas of current and changing technologies in the workforce.	Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025
3	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of workplace strategies.		Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025
4	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of technology updates.		Faculty & Students	Students will successfully complete an assignment with a passing grade.	2024-2025

The initiatives reflect student learning from specific assignments. I think a rubric should be used to measure student learning for each of the assignments/ initiatives listed. What determines a passing grade is it a 70% or better or are you looking for a higher pass rate 80-85%? Are the assignments already created or will they need to be created? what would the timeline be for creating the assignment and rubrics? Which courses will the Initiatives be measured?

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

As a newer certificate, there does not look to be a significant amount of data or evidence submitted yet. I will continue to look for more detail as faculty add evidence.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Demonstrate the use of effective office communication (SL)	Students complete the capstone assignment			
2	Learning to adapt to changing technologies (SL)				
3	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of effective workplace strategies (SL)	Students complete the capstone assignment			
4	Students will complete an assignment illustrating their knowledge of technology updates (SL)				

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of	YES

	resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
	EX. Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Entrepreneurship Technical CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The Entrepreneurship Technical Certificate provides students with the key, foundational business knowledge and skills needed to effectively manage their own small business or support the goals and success of an employer's small business. The knowledge and skills developed in this program are also highly applicable to a broad range of business positions with diverse employers in virtually every sector of the economy. Student learning in this program can also provide a strong foundation for continued studies in pursuit of an associate degree or beyond.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The Entrepreneurship Certificate Program at Vol State explores strategies necessary to start and operate a business. Entrepreneurs create new businesses that can create jobs and stimulate the economy. Entrepreneurs develop new products and offer services that can improve the lives of the community in which they operate and impact. Small business entrepreneurs are often involved in philanthropy and volunteering within their communities. Starting a new venture requires an entrepreneur to create internal jobs and develop community relationships by utilizing assets and resources. Dedicated entrepreneurs have the ability to create wealth for themselves, their employees, and stimulates the economy in which they operate. The Entrepreneurship Certificate program aligns with the Volunteer State Community College mission by building partnerships, economic development, strengthening internal and	

external community engagement in an effort to prepare students for successful careers, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

Evidence:

- ACCT AAS learning outcomes
- BUSN AAS learning outcomes
- Entre Cert Mission Statement

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Students are required to successfully complete 6 courses to meet the Entrepreneurship Certificate requirements. Each course of study prepares students to effectively open and operate a small business. Each of these courses supports the college, department, and program's mission and objectives.

ACCT 1010 - Principles of Accounting This course covers basic principles and procedures of accounting in accordance with GAAP. Determination of net and income, valuation of assets and liabilities, introduction to internal control and accounting information systems are emphasized.

BUSN 1305 - Introduction to Business This course introduces the business environment. Topics may include business ownership and organization, management, marketing, business ethics, accounting, economics, finance, and business careers.

BUSN 1330 - Entrepreneurship This course explores the strategies necessary to start and operate a business. Topics may include development of a business plan and strategies in marketing, management, finance, accounting, customer service and operations.

BUSN 2300 - Business Ethics This course is an introduction to basic ethical theories and value systems. Topics include application of these perspectives including moral issues, problems, and situations which arise within the business environment. Topics include codes of ethics, conflict of interest, social responsibility, the work ethic, and fiduciary responsibilities.

BUSN 2380 - Principles of Marketing This course is a study of basic marketing principles and practices, including the selection of target markets and the development of the marketing mix (product, price, promotion, and place of distribution).

INFS 1010 - Computer Applications Computer Applications is an examination of the development of computing technology and terminology. Topics include identification of the functional components of a computer system; using word processing, spreadsheet, and presentation graphics; the proper handling of computer media; and an exploration of the uses of electronic mail and graphical Internet.

The BUSN 1330 Entrepreneurship class has a semester project requiring students to prepare a business plan for their current or future business. Coupled with the ACCT 1010 Principles of Accounting's Comprehensive Problem, students will be prepared to request capital investments, forecast marketing and financial needs, and successfully lead and operate a business of multiple size and industries.

Evidence:

- ENT, CERT. Assessment Plan - old
- Entre Cert Assessment Plan - new
- Entre Cert recommended schedule

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			79.25%	20.75%	96.08%	3.92%	
PLO 2			88.37%	11.63%	98.04%	1.96%	
PLO 3			88.37%	11.63%	96.08%	3.92%	
PLO 4			88.37%	11.63%	97.06%	2.94%	
PLO 5			79.25%	20.75%	96.08%	3.92%	
Course Learning Outcome							
Course Learning Outcome							
Course Learning Outcome							

1. Analysis of trends

Program learning outcomes were not available for 2020. PLOs were assessed in 2021 and found that approximately 85% were met. The average of the program learning outcomes for 2022 increased by 12% to 97% met. The rubric used to evaluate student learning outcomes does not currently reflect the program or course objectives. The Entrepreneurship certificate only has one academic program assessment used to evaluate student achievement. The criteria reported in the rubric is incomplete and does not provide an accurate evaluation.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The BUSN 1330 Entrepreneurship class is currently being revised to include an updated version of the business plan course assessment. Student learning outcomes are being evaluated and modified to better reflect the course and program initiatives. Course and project updates will focus on realistic methods and opportunities for the potential small business owner.

The academic program review uncovered the need for additional assessments to ensure the certification learning outcomes have been met. The ACCT 1010 Principles of Accounting class includes a comprehensive problem as their course assessment project, and the ACCT 1010 class is a requirement for the certificate. The overlapping learning objectives support the Entrepreneurship Certificate program initiatives and will be used to assess student learning in future.

Evidence:

- ACCT1010 CLO's Standards and Outcomes Report 2-21-2024
- ACCT1010 Comprehensive Problem Rubric- Outcomes Report 01-31-2024
- BUSN1330 Entrepreneurship CLO_s AY21-23
- Entrepreneurship TC - PLO's by Gender AY21-23 Report 01-31-2024
- Entrepreneurship TC PLO's Pell and First Gen AY21-23 Report 01-31-2024
- Entrepreneurship TC Program Learning Outcomes AY21-23 Report 01-31-2024

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.

The BUSN 1330 Entrepreneurship course evaluations were positive, indicating students' desire to incorporate more technology into the certification program. Students' responses also displayed their appreciation for clear expectations regarding assignments, attendance, exams, and grade scales set in the syllabus. Although there were 48 certificate recipients in 2022 there were only 14 formally enrolled in the program. Historically, students earn the certificate while pursuing their business degree.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

The overall number of students could be increased with additional marketing to students focusing on other business certifications or degrees and students concentrating on other majors. Entrepreneurs open and operate their own business in a variety of trades. Whether you become a welder, hairdresser, electrician, or fitness trainer, the skills and knowledge learned when pursuing the Entrepreneurship certification are vital to the success of any business.

Evidence:

- Business Student Course Evaluations AY20-23-1 (1)
- Entrepreneurship -Fact Sheet

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Students will complete a business plan to understand the commitment required to own and operate a business. The rubric and assignment will be revised and updated. PLO 1 (SL)	Demonstrate the understanding of student initiative, self-direction, productivity, and accountability skills necessary to maintain their own business or effectively support the small business of an employer.	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	
2	Students will complete an accounting problem to demonstrate knowledge of financial reports. The accounting assessment will be added to the certificate. PLO 2 (SL)	Prepare annual financial reports for the business to communicate reliable economic information about the company to various stakeholders	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – include the comprehensive accounting problem as a measure	
3	Revise the Entrepreneurship Course PLO 3	Successful completion of the Entrepreneurship course objectives and certificate	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	
4	Informing business and other student majors of the certificate availability	Improve enrollment numbers by informing students of the Entrepreneurship certificate during advising, enrollment, and special activities.	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Recruiting, advising, and student activities	

Evidence:

- Entre Cert initiatives

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Academic Program Review

1. Mission Statement Alignment
 1. Building partnerships, economic development, strengthening community engagement, etc.
2. Curriculum and Student Learning
 1. 6 required courses, each aligns to college and dept. mission and objectives while preparing students to open and operate a small business.
 2. Evidence: Only one assessment is conducted to measure student achievement and SLOs are being evaluated on rubric that does not reflect current objectives.
 1. Significant increase in PLO values from 2021-2022.
 2. Already revising BUSN 1330 to reflect course assessment, SLOs being evaluated and modified. Determined need for additional assessments.
3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information
 1. Strengths: positive course evals, clear expectations. Opportunities: more technology in program, formal enrollment of students in program before certificate earned.
 2. Additional marketing to get students enrolled.
4. Improvement Initiatives.
 1. Specific PLOs listed, each with objective of completing Ent. Certificate
 2. No budget needs listed.

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

The review mentions the need for additional assessments to be implemented. Have faculty identified which courses this might happen in, or can they provide any further information regarding this idea? How does enrollment in the program contribute to student success? Yes, these skills are vital to success of business, but is this the “student success” that this question asks (typically, retention, graduation rates, etc)?

The initiatives listed all seem to be a repeat of specific PLOs for the courses. Are there specific ideas for how to achieve those goals? For instance, initiative 4 states that “Students will complete a business plan” and the parties responsible for this initiative are business/technology faculty. How will students complete the plan? Was there an issue with students not completing the plan previously, so this

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

Assessment of the entrepreneurship certificate looks to be well underway and the faculty are focused on continuous improvement.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	YEAR 2 PROGRESS
Students will complete a business plan to understand the commitment required to own and operate a business. The rubric and assignment will be revised and updated	Demonstrate the understanding of student initiative, self-direction, productivity, and accountability skills necessary to maintain their own business or effectively support the small business of an employer.	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	REVISED ENTREPRENEURSHIP COURSE WAS DEVELOPED AND IS BEING OFFERED SPRING OF 2025. PLO ACHIEVEMENTS WILL BE AVAILABLE FOR YEAR 3 PROGRESS
Students will complete an accounting problem to demonstrate knowledge of financial reports. The accounting assessment will be added to the certificate.	Prepare annual financial reports for the business to communicate reliable economic information about the company to various stakeholders	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Learning - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – include the comprehensive accounting problem as a requirement to earn the certificate	RUBRIC RESULTS BY ELEMENT ATTACHED. IMPROVEMENT FROM 2023-24 TO FALL 2024 WAS SEEN FOR 5 OF 7 ELEMENTS MEASURED
Revise the Entrepreneurship Course	Successful completion of the Entrepreneurship course objectives and certificate	Business and Technology Faculty	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Spring 2025 – Revised Entrepreneurship course offered	REVISED ENTREPRENEURSHIP COURSE WAS DEVELOPED AND IS BEING OFFERED SPRING OF 2025. PLO ACHIEVEMENTS WILL BE AVAILABLE FOR YEAR 3 PROGRESS
Informing business and other student majors of the certificate availability	Improve enrollment numbers	Business and Technology Advisors	Student Success - Increase PLO achievement	Increase number of student certificates of completion	FALL GRADUATION NUMBERS INCREASED FROM 2023 AND 2024 BUT SPRING DATA IS UNAVAILABLE AT

					THIS TIME. SEE DATA TABLE BELOW
--	--	--	--	--	--

	21-22	22-23	23-24	24-25
Entrepreneurship TC (Standalone)	14 Students	9 Students	12 Students	16 Students
Business AAS (Management) that also got the Entrepreneurship TC and the Entrepreneurship TC Standalone students Combined	22 Students	58 Students	62 Students	16 Students (missing Spring Graduates)

Evidence:

- ACCT 1010 Rubric Report 2021-2024

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student	Will there be any further action taken on this	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?

		learning or student success?	initiative? If yes, explain.	
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Diagnostic Medical Sonography CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The Diagnostic Medical Sonography program's mission is to prepare competent entry-level general sonographers in the cognitive (knowledge), psychomotor (skills), and affective (behavior) learning domains. This includes equipping students to: 1. Demonstrate knowledge in appropriate didactic areas. 2. Integrate knowledge into competency-based clinical experience. 3. Apply skills to meet the standards of the profession. 4. Analyze clinical data. 5. Write effectively in more than one format as part of the writing across the professional curriculum initiative. 6. Provide excellent quality care to enrich and support the community through active engagement. 7. Engage and maintain personal professional relationships. This program provides students with the opportunity to develop the technical knowledge and personal skills necessary for a career in the sonographic sciences. The curriculum is designed to combine compassion with integrity in order to shape a student into a skilled professional.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	

The missions of the program aligns with the mission of the institution in several key ways. First, both statements have a focus on the importance of delivering high quality educational experiences. The VSCC DMS program directly contributes to this by preparing competent entry-level sonographers with a focus on cognitive, psychomotor, and effective learning domains, mirroring VSCC's commitment to quality and innovation. Second, VSCC's emphasis on building partnerships and community engagement is reflected in the programs objective to enrich and support the community through excellent quality care and active engagement. The program also contributes to the institution's focus on diversity and cultural awareness by preparing students to provide care in a diverse community setting. This promotes cultural sensitivity and understanding through professional practice. Next, the institution strives to prepare students for successful careers and meaningful civic participation while the DMS Program emphasizes integrating knowledge into competency-based clinical experiences and analyzing data that ensures the students are well prepared for professional roles in the medical community.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

As a program that has a didactic section as well as a scanning element, it is imperative that the students are taught the significance in implementing their didactic course material into the clinical component. The rationale behind what the program views as of the most important aspects of the rubrics used as evidence are highlighted below:

Template and Formatting

Consistency in following a paper template and formatting is essential for maintaining professionalism and ease of reading. Exceptional and Accomplished categories indicate a high ability to adhere to these standards, reflecting the student's attention to detail and organizational skills. Lower scores in this category indicate the need for improvement in these areas, which are crucial for academic and professional success.

Accuracy

Summarizing paper sections accurately is crucial for showing comprehension and effectively communicating complex information briefly. High scores in this area reflect a student's comprehension and effective communication skills. Lower scores indicate misunderstandings of the material.

Grammar

The presence of grammatical and punctuation errors can diminish the clarity of written work. Achieving high scores for minimal errors reflects the student's proficiency in writing and editing, important skills in any professional field.

References

Proper citation of references is a cornerstone of academic integrity. High scores in this area demonstrate a student's commitment to acknowledging the work of others and providing a solid foundation for their arguments or findings.

Length and Timeliness

Adhering to deadlines is part of managing project requirements effectively. Appropriateness of length ensures depth without redundancy, and timeliness reflects the student's ability to plan and execute tasks efficiently.

Program Outcomes Alignment

The alignment of student performance with program outcomes (Met/Not Met) is a critical measure of the effectiveness of the educational program, and the student's readiness for professional practice. High performance across the rubric elements suggests that the student is well-prepared to meet the demands of their professional field.

Evidence:

- SONO, CERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%			
PLO 2			100%	0%			
PLO 3			100%	0%			
PLO 4			100%	0%			
PLO 5			100%	0%			
PLO 6			100%	0%			
PLO 7			100%	0%			
Course Learning Outcome TAB.2			100%	0%			
Course Learning Outcome TAB.3			100%	0%			
Course Learning Outcome TAB.4			100%	0%			

Course Learning Outcomes SONO2036C Clinical Education 4 TAB.2 Evaluations TAB.3 Clinical Education TAB.4 Competencies

1. Analysis of trends

Data is missing from the 2020 year due to changes in education influenced by the pandemic. Data is also missing from the year 2022 due to the previous program director leaving their position. The data for 2020 and 2022 outcomes is not explicitly provided, making it impossible to analyze trends over the three years directly from the given dataset. However, the data compiled from 2021 indicated exceptional performance across all outcomes measured for that year. Which suggests the program met its educational goals and objectives.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Given the success, the program should focus on how to enhance the curriculum with additional hands-on learning opportunities, real-world case studies, or incorporate technology to further develop the students' skills. While the 100% "Met" rate is indicative of outstanding performance, consistent evaluations are important to sustaining this success. By focusing on areas such as curriculum development, faculty support, student engagement, and evaluation assessments, the program can not only maintain its high standards but also adapt to meet the standards and practices of the continuously evolving imaging community.

Evidence:

- Diagnostic Medical SONO TC PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-22
- Diagnostic Medical Sonography PLOs AY21-23
- Diagnostic Medical Sonography PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-22
- Diagnostic Medical Sonography TC PLOs Gender AY21-22
- SONO 2036C SLOs AY21-22

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

According to the data provided using surveys and fact sheets, the VSCC DMS Program's area of strengths are as follows:

1. **High Levels of Instructor Preparation and Content Availability:** Across all semesters, students consistently rated the instructor's preparation and content availability highly, with means close to 5. This suggests that instructors are well-prepared and make learning materials accessible, a critical factor in student success.
2. **Adherence to Course Policies:** Students felt that instructors followed the course syllabus policies strictly, especially noted in the Fall 2022 evaluations with a mean score of 4.96. This demonstrates a clear communication of expectations and consistency in course management.
3. **Timely Feedback:** The provision of graded assignments and feedback in a timely manner was also a strong point, particularly in the Spring 2023 semester with a mean score of 4.83. Timely feedback is essential for student learning and adjustment throughout the course.
4. **Instructor Accessibility:** Students rated instructor accessibility highly across semesters, indicating that instructors were available through various communication channels as promised in the syllabus.
5. **Encouragement of Engagement and Discussion:** The data shows that instructors were successful in creating an environment conducive to questions and discussions, facilitating a more interactive and engaging learning experience

Overall, The program shows a strong performance in instructor preparedness, adherence to policies, timely feedback, accessibility, and fostering an engaging learning environment.

Based on the same data, areas of opportunity for the program are the following:

1. **Feedback and Progress Monitoring in Spring 2022:** The Spring 2022 semester saw a dip in the score for feedback and progress monitoring (mean of 4.47), indicating that some students felt less satisfied with the timeliness or quality of feedback during this period. Improving on this aspect could enhance learning outcomes and student satisfaction.
2. **Consistency in Engagement and Discussion:** While still rated highly, the instructor's ability to engage students in discussion had slightly lower scores in some semesters. Enhancing strategies to encourage all students to participate in discussions could improve learning experiences.
3. **Application of Concepts through Assignments:** During certain semesters, students noted a minor decline in how assignments related to and applied the concepts taught in the course. By making sure assignments closely align with and support the course content and skills, the effectiveness of learning can be improved.
4. **Focusing on Feedback:** Focusing on consistent, quality feedback and enhancing student engagement and the practical application of concepts in assignments can further improve the program.

Evidence:

- Diagnostic Medical Sonography- Fact Sheet FA23
- SONO Student Course Evals AY20-23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline**	Baseline Data
1	Change format and class style of the Intro to Sonography Course PLO 2 (SL)	To better prepare the students for their clinical setting, the program hopes to make the Intro to Sonography Course a hybrid course that will have online elements as well as in person demonstrations. The class is currently completely in person.	Program Faculty, specifically the program director and the clinical coordinator.	Completion of Intro material (quizzes and tests) by week 6 of the fall semester. This would allow more time for important demonstrations that are needed to be completed before the beginning of the clinical rotations.	Fall 2025	Feedback from students and clinical sites for the last two years stating that the demonstrations that occur in the Intro to Sonography course would be useful before rotations begin.
2	Providing an Edelman's Conference for board review PLO 7 (SL)	Provide student's with an additional board review resource paid for by the program, to further prepare them to pass the abdomen board that they are expected to take before graduation.	Program Faculty, specifically the program director or the clinical coordinator.	Historically, one person per cohort fails the abdominal board exam on the first attempt. This objective could improve the first time pass rate to 100%.	Fall 2024	For at least the last 7 years, one person per cohort has failed the abdomen board on their first attempt. This data can be found in the ARDMS School Reports.
3	Editing lab protocols PLO 3 (SL)	To more accurately reflect what is expected from a new graduate sonographer in the clinical setting performing an exam.	Lab instructors	The ability for 75% of students to accurately and diagnostically complete lab protocols defined by the images listed as well as finishing in the required time limit.	Spring 2024	Clinical and employer evaluations stating that new graduate sonographers from this program, are performing at a slower than acceptable rate.
4	Implementing a skill out PLO 3 (SL)	To assess the students on all abdominal and obstetrics/	Program director and clinical coordinator	The ability for 75% of students to complete multiple abdominal and obstetric/gynecological	Fall 2024	Evaluations from employers of program

		gynecological exams that have been taught through the duration of the 16 month program.		diagnostic ultrasound exams at the level of a registered sonographer by graduation.		graduates have indicated a desire for the program to implement a skill out before graduation, so that the program can evaluate one last time if the students are ready to work in the medical imaging field.
--	--	---	--	---	--	--

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The ultrasound machines in the DMS program lab need an update. Two of the six machines currently on rotation in the laboratory are dated, perform slowly, and produce poor image quality. For our students to be successful in the clinical setting while in the program, as well as being successful sonographers after graduation - the program needs new machines to stay up to date with imaging departments in the community.

Along with machines, the program would benefit greatly from at least one more 3D ultrasound probe. This probe can be used for more than its' obvious obstetrical benefits but would assist us in teaching our students a skill that is usually only learned on the job, making them more marketable after graduation.

Item	Cost	Units
GE Logiq e10	\$81,000	1
GE RAB2-5-D 3D/4D Probe	\$4,500	1
Total Monies	\$85,500	

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

Program mission aligns well with the College mission. The focus is on high-quality education and service to the healthcare community.

Section 2

2B. Lack of data and sufficient explanation

#2 Adding verbiage delineating the specific evaluation tools used (employer, graduate, course surveys) would assist in reviewing accurate assessments.

Section 3

Using employer and graduate survey results would strengthen the evidence of student success overall. These surveys would demonstrate the strength of program outcomes using feedback that encompasses both clinical

and didactic skills/knowledge.

Section 4

4A

Initiative #3 “Editing Lab protocols” - Is there a baseline for 75% goal to be compared to? Adjust the information in the “Performance Indicators” and “Baseline” columns. Performance Indicator column could say something similar to, “Clinical and employer evaluations will be used to assess whether students can accurately, and diagnostically complete lab protocols as defined by the images listed, while meeting a set time limit”. The “Baseline” column can say something similar to, “Clinical and employer surveys report 20%(?) of new graduate sonographers from the program are performing at a slower than acceptable rate”.

Initiative #4 Performance Initiatives: What tool will be used to determine if a student “completes an exam at the level of a registered sonographer? Is there a scoring rubric for this?

4B

Can course fees be used for new equipment? Can the new machines requested be tied back into 4A initiative #3. Does the cost table need to be updated to reflect the cost of the 2 machines? Can the need for 1 more 3D ultrasound probe be tied into a listed initiative?

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Diagnostic Medical Sonography program supports the mission of the institution by producing providing a high-quality innovative program that prepares students for successful careers. The program is competitive with more applicants than seats available. Graduates have a 100% job placement rate and easily pass the national board examinations. It has an engaged and supportive Advisory Committee. The program faculty, Lisa Kirkland, Program Director, and

Sami Brooks have nurtured and developed relationships with stakeholders in a variety of our service areas. The information in this document does not completely reflect a thorough review. I noted the following,

- The assessment plan narrative does not identify the PLO being assessed. I do see the details in the attached SONO, Cert Assessment Tool.
- The outcomes in section 2B were excellent according to the data provided for 2021. To add to the comment from the IA Committee, in the narrative, provide more details about what specifically is being assessed and connect it to the educational goals and objectives.
- The feedback shared in Section 3 appears to come from course evaluations. If that is the case, the assessed areas were rated highly by the students since a 5.0 represents "strongly agree". In the future, identify the types of surveys used to make the comments more meaningful to the reader. The faculty is expending effort towards focusing on the lower-rated areas although they were still well above satisfactory to improve student success. I support assessing and also including Graduate and Employer Survey results in this section as recommended by the IA committee.
- The faculty and dean will work together to find funding sources for updated ultrasound machines and probes. The SONO program's budget and the Health Science course fees do not support the purchase of expensive items such as an \$81k ultrasound machine. Potential sources of funding include TAF, grants, and the institution's R & R fund.

In summary, although I do not get a solid sense of the program through the APR, I believe with additional training in the particulars of filling out the document, a review of SMART goals, up-to-date data, and adequate time to complete the report, future reports will be more informative. The information that was provided did reflect excellence in those areas.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Change format and class style of the Intro to Sonography Course PLO 2	Contact made to upper division for guidance on course development.	Changes in Program Director/leadership. Unaware of Catalog timeline.	no changes	Currently no progress. The baseline data remains the same until the course can be changed and new feedback can be obtained.
2	Providing an Edelman's Conference for board review PLO 7	New contract made with URR (ultrasound registry review) for purchase in multiple modalities	No challenges	Summer 2025	For at least the last 7 years, one person per cohort has failed the abdomen board on their first attempt. This data can be found in the ARDMS School Reports. Cohort of 2024 had 100% pass rate with using URR material in mock board questions
3	Editing lab protocols PLO 3	Lab protocols have been updated for all abdomen and OB courses	No challenges for abdomen or OB.	Spring 2024	Clinical sites have had positive reviews on site visit made by the Clinical Coordinator that have stated increased scanning time and proficiency in at least 75% of the cohort.
4	Implementing a skill out PLO 3	An outline has been created for a dual grade in mock job interviews as well as a "scan interview"	Program Director and clinical coordinator	Fall 2025	progress indicator will remain the same and will be reviewed once again with the employer surveys that are due within 6mo-

				12mo post hire date of the graduating cohort.
--	--	--	--	---

Close

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Emergency Medical Technician CERT: Basic, Advanced, Accelerated Advanced

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

BASIC

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution? "At Volunteer State Community College, the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program is dedicated to upholding the institution's commitment to quality, innovation, and comprehensive education. Rooted in Vol State's ethos of building partnerships and fostering community engagement, the EMS Program strives to provide exemplary training and support to aspiring emergency medical professionals. Our mission is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and values essential for successful careers in emergency medical services. Through cutting-edge educational programs, the EMS Program aims to cultivate a cadre of dedicated and compassionate healthcare providers who embody the core principles of professionalism, integrity, and excellence. Moreover, we instill a sense of civic responsibility, inspiring our graduates to actively engage in meaningful community participation and contribute to the betterment of society. Volunteer States Community Colleges EMS Program Mission Statement aligns with the colleges because both emphasize providing quality education, fostering community engagement, promoting core values, and encouraging meaningful civic participation among students.	

ADVANCED

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness,

and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

"At Volunteer State Community College, the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program is dedicated to upholding the institution's commitment to quality, innovation, and comprehensive education. Rooted in Vol State's ethos of building partnerships and fostering community engagement, the EMS Program strives to provide exemplary training and support to aspiring emergency medical professionals.

Our mission is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and values essential for successful careers in emergency medical services. Through cutting-edge educational programs, the EMS Program aims to cultivate a cadre of dedicated and compassionate healthcare providers who embody the core principles of professionalism, integrity, and excellence. Moreover, we instill a sense of civic responsibility, inspiring our graduates to actively engage in meaningful community participation and contribute to the betterment of society.

Volunteer States Community Colleges EMS Program Mission Statement aligns with the colleges because both emphasize providing quality education, fostering community engagement, promoting core values, and encouraging meaningful civic participation among students.

ACCELERATED

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

"At Volunteer State Community College, the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program is dedicated to upholding the institution's commitment to quality, innovation, and comprehensive education. Rooted in Vol State's ethos of building partnerships and fostering community engagement, the EMS Program strives to provide exemplary training and support to aspiring emergency medical professionals.

Our mission is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and values essential for successful careers in emergency medical services. Through cutting-edge educational programs, the EMS Program aims to cultivate a cadre of dedicated and compassionate healthcare providers who embody the core principles of professionalism, integrity, and excellence. Moreover, we instill a sense of civic responsibility, inspiring our graduates to actively engage in meaningful community participation and contribute to the betterment of society.

Volunteer States Community Colleges EMS Program Mission Statement aligns with the colleges because both emphasize providing quality education, fostering community engagement, promoting core values, and encouraging meaningful civic participation among students.

Evidence:

- Vol State EMS Mission Statement

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Program Learning Outcomes and **Course Learning Outcomes** focus on students' ability to perform patient assessments, document medical histories, initiate basic interventions, demonstrate professional behavior, and understand operational roles in emergency care. **Assessment Methods** involve practical examinations and evaluations to measure students' competencies in these areas.

Achievement Targets are set to ensure that students meet or exceed the expected standards in their practical and theoretical knowledge.

Assessment Schedule outlines when these evaluations take place, ensuring a structured approach to student assessment throughout the academic year.

Assessment Rubric details the criteria for grading student performance, from exceeding expectations to not meeting the basic requirements.

The assessment plan's structure and content suggest a comprehensive approach to evaluating student outcomes, emphasizing both practical skills and professional behavior. This supports the program's goal of preparing students for the realities of emergency medical services as a profession by focusing on critical competencies and professional standards. The detailed rubric and assessment methods ensure that students are evaluated fairly and comprehensively, providing a clear pathway for achieving and demonstrating proficiency in key areas of EMS practice.

Evidence:

- AEMT, CERT Assessment Tool
- EMSB, CERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

BASIC

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			85.42%	14.58%	83.33%	16.67%	
PLO 2			85.42%	14.58%	83.33%	16.67%	
PLO 3			87.50%	12.50%	86.67%	13.33%	
PLO 4			89.58%	10.42%	83.33%	16.67%	
PLO 5			89.58%	10.42%	86.67%	13.33%	
PLO 6							
PLO 7							
Course Learning Outcome PG.1			85.41%	14.58%	86.66%	13.33%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.2			87.50%	12.50%	76.66%	13.33%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.5			85.41%	14.58%	83.33%	16.67%	

Course Learning Outcomes/Goals: PG.5 Trauma PG.2 Cardiac Management PG.1 Medical Diabetic

1. Analysis of trends

Over the length of the data, there's a slight fluctuation in the percentage of students meeting Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes. Most PLOs show a small decrease in the percentage of students meeting the outcomes from 2020 to 2021, indicating a need to address specific areas for improvement. However, the consistency in meeting outcomes for CLOs related to Medical Diabetic, Cardiac Management, and Trauma suggests a stable understanding in these critical areas.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

To improve student learning, targeted interventions in areas showing declines or lower performance can be beneficial. This could include:

Enhanced hands-on training or simulation exercises, particularly in areas where students are not meeting outcomes.

Additional tutoring sessions or workshops focused on weaker areas as indicated by the data. Implementing peer mentoring programs where students who excel in certain areas can assist those who are struggling, fostering a collaborative learning environment.

ADVANCED

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			85.71%	4.29%	100%	0%	
PLO 2			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 4			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
PLO 6			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.3			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcome PG.5			97.14%	2.86%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome PG.10			94.29%	5.71%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcome Peer Goals: PG.3 Medical Medication Administration PG.5 Medical Pediatric PG.10 Trauma Assessment

1. Analysis of trends

The data for the Advanced program shows a remarkable improvement in student performance across all Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes from 2020 to 2021, with many reaching 100% achievement in 2021. This indicates a significant enhancement in the program's effectiveness and student learning, particularly in areas of Medical Medication Administration, Medical Pediatric, and Trauma Assessment.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Despite the excellent outcomes, continuous improvement is always a priority. Strategies to maintain and even improve these results could include:

Continuing education and professional development opportunities for instructors to stay updated with the latest EMS practices and teaching methodologies.

Implementing a feedback loop where students can provide insights on teaching methods and curriculum, ensuring that the program remains responsive to student needs and industry standards.

Considering the establishment of a mentorship program where high achieving EMS students can provide guidance, support, and tutoring for their classmates.

ACCELERATED will not report until Cycle 3

Evidence:

- EMSA _ AEMT Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23
- EMSB Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23
- EMT ACC PLOs AY21-23
- EMTA PLOs AY21-23
- EMTB PLO_s AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Analysis of enrollment data

Analysis for Basic EMT

Strengths:

- **High placement rate:** Compared to the number of graduates, the program seems to have a good placement rate for graduates (ranging from 76% to 99%).
- **Full-time enrollment:** In Fall 2022, all students were enrolled full-time, potentially indicating strong commitment and program structure.

- **Diverse student body:** The program represents a somewhat diverse range of students from multiple populations.

Areas of opportunity:

- **Declining enrollment:** Headcount has steadily decreased since Fall 2019, suggesting potential recruitment challenges.
- **Limited retention data:** Persistence data is missing, making it difficult to assess student retention within the program.
- **Declining diversity:** While there is some diversity, the number of students from multiple populations has been decreasing.

Ideas for improvement (based on limited data):

- **Investigate reasons for declining enrollment:** Conduct exit interviews with past students or focus groups with potential students to understand why enrollment is decreasing.
- **Implement targeted recruitment strategies:** Based on findings from the investigation, develop targeted campaigns to attract students from specific demographics or backgrounds.
- **Collect and analyze retention data:** Track student progress throughout the program to identify areas where students struggle and implement support systems.
- **Develop initiatives for multiple populations:** Partner with community organizations or offer targeted scholarships to attract students from underrepresented groups.
- **Review curriculum and support services:** Ensure the program remains relevant and addresses current industry needs. Offer additional support services, such as tutoring or academic coaching, to help students succeed.

For Advanced EMT

Strengths:

- **High placement rate:** The program boasts a consistently high placement rate for graduates, ranging from 93% to 102%. This indicates strong industry demand and successful job preparation.
- **Full-time enrollment:** Over the past two years, all students enrolled in the program were full-time, suggesting strong commitment and focus.
- **Diversity in age groups:** The student body represents a range of age groups, potentially increasing program appeal to various demographics.

Areas of opportunity:

- **Declining enrollment:** Headcount has steadily decreased since Fall 2019, potentially indicating recruitment challenges.
- **Limited retention data:** Persistence data is missing, making it difficult to assess student retention within the program.

Suggestions for improvement (based on limited data):

- **Investigate reasons for declining enrollment:** Conduct outreach or surveys to understand why enrollment is decreasing. Identify specific barriers potential students might face.
- **Implement targeted recruitment strategies:** Based on your findings, develop campaigns to attract students from various demographics or backgrounds. Utilize targeted marketing channels and partnerships.
- **Collect and analyze retention data:** Track student progress throughout the program to identify areas where students struggle and implement support systems (e.g., tutoring, academic coaching).
- **Promote initiatives for multiple populations:** Partner with community organizations or offer targeted scholarships to attract students.
- **Review curriculum and support services:** Ensure the program remains relevant and addresses current industry needs. Offer updated educational resources and consider incorporating technology-based learning strategies.

Both the Basic and Advanced outcomes reveal a concerning trend of decreasing enrollment. This phenomenon aligns with the implementation of service-based programs within our state. As I previously communicated to the college administration and TBR, I anticipated this potential outcome. Unfortunately, due to the legislative timeline, opportunities to directly influence the program's structure have already passed. Moving forward, we must adapt to the current environment while strategically planning for future modifications. As legislative

opportunities arise, we can advocate for changes that align with our institution's goals and support student success.

Evidence:

- EMT Student Course Evals AY20-23
- EMT TC Fact Sheet-2 FA23
- EMTA Fact Sheet -1 FA23
- EMTA Fact Sheet -2 FA23
- EMTB Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1					
Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	Baseline Data
Student Learning:					
Develop and implement a simulation activity focused on Trauma Assessment. PLO 1 (SL)	Enhance student proficiency in applying trauma assessment skills in a realistic scenario.	Program Director, Faculty	Increase Trauma Assessment average score to 70%. Increase student confidence in performing trauma assessments as measured by a self-assessment survey.	AY 2024-2025	Current Trauma Assessment average score: 62.29%.
Integrate peer review and feedback into Medical Assessment practice sessions (SL).	Improve students' peer-to-peer learning and critical thinking skills related to medical assessment.	Program Director, Faculty	Increase Medical Assessment average score to 70%. Increase student participation in peer review activities.	AY 2024-2025	Current Medical Assessment average score: 62.17%.
Student Success:					
Implement a student mentoring program connecting experienced EMT students with new students.	Facilitate peer support, improve academic navigation, and foster a sense of community.	Program Director and Student Mentors	Students express a satisfaction rate with program support services of 75%.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data on student satisfaction needed.
Offer workshops on time management and study skills specifically	Equip students with strategies to manage their workload and effectively	Program Director, Academic Success Center	Improve student performance on national registry exams by 5%.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data exam performance needed.

tailored to EMT students.	prepare for exams.				
---------------------------	--------------------	--	--	--	--

Evidence:

- Initiative Matrix APR 2024

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

No additional expenses are required.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

The EMS program mission aligns well with the college mission. It focuses on community engagement, partnerships, and high-quality education.

Section 2a

EMT Report:

- The assessment plan is not clearly articulated in this section of the report. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. We are assuming that information is present in the attachments that we do not have access to in this part of the review process. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Paramedic Report:

- The narrative does not delineate the separate aspects of the assessment plan as clearly as EMT report does. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Section 2b

- Both reports:
 1. No 2020 data provided. An explanation for the missing data is needed.
 2. Need explanation why the 3-year outcome result not indicated/reported.
 3. The CLOs listed under the table do not comprehensively relate to or explain the data in the PLO table. More information is needed for the reviewers to understand this information.
- Paramedic Report
 1. PLO 9, 12 are missing data (0% met/not met).
 2. The *Lab Practice Skills SLOs* comment related to the table comments is presumptuous. Identifying high performance in some areas should not lead to an assumption that there is automatically high performance in areas not assessed.

Sections 3-4

Excellent job outlining and describing the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.

Are there correlations between certain questions in the Course Evaluations or Employer Surveys that relate to and support the PLOs? We suggest triangulating data/results where possible.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The EMTB and AEMT programs support the mission of the institution by providing a high-quality, innovative program. They are led by Erik Jesse, Program Director, and he has a team of dedicated full-time and adjunct instructors. The programs are taught at the Cookeville, Springfield, and Gallatin locations. There is a supportive and engaged Advisory Committee. Graduates obtain gainful employment with EMS providers throughout the communities. They demonstrate effective learning by passing the National Registry examination higher than the national average. In reviewing the APR, I noted the following.

- The assessment plan does not identify the PLOs and SLOs being assessed in the narrative sections. I understand that the 2020 data was absent due to the ramifications of the pandemic and the changeover in the research personnel. To add to the comment from the IA Committee, in the narrative, provide more details about what specifically is being assessed and connect it to the educational goals and objectives. With the EMSA Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23 data, I note a significant decrease in the percentage of students who exceed each lab category. The EMSB Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23 contained data that waxed and waned in some areas in 2022- 2023 with 4 out of 7 outcomes exceeding 2021 - 2022. Were all outcomes assessed from students at one campus? Were their changes to the curriculum, teaching style, instructor, etc. that influenced student learning?
- In assessing the EMTB PLO's AY21-23 Report, there was not much variation between AY21-22 and AY22-23 in the data. Although, EMSB.TC.4, related to professional behavior, had a slight decrease and may be worth reviewing. The AY22-23 PLOs for the EMT ACC program are excellent at 100% in each category.
- One of the "Ideas for Improvement" in Section 3 is related to declining enrollment. Feedback from students could help identify barriers to enrollment and completion. EMTB student course evaluation submission has trended downward from 44% in 2021 to 19% in the Spring of 23. Faculty should make more concerted efforts to encourage students to complete course evaluations. Current students and stakeholders such as employers and graduates can provide valuable information about the program that may affect planned initiatives. An additional opportunity for growth is assessing the results of Graduate and Employer surveys.

In summary, I recommend a detailed analysis of the laboratory competency assessments, particularly for the AEMT course. Review the EMTB course as well as it did have several areas of improvement. Identifying differences between the way the courses are taught could be key. The review should include the faculty who teach the course as well as the director. Since the program is offered at three sites, is there a difference in competency level between Cookeville, Springfield, and Gallatin students or is the data from one location? The program has a sufficient budget to order equipment and supplies that can enhance student learning. I believe that additional training in completing the assessment section of the report and having adequate time to complete the APR, will be of benefit in future reports.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	Baseline Data	Response
Develop and implement a simulation activity focused on Trauma Assessment. PLO 1	Enhance student proficiency in applying trauma assessment skills in a realistic scenario.	Program Director, Faculty	(1) Increase Trauma Assessment average score to 70%. (2) Increase student confidence in performing trauma assessments as measured by a self-assessment survey.	AY 2024-2025	Current Trauma Assessment average score: 62.29%.	Data from the National Registry is no longer available. The Registry ceased tracking trauma assessment data in May of the previous year, concurrent with the implementation of the new examination. Consequently, comprehensive historical data is inaccessible, including detailed student performance metrics. Regarding the self-assessment survey, it is administered internally as part of the affective domain questionnaire. However, due to the absence of comparative historical data, analysis will be limited to internal trends.
Integrate peer review and feedback into Medical Assessment	Improve students' peer-to-peer learning and critical	Program Director, Faculty	(1) Increase Medical Assessment average score to 70%. (2)	AY 2024-2025	Current Medical Assessment average score: 62.17%.	Data from the National Registry is no longer available. Student

practice sessions. PLO 4	thinking skills related to medical assessment.		Increase student participation in peer review activities.			participation in peer review activities will be tracked using the lab software, which records peer interactions.
Implement a student mentoring program connecting experienced EMT students with new students.	Facilitate peer support, improve academic navigation, and foster a sense of community.	Program Director, Student Mentors	(1) Increase student satisfaction with program support services. (2) Reduce first-year student withdrawal rate.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data on student satisfaction and withdrawal rate is not available due to the program's recent initiation.	The peer-to-peer mentoring program was initiated in August 2024, with 16 students participating. Due to limitations in the available data, specifically the factbook not reporting data past 2021, a comprehensive comparison of first-year student withdrawal rates is not currently feasible. Student feedback has been solicited through a feedback form distributed to the initial participant group. Further data collection and analysis will continue to assess the program's impact.

Offer workshops on time management and study skills specifically tailored to EMT students.	Equip students with strategies to manage their workload and effectively prepare for exams.	Program Director, Academic Success Center	(1) Increase student self-reported time management skills. (2) Improve student performance on standardized exams.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline exam performance is currently at 70% on the National Registry exams. Performance needed.	Workshops have been offered in-house to all EMT students in an in-person format; however, there has been no participation to date. These workshops will continue to be offered throughout the reporting period. The impact of these workshops will be assessed by comparing the first-time pass rate on the National Registry exams to the overall class average. The appropriateness of adding time management training to orientation has been assessed and is deemed not suitable.
--	--	---	---	--------------	---	---

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress

	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

Evidence:

- Initiative for EMT AEMT

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Paramedic CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution? At Volunteer State Community College, the Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Program is dedicated to upholding the institution's commitment to quality, innovation, and comprehensive education. Rooted in Vol State's ethos of building partnerships and fostering community engagement, the EMS Program strives to provide exemplary training and support to aspiring emergency medical professionals. Our mission is to equip students with the knowledge, skills, and values essential for successful careers in emergency medical services. Through cutting-edge educational programs, the EMS Program aims to cultivate a cadre of dedicated and compassionate healthcare providers who embody the core principles of professionalism, integrity, and excellence. Moreover, we instill a sense of civic responsibility, inspiring our graduates to actively engage in meaningful community participation and contribute to the betterment of society. Volunteer States Community Colleges EMS Program Mission Statement aligns with the College's because both emphasize providing quality education, fostering community engagement, promoting core values, and encouraging meaningful civic participation among students.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The sequencing of courses, gathered from the assessment detail, appears to be strategically designed to build upon foundational skills before advancing to more complex scenarios and technical competencies. This progression ensures that students develop a solid base of knowledge and skills, enhancing their confidence and competence in performing more intricate and challenging tasks as they progress through the program. The mapping of specific technical competencies (e.g., history taking, CPR for different age groups, EKG interpretation, medication administration) to assessment outcomes indicates a curriculum that is both comprehensive and aligned with real-world EMS demands.

Overall, the assessment plan demonstrates a thoughtful and systematic approach to evaluating student learning and competency in EMS practices. By closely aligning the assessment methods, schedules, and rubrics with the program's learning outcomes, it ensures that students are well-prepared for their future roles in emergency medical services, equipped with the necessary skills and knowledge to excel in their professional lives.

Evidence:

- PARA, CERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1	N/A		100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 4			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 6			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 7			98.75%	1.25%	100%	0%	
PLO 8			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 9			0%	0%	0%	0%	
PLO 10			100%	0%	97.5%	2.5%	
PLO 11			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 12			0%	0%	0%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome LP.2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome LP.4			100%	0%	97.5%	2.5%	
Course Learning Outcome LP.5			100%	0%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcomes Lab Practice SLO's LP.2 History Taking LP.3 Medical and Cardiac Assessment Scenario LP.5 Radio Transmission Scenario

1. Analysis of trends

Overall Performance Trends

- **Consistently High Performance:** The majority of PLOs and CLOs show a 100% success rate across the three years, indicating that all students met the outcomes. This suggests a high level of effectiveness in teaching and learning, with students consistently achieving the expected competencies.
- **Uniform Achievement:** The uniformity in achievement (100% met) across most outcomes highlights a program that is delivering consistent, high-quality education and effectively meeting its educational objectives.

Lab Practice Skills Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- The summary mentions specific SLOs related to history taking, medical and cardiac assessment scenarios, and radio transmission scenarios but does not provide specific data. Assuming these align with the high performance of other outcomes, it would suggest strong practical skills development among students in these areas.

3-Year Outcome Results

- **Overall Success:** The "2 Year Outcome Result" appears to be overwhelmingly positive, with the vast majority of outcomes being met by 100% of students. This indicates a program that is effectively achieving its educational goals over time.
- **Continuous Improvement:** The slight deviations in PLO 7 and PLO 10, as well as CLO LP.4, offer opportunities for continuous improvement. Focusing on these areas could further enhance the program's overall success.

Overall Performance

- **High Achievement:** Across almost all objectives, there's a consistent pattern of high achievement, with 100% of students meeting the standards in the majority of the learning outcomes. This indicates strong program effectiveness and student mastery of the material.
- **Improvement in Enrollment:** There's an apparent increase in the number of students from AY21-22 to AY22-23 across most objectives, suggesting growth in program enrollment or increased participation in these assessments.

Implications

- **Strengths:** The program demonstrates strong outcomes in teaching critical paramedic skills, as evidenced by the high percentages of students meeting the learning objectives. This suggests effective instruction and curriculum design.
- **Growth and Development:** The increase in student numbers meeting the objectives year-over-year could reflect positively on the program's reputation and its ability to attract more students or better prepare them for assessments.

Conclusion

The data reflects a highly successful program with consistently high achievement rates across most assessed learning outcomes over three years. The few areas with less than 100% achievement rates provide opportunities for focused review and improvement, but they do not detract from the overall excellence demonstrated by the program. Volunteer State Community College's Paramedic TC Program is showing strong performance and growth in its ability to prepare students for pre-hospital emergency care settings. Continuous monitoring of the few areas where not all students met the objectives will be important for maintaining and improving the high standards of the program.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Strategies to maintain and even improve these results could include:

- Continuing education and professional development opportunities for instructors to stay updated with the latest EMS practices and teaching methodologies.
- Implementing a feedback loop where students can provide insights on teaching methods and curriculum, ensuring that the program remains responsive to student needs and industry standards.
- Considering the establishment of a mentorship program where high achieving EMS students can provide guidance, support, and tutoring for their classmates.

Evidence:

- Paramedic Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23
- Paramedic TC PLOs AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The analysis of the Volunteer State Community College's Paramedic course evaluations from Spring 2021 to Spring 2023 reveals several strengths and areas of opportunity.

Strengths

1. **Instructor Preparation and Content Delivery:** Across all semesters, high scores were given for the instructor's preparedness and the availability of class instruction content, with mean scores consistently above 4.5. This indicates a strong foundation in course material preparation and delivery.
2. **Adherence to Syllabus Policies:** The evaluations consistently show high ratings for instructors following the course syllabus, suggesting clear communication of expectations and consistency in policy enforcement.
3. **Engagement and Environment:** The instructors were successful in creating an engaging environment where students felt comfortable asking questions and participating in discussions, with scores again consistently high.
4. **Assignment Relevance and Application of Concepts:** Assignments were viewed as relevant and effectively designed to apply course concepts, indicating that the course effectively links theory with practical application.

Areas of Opportunity

1. **Feedback Timeliness and Instructor Accessibility:** While still rated highly, feedback timeliness and instructor accessibility have slightly lower scores in some semesters, pointing to potential areas for improvement in communication and support outside of class hours.
2. **Use of Technology:** Although the use of technology was generally rated positively, there is room for enhancing how technology is utilized in the course to aid understanding and application of material, as suggested by the slightly lower scores and comments for improvement.

Ideas for Improvement

1. **Enhance Feedback and Communication:** Implementing more structured timelines for feedback and ensuring more consistent availability for student inquiries can further support student success. Tools like online forums or regular Q&A sessions could be useful.
2. **Leverage Technology for Engagement:** Exploring additional technological tools and platforms that facilitate interactive learning and better engagement with course materials could enhance the learning experience. This could include more interactive simulations, virtual labs, or collaborative online projects.
3. **Continuous Improvement through Feedback:** Encouraging a higher response rate to course evaluations and incorporating an iterative feedback loop where students can provide mid-semester feedback could help identify and address issues more promptly.
4. **Personalized Support and Resources:** Offering more personalized support options, such as tutoring or study groups, and resources for struggling students can improve understanding and application of course concepts, particularly for those who may not fully engage through large group instruction.
5. **Professional Development for Instructors:** Continuous professional development opportunities for instructors focusing on pedagogical strategies, technology integration, and communication can ensure that teaching methods remain effective and responsive to student needs.

FACT SHEET:

The provided data for the Paramedic program at Volunteer State Community College from Fall 2019 to Fall 2023, along with graduate placement information for 2020 through 2022, presents a clear framework to analyze the program's strengths and identify areas where there are opportunities for improvement.

Strengths

1. **Consistent Full-Time Enrollment:** The program has maintained a high level of full-time enrollment, with 100% of the students enrolled on a full-time basis from Fall 2019 through Fall 2022. This consistency suggests strong interest and commitment from students entering the program, which is a critical foundation for student success and program stability.
2. **Graduate Placement:** The data provided for graduate placement indicates a consistent number of graduates finding placement from 2020 to 2022, suggesting that the program is effectively preparing students for employment in the paramedic field.

Areas of Opportunity

1. **Lack of Part-Time Enrollment Options:** The 0% part-time enrollment across all years suggests that the program may not be accessible to individuals who cannot commit to full-time education due to work, family, or other obligations. Providing part-time options could open the program to a wider demographic.
2. **Variable Enrollment Numbers:** The fluctuation in total headcount, especially the drop in Fall 2021, points to potential instability in enrollment that could affect program resources and planning.

Ideas for Improvement

1. **Introduce Part-Time Study Options:** To address accessibility issues, the program could introduce part-time study options or flexible scheduling. This would allow more potential students to enroll who otherwise couldn't due to time constraints, thereby also possibly increasing the program's enrollment numbers.
2. **Targeted Recruitment and Support Programs:** Addressing the fluctuation in enrollment numbers could involve targeted recruitment efforts to raise awareness of the program and its benefits. Additionally, implementing support programs for students at risk of dropping out or those facing academic challenges could help improve retention.
3. **Career Placement Services:** Although placement rates seem strong, enhancing career placement services with more networking opportunities, job fairs, and partnerships with local EMS services could further improve graduate employment outcomes.
4. **Feedback and Continuous Improvement:** Regularly soliciting feedback from students and graduates about their experience in the program and outcomes after completion can provide essential data for continuous improvement efforts. This feedback could inform curriculum updates, teaching methods, and support services to better meet student needs.

By focusing on these areas of opportunity and implementing the suggested improvements, the Paramedic program at Volunteer State Community College could enhance its accessibility, student success rates, and overall program effectiveness.

Evidence:

- Paramedic Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Paramedic- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicators	Timeline**	Baseline Data
1	Enhance the Clinical Skills Simulation Lab PLO 4 (SL)	To enhance practical skills in emergency medical response through hands-on simulation exercises, increasing student preparedness for fieldwork.	Faculty	1. Successful completion of simulation scenarios by 100% of students. 2. Positive student feedback on simulation lab experience from 75% of participants.	AY2023-2024 for lab setup and instructor training; AY2024-2025 for full integration into the curriculum and evaluation.	1. N/A 2. N/A
2	Integrate a Case Study Discussion Series PLO 3 (SL)	To improve critical thinking and decision-making skills in emergency scenarios through facilitated case study discussions.	Faculty Members, Guest Paramedics, Program medical director.	1. Engagement of at least 75% of students in discussion series. 2. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of	AY2024 for development and pilot series; AY2024-2025 for full implementation	1. N/A 2. N/A

				participants regarding the relevance and usefulness of discussions.	and ongoing evaluation.	
3	Establish a Peer Mentorship Program for New Paramedic Students	To support academic and practical success for incoming students through mentorship from senior paramedic students, enhancing retention and program completion rates.	EMS Faculty, Senior Paramedic Students	1. 100% of new students are matched with a mentor. 1. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of mentees and mentors on the mentorship experience.	AY2024 for planning and mentor recruitment; AY2025 for program launch and initial assessment.	1. N/A 2. N/A
4	Launch an Online Resource Hub for Paramedic Studies	To provide accessible, comprehensive online study and practice resources, supporting flexible learning and enhancing knowledge retention and application.	EMS Faculty, School IT	Increased usage of online resources to 75%.	AY2023-2024 for resource development and platform launch; AY2024-2025 for user feedback collection and content expansion.	Current usage of existing online resources. 69%

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

Budgeting for new EMS lab equipment is a critical component of ensuring that emergency medical services education remains both current and comprehensive. As the healthcare landscape evolves, incorporating the latest technologies and equipment into training programs becomes essential for preparing students to meet the demands of the field effectively. Investing in new lab equipment not only facilitates hands-on learning experiences that are vital for developing practical skills but also ensures that students are familiar with the most recent advancements in emergency medical care.

By prioritizing the allocation of resources towards updating lab equipment, educational institutions can enhance the overall quality of their EMS programs, better prepare students for the challenges of their future careers, and ultimately contribute to the improvement of patient outcomes in emergency medical situations. The current budget and Health Science fees are sufficient to meet all budget needs of the EMS program. We foresee sufficient monies for the next three years.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

The EMS program mission aligns well with the college mission. It focuses on community engagement, partnerships, and high-quality education.

Section 2a

EMT Report:

- The assessment plan is not clearly articulated in this section of the report. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. We are assuming that information is present in the attachments that we do not have access to in this part of the review process. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Paramedic Report:

- The narrative does not delineate the separate aspects of the assessment plan as clearly as EMT report does. We do not see what the PLO or CLOs are, what the identified targets are for each outcome, etc. Additional access to information is needed for more elaborate feedback.

Section 2b

- Both reports:
 1. No 2020 data provided. An explanation for the missing data is needed.
 2. Need explanation why the 3-year outcome result not indicated/reported.
 3. The CLOs listed under the table do not comprehensively relate to or explain the data in the PLO table. More information is needed for the reviewers to understand this information.
- Paramedic Report
 1. PLO 9, 12 are missing data (0% met/not met).
 2. The *Lab Practice Skills SLOs* comment related to the table comments is presumptuous. Identifying high performance in some areas should not lead to an assumption that there is automatically high performance in areas not assessed.

Sections 3-4

Excellent job outlining and describing the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.

Are there correlations between certain questions in the Course Evaluations or Employer Surveys that relate to and support the PLOs? We suggest triangulating data/results where possible.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Paramedic program supports the mission of the institution by providing a high-quality, innovative program. It is led by Erik Jesse, Program Director, and has a team of dedicated full-time and adjunct instructors. The program is taught at the Cookeville and Gallatin locations and has a supportive and engaged Advisory Committee. Graduates obtain gainful employment with EMS providers throughout the communities. They demonstrate effective learning by passing the National Registry examination higher than the national average. In reviewing the APR, I noted the following.

- The assessment plan narrative does not identify the PLO being assessed. I understand that the 2020 data was absent due to the ramifications of the pandemic and the changeover in the research personnel. To add to the comment from the IA Committee, in the narrative, provide more details about what specifically is being assessed and connect it to the educational goals and objectives. In assessing the Paramedic Lab Practice SLOs AY21-23, I note a significant decrease in the percentage of students who exceed each lab category. I am also curious as to why EMSP.TC.9 and EMSP.TC.12 do not appear to have been assessed.
- I agree with the ideas for improvement regarding "Continuous Improvement through Feedback". Paramedic student course evaluation submission was 86% in 2021 and has trended downward to 26% in Spring of 23. Faculty should make more concerted efforts to encourage students to complete course evaluations. Students and stakeholders such as employers and graduates can provide valuable information about the program that may affect planned initiatives. An additional opportunity for growth is assessing the results of Graduate and Employer surveys.

In summary, I recommend a detailed analysis of the laboratory competency assessments. It should include the faculty who teach the course as well as the director. Since the program is offered at two sites, is there a difference in competency level between Cookeville and Gallatin students or is the data from one location? The program has a sufficient budget to order equipment and supplies that can increase student learning. I believe that additional training in completing the assessment section of the report and having adequate time to complete the APR, will be of benefit in future reports.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative

Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicators	Timeline	Baseline Data	Response	Year 2 Response
Enhance the Clinical Skills Simulation Lab PLO 4	To enhance practical skills in emergency medical response through hands-on simulation exercises, increasing student preparedness for fieldwork.	Faculty	Successful completion of simulation scenarios by 100% of students. Positive student feedback on simulation lab experience from 75% of participants.	AY2023-2024 for lab setup and instructor training; AY2024-2025 for full integration into the curriculum and evaluation.	N/A	Training has been conducted for five faculty members (Todd, Harley, Alex Smith, Rachale Turner, and Rob Demoss) to ensure proficiency in simulation operations. Training schedules varied based on instructor availability. Senior mentors, Gary and Cory, have volunteered to assist in simulation activities.	Ongoing training will continue to ensure all faculty are proficient.
Integrate a Case Study Discussion Series PLO 3	To improve critical thinking and decision-making skills in emergency scenarios through facilitated case study discussions.	Faculty Members, Guest Paramedics, Program medical director.	Engagement of at least 75% of students in discussion series. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of participants regarding the relevance and usefulness of discussions.	AY2024 for development and pilot series; AY2024-2025 for full implementation and ongoing evaluation.	N/A	N/A	Case studies have been integrated into the curriculum, specifically within the Lab class (2402), with involvement from the Medical Director. Student engagement is at 100%, as participation is required for medical director sign-off. All participating students reported a positive experience and perceived the case studies as useful.
Establish a Peer Mentorship Program for New Paramedic Students	To support academic and practical success for incoming students through mentorship from senior paramedic students, enhancing retention and program completion rates.	EMS Faculty, Senior Paramedic Students	100% of new students are matched with a mentor. Obtain positive feedback from 75% of mentees and mentors on the mentorship experience.	AY2024 for planning and mentor recruitment; AY2025 for program launch and initial assessment.	N/A	N/A	To date, student participation in the peer mentorship program has been negligible. It is surmised that the program's scheduling, following long lecture days on Mondays and Tuesdays, contributes to low engagement. Senior mentors Gary and Todd have volunteered. 100% of new students were invited to participate.

							Data supporting low participation is anecdotal.	
Launch an Online Resource Hub for Paramedic Studies	To provide accessible, comprehensive online study and practice resources, supporting flexible learning and enhancing knowledge retention and application.	EMS Faculty, School IT	Increased usage of online resources to 75%.	AY2023-2024 for resource development and platform launch; AY2024-2025 for user feedback collection and content expansion.	Current usage of existing online resources. 69%		Evaluation of online resource platforms is ongoing. Platinum Planner and JB Learning were assessed but did not meet the requirement for providing students with meaningful, independent feedback. Students continue to utilize existing online resources.	Software evaluation is still in progress.

Evidence:

- Initiative Paramedic

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis

	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Fire Science AAS & CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution? The Fire Science program's mission aligns with the institution's mission by uniting in the desire to provide students with innovative education while building lasting relationships with students to prepare our students for successful careers. The program is designed to prepare current and future firefighters to be leaders and thinkers in the firefighting profession. The FESHE (Fire and Emergency Services Higher Education Initiative) certified program can be completed 100% online and provides the flexibility required by students working all shifts and hours. As the firefighting profession continues to make technological advances, the instructors serve students by providing current, relevant instruction on today's fire service topics and trends. The program focuses on the critical thinking and problem-solving skills not learned in training or on the job. Students can acquire a broader base of knowledge and a new perspective on the fire service profession.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

1. **Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes** focus on students' ability to understand the scope, purpose and structure of the various fire and emergency services, understand the broad concepts of fire prevention, and to demonstrate a basic understanding of the relationship of materials and their relationship to fire.
2. **Assessment Methods** involve quizzes to measure students' competencies in these areas, discussions covering relevant content in the textbooks, self-studies to supplement the textbook with external learning, and final projects that focus on local concerns for respective students.
3. **Achievement Targets** are set to ensure that students meet or exceed the expected standards in their theoretical knowledge.
4. **Assessment Schedule** outlines when these evaluations take place, ensuring a structured approach to student assessment throughout the academic year.
5. **Assessment Rubric** details the criteria for grading student performance from excellent, down to unsatisfactory. All graded assessments utilize rubrics, which are provided to students at the beginning of class and are always available for them to view to ensure they understand the grading criteria. The detailed rubric and assessment methods ensure that students are evaluated fairly and comprehensively, providing a clear pathway for demonstrating knowledge and proficiency in the Fire Science field.

Evidence:

- FIRE, AASCERT Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

FIRE AAS

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	95.56%	4.44%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	95.24%	4.76%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	97.62%	2.38%	
PLO 4			95.28%	4.72%	97.58%	2.42%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	95.65%	4.35%	
Course Learning Outcome 1320.1			100%	0%	92.11%	7.89%	
Course Learning Outcome 1320.2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 1320.3			100%	0%	96.55%	3.45%	

Course Learning Outcomes FIRE1320 1320.1 Implementation 1320.2 Develop Solutions 1320.3 Communication

1. Analysis of trends

There was a slight decrease in outcomes being met from 2021 to 2022. While the outcomes met percentage for 2022 remained high, any decrease demands a closer look at the reasons for that decrease.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
Student learning can be improved by analyzing the specific areas that slipped between 2021 and 2022 and focusing on their improvement through targeted initiatives.

FIRE TC

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	95.56%	4.41%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	97.83%	2.17%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	97.62%	2.38%	
PLO 4			95.28%	4.72%	97.58%	2.42%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	95.65%	4.35%	
Course Learning Outcome			100%	0%	92.11%	7.89%	
Course Learning Outcome			100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome			100%	0%	96.55%	3.45%	

Course Learning Outcomes FIRE1320 1320.1 implementation 1320.2 Develop Solutions 1320.3 Communication

1. Analysis of trends

Like the trends of the Fire Science AAS program, there was a slight decrease in the outcomes being met percentages from 2021 to 2022. While the TC numbers are slightly higher and some areas, they still demand further analysis to make improvements.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Again, these results can be analyzed in order to identify specific areas that need improvement. While the percentages are high as they are, improvements will continue to be made until outcomes are met 100%.

Evidence:

- FIRE 1320 CLOs AY20-23
- FIRE AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- FIRE AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- FIRE TC PLO_s AY20-23
- FIRE TC PLOs Gender AY21-22
- FIRE TC PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- FIRE TC Pell First Gen PLOs AY21-23
- FIRE, AASCERT Assessment Plan
- Fact Sheet FIRE AAS & TC FA23
- Fact Sheet FIRE AAS FA23
- Fact Sheet Fire Science TC FA23
- Fire AAS PLO_s AY20-23
- Fire AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- Fire Student Course Evals AY20-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Strengths:

Experienced and knowledgeable Faculty: The Director and nine adjunct faculty members all have multiple years of fire service experience and teaching experience that combines for a well-rounded, excellent source of information for the students.

Increasing enrollment: Enrollment of current firefighters continues to increase on a consistent basis.

Transfer for credits for certifications: The Fire Science Program offers many transfer credits for fire service certifications and medical licenses, which rewards students for their prior experiences by reducing the number of courses they must complete at Vol State.

Areas of opportunity:

Recent high school graduate enrollment: While enrollment of current firefighters continues to increase, there is a need to attract younger potential firefighters to the program.

Diversity: While there is some diversity, the program continues to try to attract a broader demographic of students.

Limited retention data: Persistence data is missing, making it difficult to assess student retention within the program.

Ideas for improvement:

Networking with local fire departments and their respective high schools: Coordinate with members of the Fire Science Advisory Board to visit area high schools to ensure students are aware of the job opportunities in the fire service field. This can attract a broader demographic, as well as younger students to supplement the large amount of current firefighters already in the program.

Increase the personal aspect of instructor to student relationships: Due to the online-only format of fire science classes, better relationships with the students need to be established by the faculty. This can be accomplished by increased communication in discussion forums and reaching out to individual students to encourage those who are struggling, and to praise those who are succeeding.

Increase retention data by working closer with the Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
	Student Learning:					

1	Increase external learning opportunities for students within course content. PLO 2 (SL)	Provide students with knowledge beyond that of the textbook and instructor experience through resources such as free self-studies.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty	Adaption and completion of external studies into eLearn courses.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.
2	Improve student to student and instructor to students interaction within eLearn. PLO 4 (SL)	Provide students with increased knowledge and information by increased use of discussion forums.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty.	Improved module discussion grades and course evaluation feedback.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline discussion grade data needs to be recorded and tracked.
Student Success:						
3	Provide advising to all Fire Science students prior to each semester.	To ensure students know their progress in accordance to their goals, and to ensure students take the correct classes each semester accordingly.	Program Director	Continued and increased enrollment and retention, as well as decreased drop/add of classes by students.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline retention data needed.
4	Provide a mentor to Fire Science students.	In addition to the Program Director, students can be mentored by program graduates. This could be especially effective for current firefighters who have co-workers that	Program Director, current students, and past Fire Science graduates.	Increased retention, increased enrollment, job placement for graduates.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.

		are program graduates.				
--	--	------------------------	--	--	--	--

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

No additional expenses are required.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Mission Statement Alignment

The Fire Science mission statement aligns well with the college mission statement. Internal and external engagement are addressed as well as career-focused skills.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcome Assessment

The information is clearly articulated with easily identifiable sections. It is brief but it is assumed more detail is on the AASCERT Assessment Tool. I did not have this instrument to review.

Evidence of Student Learning

Both reports have no 2020 data provided nor an explanation for the missing entries. Seemingly good analysis of give data but I could not see the supporting documentation

Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

Great job identifying strengths and areas of opportunity!

One small item to be changed under *Increase retention data*. The office name is now Research, Assessment and Special Initiatives (RASI) isn't it?

1. Improvement Initiatives

1. Matrix- **2 Student Learning** and **2 Student Success** Initiatives (no more than 6 total)

Both sections are clear and well defined.

2. Initiative Budget- Budget details on any initiative that need financial consideration.

“No additional expenses are required.” Amazing! The overall report was excellent in content and focus.

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

Under the leadership of Jeremy Stewart, Director of Fire Science, students have flourished in the 100% online format of the program. He has an active and engaged Advisory Committee that has a vested interest in the development and recruitment of firefighters throughout the state. Mr. Stewart plans to address the area of opportunity section regarding recent high school graduate enrollment by the following:

- Ordering equipment and/or supplies for the Gallatin High School dual enrollment cohort to increase interest in the career field and to allow students to participate in hands-on learning. The program has sufficient funds to support this area.
- Increasing recruitment at high schools by visiting in uniform accompanied by a firefighter closer to the students' ages who is currently employed at a fire station in their county. A bonus would be if the firefighter is a graduate of the high school in hopes that prospective students can better envision themselves in the role.
- Note: there is no 2020 data due to the pandemic and changes in IE personnel.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
	Student Learning:					
1	Increase external learning opportunities for students within course content.	Provide students with knowledge beyond that of the textbook and instructor experience through resources such as free self-studies.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty	Adaption and completion of external studies into eLearn courses.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.
2	Improve student to student and instructor to students interaction within eLearn.	Provide students with increased knowledge and information by increased use of discussion forums.	Program Director and Adjunct Faculty.	Improved module discussion grades and course evaluation feedback.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline discussion grade data needs to be recorded and tracked.
	Student Success:					
3	Provide advising to all Fire Science students prior to each semester.	To ensure students know their progress in accordance to their goals, and to ensure students take the correct	Program Director	Continued and increased enrollment and retention, as well as decreased drop/add of	AY 2024-2025	Baseline retention data needed.

	classes each semester accordingly.		classes by students.		
4 Provide a mentor to Fire Science students.	In addition to the Program Director, students can be mentored by program graduates. This could be especially effective for current firefighters who have co-workers that are program graduates.	Program Director, current students, and past Fire Science graduates.	Increased retention, increased enrollment, job placement for graduates.	AY 2024-2025	Baseline data needed.

1. All 21 FIRE classes, with the exception of two classes, FIRE 2310 and FIRE 2340, now include external learning assignments. Those two classes are anticipated to include external assignments the next semester they are offered after the current spring 2025 semester. Student learning for these external assignments is tracked by requiring students to submit proof of completion of these assignments to eLearn dropboxes. These external assignments help improve student outcomes in their respective courses because every external assignment is linked to at least one of its' respective course outcomes.

2. All FIRE adjunct instructors were directed by the Fire Science Program Director to increase online interaction with their students by replying to all student introductions. Additionally, adjuncts were directed to participate in module discussions on a frequent basis, by replying/participating in at least one thread per module. There has been increased online interactions between instructors and students based on periodic checks conducted by the program director. However, detailed checks will be conducted of all class interactions at the conclusion of the spring 2025 semester. The Year 2 evaluation for this initiative was conducted by the program director comparing the number

3. The Program Director has made excellent progress in providing advising to all Fire Science students. To facilitate this initiative, a list of all current and prospective Fire Science students is maintained by the Program Director. The list includes contact information and program status. The list is used to email or call to advise students on a regular basis, at least once prior to each semester. At the time of this narrative, there are 139 students on that list, and all 139 of them who were on the list at the time were advised prior to the fall 2024, spring 2025, and summer 2025 semesters. Currently, the program director is working on advising all students on the list for the fall 2025 semester.

4. Providing a mentor to each student is still a work in progress. Some progress has been made, but without a formal mentoring system in place, along with a sufficient number of mentors with time and interest to provide the service, this initiative has not proven to be feasible. Moving forward, the program director will continue to gather information about students, and when students are employed in the fire service, they will be provided with names of others at their place of employment to be used as possible resources. Students without co-workers or peers in a position to provide mentorship will continue to be advised by the program director.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress

	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Medical Laboratory Technology AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
It is the mission of the Medical Laboratory Technology Program to provide well-trained, professional, knowledgeable, and competent Medical Laboratory Technicians to serve the healthcare community and public at large. The program is designed to prepare students to enter the work force as Medical Laboratory Technicians, knowledgeable and skilled in assisting physicians in the identification, monitoring, and treatment of diseases.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The assessment plan, including method, targets, and schedule, for MLAB 1520 and MLAB 2510 was evaluated and determined to be appropriate. The MLAB Clinical Assessment Rubric requires updating to remove the AAA.6 TN Medical Laboratory Board Licensure. TN Medical Laboratory Board Licensure is no longer required for all clinical laboratory personnel. Both MLAB 1520 and MLAB 2510 are taught later in the Medical Laboratory Technology Program. It would be valuable to assess

MLAB 1510 in addition to the other assessments since it is taught earlier in the program. This would provide assessments throughout the program.

Evidence:

- MLAB, AAS Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			98.75%	1.25%	100%	0%	
PLO 4			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 6			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 7			0%	0%	0%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome MLAB.2			95%	5%	90.91%	9.09%	
Course Learning Outcome MLAB.7			100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome MLAB.9			100%	0%	100%	0%	

MLAB Clinical Assessment Outcomes MLAB.2 Psychomotor Clinical MLAB.7 Cognitive Decision Making MLAB.9 Cognitive Critical thinking

1. Analysis of trends

Students have successfully met at 100% all program learning outcomes (PLO) in 2021 except for PLO 3, Technical Skills, which requires demonstration of entry-level technical competency in all skills necessary to fulfill their role as a Medical Laboratory Technician, 98.75%. In 2022, students successfully met at 100% all program learning outcomes. It is possible that the evaluations did not accurately reflect the technical skills of the students in 2022.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

To improve the student's technical skills, we have created a student simulation lab in Fall 2023 allowing students to practice laboratory skills prior to their clinical practicum. Although the simulation lab is operational, procedures for the use of the equipment are still in development.

Evidence:

- AY21-22 and AY22-23 CLO Report
- MLAB AAS PLOs AY21-23
- MLAB Clinical Assessment MLAB1520 MLAB 2510
- MLT AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- MLT AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- MLT AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Program Strengths

For the 2020-2021 graduation classes, the program has a 100% first-time pass rate for the national ASCP Board of Certification exam. For the 2022 graduation class, the first-time pass rate was 90%, 9 students passed, 1 failed. Analysis of certification data shows that the mean scaled score for VSCC program graduates is consistently above the national mean scaled score for this exam for all three years. This is well above our national certification agency, NAACLS, requirements of a three year average of at least 75%.

Course evaluations consistently show a median score of 5.0 out of 5.0 for all questions for the last three years. A strength that has remained consistent is that the instructor regularly prepared content for class instruction and the online content of the program was readily available for use when needed. There is an extensive amount of on-line content used in the program. We have also seen an increase in scores in Fall 22 and Spring 23 for creating an environment where students were able to ask questions and engage in discussion. We added group discussions and interactive activities, involving both instructor and student, to program courses to increase student engagement and interaction.

The program has a 100% placement rate within the first year of graduation. There is a high demand for qualified Medical Laboratory Technicians both locally and nationally.

	2020 Graduates	2021 Graduates	2022 Graduates
# who found employment in the field or in a closely related field within one year of graduation	11	9	6
# who did not find employment in the field or in a closely related field within one year of graduation	0	0	0
# for which you do not have any information	0	4	4
Yearly Average Placement Rate for those who submitted information	100%	100%	100%

Opportunities

Although we are above the certification pass rate required by our national accreditation agency, NAACLS, we strive for 100%. We added a new review book, *Medical Laboratory Science Review*, to the MLAB 2270 course for Spring 2024 which should help students prepare for their national certification exams. We are also leveraging digital technology to offer practice exams to the students for certification preparation.

Since there is a high demand for trained clinical laboratory professionals in this area, expanding the program to accommodate additional students would be a benefit to prospective students and the

community. According to a Lightcast Q3 2023 Data Set report, there is a high unmet demand for jobs within a 30-mile radius from Gallatin. There is a higher-than-average number of jobs in this area for medical laboratory personnel. In 2023, this area had 3,173 jobs in the field and the national average for this same size area was 1,624.

Another opportunity for improvement is to increase accessibility to the program. Many of those interested in the Medical Laboratory Technology Program are non-traditional students. Non-traditional students may not be able to attend school full time because of family commitments or employment obligations. A part-time program would be beneficial to this student population.

Evidence:

- 20-21 MFT 6 MLAB ASCP BOC 2020
- 2021 Placement Rates
- All Results Report MLT _ Placement 2022 Graduates
- MLT Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Medical Laboratory Technology- Fact Sheet FA23_King_Updated ER
- Occupation_Overview_Clinical_Laboratory_Technologists_and_Technicians_30_Mile_Radius_from_Gallatin_2023-28 10122023
- Y2 MedLab
- Yr3 Med Lab May 22 - Nov 22

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

Matrix of Improvement Initiatives						
YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)	Timeline	Baseline Data
1	Expand the program by increasing program capacity, adding clinical sites, classroom and lab space, and faculty.	To provide a greater number of graduates to support the demand for medical laboratory technology personnel.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Increase the number of Medical Laboratory Program graduates to >15.	AY2022-2024 Seek approval from TN Lab Board to increase capacity, add additional clinical sites, add faculty to support growth, add a	Program graduates (three-year average) 11

					classroom and another student lab.	
2	Increase accessibility to the program by creating a part-time program.	To provide greater accessibility for non-traditional students.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Create a part-time program.	AY2022-2024 Seek approval from TN Lab Board, create curriculum and class schedule.	none
3	Increase the Board of Certification pass rate by incorporating a review book and practice exams into MLAB 2270, Seminar II. PLO 6 (SL)	To provide additional review material to assist students with passing board exams.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Increase the pass rate on Board of Certification (BOC) exams to 100%.	AY2023-2024 Add a review book, and additional practice exams to the course.	BOC pass rate (three-year average) 97%
4	Create a student learning outcomes assessment for MLAB 1510 to evaluate students earlier in the program. PLO 3 (SL)	To evaluate students early in the program allowing time to correct unsatisfactory outcomes.	Program Director and MLAB faculty	Create a student learning outcomes assessment for MLAB 1510.	AY 2024-2025 Create learning outcomes, assessment rubric, assessment map, define the method, and establish targets.	none

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

For program expansion to accommodate additional students, the following items are needed:

ITEM	COST PER UNIT	UNITS	TOTAL COST
Vinyl chairs	680	12	8160
Lab grade tables	1800	10	18000
Incubator for Micro samples	3500	1	3500
Pipettors	600	20	12000
Total Monies			41660

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Section 1

Program mission aligns well with the college mission. It focuses on education for service to healthcare and greater community at large.

Section 2

- The assessment plan was not clearly outlined in the report we received. The report indicates they reviewed it and found it appropriate but without clearly communicating the plan's details to the reviewers. We do not see what the PLOs are except by numbers. The summary includes plans for future changes to the assessment plan.
- Suggestions: Include the PLO specifics and more detail about the assessment plan as it was defined so that the reader understands the data. Move information about changing the assessment plan after the data analysis.
- We assume that the PLO data provided is from clinical observations, not pre-clinical. Additional clarification is needed.
- No 2020 data provided. An explanation for the missing data is needed.
- Need explanation why the 3-year outcome result not reported.
- Is the Course Learning Outcome MLAB.2 the same as (or aligned to) Technical Skills as PLO#3 is? The Course Learning Outcome indicates under 100% met, but it is not discussed in the report.

Section 3

Is the ASCP Board Certification exam (referenced in the program strengths) required for all students? Is this board exam the same as the AAA.6 TN Medical Laboratory Board Licensure mentioned in part 1?

Are there correlations between certain questions in the Course Evaluations or Employer Surveys that relate to and support the PLOs? We suggest triangulating data/results where possible.

In the placement data table, we suggest adding a row to indicate the actual average placement rate – not just those who responded.

Section 4

Improvement initiatives are good. No suggestions.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Medical Laboratory Technology program supports the institution's mission by providing a quality and innovative program. It is growing at an impressive pace under the leadership of Eileen Ricker,

Program Director, and the remaining team members such as Robin Ward, Clinical Coordinator. Graduates demonstrate learning by successfully passing the national board examination at a high level and by obtaining gainful employment at facilities within our local communities. Job placement is at 100% for all who pursue. In addition to the comment from the IA Committee regarding including a detailed narrative for the assessment plan section and Yr 3, I noted the following.

- Stakeholders can provide valuable information about the program that may affect planned initiatives. An opportunity for growth is noted in the amount of feedback obtained from stakeholders through graduate and employer surveys as well as course evaluation responses. The number of students submitting course evaluations has trended down from 100% in 2020 to 45% in 2023. Graduate and employer surveys are also at a low threshold. You have an engaged and communicative Advisory Committee. I would like to see a detailed analysis of feedback, particularly from employers and graduates to ensure that all growth opportunities are being addressed. This would also relate to the IA Committee's questions regarding correlations between evaluation instruments.
- To address a question from the IA committee, the State of TN does not require licensure for medical laboratory technologists. Licensure is separate from the ASCP Board Certification examination. Upon completion of the board exam, graduates obtain credentials. Overall, the program has an excellent first-time board examination pass rate that is well above the minimum passing score. If not already completed, consider completing a detailed analysis of each section of the board exam results to determine curricular strengths and weaknesses as the total score per student trended downward in 2022. Utilizing the new MLT review textbook, and the addition of the simulation lab may also help.
- The program's budget and Health Science course fees were insufficient to meet the need of new equipment for the simulation lab. Several areas around campus shared their budget monies to assist with this dilemma. As of today, 4/11/2024, the simulation lab is up and running.

In summary, this is an effective program with increasing incidents of student success and a positive employment outlook. The progressive initiatives, which I approve, will help meet the needs of the community at a more rapid pace. The ability for students, many of whom are most likely non-traditional, to pursue the part-time pathway to secure gainful employment is unique in the state. I look forward to a follow-up next year.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Expand approved MLT Program Seat Capacity and surpass base line of 11 graduated students listed in 4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives.	a. State Lab Board Approved to seat 40 students up from 20 b. Student lecture classroom – 400 Building, Room 102 c. 2nd Student simulation lab now functional – 400 Building, Room 106 d. 5 new clinical practicum (CP) sites added	1. Qualified applicant base 2. Quantity of Microbiology clinical practicum rotation sites due to affiliation consolidation 3. Program Director retired leaving the need to add faculty 4. Student academic performance - Tutoring opportunity for student learning to increase retention/completion	1.a. – complete 1.b. – complete 1.c. – complete 1.d.– lost all Ascension lab affiliations due to LabCorp management 1.4. Add tutoring for MLT students taught by MLAB Adjunct faculty	Indicator - Met AY – 2023-2024 15 students graduated. AY – 2024-2025 16 students total - Projecting 14 to graduate in 2025. This is 1 student less than in 2024 (15).
2	Add Part-time MLT Cohort to better	a. Approval from TN	1. Qualified applicant base		Indicator – Met

	meet needs of nontraditional students	Med Lab Board 2023 b. Approval from NAACLS c. Approval from VSCC Admin 2023 d. 1st Part-time cohort began January 2024 & will graduate May 2025 e. 2nd part-time cohort began January 2025 & will graduate May 2026	2. Quantity of CP sites due to Ascension labs & Graves Gilbert Lab being managed by LabCorp causing need for new contract and TN Med Lab Board approval		AY – 2024-2025 1st cohort of Part-time MLT students will graduate 2025 with 18 applicants and 6 being offered seats in the cohort AY – 2025-2026 2nd cohort of Part-time MLT students had 35 applicants with 10 being offered seats in the cohort.
3	Increase Certification Exam pass rate to 100% by incorporating new textbook into MLAB 2270	a. Spring 2024 adopted review textbook: Medical Laboratory Science Review (5th Edition, Robert R. Harr, 2019, ISBN-13: 978-0-8036-6827-0) b. AY – 2023-2024 ASCP & AMT combined pass rate 73.3% (1	1. Didactic online exam result integrity in question - adding textbook does not address this 2. Students not registering to take certification exam by 1 month post graduation - siting cost of exam for postponing exam - adding textbook does not address this 3. Adjustment needed to grade requirement to enter the MLT Program? 4. Adjustment needed to grade requirements for course completion	Due to falling short of NAACLS pass rate threshold for 2024 graduates, the certification exam pass rate target for this metric has been adjusted down to 90% overall to allow for additional measures and further remediation.	Indicator – Not Met

		year testing window closes 5/4/25.)	while in the MLT program 4. NAACLS pass rate metric is within 1st year of graduation - has been challenging to get students to register to retake certification exam after initial fail attempt 5. Students not utilizing the exam proctoring website	More adjustment needed than simply adding a book - Spring 2025 prereq GPA updated to 2.7, MLAB course completion updated to 75% from 70%. Students moved to in-person proctored exams instead of virtual proctor. Additional remediation added for performance on section exams. Students retain access to exam proctoring for the first year post graduation until they pass their exam	
4	Student Learning Outcomes Assessment for MLAB 1510	a. VIA Assessment created and entered for			Indicator - Met

		MLAB 1510 Fall 2024			
--	--	------------------------	--	--	--

Close

Evidence:

- Exam Results 2024 Class
- Graduated Student Exam Simulator Access
- MLAB College Catalog Grade Requirements Modification SP 2025

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?

EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Entertainment Media Production - AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution? The Entertainment Media Program is a close fit with the mission of the college. The EMP works continually to develop and incorporate innovative ways to use new industry techniques such as immersive audio into the classroom. In their professional work, faculty stay up with current industry standards and practices, using current equipment and techniques. This knowledge is brought back to the classroom and informs curriculum development and teaching practices. The faculty are all professionals in their respective fields which allows for partnerships with industry companies to form naturally. These partnerships allow opportunities for internships and employment for graduates. The Capstone class has students forming groups that conceive, develop and build a project that is presented to a panel of industry professionals, From these experiences, Volstate students have secured multiple internships, direct employment, and industry contacts critical to career development and success.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The current rubric and plan are new to this assessment cycle as they recently underwent a major revision. They were revised to capture data useful to the program for assessment of student learning and to better inform program tweaks.

This new plan is much more effective in all of the prompt categories, but still needs some expansion and adjustment. Since the last cycle, the EMP has developed and implemented a new pathway, Digital Media, which covers podcasting, radio and other types of voice work. This pathway is not yet included in the overall assessment rubric, but needs to be by the time Digital Media students appear in Capstone. The plan would be to include the revision during the Summer session of 2024.

A second revision to be made at the same time would be a language tweak. PLO 5 : "Students will be able to work as a team to create an effective new artist presentation for industry representatives." should read "Students will be able to work as a team to create an effective entertainment project for presentation for industry representatives."

This change will better represent the expanded scope of the EMP and student projects

Course sequencing will undergo a major revision as the EMP will be adding three options for students to reflect the continual change in student needs.

1) The EMP will offer a 'smorgasboard" degree path option for students whose interests lie outside the 5 current pathways. This need was identified through discussions that arose during student advising sessions - a reason the EMP is choosing to keep advising in house - and through inquiries from prospective students, and through discussions with advisory board members. It will allow students to pick and choose from among a menu of classes to build a customized path that will serve their individual needs.

2) Course sequencing will also be tweaked to accommodate the needs of the English and other General Education department scheduling.

3) The EMP will be developing two certificates: 1) A beginning certificate that will provide a condensed curriculum that won't include General Education classes and will be an option for students who only want skill classes, and to service returning students who may already have a degree and who are looking to take classes to sharpen or advance their current skills. 2) An advanced certificate for students continue learning past the available classes in a two-year degree but who don't want to attend a four-year school, and to serve the same returning/skill advancement cohort mentioned for the first certificate.

Evidence:

- EMP, AAS Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			100%	0%	100%	0%	

PLO 2			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 3			100%	0%	95.24%	4.76%	
PLO 4			100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 5			100%	0%	95.24%	4.76%	
Course Learning Outcome 299P.1			93.75	6.25%	85.71%	14.29%	
Course Learning Outcome 299P.2			97.92%	2.08%	95.24%	4.76%	
Course Learning Outcome 299P.3			100%	0%	100%	0%	

Course Learning Outcome COMM299P Capstone 299P.1 Time Management 299P.2 Collaboration 299P.3

1. Analysis of trends

The EMP numbers look very good for the program and learning outcomes. We've worked hard to prepare students for the jobs market. Students are passing the outcomes at a very high rate. There was a slight dip year over year from 2021 to 2022 in PLO 3 and PLO 5 as well as CLO 1 and CLO 2, but with only two years of data there is not enough to tell if it is a trend or a fluctuation. It is something that will warrant tracking.

The numbers are high enough that it seems the EMP is doing well preparing students to face the "real world" and the challenges of building a career.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

PLO 3 addresses students technical knowledge in the manipulation of images on a professional level. Critical to this skill is the ability to train on industry standard equipment and software as the level that is considered "professional" is rising and follows a stairstep model: new software and equipment are developed which allow new and innovative techniques to become commonplace which means the starting level is new and higher, requiring teaching to rise as well.

PLO 5 involves students working as a group to achieve necessary goals. This one is somewhat dependent on group dynamics. EMP faculty strive to instill the need for successful interaction to realize a satisfactory outcome. The director of the EMP has started working on directed group work in the early Intro to Entertainment Business class to work on soft skills and how to thrive within a group, so tracking of this outcome will inform the program of the effectiveness of those efforts.

CLO 1 and 2 are tied in large part to PLO 5 and will likely rise and fall in generally the same manner and will benefit from similar actions. This will bear watching as well.

It is possible we should tweak CLOs 1 and 2 to gather different data since they are close to PLO 5

The EMP is continually looking for ways to improve student learning. All faculty are involved at a professional level within the entertainment industry which serves as constant professional development. This constant development is reflected in the classroom as exposure to the latest techniques and trends. When students have access to, and hands-on experience with, industry standard equipment, their usefulness as interns and employees is obvious and less time is spent by the employer in training and students more quickly become productive in their chosen areas.

Evidence:

- EMP COM299P Capstone SLOs AY21-23
- EMP PLOs AY21-23 Standard Report
- EMP PLOs Gender AY21-23
- EMP PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- EMP PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The EMP is showing good growth in graduates. This is exactly the result we are hoping to see. From 2020 to 2022 the graduate number has increased by approximately 60%. Part of this increase is attributable to recovery from the COVID downturn, but still it shows good growth. The EMP is also seeing an increase in returning students. One benefit of this mixing of younger and older students is the learning going both directions and the exposure to unexpected perspectives. Both sets of students gain knowledge for the experience.

We anticipate even greater growth in numbers as we see fruits from our work to build relationships and DE opportunities with high schools in the Vol State service area. In the Summer session of 2022 we are developing one class for Fall semester in Robertson Co and have two more targeted to offer soon. These relationships serve the dual purpose of offering secondary students a unique educational experience and raising awareness of the program as a whole to a population that has not been tapped fully for the EMP at Vol State.

We are hoping to increase our student numbers by 10-15%. To prepare for these possible increases the faculty and the director have been meeting regularly within the dean to form a plan, and to recruit suitable faculty to the adjunct pool to cover the need for additional sections of classes that will be needed.

To make sure the EMP prepares for increased student numbers and to keep the curriculum in line with evolving industry needs, the EMP relies on input from the advisory board. The EMP advisory board has been expanded with new members as needed to advise new directions.

One of these expansions is the addition of a new pathway - Digital Radio Media This pathway was developed to serve students interested in new media outlets such as podcasting and for more traditional outlets such as sports announcing, traditional radio, and voice over work.

The EMP is developing several collaborative opportunities for students. The EMP faculty work well together and are creating classes that will see DRM , audio, and video students working in shared classes on collaborative projects. This is reflective of the industry at large and it is felt the more practice students during their tenure at Vol State, the more seamless their transition into industry after graduation will be.

Students already have one collaborative opportunity in the Capstone class. This class is at the end of the schedule and is a practicum in which teams of students formed with at least one of each of the pathways conceive, develop, and present a project to a panel of industry professional for feedback and advice. A film project from the Spring 2023 Capstone class has garnered 9 awards in various categories from film festivals in which it has been entered.

Additional collaborative opportunities presented in different ways in other classes we feel will only raise the bar for the already fine work from EMP students.

Evidence:

- Entertainment Media Production- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Increase availability of hands-on learning with state of the industry equipment. PLO 3 (SL)	Increase value of students to internships and employers as students will already be experienced in the operation of this equipment, streamlining students path into industry positions, and lessening employers need to spend valuable resources and time on training	EMP faculty will teach students the latest techniques on the state of industry equipment	Students will more quickly secure employment and /or will increase likelihood of hire at the end of an internship	EMP is awaiting word of a major grant application. If awarded, the grant will be used by June 30 2023	Awaiting word on funding
2	Develop an advanced learning certificate for students who don't want a 4-year degree or are, along with certain community populations, interested in furthering certain skills or honing existing skills	Maximize skills for current or returning students to aid career building	EMP faculty will develop curriculum with approvals through the offices of the Dean and the VPAA	Students will show career growth, acquire advanced certifications , and will secure more opportunities based on larger skillsets.	Create and receive approvals in the 2025-2026 academic year with a Fall 2026 start.	Certificate does not currently exist

3	Develop pathways for secondary schools to take DE courses and provide seamless transition to EMP at VSCC	Increase prospective student awareness of EMP opportunities and increase likelihood of students coming to VSCC and with credits in desired pathway already in hand, stay for completion of certificates and/or degree	Director will work with appropriate VSCC offices and target service area secondary schools to develop curriculum to be offered	Student growth from target schools will be tracked, along with completion data	Create curriculum 2023-2024 academic year with start date of Fall 2024	Work has been ongoing and interest is high in the first target school. The director is working with secondary school teachers to develop classes.
4	Increase the retention rate of students (inclusive of non traditional students) to 70% within 3 years by bringing more industry standard technology into the classroom earlier in the curriculum through the development of an embedded skills first certificate (starting Fall 2025) within the AAS program	Keep students on path to completion by offering options that fit students' needs. Hands on with industry equipment will keep students involved as they acquire valuable experience that will translate to career building success	Program director and EMP faculty with approvals through Dean and VPAA offices	Measuring retention over the period	AY 2023-2024 develop curriculum AY 2023-2024 pass VSCC curriculum committee and secure TBR approval Fall 2025 offer certificate	Retention data is unavailable for recent periods. This will be gathered at earliest opportunity to form baseline

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The major funding for the initiatives is for 4A.1

Funding for this increase in state of the industry equipment is currently waiting news of award of a grant in the amount \$492,000. This funding will thoroughly revamp and expand the EMP equipment inventory and increase capabilities mentioned in the initiatives.

An example of the value of this equipment: a recent graduate of the EMP Video Production pathway secured an internship with a local company. The first thing the student was trained for was the use of the very equipment sought by EMP via this grant. The employer indicated that had the student already

been familiar with the equipment, the students would have been put immediately into a paying position.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

1. Mission Statement Alignment
 1. Program mission alignment to Institutional mission

The EMP program mission statement aligns well with the college mission statement addressing partnerships, engagement and economic development.

1. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcome Assessment
 1. Assessment Plan- Review and Rationale

It was not clear which of the 5 areas were being addressed by the text. I was not able to see the *Evidence: EMP, AAS Assessment tool* so I can only assume items were addressed. I would prefer another description instead of “smorgasboard” degree path.

1. Evidence of Student Learning
 1. *Analysis of Trends- Program Learning Outcomes- Data (2 years of data)*
 2. *Results – Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.*

This section had identifiable section headings and the chart was present. Data was not listed for 2020 and no explanation for the missing data. One assumes a COVID impact, but an explanation would have been helpful. Again, The PLOs and CLOs referenced were not present. I need more information to fully understand the specifics.

1. Improvement Initiatives
 1. Matrix- **2 Student Learning** and **2 Student Success** Initiatives (no more than 6 total)
 2. Initiative Budget- Budget details on any initiative that need financial consideration.

The information clearly showed a well-thought out plan but again it was not outlined in a way that a layperson could differentiate the Student Learning vs Student Success. The ideas are great. The budget information seems sufficient.

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

This is my first year on this committee and perhaps I should have had more guidance on what to look for in these reviews. I can did gain a better understanding of where the EMP program is going and I agree that a program that is technology driven must stay current with industry standard technology and skills.

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their

review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Increase availability of hands-on learning with state of the industry equipment.	The grant was approved. A 3 year Perkins grant was awarded. Equipment updates are in progress	Proper grant language to make purchases of required equipment	No changes	Equipment for ATMOS upgrade of Ramer studio has been purchased, delivered, and is being installed. Video equipment for this year's grant has been

		for all sectors of the EMP			delivered and is being used by students
2	Develop an advanced learning certificate for students who don't want a 4-year degree or are, along with certain community populations, interested in furthering certain skills or honing existing skills	Curriculum planning is ongoing	The studio refurbishment is a key part of the certificate facility needs	Time line is partially dependent on completion of facilities upgrades	The EMP faculty have developed a list of classes to be included in the certificate and which classes need to be developed. The development is scheduled to begin Summer/Fall 2025
3	Develop pathways for secondary schools to take DE courses and provide seamless transition to EMP at VSCC	Meetings with and initial agreements with three secondary schools have been held and are being codified	Pay for secondary school teachers was an issue. The issue has been resolved .	A one year delay was the result of the pay issue	Since resolution of the pay issues has been achieved, development of suitable curriculum formats is slated to be completed for some classes by Fall 2025 as the DE sections should be active.
4	Increase the retention rate of students (inclusive of non traditional students) to 70% within 3 years by bringing more industry standard technology into the classroom earlier in the curriculum through the development of an embedded skills first certificate (starting Fall 2025) within the AAS program	According to Factbook, the Fall to Fall retention rate over the last three years is 43.8%.	Cyclical ups and downs in the retention rate	No changes	Students support has been increased. The EMP has undergone a major curriculum realignment designed to address this issue. The new alignment allows students to design most of their own curriculum, thus removing the need to take classes the students deem unnecessary and will increase the likelihood of completion.

Close

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Fine Arts AFA - Studio Art Emphasis

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The art curriculum for the AFA Degree provides the standard pre-professional degree for artists and designers with an intensive education in problem-solving strategies, and skills for students looking to transfer to another Tennessee public university or select regionally accredited, non-profit Tennessee private colleges and universities to completed their baccalaureate degree. Additionally, this program serves students looking to take classes for personal growth, increased awareness of issues in art and design, and understand artistic practices within the community.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

As for the Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes, numbers for all areas meet goals to at least 70% with the lowest ranking being Expressive Platforms which is most likely due to each studio area focusing on specific skills within fine arts rather than on a wide variety of platforms in each course. Overall, our percentages of meeting each goal has increased between the assessments years 21-22 and 22-23 by an average of 4%.

Overall, the assessment plan to review each of the foundations areas (Drawing I, Drawing II, Foundations I and Foundations II) for the next few semesters will help us understand what achievement targets should change or if our assessment methods need adjusting. The course sequencing of students taking Drawing I and then Drawing II creates a logical path for students to complete the required courses within two years while scaffolding learning outcomes for great effectiveness.

Evidence:

- ART Studio, AFA Assessment Tool-1
- Assessment Rubric

- Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			90.21%	9.79%	95%	5%	
PLO 2			92.56%	7.44%	94.65%	5.35%	
PLO 3			75.12%	24.88%	76.88%	23.12%	
PLO 4			75.59%	24.41%	77.30%	22.70%	
PLO 5			71.83%	28.17%	70.97%	29.03%	
Course Learning Outcome 1350.1			93.33%	6.67%	66.66%	33.33%	
Course Learning Outcome 1350.2			93.33%	6.67%	83.33%	16.67%	
Course Learning Outcome AFA.4			86.67%	13.33%	50%	50%	

Course Learning Outcomes ART1350 1350.1 Formal Qualities 1350.2 Conceptual Ideas 1350.4 Craftsmanship

1. Analysis of trends

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Overall, the trends show that there is an increase in overall student learning between years 21-22 and 22-23 in each of the categories being evaluated. However, in relation to ART 1350 Foundations II Studio in particular, there are inconclusive results due to the lower number of assessments completed from the first round of assessments to the second round of assessments.

There are lower increases in Black and African American, as well as Asian student learning, with a larger gap in the percentage of goals met. However, there is still an upward trend showing that student learning is increasing, but there needs to be more effort in reaching these groups of students to reach the same level as other groups.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The Art Department could try to include a wider range of student examples, artist examples and resources for a wider variety of students in the classroom to reach students who may not have representation.

To increase student learning in artistic skills, there could be more focus on scaffolding projects and faculty working as a team within the art department to understand better how each class might influence one another so that students graduate with a more well-rounded foundational college art

education in which all studio areas relate to one another more cohesively. In doing so, students may find more relationships between these learning objectives in each course.

Evidence:

- AFA PLOs AY21-23
- AFA PLOs Gender AY21-23
- AFA PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- AFA PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- ART 1350 SLOs AY21-23
- AY21-23 AFA SLP Assessment Results

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Vitality Response

1. The program is growing in student population overall, particularly from Fall 2020 and 2021 to Fall 2022 when the student population in this area grew to 119 full time students. The participation in course evaluations has gone down quite a bit between Fall 2020 and Fall 2022, which shows the need for more encouragement to complete course evaluations or a wider range of course evaluations to be given in order to reach the most students effectively.
2. These results could be used to improve student success if we focus on the lower percentages within the student course evaluations, specifically the category that indicates a higher degree of students needing more access to faculty. As we are a department of just 4, and one of our full-time faculty travels between other campuses, we are in need of another full-time faculty member to help even out the class loads. Three of the four full-time faculty are consistently in an overload schedule of classes because we don't have enough studio space to teach more courses or faculty to teach them.

Evidence:

- ART Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Fine Arts- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1

	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Increase AFA Artistic Knowledge through expanding opportunities for students to meet with and understand methods used by contemporary artists in the field. PLO 4 (SL)	To provide students with a wider range of opportunities to understand contemporary practices within the art field, learn about job opportunities, and further their career goals within the arts.	Program Chair and VSCC Art Faculty	Increase PLO AFA 4 percentage of goals met to 80%.	AY 2023-2024 Discuss with faculty more visiting artists or gallery visit opportunities, and/or trips for students. AY 2024-2025 Set schedule for any or all of the above opportunities for students.	1. Average 77% goal met in AFA 4.
2	Increase the percentage of AFA 5 Expressive Platforms to 73%. PLO 5 (SL)	Offer students a wider variety of places and spaces to showcase their artwork as they create it throughout each semester, in addition to the Annual Student Art Show.	Program Chair and VSCC Art Faculty	Increase AFA 5 percentage of goals met to 73%.	AY 23-24 Work with our gallery coordinator and faculty to organize more student showcase opportunities, including summer student shows, t-shirt competitions, and flyers for school events. AY 24-25 Launch t-shirt competition, and post more opportunities for student engagement within the art department.	1. Average of 70% goal met.
3	Increase overall student success and	To allow faculty more time with students and	Program Chair, Administration	Student Course Evaluations	AY 23-24 Examine the courses needed most	1. 74% students agreed that they had

	respond to student evaluations pointing to need for more access to faculty.	to avoid the necessity of course overloads due to lack of space and faculty to meet the growing needs of students.			to avoid overloads for all faculty. AY 24-25 Explore solutions to spaces that might be used for studios, and possibility for a new faculty member.	access to their instructor.
4	Increase the success of Black and African American students according to student success results within the art department	To reach all students, including minority groups, and increase student success.	Program Chair, VSCC Art Faculty	Student Course Evaluations	AY 23-24 Assess the need for more representation of all student populations and groups. AY 24-25 Implement a wide range of examples for each class to include different perspectives, backgrounds, and cultures.	1. 26% goal met of Black or African American students for AFA 4 "Artistic Knowledge" 2. 20% goal met of Black or African American students for AFA 5 "Expressive Platforms"

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

Initiative related to AFA 4 Artistic Knowledge: In order to create a sustainable visiting artist program, we will need a stipend/budget of at least \$200 for each visiting artist, and preferably, accommodations paid for each artist to stay and visit with students for a day. We would like to host at least 1 visiting artist each semester, and rotate the media each artist works in to expose students to a wide variety of art techniques.

Initiative related to AFA 5 Expressive Platforms: The art department will need more studio space to accommodate the growing number of art majors, as well as at least one more full-time faculty member to fulfill needs of students and allow for fewer overload assignments.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Academic Program Review

1. Mission Statement Alignment
 1. Ties directly back to mission statement in terms of specifics related to curriculum, but also “personal growth” elements
2. Curriculum and Student Learning
 1. Review and rationale seem solid – goals being met at least 70%; rising between assessed years.
 1. While I don’t disagree with the plan to assess Drawing I/II and Foundations I/II, are there any other courses that would make sense to also assess, such as specific studio courses?
 2. Improvement in each PLO; amount of increase varies. CLOs not demonstrating the same increase; in fact, substantial decrease evident year over year.
 1. Decrease in CLO blamed on low response rate/small n value, but number of responses are not provided.
 2. Results include some initial ideas to increase student learning.
3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information
 1. Strengths = continued growth; Opportunities = focused effort to get evaluations submitted or more evaluations administered
 2. Evaluations can then be used to identify lower-scoring targets, and potentially identify or justify the need for additional staff.
4. Improvement Initiatives.
 1. Initiative 1: Expand opportunities for students to interact with artists in the field; Initiative 2: Offer students wider variety of places to display artwork; Initiative 3: Increase response rate on evaluations, respond accordingly to suggestions indicating need for more staff; Initiative 4: Increase success of African American Students
 1. How will the department proceed with Initiative 4 in light of recent changes to federal law (SFFA)?
 2. Budget needs are focused on Init. 1 (stipends/travel costs) and 2 (more faculty and studio space to accommodate growing program).

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

Overall, the report and findings are solid and thorough. Through the course of the program review, faculty identified key areas where the program tends to struggle, such as providing regular and frequent opportunities for students to display their artwork or identifying different career pathways for students and mentoring along those paths. Using that information, faculty then proposed solutions to these issues; these solutions could appeal to students in several ways while also allowing the College to develop new partnerships with external organizations and/or other artists in the field.

I’m interested in knowing more about the plans for how Initiative 2 will be accomplished if funding for additional faculty cannot be obtained. Have faculty already identified potential options for additional studio spaces that could be used? I’m aware this is part of the initiative; more information in this initiative may be helpful in determining whether the initiative is a success in future years. Further, there was an emphasis on increasing the number of evaluations submitted, but how specifically will faculty address this issue?

5.B DEAN’S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean’s should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No

EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Volunteer State Community College
Associate of Fine Art Degree Program
Academic Audit
Self-Study Report 2021-2022

Table of Contents

Part I: Introduction	2
Part II: Overall Performance	3
Part III: Performance by Focal Area	4
Part IV: Potential Initiatives	20
Part V: Matrix of Improvement Initiatives.....	21
Part VI: Follow-Up Report.....	22
Appendix A – Visual and Performing Arts Calendars.....	24
Appendix B – Scoring Rubrics	25
Appendix C – Music AFA Jury Sheet	27
Appendix D – Majors and Graduates	28
Appendix E – VPA Writing Assessment	29
Appendix F – Pre-/Post-Test Analysis Fall 2016-Spring 2020.....	31
Appendix G – Success and Retention Rates	32

Part I: Introduction

The AFA Degree at Volunteer State Community College is offered in two disciplines: Art and Music.

The AFA in Art (Studio) is a degree program that was first offered in Fall 2017. Since then, enrollment has grown significantly, more than doubling since the previous academic audit was submitted (see appendix D). The program is a Tennessee Transfer Pathways (TTP) degree option designed to prepare students for transfer into BFA programs in art and design. This degree allows students to focus more on developing their studio practice and technical and conceptual art skills, leading to stronger portfolios of work for transfer applications. It also helps to lessen the challenge these students face after transfer of having far too many studio art courses still to take and far too few general education and lecture courses to balance them out each semester during their junior and senior years.

The Art Department consists of four full-time faculty and between 7-12 adjunct instructors. Students in the Art AFA program take courses in drawing and foundations instruction, including two-dimensional and three-dimensional design, and choose from a variety of additional media-based studio courses including painting, printmaking, photography, graphic design, ceramics, and the occasional special topic studio course. Art majors normally participate in an annual art exhibition each spring in the college art gallery, and sometimes at off-campus sites as well, to showcase their work.

The AFA in Music, created Fall 2011, upon graduation provides a seamless transfer to any state of Tennessee four-year institution. As part of the TTP, it recognizes and promotes students' success in degree completion. The AFA offers students academic courses and performing opportunities, which align with the first two years of a Bachelor of Music degree at Tennessee institutions. The AFA offers private instruction in voice, piano, brass and guitar. Other performing opportunities include two choral groups, traditional and commercial, guitar ensemble, brass ensemble, and a commercial music ensemble. Students have the opportunity to record solo performances as well as departmental ensemble pieces showcased at the end of each semester and housed on our departmental [YouTube Channel](#).

As an outcome-based degree, the AFA is associated with behavioral objectives for the student at the course level. Learning objectives are designed for educational success and individual student growth, listed in course manuals. These goals and learning objectives are optimized to focus on student progress, promote collaboration in areas of study of lecture and lab courses and create numerous performance opportunities.

The Music department, part of Performing Arts, includes four full-time faculty members and approximately 13 adjunct faculty. The current number of AFA Music majors has declined since the previous Academic Audit in part due to COVID-19 but has seen an increase in the fall of 2021 and is currently at 28 students (see Appendix D).

This self-study was a collaboration between the Chairs of Performing Art and Art Departments, Professors Nicholas Reynolds and Nate Smyth, with input from faculty and students from both departments, as well as data collected from the Humanities Division, feedback from graduates, and meetings with members of the Volunteer State community who have important objective perspective about the self-study process. In addition, this study was reviewed by the Dean of Humanities Division, Erin Mann, and the Dean of Academic Support, Rhonda Gregory, as the academic audit coordinator.

Part II: Overall Performance

The Art and Music departments assess quality in our programs by collecting data (see appendices B and C) surrounding student performance in their studies, and by judging the quality of student work in the annual art exhibitions, music showcases, juries, concerts, and recitals. In addition, we make a habit of continually speaking with both students and stakeholders about what should and should not be included in the curriculum, what they would like to see changed or improved, etc.

Strengths

Although the courses in the Music and Art AFA degrees are mandated by TBR via the TTPs, Vol State shows its individual strength via commitment to our students:

- The variety of studio offerings in the Art AFA track: Unlike smaller colleges, we are able to offer regular courses in ceramics, photography, graphic design, printmaking, and painting, with dedicated spaces for each and studio access for students outside of regular classroom hours. This means students who begin their studies at Vol State before transferring to a BFA program elsewhere will have had very similar studio options to those available to them at university.
- The Art Gallery: The exhibition space in our SRB Humanities Building is a fantastic way to both display the work of our art students as well as to expose the whole college to fantastic art from around the country. We have also been able to bring many of the exhibiting artists to campus to lecture and engage in class discussions, lead studio critiques, and give technical demonstrations.
- The Music Theory course sequence in the Music AFA track: Beginning with Fundamentals of Music, students complete four semesters of music theory study, presently using Norton's *The Musician's Guide to Theory and Analysis* (Clendinning/Marvin). This is a comprehensive text, and by the end of Music Theory III, students have usually covered more than half of the book, which prepares them for continuing as juniors upon transfer into a Bachelor of Music program.
- Our Ensemble program in the Music AFA track: We offer a wide variety of student performance ensembles for credit (four semesters are required for graduation), including Commercial Music Ensembles with a focus on pop/rock and jazz, Commercial Vocal Ensemble (popular music), Vol State Singers (art music), Bluegrass Ablaze (bluegrass ensemble), Wind Ensemble, and Guitar and String Ensemble.

Key Findings

Here are some observations about deficits of our programs:

- The Visual Art Department has improved the deficit of full-time to part-time instructors, but we are still working near capacity for our physical studio spaces. We have had to offer studios on Fridays many semesters due to this limitation, and it cuts into our ability to provide studio work time for students to complete work outside of the scheduled class times. If our programs grow any more, then we will need additional space.
- Need for outreach/recruitment: the music program has seen a decline in enrollment since the last academic audit. High School Music Day was created as a recruiting tool but was not held during the spring of 2021 due to COVID-19. Significant improvement has been made in establishing relationships with local area high schools and coordinating the date for High School Music Day to be held when most high school music students are able to attend.
- In terms of physical resources, the Music department would benefit from a concert grand piano to be permanently housed in Caudill Hall, the performance hall.
- With the rate of pay for adjunct faculty (as well as full-time, although we feel there's much more room for improvement in the adjunct scale), we are severely limited as to the number and caliber

of instructors that we can attract and keep, and who can thus learn effective methods of imparting course material over time. As we have very little control over this directly, we plan to continue to include the problem in reports like this and to remind our administrators regularly to keep bringing it up in meetings with the people who *do* have some control in this area.

Part III: Performance by Focal Area

1: Learning Outcomes

The AFA in both Music and Art maintains learning objectives for each course offered in the catalog, and these objectives are clearly stated in the course manuals and in individual syllabi for all courses. With the adoption of TTPs, the process of preparing students for successful matriculation to senior institutions has been facilitated in some areas. We continue to emphasize practical preparation for entry-level opportunities in Nashville's music and design industries.

1.1 Program Learning Outcomes

Art

Art faculty discuss program learning outcomes (described in more detail in section 2.1) at the start of each school year and on a regular basis during the semester as it comes up in classes. They expect art students to practice theoretical understanding and hands-on creation. Graduates from the Art Program will:

- Demonstrate skills in critical thinking and visual analysis;
- Demonstrate fundamental skills in drawing, design, and composition;
- Demonstrate knowledge of functions, materials, and history of art;
- Demonstrate knowledge and skills in at least one area beyond drawing and design.

Music

Music faculty meet on a semesterly basis to discuss goals for our majors based on their performance in private lessons, ensembles, and music theory/ear training. Upon graduation AFA music majors will:

- Demonstrate an understanding of styles and structures of music and be able to apply this knowledge through performance;
- Demonstrate competencies in theory and aural skills through sight-singing performance, generating and analyzing harmony, creating and notating self-generated musical ideas, and the graphic dictation of aural sounds;
- Demonstrate cooperative learning and creative expression through performance as a member of performing ensembles;
- Demonstrate high level of performance attributes through private lessons and end-of-semester juries.

1.2 Student Learning Outcomes

Student learning outcomes in Art and Music are specific to each course and are explicitly listed on the syllabi for core courses within the respective AFA curriculum for each area. Syllabi may be found in the Humanities division office files for all classes.

Art

As described in more detail in section 2.1, Art faculty review courses for appropriate goals and learning outcomes at the start of each semester, as well as whenever a problem or question arises, both through written updates and through discussion with the teaching faculty. A master syllabus template is maintained for every course to assure uniformity as courses may change hands from semester to semester. Assessment of objectives is also reviewed. Some Art course student learning examples are:

- Understanding of the fundamental visual elements and principles of art and design. (ART 1340 Foundations Studio I)
- Connecting relationships of works of art to the social processes of its culture including, but not limited to: economy, religion, geography, technology, science, intellectual development, political structures, philosophy, and social structures. (ART 2000 Art History Survey I and ART 2020 Art History Survey II)
- Organize and construct 3D forms using the elements and principles of design. (ART 1350 Foundations Studio II)
- An ability to record visual impressions from the environment through the use of line and tone with acceptable accuracy. (ART 1045 Drawing I and ART 1050 Drawing II)

Music

Music remains an outcome-based discipline, with numerous behavioral objectives at the course level. Learning objectives designed for educational student success and individual student growth, while still stated on course syllabi, are also available to students for every assignment in their Connect software, and/or are stated on course syllabi specific to the skill or application (instrument or voice). Music faculty use these goals and other stated learning objectives from syllabi to discuss student progress, to collaborate in areas such as Music Theory lectures and lab courses, and to create numerous performance opportunities for students in all areas of music. Some examples of syllabus-level course outcomes are:

- A fundamental understanding of music theory and ear training (MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music, MUS 1057/1058 Theory I/Ear Training I, MUS 1555/1156 Theory II/Ear Training II, MUS 2055/2056 Theory III/Ear Training III)
- A basic knowledge of keyboard skills, ability to perform all 12 major and minor scales. (MUS 1027 Class Piano I and MUS 1127 Class Piano II)
- Introductory competencies in private lessons (voice, piano, guitar, woodwind, percussion, strings, and brass).
- Preparation in a general education core for success in transferring to four-year universities.

1.3 Evaluation

A desired outcome of our AFA programs is the common goal of helping students transfer to senior universities, a process that has been greatly facilitated by the TTPs and University Parallel. To that end, our learning outcomes are largely modeled after those in the university programs that our students would be transferring into, particularly those institutions that adhere to the TTP. The majority of these outcomes are relatively universal for higher education programs in these areas, usually requiring adjustments only to keep up with changes in professional practices, new equipment, or when we identify an unaddressed student need through discussions with relevant stakeholders and student performance in exhibitions, recitals, juries, and general coursework.

2: Curriculum and Co-curriculum

The AFA degrees offer an array of co-curricular activities in addition to, and in support of, their curricula. These activities aim to reinforce the learning outcomes described in the previous section and to improve the students' skills as artists and performers. Curriculum continues to fall in line with other state schools in keeping with the TTP.

2.1 Collaboration

Art

The foundation of the department is based on a belief that art is a way of learning that enriches life and builds creative and skilled individuals. When not prohibited by the recent pandemic, the Art Department holds annual faculty meetings/retreats that include adjunct faculty. During remote instruction, this took place on Zoom. Full-time faculty have ongoing discussions of department and student needs at least weekly. Since it is such a small department, meetings happen as needed between classes or over lunch (or more recently, in the form of phone calls, text messages, and video conferencing) to assure that everyone stays informed and connected. This ongoing discussion allows for an evolving flow of ideas that facilitates true problem solving. It also promotes collaborative planning and awareness of the Art Department as a whole that plays to the overall strengths of our faculty and facilities.

Additional examples of collaboration include planning with the Entertainment Media Production (EMP) program, which requires students to take art courses, and working with faculty and the new Gallery Coordinator to increase in the number and quality of artists exhibiting in the gallery and giving lectures, presentations, and demonstrations for students. During the height of the pandemic, with in-person exhibitions and visits off the table, emphasis shifted temporarily to building our social media presence.

Music

Music faculty meet at least once a semester to collaborate regarding curriculum changes and additions. Meetings have agendas but formal minutes were not kept. We will begin keeping minutes this spring. Examples of collective decisions made recently at such meetings include:

- Adjunct theory instructor William Fitzhugh is completing a course update for MUS 1002 to remove *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) from the required course materials. Instead, he will supplement the course with his own worksheets, preparing students for Theory/Ear Training 1.
- Addition of Fall sections of Vol State Singers and Spring sections of Showstoppers (now called Commercial Voice Ensemble) to provide AFA students more ensemble opportunities.
- Our annual High School Music Day will take place in Spring 2022 for the fifth time, involving all full-time music faculty and some adjuncts collaborating with Steve Bishir from the EMP program in an “open house” style effort to give local high school students an opportunity to come and experience our faculty and facilities in action.

2.2 Content and Sequencing

Routine advising (Campus Connect throughout the Summer and full-time faculty advising during the semester) provides faculty an opportunity to regularly review the sequence of our courses and even methods for teaching them. Sequencing and teaching effectiveness is also a regular consideration as part of schedule management.

Art

First available in Fall 2017, the Art AFA grew out of the AA in Art (Studio) program and the need for a program that would better equip students for transfer to university and for work in the arts. Some flexibility in sequencing is required, since students go in different directions with their studio work and because the need for learning support classes is so common in art students during their first year. One-on-one faculty advising is very important.

In the general education requirements, students are encouraged to take English Composition I and II, any required learning support courses, and Art History I and II during their first year. They are also normally scheduled for Drawing I and II and at least the Foundations I studio courses their first year, before

sampling the other studio courses. There is some flexibility for students, but there are scheduling challenges with courses that are only scheduled yearly rather than every semester. There are also some pre-requisite requirements in place:

- Drawing I is a prerequisite for Drawing II as well as Painting.
- Foundations Studio I is a prerequisite for Graphic Design and Printmaking.

Music

Curriculum in the Music AFA degree is comprised of several categories. Perhaps the most emphasis is placed on Music Theory, Ear Training, Private Lessons and Ensembles, although much time is spent norming our approach to our MUS 1030 Introduction to Music classes since we offer most sections of that class. The five different areas of focus that we have in our curriculum are:

- Music Theory/Ear Training
- Private Lessons
- Ensembles
- Class Piano track (two semesters)
- MUS 1030 (Introduction to Music)

Faculty recommend that students enroll in Introduction to Music and Class Piano I during their first semester of study. Introduction to Music covers a broad overview of musical history, helping students better understand a variety of styles, and Class Piano I outlines the basics of playing the piano, note and rhythm reading, and understanding basic harmony. Students have the option to test out of our prerequisite theory course (MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music); however, most students are advised to enroll in it.

2.3 Curriculum Review

Art

Full-time Art faculty have regular discussions about the curriculum and ways to improve it based on student performance and faculty feedback. Discussions over the last couple years have included requiring Foundations Studio I as a prerequisite for the Printmaking course (which is now the case), and integrating ePortfolios into studio courses as a way of evaluating learning outcomes (which turned out to not work well at all no matter how we tried to fit them in).

Currently much of the discussion is centered around developing and rolling out additional graphic design courses, as conversations with students have shown this to be the clear direction that they are most interested in going with their studies. We are interested in the possibility of developing a new program around graphic design. We've already gotten a new design course approved as of January 2022, and are beginning to look at how this program would impact this AFA program in terms of enrollment and course offerings. We have also started to pool our knowledge to compile a shared resource listing recent events, artists, and art movements outside of the generic art history canon that we can use to expand what we are teaching to include more interesting examples outside of the straight white males that dominate the field.

As a TTP program, the basic outline of the Art AFA curriculum was agreed upon by a TBR committee made up of representatives of TBR and UT art departments, as well as other local art departments, and cannot be changed without TBR approval. This has been a problem to an extent, as it prohibits us from offering some courses to our AFA students that they really want to take in order to improve their skills.

Music

As with the Art AFA, TBR representatives from area school music departments formulated the basic outline of the degree. It is difficult to effect much change, but a few minor changes have been successful:

- Ben Graves rebranded Show Stoppers as Commercial Vocal Ensemble in Spring 2022. This was a decision to align our courses with the name most listed in the Tennessee four-year institutions. This change offered a more recognizable name upon transfer to another music department, producing less confusion about the content of the course.
- Collective reviewing of adjunct faculty applications, resulting in the discussion and hiring of a new adjunct piano instructor in Spring 2020. This allows the students to continue with Class Piano I and II, while providing an additional opportunity for private lessons, which raises the performance skill level to meet requirements in the four-year institutions.
- Since the bulk of our students attend the following schools, we continue to consult with ETSU, MTSU, Cumberland, APSU and Belmont for articulation concerns. This affects course assignments, such as repertoire and ensemble choices.
- MUS 1030 Introduction to Music represents the fine arts credit in the department. Full-time and adjunct faculty teach the course. This course was redesigned in summer 2021 by adjunct instructor William Fitzhugh, to reflect the updated 10th edition of the Roger Kamien textbook, which includes a more diverse, equitable, and inclusive approach to the composers in the text, plus easier integration of the e-book with the audio/video material.

2.4 Co-Curricular Activities

Music and Art have no shortage of co-curricular activities, most of which serve to give our students real-world, if not professional, experience, prior to their entering the job market/workforce. Each department's faculty establish opportunities independently to align with performance and skill outcomes within the program.

Art

Many of the activities we do are regular, annual events that require just some tweaking each year (like finding a new juror for the student art exhibition). Others are proposed by faculty or decided as a group (such as setting up student profiles on our social media pages in lieu of a gallery exhibition during the pandemic). Examples of recent co-curricular activities include:

- Annual Juried Student Exhibition. Students learn to prepare for exhibition, experience the competitive environment, install an exhibition and interact at a public reception. This exhibit is juried by a different visiting artist/educator each year. Awards and prizes are given.
- Social media student profiles. During the pandemic, instead of a physical gallery exhibition, we encouraged students to participate in our social media presence with a campaign displaying student work and brief profiles of advanced students and their inspirations.
- Participating in and hosting the Intercollegiate Art Exhibition, a group show of work done by students in all of the TN community college art programs. This is organized and curated by a different TN community college each year.
- Every year or two we schedule student visits to nearby university art programs, such as MTSU, where our students most recently got a print demonstration from local printmaker Nick Satinover.
- We work to bring local and national working artists to campus for exhibitions, lectures, demonstrations, and to interact with our students whenever possible. These are proposed by faculty and decided by group vote in collaboration with our gallery coordinator. Some recent examples include: Eric Beehn, Landon Crowell, Richard Painter, Connie Smith, Cortland Jones, Heather Jones, Rachel Mauser, Chip Boles, Monica Stewart, Erinn Nordeman, Kathryn Polk, Jeffrey, and Ted Jones.

Music

Individual faculty in music ensemble and private instruction courses plan for their students to perform multiple times per semester in various events both on campus and off-campus. In a normal, non-pandemic year, off-campus performance opportunities are common. Commercial Music Ensembles perform at Squarefest and donor events such as the Harvest Moon Soiree, Vol State Singers has performed in collaboration with West End United Methodist Church, and vocal students have performed at the Gallatin Public Library's Bach's Lunch series. For the MUS 1030 Introduction to Music courses, students attend and write reports on two concerts per semester (and moved to online videos during the beginning of the pandemic). Mostly in conjunction with the Private Lessons and Ensembles components of the Music AFA program, there exist a host of opportunities for co-curricular involvement for students:

- Although aimed at area high school students, High School Music Day takes place annually in February (apart from February 2021, due to COVID-19), and involves select AFA Music students. Events include guest presentations and performances, tours of the facilities, and a variety of breakout sessions led by music faculty (see Appendix F, "Professor Ben Graves," for sessions).
- While part of the curriculum and required, our ensembles routinely engage in off-campus and "outside the classroom" activities; Vol State Showstoppers, Commercial Music Ensembles, students from Songwriting classes and Bluegrass Ablaze take part in the Spring Showcase and the Vol State Winter Showcase, and the Vol State Singers and select voice students perform in off-campus concerts and recitals, all arranged by the instructors.
- Vocal students of Professors Nancy Slaughter and Mark Granlund perform in the Gallatin Public Library's Bach's Lunch series, a free public event on the first Tuesday of every month.
- AFA Voice and Piano majors present sophomore recitals (vocal majors rehearse and perform with Chair Nicholas Reynolds on piano). Upon successful graduation, Austin Peay State University allows vocal students to use a recording of the recital to substitute as the students' junior level hearing, allowing students to transfer as a junior.
- Students continue to contribute to performance events for the VSCC Foundation, the local community (such as Spring and Fall Squarefests), and numerous VSCC campus events including the Festival of Lights and the semesterly Commencement Ceremony.
- The department produces at least two live performances a year that are videorecorded and shared to the department's [YouTube Channel](#). Pre-Covid, Music and the EMP program collaborated on the Interdisciplinary CD project, producing two original CD recordings in support of the Songwriting curriculum and Winter Show.
- Piano students enrolled in MUS 174 Piano Lessons often participate in studio classes in which students perform for each other and receive constructive feedback.

3: Teaching and Learning

The ongoing evolution of individual instructors and their teaching methods is at the heart of the AFA degree programs; our programs are only as good as the faculty who teach them! All the full-time and most of the part-time faculty are practicing artists, which is crucial in the teaching of art and all its disciplines. Art faculty are privy to individual methods by monitoring fellow faculty members' classes, while the Music faculty often spend time discussing individual students' progress, since it often involves individual instruction or multiple classes, all of which work together to achieve a common purpose.

3.1 Collaboration

Art

Faculty in the Art Department have ongoing discussions about course content and the best way to teach classes. We regularly share relevant articles, web links, and videos to share with our classes, and we let

each other know when we have found an especially effective activity. Faculty in Art also communicate with each other throughout the semester about students who may need special attention or intervention. We have recently partnered with our EMP program to share storage and a new checkout system to facilitate students checking equipment out for use outside of the classroom.

The art department collaborates locally with Sumner County elementary schools, hosting an annual art exhibition of student work from nearby elementary schools with a very highly attended reception each spring. And in the summer of 2021, we also hosted an exhibition celebrating the career of local art educator Doris Bills and the work of her students.

Music

Educational approaches can vary in creative fields such as music, and in classes such as Ear Training or studio instruction, faculty can deploy techniques unique to everyone to achieve a desired learning outcome. As previously mentioned, this makes communication and sharing of ideas imperative within the department, and frequent meetings are required to discuss the practicality of various approaches. Given the Theory/Ear Training requirements of the EMP program, there is an overlap between the Music AFA, EMP, and Recording Industry Management programs, resulting in greater collaboration between faculty.

High School Music Day began in Spring 2017 and offers opportunities for collaboration between faculty and members of the professional musical community. We offer a variety of breakout sessions for high school and middle school students to recruit for our programs, but also simply to foster awareness of our degrees and educational tracks for students who may not yet be thinking seriously about college.

End-of-semester juries are another opportunity for collaboration within the music program, aimed at Music AFA majors. Although AFA juries have different sub-sets (voice, piano, brass, guitar, and string), faculty members from different instrumental areas often evaluate more than just the jury involving their applied instrument. Finally, end-of-semester showcases and voice concerts provide other collaborative opportunities for students and faculty.

3.2 Effective Use of Instructional Materials and Technology:

Teaching materials vary from instructor to instructor in some areas of Art and Music. As in all fields, technology is increasingly prevalent in the AFA programs.

Art

Examples of technology and instructional materials we use in the Art AFA program that are standard equipment in their respective industry fields include:

- An Apple computer lab with laser and inkjet printers, a large flatbed scanner, and the Adobe Creative Suite of design software,
- A class set of Wacom digital drawing tablets,
- A full class set of DSLR cameras for student use,
- A digital ceramics kiln,
- Ventilation booths for using spray fixatives and ceramics glazes, and
- High-end flashlights with colored filters to demonstrate additive color mixture and Enchroma glasses that “correct” for color blindness. (These two aren’t industry standards, but are effective in demonstrating phenomena to students in class.)

Newly acquired equipment that is now being phased into regular use includes:

- A class set of MacBooks equipped with current design software,

- A class set of iPad Pros with Apple Pencils to be used in design, drawing, and painting classes as well as Intro to Art lecture courses,
- A full class set of new DSLR camera kits, and
- An upgraded photo printer and a new color laser copier.

Music

Examples of learning materials and technology that have been found to be effective in the Music AFA degree program are listed below. Effectiveness of these tools over time will be evaluated based on student success in academic courses and students' observed progress in performance courses.

- The Music Department continues to use McGraw-Hill's Connect software for teaching MUS 1030 Introduction to Music. The software provides an electronic copy of the book as well as all homework assignments and tests in an online format. Although this approach has its pros and cons, it has become the norm, and the opportunity it affords for the "flipped classroom" where class time can be devoted to conceptual demonstration and discussion, has proven particularly advantageous. So much so, that hybrid sections that allow for one discussion day (rather than two) but otherwise resemble an online section, are being integrated into the schedule. With this change, which took place in 2015, we can establish a greater consistency in our approach to teaching this class by using a Model Course shell in eLearn, and the sharing of strategies has proven easier and more fruitful. The student success rate in MUS 1030 has proven to be very high, with the majority of the students receiving As and Bs.
- uTheory and Aurelia are web-based applications used in theory instruction. uTheory, used in Fundamentals of Music, is an individual tutorial practice and response, giving students immediate feedback. Aurelia is a music dictation and ear-training tool used in the upper-level Music Theory and Ear Training classes. During the pandemic, additional phone apps like MyEarTraining, Chords Pad, Music Theory, and Solfa were used to help raise students' skill level and grades. After using these phone apps, the average grade improved from a C to a B in theory courses.
- The Clendenning series of texts and educational materials have been invaluable for our Music Theory and Ear Training class sections. They have proven to be successful at preparing our graduates for transition to 4-year schools' theory and ear training courses.
- Recent technology purchases include 25 iPads and Apple Pencils and 25 MacBooks, available for music students and faculty to check out. These feature apps and programs for music reading and notation, composition, ear training, and music arranging, helping prepare students to be a 21st-century musician by embracing technology.
- When the Covid-19 pandemic forced education online, instructors embraced Zoom for musical instruction and the Acapella app for pre-recorded collaborative musical collages, showing students that online musical education is possible and effective.

3.3 Evaluation of Effectiveness of Teaching Methods/Materials

Faculty are regularly evaluated by their supervisors and their peers:

- Full-time faculty undergo peer observations annually, or every three years after receiving tenure.
- Full-time faculty submit a detailed self-assessment and are evaluated by the Dean of the Humanities Division annually.
- Part-time faculty are observed and evaluated by full-time faculty from their department, or by the Humanities Adjunct Coordinator, and meet with their evaluators to discuss the results and how best to act on them.

Art

The Art Department faculty, in their regular discussions and meetings, evaluate the effectiveness of course materials and teaching methods. Some recent changes resulting from these discussions include:

- Out of necessity, we have completely reimagined how we can offer our courses remotely or in a hybrid format where fully remote learning is feasible. We are now transitioning back to campus as much as we are able to safely (remote learning isn't ideal for the majority of our studio courses), but there are a lot of discussions taking place right now about all of the ways we can continue to use some of the things we have learned from this experience. For example, video conferencing could be an option for some work sessions when the instructor cannot be on campus, our eLearn learning management system is now being used to perform many of the functions we had hoped to use ePortfolios for, and we are now beginning to post important demonstrations and lectures online as recordings for students to refer to as needed.
- We have worked with our Institutional Effectiveness team to create standardized rubrics (see Appendix B) for evaluating student work and the effectiveness of our studio instruction. We are embedding the rubrics into our eLearn course shells to streamline the process, and we will be able to gauge a baseline score for this metric once we have had the rubric in use for a bit longer.
- The department has added 20 more DSLR cameras to our equipment to help students be more successful in the Photography course without having to purchase their own cameras. We also reevaluated and revamped the checkout process for borrowing cameras in collaboration with the EMP program. This helps make the course less prohibitively expensive for students, and thus more equitable.
- As mentioned before, the department has also recently acquired classroom sets of MacBook laptops and iPad Pros with Apple Pencils. We will begin using them in Foundations I classes where students don't normally have easy access to computers, and in Drawing I and II and Painting classes to be able to explore digital drawing and painting, and from there we will be exploring additional uses.

Music

Music has seen examples of evaluation of teaching methods and materials recently:

- The MUS 1030 Introduction to Music instructors have been using the McGraw Hill Connect software since the last academic audit. Student success rate in these courses is quite high in all three methods of instruction: face-to-face, hybrid, and asynchronous. This past summer, adjunct instructor William Fitzhugh (who teaches Fundamentals of Music and guitar lessons), rebuilt the course to accommodate the newer, 10th edition of the Roger Kamien textbook. This text includes more composers who have been historically underrepresented (particularly BIPOC and female composers) and has an easier integration of the e-book with the audio/video material.
- The music library, complete with moving storage racks, recently acquired new choral, vocal, and piano music that students have already been using and performing.
- During the pandemic, it became necessary for students enrolled in Piano Instruction and Class Piano to continue instruction and practice remotely from home, and 11 new Yamaha P71 keyboards (complete with keyboard stand, pedals, music stand, and adjustable bench) were purchased. Even though instruction is now in-person again, students without pianos at home continue to checkout keyboards. Snowball microphones were purchased for faculty to use, providing a much higher-quality sound on the student's end when participating in Zoom lessons and classes.
- Within the past year, the music program purchased MacBooks and iPads with Apple Pencils for both students and faculty to use. Programs and apps allow students to compose, arrange, and mix music, read and annotate scores. The keyboard lab has been upgraded to include a brand-new Yamaha keyboards with instructor's station; the newer keyboards provided a better touch and sound for Class Piano students.

- Due to student interest and to grow our instrument collection, we recently purchased a tenor saxophone, trombone, and a professional-level clarinet, available for student checkout.
- MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music, as mentioned earlier, underwent a course revision to remove *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) from the required course materials. Adjunct theory instructor William Fitzhugh will supplement the course with his own worksheets, preparing students for Theory/Ear Training 1.

3.4 Analysis and Modification of Teaching Methods

As mentioned above in section 3.3, faculty meet with their evaluators after observations and/or assessments are conducted. They discuss strengths, weaknesses, and brainstorm ways to improve their teaching methods. Faculty also meet after receiving data from course assessments (pre- and post-test data, QEP rubrics, grade distribution, etc.) and student evaluations to see if any areas can be improved.

Art

Faculty discussions of student progress often lead to changes in teaching methods in art studio courses. This is especially true of Foundations I classes, which include constantly changing student projects as instructors share ideas and reevaluate what might work best based on the overall quality of student output, student understanding of underlying learning objectives independent of output, and overall student engagement with and enthusiasm for the assignment. Drawing I and II classes tend to share still-life setups to keep different sections relatively standardized. These still-life setups are always tailored to the specific skills that students as a group need to develop further in order to meet course learning outcomes, as determined by the instructor's informal ongoing in-class assessment.

We have also begun using a new evaluation procedure for studio courses that we hope will help guide these modifications in a more focused way as we gather enough data to begin seeing trends (sample rubric in appendix B).

Music

Music has recently seen modification of collective approaches to teaching. A few examples include:

- In MUS 1002 Music Fundamentals, the Theory in a Box tutorials are no longer used since the company went out of business and have been replaced uTheory, an online program allowing students to complete assignments with live feedback and immediate grades. uTheory provides a better learning system for students in that they receive real-time feedback and can use mobile devices, allowing them the convenience of completing work without needing to print assignments.
- Students in MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music have been using *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) for at least three years, requiring students to purchase an additional textbook (*The Musician's Guide to Theory and Analysis* by Clendinning and Marvin) for Theory 1-3. Music faculty members are in the process of revising the required text for MUS 1002 to remove *Introductory Musicianship* from the required course materials. Students have expressed financial concerns at needing to buy an additional textbook, leading to the change in required materials.
- The course texts for Class Piano I and II have been slightly revised to include only one book per class (Class Piano I uses the *Prep Level* and Class Piano II uses *Level I* from Daniel Landes' *Class Piano Resource Materials*). Previously, students were required to purchase two books per class, and the texts were unnecessarily redundant.

3.5 Professional Development

It is perhaps the greatest evidence of our ability to demonstrate materials and guide our students through creative growth that the faculty of the Art and Music AFA programs continue to practice their crafts as professionals; faculty continue to exhibit, perform, play gigs, and maintain active presences in the

community as artists. This is imperative to maintain credibility since many students will not be convinced of instructors' abilities until they see them in action outside the classroom. In addition, faculty engage in ongoing professional development as educators through Vol State's faculty-led Teaching and Learning Center (TLC). The TLC offers an array of faculty development sessions throughout the fall, spring, and summer on topics such as diversity, equity, and inclusion, technology-enhanced learning, student engagement, etc. They also provide online resources and a blog where faculty can collaborate across disciplines. For more information, visit the TLC's website: <https://libguides.volstate.edu/tlc>.

Art

Art faculty are exhibition professionals and also provide artistic or educational services to outside groups. This also serves as a recruiting tool to the community and a networking opportunity with colleagues at colleges and universities in the region. When funding and time allow, Art faculty members also attend educational and art conferences. Recent examples:

- Abigail Felber: developed and co-hosted PD trainings *Culturally Responsive Teaching and the Brain*, *Alternative Assessments*, and *Are You Still Watching?: Self-Care for Educators*; attended SGC conference in 2018; led a Study Abroad group and taught a course in India in 2020; serves as leader for the Teaching Learning Commons.
- Patrick Green: Board Member of the Gallatin Arts Council; attended NCECA conference in 2019 and 2021; featured artist for the Fall Creek Falls State Park in Summer 2017; participated in 15 group exhibitions since 2017.
- Nathaniel Smyth: participated in the Hendersonville Arts Council group exhibition called *Humane Society: A View From Our Lenses*; attended GenCon conferences in 2017, 2018, and 2019.
- Shane Prine is brand new at Vol State beginning in Fall 2021, but he also has a strong exhibition record and has served as a juror and guest lecturer many times over the last few years.
- Art faculty also participate in the Faculty Art Exhibition on campus every 1-2 years.

Music

All four full-time faculty are active as professionals, attend conferences, and participate in professional development, although limited funding often makes this difficult. Participation in such events helps keep us current with best practices. A few examples include:

- Ben Graves performs regularly with his jazz trio in Nashville.
- Nancy Slaughter performs as a worship musician and leader at area churches.
- Lynn Peterson performs as a sideman in various capacities at Nashville area venues.
- Nicholas Reynolds regularly performs recitals, gives masterclasses, and teaches at music festivals.

3.6 Student Persistence and Success

In general, both Art and Music slightly outperform college averages for persistence and retention, and in the past two years, graduation rates for both degrees have also exceeded VSCC averages. (Please refer to Appendix G for student success and retention data.) Perhaps the most critical single element relative to student success is advising of our Music and Art AFA majors. In addition to the advising practices of the Art and Music departments, we also utilize an electronic early alert system that allows us to provide feedback to students about their progress while providing documentation to relevant college administration. Vol State has full-time completion advisors who follow up with students after an alert indicates a problem, which has made communication and response time much more effective.

Art

As the Art AFA program began to grow, the department saw a sharp increase in advising requirements and updated advising practices accordingly. New students in the program now receive an extremely thorough explanation of curriculum, course options, and registration processes. By front-loading advising

in this way, students become much more self-sufficient. It has reduced registration problems and student confusion, and subsequent advising sessions are much simpler and less time consuming.

As data has indicated a drop in our retention, likely as a result of moving studio classes online in the midst of the pandemic, our focus has shifted more to developing relationships with our students early, especially in core classes like Foundations Studio I, Drawing I and Art History Survey I. We also fully expect that the new design offerings coming soon will have a big impact on retention since we will more directly be meeting student expectations/demands.

Music

Music has identified and begun to correct a handful of critical oversights in the advising process of its majors having to do with catalog information as represented in DegreeWorks, the worksheets that all students can use with their advisors to map a plan towards graduation. We have attempted to make it clearer to students what they must do in what order to fulfill their degree requirements. Chair Nicholas Reynolds has assumed the responsibility of contacting all declared Music AFA majors at the beginning of each semester and furnishing a list of requirements, namely:

- Each Music AFA student must take or test out of MUS 1002 (Music Fundamentals) their first semester. Since the following three Music Theory/Ear Training courses in the four-semester Theory/Ear Training track are only offered once a year in specific semesters, if they fail to take this course in the Fall, they will be delayed a semester from graduating in two years.
- Music AFA students must take an applied private lesson and be enrolled in an ensemble every semester or totaling four of each of these classes.
- Each Music AFA major must take Class Piano I and Class Piano II or take private piano lessons which equip them to successfully perform an end of the semester jury representing the respective material from these classes.

Other examples of our commitment to student success in Music include:

- Conducting exit interviews with students upon successful graduation and integrating suggestions from Course Evaluations into faculty teaching methods.
- A more rigorous and hands-on approach to student advising helps ensure that students are well-advised by music faculty for the duration of their studies at Vol State. This will enable students to graduate in a timely fashion and guarantee success in transferring to a four-year institution. We expect to improve retention by at least 5-10% with this new approach.
- We use the technology of the EMP's recording facilities to provide students with valuable objectivity through the recording process. This interdisciplinary collaboration has resulted in two Bellwether Award nominations for excellence within the two departments.
- Piano labs are used as teaching tools in applying skills in composition, arranging, and music theory, and are available for student practice outside of class if practice rooms are occupied.
- In the summer of 2021, Nicholas Reynolds worked with the previous Chair Ben Graves to approve the purchase of 17 new Yamaha keyboards to replace the much older Kurzweil keyboards.
- During the COVID-19 pandemic, Nicholas Reynolds and Ben Graves approved the purchase of 11 keyboards for students enrolled in Class Piano or piano lessons to check out to practice from home. The keyboards are full-sized with weighted keys, a pedal, a keyboard stand, music stand, and an adjustable bench.
- Chair Nicholas Reynolds gave a workshop for Sumner County high school and middle school music teachers in the summer of 2021. The workshop established connections with many area schools, which will hopefully positively affect recruitment numbers. It has already led to Vol State

hosting the Middle Tennessee Vocal Association State Solo and Ensemble Competition in May 2022 and the possible donation of older keyboards from the piano lab to a high school in need.

4: Student Learning Assessment

4.1 Indicators of Student Learning Success

For Art and Music AFA students, the best benchmarks of student success are examples of the work they complete during their educational experience at Vol State. Thus, Art and Music faculty assess student learning in a more holistic and organic way than is possible in some other fields.

Art

Student success is gauged largely through the quality of the work they make: how well they can demonstrate a given technique or principle of design in class projects, and the overall quality of the work as a whole. This is especially relevant each spring when students submit work for the Annual Student Art Exhibition. We also put a lot of emphasis on the successes of our graduates in transferring into BFA programs and gaining employment and freelance work in related fields.

In an attempt to make this process a little less subjective, we also developed the studio assessment rubric found in Appendix B. This rubric was kept simple, as it's still ultimately a subjective assessment, but also so that the items being scored on the rubric can provide information about individual classes and student motivation and also directly reflect the program goals listed in section 1. This data will be a way to identify trends over time.

Examples of student artwork can be viewed at <https://www.volstate.edu/humanities/art>, and more can be made available during the site visit.

Music

The Pre- and Post-Tests provide data about student learning, specifically for Music and Art 1030 students. Additionally, Music faculty use several other performance-based assessment methods:

- Music students in the Songwriting classes, Bluegrass ensemble, Commercial Music Ensembles, and Show Stoppers all contribute to end-of-semester video recording projects that provide a valuable document of students' growth and ability at important junctures in their evolution.
- End-of-semester juries assess growth from our Private Lessons program, which is at the core of the Music AFA (see Appendix C).
- End-of-semester and regular performances of performance ensembles.
- Theory and Ear Training classes embrace traditional, regular sight-singing tests and end-of-semester exams.

4.2 Faculty Assessment of Student Learning

Our students are, almost without exception, active in their fields; as previously mentioned, there are numerous performances, recordings, or other semester-long endeavors that they are charged with completing. With this project-oriented approach to their disciplines, students give faculty an opportunity to monitor and guide their learning experience over time.

Art

Art students are expected to practice not only theoretical understanding but hands-on individualized creation. Student work is evaluated every few weeks (sometimes much more frequently depending on the class and the projects) by teachers and peers in formal oral &/or written critiques. In each course, teachers

follow and provide written rubrics appropriate to the media for evaluating student achievement of objectives (see sample in Appendix B).

- The art department ends the year with a juried exhibition, enlisting an arts professional or art faculty member from another institution to jury the student work to ensure neutrality and provide a professional, real-world experience for students. Since the pandemic, some discussion has been happening about also using our social media presence to highlight individual student profiles.
- As mentioned before, the Art Department has also worked with our Office of Institutional Effectiveness, Research, Planning, and Assessment to create a standardized rubric that we are beginning to embed into the eLearn course shells for our studio courses to streamline the process of gathering data to assess the quality of student work and instructional effectiveness in these courses. We are at the beginning stages of this process, and quantitative data is an inherently problematic way of assessing subjective work such as art and design, but the rubric was designed to take this into account so we are hopeful that this will prove to be a useful tool as we continue to gather data and discuss the findings.
- We experimented with an ePortfolio initiative to allow for better reflection on student progress and to make it easy for students to share their work with others, but it was found to be far too limited and too expensive, so this project was ended.

Music

Music assessment is a mixture of pre- and post-test assessment (MUS 1030), and performance project grading that is specific to classes. Students in music not only take classes but perform in various ensembles and/or musical productions, giving faculty an opportunity to see them rehearse as well as perform. In this way, faculty make assessments of both the quality of the finished product and the processes they employ. End-of-semester evaluations exist as well, involving faculty other than the student's primary instructor:

- Music faculty all participate in juries required of AFA majors and encouraged for all private instruction students. In addition to the full-time faculty members, four adjunct faculty members (piano, brass, and guitar) evaluate students by listening to the student's performance, the goal being to assess the student's progress from the individual semester. At the end of the student performance, faculty complete a rubricated jury analysis sheet (See Appendix C) to 1) make constructive criticism concerning the selection that was performed, and 2) to suggest a grade for that performance, which also figures heavily into the student's semester grade.
- Assessment in Theory and Ear Training classes takes place for students on a semesterly basis in the track, as well as regularly, via sight-singing quizzes, written music theory tests, and online assessments in the uTheory program.

4.3 Implementation of Improvements

Art

The quality of art is a very difficult thing to assess and quantify, but the Art department has established some effective rubrics to help guide faculty and explain the assessments to students.

- We have recently worked to standardize our rubrics to facilitate comparisons between courses. (See the Appendix B for samples.) When we notice recurring problems, we discuss and implement ways to better explain project assignments, more relevant examples to show students, new activities to explore content, etc.
- Faculty interaction has been especially essential over the last two years, where even our "hands on" studio classes had to be completely reimaged to work in a remote format and we would refer to the newly standardized rubrics as a basis to conduct more short-term surveys to help ensure that the quality of our instruction remained as strong as possible. Some of the technology and

techniques from our foray into remote learning are being used or repurposed to enhance our classes now that we have returned to campus instruction. (For example, video demonstrations and online discussion forums for critique.)

- As mentioned above, we are also looking into ways to more effectively use individual student profiles on our social media pages to extend the reach of our Student Art Exhibition capstone experience.
- The Art History classes have been updated to use a flipped classroom format and also to be more inclusive of non-western art and art history. According to anecdotal data collected from students taking the course, the accessibility of information has been broadened and improved, making the class more equitable and more inclusive. The flipped classroom model has helped students to become independent learners, with access to supplemental and robust support in the classroom.
- Many of the studio courses have been incorporating more use of self-reflection and other CRT (Culturally Responsive Teaching) methods.

Music

Music strives to normalize and share best practice information amongst instructors of Music Theory and Ear Training to achieve consistent results and refine expectations between lecture and lab. The faculty discuss objectives, sometimes in formal meetings but often in casual conversations. Recently we have reacted to identified shortcomings in student learning in the following ways:

- In Fall 2022, we will no longer use *Introductory Musicianship* (Lynn) for MUS 1002 Fundamentals of Music. The text will instead be supplemented with worksheets created by adjunct Theory instructor William Fitzhugh. This will allow students better continuity between semesters and save them from having to purchase a preliminary text.
- There is a regular bi-monthly vocal lab, offering opportunities for periodic performance experience and peer review for our voice principles, as well as regular monthly recital opportunities for all AFA majors.
- Music outside of the traditional classical canon is being integrated into the faculty's studios, including compositions from the African diaspora, female composers, and other historically underrepresented composers.

5: Support

5.1 Library, Equipment, and Facilities

As with other areas related to our AFA programs, we continue to seek to improve our use of our facilities and equipment, to identify ways they can be built upon and improved, and to further realize the potential of what we already have.

Art

The Art Department relies heavily on facilities; drawing and painting courses require space for easels and still-life setups; ceramics and three-dimensional work requires space and equipment, particularly pottery wheels, kilns, and glazes; printmaking courses require access to printing presses, acid baths, and ventilation hoods; and design and photography classes, as well as all other art courses on occasion, make great use of our computer lab, printers, scanners, cameras, and drawing tablets.

We have recently built up our digital equipment significantly, adding classroom sets of MacBook laptops and iPad Pros with Apple Pencils, as well as upgrading our photo printer. We are currently in the process of upgrading our color laser printer as well. In summer 2021 we greatly increased our collection of still

life props for Drawing, Painting, and Foundations I classes, with emphasis on improving the quality and variety of artificial plants and flowers.

And finally, our gallery space is used to exhibit the work of professional artists, and to exhibit the best examples of student work each spring. We are beginning to improve the tools in the gallery used for installation, drywall repair, and painting.

Music

In the Thigpen Library, Music has about 3,232 books and materials through EBSCO alone and 67 from Safari Tech Books; however, this number does not factor in all the additional eBooks (music encyclopedias and dictionaries, other reference books) that are available from our database collections of reference materials (see CREDO, Gale Virtual Reference Library, General Reference Center Gold, and Oxford Reference Online). We also have a DVD collection including 75 DVDs with composer credits for original music and a music library of over 1000 historical CDs. Additionally, we have the luxury of:

- Soundproofed practice rooms
- A piano lab with smart instructor stations and a separate home for our Steinway grand piano.
- A formal instrument storage locker room for students and faculty.
- A dedicated copy room and home for our extensive music library/archives.

5.2. Operating Budget

The Art and Performing Arts Departments both have individual departmental budgets, and both also draw from the TAF budget to purchase items such as computer equipment and software.

Art

The Art Department does have a healthy budget that meets the needs of the program. Money is used to replenish supplies and equipment as needs arise, as well as to acquire additional big-budget items at the end of each fiscal year.

We also instituted some studio fees in Fall 2019 that are used to supplement this budget in providing more of the supplies for students directly, alleviating the need for them to purchase so much individually. This is especially helpful in beginning to make these courses a little more equitable in terms of costs. We are working to get to the point where we can balance these studio fees with the supply kits required for the courses, effectively building the cost of the supply kits into the course fees entirely and greatly reducing the hassle (and likely the cost as well) of purchasing these supplies.

Music

Music uses two budgets, Music Education and Music Performance, to support our annual needs. Music Performance is used for professional contracts and expenses to produce our annual recitals and shows and has proven to be adequate in recent years. Additionally, receipts from the musical performances, donations and CD sales go to the Music Department Scholarship Fund. This fund allows us to recruit students from high school, assist with the financial needs of music students, and makes us marketable in bringing quality students into the program. We also have individual need-based scholarships available.

5.3 History of Enrollment/Graduation

Art

Since its creation, the AFA Art major enrollment has grown quite a bit. The size of the program has declined a bit since the pandemic started in 2020, but it is still almost twice the size (in terms of declared majors) as it was when it first began in 2017. The Headcount in this program jumped from 23 in 2017 up to 64 in 2019 before falling a bit to 44 now in 2021.

Our graduation rate has remained fairly steady and actually grown despite the recent decline in declared majors. The graduation rate may not be especially high relative to the total number of majors, but this is a field in which a degree is not necessary to enter the field, and many students come to learn without finishing the degree being the final goal, so it is difficult to parse out a sense of how successful the program is by comparing enrollment to the graduation rate.

Music

Since the inception of the AFA Music program, there was a steady increase in enrollment, however in recent years the number has declined, partially due to the creation of the AAS Professional Music program in 2017. The Covid-19 pandemic has not helped enrollment and retention, but we are optimistic about future semesters. Efforts to improve enrollment and retention are underway, including working with local high schools and better advising of current students by music instructors.

Part IV: Potential Initiatives

The following initiatives are either a result of the analysis of the programs as discussed in this report or are a result of external influences. They are not presented in order of priority.

- Create additional studio space for Art: We need to annex another classroom from nearby lecture rooms to repurpose as an additional art studio. This would relieve a lot of scheduling issues that have arisen since our enrollment increased dramatically since the planning for our current building. A room has been identified, and we are working with the division dean to see what we can do to help make this happen.
- Develop a Graphic Design track for Art: The hiring of new graphic design instructor will allow us to pursue the development of additional design courses for students. We are in the planning stages of creating a degree track for this and exploring potential crossovers in the curricula of the EMP and Communications programs. As this is being instituted, success should be evidenced by enrollment numbers and feedback from transfer programs and local industry professionals.
- Create and fill new technician role for our facilities: With all of the facilities we now have in the Humanities building at the Gallatin campus (such as the Performing Arts Space and the Vol State Art Gallery), a need exists for a technician to serve the technical demands of both it and the Wemyss Auditorium.
- Achieve accreditation from the National Association of Schools of Music: This is a long and challenging initiative, involving curriculum modifications, as well as facility requirements. We now have the space and physical resources (study and performance space, practice rooms, etc.) to realize this long-standing goal. Communication with the NASM will begin in the summer of 2022 to see if this is a feasible goal for the near future.
- Create a pre- and post-test instrument for Music Theory courses: This will inform faculty of students' knowledge of music theory upon enrolling in classes at Vol State, and to better understand students' proficiency and retention of skills learned in previous semesters. Theory instructors will need to work together to create and employ these instruments.
- Need for outreach/recruitment in Music: Due to our low enrollment, the music program is revising our recruitment strategies and reaching out to local high schools to improve our relationships within the community. High School Music Day, hosting high school events on campus, and workshops for high school music instructors and students will help us realize this goal.
- Need for a performance grand piano to be housed permanently in Wemyss Auditorium: It is very expensive to rent a grand piano for performances in Wemyss Auditorium. While the cost of purchasing a quality grand piano is much higher, it will pay for itself in time, and allow for more

guest artists to visit Vol State's performance hall. Significant funds and climate control are necessary for this initiative. Fundraising efforts are already underway.

Part V: Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

<i>No.</i>	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicators</i>	<i>When</i>
1	Develop a Graphic Design track for Art	Increase course offerings in design and build a degree program as either an AFA concentration or an AAS degree	Art Department Chair, Dean of Humanities, and Vice President of Academic Affairs	Enrollment numbers in the developed courses, and eventually the degree program, will be a strong indicator of student demand. Feedback from transfer universities and local industry professionals will be necessary for ensuring the quality of the program.	Academic year 2022-2023
2	Create additional studio space for Art	Grow the physical space of the Art Department to make space for additional students	Art Department Chair, Dean of Humanities, and Director of Facilities	The ability to offer enough studio courses to meet demand without adversely sacrificing open studio time	Fall 2023
3	Achieve accreditation from the National Association of Schools of Music	This affects our regional and national reputation as an institution and remains an important goal.	Music Department Chair and full-time faculty	Achieving accreditation	Beginning Summer 2022, ongoing. This will likely be a two-year process.
4	Create a pre- and post-test instrument for Music Theory courses	To better understand the effectiveness of our instruction in these classes.	Full-time Music faculty and adjuncts	Completion of the project and a successful pilot	Summer 2022 development Fall 2022 pilot
5	Improve Music outreach/ recruitment, enrollment, and graduation rates	To improve our outreach efforts to increase our student enrollment	Full-time Music faculty	Increase enrollment and graduation rates by at least 10%.	Fall 2022
6	Purchase performance grand piano	Higher quality instrument for students, faculty, and guest artists to perform on	Music faculty, the Vol State Foundation	Significant fundraising and donations are required to purchase this instrument.	Fall 2027

Part VI: Follow-Up Report

Recommendation 1

The team recommends more research into the Music low graduation rates.

Follow-Up:

Since the last audit, the Music program has seen a decline in graduation rates, largely due to the Covid-19 pandemic and lower enrollment numbers. In recent years, faculty members have become more involved in recruitment and increased visibility in local public schools. In addition, the music faculty believes it is important for them to directly advise music students so they can better guide them and is working with the advising office to send them students directly.

Recommendation 2

The team recommends that more effort be put into acquiring instruments students need, such as pianos, percussion, and other band instruments.

Follow-Up:

The music program has recently acquired a tenor saxophone, trombone, professional-level clarinet, a full keyboard lab with instructor's station, and several full-sized weighted keyboards for piano students to checkout during their studies. In addition, damp chasers have been installed on both grand pianos to ensure longevity by controlling humidity and temperature.

Recommendation 3

The team recommends that faculty, including adjuncts, have more academic control over the content of their courses, including online courses.

Follow-Up:

Art

Adjunct faculty in the Art Department currently have near total control over the content of their courses *so long as they are adequately meeting all student learning objectives for the course*. All faculty, including adjuncts, are supported by the department in this regard, including access to course manuals, examples of assignments, and (when available) model course shells, and regular discussions (and official meetings as called for) are held to support the open exchange of ideas and tips for teaching the various courses effectively. This helps keep the course content current and fresh, and facilitates better communication about student progress.

Music

Model course shells for MUS 1030 Introduction to Music are copied for each section, but full-time and adjunct faculty are allowed freedom to teach their lectures or add additional assignments/discussions as they see fit. The four theory courses currently have three different instructors; while they teach independently, the instructors coordinate assignments to ensure students' learning objectives are met.

Recommendation 4

The team recommends that additional faculty and staff be hired to support these programs.

Follow-Up:

Art

Since the last audit, the Art Department has added two more full-time faculty, doubling the number in the department and allowing the department to expand its offerings in two of its most popular studio areas: ceramics and graphic design. Patrick Green was hired in 2018 and now runs our ceramics area, and Shane Prine was just hired in 2021 to begin building a new program in graphic design.

Music

One new full-time faculty member has been added to the Performing Arts department since the last audit, with degrees in piano performance and experience teaching both music majors and secondary majors.

Recommendation 5

The team recommends that the Music adjunct faculty be more included in the workings of the department.

Follow-Up:

Two new adjunct faculty members have been hired to the Performing Arts department with training in music theory and piano performance. All adjunct faculty are directly involved in the end-of-semester showcases, recitals, and theory instruction.

Appendix A – Visual and Performing Arts Calendars

A schedule of exhibitions in the college art gallery, including current, recent, and future shows, can be found at <https://www.volstate.edu/humanities/art/gallery>.

A schedule of the 2021-2022 Music Calendar is listed below.

Voice Recitals: September 7, October 5, November 2, and December 7, 2021, at the Gallatin Public Library. Students studying voice with Professors Nancy Slaughter and Mark Granlund performed voice recitals of music from the Baroque period to modern day.

Vol State Singers: October 20 and November 17, 2021, in Wemyss Auditorium. Led by Professor Nancy Slaughter, Vol State Singers performed short concerts during school hours for the staff, students, and Gallatin community.

Vol State Singers: November 21, 2021, in Wemyss Auditorium. Vol State Singers perform their end-of-semester concert, featuring a full-length program of music from the classical and modern eras.

Music Winter Showcase: December 3-4, 2021 at 7:30 PM in Wemyss Auditorium. Students and faculty in Showstoppers, Vol State Jazz, Bluegrass Ablaze, Songwriting, and the Theater program performed solos and group performances.

AFA Music Sophomore Recital: Sunday, April 3, 2022 in the Vol State Choral Room. Elizabeth Chandler and music faculty and pianist Dr. Nicholas Reynolds collaborate in recital.

Spring Showcase: April 29 and 30, 2022 at 7:30 PM in Wemyss Auditorium. Vol State Singers, Commercial Music Ensemble, Bluegrass Ablaze, and the Theater program will perform solos and group performances.

Appendix B – Scoring Rubrics

Long form:

Indicate numerical value 1 - 5 for each assessment category

For college level standards:

5 points = Excellent: meets or exceeds requirements (A)

4 points = Good: meets most requirements and exceeds some (B)

3 points = Adequate: meets requirements but shows weakness in some (C)

2 points = Weak: meets some requirements but below college level standards (D)

1 points = Unacceptable: fails to meet most or all requirements and standards (F)

Assessment categories 1 – 4	
	1. Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)
	Includes appropriate issues and materials as assigned
	Describes the artistic experience or event in a clear and appropriate manner
	Makes proper use of learned vocabulary specific to the discipline
	Follows format and assignment requirements
	2. Analysis and Evaluation of the artistic experience or event
	Thoughtful and clear evaluation based on the learned methods of the discipline
	Makes specific claims or responses, backed by reasoning and information
	Evaluations or responses show understanding of the issues in the area of study
	Evaluations show understanding of the assignment goals
	3. Personal insight and response
	Shows personal insight as appropriate backed by reasoning
	Shows thoughtful observation and learning
	Shows originality
	4. Writing Skills
	Ideas are well organized and in proper paragraph form
	Correct use of diction, syntax, , and mechanics of writing
	Sentence structure is clear, varied, and fluid
	Words are used correctly and aptly
	Supporting material is appropriate, adequate and convincing
	If the instructor chooses to use this form as direct student feedback, enter a grade for the student (letter, points or %) appropriate to your course grading style

Short Form:

Preview Rubric

Rubric Response Papers v13

Criteria	Level 5	Level 4	Level 3	Level 2	Level 1
Understanding of assignment & meets needs of the discipline	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Analysis of artistic works or event : supported by evidence & use of terms	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Personal Insight: thoughtful observations	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Writing Skills: organization, grammar, word usage etc	excellent	good	adequate	weak	unacceptable
Overall Score	Level 5	Level 4	Level 3	Level 2	Level 1

Studio Evaluation Rubric:

| STUDIO EVALUATION

ART 1350 AFA Studio Evaluation Rubric

CLOSE

☐ Show all standards

Total Score: 0/0 - 0.00% - Mean 0.00

CLEAR SELECTION

ELEMENTS	VERY GOOD	ACCEPTABLE	NEEDS WORK
Formal Qualities Includes Principles and Elements of Art and Design: Line, Shape, Composition, etc	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			
Conceptual Ideas Creativity in using the principles and elements. Is the idea conveyed successfully	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points
Comment			
On target with the assignment Were the assignment guidelines followed?	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			
Craftsmanship Clean margins, evenly cut or torn paper, no smudges, etc.	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			
Effort On time and complete, general effort and commitment to the project	2 Points Very Good	1 Point Acceptable	0 Points Needs Work
Comment			

Appendix C – Music AFA Jury Sheet

Jury Performance Sheet Volunteer State Community College

Student _____ Semester _____ Instrument _____

Instructor _____ Number of semesters studied _____

List jury piece(s):

List all literature, scales, and chords studied this semester:

Students do not write below this line.

Please rate the following from 1-10 (10 being the best)

Preparedness of the score (notes, rhythms, basics) _____

Musicianship (dynamics, phrasing, expressiveness) _____

Quality of sound (pitch, color, placement, breath) _____

Technique (tension, agility, body alignment) _____

Physical appearance / Stage presence _____

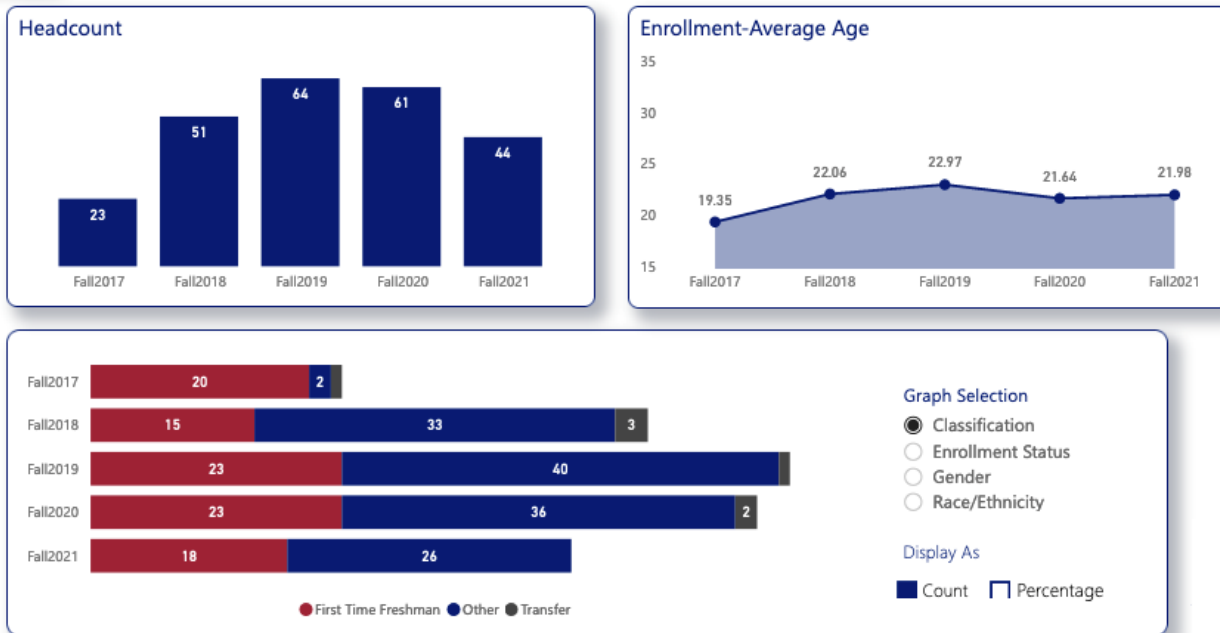
Memorization _____

Total (out of 60) _____

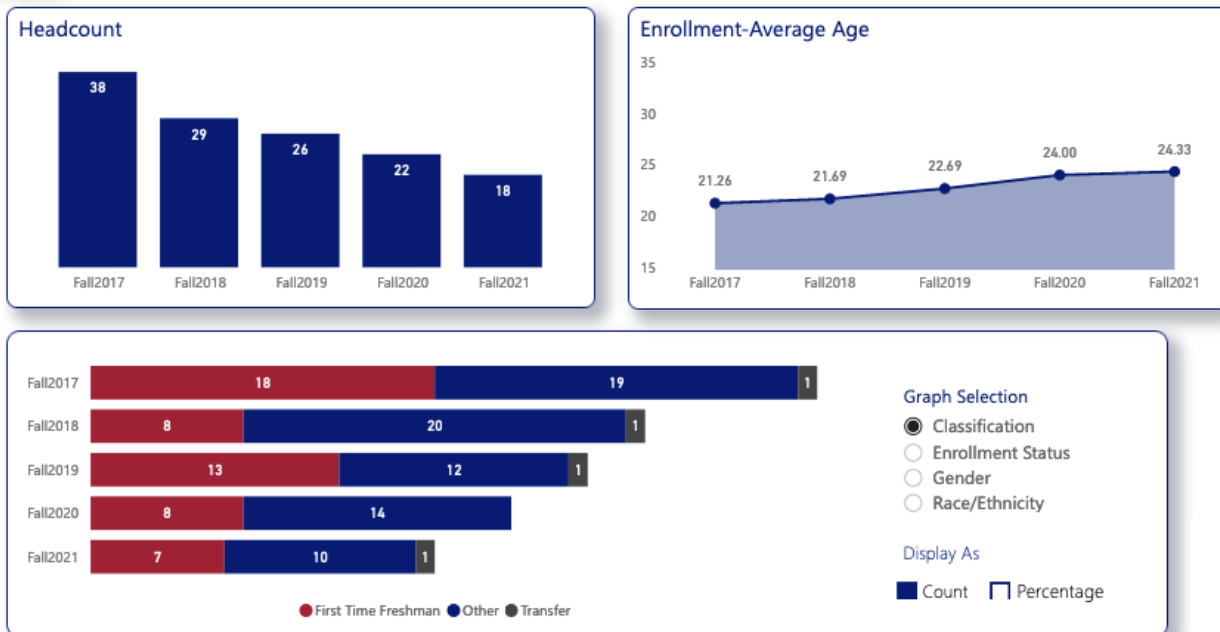
Comments:

Appendix D – Majors and Graduates

AFA Art Enrollment:



AFA Music Enrollment:



AFA Graduates:

Concentrations	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Art (Studio)		3	11	11	13
Music	4	2	4	9	3

Appendix E – VPA Writing Assessment

Visual & Performing Arts (including Theatre) Writing Assessment Results (Spring 2017)

Prepared by the Office of Institutional Effectiveness Research Planning & Assessment

Full-time and adjunct faculty teaching general education courses in Visual & Performing Arts used a scoring rubric to assess student writing in Art 1030, Music 1030, and Theater 1030 courses. The rubric used a 5-point scale to score students (5=excellent and 1=unacceptable). This report contains the results aggregated by course and overall.

As shown in Table 1, a little over three quarters of students enrolled in these courses (at time of Census) were scored using the rubric. Table 2 displays mean item and overall assessment scores by course. Students in the music course had the highest average assessment score of all courses (avg = 4.38 on a 5-point scale.) Table 3 indicates statistically significant differences in averages between courses. Theater courses were awarded statistically significant lower scores than Art and Music for Item “Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater),” Item “Personal insight and response” as well as the overall rubric score. Music courses had statistically significant higher scores than Art and Theater for items “Personal insight and response” and Item “Writing Skills.” Table 4 includes frequencies by scoring categories for all items and courses.

Table 1: Enrolled students scored using the writing assessment rubric

Course	No Assignment Completed		Assignment Completed	
	N	%	N	%
ART 1030	65	16.20%	336	83.80%
MUS 1030	104	25.90%	297	74.10%
THEA 1030	22	16.30%	113	83.70%
Total	191	20.40%	746	79.60%

Table 2: Frequencies and means for assessment items

	Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)		Analysis and evaluation of the artistic experience or event		Personal insight and response		Writing skills		Overall	
Course	N	Avg	N	Avg	N	Avg	N	Avg	N	Avg
ART 1030	336	4.44	336	4.17	335	4.22	334	4.19	336	4.25
MUS 1030	295	4.36	292	4.29	291	4.45	292	4.39	297	4.38
THEA 1030	113	4.05	113	4.10	113	3.88	113	3.97	113	4.00
Total	744	4.35	741	4.21	739	4.26	739	4.24	746	4.26

Table 3: Means Statistical Significance

	Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)	Analysis and evaluation of the artistic experience or event	Personal insight and response	Writing skills	Overall
Course					
(A) ART 1030	C		C		C
(B) MUS 1030	C		AC	AC	C
(C) THEA 1030					

Results are based on two-sided tests assuming equal variances. For each significant pair, the key of the smaller category appears in the category with the larger mean.

Significance level for upper case letters (A, B, C):

.05

a Tests are adjusted for all pairwise comparisons within a row of each innermost subtable using the Bonferroni correction.

Table 4: Frequency distribution for assessment items

Item	Level	ART 1030		MUS 1030		THEA 1030		Total	
		N	%	N	%	N	%	N	%
Assignment is understood and covers the material in a manner that meets the needs of the discipline (art, music or theater)	Unacceptable (1)	1	0.30%	3	1.00%	0	0.00%	4	0.50%
	Weak (2)	6	1.80%	5	1.70%	1	0.90%	12	1.60%
	Adequate	43	12.80%	48	16.30%	26	23.00%	117	15.70%
	Good (4)	81	24.10%	65	22.00%	52	46.00%	198	26.60%
	Excellent (5)	205	61.00%	174	59.00%	34	30.10%	413	55.50%
	Total	336	100.00%	295	100.00%	113	100.00%	744	100.00%
Analysis and evaluation of the artistic experience or event	Unacceptable (1)	0	0.00%	9	3.10%	0	0.00%	9	1.20%
	Weak (2)	9	2.70%	12	4.10%	0	0.00%	21	2.80%
	Adequate	61	18.20%	38	13.00%	26	23.00%	125	16.90%
	Good (4)	130	38.70%	60	20.50%	50	44.20%	240	32.40%
	Excellent (5)	136	40.50%	173	59.20%	37	32.70%	346	46.70%
	Total	336	100.00%	292	100.00%	113	100.00%	741	100.00%
Personal insight and response	Unacceptable (1)	1	0.30%	8	2.70%	0	0.00%	9	1.20%
	Weak (2)	16	4.80%	5	1.70%	8	7.10%	29	3.90%
	Adequate	45	13.40%	27	9.30%	31	27.40%	103	13.90%
	Good (4)	119	35.50%	59	20.30%	40	35.40%	218	29.50%
	Excellent (5)	154	46.00%	192	66.00%	34	30.10%	380	51.40%
	Total	335	100.00%	291	100.00%	113	100.00%	739	100.00%
Writing skills	Unacceptable (1)	1	0.30%	5	1.70%	0	0.00%	6	0.80%
	Weak (2)	13	3.90%	6	2.10%	2	1.80%	21	2.80%
	Adequate	64	19.20%	33	11.30%	25	22.10%	122	16.50%
	Good (4)	101	30.20%	73	25.00%	60	53.10%	234	31.70%
	Excellent (5)	155	46.40%	175	59.90%	26	23.00%	356	48.20%
	Total	334	100.00%	292	100.00%	113	100.00%	739	100.00%

Appendix F – Pre-/Post-Test Analysis Fall 2016-Spring 2020

Table 1. Means & Correlations of Pre-test/Post-test scores and final course grades.									
		Fall 2016	Spring 2017	Fall 2017	Spring 2018	Fall 2018	Spring 2019	Fall 2019	Spring 2020
	Exam Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score	Mean Score
Art	Pre	48.16	46.92	48.29	45.22	46.74	46.16	45.40	46.09
	Post	58.61	63.64	63.31	60.00	62.80	58.39	58.18	63.03
	Difference	10.45	16.72	15.02	14.78	16.06	12.23	12.78	16.94
	Final course grade of Post-test takers	3.16	3.31	3.32	3.18	3.29	3.17	3.20	3.41
	Correlation of Post-test score with final grade	0.25	0.33	--	0.27	0.11	--	0.14	--
Music	Pre	--	63.31	63.16	59.19	60.50	60.79	62.08	59.92
	Post	--	74.79	77.90	74.99	78.08	73.66	77.19	76.91

	Difference	--	11.48	14.74	15.80	17.58	12.87	15.11	16.99
	Final course grade of Post-test takers	--	3.17	3.32	3.56	3.54	3.43	3.37	3.55
	Correlation of Post-test score with final grade	--	0.21	--	0.17	0.15	--	0.21	0.24
	Pre	49.58	55.16	55.78	53.03	50.71	53.08	54.06	53.05
	Post	59.04	69.06	69.55	67.81	68.96	65.29	68.43	69.48
	Difference	9.46	13.90	13.77	14.78	18.25	12.21	14.37	16.43
	Final course grade of Post-test takers	3.11	3.21	3.30	3.41	3.39	3.29	3.29	3.48
	Correlation of Post-test score with final grade	0.23	0.24	--	0.26	0.12	--	0.19	0.17
Significant differences in average Pre-test and Post-test scores are indicated in bold (p<0.05).									
Only significant correlations are shown (p<0.05).									

Appendix G – Success and Retention Rates

AFA Art Retention:

Fall to Spring Persistence

NA
Fall 2016 to Spring 2017
78.3%
Fall 2017 to Spring 2018
65.0%
Fall 2018 to Spring 2019
67.9%
Fall 2019 to Spring 2020
59.6%
Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Fall to Fall Retention

NA
Fall 2016 to Fall 2017
69.6%
Fall 2017 to Fall 2018
40.0%
Fall 2018 to Fall 2019
47.3%
Fall 2019 to Fall 2020
38.8%
Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

3yr Graduation Rate*

NA
Fall 2016 Freshman Cohort
40.0%
Fall 2017 Freshman Cohort
26.7%
Fall 2018 Freshman Cohort

AFA Music Retention:

Fall to Spring Persistence

76.7%
Fall 2016 to Spring 2017
67.6%
Fall 2017 to Spring 2018
85.2%
Fall 2018 to Spring 2019
81.0%
Fall 2019 to Spring 2020
75.0%
Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Fall to Fall Retention

50.0%
Fall 2016 to Fall 2017
57.1%
Fall 2017 to Fall 2018
52.2%
Fall 2018 to Fall 2019
60.0%
Fall 2019 to Fall 2020
50.0%
Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

3yr Graduation Rate*

6.7%
Fall 2016 Freshman Cohort
33.3%
Fall 2017 Freshman Cohort
25.0%
Fall 2018 Freshman Cohort

VSCC Overall Retention:

Fall to Spring Persistence

68.5%
Fall 2016 to Spring 2017

67.4%
Fall 2017 to Spring 2018

67.6%
Fall 2018 to Spring 2019

67.6%
Fall 2019 to Spring 2020

63.1%
Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Fall to Fall Retention

43.6%
Fall 2016 to Fall 2017

44.0%
Fall 2017 to Fall 2018

43.4%
Fall 2018 to Fall 2019

44.0%
Fall 2019 to Fall 2020

40.6%
Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

3yr Graduation Rate*

20.9%
Fall 2016 Freshman Cohort

23.0%
Fall 2017 Freshman Cohort

22.0%
Fall 2018 Freshman Cohort

*Graduation Rates cannot be filtered by Classification

Art Grade Distribution by Course 2016-2020:

Course	A	B	C	D	F	FA	I	N	NR	W
ART 100	2	1	1		1					
ART 1030	806	517	280	106	197	77		2		111
ART 1035	1206	531	256	147	273	240	6		1	135
ART 1045	67	36	17	10	5	16	1	6		10
ART 1050	22	14	11	3	5	3		5		
ART 1340	80	89	31	14	34	21	4		1	12
ART 135	45	9	4	1	1	2	4	8		
ART 1350	40	25	4	1	2	2				4
ART 136	12	11						1		3
ART 145	4			1				7		
ART 155	66	44	10	6	3	17		1		13
ART 2000	44	44	25	15	14	8	2	3		9
ART 2020	29	29	11	7	7	2	3			7
ART 211	8	9	6	2	1		1			1
ART 212	1							1		
ART 253	38	23	11	3	6	6				2
ART 280T	35	8	1				6	11		1
Total	2505	1390	668	316	549	394	27	45	2	308

Grade	Fall 2016	Fall 2017	Fall 2018	Fall 2019	Fall 2020	Spring 2016	Spring 2017	Spring 2018	Spring 2019	Spring 2020
A	9148	9543	10119	10300	9597	7622	8394	8733	8918	9464
B	7168	7209	7072	6721	5627	5471	5862	5818	5807	5494
C	4113	4067	4037	3824	3140	3511	3511	3269	3333	2889
D	1461	1479	1429	1434	1265	1265	1336	1314	1285	1100
F	4411	2603	2816	2709	2785	3508	3702	1890	2190	3695
F.				1						
FA		2126	2702	2693	3345			1643	1842	220
I	161	129	114	104	132	142	107	106	67	235
N	28	32	36	25	19	33	25	29	33	27
NR	3		31	22	2		1	1		1
P	43	58	48	44	33	53	43	53	80	63
W	2055	1871	1968	1833	2180	1539	1527	1339	1402	1374

General Education Review, Cohort A- Cycle 2

Communication GE

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

Program and institution mission alignment

How does the mission of the area align to the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Gen. Ed. Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The goal of the communication requirement is to enhance the effective use of the English language essential to students' success in school and in the world by way of learning to read and listen critically and to write and speak thoughtfully, clearly, coherently, and persuasively.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the area align with the mission of the institution? The program mission of enhancing communication skills directly supports the college's commitment to providing quality innovative educational programs. Effective communication is essential for students' success in school and beyond, aligning with the college's goal of preparing students for successful careers and university transfer. Additionally, improved communication abilities foster cultural awareness and diversity, supporting the college's dedication to promoting these values within its community.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A Assessment Plan

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule

5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

English:

Since the last General Education review, the English Department decided it would make more sense to assess English 1010 only in the fall and English 1020 only in the spring based on course offerings (i.e., more students take 1010 in the fall and 1020 in the spring). Of the seven TBR outcomes, English assesses five, including: primary purpose, rhetorical patterns, written/oral presentations, problem-solving and decision-making, and evidence, analysis, and persuasive strategies. Mapped to a rubric, this translates to primary purpose, ordering major points, developing ideas, diction/syntax/grammar, and supporting information. For both English 1010 and 1020, we consider the research paper as the student-learning piece. Students are scored from Excellent-Good-Average-Fair-Poor, and there's an N/A section to account for students who drop the course and/or do not turn in a paper. Anything from fair-excellent is considered "met," with a target of 80% of students meeting each outcome. Faculty find assessing every single student in every single outcome on the rubric to be cumbersome and unnecessary. Previously, random samples were used, which seemed to work well. The English Department has discussed other methods to assess outcomes, including reverting to some traditional methods like meeting in person and having a group of faculty assess a random stack of papers from across different sections. We plan to explore other methods and vote at the end of the semester.

Communication:

Communication Studies department faculty work collaboratively to develop, evaluate, and modify assessment instruments to ensure that learning outcomes remain measurable and meaningful. Once the assessment method is developed, an assessment rubric is created and used by all faculty that teach that course. Based on the assessment data, the faculty review the assessment assignments and make changes as needed to improve student achievement. Using the results of the student learning outcome assessments, faculty evaluate teaching strategies to determine the best way to achieve these student learning outcomes. GE.COMM.1 Oral and/or Written Expression, GE.COMM.4 Writing and/or Speaking Processes Components, GE.COMM.2 Primary Purpose, and GE.COMM.5 Written and/or Oral Presentations are assessed in COMM 2025 annually. These outcomes are assessed using the Informative Speech and Peer/Self Evaluation in COMM 2025. GE.COMM.1 Oral and/or Written Expression, GE.COMM.4 Writing and/or Speaking Processes Components, GE.COMM.2 Primary Purpose, and GE.COMM.5 Written and/or Oral Presentations are assessed in COMM 2045 annually. These outcomes are assessed using the Persuasive Speech and the Peer/Self Evaluation in COMM 2045. Students are scored from Exemplary, Meets Expectations, Developing, Novice, and Not Acceptable. Exemplary and Meets Expectations are considered meeting expectations, while Developing, Novice, and Not Acceptable are considered not meeting expectations.

Evidence:

- GECOMM, Assessment Tool

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the general education area course list.

Utilizing the assessment matrix and gateway data provided please provided the following:

1. Provide an analysis of trends found within the data.
2. Identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
3. Review disaggregated data for gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1	95.79%	4.21%	70.27%	29.73%	63.38%	36.62%	
PLO 2	90.91%	9.09%	84.11%	15.89%	79.69%	20.31%	
PLO 3	96.34%	3.66%	88.41%	11.59%	86.79%	13.21%	
PLO 4	95.77%	4.23%	71.94%	28.06%	62.93%	37.07%	

PLO 5	92.28%	7.72%	87.91%	12.09%	83.63%	16.37%	
PLO 6	92.68%	7.32%	85.55%	14.45%	83.81%	16.19%	
PLO 7	93.29%	6.71%	85.79%	14.21%	84.36%	15.64%	
Course Learning Outcome 2025.1			69.58%	30.42%	54.15%	45.85%	
Course Learning Outcome 2025.6			74.27%	25.73%	58.51%	41.49%	
Course Learning Outcome 2025.8			69.51%	30.49%	60.14%	39.86%	

Course Learning Outcome COMM 2025 2025.1 Primary Purpose 2025.6 Oral Delivery 2025.8 Self Evaluation

1. Analysis of trends

Analysis of PLOs: There is a noticeable decline in the percentage of students meeting certain outcomes over the three years, particularly for PLO 1 and PLO 4. This suggests a need to investigate and address potential challenges in these areas. PLO 2, PLO 3, PLO 5, PLO 6, and PLO 7 have maintained relatively high percentages of students meeting the outcomes, with all meeting the 80% target in the three-year average. This indicates strengths in these areas of the curriculum. Despite the declines in some areas, the general trend across all PLOs is toward a significant proportion of students meeting the learning outcomes. This suggests effective teaching and learning processes in place, though there's room for targeted improvements.

CLOs 2025: Karen

The sharply lower attainments in proficiency are very likely due to proficiencies that were failed to be met during the pandemic. Extensive online instruction and decreased student engagement produced students whose writing and comm skills were weaker than if instruction had been in person. It is anticipated that a return to traditional instruction modalities with prompt and frequent feedback on speeches will result in a regression toward the mean as in previous years. However, there may be a latency of a year due to the gradual nature of the transition back to traditional residential instruction. Observed trends are in keeping with those of peer institutions with similar student demographics and desired education educational outcomes. Further analysis including factor analysis and root cause would be required if the trends persist despite return to pre pandemic instructional modalities. The results furnish a cautionary tale that distributed education may not produce effectively identifiable student outcomes, even in courses that are functionally equivalent. Further investigation should explore any statistically significant difference and persistence and attainment of core objectives between online and on ground sections. A factor analysis should differentiate student achievement in light of available demographic information via the office of RESI. Self-reflection is more resistant to changes in instructional modality whereas delivery of speeches and brainstorming of ideas for topics is inherently simpler in a traditional classroom environment in which participants share a greater degree of intimacy and rapport with instructor. Differences could be attributed to looking inward alone. To support this hypothesis, we could look at metrics for online courses this semester and compare the results of online and in-person. Significant challenges remain equalizing online and traditional face-to-face modalities of instruction.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

English: PLO1 relates to rhetorical strategies in English classes. Students tend to struggle with rhetorical concepts. The model course could be improved by scaffolding these ideas to increase understanding. PLO4, which focuses on process writing in English classes, highlights the importance of guiding students through the various stages of writing, from pre-writing and drafting to revising and editing. Students often face challenges in understanding that writing is a process that involves multiple revisions and feedback cycles to enhance clarity, coherence, and effectiveness. To address these challenges and improve outcomes for PLO4, the model course could be enhanced by incorporating more explicit instruction on each step of the writing process.

Communication:

Assignments could be benchmarked throughout the semester to measure key indicators as students progress through the course. Additionally, the benchmarked assignments could provide opportunities for support in the Learning Commons, or by faculty appointment for students who fail to achieve significant progress throughout the semester. The threshold of significance would be defined by the common opinion of the faculty and identical instruments made available to each course throughout the department. After benchmark 1 is identified, faculty could analyze who did not meet the benchmark, and refer students for support.

Evidence:

- COMM2025 Peer _ Self Eval AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115712
- COMM2045 Peer _ Self Evaluation AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115732
- Communications Student Course Evals AY20-23

- ENG1010 Gen Outcome Assessment AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115652
- ENG1020 General Education Outcome Assessment AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115557
- GE COMM CLOs AY21-23
- GE COMM PLOs AY20-23
- GE COMM PLOs Gender AY21-23
- GE COMM PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-22
- GE COMM PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- GE COMM, Assessment Plan
- Student Pass Rate COMM Intro Courses
- Submitted University Parallel Academic Audit-1 (1)

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.

English

The 5:5 teaching load significantly burdens faculty, particularly in composition courses requiring extensive feedback, a task made more challenging by rising class sizes. This diminishes the opportunity for personalized feedback, crucial for developing writing and critical thinking skills. Smaller class sizes could improve outcomes by allowing more individualized attention. Moreover, the English Department's loss of 8 full-time faculty members, with no replacements, necessitates reliance on last-minute, often inexperienced temporary hires. This leads to student complaints due to inconsistent teaching quality and disrupts the educational experience. Full-time faculty, stretched thin by overloads to compensate for staffing shortages, face burnout, hindering their ability to support and engage students effectively. This situation underscores the urgent need for systemic changes, including addressing full-time faculty shortages and reevaluating the use of temporary hires. Investing in experienced full-time faculty recruitment and retention is essential for departmental stability, teaching quality, and student success.

Communication

Three years ago, in 2021, the same outcomes were analyzed and one of the initiatives/requests was a NEW full-time faculty position at the Springfield/Highland Crest campus.. This position would allow our department to service both Highland Crest and the surrounding High Schools (especially Robertson County). This request was not fulfilled; therefore, this need is being communicated three years later. The full-time faculty member could teach at Highland Crest (possibly a course during the day and an evening course) along with staffing many of the local Robertson County HS to make a full load. This new position would provide a dedicated person at Highland Crest and the surrounding Robertson County HS ensuring we meet the demand for classes and ensuring consistent high caliber instruction.

2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

English:

Addressing the shortfall in full-time faculty by hiring more permanent instructors could stabilize the department and improve teaching quality. Full-time faculty are generally more available for student support and mentorship, positively impacting student achievement and satisfaction.

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.

2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.

English:

Students do not do as well in online classes. Additionally, academic integrity in online classes is an issue. We have spoken with the interim president and VPAA about offering more in-person classes, which they support, but we would need funding for more faculty to teach on-ground.

Communication:

Course modality has been identified as an area of investigation since a noticeable difference in student success regarding modality has been observed.

2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Students who enrolled in the online sections of 2025 and 2045 did not perform as well as students who enrolled in face-to-face sections of the same course. Due to this observation, more face-to-face sections and fewer online sections are being offered in an effort to increase student success. The same is true for English.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
1 (English).	Implement OER in English 1020 courses.	To reduce textbook costs and increase accessibility for all students enrolled in English 1020, aiming to enhance engagement and improve success rates.	English faculty	(1) Increase in course success rates by 2% over the first three years. (2) Monitoring student feedback on resource accessibility and usefulness.	Implementation in fall 2024 with ongoing assessment over the next three academic years.	Need overall success rates in ENGL 1020.
2 (English) (SL)	Offer a new co-requisite model for	To increase success and retention	English team focused	(1) 5% increase in success and	Development and pilot phase in the	Need rates.

	English 0810.	rates for learning support students in English 1010 by providing additional support and resources tailored to their needs.	on learning support.	retention rates over the next 3 years for English learning support students. (2) Collection of qualitative feedback from students on the co-requisite model's effectiveness.	upcoming academic year, with full implementation and review over the following two years.	
3 (Communication).	Refocus departmental assessment for COMM 2025	To increase success rate in face-to-face COMM 2025 sections	Comm Studies Faculty	(1) Increase number of f2f sections over the next two years (2) Benchmark assignment to evaluate progress	Implementation in fall 2024 with ongoing assessment over the next four academic semesters	Need rates in online and f2f sections
4 (Communication) (SL)	Offer campus-wide story slam	To increase student engagement and belonging	Comm Studies Faculty	(1) Host slam for COMM 2025 and 2045 students in an all-campus event (2) Collection of participation percentages of all face-to-face sections	Implementation in fall 2024 and subsequent fall semesters	Need rates of participants

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

English -

Funding for more full-time position to support increasing on-ground courses.

Communication-

A full-time position for Springfield and Cookeville needs to be funded.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee Review

Members of the General Education Committee will review the GER and provide feedback.

Please attach committee minutes and any other applicable documentation regarding the committee's discussion.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Changes if applicable</i>	<i>Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video created. -Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. - Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	-Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. -	No changes to the timeline.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1.	English: Implement OER in ENGL 1020	The course was created and piloted in Fall 2024. Most online, asynchronous sections are using the model course and a few faculty are following it for F2F classes.	No challenges at this time.	N/A	We will be able to collect data for Spring 2025 later this year to determine success.
2.	English: Offer a new co-req model for ENGL 0810	A faculty workgroup was given release time in spring 2025 to research and create the new co-req model. The model will go into effect fall 2025.	No challenges at this time.	N/A	We will collect our first round of data after the fall 2025 semester.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Performance Indicator Result</i>	<i>Initiative Achieved? Yes/No</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video was launched in the model shell -Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. -The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	- none.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	-No
1.					

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
Ex.				
1.				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Veterinary Technology AAS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
The mission of the Veterinary Technology Program is to enable students to attain licensure and gainful employment by providing high quality education and clinical experiences. These services contribute the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
These services contribute the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Program Learning Outcomes:

1. Demonstrate knowledge of hospital procedures, communicate in all formats, and recognize applicable laws
2. Calculate and administer prescribed drugs and communicate necessary client information

3. Assess patient and demonstrate care under the following: husbandry, nutrition, therapeutics, and dentistry for companion animals, farm animals, laboratory animals and exotic species
4. Formulate an anesthetic plan and demonstrate ability to implement the plan and maintain anesthesia during all phases, including utilizing appropriate equipment
5. Recognize routine surgical procedures, manage patient preparation and surgical environment accurately
6. Manage laboratory specimens, operate equipment to analyze specimens and evaluate validity of results
7. Create diagnostic radiographs and recognize non-radiographic imaging modalities

Course Learning Outcomes:

VET 215 – Small Animal Medical Nursing

1. Calculate anesthetic agents for administration – Dental Rubric
2. Perform diagnostic dental radiographs - Dental Rubric
3. Perform dental exam and cleaning - Dental Rubric
4. Create appropriate medical records - Dental Rubric and Animal Care Rubric
5. Provide appropriate husbandry and nutrition for hospitalized animals – Animal Care Rubric

VET 220 – Veterinary Surgery and Anesthesia

1. Assess patient before surgical procedure – Pre-Op Nurse Rubric
2. Prepare patient for surgery – Scrub Nurse Rubric and Pre-Op Nurse Rubric
3. Calculate and administer anesthetic agents – Anesthetist Rubric
4. Induce and maintain anesthesia throughout surgery – Anesthetist Rubric
5. Create an aseptic surgical environment – Scrub Nurse Rubric
6. Monitor patient using appropriate equipment – Anesthetist Rubric
7. Record all procedure appropriately – Anesthetist Rubric

Rubrics of student skills are used for all official assessment methods

Target for all – 95% successful completion of skills.

See Evidence for Rubrics and Assessment Schedule

Evidence:

- VET, AAS Assessment Tool

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1	100%	0%	96.45%	3.55%	93.82%	6.18%	
PLO 2	83.9%	16.09%	85.06%	14.94%	94.19%	5.81%	
PLO 3	99%	1%	98.77%	1.23%	99.03%	.97%	
PLO 4	95.37%	4.62%	97.4%	2.6%	98.64%	1.36%	
PLO 5	97.77%	2.22%	99.05%	.95%	100%	0%	

PLO 6	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	
PLO 7	93.33%	6.66%	100%	0%	82.61%	17.39%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.1	93.33%	6.66%	90.91%	9.09%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.2	93.33%	6.66%	100%	0%	92.61%	17.39%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.3	98.33%	1.66%	100%	0%	98.91%	1.09%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.4	100%	0%	95.45%	4.55%	94.2%	5.8%	
Course Learning Outcome 215.5	100%	0%	97.27%	2.73%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.1	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.2	96.29%	3.7%	98.41%	1.59%	98.41%	1.59%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.3	79.62%	20.37%	84.85%	15.15%	92.06%	7.94	
Course Learning Outcome 220.4	93.05%	6.94%	95.45%	4.55%	97.62%	2.38%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.5	97.22%	2.77%	97.62%	2.38%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.6	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	
Course Learning Outcome 220.7	100%	0%	100%	0%	100%	0%	

1. Analysis of trends

- Program learning outcomes 1) hospital procedures and 7) imaging are trending downward. Neither have met the 95% success rate goal.
 1. The Imaging PLO is directly related to the VET 215 course learning outcome 2) diagnostic radiographs. The trend in this class is due to a change in procedure for this assessment. In the past students could prepare for which x-ray would be taken. This past summer students only have a list of possible x-rays, they are given the specific x-ray the day of the assessment. Because of the changes made in VET 210, we expect this CLO and PLO to increase again in the future.
 2. The hospital procedures PLO is related to the VET 215 course learning outcome 4) medical records. The reason for this decrease in success rate needs to be investigated.
- Program learning outcome 2) Pharmacy has increased every year. This PLO is related to course learning outcomes in VET 215 1) Calculate drugs and VET 220 3) calculate and administer medications. It is not at the target goal at this time.
- The goals for program learning outcomes 3, 4, 5 and 6 are being met.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

- Diagnostic imaging improvement: Move dental x-ray labs to the end of summer. That will decrease the gap between when students learning the skills initially and when they are assessed over them.
- Hospital procedures improvement: Reinforce information about items that are included in proper recording of patient care and medical needs. Emphasize that animals needs are not being met when students are late for animal care duties.
- Pharmacy improvement: Find a textbook that is easier for students to understand, with fewer mistakes. Increase the level of memorization they must accomplish.

Evidence:

- PreOp Rubric AY 2021-2023
- VET 220 CLOs AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- VET AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- VET215 CLOs AY21-23
- Vet Tech Student Course Evals AY20-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
 1. Strengths: The program has focused on students skills required of entry level veterinary technicians. As a result, practices seek out our graduates for employment because of their skill level. The clinical practicum student evaluations indicate our students are performing as expected in clinics. In addition to skills, our students learn how to work well with others. This helps them to become valuable team members when they get jobs.
 2. Areas of opportunity: Retaining didactic knowledge needs improvement. As students move through the curriculum, they should retain knowledge from previous classes. This allows them to be better prepared for their national exam. Since COVID our VTNE passage rate has decreased.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.
 1. The program needs to focus on strategies that will help students retain the information and better prepare for the VTNE. That starts with developing assessments that will mark milestones in their progress. Students that do not pass those milestones will need remediation so they will be able to continue with the curriculum.
 2. Focus on areas of weakness, as evidenced on the VTNE domain scores. Weak areas include pharmacy, animal care and anesthesia. While the students skills in those areas good to excellent, their didactic knowledge is lacking.

Evidence:

- VTNE CVTEA Report 2020 July - Dec
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2021 July - Aug
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2021 Nov - Dec
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2022 July - Aug
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2022 Mar - Apr
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2022 Nov - Dec
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2023 July - Aug
- VTNE CVTEA Report 2023 Mar - Apr

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1	Increase the achievement of PLO#1 by developing and implementing assignments in the summer that will strengthen their medical record skills. (SL)	To bridge the gap between introduction of skills (spring) to assessment of skills (fall).	Vet Tech Program Director and faculty	Increase VET CLO 215.4 and PLO#1 to greater than 95%.	AY 2023-2024 - Develop and implement assignments in VET 130 and VET 210 (summer 2024) AY 2024-2025 - Evaluate results based on 2024 CLO 215.4 results	PLO#1 – 93.82% VET CLO 215.4 – 94.2%
2	Increase the achievement of PLO#2 by developing and implementing changes to the VET 130 course. (SL)	To provide students with relevant and consistent opportunities to apply pharmacy knowledge and facts	Vet Tech Program Director and faculty	Increase PLO#2 to greater than 95% Increase VET 130 final exam average to 80% Increase VTNE domain 2 to 60% by summer 2025.	AY 2023 – 2024 - Redesign VET 130 lecture to incorporate: memorizing drug facts, simplify drug classifications and applying pharmacy knowledge AY 2024 – 2025 - After analyzing summer 2024, consider incorporating a nursing OER text	PLO#2 – 94.19% VET 130 Final exam average – 77% VTNE domain 1 – 56%
3	Increase the achievement	To increase the number	Vet Tech Program	Increase VTNE domain	AY 2023 – 2024	VTNE domain 5 –

	of VTNE Domain 5 by developing additional rubrics and quizzes pertaining to animal care and nursing. (SL)	of times a student is required to recall this information.	Director and faculty	5 to 65% by summer 2024 and at or above the national average by summer 2025.	- Develop and implement an animal care exercise or quiz that must be completed prior to the animal care rotation - Develop a more robust rubric for physical examinations AY 2024 – 2025 - Redesign VET 215 Topic project: consider modifying topics covered, give groups the outline, increase the number of questions on the final exam over the topics.	61%
4	Increase the graduate first time passage rate of the VTNE by creating major milestones students must pass to progress through the program.	To increase the recall rate and accuracy of information as students progress through the program	Vet Tech Program Director and faculty	Mid-curriculum test average score to >75% by summer 2024 VTNE passage rate of first time test takers to 60% by 2024 and 70% by 2025.	AY 2023 – 2024 - Improve mid-curriculum test at the end of summer semester, part of VET 150 - Develop a remediation process for students that do not pass the mid-curriculum test which will allow them to continue taking courses AY 2024 – 2025	Mid-curriculum test summer 2023 – 61% VTNE passage rate summer 2023 – 40%

					• Implement the remediation process if needed • Improve the VTNE review course (VET 265) for Spring 2025 • Develop more formal study sessions for first year students.	
--	--	--	--	--	--	--

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The first 3 initiatives to do require any budgetary changes.

Initiative four will require the development and implementation of a remediation process for students that do not pass the mid-curriculum exam. The remediation will need to be an outside of class time commitment for both the students and instructor. Tentative plans include an hour of added instructional time during the fall semester. The program is also assessing the need to develop and implement structured study sessions during spring semester for first year Vet Tech students. There is a great need to teach students effective study skills so they can pass all the required testing.

Because the plans do not include adding curriculum hours, there will be no TLE for the instructor. Therefore, during the 2024-2025 year, the Program Director should get an additional 3 release hours during the fall semester to develop and implement the plan outlined above. At the end of the year, the success of this initial phase will be reevaluated, along with the time commitment needed for another instructor to continue.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Mission Statement Alignment

- **Program Mission statement is in alignment with Institutional mission statement.**

Curriculum and Student Learning

- **Learning outcomes focus on developing a comprehensive understanding and practical skills in veterinary medicine. They encompass knowledge of hospital procedures and**

applicable laws, effective communication skills, drug calculation and administration, patient assessment and care across various species and conditions, anesthesia management, surgical preparation and execution, laboratory specimen management and analysis, and diagnostic imaging techniques including radiography and non-radiographic modalities. Overall, these Curriculum and Student Learning outcomes are measurable and follow the Bloom's taxonomy framework.

Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

Quantitative (Strengths)

- High employability of graduates due to their entry-level skills.
- Positive performance evaluations during clinical practicums.
- Identified weaknesses in retaining didactic knowledge, especially reflected in decreased VTNE passage rates post-COVID.

Qualitative (Strengths)

- Graduates are praised for their practical skills and ability to work well in teams.
- Positive feedback on students' performance in clinical settings.

Noted areas for improvement:

- Need to improve retention of didactic knowledge, especially for better preparation for the VTNE.
- Identified weak areas in VTNE domain scores: pharmacy, animal care, and anesthesia, indicating a need for improvement in didactic knowledge.

Improvement Initiatives

Proposed initiatives (also discussed during the meeting) –

- Trying to increase hospital procedures and medical records
- Create additional assignments over the summer that pick up on medical records.
- Increasing the pharmacy program learning outline – redesign the pharmacy class (find OER textbook to supplement some of the material)
- Increase domain 5 on the national board – animal care and nursing – plan is to develop an additional rubric and assignments that is picking up on animal care and physical exams to increase feedback for students to
- Increase overall passage rate (since 2020, the students struggled with passing national boards); there will be a mid-curriculum exam at the end of the summer; students who fail will have to re-take the exam.

- *Create additional exams/assignments to facilitate retention of information which may ultimately lead to better outcomes on the National Board exam. In addition, focus on addressing specific weaknesses identified in VTNE domain scores through targeted instruction and support in pharmacy, animal care, and anesthesia, to ensure students have a well-rounded understanding and preparation for the VTNE.*

- *The fourth initiative, focusing on the development and implementation of a remediation process for students who fail the mid-curriculum exam, requires financial consideration for additional instructional time and resources. This includes allocating funds for an hour of added instructional time during the fall semester and potentially funding structured study sessions during the spring semester to enhance students' study skills. Additionally, there is a need to allocate resources for the Program Director to receive an additional 3 release hours*

during the fall semester to develop and oversee the implementation of these initiatives without increasing the curriculum hours.

Overall Comments, Suggestions, or Recommendations

- *Based on the information provided in the report, Vet Tech faculty members are committed to maintaining the high standards of education and support for our students. It's evident that there are areas for improvement, and by actively addressing these opportunities and securing the necessary resources to achieve goals, it is anticipated that the program will not only grow but also become stronger.*

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was

	resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	media services improved the video quality.		78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1					
2					
3					
4					

Close

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?

		student success?		
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

General Education Review, Cohort A- Cycle 2

Mathematics GE

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

Program and institution mission alignment

How does the mission of the area align to the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Gen. Ed. Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the area align with the mission of the institution?	
The department encourages faculty to be involved in various activities throughout the college as well as local community. Support of the mission of the college in strengthening internal and external community engagement is exhibited through the various activities in which members of the math department are involved. Faculty are actively involved in VSCC community outreach activities such as the Parris Powers Science and Math Expo. The Expo invites area students (focused on homeschool and public school elementary and middle school students) to visit the campus for an open-house-style, fun, interactive opportunity to experience math and science. Vol State students, faculty, and third-party guests present informational displays and offer hands-on experiments and activities. These include an egg drop, a life-sized Operation game, making ice cream with liquid nitrogen, planting tomatoes with the Sumner County	

Master Gardeners, learning about the cosmos with the Cumberland Astronomical Society, touring an ambulance with our EMS program, and learning about the eye with medical equipment from our ophthalmic tech program, among many other student- and faculty-led exhibits. The expo is not only a fun afternoon to encourage kids to enjoy science, but it is also an important outreach opportunity to welcome the community to our campus.

Several Math Department faculty are TN Achieves mentors and some teach the TN Achieves summer Bridge program to high school students registered for TN Promise.

VSCC serves as a testing site for Tennessee Mathematics Teachers Association State-Wide High School Mathematics Contest held each spring. Math department members handle fees, proctor tests, organize tests for scoring, provide a hospitality room for the teachers, award the winners with plaques at the final awards ceremony, and generate statistics associated with the tests.

The math faculty hosts the Tennessee Girls in STEM Workshop. This group consists of young women in middle school grades (grades 5-8) and high school (grades 9-12). These girls are introduced to STEM components by spending a day in workshops focusing on STEM education and career options.

Vol State Math/Science Division faculty hosts Engineering Day each spring. Students come to the campus for a day to participate in workshops and hear from industry speakers. Also, in the spring, the Math Department hosts Pi Day, where students can participate in fun games and activities related to Pi.

The International Education Committee is chaired by a math faculty member. One component of this committee is the Faculty Exchange Program. The exchange is a two-week professional and cultural exchange with the United States of America. A faculty member or administrator from the Netherlands will be matched with an American counterpart with similar job responsibilities. As a rule, the two weeks' exchange will consist of nine days of professional exchange and three days of leisure time (weekend) plus orientation day upon arrival.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A Assessment Plan

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs), Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs), assessment method, and assessment rubrics.

Evidence:

- GEMATH Assessment Tool

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the general education area course list.

Utilizing the assessment matrix and gateway data provided please provided the following:

1. Provide an analysis of trends found within the data.
2. Identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
3. Review disaggregated data for gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			69.04%	30.96%	59.53%	40.47%	
PLO 2			65.84%	34.16%	61.14%	38.86%	
PLO 3			72.85%	27.15%	61.74%	38.26%	
PLO 4			60.65%	39.35%	54.09%	45.91%	
PLO 5			65.73%	34.27%	62.17%	37.83%	
PLO 6			74.62%	25.38%	64.69%	35.31%	
Course Learning Outcome 1010.5 Counting Methods			36.53%	63.47%	46.49%	53.51%	
Course Learning Outcome 1130.2 Quadratic Equations			83.26%	16.74%	44.44%	55.56%	
Course Learning Outcome 1530.6 Hypotheses			63.36%	36.64%	59.29%	40.71%	

1. Analysis of trends

The math program level outcomes "GE.MATH.1 Building", "GE.MATH.3 Real World", and "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning" all decreased by 10% or more students who met the outcome from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23. The math program level outcome "GE.MATH.4 Connections", decreased by nearly 7% for students who met the outcome from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23. The math program level outcomes "GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving" and "GE.MATH.5 Technology" decreased by less than 5% for students who met the outcome from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23.

The course learning outcome that we selected to analyze from MATH 1010 was "Math.1010.5 Counting Methods". This CLO exhibited the strongest increase for percentage met from AY 21-22 (36.53%) to AY 22-23 (46.49%).

The course learning outcome that we selected to analyze from MATH 1130 was "MATH1130.2 Quadratic Equations". This CLO exhibited the most drastic decrease for percentage met from AY 21-22 (83.26%) to AY 22-23 (44.44%).

The course learning outcome that we selected to analyze from MATH 1530 was "MATH1530.6 Hypotheses". This CLO exhibited the most lowest percentage met (63.36%) beginning AY 21-22, and the percentage fell to 59.29% for AY 22-23.

We will need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentages of decrease are consistent or if any rebound occurs.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The PLOs for the department are set by TBR. The department created SLOs for general education courses two years ago and has been using Watermark/VIA to collect data. As more data is collected, the course committees for each course will be able to analyze the data for each outcome. The committees will then be able discuss strategies and implement ideas into the course to try to improve student success.

The analysis of the trends the trends indicates a downward turn in the percentages of students meeting the PLOs. This is not altogether surprising as the data window includes the semesters coming out of the COVID-19 pandemic. The math department has already taken steps to get students back on track by 1) revamping all the Learning Support Courses, 2) piloting multiple learning platforms, and 3) making policy changes regarding calculator use. We hope to see improvements in the coming cycles based on these changes. Finally, we should also revisit the questions used in the mappings to make sure they are appropriate in measuring the PLOs/CLOs.

3. Review disaggregated data for our gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

MATH 1010: Presented below is the disaggregated data for our course MATH 1010: Math for General Studies. This chart displays the percentage of students who met the PLOs specifically in MATH 1010.

PLO	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)

GE.MATH.1 Building	64.56%	35.44%	65.65%	34.35%			
GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	53.26%	46.74%	58.84%	41.16%			
GE.MATH.3 Real World	62.26%	37.74%	65.99%	34.01%			
GE.MATH.4 Connections	41.00%	59.00%	46.60%	53.40%			
GE.MATH.5 Technology	48.08%	51.92%	48.30%	51.70%			
GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	60.92%	39.08%	68.03%	31.97%			
Course Learning Outcome MATH.1010.5 Counting Methods	36.53%	63.47%	46.49%	53.51%			

Based on the disaggregated PLO data for MATH 1010, all PLO mapping for this course saw a percentage increase from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23 for students who met the PLOs. The PLO with the lowest percentage increase, "GE.MATH.5 Technology," saw an increase of 0.22% of student who met the PLO while the PLO with the highest percentage increase, "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning," saw an increase of 7.11% of students who met the PLO.

The CLO we selected as part of our analysis, "MATH.1010.5 Counting Methods," is the CLO with the largest percentage of increase (9.96%) from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23.

We need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentages of increase continue.

MATH 1130: Presented below is the disaggregated data for our gateway course MATH 1130: College Algebra. This chart displays the percentage of students who met the PLOs specifically in MATH 1130.

PLO	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
GE.MATH.1 Building	78.65%	21.35%	63.43%	36.57%	15.22		
GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	74.59%	25.41%	61.11%	38.89%	13.48		
GE.MATH.3 Real World	79.70%	20.30%	44.44%	55.56%	35.26		
GE.MATH.4 Connections	80.63%	19.37%	37.50%	62.50%	43.13		
GE.MATH.5 Technology	83.64%	16.36%	78.24%	21.76%	5.4		
GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	87.70%	12.30%	35.65%	64.35%	52.05		
Course Learning Outcome MATH.1130.2 Quadratic Equations	83.26%	16.74%	44.44%	55.56%			

Based on the disaggregated PLO data for MATH 1130, all PLO mappings for this gateway course saw a percentage decrease from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23 for students who met the PLOs. The smallest decrease in percentage of students who met the PLO, based on mapping to MATH 1130, was "GE.MATH.5 Technology" which was approximately 5%. "GE.MATH.1 Building" and "GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving" saw a decrease of 15% or less. While "GE.MATH.3 Real World," "GE.MATH.4 Connections," and "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning" only saw a decrease by less than 1% of students who met the PLO.

The CLO we selected as part of our analysis, "MATH.1130.2 Quadratic Equations," maps to "GE.MATH.3 Real World" which is a PLO that also saw a percentage of decrease (35.26%) in students who met the PLOs exclusively in MATH 1130. This decrease was in the middle of MATH 1130 specific decrease which ranged approximately from 5% to 52%.

We will need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentage of decrease continue.

MATH 1530: Presented below is the disaggregated data for our gateway course MATH 1530: Introductory Statistics. This chart displays the percentage of students who met the PLOs specifically in MATH 1530.

PLO	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	2023 Met	2023 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
GE.MATH.1 Building	57.10%	42.90%	59.29%	40.71%			
22GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	67.26%	32.74%	70.83%	29.17%			
GE.MATH.3 Real World	74.61%	25.39%	75.48%	24.52%			
GE.MATH.4 Connections	59.99%	40.01%	69.07%	30.93%			

GE.MATH.5 Technology	59.60%	40.40%	66.08%	33.92%			
GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	74.31%	25.69%	74.20%	25.80%			
Course Learning Outcome Math.1530.6 Hypotheses	63.36%	36.64%	59.29%	40.71%			

Based on the disaggregated PLO data for MATH 1530, all but one PLO mapping for this gateway course saw a percentage increase from AY 21-22 to AY 22-23 for students who met the PLOs. The one PLO with a percentage decrease, "GE.MATH.6 Reasoning," only saw a decrease by less than 1% of students who met the PLO.

The CLO we selected as part of our analysis, "MATH 1530.6 Hypotheses," maps to "GE.MATH.5 Technology" which is the PLO with the smallest percentage of decrease (3.56%) department wide. Yes, this mapping saw a percentage of increase (6.48%) in students who met the PLOs exclusively in MATH 1530.

We will need to see AY 23-24 data to have a better understanding if these percentages of increase continue.

Evidence:

- GE PLOs AY 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1010 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1010 Rubric 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1010 SLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1130 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1130 Rubric 21-22
- MATH 1130 Rubric 22-23
- MATH 1130 SLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1530 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1530 Rubric 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1530 SLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- MATH 1630 and MATH 1830 PLOs 21-22 and 22-23
- STEM PLOs 21-22 and 22-23

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

The Mathematics Department of VSCC (hereinafter referred to as “the department”) consists of 20 full-time and 16+ adjunct faculty and is part of the larger Math and Science Division. A table including the number of full-time faculty and adjunct instructors along with instructor to student ratios can be found in the evidence. This data is monitored to ensure that faculty have class sizes that are within the recommended best practices for student success.

Department members are active in professional organizations, most notably the Tennessee Mathematics Teachers Association (TMTA), Tennessee Mathematical Association of Two-Year Colleges (TMATYC), American Mathematical Association of Two-Year Colleges (AMATYC), National Center for Academic Transformation (NCAT), National Council of Teachers of Mathematics (NCTM), and Tennessee Education Association (TEA). Vol State also offers free professional development through the Teaching & Learning Center. Most faculty report they have made changes to their teaching methods as a direct result of training or attending conferences. Faculty attending meetings present what they learned at either professional development sessions, division meetings, or departmental meetings.

Evidence:

- Faculty Numbers and Ratios

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Since the implementation of Ad Astra, the department has been using it to help improve scheduling and ensure the appropriate classes are offered at each campus. The math department chair works with the science department chair and others to utilize space efficiently.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least *two student learning* and at least *two student success initiatives*. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
1.	Increase regular and substantive interaction in online math courses. (SL)	Provide faculty teaching online courses a training course on student engagement.	Department Chair	50% of online math faculty attend a training session in year 1. 100% of online math faculty attend training by year 2.	AY 2023-2024 and AY 2024-2025 -Provided training sessions for faculty	
2.	Increase PLOs and CLOs in Gateway courses (SL)	Include skills material in MATH 1130 and MATH 1530 (Gateway Courses) for all students as review material to ensure they can practice math skills they may be missing or have forgotten.	MATH 1130 and MATH 1530 Course Coordinators and Course Committees	Increase objectives met by 3%	AY 2023-2024 -Build course material to make Learning Support materials available to all students -Provide material to students by Spring 2025	See evidence
3.	Align assessments with PLOs and CLOs.	Review assessments of PLOs and CLOs to ensure they are accurately measuring outcomes.	Course Committees		AY 2023-2024 -Course committees review current assessments AY 2024-2025 -Course committees revise assessments as needed	

					AY 2025-2026 -Implement any changes in assessments	
4.	Increase the achievement of PLO #5 by developing technology resources for MATH 1530. (SL)	Provide students and tutors in the Learning Commons with a comprehensive document explaining the procedures for using the TI-84 calculator for statistical purposes	Department chair and MATH 1530 faculty	Increase PLO #5 achievement to 70%.	AY 2023-2024 -Faculty develop and review document -Share document with all MATH 1530 students and Learning Commons staff by Dec. 2024	PLO #5 66% met outcome in MATH 1530

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee Review

Members of the General Education Committee will review the GER and provide feedback.

Please attach committee minutes and any other applicable documentation regarding the committee's discussion.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Changes if applicable</i>	<i>Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video created. -Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. - Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	-Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. -	No changes to the timeline.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1.	Increase regular and substantive interaction in online math courses.	-Several lists of things faculty should do before the semester begins, during the semester, and at the end of the semester were created and put into eLearn module course shells. The lists are not exhaustive but give faculty a good sense of what is needed.	Creating a training session and finding time for faculty to attend proved to be difficult with so many different schedules.	The math leadership team decided to make a change and created modules within eLearn for instructors that give details on what is expected.	The instructor module is available to all faculty.
2.	Increase PLOs and CLOs in Gateway courses	-Built course material and added Learning Support materials in gateway	none	none	See tables below.

		courses -Provided materials to students starting in the Spring 2025 semester			
3.	Align assessments with PLOs and CLOs	-Committees did not implement changes in AY 2024-2025 -Committees met to review and make changes to assessments and course learning outcomes. They also aligned the assessment to the new GE Math outcomes and the CORE outcomes.	none	TBR made changes to the General Education Math outcomes.	-Work is complete in all but one course, which will be done Summer 25 - Assessments have been uploaded into the system -Ready to implement Fall 25
4.	Increase the achievement of PLO #5 by developing technology resources for MATH 1530.	-A document was created for faculty to give to students explaining the procedures of using the TI-84 calculator for statistical purposes. It was also shared with the Learning Commons staff. Note: Not all instructors use the calculator; some may use other technology to perform statistical calculations.	none	none	For the AY 24-25, MATH 1530 results show that 58.86% met the outcome (909 results) for PLO#5. This has not met our goal and needs more work in the area for improvement.

For the AY 24-25, the results show the following:

Program Learning Outcomes MATH 1130 and MATH 1530 Combined	% met outcome AY 24-25	Number of results AY 24-25
GE.MATH.1 Building	61.87%	632
GE.MATH.2 Problem Solving	71.49%	1105
GE.MATH.3 Real World	68.78%	1086
GE.MATH.3 Real World	59.82%	1105
GE.MATH.5 Technology	63.90%	1086

GE.MATH.6 Reasoning	73.76%	1105
---------------------	--------	------

Course Learning Outcomes MATH 1130	% met outcome AY 24-25	Number of results AY 24-25
MATH.1130.1 Linear Equations	90.96%	177
MATH.1130.2 Quadratic Equations	69.49%	177
MATH.1130.3 Inequalities	64.97%	177
MATH.1130.4 Graphs	89.83%	177
MATH.1130.5 Evaluate functions	-----	-----
MATH.1130.6 Exponential Equations	62.15%	354
MATH.1130.7 Logarithmic Equations	56.50%	177

Course Learning Outcomes MATH 1530	% met outcome AY 24-25	Number of results AY 24-25
MATH.1530.1 Identify Terms	70.68%	464
MATH.1530.2 Organize Data	83.84%	464
MATH.1530.3 Calculate Measures	81.90%	928
MATH.1530.4 Apply Distributions	78.88%	1392
MATH.1530.5 Confidence Intervals	72.09%	455
MATH.1530.6 Hypotheses	56.92%	455
MATH.1530.7 Linear Regression	65.20%	454

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Performance Indicator Result</i>	<i>Initiative Achieved? Yes/No</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video was launched in the model shell -Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. -The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	- none.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	-No
1.					

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
Ex.				
1.				

General Education Review, Cohort A- Cycle 2

History GE

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

Program and institution mission alignment

How does the mission of the area align to the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Gen. Ed. Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
<i>The history program at Vol State aims to educate students on cultural, religious, social, and economic systems that have existed over time and place, thereby promoting global awareness and acceptance, developing critical thinking through source analysis, and preparing students for civic engagement through discussions of ethics and human action.</i>	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the area align with the mission of the institution?	
The history program aligns with Vol State's mission by providing some of the most challenging and innovative instruction at the college. The history program promotes cultural awareness and ethical action through thoughtful and open discussion of diverse opinions, actions, and events throughout history. Additionally, the history program empowers students to research, think critically, and therefore promotes civic engagement and life-long learning.	

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A Assessment Plan

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes

1. Students will demonstrate the ability to....
 1. Analyze historical facts and interpretations.
 2. Analyze and compare political, geographic, economic, social, cultural, religious and intellectual institutions, structures, and processes across a range of historical periods and cultures.
 3. Recognize and articulate the diversity of the human experience across a range of historical periods and the complexities of a global culture and society.
 4. Draw on historical perspective to evaluate contemporary problems/issues.
 5. Analyze the contributions of past cultures/societies to the contemporary world.

2. Assessment Method

1. Academic freedom and the nature of instruction in history dictate that each instructor is at liberty to determine the assignment(s) that are used to assess student learning. However, all instructors utilize some writing or other project that requires argument and evidence-based analysis. These are the assignments that are typically utilized for collecting data.

3. Achievement Targets

1. To my knowledge, the History Program has not set specific achievement targets.

4. Assessment Schedule

1. The schedule dictates that we report data for Early and Modern US History, as well as Early and modern World History, in the spring term each academic year. At this time, we do not report data for African American History and Tennessee History.

5. Assessment Rubric

1. See HIST Assessment Tool

2. Rubric Structure

Elements	Proficient	Satisfactory	Developing	Novice
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
SOURCES	Student clearly demonstrates the ability to distinguish primary sources from secondary sources.	Student demonstrates the ability to distinguish primary sources from secondary sources most of the time.	Student mistakenly classifies primary and secondary sources most of the time.	Student does not demonstrate the ability to distinguish between primary and secondary sources.
GE.HIST. 1 - GE.HIST.1	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met

Historical Facts and Interpretations				
HIST.2010.1 - HIST.2010.1 Sources	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
SOCIETAL DEVELOPMENT	Student includes the most important historical concepts or information to explain the topic. Concepts and facts included are accurate and used appropriately.	Student includes some of the most important historical concepts or information, although one or two key ideas are missing. Any misconceptions/factual errors are minor and do not affect the overall accuracy of the argument.	Student omits most of the important historical concepts or information necessary to answer the questions. Specific details included may be accurate but could be seen as insignificant. Alternately, factual errors are prevalent enough to negatively impact accuracy.	Student includes information that is either irrelevant or insignificant to the topic. The student does not include any of the most significant historical concepts or terms. Key statements reveal misconceptions; details and examples contain many factual errors.

GE.HIST. 2 - GE.HIST.2 Institutions, Structures, and Processes	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
HIST.2010.2 - HIST.2010.2 Causes/consequences	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
INTERACTIONS	The student includes the most important historical concepts or information to explain the topic. Concepts and facts included are accurate and used appropriately.	Student includes some of the most important historical concepts or information, although one or two key ideas are missing. Any misconceptions/factual errors are minor and do not affect the overall accuracy of the argument.	Student omits most of the important historical concepts or information necessary to answer the questions. Specific details included may be accurate but could be seen as insignificant. Alternately, factual errors are prevalent	Student includes information that is either irrelevant or insignificant to the topic. The student does not include any of the most significant historical concepts or terms. Key statements reveal misconceptions; details and examples contain many factual errors.

			enough to negatively impact accuracy.	
GE.HIST. 3 - GE.HIST.3 Diversity	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
HIST.2010.3 - HIST.2010.3 Changes	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
HISTORICAL PERSPECTIVE	Student clearly demonstrates the ability to make multiple connections between historical events and the present day.	Student demonstrates the ability to make some connections between historical events and the present day.	Student makes superficial or loose connections between historical events and the present day.	Student fails to make connections between historical events and the present day or makes connections that are inaccurate.
GE.HIST. 4 - GE.HIST.4 Historical Perspective	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
HIST.2010.4 - HIST.2010.4 Historical perspective	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met
GE.HIST. 5 - GE.HIST.5 Past Cultures and Societies	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met

	4 Points	3 Points	2 Points	1 Point
ARGUMENT	Student crafts a valid and defensible argument using both primary and secondary sources that are well explained and placed in historical context.	Student crafts a valid and defensible argument using both primary and secondary sources but the explanation of how primary and secondary sources support the argument and the historical context of the sources is less effective.	Student crafts an argument that is a somewhat questionable interpretation of the primary and secondary sources.	Student crafts an argument that is illogical or is not supported by primary and secondary sources.
HIST.2010.5 - HIST.2010.5 Argument	Met	Met	Not Met	Not Met

Rationale for Findings:

1. Like other programs, the history program at Vol State crafted assessments rubrics based on TBR guidelines and rubrics, and we did not have sufficient flexibility to craft our own program outcomes. Further, each instructor has their own assignments with their own rubrics (exactly as it should be, with academic freedom and all), which makes determining our student's success using TBR mandated metrics like smashing a square peg into a round hole.

2. On the current assessment rubric we must follow, metric 2, 3, and 4 are so overlapping and vague as to be almost useless to measure. Many in the department have significant issues with metric 4- "Historical Perspective"- in particular, which requires that students make connections between the past and present day- something that should be left to experts (not students)- as it often invites ill-conceived, poorly considered comparisons that can even be dangerous in their lack of nuance. In teaching history, we are constantly telling students to stick to the time period under study and do not go outside of it. If we have not covered a current events topic, then we should not be asking students to construct a comparison to it.

3. Collecting data using the current method- leaving eLearn, using one assignment, translating from personal rubric to a standardized, TBR mandated rubric of learning outcomes- is cumbersome, time-consuming, and yields questionable results. Collecting good data should be seamless if it to be reliable and the instructor should not even know that it is happening. I don't know that this exists, but what would work would be software that integrates with D2L where individual assessment metrics can be linked to rubric metrics for one or more assignments, and the information is gathered as graded. No potential changes, however, should add more work to instructors plates. Any changes should end by easing teaching workload, not adding to it.

Evidence:

- GE HIST Assessment Tool

2.B Evidence of Student Learning

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the general education area course list.

Utilizing the assessment matrix and gateway data provided please provided the following:

1. Provide an analysis of trends found within the data.
2. Identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.
3. Review disaggregated data for gateway courses to identify ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning for gateway courses.

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			86.24%	13.76%	84.33%	15.67%	
PLO 2			83.77%	16.23%	82.26%	17.74%	
PLO 3			84.05%	15.95%	82.14%	17.86%	
PLO 4			78.38%	21.62%	81.68%	18.32%	
PLO 5			78.38%	21.62%	81.68%	18.32%	
Course Learning Outcome 2010.1			83.84%	16.16%	82.03%	17.97%	
Course Learning Outcome 2010.2			81.96%	18.04%	81.36%	18.64%	
Course Learning Outcome 2010.3			84.05%	15.95%	82.14%	17.86%	

Course Learning Outcomes HIST2010.1 Sources HIST2010.2 Causes/Consequences HIST2010.3 Changes

1. Analysis of trends

1. Overall success rates for learning outcomes hold fairly steady over several years at or above 80%. Given the nature of college attrition, especially community college, 80% seems a very reasonable success rate, one that is unlikely to increase significantly.
2. In US history, success in almost every category dropped between AY21/22 and 22/23. In nearly every category, the reverse is true for World History: there was improvement between those years.
3. There is a noteworthy gap in the success rate of African American and Hispanic students and the overall population. The success rate for AY22-23 was 72.55% for AfAm students and over 82% for overall population.
4. There was a noticeable drop in the success rate first gen students between AY21-22 and AY22-23, but an improvement in success rates for Pell Grant recipients between the same years.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

1. Develop targeted programs for minority students
2. Allow for more departmental freedom to develop learning outcomes (no TBR mandated outcomes)
3. Streamline data collection- integrated into LMS/Rubrics

Evidence:

- GE HIST Assessment Plan
- GE HIST PLOs Gender AY21-23
- GE HIST PLOs AY21-23
- GE HIST PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- GE HIST PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- HIST CLO_s AY21-23
- HIST2010 SLO_s AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 115942
- HIST2020 SLOs AY21-23 Rubric Report 12-06-2023 120018
- Pass Rates HIST Intro Courses
- Submitted University Parallel Academic Audit-1 (1)

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.A Faculty Usage

1. Utilizing data regarding teaching loads, faculty-to-student ratios, adjunct to full-time ratios, or other faculty-specific data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
 1. **Full time/adjunct ratio:** there are consistently about 30% more adjuncts than full-timers teaching history, and most teach at or near the max load for adjuncts. Additionally, one of our full-time faculty retired over a year ago whom we have not replaced, and another is planning retirement within the next year or so. We could certainly benefit from another full-time instructor soon.

2. **Pre-requisites:** Require ENGL 1010 and 1020 before history. History courses are reading and writing intensive, and often require research and certainly require critical thinking, analysis, synthesis, and reading comprehension skills.
 3. **Fewer students/classes:** though unlikely to happen, fewer students or classes would certainly allow instructors the ability to engage more directly with students, especially those who need more direct assistance. With the current 30 student limit in most on ground history sections, I believe that fewer sections would be preferable to smaller class size, since 30 students is great for liveliness and discussion.
 4. **Fewer non-teaching related assignments:** streamline data-collection (instructors should not even know that they are doing it) through elearn/rubric integration, reduce administrative workload and data interpretation and collection.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.
1. **Full time/adjunct ratio:** More devoted (full-time) faculty who have greater opportunity to engage directly with well-prepared students equates to student success.
 2. **Pre-requisites** One of the most effective ways to help students succeed in history is to give them better foundational skills. Having to complete ENGL 1010 and ENGL 1020 as prerequisites (preferably with a grade of C or better) before entering history would increase the likelihood of success.
 3. **Fewer students/classes:** better teacher/student ration generally results in higher success rates
 4. **Fewer non-teaching related assignments:** Our faculty are excellent and devoted to student learning. Clearing out the extraneous work that is not in their wheelhouse would allow for greater focus on students.

3.B. Course Offerings

1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
2. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Section 3. Supporting Program Information

3.B. Course Offerings

1. **3.B. Course Offerings**
 1. Utilizing data regarding scheduling, space utilization, modality ratios, course success data, or other course-related data, discuss areas of significance to the general education area.
 1. **On-ground v online classes:** based on data provided by Vol State interim President Deaton, success rates are higher in on-ground classes than online. I suspect that outcome numbers for online classes are even lower than the data show due to often compromised academic integrity in online classes.
 2. **Academic Integrity:** Use of AI, especially in online classes, is becoming ever more common.
 3. **Classrooms:** In many of our classrooms in Caudill, the projector screen covers nearly all of the white board.
2.
 1. Identify ideas for how this information can be used to improve student success.
 1. **On-ground v online classes:** Online classes will not go away. It is important to create strong online classes that ensure student *learning* as well as student success. However, having robust on-ground offerings is important for ensuring positive outcomes. One way that the history program is doing this is by offering Tennessee

History and African American History on-ground in both the fall and spring semesters (they used to alternate on-ground, one fall, the other spring).

2. **Academic Integrity:** Having robust technology and course design training to prevent and detect AI use is essential to improving student learning and ensuring the student success is authentic.
3. **Classrooms:** Having white boards that span the full length of the wall would much improve clear communication in the classroom and improve student learning and effective note-taking.

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 4 initiatives in total.

General education areas may include separate action plans for each discipline or may label each initiative to identify which discipline is responsible for the initiative within its area if deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
1.	Create more robust, targeted assistance for students of color and others through history tutoring at the Learning Commons. (SL)	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of history projects/essays.	Delois Reagan and history faculty who participate in Learning Commons tutoring-Stella Pierce, Merritt McKinney, Melanie Cochran	Close the gap in success rates for students of color to an 80% success rate	By S25, have a published schedule of history faculty availability at the learning commons with targeted outreach for students of color	
2.	Identify a broad range of clear, well-defined, techniques in both course/assignment design training and technological	to support genuine academic rigor and dissuade academic dishonesty	Distributed Ed or IT as well as faculty from a broad	As far as I know, data is not collected through RASI on academic integrity so developing	In one year, have collected data on AI cases from student services and academic	

	software to prevent and detect AI use, also normalize faculty use of AI detection		range of disciplines	performance indicators will require information from Student Services and the Academic integrity	integrity committee from which we can determine frequency of AI use and correlation to success rates	
3.	Reduce instructor bureaucratic workload and streamline assessment data reporting including ALERTS	Free up instructor time to spend engaging with students, providing targeted feedback, ALERTS and direct assistance	RASI team, IT, and eLearn with feedback from faculty		By S25, determine feasibility of integrating ALERTS into eLearn and research software that will allow assessment tool (watermark/VIA) integration into eLearn rubrics	
4.	More full time history faculty	Increase student learning and success through more focused, devoted, and better paid faculty, IE full-timers	HPEG department would be responsible for hiring committee, approval would come from Pres, VP		Realistically, we can probably determine get approval within a year.	

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

- No budget requirements for item 1 (tutoring, targeting assistance).** History faculty are already acting as tutors in LC. The only progress that needs to be made is consistency and creating a published schedule, which Delois has begun planning
- Budget needs for item 2 (AI detection) might include:** AI detection software and more manpower in Distributed Ed (desperately in need already).
- Budget needs for item 3 (eLearn integration of assessment software and ALERTS system) might include:** improved assessment software and more manpower in IT and Distributed Ed to do the backend work and training.
- Budget needs for item 4 (Full-time History Faculty) will include:** salary and benefits for full-time faculty.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee Review

Members of the General Education Committee will review the GER and provide feedback.

Please attach committee minutes and any other applicable documentation regarding the committee's discussion.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

4/3/24.

Going forward, the history department needs to set achievement targets. This is the faculty's responsibility, though Theresa and I are available to help you work through that. For this cycle, you do not need to go backwards. It could be something like, "75% of students will meet SLO X" and could be an improvement over what the data is showing currently or a target to maintain if already sufficiently high.

Initiatives

Bear in mind that all of the initiatives you set for the department this year will have to be planned out, executed, and reported on annually over the coming three years. Going into Fall 2024, you will have to create a plan for how each initiative will be implemented. There should be at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives.

Initiative 1: "Create more robust, targeted assistance for students of color and others through history tutoring at the Learning Commons."

This initiative focuses on student support. Under current state and TBR directives, we are unable to targeted programs for minority students. However, we may develop interventions to deploy or make available to all students that would encompass minority students in the effort. Also, what exactly do you intend to measure here - how many history faculty are providing tutoring or student success rates? The information you've listed as 'baseline data' is really a timeline. This initiative needs some work to be measurable, and the focus of needs to be expanded to include improvement for all students taking history classes.

Initiative 2: identify a broad range of clear, well-defined, techniques in both course/assignment design training and technological software to prevent and detect AI use, also normalize faculty use of AI detection

This initiative also seems related to student support, though it will require a great amount of collaboration to plan and complete.

Initiative 3: Reduce instructor bureaucratic workload and streamline assessment data reporting including ALERTS

While I understand the rationale and support the idea, this initiative may prove difficult to accomplish simply because of the onus on other departments and technological limitations. Even so, RASI, DE, and IT cannot help us unless we work with them to identify and implement changes. It's important, but it also is not clearly tied to student learning outcomes or student support. I recommend replacing initiative 3 with something focused specifically on sustaining or improving student learning outcomes.

Initiative 4: More full time history faculty

Let's think about how best to support this by tying it to student learning. In your initiative chart, you say "Increase student learning and success through more focused, devoted, and better paid faculty, IE full-timers." To do this effectively with data, you have to analyze what is already happening and establish a baseline. I would like to see an analysis of student learning outcomes between full-time faculty and adjuncts within the history department. I spoke with Theresa, and she says that she can show you how to pull that data. Additionally, I recommend analyzing outcomes and success rates by modality within the department. The results of such studies could highlight any number of things that need to be addressed through targeted faculty development, communication/collaboration improvements, curriculum changes, and/or student support initiatives.

Comparing the full-time to adjunct ratio within History to that of other general education departments is informative. I have a report generated by Academic Affairs that contains this information. Within the SSE division, the percentage of history adjuncts is on the low side (40.74%) compared to sociology (47.06%), Psychology (53.06%). Only lower-enrolled areas (ECON, GEOG, POLS) have low adjunct rates within this department. Comparatively, BIOL has a less than 4% adjunct rate, CHEM has about 23%, COMM has about 43%, and ENGL has about 20%. Additional details are below.

Academic Year 2023-2024

Row Labels	Count of FT/PT	Sum of TLE	% of TLE
HIST	17 162	100.00%	
Adjunct	10 66	40.74%	
On Tenure Track	1 15	9.26%	
Tenured	5 66	40.74%	
Term	1 15	9.26%	

SOCI	6 51	100.00%
Adjunct	3 24	47.06%
On Tenure Track	1 9	17.65%
Tenured	2 18	35.29%

PSYC	16 147	100.00%
Adjunct	11 78	53.06%
On Tenure Track	2 30	20.41%
Tenured	2 30	20.41%
Term	1 9	6.12%

ECON	5 42	100.00%
Adjunct	3 12	28.57%
Tenured	1 15	35.71%
Term	1 15	35.71%

BIOL	18 252.4	100.00%
Adjunct	1 9	3.57%
Non-Tenured Track	1 14	5.55%
On Tenure Track	5 72	28.53%
Tenured	9 124.4	49.29%
Term	2 33	13.07%
CHEM	6 56	100.00%
Adjunct	2 13	23.21%
On Tenure Track	1 10	17.86%
Tenured	3 33	58.93%

COMM	20 154.2	100.00%
------	----------	---------

Adjunct	11	66	42.80%
On Tenure Track	2	16.2	10.51%
Tenured	7	72	46.69%

ENGL	35	360.1	100.00%
Adjunct	11	72	19.99%
Non-Tenure Track	2	24	6.66%
On Tenure Track	9	108	29.99%
Tenured	13	156.1	43.35%

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Changes if applicable</i>	<i>Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video created. -Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. - Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	-Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. -	No changes to the timeline.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1.					

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Achieved Milestones (Fall 2025 – Summer 2026)</i>	<i>Challenges</i>	<i>Performance Indicator Result</i>	<i>Initiative Achieved? Yes/No</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	-The tutorial video was launched in the model shell -Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. -The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	- none.	-The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% -PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	-No
1.					

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix provided.

Narrative:

6.C INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

	<i>Initiative</i>	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
Ex.				
1.				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- Cycle 2

Criminal Justice AAS & CERT

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	
The mission of the Criminal Justice program is to be the leader in educating future criminal justice practitioners by providing students with the skills needed to critically examine the world around them, the ability to understand and embrace the diversity of the society in which they serve and live, and the continuing desire to learn more about themselves, society, and the criminal justice field. The Criminal Justice program encourages students to use problem solving skills, to communicate clearly both verbally and in writing, to evaluate the various methodologies used to measure crime, to compare and contrast theoretical perspectives, to interpret case law, and to describe the functions/roles of law enforcement, courts, and corrections. There has been no change in the mission statement. The program probably needs to rephrase “embrace the diversity of the society in which they serve” to “embrace the society in which they live and serve,” in order to follow the current trend in TBR. The purposes of these two mission statements is about building innovative education programs and strengthening community ties while embracing people from all backgrounds. The main idea in promoting these goals is to provide a student who are ready for successful careers when they graduate.	

Evidence:

- Mission Statement Audit

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan attached as evidence details the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

Section 2a: Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment- Assessment Plan

The program had identified two student learning outcome for the Criminal Justice Certificate. These are:

1. Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills necessary for an entry level position in the criminal justice field. and
2. Students will demonstrate an understanding of the organizational structure, common legal terms, definitions, concepts, and roles of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.

The program learning outcomes are measured through an one hundred question exit exam. Students must meet a target score of at least an eighty-five percent in order to show knowledge attainment. The program learning outcomes are also measured through three core classes in the Criminal Justice AAS nad certificates. Students must score a seventy percent or above to show knowledge attainment. These are measured through a learning outcome assessment embedded in the courses. The learning outcome assessments are given each semester. The rubrics and evidence are provided within the evidence of this section.

The program added a Corrections Certificate in the fall of 2023 as part of a governor’s initiative to provide more education and jobs in the State of Tennessee. This added the PLO’s which are tracked in the CRMJ 2020 Learning Outcome Assessment. These new PLO’s are below and are going through curriculum committee to be added to the catalog. No data is available for the new certificate due to how recently it was added. The rubric for the learning outcome assessment for the Corrections Certificate needs to be added.

Corrections CERT PLO’s

- Discuss the history of corrections, special populations in corrections, gangs, and PREA (Prison Rape Elimination Act).
- Identify issues concerning mental illness, suicide prevention, officer wellness, cultural diversity, and sexual harassment in corrections.
- Relate communication, report writing, and intelligence-gathering techniques to a corrections environment.
- Identify and cite laws concerning use of force, duty to intervene, and constitutional and civil rights laws for corrections populations.

The following questions are form the Learning Outcome Assessment for CRMJ 2020 Corrections and will be used to gauge success in learning the above PLO’s:

1. Corrections can be viewed as a series of processes that are _____, meaning that each process affects another part of the criminal justice system in some way. (Question 3)
2. Which of the following is NOT one of the four commonly accepted goals of criminal sanctions in the United States? (Question 4)
3. Which of the following is NOT an issue for correctional institutes dealing with offenders who have HIV/AIDS? (Question 10)
4. A judicial order asking correctional officials to produce the prisoner and to give reasons to justify continued confinement is called a writ of _____. (Question 19)
5. The number of Section 1983 lawsuits among both state and federal prisoners dropped dramatically following the passage of the _____. (Question 21)
6. The first juvenile court in the U.S. was established by legislative act in 1899 in what city? (Question 23)
7. Which Supreme Court case defines how to run a modern correctional facility? (Question 25)
8. What U.S. Constitutional amendment; and right within that amendment, is most often cited by the courts regarding prisoner rights violations? (Question 28)

The curriculum has changed slightly due to adding new classes for the certificate and making the Criminal Justice AAS fully attainable online. The catalog description and recommended schedule are:

General Education Requirements - Credits (15-16)

- [COMM 2025 - ^Fundamentals of Communication](#) Credits: (3)
- **OR** [COMM 2045 - ^Public Speaking](#) Credits: (3)
- [ENGL 1010 - ^English Composition I](#) Credits: (3)
- [Humanities and/or Fine Arts](#) Credits: (3)
- [Mathematics](#) Credits: (3-4)
- **OR** [Natural Science](#) Credits: (3-4)
- [Social/Behavioral Sciences](#) Credits: (3)

Major Core Course Requirements - Credits (30)

- [CRMJ 1010 - Introduction to Criminal Justice](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1020 - Introduction to the Legal Process](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1311 - Criminal Law](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1340 - Criminal Investigation](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1355 - Understanding Terrorism](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 1360 - Introduction to Crime Scene Investigation](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2010 - Introduction to Law Enforcement](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2020 - Introduction to Corrections](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2312 - Criminology](#) Credits: (3)
- [CRMJ 2390 - Probation and Parole](#) Credits: (3)

CRMJ Electives - Credits (15)

- CRMJ Electives (Choose from the following list or consult with the Program Advisor for approved course options) Credits: (15)

[CITC 2352 - *Digital Forensics](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 1325 - Issues and Ethics in Criminal Justice](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 1341 - *Physical Defensive Tactics](#) Credits: (4)
[CRMJ 1381 - *Interview and Interrogation](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2311 - Juvenile Justice](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2332 - Drug Identification and Effects](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2340 - Investigative Report Writing](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2381 - Selected Topics in Criminal Justice](#) Credits: (1-6)
[CRMJ 2395 - Corporate Security and Loss Prevention](#) Credits: (3)
[CRMJ 2396 - Criminal Justice Internship I](#) Credits: (3)
[HED 200 - First Aid and Safety/CPR](#) Credits: (3)

The program is making CRMJ 2340 a major course requirement due to feedback from the advisory board. The board has identified writing reports as a major issue with new recruits and specifically requested the college to make sure students are taking this course (September 2020 Advisory Board). This request has passed curriculum committee review, and the change will be in the next catalog.

The program has added a new corrections certificate based on identified need from the governor. This has allowed the program to receive special funding through a grant. The program has also analyzed the class schedule and front-loaded program courses in the student schedule in an effort to help retention. The sequencing in the program meets a cross section of classes that support the mission statement in preparing students for careers in the criminal justice field.

The assessment plan includes an evaluation of core concepts in core courses. These core courses have been identified by the TBR and program stakeholders to contain knowledge necessary for success in the criminal justice field. The questions identified have provided a cross-sectional framework of knowledge, skills and abilities needed to progress not only in core and elective courses, but in on-the-job success in the future. Data from these evaluations shows consistency in determining whether the goals were met, with very few outliers to explain.

Evidence:

- CRMJ AAS Cert Assessment Tool
- CRMJ Evidence Email
- Criminal Justice AAS Exit Exam

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

CRMJ AAS

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result	(Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			59.55%	40.45%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 2			88.30%	11.70%	61.97%	38.03%		
PLO 3			87.66	12.34%	88.32%	11.68%		
PLO 4			63.42%	36.58%	62.50%	37.50%		
PLO 5			60.98%	39.02%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 6			16.97%	83.03%	5.88%	94.12%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.1			61.59%	38.41%	59.42%	40.58%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.2			60.37%	39.63%	60.14%	39.86%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.5			63.41%	36.59%	59.42%	40.58%		

Course Learning Outcomes- CRMJ1010.1 Goals CRMJ 1010.2 Components CRMJ 1010.5 State and Federal

CRMJ TC

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result	(Met/Not Met)
PLO 1			59.55%	40.45%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 2			58.16%	41.84%	61.97%	38.03%		
PLO 3			87.59%	12.41%	88.32%	11.68%		
PLO 4			63.42%	36.58%	62.50%	37.50%		
PLO 5			60.98%	39.02%	60.87%	39.13%		
PLO 6			16.97%	83.03%	5.88%	94.12%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.1			61.59%	38.41%	59.42%	40.58%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.2			60.37%	39.63%	60.14%	39.86%		
Course Learning Outcome 1010.5			63.41%	36.59%	59.42%	40.58%		

Course Learning Outcomes CRMJ1010.1 Goals CRMJ1010.2 Components CRMJ1010.5 State & Federal

1. Analysis of trends

The PLO's Data shows that approximately sixty percent of students are meeting the learning outcomes for section 1 Terms and Concepts, 4 Evidence and Investigation, 5 Organizational Structure, and eighty-eight percent of students are meeting learning outcomes for section 2 Individual Rights and 3 Safety procedures and Protocol. There is no data for section 6 Entry Level Skills.

PLO's by gender are in line with the data shown overall. The trend, with one exception, show that females scored slightly above the class average while males scored slightly below the class average. Traditionally, we have more female students in the classes, so outliers will be less of an effect for them in the classes.

PLO's for Pell Grant and First-Generation students are not as consistent as the previous areas. In many areas, these subsections of students scored better than the class average. The areas Pell Grant students scored lower were terms and organizational structure. First generational students scored higher in the 21-22 academic year than they did in the 22-23 academic year. In some cases, their scores were significantly higher.

PLO's involving race showed that minorities scores were fairly consistent in AY 21-22 with their scores just below the class average. This trend remained the same for black students in 22-23, but the Hispanic population showed a remarkable increase in AT 22-23 going from a 58% success rate to over a 90% success rate.

The CLO's were in line with the PLO's and show approximately sixty percent for knowledge attainment for all ten areas.

The exit exam results show that the program is not meeting its goals in this area. For Fall 2021 the average was sixty-one percent and only one student reached the goal of eighty-five percent. The average for Spring 2022 was seventy-two percent with one student meeting the required eighty-five percent. The average for Fall 2022 was seventy-five percent with no students reaching the eighty-five percent threshold. The average for Spring 2023 was sixty-eight percent with no students meeting the threshold. The average for Summer 2023 was seventy percent with no students reaching the eighty five percent threshold. The average for Fall 2023 was seventy-eight percent with two students meeting the threshold. The average for Summer 2024 was eighty-seven percent with the one student reaching the threshold. The average for Spring 2024 was sixty-six percent with no students reaching the threshold.

2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

The program is still recovering from an enormous shift of student population going online after covid. Students are generally not as successful in online formats. The program is actively recruiting in person students to help with student success. TBR has recently stated that the preferred method of instruction is in person. The program is in the process of revising/re-developing online courses to provide current and meaningful learning tools to enhance student success. The program is also focusing on developing OER classes and has developed three such classes to enhance student learning. The program will support online learners by working with the library and learning commons to encourage students to use the services provided and track data.

The program has also received funding from grants to promote project-based learning and job skills in classes. This delivery method helps non-traditional and minority students be successful in class. Data shows that minorities are only slightly below class average, and a remarkable improvement of Hispanics in the second year evaluated. The program encourages a variety of teaching methods to improve comprehension and

retention of core concepts to increase understanding of core concepts. The program also supports several of the TBR HIPs to improve student success. These include internships, certificates, advising by program leaders, international education, service learning, interactive learning, and technology usage in the classroom.

The results of the exit exam are disappointing, but could be drastically improved with two things. The test is a two-year comprehensive test covering the classes in the program. An eighty-five percent pass rate is extremely high and only five students in 3 years met this requirement. A seventy percent is passing with a "C" in college. Based on the fact that seventy percent shows knowledge attainment and the fact this is a comprehensive test covering two years of college course, the program should track rates of seventy percent or better. If tracked at this level, the average for each semester except for two would be met. A majority of students, twenty-five, would meet the threshold. The second item for improvement would be to develop a study guide for the test. This would help students familiarize themselves with material that they may have been exposed to several semesters ago.

Evidence:

- CRMJ 1010 CLOs AY21-23
- CRMJ AAS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- CRMJ AAS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- CRMJ AAS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- CRMJ TC PLOs Gender AY21-23
- CRMJ TC PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- CRMJ TC PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- Criminal Justice AAS Exit Exam
- Criminal Justice AAS PLOs AY21-23
- Criminal Justice TC PLO_s AY21-23

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

Analysis of the program fact sheet shows the continued decline in enrollment since covid. Criminal justice is traditionally an in-person major with lots of hands-on activities. The swing in student registration to online programs has had an effect on enrollment. There has been a drastic decrease in full-time students since 2021. This trend shows an approximate fifteen percent shift in full-time students versus part-time students. Providing PLA's for current law enforcement officers may have increased our part-time students. This would explain why there was a raise in part-time enrollment in 2021, while the full-time students declined. Enrollment has been down across the college and the program is in line or better with the college enrollment shifts over this period. Factbook shows that enrollment in 2020 was 8,619 for the college and that it dropped to 6,623 in 2023. According to Factbook, the criminal justice enrollment in 2020 was 82, but dropped to 54 in 2023.

Graduate data shows an improvement since 2020. 2021 shows a drastic improvement with students returning from covid to complete their degree.

Placement data is absent from this report. Previous staff indicated the office of IERPA was responsible for keeping this data. As of now, it is unknown how the data is to be tracked. However, based on continued faculty communication with graduates, students are being employed at local departments at a constant rate.

Retention showed a markable increase each year from 2019 to 2022. 2019-2022. Retention increases from 11 percent to 28 percent in 2021. It increased again to 48 percent in 2022. Retention then dropped off in 2023 to 41 percent. There was a slight decline in retention in 2023, dropping to 41%. There are two factors that have been identified to account for this change. The first factor is the substantial increase in part-time students and a significant lower enrollment the year prior. Part-time students are not as likely to complete a degree. The second is the employment rates increased in 2022, causing lower enrollment and more people returning to work. The employment change is a result from rising wages. These facts are confirmed in an email from Assistant Chief Bill Sorrells. (A new system is being created to track persistence retention. Currently persistence numbers are not available)

An analysis of student survey responses show that Vol State criminal justice faculty are consistently rated very high in all categories. The strength of faculty involves teaching methodology and assessments that provide hands on collaborative learning, engaging classroom environments and faculty with practical experience. Survey data showed a slight indication for two areas of improvement. These are:

1. "The instructor posted graded assignments and provided feedback on my progress in this course in a timely manner." and;
2. The instructor was accessible by appointment, office hours, emails, phone, online, as indicated in the syllabus."

When evaluating the instructors in the program, there were rare instances where grades could have been posted more frequently. The previous dean indicated that posting grades was a part of the instructional freedom of the college. It is now a part of the evaluation process and instructors can be held accountable in this area. Additionally, the program is developing a weekly form to help track the work completed in areas that the college evaluates for full-time faculty. This will help instructors when it is time for their evaluation to show proof for the areas evaluated.

The outlook for the criminal justice field is good. The change in the law enforcement climate since 2020 and the reforms pressuring departments and officers has subsided. As a result, jobs in the field are numerous and the pay has substantially increased. Local departments are currently hiring officers with no experience and a starting pay of over \$65,000. Some of the improvements of the plan since the last audit are:

- Employment and Career resource on eLearn.
- Front loading the sequence of classes to accommodate more major-based courses and allowing for English to be moved to the spring semester of freshman year.
- Making the AAS fully attainable online.
- Increasing PLA credits for certifications in the workforce.
- Revising/re-developing online courses to make them more up to date and providing OER
- Program Focusing on TBR's HIPs
- Receiving grants through different sources in order to provide technological advances in the classroom for hands on learning.
- Creating a new corrections certificate
- Offered TCI corrections classes to students and local law enforcement.

- Increasing full-time faculty
- Decreasing adjunct faculty
- Promoting hands on collaborative learning to all faculty
- Creating a criminal justice lab
- High attendance at recruitment events by faculty
- Advancing SkillsUSA

The program recently implemented an online career resource module that is open to all students throughout their student career. This was accomplished by taking a discontinued course and converting it to a resource for all careers in criminal justice that students can use to discover criminal justice careers, employment, and success in the program by understanding the careers available and how those careers meet their aptitude.

The program has also changed the schedule to enable students to front load major classes. This was a TBR initiative last year. Data suggests that providing their major courses in the beginning of their college career allows them to be more successful. Courses were also developed so that the Criminal Justice AAS degree could be completed fully online. This, along with the addition of PLA credits has increased part-time enrollment.

While this can be seen as a factor that has led to lower persistence and retention, it did help offset the lower enrollment to some extent. The Criminal Justice AAS degree was also made fully available online for the first time. This also supports the addition of part-time students who are returning to school. In an effort to support online students, course have been redesigned to be more in line with current practices. These include adding three OER sections, with plans to add more in the coming years. The program also focuses on TBR's HIPs to increase student success. The program currently supports work-based learning with internships at several local locations. The additional certificate now provides two certifications for students, as well as other embedded certifications. The program is active in advising students both academically and professionally. This involvement has resulted in several students obtaining employment after they graduate. The program has also purchased several items to increase the use of technology in the classroom.

The program has received funding from Perkins and other school-based grants to provide new equipment such as simulators and duty belts. The program also received funding from an initiative from the governor to increase corrections personnel. This funding provided \$80,000 in resources for equipment and program needs as well as funding for an additional full-time faculty member. This funding and equipment has enabled the program to complete a criminal justice lab with new technology, especially in the field of corrections. These purchase help in advancing the newly created corrections certificate as well as supporting the enrollment in local agencies in the Tennessee Corrections Institute classes offered on Vol State campus to both students and local officers. The addition of a full-time faculty member has allowed for the reduction in adjunct faculty. This saves the program money and provides consistency to students in the program. It also allowed for more collaborative teaching with hands-on learning objectives that are preferred in the criminal justice setting.

The additional faculty member also allowed for the program faculty to get more involved with campus initiatives and recruiting. The criminal justice program was present at almost every recruiting event and career fair the college hosted in the last year. These include events at the distance learning locations.

The program was also the first at the college to take part in SkillsUSA. SkillsUSA is a career and technical organization that allows students to compete against other schools, provides training, and places students in touch with employers for training and job placement. Initial attempts to grow this student based academic program were problematic, especially in securing a source of funding. Through the efforts of the program, the students have been labeled as an academic entity and receive funding through the college. This has allowed SkillsUSA to expand to other programs. Students have been very successful in this endeavor, winning first place in state every year, and placing in nationals every year with eight first place awards to students on the national stage.

Evidence:

- Criminal Justice AAS- Fact Sheet FA23- Adjusted
- Criminal Justice Student Course Evals AY20-23
- Criminal Justice TC Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
1 (SS)	Provide students with viable affordable learning options in an online setting and encourage use of resources at VolState	Increase offering of OER online classes and support services	Program director and criminal justice faculty	Develop three more OER courses and collect data on support services	By next academic audit 2027	There are currently only two OER online options in the program. CRMJ 2312 CRMJ 2311
2 (SS)	Track successful student employment after graduation	Develop a student and employer survey to track data	IERPA or current office responsible for the data	At least 30 percent of graduates job placement is tracked after graduation	2024	There is currently no baseline as this data has not been tracked for several years.
3 (SL)	Increase lowest PLO from class learning outcomes	Provide students with updated curriculum that supports success in this PLO	Program directors and faculty	Increase student learning outcomes for identified PLO	2025	The lowest PLO attainment was forty percent.

4 (SS)	Increase persistence and retention, in the program	Director and program faculty will continue using instructional methods to support academic student success in all modalities.	Director and program faculty	Increase persistence 25% and retention 18%	2025	Student persistence is currently 23% and retention is 15%
5 (SL)	Increase student exit exam scores (PLO 1)	Provide students with study materials that will support the successful completion of the exit exam	Director	Increase successful exam results by five percent	2025	Class averages per semester Fall 21 61% Spring 22 72% Fall 22 75% Spring 23 68% Summer 23 70% Fall 23 78% Summer 24 87% Fall 24 65%

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Narrative:

The only budgeting needs from the improvement matrix would be to update the online courses and make these OER. Currently the cost for developing courses in house is \$2400 a course. So the total cost would be \$7200 to meet this goal. There are, however, grants through the TBR that will provide money at no cost for the college to develop these courses. The program will be exploring these options as well.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A Instructional Assessment Committee Review

The Instructional Assessment Committee will conduct a review of the APR. The Committee will provide feedback of the completed APR and action plan as a supportive step.

Narrative:

Mission Statement Alignment

The mission of the program is aligned with significant portions of the institutional mission

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcome Assessment

The review describes two program-level learning outcomes and the method of assessment of each. The review calls these learning outcomes. I suggest it would clarify the document to call these PLOs since the discussion also mentions assessment of course-level learning outcomes to assess the second PLO. The assessments and targets seem appropriate for the program.

One suggestion would be to separate the AAS program and the Cert program in the program review section. As a person without familiarity with the criminal justice program, blending the discussion of these two different programs makes it difficult for me to follow this thread. For example, what part of the curriculum applies to the AAS that doesn't apply to the Cert?

The modification of the curriculum to require the CRMJ 2340 course is a great example of responding to externally identified student deficiencies.

Evidence of Student Learning

I think I am not following the PLOs being measured in this section. In 2A, it appears that goals are set at 80% for one learning objective and 70% for another learning objective but in this section, there are more objectives listed and it appears that 60% is labelled as meeting the objective. I must be misunderstanding.

Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

Very good analysis of current enrollment trends.

Improvement Initiatives

I am not in the program area and so cannot directly relate to the needs of this program, but I would note that the anticipated move towards increasing online options in this program is counter to the plans for other programs in the college. Other programs are moving to offer more in-person options. Similarly, as an outsider I would question if the lack of interactions between students and mentoring faculty in online education would be detrimental to the development of the students.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Dean's should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

Section 2a

As written:

Success for the second learning outcome is gauged by six learning outcomes in three core classes for the Criminal Justice AAS and Criminal Justice Certificate. *A student must score a seventy percent or above to show knowledge attainment.* These are measured through a learning outcome assessment embedded in the courses. *The target is to have every student pass the test with at least an eighty percent success rate.* The learning outcome assessments are given each semester. The rubrics and evidence are provided within the evidence of this section.

Above, you state two different targets, 70% and 80%. Please clarify.

Further, documentation attached to the review indicates there are 6 PLOs, the last of which is measured by an exit exam. The numbering and description provided in the narrative does not align with the supporting documentation. #1 equals #6 and #2 equals #1. Numbers 2, 3, 4, 5, and 5 are not mapped in any comprehensible way. They should be consistently numbered and labeled in all parts of the report and supporting documentation.

As written:

- 1. Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills necessary for an entry level position in the criminal justice field, and
- 2. Students will demonstrate an understanding of the organizational structure, common legal terms, definitions, concepts, and roles of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.

Attached:

- 1. Students will demonstrate an understanding of common legal terms, definitions, and concepts of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.
- 2. Students will identify individual rights as they apply to law enforcement interaction as they apply to the public.
- 3. Students will apply safety procedures and protocol to law enforcement situations.
- 4. Students will analyze evidentiary and investigation procedures.
- 5. Students will demonstrate the organizational structure, evolution, and roles of law enforcement, the courts, and corrections.
- 6. Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills necessary for an entry level position in the criminal justice field.

Lastly, please provide evidence to support the following claims:

- The program is making CRMJ 2340 a major course requirement due to feedback from the advisory board. The board has identified writing reports as a major issue with new recruits and specifically requested the college to make sure students are taking this course.
- The program has added a new corrections certificate based on identified need from the community....Data has shown this helps students success rates in college.

Section 2.B

Please correct the typos where commas are used instead of decimals.

It should be stated that students are performing below the target level, whether that is 70 or 80%.

Why is there no data for PLO 6, Entry Level Skills? Was the exit exam not administered as planned? If not, explain why it was not.

In addition to increasing the use of OER, I would like to see a plan to support online learners. You stated that the program has received grant funding to promote problem based learning and job skills. In my view, those resources need to be made available to online students in some way.

Section 3

Please provide evidence to support these claims:

- Enrollment has been down across the college and the program is in line or better with the college enrollment shifts over this period.
- The second is the employment rates increased in 2022, causing lower enrollment and more people returning to work.

The student survey data indicates a slight, but noticeable trend in two areas:

- The instructor posted graded assignments and provided feedback on my progress in this course in a timely manner.
- The instructor was accessible by appointment, office hours, emails, phone, online, as indicated in the syllabus.

Please comment on these areas and explain what, if anything is or can be done to improve them.

Section 4

Initiative 1, please include the course numbers that are currently using OER in the baseline data. Courses may be redeveloped for compensation through the Distance Learning office's existing budget if faculty apply and are awarded a contract, or faculty may apply for a TBR OER grant. No division or department funds are currently available to compensate faculty for this work.

I would like to see initiative 4's objective expanded to include all modalities. Director and program faculty will continue using instructional methods to support academic student success in all modalities.

Initiatives 1, 2, and 4 are student success oriented while #3 is about tracking student learning outcomes. The expectation stated is that the matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives, so you are currently short one initiative related to student learning.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Note that the matrix was incorrectly formatted and difficult to comprehend at the time of the Year 2 updates made in August-September, 2025. This is a link to the matrix with its original content as well as our revisions: [Assessment Initiatives Tracking F25.docx](#). The table inserted here reflects only the revised versions (without the original content that has been replaced).

Initiative	Measure	Target	Baseline	Who	Due Date	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes, if Applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1 (Student Success)	Increase offering of	Develop three more	There are only 2 OER courses in	Program director and	By next academic	As of August 2025, 2/3	CRMJ 1311- Criminal Law was	In August 2025, we narrowed	During AY 24-25, two courses (CRMJ 1010 Intro

Provide students with viable affordable learning options in an online setting	OER online classes	OER courses	the program. CRMJ 2312 CRMJ 2311	criminal justice faculty	audit 2027	of the goal has been met.	contracted but not complete due to loss of the program director in May 2025. Funds from Distance Education are limited, delaying additional development during AY25-26.	the focus of this initiative to only OER course development because it should not be conflated with the encouraging online students to use the library and learning commons resources. These student support services are already accessible to online students in every course, and a more focused initiative in this vein might be appropriate in the future based on an analysis of online and on-ground student success rates.	to CJ and CRMJ 1355 (Understanding Terrorism) were redeveloped with OER and received approval from Distance Learning in May 2025. In August 2025, the faculty identified the following priorities for additional OER model course development: 1. 2020 Introduction to Corrections – by Kevin Cook AY25-26 2. 2010 Introduction to Law Enforcement – by Catherina Castiglione AY25-26 3. 1020 Introduction to Legal Process – TBD 4. 1311 Criminal Law – TBD Note that this initiative aligns to initiative #5 in the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 .
2 (Student Success) Track successful student employment after graduation	Develop a student and employer survey to track data	At least 30 percent of graduates job placement is tracked after graduation	There is currently no baseline as this data has not been tracked for several years. Plan has been established to track these.	RASI and program director	2024	In Fall 2024, RASI prepared a survey and provided instructions and training to program directors and deans.	Three challenges exist. 1. Student engagement, 2. the timeline for survey collection, and 3. a manual distribution process of employer surveys required of program directors after students respond. RASI creates 3 surveys and deploys them all on	None, N/A	June 2025, Dean Gregory emailed graduates to encourage completion of their two surveys. Spring & Summer graduate data is collected from October to August of the following year. Fall graduate data is collected from February to August. Reports become available September 30 th for the prior academic year. Employer surveys are also available for distribution and collection at the same time, but not after.

							the same timeline: 2 students go to students (graduate satisfaction and job placement are separate surveys) and 1 is created for employers. RASI emails the 2 student surveys. Program directors are responsible for contacting the employers identified in the student's survey response.		At the time of this report, data for 2024 graduates is still being collected. No respondents (to date) provided any employer information, so we are unable to distribute the employer satisfaction survey. Note that this initiative aligns to initiative #2 of the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 .
3 (Student Learning) Implement improved assessment instruments being used to measure student learning.	Completion of project: Assessments will be updated across all model courses to remove errors, and outcomes will be assessed by more than one exam question.	<u>AAS PLO 1:</u> 70% Met	<u>AAS PLO 1</u> AY21-22 59.55% (293) Met 40.45% (199) Not Met AY22-23 60.87% (252) 39.13% (162) Not Met	Program director and faculty	December 2025	None yet	August-September 2025: As written, the initiative lacked clarity and purpose. The former director had not shared or discussed this initiative or PLO data with the other full-time faculty members. Faculty identified that some of the course assessments contained errors such as incorrectly marked answer options and misspelled words. Further, the outcomes are only being assessed by a singular question on one exam.	September 2025: Rewrote the initiative and measure, focusing on overall improvement of the assessment instruments to correct the errors and challenges noted. Revised the baseline to reflect attached evidence. Set a specific target at 70% (C or better equivalent). Set a December 2025 due date.	While completing the program curriculum map this fall, we noted that PLO 1 (terms and concepts) is introduced in CRMJ 1010 and developed in every course thereafter. To improve visibility alongside other program initiatives, we included the tracking of this revised initiative into the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 and plan to follow-up with additional analysis in future years to measure its impact.
4 (Student Success) Identify curriculum updates	Increase persistence and retention, in the program	60% retention rate 70% persistence	August 2025 data: Retention rates in the AAS program	Program Director and Faculty	2025	No	In the drafting of this initiative and his initial update in Spring 2025,	September 2025: Rewrote this initiative, measure, and target,	The process of curriculum review is being tracked in detail as part of initiative #6 of

needed to support student success initiatives so that all AAS graduates also earn the two embedded certificates to improve retention and persistence rates		rate	ranged from 25% to 56.3% over the past 5 years. Retention from F23 to F24 was 47.4%, compared to 49% in the college overall. Persistence rates ranged from 46.4% to 87.5% over the past 5 years. Fall 23 to Spring 24 persistence was 63.2% compared to 72.6% at the college.				the former director conflated curriculum sequencing and delivery formats with actual instructional methods. The measure and target as presented are not specific nor measurable. Further, the baseline data reported was inaccurate.	citing accurate baseline data.	the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 .
5 (Student Learning) Increase student exit exam scores (PLO 1)	Provide students with study materials that will support the successful completion of the exit exam	Increase successful exam results by five percent	Class averages per semester: Fall 21 61% Spring 22 72% Fall 22 75% Spring 23 68% Summer 23 70% Fall 23 78% Summer 24 87% Fall 24 65%	Program Director	2025	None	The former director only shared the study guide with the Testing Center and one other full-time faculty member. Additional distribution methods are needed to increase student awareness of the exam as well as of the study guide and how to use it.	August 2025, CJ faculty determined to create additional distribution avenues to make the study guide widely accessible to all students in the AAS program. Note that this initiative and its action steps are tracked in the Action Plan AA CRMJ 2025 , initiative #4.	Spring 2025, the former director created a study guide and provided it to the Testing Center at Vol State. In August 2025, the Testing Center Director added a link to the Criminal Justice Exit Exam study guide to the Testing Center webpage (under Graduation Exit Exams), on the Graduation Exit Exams webpage , and within their online scheduling system when students select the Criminal Justice Exit Exam.

Narrative:

There are some overarching challenges facing the department at the time of this update. One major challenge that will be noted in the matrix is that the program director position was vacated in May 2025, leaving the department without direct leadership and one full-time faculty member short. Related, the remaining program faculty reported to the dean that they were unaware of the assessment process and the level of detail required in managing implementation and tracking of the identified initiatives. Further, some initiatives were written without measurable or specific targets despite earlier feedback provided to the former director; this input has been documented in previous sections of this report. The two remaining full-time faculty members are 9/10-month employees who do not work through the summer on program-related initiatives outside of optional teaching assignments. This left the Year 2 update work for the Fall 2025 semester.

The TBR academic audit of the program occurred last year, AY24-25, and included a self-study that was written by the former program director. The audit resulted in a separate set of program improvement initiatives that must be planned, implemented,

tracked, and reported on annually for the next five years, at which time the audit will be repeated. There are some overlapping initiatives between this internal reporting process and the TBR audit, but not all initiatives overlap.

Finally, the program curriculum has not been properly mapped to identify which course learning outcomes align to specific program learning outcomes and the degree to which those outcomes are introduced, developed, or mastered throughout the curriculum. All combined, these challenges create a sizable amount of work to sort through, prioritize, and complete - all in service to improving program outcomes and student success. Program faculty, an interim department chair from the Sociology, Psychology, and Social Work department, and I are working together currently to accomplish this work and provide a clearer direction for future success.

~Dean Rhonda Gregory, written 8/26/25 and revised 9/29/25

Reviewed and confirmed at department meetings, fall 2025 (minutes available upon request)

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort A- University Parallel Cycle 2

University Parallel AA & AS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
"Be a great program"	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	

Evidence:

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Volunteer State Community College's University Parallel program offers Associates of Arts and Associate of Science degrees in sixty-seven areas of emphasis. The programs span five academic divisions: Business, Humanities, Math and Science, Social Science and Education, and Health Sciences. The mission of the University Parallel Program aligns with the mission of Volunteer State Community College.

All courses offered by the college correspond with the mandated student learning outcomes for each general education course by the Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR). The courses taught at Volunteer State Community College are offered through four different delivery methods: traditional face-to-face, online, hybrid, and TNeCampus. The faculty of Volunteer State Community College have developed programs designed to meet the educational needs of our service area. Consistency of instruction and preparation of appropriate course materials that meet the students' needs is a challenge, however, faculty implement several learning initiatives to address these challenges. For example, increase direct assessments of University Parallel student learning outcomes, the development of a vigorous Quality Assurance Process for online learning, and the development of the Teaching & Learning Center. Additionally, the academic freedom allowed to each faculty member illustrates the commitment of establishing attainable course outcomes and allows for the implementation of best practices throughout each program's curriculum.

The curriculum of each University Parallel program promotes the mission of the college by providing innovative educational programs in the context of preparing students for successful careers and community service.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan is attached as evidence. Assessed A.S. and A.A. areas of emphasis assessment plans are also attached as evidence. Assessment plans detail the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcome for the A.A. & A.S. are evaluated in a variety of subjects annually. Each division identified faculty members who created standardized rubrics and faculty provided input regarding the creation of those rubrics. Additionally, faculty within each division have chosen an assignment or assessment to evaluate the learning outcomes. Faculty have also identified achievement targets as either "met" or "not met", respective to their content area. Assessments take place once an academic year, but each division has the liberty to choose which semester the outcomes are evaluated.

Evidence:

- ART1035 General Education SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144759
- BIOL 1010 Student Learning Outcome Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145036
- CHEM1030 General Education Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145251
- ECON2100 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144442
- ECON2200 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144504
- GEOL1060 Assessment Rubric- Lab Activity Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145115
- MATH 1530 Student Learning Outcomes Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144954
- MUS1030 General Education SLO Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144832
- SOCI1010 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144548
- University Parallel A.A. & A.S. Assessment Plan

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends.
2. Attach effectiveness documentation of each assessed area of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Attach: Academic Program Review, University Parallel Area of Emphasis Assessment Reviews

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)	
PLO 1			87.54	12.46	83.81	16.19	93.64	6.36
PLO 2			74.59	25.41	64.87	35.13		
PLO 3			67.01	32.99	62.5	37.5		
PLO 4			77.94	22.06	70.37	29.63	96.36	3.64
PLO 5			81.82	18.18	75	25	92.73	7.27
PLO 6			79.10	20.9	94.2	5.8	78	22
Course Learning Outcome 1 HIST.2010.1 Sources Students will explain the difference between primary and secondary sources.			83.84	16.16	82.03	17.97		
Course Learning Outcome 2 HIST.2010.2 Causes/consequences Students will analyze the causes and consequences of major historical events in early US history			81.96	18.04	81.36	18.64		
Course Learning Outcome 3 HIST.2010.3 Changes Students will demonstrate an understanding of the various social, economic, and political events and changes of the early US period			84.05	15.95	23.82	17.86		

PLO 1: Students will use problem solving as an application of critical thought.

PLO 2: Students will understand and apply knowledge of the foundations and practice in the scientific method of inquiry.

PLO 3: Students will understand and apply knowledge to the foundation and practice in relevant mathematical skills.

PLO 4: Students will demonstrate effective oral communication skills.

PLO 5: Students will demonstrate effective effective written communication skills.

PLO 6: Students will identify and analyze national and global societal challenges.

PLO results dropped in all categories except PLO 7. The most significant drop was in PLO 2, followed by PLO4. The significant decrease in PLO2 is due to students are weaker in science skills coming into college. Additionally, during the transition from Covid to post-Covid, we were seeing students who took more of their science courses online. We know that success went down in the online science courses compared to in-person science courses. Since then we have switched back to modalities that have more in-person components. The significant decrease in PLO4 is most likely a result of the lack of oral communication activity in students due to isolation during the pandemic. The isolation from others increased the level of social anxiety, which decreased the level of effective oral communication skills. Once students were able to return to social activities, too much time had passed in not exercising said skills and at this point, electronic communication was more commonplace than before.

Evidence:

- History Course Learning Outcomes Report
- UPR AA AS PLO_s AY20-23

- UPR AA AS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- University Parallel Learning Outcome - Courses Assessment Chart - UPR

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Analysis of top and low-performing areas of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Assessment of Strengths

The program's biggest strength lies with the faculty at the college. Their ability to adapt and innovate seems to be the driving force behind the increase in graduation rates of students in the University Parallel programs by approximately 500 students from 2020 to 2022, even with the decline of student headcount of approximately 1500 students from Fall 2018 to Fall 2021. There are numerous examples across many departments within the University Parallel program, illustrating the faculty's ability to adapt not only the course modality, but also course content delivery to reach our students' ever-changing needs. Faculty are engaged in HIPs (High Impact Practices), rigorous course review, development and re-development of model courses, annual assessment and review of course learning outcomes, course textbook revisions, and supporting students through the Learning Commons. During the academic audit timeline, the data shows that there are fewer adjunct faculty compared to full-time faculty. This means there are more hours each semester where students have access to faculty during office hours, tutoring time in the Learning Commons, and other unplanned, random interactions with faculty. An increase in student graduation rate in the University Parallel Programs could be attributed to an increase in one-on-one student interactions both inside and outside of the classroom.

3. Areas of Opportunity

In addition to faculty attendance at regional conferences for subject area two-year colleges and similar groups, we find that this is also an area of opportunity. There are several departments within the University Parallel program that would benefit from more consistent interaction with other TBR and out-of-state community colleges and 4-year schools, which would serve both as opportunities to network as well as to gather information about what is being done. This can also lead to continued innovation within our department and program.

Another area of opportunity lies with interdepartmental and cross divisional collaborations and interaction within the program. Many departments have interesting and useful initiatives and other departments may not be aware of these. We find that working on the University Parallel Academic Audit and University Parallel Review makes this clear as we find out about a variety of such initiatives through these processes. This may also be true within each department regarding how classes are taught and different activities, methodologies, and best practices.

By increasing student retention, we would also be increasing graduation rates. Focusing on faculty support of students in the classroom in both content area and study skills and critical thinking abilities may continue to increase graduation rates. Gateway courses, FYEX, and a broader adoption of HIPs, best practices, and innovations that are occurring in some areas.

Another area of opportunity is leadership structure. One of the University Parallel Academic Audit's initiatives from Spring 2023 was to provide a leadership group for the University Parallel program. The goal date for this was Spring 2024. Thus far a leadership group has not been announced. A General Education committee was created and approved in Fall 2022, so the precedent has been set for such a committee for the University Parallel. A leadership organization would go a long way towards accomplishing the area of opportunity listed above.

Evidence:

- University Parallel Academic Audit 2022
- University Parallel- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 Develop Tutorial Faculty review of the tutorial. Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1	To increase student success achievement of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during	To provide faculty with resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques to best meet the needs of the	VPAA, Deans, Department Chairs, and Faculty.	Increase of each PLO by 2.5%	Provide a round table discussion time during convocation days. Record minutes to share with	

	convocation to discuss best practices.	student population.			faculty not in attendance.	
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective oral communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #4 met outcome rate to 80% which is an increase of 9.63%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped from 77.94% in 2021 to 70.37% in 2022	Baseline of 77.94 in 2021 70.37% in 2022 of met outcome.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the development of course material in Gateway courses.	To provide all students in Gateway math courses additional resources of prerequisite material to ensure they are prepared to learn new and more complex concepts.	Dean Math and Sciences Division, Math Department Chair, and Math Faculty	Increase the PLO #3 met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (67%)	AY 2023-2024 -Build course material to make Learning Support materials available to all students -Provide material to students by Spring 2025	Baseline of 67.01% (2021) and 52.5% (2022) met the outcome.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective written communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #5 the met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (81.2%) which is an increase of 6.2%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped in 2021 from 81.2% to 75% in 2022	Baseline of the met outcome of 81.2% (2021) and 75% (2022).

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee

Faculty will present the General Education Review (GER) to the General Education Committee. The Committee will conduct a review of the UPR and GER. The committee will provide feedback for the completed review and action plan as a supportive step.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Deans should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	To increase student success achievement		During the past academic year, the college experienced a significant leadership	As the new leadership continues to settle in,	Unable to compare because no progress has

	of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during convocation to discuss best practices.		transition with the appointment of a new president. While this change brought fresh perspectives and long-term strategic vision, it also required a period of adjustment and realignment of priorities across departments. As the administration focused on assessing current practices and establishing new goals under new leadership, our effort to provide faculty with targeted resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques was temporarily paused or delayed. This transition period limited the availability of time and support needed to fully implement faculty development programs.	we anticipate renewed momentum for faculty support in the upcoming year.	been made in the initiative.
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #4 79.66% met. This is 0.34% below the goal.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the	The Math Gateway courses use a third-party learning platform	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #3 57.88% met. This is a

	development of course material in Gateway courses.	to deliver the majority of course content, including homework assignments, quizzes, and tests. The math department added the Learning Support Math material into these learning platforms in the model courses as optional assignments to ensure that the material is available to all students.			5.38% increase from 2022, but still below the goal.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #5 84.05% met. This exceeds the goal of 81.2%.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1	The tutorial video was launched in the model	None	The assignment success rate for pilot	YES

	by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Cohort B

Academic Program Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Computer Information Technology AAS & CERT

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

There is no evidence of any Three-Year Program Review or Annual Program Review conducted for the Computer Information Technology (CIT) Associate of Applied Science (A.A.S.) degree program.

There was an 'Academic Audit Self-Study Report' internally produced by the CIT department in January 2018. There was also an 'Audit Report' completed by a team of three auditors that were employed at three different Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR) Community College institutions.

The 2018 Self-Study Report addressed A.A.S CIT degree program performance within the following key 'focal areas':

- Learning Outcomes
- Curriculum and Co-Curriculum
- Teaching and Learning
- Student Learning Assessment
- Support

The 2018 Self-Study Report provided the following 'Potential Improvement Initiatives':

- Complete documentation of a standard process for CIT Quality Assurance and Continuous Improvement Process.
- Increase enrollment and completion of females in CIT degree program.
- Update all CITC course syllabi with TBR Common Curriculum Learning Outcomes
- Complete Quality Matters (QM) Course Alignment Worksheets for all CITC courses.
- Complete Quality Matters (QM) Audit for all CITC courses.

The 2018 Audit Report provided the following 'Recommendations':

- Internship program should remain in-place rather than adopting job shadowing
- Establishment of clear alignments between course sequencing and industry certification exams
- Provide more credit by exam opportunities for introductory classes.

Assessment of 2018 Self-Study and Audit Report(s):

- Completing an Annual Program Review (APR) is a first step towards building a Quality and Continuous Improvement Process. Establishing baseline assessment data that is mapped to degree program outcomes is on-going at this point.
- Distributed Education (DE) implemented Course Review Guidelines that closely align to Quality Matters (QM) Course Review Standards. ALL CITC courses within the current A.A.S. CIT degree curriculum have successfully passed through the DE Course Review process, and have an approved 'Model Course'.
- The CITC degree program does not include a required Internship course, because there were no active participating employers involved within the program. Students interested in internship/co-operative education opportunities can request for Work-Based Learning credit by consulting with the Work-Based Learning Coordinator and CIT Department Chair. Once an opportunity is established, the student then registers for the WKBL 2399 course. In addition to working within a team to complete a comprehensive project, the CIT Capstone course also provides students resume building opportunities along with

potential employer networking opportunities.

- The current A.A.S CIT degree curriculum aligns to Cisco, CompTIA, and Microsoft vendor-supported certification pathways.
- Grant-funded certification exam vouchers were used to embed CompTIA Network+ and CompTIA Linux+ exams as the final examinations within the *CITC 1302: Introduction to Networking* AND *CITC 1332: Unix/Linux Operating System* courses.

Evidence:

- 2018 Academic Audit Team Report
- 2018 CIT Academic Audit Self-Study Report

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The current mission statement for the Associate of Applied Science (A.A.S.) Computer Information Technology (CIT) degree program is defined within the [VSCC Undergraduate Catalog](#) and [CIT AAS degree program website](#) as follows:

"The Associate of Applied Science degree in Computer Information Technology prepares students for positions in the workplace through the use of various systems, applications, languages and products. The program consists of a common core of General Education and Computer Information Technology major core courses, combined with subject-specific courses designed to address skills within the concentration area. These subject-specific courses focus on those skill-sets identified by employers as essential in today's workplace and, where appropriate, will prepare students for industry-recognized certification examinations. The concentrations are designed to ensure that students have the proper experience, training, and skills to begin work in the chosen field upon successful completion of the chosen program of study."

No changes have been proposed to the CIT A.A.S., degree program's current mission statement.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The current mission statement for the Associate of Applied Science (A.A.S.) Computer Information Technology (CIT) degree program is defined within the [VSCC Undergraduate Catalog](#) and [CIT AAS degree program website](#) as follows:

"The Associate of Applied Science degree in Computer Information Technology prepares students for positions in the workplace through the use of various systems, applications, languages and products. The program consists of a common core of General Education and Computer Information Technology major core courses, combined with subject-specific courses designed to address skills within the concentration area. These subject-specific courses focus on those skill-sets identified by employers as essential in today's workplace and, where appropriate, will prepare students for industry-recognized certification examinations. The concentrations are designed to ensure that students have the proper

experience, training, and skills to begin work in the chosen field upon successful completion of the chosen program of study."

The CIT program mission aligns to VSCC's institutional mission within the following key areas:

- **Quality and innovative education programs** - Both the CIT A.A.S degree and CIT Technical Certificate credentials provide individuals with relevant skillsets required in current Information Technology (IT) entry-to-mid-level jobs. Several courses within the CIT program curriculum align to industry recognized certifications that are heavily valued in the IT workforce. These certification examinations provide a 'standard' for quality and avenue for 'stacked credentials' for students that graduate with not only a degree/certificate, but with industry-standard IT certifications.
- **Building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement** - Several members of the CIT Advisory Committee come from IT employers within VSCC's service area(s), helping to establish an active consortium (or pipeline) for potential Work-Based Learning partners for students within the CIT program. Career and Technical Education (CTE) Coordinators at surrounding school systems are also members of the CIT Advisory Committee, and help provide a clear pathway for high-school students as they pursue Dual-Enrollment and Dual-Credit opportunities within the CIT degree program.

CIT Faculty participate in high school and middle school tours and site visits, as well as facilitate student-ran organizations, such as the Cyber Security Club, who hosts cyber competitions, and speaker events, and seminars. The Technology Department and CIT programs collaborate closely with area school systems, job centers, and economic development officials in order to meet the needs of students and area employers and to secure external funds (grants) and other forms of support for this important and complex mission.

- **Promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development** - The CIT program supports VSCC goal's to promote diversity and cultural awareness by fostering an academic environment that allows students from all backgrounds to contribute and participate as part of their learning experience at the college. This environment is shaped through a combination of classroom experiences and curricular activities.
- **Prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society** - As stated on the [VSCC CIT Department website](#):

"The A.A.S. CIT degree prepares students for positions in the workplace through the use of various systems, applications, languages and products. The program consists of a common core of General Education and Computer Information Technology major core courses, combined with subject-specific courses designed to address skills within the concentration area. These subject-specific courses focus on those skill-sets identified by employers as essential in today's workplace and, where appropriate, will prepare students for industry-recognized certification examinations. The concentrations are designed to ensure that students have the proper experience, training, and skills to begin work in the chosen field upon successful completion of the chosen program of study."

- The information technology (IT) field offers an abundance of high quality entry-level and middle skills jobs paying a living wage and providing significant job security and career growth opportunities. IT is the career field most critical to our region's success in the digital, global economy. It is also a field where people with as little as a technical certificate and/or an associated industry certification can land a quality job. An associate's degree in the field, particularly if paired with an industry certification earned

in our program or soon after graduation, is a ticket to prosperity and security.

- The department also offers an Associate of Science – Tennessee Transfer Pathway (A.S. – TTP) degree in Computer Science and another in Information Systems. The A.S. degree is for students planning to transfer seamlessly to a university when they graduate. The curriculum consists of general education courses with numerous advanced math classes to prepare for upper-division university courses. The curriculum for both programs also includes two or three courses in the student's chosen major."

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

Program Outcomes for the the A.A.S. CIT degree and CIT Technical Certificate programs are defined by TBR. The outcomes to CITC/INFS/WEBT courses offered within both programs are also defined by TBR.

There are 5 "Major Core" courses defined within the A.A.S. CIT degree program:

CITC 1300 - *Beginning HTML and CSS
CITC 1301 - *Introduction to Programming and Logic
CITC 1302 - *Introduction to Networking
CITC 1303 - *Database Concepts
CITC 2190 - *Capstone Course in Computer Information

Based on review of Institutional Effectiveness (IE) Year-End Reports, and even the 2018 CIT Self-Study Audit Report, it seems that none of the "Major Core" CITC courses had been identified with measurable outcomes in alignment to the the CIT Program Outcomes, in respect to the type of assessments included in those courses. After reviewing the catalog of ALL CITC courses, a basic outcome mapping was put together that defines how each course's defined outcomes (or SLOs) are aligned to the CIT program outcomes (or PLO). The attached evidence 'CITC AAS Curriculum Mapping ' demonstrates these alignments.

Key Assessments to Help Establish Clear Evidence of Student Learning

To better establish 'clear' evidence of student learning, it has been decided to utilize (2) "key assessment" CITC courses that are offered within both the A.A.S CIT degree and CIT Technical Certificate programs. Both *CITC 1301: Introduction to Programming and Logic* and *CITC 1320: A+ Hardware and Software* were chosen due to how assessment rubric criteria defined within both courses are aligned to CIT program outcomes.

CITC 1320 Key Assessment

The key assessment identified in CITC 1320 is in the form of a comprehensive 'Team Capstone Project # 2' that aligns to CIT Program Outcomes 1, 2, 3, and 5. The assignment presents a problem statement and case scenario, and gives students a learning opportunity to work together (as a team) with the goal of upgrading a set of server computers, diagramming and connecting a simple network, and preparing a summary report. All of these deliverable require students to utilize both communication and critical-thinking skills.

CITC 1301 Key Assessment

CITC 1301 identifies 'Module 4 Programming Lab Assignment' as a "Key Assessment" that aligns to the CIT Program Outcome 4. The Module 4 Programming Assignment assesses students' knowledge of conditional logic using 'if / "else" conditional logic statements along

with a combination of logical operators and Boolean variables. The original rubric for the CITC 1301 Key Assessment is in the process of revision with a more-refined set of grading criteria, which would be better utilized for measurement of student learning.

Evidence of both CITC 1301 and CITC 1320 key assessment assignment rubrics are attached.

Key Assessment Target Measurements

Going forward into the next Academic Year, it is expected that that 80% of the students will achieve a score of 75% or higher on both CITC 1301 and CITC 1320 Key Assessments.

Evidence:

- CITC 1301 SLO Assessment Rubric
- CITC 1301 SLO Assessment Rubric_Revised
- CITC 1320 Team Capstone Project 2 Rubric
- CITC AAS Curriculum Mapping 2021-22

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

Previous Evidence of Student Learning

Based on review of previous Institutional Effectiveness (IE) Year-End Reports and the 2018 CIT Self-Study Audit Report, although there were some defined program outcomes, none of these reports seem to define a consistent instrument used to measure assessment data for TBR-defined Program Outcomes of the A.A.S. CIT degree program.

Currently, there is a CIT Exit Exam that all CIT students are required to complete before they officially graduate. The CIT Exit Exam attempts to assess students' knowledge of the five major course courses defined within the A.A.S. CIT degree program:

CITC 1300 - *Beginning HTML and CSS
CITC 1301 - *Introduction to Programming and Logic
CITC 1302 - *Introduction to Networking
CITC 1303 - *Database Concepts
CITC 2190 - *Capstone Course in Computer Information

'Appendix 3' of the 2018 CIT Self-Study Audit Report indicates key assessment questions within the CIT Exit Exam that can be used to help better measure CIT Program Outcomes. The problem with this measurement, however, is the fact that none of the CIT Program Outcomes identified in this report are derived from the TBR-defined program outcomes as indicated within the A.A.S CIT degree program. During the Fall of 2019, the CIT Exit Exam was revised with updated questions to reflect changes in the content taught within CITC core course courses, specifically CITC 1301 and CITC 1302 courses. Attached is the latest version of the CIT Exit Exam, as well as the 2019-20 and 2020-21 Exit Exam Results.

Key Assessments to Establish Clear Evidence of Student Learning

As discussed in the previous 'Curriculum Map' section, it has been determined that evidence of student learning is best assessed using rubric-based assessments within courses that are defined within both A.A.S CIT degree and CIT Technical Certificate programs. CITC 1301 and CITC 1320 are the identified key assessment courses, and both courses use rubric-based key assessment(s) that can measure student learning from a Course Learning Outcomes (CLO) perspective, and, of course, Program Learning Outcomes (PLO) perspective. The target (or

expectation) for the next upcoming Academic Year (AY) is that 80% of the students will achieve a score of 75% or higher on both key assessments.

CIT Exit Exam Review and Re-Alignment

The CIT Exit Exam can still be an effective measurement of student learning, however, "key" exam questions need to be aligned to specific CLOs, and most importantly CIT PLOs. Questions from each course should also be re-reviewed to keep consistent with content and materials taught in the Major Core courses, such as CITC 2190, which is now a 1-credit hour course that will focus on career exploration and team-and-project based learning objectives.

Evidence:

- Appendix 3 CIT Self-Study Audit Report
- CIT 1920 Exit Exam Item Analysis
- CIT 2021 Exit Exam Item Analysis
- CIT EXIT EXAM -Revised Fall 2019

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Graduate Survey Results

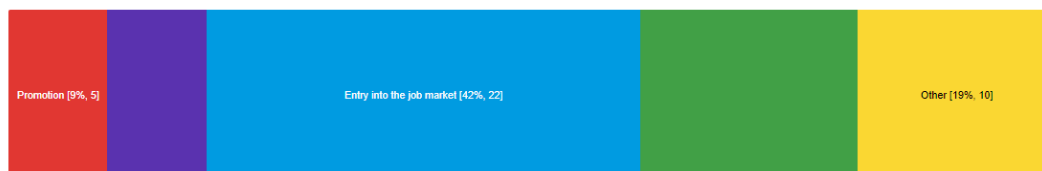
Students that graduated from the A.A.S. CIT Degree program completed a Graduate Survey during 2020 and 2021.

Based on the data taken from both surveys, the largest percentage of CIT graduates that completed the surveys felt that the A.A.S CIT degree impacted their life by helping them gain "entry into the job market" (42% in 2020, and 36% in 2021). Graduating students also felt that the A.A.S. degree helped "improved job mobility opportunities", and "salary increase".

2020 Graduate Survey Results (Areas of Impact)

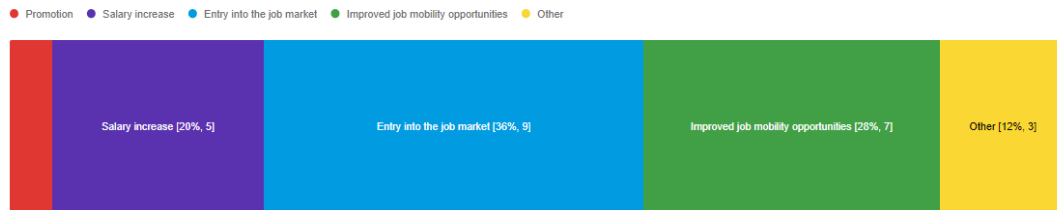
What impact(s) did the Computer Information Technology A.A.S. have for you? Mark all that apply.

● Promotion ● Salary increase ● Entry into the job market ● Improved job mobility opportunities ● Other



2021 Graduate Survey Results (Areas of Impact)

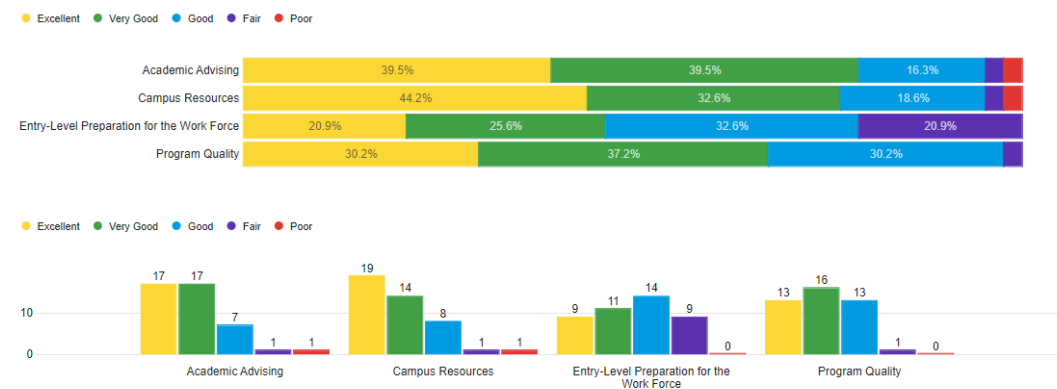
What impact(s) did the Computer Information Technology A.A.S. have for you? Mark all that apply.



When looking at the quality of the degree program itself, both 2020 and 2021 survey data indicated that the majority of CIT graduates that completed the survey rated the "Program Quality" of the CIT degree program as "Very Good" (37.2% in 2020 and 31.6% in 2021). The majority of CIT graduates that completed the survey also felt that the A.A.S. CIT degree program provided them with an "Entry-Level Preparation for the Work Force", as this particular was rated "Good" (32.6% in 2020 and 36.8% in 2021);

2020 Graduate Survey Results ("Program Quality" and "Entry-Level Preparation for the Work Force")

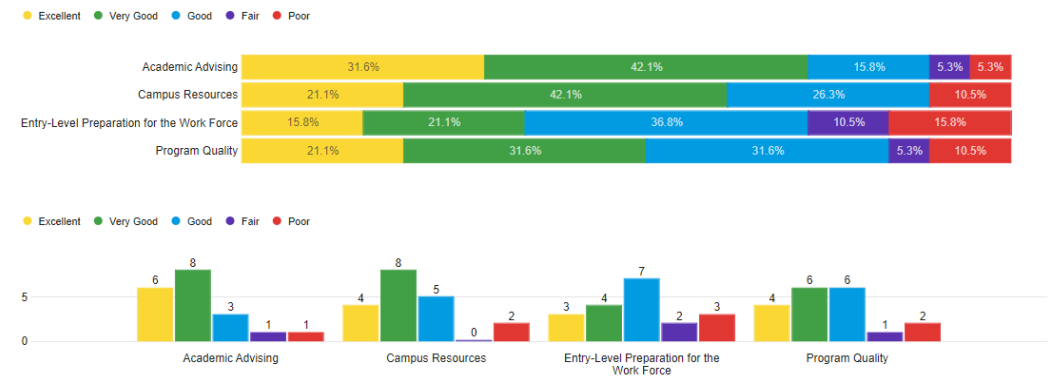
Rate the following OVERALL areas:



Field	Min	Max	Mean	Standard Deviation	Variance	Responses	Sum
Academic Advising	1.00	5.00	4.12	0.92	0.85	43	177.00
Campus Resources	1.00	5.00	4.14	0.95	0.91	43	178.00
Entry-Level Preparation for the Work Force	2.00	5.00	3.47	1.04	1.09	43	149.00
Program Quality	2.00	5.00	3.95	0.83	0.70	43	170.00

2021 Graduate Survey Results ("Program Quality" and "Entry-Level Preparation for the Work Force")

Rate the following OVERALL areas:



Field	Min	Max	Mean	Standard Deviation	Variance	Responses	Sum
Academic Advising	1.00	5.00	3.89	1.07	1.15	19	74.00
Campus Resources	1.00	5.00	3.63	1.13	1.29	19	69.00
Entry-Level Preparation for the Work Force	1.00	5.00	3.11	1.25	1.57	19	59.00
Program Quality	1.00	5.00	3.47	1.19	1.41	19	66.00

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

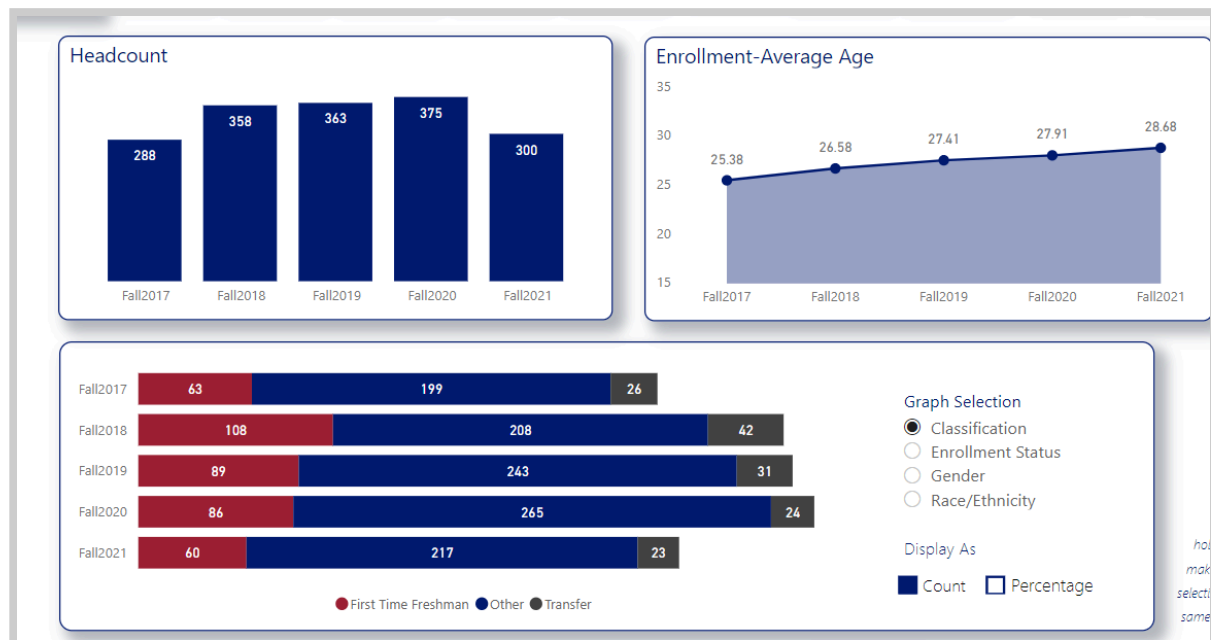
Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

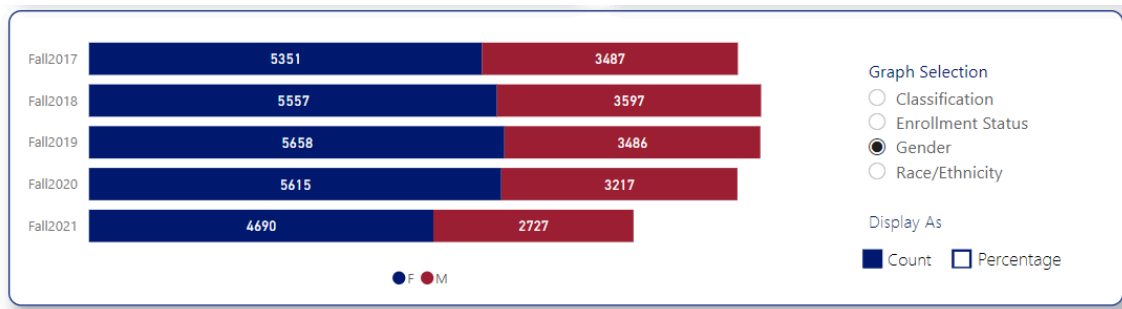
The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

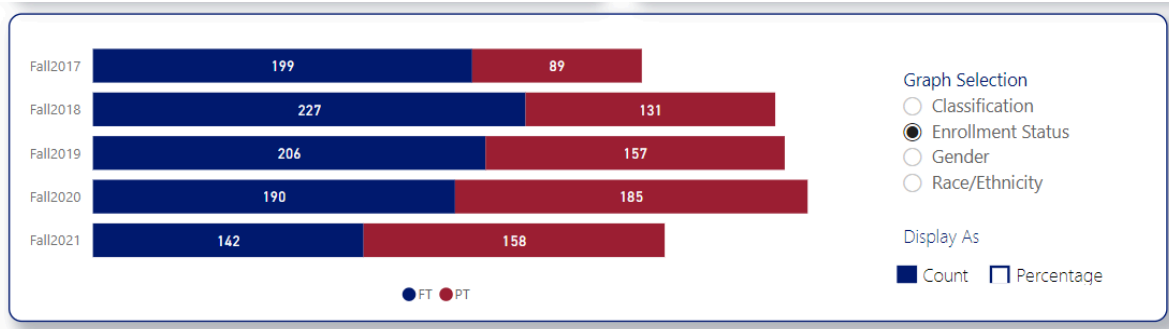
Enrollment By Count: Down 20% from Fall 2020; Up only slightly from Fall 2017; FTF declining sharply; Avg. age rising steadily (now at 29)



Enrollment by Gender for the college overall - 37% male

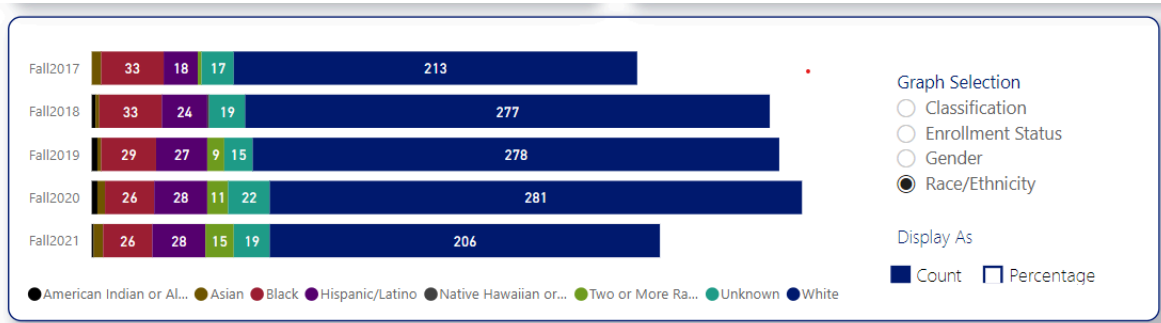


Enrollment by Classification: 69% of CIT AAS students attended FT in Fall 2017 -- down by almost a third to 47% in Fall 2021

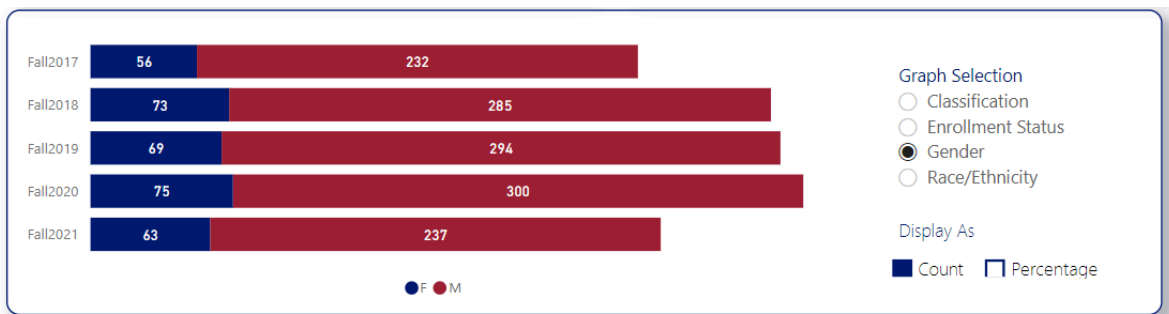


Enrollment by Age:

Enrollment by Race/Ethnicity: White students make up 69% of CIT AAS enrollment; Students of color in CIT AAS meet/exceed their representation levels in the overall VSCC population

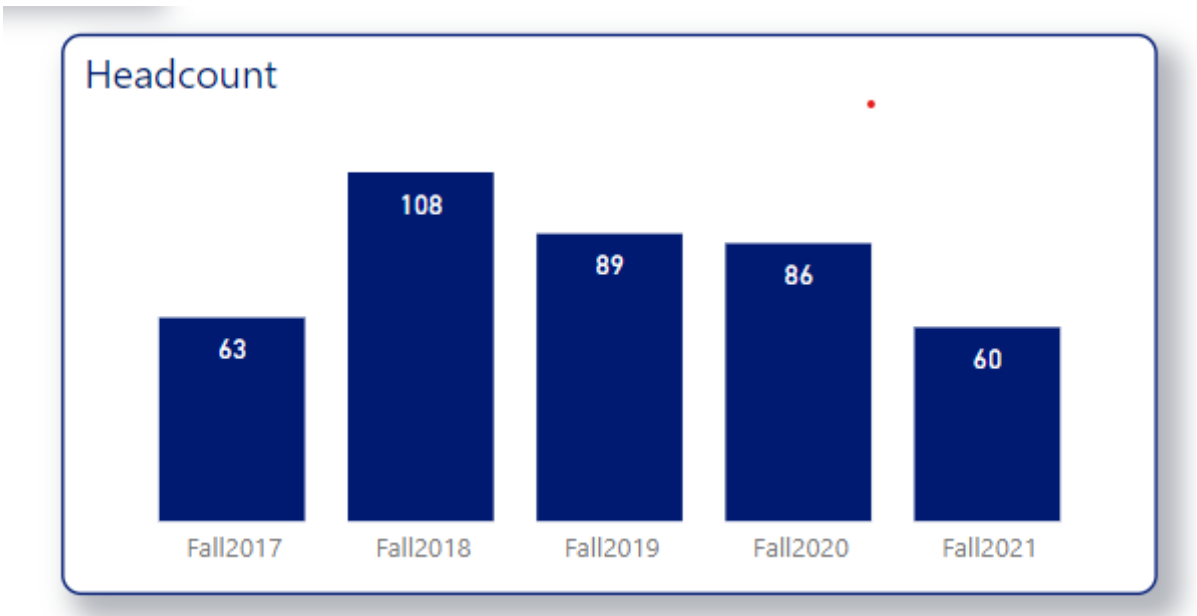


Enrollment by Gender for CIT AAS: 79% Male



First Time Freshmen in CIT AAS: The number of FTF entering the CIT AAS programs has dropped 44% since the peak in Fall 2018. Vol State and other TBR CCs saw a large, brief spike in FTF enrollments in Fall

2018. CIT AAS and other STEM programs that attract mostly male students have been particularly hard hit by the Covid pandemic and the effects of rising wages in plentiful unskilled jobs.



Persistence, Retention, and 3-Year Graduation Rate for CIT AAS

 COVID

Filters on this page are based on initial semester enrollment information.

Fall to Spring Persistence

- 76.0%
Fall 2016 to Spring 2017
- 72.5%
Fall 2017 to Spring 2018
- 67.5%
Fall 2018 to Spring 2019
- 72.0%
Fall 2019 to Spring 2020
- 66.6%
Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Fall to Fall Retention

- 54.3%
Fall 2016 to Fall 2017
- 58.3%
Fall 2017 to Fall 2018
- 48.1%
Fall 2018 to Fall 2019
- 56.3%
Fall 2019 to Fall 2020
- 47.4%
Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

3yr Graduation Rate*

- 28.4%
Fall 2016 Freshman Cohort
- 19.0%
Fall 2017 Freshman Cohort
- 19.4%
Fall 2018 Freshman Cohort

*Graduation Rates cannot be filtered by Classification

Graduation Numbers for CIT AAS: Up 111% since AY16-17; up 49% vs AY18-19

Degree	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Associate of Applied Science	36	58	51	54	76
Total	36	58	51	54	76

Concentrations	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Administration and Management	1	4	2	4	8
Cyber Defense	6	11	18	21	35
Networking	13	18	12	7	10
Programming	16	23	16	19	21
Systems Analyst		2	3	3	2

Majors	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Administrative Prof Technology	6				
Advanced EMT	53	45	58	86	48
Allied Health Career	1		1		
Business	45	49	47	61	80
Coding Reimbursement	15		1		
Computer Information Tech	36	58	51	54	76
Criminal Justice			9	33	57
Criminal Justice Law Enfrcemnt	60	49	37	23	1
Dental Assistant	16	12	19	14	12
Diagnostic Medical Sonography	10	16	16	15	13
Early Childhood Education	22	22	14	25	39
Emergency Medical Technician	79	103	106	135	95
Entertainment Media Production	10	12	22	12	18
Fire Science	4	9	36	42	59
Fire Science Technology	29	12	1	2	
General Business Admin	10	1	2		
General Technology					

Computer & Information Sciences Associate Degrees Awarded by Institution								
Institution	2014-15	2015-16	2016-17	2017-18	2018-19	2019-20	2020-21	2021 CIT AAS degrees awarded as % of Institution's 2020-2021 Associate's Degrees
Pellissippi State CC	183	142	106	205	200	190	167	7.6
Nashville State CC	66	53	43	46	33	76	74	6.1
Jackson State CC	15	21	19	30	20	35	41	5.5
Volunteer State CC	14	25	57	58	51	53	76	4.4
Northeast State CC	32	34	32	43	37	55	51	3.5
Columbia State CC	37	15	10	16	21	19	32	3.1
Cleveland State CC	13	14	15	10	25	32	32	2.8
Southwest Tennessee CC	40	36	44	57	36	22	29	2.6
Dyersburg State CC	12	8	5	7	7	9	16	2.3
Roane State CC	2	3	8	5	8	9	16	1.4
Chattanooga State CC	27	33	20	24	26	29	18	1.2
Motlow State CC	1	2	1	5	0	10	13	1
Walters State CC	19	20	15	26	29	15	12	0.9

*<https://www.tbr.edu/policy-strategy/data-and-research>

Recruitment:

- Many more Tennessee high schools are now adding CIT CTE courses to their curriculum - bodes well for an upturn in enrollment by traditional, college age students if we can promote access to on ground, cohort-like learning opportunities
- We believe scheduling our on ground sections more intentionally and promoting cohort-like learning opportunities with optional "bootcamp-like" labs for completing homework will help us attract more students in the 23-and-under age category and help inspire them to attend full-time and persist and succeed at higher rates.
- The Governor's GIVE Grant I was supposed to fund the Greater Nashville Technology Council to do lots of things to promote IT careers and associated education pathways. Covid prevented them from executing many of those. We expect they will be able to execute them in Spring and Fall 2022. We believe that may benefit (slightly) our efforts to reverse the current trend of declining enrollments.

Enrollment

- Headcount declining sharply in last two years -- Covid plus males foregoing college at even higher rates than girls and CIT AAS and other STEM fields that attract mostly male student populations are being particularly hard hit
- Demographics swinging decidedly toward older students attending in part-time status

Retention

- Retention has been near the overall rate for the college. Student success is a challenge in these rigorous programs with only 55% of all students classified as "college ready." To increase our contributions to the region's tech workforce, the CIT AAS program not only needs to attract more students but also needs to attract a larger number of better qualified students. To do so, the college will have to provide the Technology Department/Division/Programs the program management and promotion capacity to work with others to promote interest in the profession, publicize our program and their ROI, and deliver them innovatively.

Graduation

- Graduation numbers for the CIT AAS programs have skyrocketed. This was accomplished by improving teaching and making courses and degrees more accessible by developing a quality, "model course" for every course in the curriculum, thereby making the degrees highly accessible online. The launch of the Tennessee Re-Connect program in 2018 brought many more adult students into this and many other Vol State programs. That, too, has influenced the number of students coming out of the programs recently.
- The final table inserted above shows that Vol State produced the second most CIT AAS degrees of any TBR community college in AY2020-2021. Vol State CIT AAS programs rank fourth among TBR CCs for CIT AAS degrees awarded as a percentage of total Associate's degrees awarded from each institution (4.4% in AY2020-2021).

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

Previously summarized demands for entry- and middle-skills tech employees is rising both in the greater Nashville area and around Cookeville in the eastern side of our service area. The workforce gap is growing rapidly, nationally and locally, in this critical, strategic field. The program requires FT CIT faculty to develop, manage, continually update, and teach the robust portfolio of 31 courses and three concentrations and a technical certificate that we offer, advise and support 400 students (in CIT and Computer Science AS - TTP programs), build strategic relationships with employers and community partners, team with and engage feeder school systems and their students, and satisfy routine college tasks of academic administration and shared governance. The college also needs FT CIT faculty to teach on ground, day-time courses in order to attract more traditional students and give them the best chance of success and completion. At present, the program has 11 FT faculty, 1 of whom is in a temporary, grant-funded position. Four have course releases -- the department chair (with a two-course release); a faculty member managing our grants; a Distance Education fellow supporting the college's development of model courses; and a FT faculty member in a temporary, grant-funded position in the UC - tasked to support student outreach and recruitment to help boost the visibility of our programs there. The resulting teaching capacity associated with each concentration or cluster of courses and campus location are listed, below:

- 2.8 FT Faculty Specializing in Programming - all at the Gallatin campus (one serves as our DE fellow)
 - Programming concentration has our highest enrollment and has the highest number of concentration-unique courses in that pathway (8)
 - All three transfer Computer Science courses in the Comp Sci AS - TTP program are taught by one of these faculty members
 - Computer Science enrollments and retention rates have been rising significantly in recent years
- 1.8 FT Faculty Specializing in Cyber Defense - both at the Gallatin campus

- One of these faculty members has a one course release this AY to oversee/lead our participation in the GIVE Grant (ends Dec 2022).
- 4.2 FT Faculty that teach Networking and other key, high-demand intro courses (A+ Hardware and Software)
 - The department chair and temporary, and the two FT CIT instructors in Livingston (one is temporary, grant funded) are among them
- 1 FT Faculty member in Gallatin who is a CIT generalist, managing our INFS 1010 course (required by every Business and Technology student in every program, ~1,400 students), Spreadsheet Applications, Project Management, and Introduction to Database Concepts courses.

Other notable observations include:

- The 31 courses required for our three CIT AAS concentrations and Computer Science AS - TTP program and 11 FT faculty (one temporary) produces an average course management/update/development/refresh workload of ~3 courses for every FT CIT faculty member. Because the technologies to which these courses are aligned is constantly changing and industry certifications to which these courses are aligned is constantly changing, course development and course management responsibilities for CIT courses are quite significant.
- The percentage of CIT program sections taught by adjunct faculty has been declining the last two years as enrollments in CIT programs and courses began declining in 2019. The college's Fall 2019 decision to remove/drop "Digital Literacy" from core gen ed graduation requirements (which had required all students to take INFS 1010 or test out of it) also reduced the department's dependence on adjunct faculty. We expect department initiatives will stop the enrollment decline in coming academic years and with sufficient resources for outreach, recruiting, and promotion, we expect enrollments to begin rising in response to more area high schools offering CIT CTE courses and pandemic infection rates beginning to wane.
- The department is particularly thin in FT faculty qualified to teach transfer courses required for the Computer Science program which is offered by this same department. Only three of our FT faculty meet SACS qualifications for teaching transfer courses. One of them is not a Programming instructor and those three courses are best taught by a faculty member specializing in Programming. The second of the three FT instructors qualified to teach the transfer courses has never done so and already carries an average course prep load of ~4 courses each semester. This highlights the challenge of attracting and retaining professionals with a master's degree in a qualifying field is a threat to these programs and our ability to deliver both our CIT AAS program and its three concentrations as well as the Computer Science AS - TTP program.
 - The program faces a similar threat/challenge with the CIT AAS - Networking concentration, where a cluster of three courses aligned with the Cisco Certified Network Administrator (CCNA) certification are the heart of the program. Only one of our FT faculty members is presently certified to teach these three courses. The FT faculty member in the temporary, grant-funded position is beginning the training required to be certified to teach those courses. He should be qualified to teach the first one by Fall 2022 and qualified to teach all three by Spring 2023. We also hope to have one of our new FT CIT faculty members in Gallatin is now beginning to take these courses in Spring 2022 with the same, desired certification timetable. These challenges are representative of the significant professional development workload required of FT CIT faculty members in this department.
- Program faculty have heavier average course prep workloads than found in many departments of the college.
- With courses aligned to key industry certifications, some faculty have to complete training required by industry or proprietary certification bodies just to teach those courses. Industry standards, best practices, and technologies are constantly evolving in IT, requiring CIT faculty to invest significant effort in training and professional development related to their field every year. Despite this, their participation rates in Teaching and Learning Center offerings relative to the department's FT faculty numbers is very comparable to that of the college, overall.
- Serving the CIT workforce development needs of the Upper Cumberland region is a significant strategic challenge for this program.
 - Putnam County (Cookeville) has a moderate population density but surrounding counties are quite rural and sparsely populated
 - Post-secondary attainment levels outside of Putnam County are quite low and some counties in the region are classified as at risk
 - Because Tennessee Tech University has strong Computer Science/Engineering programs and a low cost of living, Cookeville has attracted tech companies looking to capitalize on the strong supply of IT/Computer grads with Bachelor's degree credentials and above. However, those employers are reporting enormous struggles finding and hiring entry-level and middle skills IT technicians. They

- are looking to us to do that for them and we do not have sufficient enrollments to do so and produce very, very few CIT graduates from that part of our service area.
- Compounding the challenge of a low population density in the region, TCAT Livingston and Vol State have based overlapping/competing CIT offerings at facilities two minutes apart in Livingston, a 30-minute drive from the more densely-populated sector of the region, Cookeville, where on ground CIT offerings would have a much better chance to generate much better enrollments.
- With insufficient enrollments for on ground sections to make, FT CIT faculty assigned there have been teaching online sections. An inability to provide reliable access to on ground CIT courses is likely an additional barrier to growing CIT AAS enrollments there and meeting CIT workforce needs of the region.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

Narrative:

In 2019 and 2020, CIT AAS faculty worked with their chair and the dean to review enrollment and persistence numbers and decided to right-size the portfolio of concentrations, reducing them from five down to three by consolidating three very similar, lower-enrollment concentrations into one (Networking). The portfolio of concentrations has now stabilized at three. Faculty also reviewed and redefined the curriculum for each concentration to improve our alignment with key industry certifications most sought after by employers. They not only defined the curriculum for each concentration but worked to optimize the sequencing of courses to maximize the number of course requirements common across the three concentrations and where they fall in the pathway in order to concentrate demand for each course across the portfolio of programs. The goal was to expand students' modality, location, and time choices by doing so. We also began applying the best practice of prescriptive scheduling, offering required courses in either Fall or Spring semester but not both. This, too, helps concentrate enrollment demand.

We also began offering at least one section of all first-year CIT AAS courses every summer to provide a "safety net"/buffer for any CIT AAS students that had to drop or failed a first-year course. This also helps Part-Time (PT) students progress through the program more expeditiously and allows students who start the program in a spring semester complete all first year CIT course requirements before Fall semester.

In Fall 2021, we introduced a new imbedded Technical Certificate in Computer Information Technology (CIT). The 18-credit hour, intermediate post-secondary credential can be earned in two semesters of either FT or PT study. The courses are imbedded in all three concentrations.

Since many of our students attend part-time, we worked hard to develop a sequencing map for part-time students. This was particularly challenging given the highly clustered nature of the curriculum. However, after many hours of effort, it was developed and shared with faculty and supporting FT advisors. We have attached a copy of that file, as well.

Classroom access in the Mattox Building in Gallatin is sufficient for current and projected enrollments. With the shift to more prescriptive scheduling, the department is becoming more intentional about how on ground sections are scheduled. Beginning Fall 2022, the program will schedule for and promote "bootcamp-like" learning/tutoring opportunities in the 8:00 - 9:25 window and 12:45 - 2:10 window. We hope to promote these aggressively, particularly to new First Time Freshmen as a means of inspiring more to attend FT and to register for on ground sections. There is sufficient classroom capacity at the Livingston campus to offer any on ground course that enrollment might allow. Unless Robertson County Schools can somehow market IT careers sufficiently to grow significant interest in dual enrollment offerings at the Springfield campus, we do not think demand for on ground sections there will be sufficient to offer on any ground sections there even in the mid-term.

With the Spring 2021 schedule, we began "pairing" on ground sections of CIT classes at the Livingston campus with a synchronous, "Zoom" online section in the same time slot. Our goal is to have the Livingston-based CIT instructor teach students registered for the on ground section and those registered for the Zoom session in the same time slot, simultaneously. By "pairing" these sections, we hope to reach enrollments sufficient for the on

ground sections to "make." Such creative scheduling practices will be necessary to enable on ground offerings of CIT courses in the Upper Cumberland.

Evidence:

- CIT AAS Curriculum - Fall 2021
- Pathways for Part-Time CIT AAS Students

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

With a portfolio of 31 courses and only 11 FT faculty to deliver them at two sites, Gallatin and Livingston (attempted), faculty in the department have heavy course development/refresh, course prep, and professional development loads. This leaves little capacity to offer, promote, and manage co-curriculum programs. However, with the curriculum in these young programs (first launched in 2016) now maturing and stabilizing a bit and model courses now developed and certified for every offering, our co-curricular efforts are expanding. Today, these include:

- A Cyber Defense Club
- An annual forum each fall in conjunction with Cyber Security Day
- A "Capture the Flag" cyber defense competition in AY2020-2021

GOING FORWARD:

Program faculty aspire to participate in SkillsUSA competitions in the future, potentially as early as Spring 2022.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from creditable industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

INDUSTRY TRENDS:

- Exploding Workforce Requirements/Expanding Workforce Gap: Economic Modeling (Emsi) projects that middle-skills tech jobs and IT technician positions for which our programs prepare students will increase 14% this decade. The Tennessee LEAP report listed IT and computer science jobs as one of the top six career clusters in their workforce development requirements report. Economic development leaders at the state, in Nashville, Gallatin, and Cookeville have all stated that tech sector employers are their number one targets for industry recruitment due to the quality of jobs they offer, the smaller facility footprint such employers provide, and the prestige they bring to our region. These jobs and associated employers pay higher wage rates with smaller industrial footprints, making them top targets for economic development agencies seeking to boost per capita income and the quality of jobs in their community. Nashville and its suburbs are becoming internationally recognized as a Tech Hub, drawing more and more tech employers to the region. Companies announcing major moves and/or expansions in or near our service area include NTT Data, Amazon, Google, Facebook/Meta, Oracle, Dell, and SAIC.
- Digitization and Automation of the Global Economy: The modern, digital economy is greatly expanding both the number of jobs that require formal IT training and the percentage of those jobs as a total portion of the economy. The large tech workforce requirements of newcomers will be in addition to the rising number of tech workers required by employers already present, both in and out of the tech sector. Employers in every sector are ramping up the pace of their digitization and automation efforts in response

to the labor shortage that will not go away any time soon. Education institutions in the region will have to prioritize Computer Science and CIT programs if they hope to come anywhere close to satisfying the workforce requirements of the region. At their Dec 2021 meeting, Vol State CIT Advisory Committee members expressed strong praise for the design of Vol State CIT programs as well as strong concern about the number of graduates coming out of the state's education institutions and the growing workforce gap in this field.

- Path to Prosperity: The Computer Information Technology field provides job opportunities and strong earning power to entry- and middle-skills tech professionals with as little as an Associate's degree or even a technical certificate. Wage and salary growth in this field is likely to continue soaring in the years ahead as the supply of such professionals and the demand for such workers grow farther and farther apart. This field is an ideal place for community colleges to lift students from less advantaged backgrounds and their families into economic prosperity and security.
- Employers' Desire/Preference for Industry Certifications: Employers in the tech sector increasingly look for/prefer applicants with industry certifications that validate their skills proficiency level. There are a soaring number of entry-level and middle skills IT jobs that provide quality work and a living wage. However, many employers look to industry certifications as proof of an applicant's proficiency level and capabilities. To prepare Vol State students to compete for and excel in the *better* middle-skills, tech jobs, we will need to boost students' commitment levels, academic aspirations, and understanding of the jobs marketplace and market value of various credentials and skill sets.
- Competing Education and Training Programs: Because of the large and growing workforce gap, more and more non-traditional and proprietary training programs are popping up in IT -- from those offered by the larger tech companies themselves (Google, Amazon, Cisco...) to those provided by non-profit agencies such as Nashville Software School. The ever increasing number of providers and product/program variations (CompTIA networking certification vice Google vice Cisco...) actually threatens to fragment demand and undermine the viability and quality of traditional providers by fragmenting the relatively small number of students who elect to pursue an education/training program in IT and other STEM fields. With so many new, market entrants emerging every day, organizations stretching their own product/program lines too long and thin may cannibalize their own share of the market and threaten the viability of some of their own core programs. Community colleges will need to make very good, strategic decisions and execute them well in order for their credit- and degree-bearing programs in this field to survive and thrive in this highly competitive, increasingly crowded market. They have an important role to play but they must do so wisely and invest in appropriately for these programs to survive and succeed.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Narrative:

EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITIES FORECAST:

Producing a sufficient supply of IT-qualified workers is seen as a key to the economic growth strategies of mid-state communities. Nashville, Gallatin and Putnam County, in particular, are prioritizing recruitment of technology-based employers. Those employers report finding entry- and middle-skills CIT workers particularly challenging. We believe our CIT AAS programs are strategically important to the economic health and future strength of our service area since greater Metropolitan Nashville and the Upper Cumberland are becoming major centers for IT employment. Facebook's recent decision to put a data center in Gallatin and SAIC's large investment in Cookeville are just a few examples of the rich employment opportunities in this field.

A 2019 article in the *Nashville Business Journal* quoted a study by *RentCafe* ranking Nashville as the third fastest growing tech region in the US with a 22.7% increase in tech jobs during the preceding three years. In their 2018 LEAP Occupational Analysis, the Center for Economic Research in Tennessee (CERT) listed IT as one of the six occupations with the highest employer demand. The same report documented that there were 46,099 tech job postings in the preceding year, more than 12 times the number of college degrees awarded in the field in the same time frame. MTSU's, "State of Middle Tennessee Tech 2018 Workforce Report" predicted a 16% growth rate for IT jobs for the 2017-2022 time frame.

IT integration services giant, SAIC, has a major business unit in Cookeville and they have reported significant challenges finding personnel to fill their entry- and middle-skills IT positions in the Upper Cumberland. Sumner County economic development officials have told Vol State leaders that IT and tech employers are the number one target for their employer recruitment/economic development efforts. They believe the region's success landing Facebook has positioned the region to land more such tech-based employers but indicate the region's ability to produce more IT-qualified workers is the most important decision criteria for targeted companies.

According to 2020 data from www.onetonline.org, professionals in this job category, SOC code 15-1232, Computer User Support Specialist earning at the 25th percentile make annual salaries of \$36,150 in our service area. Those at the median earn \$45,170. A sample of job titles included Help Desk Technician, Desktop Support Specialist, Technical Support Specialist and IT Technician. Jobs in this cluster are particularly appropriate for graduates of community colleges, as 51.4% of all personnel in these roles have reported educational attainment of an associate's degree or less (nationally). The Emsi report rated job posting demand in our service area as **High**. An Emsi Q1 2021 Data Set report for the SOC code 15-1232, Computer User Support Specialists shows that jobs in this field are projected to grow 14.3% in our service area for the period of 2020-2030.

TRANSFER OPPORTUNITIES/FORECASTS:

Bachelor's degree-awarding institutions are accepting more and more CTE program credits into degree completion programs. Additionally, Western Kentucky University accepts all *courses in the Vol State CIT AAS program for their Bachelor's Degree in Cyber Defense.

Both Tennessee Tech and Middle Tennessee State University offer bachelor's degree programs in professional studies that will accept all or most credits earned in Vol State CIT AAS programs. This enables students who "flip the curriculum" and take tech education courses at the front of their college journey to earn a bachelor's degree for a ticket to middle management and beyond.

The number of non-traditional, proprietary IT training programs is exploding, providing CIT AAS graduates opportunities to continue their professional development and broaden their credentials and expand their earning power.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS:

This report provides valuable insights into the performance of this programs, the perspective with which we should view it, and its potential to make invaluable contributions, going forward, to the interests and needs of area students and employers.

PERFORMANCE - WHAT WENT RIGHT: Several very positive trends were documented in this report, including:

- Completion: CIT AAS degrees awarded went up 44% in AY2020-2021
 - Vol State was #2 of 13 among TBR community colleges in CIT AAS degrees awarded in AY2020-2021
 - CIT AAS degrees accounted for more than 4% of associates degrees awarded by the college in AY2020-2021
- Access:
 - FT faculty developed new model courses for about a third of their 31-course portfolio in just two years
 - Today, every course is available online, greatly benefitting the working adults that comprise >50% of the students

- Secured Perkins Grant funding for a temporary, FT CIT instructor to double FT CIT instructors and capacity for on ground instruction in the Upper Cumberland
 - This new faculty member also has course releases to support program promotion and student recruitment
- Curriculum: Faculty made many wise, strategic decisions in the last two years
 - Right-sized and reshaped the portfolio of CIT AAS programs, consolidating three very similar, loosely structured concentrations into one -- yielding a portfolio of three CIT AAS concentrations much more appropriate for the enrollment levels possible in the region and the interests of area students and employers.
 - Created a new, 18-credit hour, imbedded CIT Technical Certificate that can be earned in just two semesters of part-time study.
 - Redesigned the curriculum to align it with industry certifications and skills employers seek in entry- and middle-skills IT programmers and technicians. Students in the Networking and Cyber Defense programs now take courses that align with nine sought after industry certifications
- Facilities:
 - College leaders submitted a proposal for a major, capital improvement project to renovate and update the Mattox Building. If approved, this would greatly enhance the learning environment and aesthetics of our on ground instructional location.

PERSPECTIVE - WHAT WENT WRONG AND FACTORS AFFECTING IT:

- Even as degrees awarded have been sharply rising and programs have been rapidly maturing, enrollments of First Time Freshmen have been declining at rates even faster than that of the college overall.
 - Historically, males make up ~80% of CIT AAS enrollments and male high school graduates have been foregoing/delaying post-secondary education at significantly higher rates than female students in the Covid era.
 - With the large and growing workforce gap with entry- and middle-skills IT workers, more and more competing providers are offering IT training programs. This is likely fragmenting enrollment more than it increases it, making it hard for legacy programs to achieve enrollment levels needed to maintain healthy, quality programs and provide them in the range of modalities and location sites needed to serve diverse students with diverse learning preferences and needs.
 - Competition to attract and serve working adults looking to upskill or make a career change is most intense and increasing most rapidly. These students currently make up more than 50 of CIT AAS enrollment.
 - The increasingly competitive higher education and training marketplace is perhaps most crowded and most competitive in the IT arena.
 - To make these programs successful and contribute anywhere near the number and quality of IT workers we should for the region, the college will have to make really good strategy decisions that require deep analysis of intended and unintended consequences of each action and invest more resources to enable market analysis, program adaptation and marketing, partnership development (with feeder school systems and employers), grant writing to secure non-traditional resources, student engagement, and career transition/job placement support.
 - Area CTE directors and employers report that today's high school students, their families, and secondary teachers have little understanding of post-secondary career (CTE) programs in IT or the associated careers, professional duties, and earning power of these credentials and associated industry certifications. Students and families who do understand it generally have higher education attainment levels and higher post-secondary aspirations and resources. Most of those students choosing to pursue a STEM major do so at a regional or national university.
 - These challenges make it particularly hard to recruit, retain, and graduate a significant number of "traditional" students from community college and TCAT CIT programs. Yet, this is the subset of the potential CIT student population where community colleges have some potential strategic advantage in the marketplace.
 - Location: The decision years ago to offer CIT AAS courses at the Livingston campus (30 minutes from the population center of the region and largest concentration of students with Tech/IT interest, Cookeville and two minutes from another TBR institution offering directly competing programs) has hurt CIT AAS enrollments in the UC, despite the sizeable number of tech employers and tech jobs in that region. It remains to be seen whether recent grant-funded interventions and a forthcoming articulation agreement with TCAT Livingston will be sufficient to overcome the location challenge.
- Learning:
 - Like the CIT AAS itself, course and program learning assessment instruments are very young and maturing and require additional attention in coming months and years.

- Less than 10% of students taking industry certifications imbedded in Fall 2021 courses (with grant dollars) earned those certifications. Most scored at levels below that required for certification. Score distribution needs to be further evaluated. Faculty and leaders should reflect on feasible changes that could boost pass rates.
 - Unlike selective admissions and licensing-based programs such as Nursing and Health Science, passing these exams is not a standard of success/quality for community college IT programs. However, scores on these nationally normed, industry-created exams does provide an important reference point. We expect these numbers to rise significantly over time if we get resources to engage students earlier to attract more who are better qualified and influence their academic aspirations and life decisions that significantly affect their academic success.

POTENTIAL - ANALYSIS AND RECOMMENDATIONS: Though recent trends in CIT AAS enrollments and declining admissions of new first time freshmen will surely reverse rising completion rates in the near-term, with sufficient prioritization, sound strategies, and sufficient staff capacity added and logically deployed for program promotion and program management, the CIT AAS program could make enormous contributions to the college's workforce contribution in this vital field, the continued economic growth of the region, and the strategic interests of the college. Evidence supporting this conclusion includes:

1. The portfolio of CIT AAS concentrations is now logically sized and shaped and well suited to meet the needs of all our stakeholders.
 - Though it will require constant reevaluation and refinement in response to never-ending technology changes and marketplace developments, our program/product offerings are well positioned for the near-term.
2. The Technology Department now has a strong cadre of full-time faculty with IT knowledge levels and specializations that align very well with the programs/concentrations we are providing and enrollment patterns across them.
 - The Department now has two FT CIT faculty in the Upper Cumberland (one temporary, grant-funded), the minimum number needed to have any chance at developing a viable enrollments and on ground access to two of the three CIT AAS concentrations.
3. Sumner County Schools, Wilson County Schools, and Putnam County Schools have greatly expanded the computer science and CIT courses they teach in their high schools (college prep and CTE) as well as the number of high schools where they offer them. Thus, many more secondary school students are developing an aptitude and stronger interest in IT-related careers.
 - These courses at nearby high schools also provide a channel for engaging prospective CIT AAS students earlier and more impactfully to attract more traditional students, attract more better qualified traditional students, and influence the decisions they make that affect their potential for post-secondary success.
4. Our state government, federal agencies, corporations, and non-profits are all very concerned about and emphasizing and investing in support of career education programs - particularly those in strategically-critical fields like IT.
 - Most of the investments are in the form of grant monies fenced for STEM education fields (such as IT and computer science) and for career programs (such as CIT AAS). However, while these funding opportunities are significant, rising and likely to continue doing so, the Business and Technology Division needs more administrative capacity to pursue, capture, and manage these resources and meet other, program promotion and program management missions. Failure to make these investments not only misses out on valuable, non-traditional resources needed for our programs to thrive, it defers those funds to other providers with whom we compete for enrollments. It is not capture these dollars and benefit or maintain status quo. It is capture these dollars and benefit or lose competitive advantage and strategic opportunity to others and have our own programs decline.
5. We have recently added numerous members to our CIT Advisory Committee from upper-management and executive levels of larger, tech companies and tech-dependent employers, along side CTE leaders from area school systems, and regional economic development officials.
 - This provides us the connections and relationships with which we could strengthen pathway alignments, promotional teamwork, and employer investments (scalable, program-compatible work-based learning; post-program pipelines to employment; and financial).
 - Though other Vol State units foster and support relationships with schools, employers, and economic development agencies, to turn relationships with these potential partners into strong, synergistic teamwork requires significant, division- and program-level engagement for which we are not currently resourced.
6. We have developed and socialized a viable plan for a 12-month "*FastPath*" to a CIT AAS degree.

- Students most interested in career programs prefer shorter paths to strong earning power and a rewarding career. More and more providers are marketing micro-credentials and a fast path to a job. To attract more and better qualified students into the CIT AAS program, we must develop, make viable, and market shorter pathways to this credential.
 - Earning credit for as few as two, first-year CIT AAS courses while in high school would position new FTF to complete the CIT AAS degree (and sit for associated industry certification exams) just 15 months after their high school graduation. Completing two CIT AAS courses and three or more gen ed courses in high school would position them to earn their CIT AAS degree only 12 months after graduating high school. Making this a reality and assertively marketing it could attract many more students into this program and many more, better qualified students into it. These actions would produce many more graduates from the CIT AAS program with much stronger IT skill levels and job readiness.
 - Besides enabling and inspiring HS students to earn credits for two CIT courses while in high school, the plan also would require students to enroll FT the summer immediately after they graduate high school through the following Spring (12 months). The opportunity to earn a CIT AAS degree and qualifying to sit for as many as nine industry certification exams within a year of HS graduation should be very attractive relative to trying to work near-full time while taking 12-15 hours of courses per semester.
 - Financial aid to cover tuition and fees for enrollment in the bridge summer semester (immediately following HS graduation) is a gap in the plan. However, we assess that employers or grants would be willing to provide the funds to scholarship qualifying students to attract more highly qualified students into these pathways and get them through them successfully at higher rates and faster tempos.
 - The program could and should seek support of area school systems to offer dual enrollment courses on ground at select, area high schools and then do so - either with current or additional (grant-funded) FT faculty. In this way, we would increase the visibility of our programs, boost our FTE, and "prime the pump" for our own "FastPath" program.
 - More effectively promoting existing dual credit opportunities and looking for additional (and legitimate/appropriate) new dual credit opportunities for CIT classes could help.
 - The soon-to-be signed articulation agreement with TCAT Livingston could help, since they teach CIT courses on ground to large numbers of students enrolled in CIT CTE courses at Putnam County high schools.
7. With a portfolio of programs and pathways that align well with each other and with employers' needs, we are well-positioned to *strategically* and simultaneously engage a select group of tech and tech-dependent employers to propose the creation of a pool of similarly structured, clinicals-like, college compatible, paid internships for qualifying second year CIT AAS students.
- Informing them of our current enrollment challenges and likely workforce contribution declines and our potential to do radically better with their support (in the form of these internship programs), we would likely find many employers more than happy to partner with us in this initiative.

Evidence:

- CIT VSCC Insider Article

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Student Learning Item 1: Schedule on ground sections of first year CIT courses to facilitate *de facto* cohort-based learning and draw more students into on ground sections for increased hands-on learning,

stronger student-to-student connections, closer connections to the faculty and department, and increased proximity to college support programs and support staff.

- The 2020 move to prescriptive, highly sequential, horizontally-aligned curriculum pathways concentrates enrollment demand and enables us to offer more modality options and on ground sections.
- This enables us to assertively promote de facto or cohort-like learning for stronger learning communities and greater participation rates in co-curricular programming.

Timeline:

- Early-Feb 2022
 - Meet with faculty to solidify the specific scheduling decisions for on ground sections at the Gallatin campus for Fall 2022 and Spring 2023
 - Distribute press release through PA publicizing this scheduling innovation and associated learning benefits for students.
 - Distribute recruiting materials promoting CIT programs and de facto cohort/cohort-like learning opportunities to students at area high schools, leveraging partnerships with area CTE directors.
- Mid-Feb 2022
 - Meet with employers to explore feasibility of offering commonly-structured and -scheduled, paid internships to qualified second-year CIT AAS students
 - If a plan/program materializes, market that in conjunction with program and career field promotion
- Spring- Summer 2022
 - Send texts, emails, and letters with program and career field information to to all Vol State applicants and visitors expressing interest in CIT and/or Computer Science
- Sum 2022
 - Host Program forums in conjunction with each Campus Connect to educate CIT enrollees and prospects about pathways and career options in CIT
- Fall 2022
 - Host an early semester "Welcome Event" for CIT AAS majors to reinforce messages and promote optimal learning choices
- CY2023 and CY 2024
 - Repeat the same cycle but apply lessons learned from previous year(s)
 - ideally commit to and assertively promote "cohort-like" on ground learning opportunities for Year 2 classes in Gallatin for AY2023-2024
 - Ideally find/stimulate sufficient enrollment demand to begin offering cohort-like, on ground learning opportunities for the Networking and Cyber Defense concentrations in the Upper Cumberland by AY2023-2024

Student Learning Item 2: Schedule and assertively promote optional, instructor-supported, on-ground lab time before and after two-course blocks of CIT classes offered as part of the on-ground cohort opportunity in Gallatin. This bootcamp-style learning opportunity is a common learning and scheduling tactic in skills-focused computer and IT classes.

TIMELINE: The actions and schedule for this initiative will parallel that of the cohort scheduling initiative listed as Item 1, above.

- Early Feb 2022
 - Meet with faculty and commit to specific scheduling model and classrooms/lab assignments for Fall 2022 and Spring 2023
 - Promote the bootcamp-style learning opportunities in conjunction with initiatives to promote the de facto cohort opportunities in item 1, above.
- Spring 2022
 - Brief employer partners about this initiative in Feb/Spring meetings and inquire about possible employer-provided incentives to boost student utilization of "bootcamp" lab time.
- Spring - Fall 2022
 - Educate prospective and incoming CIT students about the "bootcamp style" learning time and the benefits of participation.
- CY2023 and CY2024
 - Review Fall 2022 participation rates, learning and retention impacts and opportunities for program refinement.
 - Identify them and publicize the initiative again in subsequent recruiting cycles and student engagement campaigns

Student Success Item 1: Redevelop the model course for INFS 1010, Computer Applications to integrate key Student Success material from FYEX classes into INFS 1010 assignments. Make more of the assignments team-based to foster student-to-student connections and working as teams.

- The breadth and depth of learning required for entry-level and middle skills CIT/tech jobs and certifications doesn't allow room for FYEX in CIT AAS or BUS AAS curriculum
- INFS 1010, Computer Applications is an early-pathway course required for every BUS and CIT/TECH major (AAS, TCs, and AS - TTP)
 - This makes it an ideal course to introduce or reinforce key student success principles and foster student connectedness

Timeline:

- Fall 2022
 - Dean and Chair meet with key faculty and instructional design specialists to discuss the idea and get feedback on its feasibility
 - Dean and Chair formally charter interdisciplinary team to work the project and redesign the model course in Spr 2022
- Spr 2022
 - Interdisciplinary team (CIT and BUS faculty; instructional specialists in DE; FYEX course managers...) redesign INFS 1010
- Sum 2022
 - CIT Faculty beta test a prototype of the revised course
- Sum 2022
 - Course manager provides course orientation to adjunct faculty who will teach the revised version of the course for the first time in Fall 2022
- Dec 2022/Jan 2023
 - Course manager revises/"tweaks" INFS 1010 model course in response to end-of-course student evals and post-semester feedback from faculty who taught it.
- CY 2023-2024
 - Division/Tech Department continues to deliver the revised version of the course universal to the curriculum of every B&T program student (~1,500)

Student Success Item 2: Simultaneously meet with senior leaders from larger tech- and tech-dependent employers from the region to pitch the creation of a pool of similarly-structured, college- (schedule- and workload-) compatible, recurring, paid internships or apprenticeships for qualifying second year CIT AAS students.

- Most students already enrolled in the CIT AAS program are already working full-time or nearly full-time. Jobs are plentiful and most are trying to take advantage of high wage rates in unskilled jobs at the same time they work their way to a CIT AAS degree. Thus, we have seen very low student interest in part-time job postings from area employers that are publicized in the middle of or just prior to the start of a semester.

Conversely, prospective and future traditional students entering or contemplating the CIT AAS program would likely have significant interest in part-time, college-friendly, paid IT internships available to them (with long lead/notice times) during the second-year of their CIT AAS studies. Developing and systematically promoting a pool of such opportunities as an optional but alluring element of our program available to qualifying students could produce many strategic dividends:

- attract more students and better students to the program - particularly traditional students who lack but need significant work experience in white collar roles
- positively affect students' early-program, work-school balance decisions
- inspire increased academic commitment and excellence to compete for the opportunities
- support more successful transitions to work for CIT AAS graduates and boost the reputation of our program and enhance student recruitment
-

To produce internships for CIT AAS students at a scale that would meaningfully impact student recruitment, academic performance, retention, and completion, we need to work intentionally and collaboratively with employers to develop a "program" of such opportunities that could be promoted in aggregate and would roll over systematically from semester-to-semester, year-to-year. Because "traditional" students attending full-time (and therefore most likely to be interested in such opportunities) are only a fraction of each cohort of graduates, we estimate that we could have a very significant impact on workforce production and student recruitment with a pool of only 20-25 or so

opportunities in a pilot year or two. If the program had the impact on student recruitment and completion we desire, we might need to scale it up further or the student competition for the opportunities would just increase -- either way we go would be good for the program, the employers, and for workforce production.

TIMELINE:

- Feb-Mar 2022
 - Division hosts meeting with leaders from tech- and tech-dependent employers and economic development leaders with interest
 - Division provides overview of CIT AAS program/concentrations and discuss workforce needs and gaps
 - Present vision for a CIT AAS "FastPath" and for a pool of similarly structured, paid, college-friendly, IT internships for students in the second year of the pathway
 - Explore employer interest in these ideas as responses to the workforce gap and program recruitment and workforce production challenges
- Mar-Apr 2022
 - Follow up meetings with employers, college support units, and other stakeholders/partners and supporting agencies
- Apr 2022
 - Publicize the Fall 2022 pilot of any new pool of paid internships that the employers might elect to create
- Summer 2022
 - Reach out to returning CIT AAS students to promote the opportunities and support applicant screening and placement
- Fall 2022
 - First cohort of interns begin work with their IT employers
 - Business and Technology Dean and Tech Dept Chair work with partner employers to assess success and logical refinements to the program
 - Promote successes to other tech- and tech-dependent employers and seek to scale up the program by Fall 2023
- Spring 2023
 - Repeat actions listed above to promote the opportunity and help employers identify program participants for AY 2023-3024

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

The Department Chair, Johnny Maynard and I collaboratively wrote this report and deliberated and reviewed one another's input into the report. We both agree this report accurately depicts the current state of the CIT AAS program, where it has been, how far it has come, and sound strategies to improve it, going forward. Thus, naturally, I approve it. We look forward to having others review this report and provide us their feedback.

ANDREW W. WHITE, Dean
Business and Technology Division

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Student Learning Item 1: Schedule on ground sections of first year CIT courses to facilitate <i>de facto</i> cohort-based learning and draw more students into on ground sections for increased hands-on learning, stronger student-to-student connections, closer connections to the faculty and department, and increased proximity to college support programs and support staff. PLO 1	Beginning in AY 2022-23, first year on-campus classes were scheduled within daytime timeslots that would encourage student cohorts.	Not enough enrollment in second-year on-campus classes. The majority of students that were in the second half of their degree were mostly online at this point.	No changes in timeline.	40% of CITC courses within the AAS CIT degree curriculum were scheduled as daytime on-campus class offerings.
2	Student Learning Item 2: Schedule and	Select on-campus courses in the curriculum offered additional on-campus	Not all FT faculty agreed to offer additional lab times to support	No changes in timeline.	15% of the CITC courses within the

	assertively promote optional, instructor-supported, on-ground lab time before and after two-course blocks of CIT classes offered as part of the on-ground cohort opportunity in Gallatin PLO 5	lab sessions outside the regularly scheduled classes. The courses included -- Cisco CCNA classes (CITC 1323, 1324, 2321) and CompTIA A+ and CompTIA Network+ classes (CITC 1320 and CITC 1302).	their classes outside of the individual office hours they were already required to provide. Only two FT faculty members agreed to provide additional lab time schedule after their regularly scheduled class periods. This was to help encourage test prep for industry standard IT certifications (CompTIA and Cisco) and also preparation for SkillsUSA-related competition events that select students elected to participate in.		AAS CIT curriculum offered on-campus lab support outside of the required class time period.
3	Student Success Item 1: Redevelop the model course for INFS 1010, Computer Applications to integrate key Student Success material from 3 FYEX classes into INFS 1010 assignments. Make more of the assignments team-based to foster student-to-student connections and working as teams.	A new FYEX course is in the process of being finalized which may include team-based assignments/activities.	Due to changes in faculty and leadership personnel within the B&T division, the INFS 1010 course was <u>not</u> modified to include Student Success materials that were originally intended for a FYEX course.	A new FYEX course is in the process of being finalized which may include team-based assignments/activities.	The INFS 1010 course was <u>not</u> modified to include Student Success materials that were originally intended for a FYEX course.
4	Student Success Item	Met with leadership within the Workforce	The VP of Economic	This outcome was not achieved.	This outcome

2:	Simultaneously meet with senior leaders from larger tech- and tech-dependent employers from the region to pitch the creation of a pool of similarly structured, college- (schedule- and workload-) compatible, recurring, paid internships or apprenticeships for qualifying second year CIT AAS students.	and Economic Development division at VSCC 2-3 different occasions to discuss Work-Based Learning (WBL) opportunities and building a consortium group of local-area employers that would commit to offering rotating WBL/Internship opportunities for CIT students every academic year.	Development Workforce never did follow-up with any support with assisting in building WBL/Internships. In addition, there were leadership changes at the VPAA and Dean-level, which affected this initiative as well.	was not achieved.
----	--	--	--	-------------------

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
1	Incorporate CompTIA A+, Network+, and Security+ certification exams as the final exam component within key CITC certification-aligned courses. PLO 5	Certification exams were embedded as the Final Exam component in the following CITC courses: CITC 1302, CITC 1320, CITC 1332, CITC 2321, and CITC 2326. The certification exam vouchers were funded using (3) different grant sources.	Difficulty scheduling exams at low-capacity Pearson VUE on-site Testing Center during Final Exam week. Limited grant funding in terms of dollar \$\$ amount eligibility and availability.		YES
2	Schedule first year CITC courses on-campus to continue				

	cohort student groups. PLO 1				
3					
4					

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1	Incorporate CompTIA A+, Network+, and Security+ certification exams as the final exam component within the CITC 1320, CITC 1302, and CITC 2326 courses.			
2	Schedule second year CITC courses on-campus to continue cohort student groups.			
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Health Sciences AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first Academic Program Review (APR).

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The mission statement of the Health Sciences Associate of Applied Science (HS AAS) options degree is as follows: The College offers an Associate of Applied Science degree as a career ladder for persons who have successfully completed their certificate program of study in Dental Assistant, Diagnostic Medical Sonography, EMT-Paramedic, or Sleep Diagnostics.

The only change that is warranted at this time for consistency of terminology is changing Dental Assistant to Dental Assisting.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

The mission statement aligns with the institution's mission to offer quality, innovative programs, build partnerships, and prepare students for successful careers.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

See attached evidence for an example of curriculum mapping for the Diagnostic Medical Sonography program.

HS AAS Outcomes

1. Develop the knowledge and skills required of a health sciences professional. [DAST1530, DAST1610, SONO2036C, SONO2010, SONO2000, EMPS2412, PSG120, PSG131, PSG132]
2. Utilize the language of medicine to enhance effective communication. [DAST1530, DAST1610, SONO2036C, SONO2010, SONO2000, EMPS2412, PSG132]
3. Demonstrate critical thinking skills in the clinical environment. [DAST1530, DAST1610, SONO2036C, SONO2010, SONO2000, EMPS2412, PSG120]
4. Exhibit proficiency in the licensure and/or certification. [DAST1530, DAST1610, SONO2036C, EMPS2412, PSG120]

Dental Assisting: Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this program, the graduate will have developed the skills, knowledge and abilities to accomplish the following:

1. Student will demonstrate the basic skills to be a competent dental assistant. [DAST1530 & DAST 1610] [HS AAS PLO #1]
2. Students will define the terminology unique to dental assisting. [DAST1530 & DAST 1610] [HS AAS PLO #2]
3. Students will illustrate comprehension of professional ethical standards for dental assisting. [DAST1530 & DAST 1610] [HS AAS PLO #1]
4. Students will apply and demonstrate critical thinking, problem solving and decision-making skills within the parameters of dental assisting. [DAST1530 & DAST 1610] [HS AAS PLO #3]

Diagnostic Medical Sonography: Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this program, the graduate will have developed the skills, knowledge and abilities to accomplish the following:

1. Demonstrate knowledge in appropriate didactic areas. [SONO2036C] [HS AAS PLO #4]
2. Integrate knowledge into competency-based clinical experience. [SONO2036C] [HS AAS PLO #1]
3. Apply skills to exceed the standards of the profession. [SONO2036C, SONO2010, SONO2000] [HS AAS PLO #1]
4. Analyze clinical data. [SONO2036C, SONO2010, SONO2000] [HS AAS PLO #3]
5. Write effectively in more than one format as part of the writing across the professional curriculum initiative. [SONO2036C, SONO2010, SONO2000] [HS AAS PLO #2]
6. Provide excellent quality care to enrich and support the community through active engagement. [SONO2036C, SONO2010, SONO2000] [HS AAS PLO #1]
7. Engage and maintain personal professional relationships. [SONO2036C] [HS AAS PLO #1]

Emergency Medical Technology- Paramedic Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this program, the graduate will have developed the skills, knowledge and abilities to accomplish the following:

1. The student will integrate and synthesize the multiple determinants of professional roles and responsibilities of the emergency medical services system as well as emergency medical services system operations as a paramedic in the pre-hospital emergency care setting. [EMPS2412] [HS AAS PLO #1]
2. The student will integrate and synthesize the multiple determinants of medical and legal considerations of operating as a paramedic in the pre-hospital emergency care setting. [EMPS2412] [HS AAS PLO #3]
3. The student will integrate and synthesize the multiple determinants of pharmacological interventions available to treat patients as a paramedic in the pre-hospital emergency care setting. [EMPS2412] [HS AAS PLO #4]

4. The student will recognize, classify and translate the multiple determinants of public health as a paramedic in the pre-hospital emergency care setting. [EMPS2412] [HS AAS PLO #1]
5. Students will safely and effectively perform the psychomotor skills relative to medical and trauma care of age-related patients associated with care as a paramedic in the pre-hospital emergency care setting. [EMPS2412] [HS AAS PLO #3]

Sleep Diagnostic Technology: Learning Outcomes

Upon completion of this program, the graduate will have developed the skills, knowledge and abilities to accomplish the following:

1. Graduates will become competent polysomnographic technologists with training in the fundamentals of polysomnographic technology, laboratory fundamentals, and clinical skills as outlined in, but not limited to, the American Association of Sleep Technologists (AASST) Curriculum Outline. [PSG120] [HS AAS PLO #3 & #4]
2. Graduates will have achieved both academic and clinical competency in cognitive, psychomotor, and affective learning domains using the following organizations as sources of standards: American Association of Sleep Technologists, Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists, and the American Academy of Sleep Medicine. [PSG120] [HS AAS PLO #1]
3. The students' accomplishments of their academic and clinical objectives will prepare them with entry level skills as Polysomnographic Technicians. [PSG120, PSG131, PSG132] [HS AAS PLO #1 & #2]
4. Successful completion of the program will help prepare the graduate to take the Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists Registry Exam. [PSG120] [HS AAS PLO #4]

Evidence:

- DMS Program Outcome Mapping 2021

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

[Paramedic National Registry](#)__The College is committed to developing graduates who effectively meet the needs of the workplace. Associate of Applied Sciences degree options in Health Sciences (HS AAS) is offered as a career ladder for persons who have successfully completed a technical certificate program of study. The degree is designed to assist employees in the health sciences field with their general and continued education. The technical certificate programs of study include Dental Assisting, Diagnostic Medical Sonography, Emergency Medical Technology (EMT) - Paramedic, and Sleep Diagnostics Technology.

The HS AAS degree requirements are listed:

General Education Requirements - Credits (15 - 17)

- [Humanities and/or Fine Arts](#) Credits: (3)
- [Natural Sciences/Math](#) (BIOL 2010 Preferred - See Advisor) Credits: (3-4)
- [ENGL 1010 - ^English Composition I](#) Credits: (3)

- One additional [General Education](#) course from any of the following categories: Communication, Humanities/Fine Arts, Math, Natural Science or Social/Behavioral Sciences **Credits: (3-4)**
- [PSYC 1030 - ^Introduction to Psychology](#) **Credits: (3)**
- **OR** [PSYC 2130 - ^Lifespan Development Psychology](#) **Credits: (3)**

Professional Core Course Requirements - Credits (15)

- [ALHS 2312 - *Contemporary Issues in Healthcare](#) **Credits: (3)**
- [BUSN 1380 - *Supervisory Management](#) **Credits: (3)**
- [BUSN 2370 - *Legal Environment of Business](#) **Credits: (3)**
- Electives: Choose from the list below or from a MATH, AHC, ALHS, Natural Science course or the student may apply Dental Assisting Technical Certificate credits earned in excess of 30 credit hours as electives **Credits: (6)**
- [AHC 115 - *Medical Terminology](#) **Credits: (3)**
- [BIOL 2020 - ^Human Anatomy and Physiology II](#) **Credits: (4)**
- [MATH 1130 - ^College Algebra](#) **Credits: (3)**
- [PHYS 1030 - ^Survey of Physics](#) **Credits: (4)**

Total Degree Requirements - Credits (60-62)

It is recommended that prospective students follow recommended schedules for the specific technical certificate and to consult with an academic advisor to schedule the remaining courses. Students may be awarded up to 31 - 32 hours of credit based towards the HS AAS degree upon initial certification in the programs.

Each of the programs provide an exceptional education that when partnered with the HS AAS degree will benefit the graduate. The programs are fully accredited by their respective accrediting bodies thereby undergoing stringent processes for reviewing effectiveness from an external perspective. The bodies utilize collaborative, peer-reviewed processes to evaluate educational quality. They require obtainment of evidence-based standards that reflect what a student needs to know and be able to do to successfully function within the profession upon graduation.

External Evaluation

To ensure accountability, annual surveys or reports are submitted by the program directors. The compilation of the reports provides an opportunity for faculty to assess quality and reflect on the previous year. Programs must undergo the reaccreditation process every several years at various intervals depending on the program. The process includes completion of a self-study and culminates with a site visit by the accreditors.

The self-study is an in-depth evaluation and recording of the educational journey of the program since the previous accreditation cycle. An example of an areas that is included is institutional effectiveness, which evaluates everything from planning and assessment to financial and community support of the program. The program itself is assessed with regards to admissions, matriculation, curriculum, instruction, and assessment.

Additional areas of evaluation are support services, clinical affiliations, resources such as classroom, library, and computer access as well as support from business and industry, advisory committees (see meeting notes in evidence section) administration, faculty, and staff. Job placement and obtaining licensure, registry, and credentials are also assessed. The programs are accrediting by the following organizations:

Dental Assisting: The Commission on Dental Accreditation (CODA),
<https://coda.ada.org/en>

Diagnostic Medical Sonography: The Commission on Accreditation of Allied Health Education Programs in cooperation with the Joint Review Committee on Education in Diagnostic Medical Sonography

<https://www.caahep.org/>
<https://www.jrcdms.org>

Emergency Medical Technology – Paramedic: The Commission on Accreditation of Allied Health Education Programs upon recommendation with the Commission on Accreditation of Educational Programs for the Emergency Medical Services Professions

<https://www.caahep.org/>
<https://coaemsp.org/>

Sleep Diagnostic Technology: The Commission on Accreditation of Allied Health Education Programs in cooperation with the Commission on Accreditation of Educational Programs in Polysomnographic Technology

<https://www.caahep.org/About-CAAHEP/Committees-on-Accreditation/Polysomnographic-Technology.aspx>

To continue to deliver a high-quality education, program faculty meet regularly to discuss student matriculation, course structuring, student and program evaluation, clinical objectives, job placement, and registry and credential attainment. Program directors and College administrators review the status of each program to ensure that competencies are consistent with stated goals and standards. Additionally, respective advisory committees and clinical personnel provide input related to overall program effectiveness.

Program directors must also ensure compliance with the Southern Association of Colleges and Schools Commission on Colleges (SACSCOC). It is the College's institutional accrediting body. In addition to ensuring quality, the organization desires to improve effectiveness at institutions of higher learning by requiring compliance of specific standards which cover similar categories as the programmatic accreditation bodies. Examples of categories of standards that are addressed with SACSCOC are educational policies, procedures, and practices, student achievement, and qualifications of faculty members.

Internal Evaluation

Internal evaluation of each program's effectiveness is evaluated by Academic Audits that are facilitated by the Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR). The audit is a faculty-driven model of ongoing self-reflection, collaboration, teamwork, and peer feedback. Academic Audit Outcomes:

1. A faculty-centered methodology that supports institutional effectiveness expectations.
2. A thoroughly documented process that meets the requirements for Quality Assurance Funding
3. A process that sustains continuous quality improvement of teaching and learning

The audits are typically completed every three-years and require completion of a self-study, peer review, and a site visit. At the end of the audit, the auditor team provides feedback which includes commendations, affirmations, and recommendations for continued improvement.
(<https://www.tbr.edu/academics/academic-audit>).

Through collaboration with the Office of Institutional Effectiveness, Research, Planning and Assessment, programs are further assessed through Academic Program Reviews (APR). The APR is a comprehensive assessment designed to ensure the programs are providing quality and innovative education to students. Completion of the APR requires assessment, reflection, and actions over a 3-year cycle.

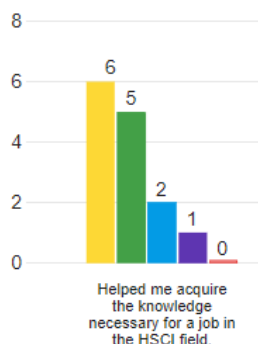
The evaluation of the following areas: job placement rates, licensure/certification passage rates, employer and graduate satisfaction ratings are of particular interest to all stakeholders. Information from those areas provide insight about the quality of each individual program connected to the HS AAS degree and the services of the college. The Academic Program Review will examine the results of Graduate and Employer survey results as well as data from IERPA to assess the effectiveness of the degree.

Evidence of student learning after obtaining the HS AAS degree consists of the following questions obtained from the 2020 Graduate Surveys:

● Strongly Agree ● Generally Agree ● Neutral ● Generally Disagree ● Strongly Disagree

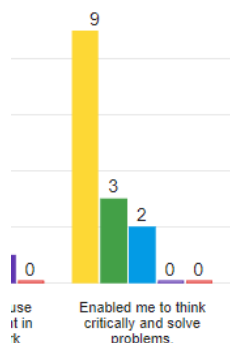
1. Graduates will acquire the knowledge necessary for a job in the health care field. 4.14 (Graduate Survey, page 7)

Field	Min	Max	Mean	Standard Deviation	Variance	Responses	Sum
Helped me acquire the knowledge necessary for a job in the HSCI field.	2.00	5.00	4.14	0.91	0.84	14	58.00



2. Graduates will be able think critically and solve problems. 4.50 (Graduate Survey, page 7)

Field	Min	Max	Mean	Standard Deviation	Variance	Responses	Sum
Helped me acquire the knowledge necessary for a job in the HSCI field.	2.00	5.00	4.14	0.91	0.84	14	58.00
Enabled me to think critically and solve problems.	3.00	5.00	4.50	0.73	0.54	14	63.00



3. The employee demonstrates the ability to work independently as evidenced by Employer Survey results (page 2).

Field	Poor	Needs Improvement	Fair	Good	Excellent	Total
4. The ability to work independently.	0.0% 0	0.0% 0	0.0% 0	25.0% 3	75.0% 9	12

4. Graduates will demonstrate appropriate work ethic as evidenced by Employer Survey results (page 2).

Field	Poor	Needs Improvement	Fair	Good	Excellent	Total
6. Appropriate work ethic.	0.0% 0	0.0% 0	0.0% 0	25.0% 3	75.0% 9	12

5. Board examination passage and state registry rates will reach a threshold of 90% in all degree option programs. One of the primary goals of all programs is to prepare graduates to successfully pass certification and registry exams. Examination agencies publish content outlines. Program faculty crossmatch the information with learning outcomes and objectives from accreditation agencies and employers. This information can serve as a gap analysis for faculty to assist with the development and revision of learning objectives particularly when revisions in the exams occur.

To become a Registered Dental Assistant (RDA) graduates from the program must apply for registration through the Tennessee Department of Dentistry and pass an ethics course. The chart below represents the number of graduates who obtained the RDA designation. During the program, specialty certification courses were implemented to strengthen the students' knowledge base and to increase employability. One such course is the certification course in coronal polishing. The link to the content outline is noted. Review national examination matrices for the remaining programs through the accompanying links.

Dental Assisting	Certification Course in Coronal Polishing _ Content Outline pages 19-22
Diagnostic Medical Sonography	Sonography Principles and Instrumentation Exam - Content Outline
EMT - Paramedic	Paramedic Registry Exam - Content Outline
Sleep Diagnostics	Registered Polysomnography Technician Exam - Content Outline

As indicated below, although the 90% threshold average was met in the Diagnostic Sonography and Paramedic programs. The average passage rate for Dental Assisting is 89% over the 3-year period. This is primarily due to the 79% passage rate in 2018. Since then, the curriculum has been revised and additional certifications were implemented. Note a steady increase in the program in subsequent years. The Sleep Diagnostics program is well below the 90% threshold for passage rates. This could be due to a variety of reasons and will be examined in detail in the 2nd-year APR.

PASSAGE RATES				
*Registry	# National Board Examination			
Program	2018	2019	2020	2018 - 2020
Dental Assistant*	15/19 = 79%	13/14 = 93%	12/12 = 100%	40/45 = 89%
Diagnostic Medical Sonography#	16/16 = 100%	16/16 = 100%	12/13 = 92%	44/45 = 98%
EMT - Paramedic#	41/45 = 91%	43/48 = 90%	37/41 = 90%	121/134 = 90%
Sleep Diagnostics#	6/9 = 78%	9/11 = 82%	6/11 = 55%	21/31 = 68%

In summary, evidence of student learning with the HS AAS degree option is demonstrated by positive internal and external accreditation results, maintenance of standards, the production of high outcomes, the responses to graduate surveys, and the excellent board examination passage rates. The faculty use methodical processes for developing measurable, clear, and relevant outcomes based on accreditation standards and objectives. Through combining and analyzing the resulting data, program faculty can identify strengths and gaps in instructional sequence and content and make modifications as needed.

Evidence:

- Accreditation Report - Paramedic
- Annual Reports
 - Dental Assisting
 - Diagnostic Medical Sonography
- Surveys
 - Employer _ HS AAS 2020
 - Graduate _ HS AAS 2020
 - Graduate and Employer Response Report _ HS AAS 2020
- Minutes of Advisory Committee Meetings
 - Dental Assisting
 - Emergency Medical Services (includes Paramedic)
 - Sleep Diagnostic Technology

Evidence:

- Accreditation Report _ Paramedic
- Annual Survey _ Dental Assisting
- Annual Survey _ Diagnostic Medical Sonography

- Minutes 2020 Dental Advisory Committee
- Minutes 2020 Diagnostic Sonography Advisory Committee
- Minutes 2020 Emergency Medical Services Advisory Committee
- Minutes 2020 Sleep Diagnostic Advisory Committee
- Surveys _ Employer 2018 _ HS AAS
- Surveys _ Employer 2019 _ HS AAS
- Surveys _ Employer 2020 _ HS AAS
- Surveys _ Graduate 2018 _ HS AAS
- Surveys _ Graduate 2019 _ HS AAS
- Surveys _ Graduate 2020 _ HS AAS

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

The Health Sciences Technical Certificate programs within the HS AAS degree have strong support from the College, clinical affiliates, communities of interest, current students, and graduates. Course evaluations for current students are captured and analyzed through the College's EvaluationKIT software to aid instructors in improving course content and teaching practices. Graduate survey tools are collected and evaluated to measure graduate satisfaction with the assistance of the IERPA department. The programs implement comprehensive assessments and strategies to continuously improve effectiveness.

Faculty members routinely pursue continued education to ensure teaching excellence and the overall success of the programs. Continued education is pursued, externally, through respective professional and accreditation organizations. From an internal perspective, they participate in educational offerings through Vol State's Teaching and Learning Institute for topics related to High Impact Practices such as service and experiential learning.

The diverse pedagogical approaches employed by faculty include, but are not limited to, group facilitation, lecture, utilization of technology, clinical simulations, and pragmatic laboratory activities. In addition to volunteer activities, students participate in service-learning activities during clinical rotations. In the clinical realm, learning is enhanced through direct patient care while students are also providing service to the community. The varied approaches afford students the opportunity to experience success in a variety of formats.

Although each technical certificate program had a robust submission of course evaluations, one weakness noted is the low number of responses for the HS AAS 2020 Graduate and Employer Surveys. The number of graduate responses was 14 and there were 12 employer responses. Some potential roadblocks to survey completion are IERPA not knowing a graduates preferred contact method or current employer. The program directors typically know the best way to get in contact with graduates, where they are employed, and the name of their direct supervisors. A recommendation is that program directors more closely collaborate with IERPA to increase the number of responses.

Graduates appreciate the significant value of the HS AAS options degree as reflected in the following comments from anonymous surveys:

- "Highly recommend this program, and I am so thankful I pursued it!" (2020)
- "I was a paramedic for 30 years prior to finishing my degree. The courses provided by Vol State are great for entry level EMTs and paramedics. I would recommend all paramedics finish their degree to help them advance in their career. If more medics and EMTs have degrees, it is easier to negotiate for more money." (2019)
- "Upon hire, I was able to perform nearly all exams required as a professional and I was able to clearly communicate findings to radiologists." (2018)

According to page 8 of the Graduate Survey, course content, working with peers, and the faculty are listed as top strengths of the Health Sciences AAS degree. Students' perception of faculty efficacy can be noted in course evaluation responses for the question *"The assignments were relevant to the course outcomes and helped me learn the material"*.

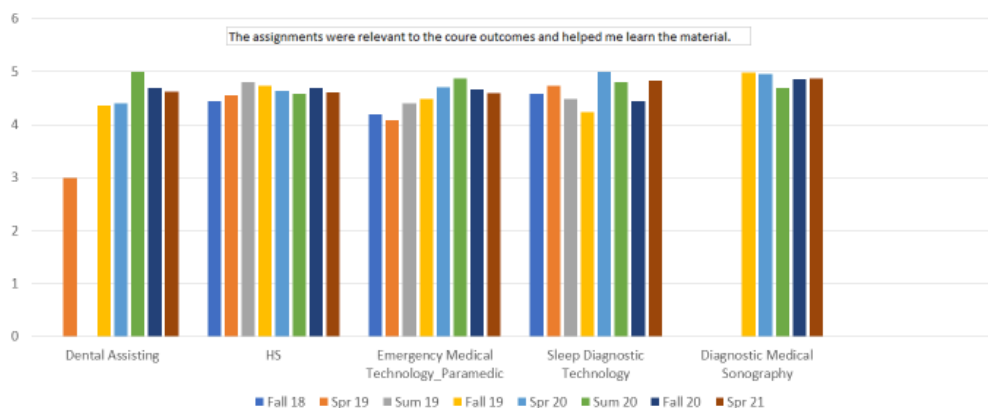
The following Likert scale was utilized:

- 5 = Strongly Agree
- 4 = Agree
- 3 = Neither Agree or Disagree
- 2 = Disagree
- 1 = Strongly Disagree

The 3-year average rating for the question with each discipline, including the HS AAS, is listed below.

Discipline	3-Year Average (Fall 18' to Spring 21')
Dental Assisting	4.35
Diagnostic Medical Sonography	4.87
Emergency Medical Technology - Paramedic	4.5
Health Sciences (HS)	4.63
Sleep Diagnostic Technology	4.64

Course Evaluations



Another satisfaction tool is assessing how many graduates have obtained obtain gainful employment. With each technical certificate program having an excellent reputation in the healthcare community of Middle Tennessee, employment has not been an issue. Graduates are well-received within their individual employment settings and have strong employment outcomes as demonstrated by the placement data below:

Placement Rates				
	2018	2019	2020	2018 - 2020
Dental Assistant	14/19 = 73%	13/14 = 93%	12/12 = 100%	39/45 = 87%
Diagnostic Medical Sonography	16/16 = 100%	16/16 = 100%	12/13 = 92%	44/45 = 98%
Paramedic	45/45 = 100%	48/48 = 100%	41/41 = 100%	134/134 = 100%
Sleep Diagnostics	14/23 = 61%	27/31 = 87%	16/23 = 70%	57/77 = 74%

In summary, the HS AAS degree option has been shown to be effective based on student and graduate satisfaction. Listed strengths include the faculty, accomplishment of learning outcomes, and improvement in career opportunities and gainful employment. It supports the mission of the College by being an option in innovative, quality programs and promoting economic development to prepare students for successful careers. Students are educated in high quality programs that prepare them to be competent and proficient graduates. Upon graduation, gainful employment is obtained to meet the demands of the workforce. In the future, each program director will collaborate more closely with the IERPA department to increase the quantity of survey responses. Satisfaction for all stakeholders will continue to be monitored.

Evidence:

- Course Evaluations – 2018 to 2021
 1. Dental Assisting
 2. Diagnostic Medical Sonography
 3. Emergency Medical Technology – Paramedic
 4. Health Sciences
 5. Sleep Diagnostic Technology
- Surveys
 1. Graduate – HS AAS 2020
 2. Employer – HS AAS 2020
 3. Graduate and Employer Response Report – HS AAS 2020

Evidence:

- Course Evaluations_ Dental Assisting 2018 to 2021
- Course Evaluations_ Diagnostic Medical Sonography 2018 to 2021
- Course Evaluations_ EMT Paramedic 2018 to 2021
- Course Evaluations_ Health Sciences 2018 to 2021
- Course Evaluations_ Sleep Diagnostic 2018 to 2021
- Surveys _ Employer 2020_ HS AAS
- Surveys _ Graduate 2020_ HS AAS
- Surveys _ Graduate and Employer Response Report 2020_ HS AAS

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics

5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

The following data was obtained from Vol State's Fact Book on 11/30/2021. It reflects students and graduates who declared the HS AAS as a degree from Fall 2018 to Spring 2021. They are blocked out in blue and contained details about programs unrelated to the HS AAS degree.

HS AAS Program Headcounts					
Degree/Program/Concentration	Fall2017	Fall2018	Fall2019	Fall2020	Fall2021
☒ Associate of Applied Science	1256	1392	1460	1460	1335
☒ Health Science	39	7	36	59	78
	20	4	2	1	
Dental Assistant	2	1	4	3	1
Dental Assisting				15	15
Diagnostic Medical Sonography				1	17
EMT Paramedic	1		18	29	36
Sleep Diagnostic Technology	16	2	12	10	9

FTE Comparison

Full Time Equivalent (FTE) 46.20 Fall2017 7.13 Fall2018 29.00 Fall2019 50.50 Fall2020 62.07 Fall2021	Gallatin Full Time Equivalent (FTE) 45.20 Fall2017 7.13 Fall2018 29.00 Fall2019 50.50 Fall2020 59.07 Fall2021	Online Full Time Equivalent (FTE) 14.40 Fall2017 2.27 Fall2018 12.53 Fall2019 38.37 Fall2020 14.47 Fall2021
Cookeville Full Time Equivalent (FTE) 1.00 Fall2017 7.00 Fall2020 2.00 Fall2021	Livingston Full Time Equivalent (FTE) 	Springfield Full Time Equivalent (FTE) 1.00 Fall2021

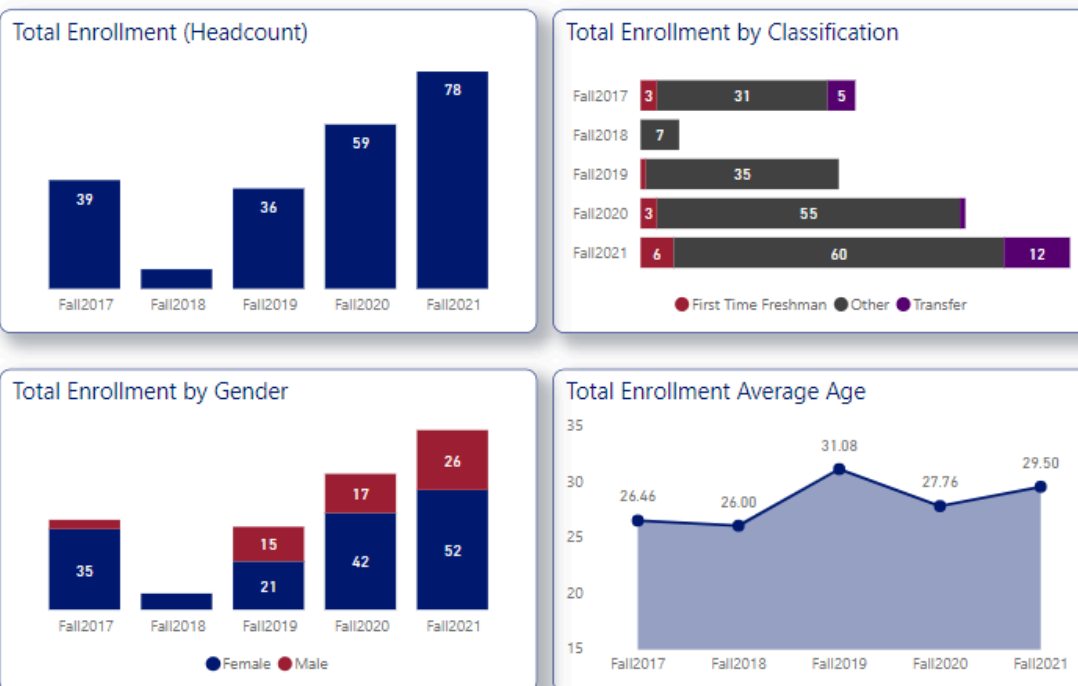
Residency

Resident	Fall2017	Fall2018	Fall2019	Fall2020	Fall2021
In State	36	7	35	59	75
Out-of-State	3		1		3
Total	39	7	36	59	78

State/County	Fall2017	Fall2018	Fall2019	Fall2020	Fall2021
Sumner County	14	3	11	19	26
Davidson County	4		3	5	10
Montgomery County	2		6	7	4
Wilson County	1	1	2	6	7
Robertson County	4		3	2	5
Rutherford County			3	2	5
Putnam County	2			4	2
Cheatham County	1		2	1	3
Macon County	1	1	1	1	1
White County				3	2
Hamilton County	2				1
Jackson County		1			2
Shelby County	1			2	
Van Buren County	1			1	1
Cumberland County			1	1	
KENTUCKY	1		1		
Smith County			1		1
Trousdale County	1			1	
Bradley County	1				
Clay County				1	
Coffee County				1	
DeKalb County					1

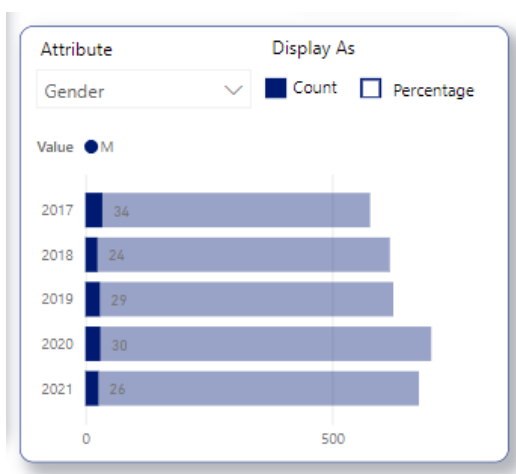
DeKalb County			1
Dickson County			1
Fentress County			1
GEORGIA			1
Gibson County		1	
Greene County			1
Humphreys County	1		
INDIANA			1
Logan County	1		
Maury County			1
NORTH CAROLINA	1		
Scott County		1	
Simpson County			1
Stewart County		1	
Tipton County			1
Williamson County			1

Student Primary Location and Demographics

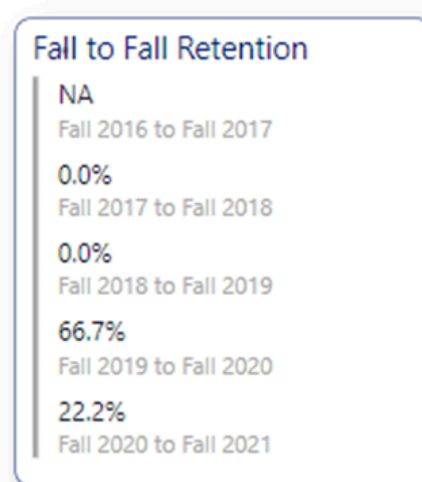


Demographics based on Gender and Age

When reviewing the total enrollment, note that the average enrollment age represents what is traditionally considered a non-traditional student or adult learner. There have been more female students than males for the past three years. Most of the male graduates are from the EMT - Paramedic Program, as evidenced by the following graph.



The Fact Book defines persistence as students who enroll in the fall semester and return the following spring or graduate within that academic year. Fall-to-spring persistence for the HS AAS degree averaged 75% from 2018 to 2021.



Since 2018, 102 graduates have earned the HS AAS degree, as evidenced by the following graph:

Degree	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Associate of Applied Science	59	50	50	34	18
Total	59	50	50	34	18

Graduates are further divided by program of study.

Concentration	Number of Graduates (2018-2021)
Dental Assistant	15
Diagnostic Medical Sonography	17

Emergency Medical Technology - Paramedic	64
Sleep Diagnostic Technology	35

Concentrations	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Dental Assistant	14	10	6	5	2
Dental Assisting					4
Diagnostic Medical Sonography	10	8	9	8	
EMT Paramedic	21	13	29	15	7
Sleep Diagnostic Technology	14	19	5	6	5

Based on the collected data, there are specific categories of students who could possibly benefit from the College's Office of Student Services. Marketing that focuses on available support services should provide emphasis on non-traditional students. Prospective male students should be solicited even though health careers at the community college level tend to be more female-dominated industries.

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could

also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The HS AAS option degree has been shown to be effective through the results of surveys from graduates and employers and during discussions with faculty and advisory board committees and positive standings with all accrediting bodies. As part of this review, students were surveyed through course evaluations and the responses were assessed. The students' perceptions regarding the value of the degree itself is of particular significance. Students overwhelmingly (4.6 out of a 5.0 Likert scale) agree that the assignments provided by faculty were relevant to the course outcomes and helped them learn the material.

The faculty consistently deliver high quality education with support from the College and community stakeholders. In the graduate survey, alumni expounded on the value of the degree for career advancement and increased competence in chosen healthcare fields. Since 2018, 89% (226/255) graduates have obtained state registry and credentials thereby providing an opportunity to join the growing workforce. Approximately 91% (274/301) graduates have obtained employment in the last three years. The employer survey revealed that 100% (12/12) employers indicated that graduates were adequately prepared for their positions and would hire another graduate from the HS AAS program if given the opportunity.

Recruitment is an area that needs specialized attention to assist the College with optimizing its mission statement of offering quality programs, promoting diversity, and preparing students for successful careers. The current headcount of students pursuing the degree is 78. Although that number is higher than it has been since 2018, recruitment efforts should be escalated. Most of the students reside in Sumner County which is not surprising since Vol State is the only public community college in the service area.

According to the US Census Bureau, Women hold 76% of all healthcare jobs <https://www.census.gov/library/stories/2019/08/your-health-care-in-womens-hands.html> and as expected the total enrollment by gender indicates that most students identify as female. The College can address the lack of diversity by marketing to other genders and races. The total enrollment age remains steady at approximately 29-years-of-age. We are attracting non-traditional students who have needs that are different from the 18-year-old college student. Are we meeting the needs of the adult learner? Do we have enough flexibility in course offerings to make it possible for them to be successful in our programs?

In summary, the HS AAS degree is fulfilling its mission statement by being a career ladder to those who have successfully completed technical certificate programs for Dental Assisting, Diagnostic Medical Sonography, EMT-Paramedic, and Sleep Diagnostic Technology. Students receive stellar educations and are eligible to obtain registry and credentials to make them job ready. Employers are

pleased with the graduates and provide gainful employment at increased rates. The ultimate beneficiary is the community who receive health care from our graduates.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

- **Student Learning Recommendation:** Assess components of the following professional core courses for the HS AAS degree in spring of 22:
 - **ALHS 2312** –Contemporary Issues to Healthcare
 - AY 2022-2023- Revise learning objectives to include higher levels of Bloom’s Taxonomy.
 - AY 2023-2024
 - **AHC 115** – Medical Terminology
 - AY 2022-2023- Collaborate with health sciences program directors to create short videos discussing physiological systems into eLearn shells. The goal is to introduce a different way to familiarize students to medical terminology from the health care professional perspective.
 - AY 2023-2024

- **Student Success Recommendation:** Improve Graduate Satisfaction Survey response rates.
 - **AY 2022-2023-** Collaborate with IERPA in the solicitation of completed graduate and employer surveys.
 - **AY 2023-2024-**

- **Student Success Recommendation:** Improve recruitment efforts of the HS AAS degree.
 - **AY 2022-2023-** Assist in the development of marketing efforts targeting under-represented demographics in Fall 2022. Promote the HS AAS options degree to persons who complete one of the technical certificates in Spring.
 - **AY2023-2024-**

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed, and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Revise learning objectives to include higher levels of Bloom's Taxonomy for ALHS 2312	A new edition of the textbook has been adopted and the SLO's have been reviewed.	This course does not have a lead instructor who is tasked with this initiative. A faculty member is needed to complete this project.	No changes	In process
2	For the AHC 115 course, collaborate with health sciences program directors to create short videos discussing physiological systems into eLearn shells. The goal is to introduce a different way to familiarize students to medical terminology from the health care professional perspective.	The medical terminology coordinator has created a list of topics based on the course schedule.	Not having a coordinator has created challenges. Now, we have one and she will lead this project.	No changes	In process
3	Collaborate with RASI in the solicitation of completed graduate and employer surveys.	The process for survey dissemination has been reviewed.	Lack of adequate staffing in RASI has delayed this initiative.	No changes	In process
4	Assist in the development of marketing efforts targeting under-represented demographics in Fall 2022. Promote the HS AAS options degree to persons who	This milestone was not met by Fall of 2022. Currently, the marketing	Lack of adequate staffing in Marketing/PR to assist with this initiative.	No changes	In process. An example of a proposed banner reflecting multiple

complete one of the technical certificates in the spring.	team has created videos and collected images with multiple populations.		populations is saved in the evidence section.
---	---	--	---

Year 1 Academic Program Review - Two Year Recommendation Action Plan

- **Student Learning Recommendation:** Assess components of the following professional core courses for the HS AAS degree in the Spring of 22:
 - **ALHS 2312** –Contemporary Issues to Healthcare
 - AY 2022-2023- Revise learning objectives to include higher levels of Bloom’s Taxonomy.
 - AY 2023-2024- Review the outcomes associated with the new textbook edition and the faculty with complete revisions by the Fall of 2024.
 - **AHC 115** – Medical Terminology
 - AY 2022-2023- Collaborate with health sciences program directors to create short videos discussing physiological systems into eLearn shells. The goal is to introduce a different way to familiarize students with medical terminology from the healthcare professional perspective.
 - AY 2023-2024- Assign topics to the directors. Collect completed videos and add them to the eLearn shells in the Fall of 2024. At least 75% of all programs will be represented.
- **Student Success Recommendation:** Improve Graduate Satisfaction Survey response rates.
 - **AY 2022-2023-** Collaborate with IERPA in soliciting completed graduate and employer surveys.
 - **AY 2023-2024-** The dean will assess survey submission rates. Contact graduates and employers to increase the obtainment of feedback.
- **Student Success Recommendation:** Improve recruitment efforts of the HS AAS degree.
 - **AY 2022-2023-** Assist in developing marketing efforts targeting under-represented demographics in Fall 2022. Promote the HS AAS options degree to persons who complete one of the technical certificates in the spring.
 - **AY2023-2024-** Purchase and display program literature and banners that reflect multiple populations by the Fall of 2024.

Evidence:

- 2024VS_11x21-TableBanner_HealthSci_FINAL

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

The first initiative was focused on revising the learning objectives for ALHS 2312 to align with higher-order thinking skills from Bloom's Taxonomy. Although a new textbook was received and an instructor was assigned to lead the revision process, progress was slower than expected due to the instructor's limited time and the course falling outside of her regular workload. As a result, the goal of having 70% of Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) written at or above the "Understand" level of Bloom's Taxonomy wasn't achieved. This initiative remains important and will continue, as the goal is to enhance critical thinking skills.

The second initiative aimed to enhance the AHC 115 course by embedding short instructional videos created by Health Sciences program directors. These videos are meant to introduce physiological systems from the perspective of healthcare professionals to help students better understand medical terminology. So far, one program has submitted a video that has been successfully integrated into the AHC 115 eLearn shell, but additional submissions were delayed due to time constraints. The original goal of 50% program participation has not been met yet. However, this initiative should continue as it will be another way to engage students with different learning styles.

The third initiative has been met. It involved collaboration with RASI to improve the process of soliciting graduate and employer survey responses. The survey plan was explained to all directors.

The fourth initiative was aimed at developing marketing strategies targeted at special populations, specifically to promote the Human Services AAS Options degree to students completing technical certificates. Although new staff were hired in the Office of Marketing and Public Relations to support this initiative, delays occurred due to earlier staffing shortages. A strategy meeting is scheduled for May 2025 to discuss the next steps. This initiative remains a priority, as it plays an important role in increasing enrollment and improving access for special populations.

In summary, while only one initiative has been fully completed, individuals are positioned to reach the goals of the remaining initiatives which have potential for successful completion with continued effort and institutional support. Each of these initiatives contributes to success. However, it's important to note that initiatives without clear ownership are unlikely to be prioritized, given the many other competing demands. Assigning responsibility to specific individuals or units will be key to ensuring successful completion moving forward.

YEAR 3					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
1	Revise the learning objectives for ALHS 2312 to incorporate higher-order thinking skills by aligning them with the upper	A new textbook was received at the start of Spring 2025. An instructor has been assigned	The instructor lacked dedicated time during the semester to complete the	At least 70% of Student Learning Outcomes should be written at or	No

	levels of Bloom's Taxonomy.	to revise the objectives and consult with the course developer at RSCC, as this is a common core course. Work on this initiative is ongoing.	revisions, and the course is not part of her regular teaching responsibilities.	above the "Understand" level of Bloom's Taxonomy.	
2	The Health Sciences directors will develop brief lecture videos into AHC 115 eLearn shells via the coordinator. These videos aim to present physiological systems from a healthcare professional's perspective to enhance student understanding of medical terminology.	A video was submitted by the respiratory care director. It has been embedded into the AHC 115 eLearn shell. The initiative remains in progress.	While supportive of the initiative, the remaining program directors have not yet allocated time to develop their videos.	50% of Health Sciences programs will contribute videos for medical terminology topics.	No
3	Collaborate with RASI to improve the solicitation of graduate and employer survey responses.	The Dean met with RASI staff to refine and implement the data collection process. This initiative is complete.	None reported.	100% of program directors will be notified of the survey solicitation process.	Yes
4	Assist in the development of marketing strategies targeting special populations, with a focus on promoting the Human Services AAS Options degree to technical certificate completers.	New staff were hired in the Office of Marketing and Public Relations to support this initiative. The Dean and Marketing/PR Director will meet in Summer 25' to finalize strategies.	The Office was previously understaffed and unable to prioritize this initiative.	70% of marketing content will include messaging tailored to special populations.	No

Academic Program Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Ophthalmic Technician AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first Annual Program Review for this program.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The mission of the Ophthalmic Technician Program at Volunteer State Community College is to prepare students to enter the workforce at an intermediate level for ophthalmic technicians. The program also instills a desire and commitment in students to become proficient not at the minimum level to graduate, but at the highest level of their ability. In addition, the program prepares students to demonstrate their service to others in a caring, knowledgeable, and skillful manner.

No revisions have been made to the program's mission statement.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Volunteer State Community College Mission Statement

Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

Graduates from the program will support the college's mission by providing skilled expertise to the ophthalmology community, including private practice settings, hospital-based practice, military eye clinics, and educational practice settings around the world. The program assists both traditional and non-traditional students to achieve a degree in a profession that will be in demand for years to come. In addition, the Ophthalmic Program provides meaningful civic participation through a variety of service learning projects.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

The program learning outcomes for the Ophthalmic Program will be assessed in OPHT 2310 Clinical Applications I and OPHT 2230 Clinical Applications III. The program designated the learning outcomes to be assessed in the first and third semester of the program to track the improvement of knowledge and skills from the beginning of the program to the end, just prior to graduation. The learning outcomes will assess both the knowledge and skill required for an ophthalmic technician to pass their certification exam and to be considered good employees by the ophthalmology practices that employ them.

The manner in which the learning outcomes will be assessed is through testing of the students in the clinical setting during the first and third semesters. The program's clinical coordinator will observe students in their clinical setting while they perform a patient exam using the knowledge and skills taught to them during the current or previous semesters. In order for a student to be successful in performing a patient exam, students will have to use proper communication skills, document test findings in the proper manner, solve problems, work within their scope of practice, and physically perform the testing with accuracy. Program faculty hope to observe that students are meeting the mentioned requirements at an average level in the first semester and at an above average level in the third semester.

Evidence:

- Ophthalmic Technology AAS Curriculum Mapping_ (6)

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

Program Learning Outcomes:

1. Graduates will utilize and apply their knowledge of ophthalmic technology to solve problems in a clinical setting.
2. Students will demonstrate the knowledge and skills needed to assume positions as entry-level technicians in a variety of eye-care settings.
3. Graduates will perform ophthalmic skills at the technician level with competency and safety as defined by national certification and accreditation standards set forth by JCAHPO and ICA.
4. Graduates of the program will be able to perform patient testing and demonstrate proper documentation in the patient record.
5. Graduates will demonstrate proficiency with the terminology and abbreviations used within the field of ophthalmic technology.
6. Graduates will demonstrate and apply their knowledge of the rules and regulations of the boards and agencies involved in the field of ophthalmic technology.

Assessment of student and program learning outcomes is currently based on data from the Certified Ophthalmic Technician (COT) exam scores and course and graduate surveys. The data from these items will be used to determine if curriculum and programmatic changes made in the fall of 2020 are beneficial and have allowed for student success. In addition, the program will use the results of its assessments in its key assessment courses OPHT2310 and OPHT2230 to determine the effectiveness of its curriculum and teaching methods.

One of the changes made in the fall of 2020 was a change to the program's curriculum, which increased the credit hours in some of the courses that students have historically struggled with the most, and in which past course and graduate survey feedback suggested that credit hours be increased. Because the 2020-2021 academic year was a large departure from the manner in which the courses are normally taught, it is difficult to assess how thoroughly successful these changes were in 2020-2021. The program will use the 2021-2022 academic year to assess Introduction to Ophthalmic Disease, Ophthalmic Optics, Retinoscopy and Refractometry, and Ocular Motility for increased course success and retention of material. Program faculty will look at the scores on the comprehensive final exams and scores on the COT exam to determine if the changes have had the desired effects.

The Certified Ophthalmic Technician (COT) exam is a 2 part test needed by graduates in order to obtain certification. Part 1 of the COT exam is a 200 question multiple choice exam covering 22 content areas. It is a requirement that students take part 1 of the exam prior to graduating from the program. Part 2 of the COT exam is a simulated skill exam. Students have up to 2 years after passing part 1, to take part 2. Both parts of the test must be passed before a graduate can earn their Certified Ophthalmic Technician credentials.

The program has had 100% passage of part 1 of the Certified Ophthalmic Technician exam for the last 2 years. The improved pass rates represent a dramatic increase over the results from 2019 when the program and national pass rates were down significantly due to a considerable change in the certification exam. The class of 2019 had a 44% passage rate on part 1 of the COT exam. The program made adjustments in various courses at that time to improve the passage rates for 2020.

Official passage rates for the Class of 2020 are attached to this report. Official passage rates will not be provided for the Class of 2021 until later in 2022, however, students must submit their results from the Pearson VUE testing center, prior to graduation. Therefore, program faculty already have proof that all students in the most recent class, passed part 1 of the COT. The VSCC Ophthalmic Program passage rates are consistently higher than the national average and demonstrate that the program is providing a high equality education to its students. Although the program has enjoyed great passage rates on its most recent examinations, program faculty believe that improvements can always be made.

The exam report submitted by each student upon completion of part 1 of the COT breaks down the scores in each of the 22 content areas. Each year the program director evaluates the results and chooses 1-2 content areas to focus on improving in the coming year. For the 2020-2021 academic year, program faculty concentrated on improving the biometry (ultrasound) COT results. To achieve the goal of improving the scores on this content area, faculty developed extra assignments, brought in guest lecturers with extensive experience in biometry, and utilized webinars on the content areas. The results of the extra effort made in this area was a 15% increase in the biometry content scores from the Class of 2020 to the Class of 2021.

For the 2021-2022 academic year, program faculty have chosen to concentrate on improving the scores on the contact lens section of the COT. Success on the contact lens section of the COT requires students to apply a great deal of the math concepts they learned in various ophthalmic classes in previous semesters. Math tends to be a significant weakness for many students. As a result of the math challenges faced by many students, the program increased the course credit hours in its math course, Ophthalmic Optics, as well as its Retinoscopy/Refractometry course, as it is heavily math based. In conjunction with the curriculum changes, faculty have developed new clinical assignments relating to contact lenses and are working to obtain more clinical experience in this area for students. The goal of the course changes, and additional content activities, is to see the contact lens scores on the COT improve by at least 15% for the Class of 2022.

Starting with the 2021-2022 academic year, the Ophthalmic Program will assess the course and program learning outcomes in its key assessment courses, OPHT 2310 Clinical Applications I and OPHT 2230 Clinical Applications III. The program chose clinical courses for key assessment courses as they require students to utilize and transfer class and lab knowledge and skills across all ophthalmic courses, in order to perform competently as an ophthalmic technician. Program faculty hope to see that all students achieve an "average" score on the first semester assessment and "above average" on the same assessment areas and skills on the 3rd semester assessment. If areas of weakness are determined by assessment data, program faculty will concentrate on strengthening activities to improve assessment outcomes. Assessment Rubrics are provided as evidence.

Evidence:

- Class of 2019 COT Passage Rates
- Class of 2020 COT Passage Rates
- Class of 2021 COT Passage Rates
- OPHT 2230 Employee Characteristic SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-15-2021 152306
- OPHT 2230 Knowledge SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-15-2021 152318
- OPHT 2230 Skill Demonstration SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-15-2021 152328
- OPHT 2310 Employee Characteristics SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-15-2021 152341
- OPHT 2310 Knowledge SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-15-2021 152347
- OPHT 2310 Skill Demonstration SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-15-2021 152353

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Graduate Survey

Graduate surveys completed for students graduating in the spring of 2020 yielded positive scores.

These surveys are the latest set of surveys available to the program. The average mean score on the 4 main sections of the survey is 4.75 out of 5.00. The score for "program quality" was 5.00 out of 5.00. The lowest section score on the survey was a 4.20 out of 5.00 on the academic advising section. The advising question includes advising for the entirety of the students time at Volunteer State, and not just the time that Ophthalmic Program faculty were assigned as advisors. The program director attempts to meet with every student interested in the Ophthalmic Program, in person to provide a tour of the lab and in-person discussion. The program director will continue to place importance on advising and will engage the division completion advisors to improve the scores on the advising section. The International Council of Accreditation does not have set thresholds for the various sections on required surveys.

The Ophthalmic Program revised its curriculum with an effective start date of fall of 2020. Feedback received from students on previous graduate surveys reflected the students' desire to be taught more

information about diseases. Program faculty also noted that the program needed to increase and reinforce topics on ocular and systemic disease, therefore this need was addressed by changing the curriculum. The Introduction to Ophthalmic Disease, Basic Ophthalmic Pharmacology, and Ocular Motility courses were increased by 1 credit hour each. Each of these courses covers topics on ophthalmic and systemic diseases. The goal of the changes was to bolster the education of students in the area of disease. Program faculty will assess the overall score on the Certified Ophthalmic Technician (COT) exam and the comprehensive final exam scores in each course for the effectiveness of the changes.

Employer Survey

Employer surveys were conducted on the Class of 2020, however, only 3 surveys were returned. It is difficult to make significant assessments with such a small return. One survey can have a significant impact on the results with a small return. Faculty will work with personnel in the Institutional Effectiveness, Research, Planning, and Assessment (IERPA) office to improve the return results.

Faculty sent placement information to IERPA for the Class of 2021 and will stress the importance of survey returns with employers. During the most recent program advisory committee meeting, program faculty discussed the importance of returning the employer survey during its annual advisory committee meeting.

The results of the employer survey yielded a mean average of 4.18 out of 5.00 on the 4 sections surveyed. The feedback received from one employer revealed that the employer would like students to have more knowledge of the retina. As a general practice, the program ensures that all students rotate through a retina specialty clinic during their year in the program. Program faculty believe that increasing the credit hours in the courses in which disease topics are taught, will enhance students' knowledge with regards to the retina. To enhance learning, new clinical activities were developed for specialty areas such as the retina. Providing additional clinic activities will require students to utilize their time effectively and enhance their knowledge when in specialty clinics.

Student Resource Survey

The Student Resource Survey was sent to 13 students. Eight students returned the survey for a return rate of 62%. Students rated the program a 4.88/5.00 for the overall quality of the resources supporting the program. Resources include faculty, class, lab, library, equipment, and clinical resources.

The lowest scores on the survey were in the areas of clinical instruction and physician interaction. The pandemic had significant impacts on the healthcare community. Ophthalmology offices were closed for an extended period of time in the spring to summer months of 2020. As a result, when clinics reopened, it resulted in a significant increase in the workloads of doctors and technicians. The increased workload lasted through the fall semester, when more clinic shutdowns were feared.

Program faculty work hard to ensure students have the best clinical experience by routinely meeting with students to discuss positive and negative aspects of their ongoing clinical experience, and to solve any identified problems. During the 2020-2021 academic year, faculty utilized a new clinic assignment tool to ensure that students were receiving the practice and supervision that is required for success. If a regular and routine review of the clinic assignment demonstrated that students were not performing the number and type of skills required for competency, the program clinical coordinator was armed with specific data that could be used in discussions with clinical instructors and students.

Program Resource Survey

Program resource surveys were completed by advisory board members, VSCC faculty, and the program's various clinical instructors. The overall score across all areas surveyed was 4.67 out of 5.00. The program scored 4.86 out of 5.00 on the classroom, lab, and resources available to students. The clinical resources available to students scored a 4.64 out of 5.00.

The feedback expressed in the survey included:

- Increase the number of clinical rotation sites
 - The program has 12-15 clinical sites available to it each semester. Multiple sites have multiple locations and or take multiple students, therefore, the program has more than

enough sites to meet its maximum student capacity. The program will continue to monitor its need for additional clinic sites.

- Physician Interaction
 - To increase student interaction with physicians, the program arranges guest lectures from ophthalmologists in the community. In addition, program faculty consistently stress the importance of physician interaction during its annual advisory committee meeting. Students are also routinely encouraged to seek instruction and knowledge from physicians while in clinic. When able, students are encouraged to follow the physician's scribe (and scribe themselves after they learn this skill) to allow them to be part of the exam process for which the physician is involved.

Evidence:

- 2018 Graduate surveys
- 2019 Graduate surveys
- 2020 Employer Survey
- 2020 Graduate surveys
- Program Personnel Resource Surveys
- Student Resource Survey

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

Enrollment and retention have been a challenge for the program for several years. Beginning with the 2016 cohort, which became the class of 2017, college administration required the program to change its start date from fall to a summer. This change was made with the thought that TN Promise would not cover the program if it didn't start its cohort in the summer. Program faculty voiced serious concern about this change, to no avail. As predicted and voiced, the change was detrimental to the program in a few ways.

By changing the start date, students had only 2 semesters in which to complete their prerequisite classes. Not only was the program required to move up its start date, shortening the length of time that

students had to complete prerequisite courses, it was also told to add prerequisite courses to make it full-time for 5 semesters. Over the years, many students used the summer before the fall cohort began, to complete 1 or 2 remaining prerequisites. This was no longer an option with the program starting in the summer. Many students were prevented from applying to the program because required prerequisite courses like Anatomy and Physiology I, were full before students could register in the fall. With only the fall and spring semesters available to take BIOL 2010 and 2020 before application for a summer start, something as simple as not being able to register for BIOL 2010 in the fall can put a student a year behind. The program lost several applicants every year because they did not have 1 or 2 of their prerequisites completed. Students were then forced to wait an entire year before applying to the program. Based on experience, if a student is not accepted into a program, and therefore must wait a year to reapply, the likelihood of them reapplying decreases significantly.

Once the program start date was changed to the summer, it could no longer be used as a back-up option for the students who did not get accepted into the 2 largest health science programs on campus, Physical Therapist Assistant (PTA) and Radiologic Technology (RADT). The PTA program starts in the summer and the RADT program starts in the fall, therefore these students were no longer able to apply to the OPH Program as a second option, when not accepted into these programs. Before the semester start change, the program accepted several students each year who chose the Ophthalmic Program as a back-up option if not admitted into PTA or RADT. The VSCC Factbook only provides information dating back to 2016, therefore a table titled "Ophthalmic Headcount" was formulated to demonstrate the impact that the semester change had on program enrollment and retention. The table can be viewed by looking at the document attached to this section.

Retention became an issue when the start date changed from fall to summer for a couple of reasons. First, the program was forced to accept students with lower GPAs to ensure the program enrolled enough students. Students who are not academically strong generally struggle with health science programs. Program faculty were able to achieve success with some academically weaker students, but others were not able to maintain the grades and rigors of the program, even with extra intervention.

The second reason for retention struggles after the semester start change is because at the same time the program start date changed, the program's accrediting body made changes. The accreditation change required the program to increase its clinical hour requirements from 760 hours to 960 hours.

This significant addition of clinical hours, along with a shorter summer semester, meant that students would have to be in class and clinic almost all day, 5 days per week, for the entire summer. During the years in which the program changes were in affect, students who struggled academically or financially quit during or after the first semester at higher rates. A student is much more likely to quit in or after their first semester than their second or third, as they are far more invested the longer they remain in a program. Student retention would have been far better if this difficult summer semester was the third and final semester of the program, versus the first semester. If the program had remained a fall start with the increased clinical hours, the schedule would have still been full and demanding but students would have had some days off and periodic breaks (Labor Day, Fall Break, Thanksgiving) to help.

As of the Class of 2020, the program has gone back to a fall start and has been able to decrease its clinical hour requirements to 750, due to new accreditation changes. These changes resulted in a class size similar to that prior to the semester start change.

Program marketing is extremely important for the Ophthalmic Program. The Ophthalmic Program has a couple of unique challenges not faced by other health science programs. One challenge of the program is that it is the only Ophthalmic Program in the state. Students often search various college and university websites looking for degrees and professions. Students are more familiar with programs that show up on multiple websites and unfamiliar with programs that are less common or easy to find. Another unique challenge that the program has that other programs do not, is the lack of understanding of the profession. Many people have never had an eye exam and are therefore not familiar with eye conditions. Students who have had an eye exam are familiar with optometry, not ophthalmology. While these 2 professions both care for the eyes, the technicians that work in each, have very different roles and responsibilities and this concept is not understood.

Ophthalmic technicians must learn photography, ultrasound, and surgical assisting, amongst many other skills. Optometry technicians will not perform any of these skills. Most people don't understand that there is a difference. To combat these challenges, program faculty spend a great deal of time with marketing and education. For many years, program faculty have hosted medical terminology students in the ophthalmic lab to teach them about eye terminology with hands-on activities. Many ophthalmic students have come to the program as a result of attending one of these sessions and getting to see and work with the equipment. In addition, program faculty visit anatomy and physiology classes to educate students on the program and profession.

In addition to marketing to VSCC students, program faculty also market the program to high school students in various ways. Faculty participate annually in between 5-10 high school visits per year.

High school visits give faculty an opportunity to discuss the profession of ophthalmic technology while providing hands-on ophthalmic learning activities, led by ophthalmic students. The visits not only benefit the program as a marketing tool, but also benefit the students in allowing them to demonstrate their knowledge and grow their communication skills as they educate the high school students. In addition to the regular high school visits, program faculty have provided ophthalmic workshops at the HOSA (Health Occupations Student Association) competition held on campus each spring. Program faculty have also visited several local high schools to teach the ophthalmic content contained within their health science classes. These various activities help program faculty create awareness of this unique program and profession.

The program creates the majority of its awareness through both the campus and high school events discussed. As a result of program faculty not being able to participate in these events during 2020-2021, applications to the program were down this year. Program faculty have restarted their pre-COVID marketing strategies to increase applications for the 2022-2023 school year.

Evidence:

- Program Statistics-grad, retention

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

The Ophthalmic Program incorporates several high impact practices (HIP) and co-curricular activities into its curriculum. The biggest HIP embedded in the Ophthalmic Program is its partnership with the Hendersonville Rotary Club and the shared medical mission in Guatemala. Ophthalmic students and the ophthalmic program director have partnered with the Hendersonville Rotary Club for approximately 13 years. The project requires that the entire cohort of students obtain donated glasses, measure the prescriptions, and organize the prescriptions so they may be used in the eye clinic in Guatemala. Once the glasses have been prepared, they are taken to Guatemala where 5-6 of the program students will spend 4 days working in an eye clinic. Students and faculty service between 500-700 patients in the 4 day clinic. Not only do the students get to use the skills they are acquiring during their time in the program, they gain knowledge of Rotary as an international charitable organization, gain an understanding of the challenges in a third world country, and strengthen their critical thinking skills.

In the past, program faculty analyzed the scores on the COT exam for those students participating in the entire Guatemala project versus those that helped ready the glasses but did not travel to Guatemala.

Faculty found that scores in key areas of the COT were consistently higher for those students working in the Guatemala clinic due to the great deal of clinical practice and the requirement of critical thinking skills as they applied to the clinical tasks. In addition to the ophthalmic benefits gained from this project, students have gained cultural and global awareness, that has led several graduates to participate in medical mission projects after leaving the program.

Another HIP incorporated into the Ophthalmic Program is the integration of program students with the variety of students visiting the VSCC campus. Many high school students, as well as some VSCC science students, visit the ophthalmic lab to learn about the eye. The program includes its students in this process to provide an opportunity for students to practice and reinforce their clinical and communication skills as they teach the visiting students about the eye equipment and various ocular conditions. These opportunities also serve as great marketing tools, as visiting students feel comfortable asking program students many questions.

In addition to the program's HIP opportunities, students do work-based learning. Students must obtain a minimum of 750 hours in various ophthalmology specialty clinics, prior to graduation. Work based learning is an invaluable piece of the student's education and allows them to reinforce the concepts and skills taught in class and lab.

The program uses guest lecturers in courses within the program. Program faculty are responsible for teaching students how to use approximately 60 pieces of equipment and perform approximately 80-100 different tests spanning all ophthalmology specialties. As a result of the vast equipment used in the profession, and the continual change and development of new equipment, program faculty utilize guest lecturers to provide the high level of didactic education needed for skill development on certain pieces of equipment. Many of the specialty equipment guest lecturers are graduates of the program.

Program faculty believe that using program graduates to teach material, encourages current students and demonstrates that there are rewards for hard work while in the program and after graduation. In addition to the utilization of program graduates as specialty guest lecturers, the program is fortunate to have several ophthalmologists, covering various specialties, provide free guest lectures for students.

It is the belief of program faculty that the various activities listed in this document create well-rounded, highly educated, and skillful technicians.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-

graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

There is a great need for trained ophthalmic technicians in Tennessee and across the U.S.. A discussion takes place at every Ophthalmic Advisory Committee meeting regarding the need for trained technicians. Many of the program's clinic sites hire multiple graduates each year. Frequently, students are offered jobs during their first semester clinical rotation, as clinics try to ensure that they can hire knowledgeable and skilled technicians. Vanderbilt Eye Institute started its own training program this year due to the lack of trained technicians. Program faculty get requests consistently from all over the country, from clinics wanting to hire graduates.

Tennessee, especially Middle Tennessee, employs one of the higher numbers of ophthalmic technicians in the country. See attached document. The job forecast for ophthalmic technicians is projected to grow by 14% between 2020-2030 per [CareerOneStop.org](https://www.careeronestop.org). With the U.S. population ageing, the number of people suffering from eye disease will continue to grow. In addition, around 700,000 people in the U.S. undergo elective corrective eye surgeries like LASIK, each year. The large numbers of people with significant eye disease means that ophthalmologists see anywhere from 30-60 patients per day. The only way to efficiently care for such a large number of patients is to have competent and skilled ophthalmic technicians as part of the eye team.

Evidence:

- Labor Market Information

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The area that the program will concentrate on most heavily in the next few years is enrollment and retention. The program will work to return to its normal enrollment with the marketing efforts discussed in the annual program review. In addition, the program will track its retention as a result of the curriculum changes that moved the start date back to the fall and lowered the clinical hour requirements by 200 hours. In addition, course outcomes will be monitored for those courses that increased their credit hours. This year program faculty will specifically evaluate Introduction to Ophthalmic Disease, Ocular Motility, Retinoscopy and Refractometry, and Ophthalmic Optics courses for improved knowledge and retention. The effectiveness of the changes to these courses will be monitored using comprehensive final exam scores, assessing the distribution of course grades, and evaluating the success of students on the COT exam.

Program faculty will continue to use the most recent results of the COT exam to strengthen areas within the curriculum, until the program undergoes the assessment of its course and program learning

outcomes in the Summer of 2022. The program will create additional lab, class, and clinical activities in content areas on the COT exam, which demonstrated lower scores. In addition, the program will utilize the results of the program and student learning outcomes assessment finalized in August 2022, to further improve student learning outcomes.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Student Learning Action Plan

1. Program faculty will assess the effectiveness of changes to its curriculum. Program faculty will evaluate 2 factors in 4 of the courses that underwent curriculum changes in the Fall of 2020. The 4 courses that will be evaluated for better student learning outcomes are, Introduction to Ophthalmic Disease, Ocular Motility, Retinoscopy and Refractometry, and Ophthalmic Optics. The 2 factors that will be assessed in the individual courses to determine student success are:

- Grades on comprehensive final exams: Each course requires students to take a comprehensive final exam covering all topics taught during the semester. By evaluating this exam, program faculty will determine if the increase in class and instructor time created improvement in learning and retention of knowledge. The evaluation will take place during the 2021-2022 academic year at the end of the course.
- Passage rates on the COT as a whole and individual content areas: Faculty will evaluate the passage rate on the COT exam to determine if the curriculum changes are maintaining high passage rates. In addition, faculty will evaluate the various content area scores for success on content related to the listed courses. The effectiveness of the curriculum changes in the 4 courses listed above on the COT exam will take place at the end of August 2022 after the students have completed and reported the scores for part 1 of the COT exam.

In addition to assessing the above mentioned individual courses for their outcomes, the program will assess the overall effectiveness of the curriculum changes by assessing course and program learning outcomes in its key assessment courses. If students are benefiting from the curriculum changes across all courses that were changed, the course and program learning outcomes assessed clinically should reflect expected scores.

- Course learning outcomes 1 and 2 will be assessed clinically to determine if students are meeting the outcome goals of transferring their knowledge and skills from the classroom and lab to the clinical setting. Faculty will look to see that students score as "average" during the first semester and "above average" in their third semester.
- Program outcomes 1, 4, and 5 will be assessed in OPHT 2230 to determine if the curriculum changes have been effective. Faculty will be looking to determine if students scored "above average" on the above mentioned program outcomes in OPHT 2230.

2. Program faculty will assess the contact lens section of the COT exam for improvement in contact lens scores. Program faculty have developed new clinical activities to aid students in using their contact lens knowledge and to push them to use their clinical time wisely to improve their knowledge and skills in this area. The 2022 scores on the content lens section of the COT exam will be assessed for improved scores over previous years.

Student Success Action Plan

The Ophthalmic Program will concentrate over the next 2 years on increasing enrollment and retention. . In order for the program to be successful in the area of retention, it must attract many students so it can enroll a cohort of students who are academically strong enough to handle the challenges of a full didactic course load, 750 clinical hours, and balance life and financial challenges.

The program will return to its normal marketing events to increase enrollment of academically ready and capable students and improve retention of those enrolled students. Program faculty will interact with high school visitors, meet with health science teachers from the various high schools in Sumner County, participate in Health Science Discovery Days, and will visit various medical terminology and anatomy and physiology classes on the VSCC campus. The program will determine the success of this action plan with application and enrollment numbers for the next cohort of students, starting the program in fall of 2022. Based on its marketing efforts, the program will continue with its strategies for the 2022-2023 school year, while exploring alternative marketing strategies if needed.

The program will also work with IERPA to improve its Employer Survey return results.

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

A comprehensive review of the Ophthalmic APR has been conducted. Dr. Cornish has a thorough understanding of the strengths and weaknesses of the program. She has a solid plan for continuous improvement and assessment of outcomes. The College will collaborate with program faculty with efforts to increase exposure and enrollment of the program.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment has reviewed this report and will begin supporting the report champion in preparing for the presentation of this review to the Institutional Effectiveness Committee.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports**YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the

results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Program faculty will assess the effectiveness of changes to its curriculum. PLO 2	VIA Assessments were developed and placed into eLearn for future assessment of curriculum and program initiatives.	The heavy and intensive didactic, lab, and clinical schedule is a challenge for many students who must also work and or take care of a family. These challenges play a significant role in students' success despite curriculum changes. VIA Assessments were not in place for the 2021-2022 academic year.	Consideration being given to model course development for online and hybrid delivery to help students with time management. Use Employer Satisfaction Survey results for assessing PLOs against curriculum changes.	• 3 of the 4 courses showed an increase in the comprehensive final exam scores over the previous 2 cohorts using the old curriculum. OPHT 2327 demonstrated a significant increase in scores. One of the 4 courses showed test scores slightly lower than the previous 2 cohorts on the old curriculum. • 6 out of 7 students passed the multiple-choice certification exam on the first attempt. One student passed on the second attempt. • Employer Surveys for the Class of 2022 reported a mean score of 4.84/5.00 on the knowledge base section of the survey demonstrating high scores for PLO #1.

					Employer Surveys for the Class of 2022 reported a mean score of 4.92/5.00 on the clinical proficiency section of the survey demonstrating high scores for PLO #4.
2	Program faculty will assess the contact lens section of the certification exam for improvement in contact lens scores. PLO 1	Contact lens activity developed to ensure students engaged with pertinent concepts while in clinic.	The area of contact lens knowledge and skill is one of the areas in which students have the least exposure clinically. The majority of the program clinic affiliates do not work with contact lenses. It is a constant challenge to ensure students get contact lens exposure.	Continue to develop contact lens activities to utilize in clinic and to offer contact lens opportunities to students to help reinforce didactic knowledge.	The mean score on the contact lens section of the exam showed a mean score of 5.6 out of 6.00 as compared to a national mean score of 3.78 for the contact lens section. Mean score averages on this section from 2017-2020 were 5.0.
3	The program will increase enrollment and retention.	Faculty began participating in select pre-pandemic marketing events.	The heavy and intensive didactic, lab, and clinical schedule is a challenge for many students who must also work and or take care of a family. These challenges play a significant role in retention rates. GPA and BIOL 2020 are	Decrease the GPA for application to the program. Remove BIOL 2020 as a required program and replace with COMM 2045 or 2025. Discuss changes with the Ophthalmic Advisory Committee to discuss changes to the	AY 22-23: The program enrolled 10 students and graduated 10. The program therefore had 100% retention. Enrollment needs to increase.

		barriers for some students pursuing the program.	program that may alleviate some of the barriers to student enrollment and success.	
--	--	--	--	--

Evidence:

- VSCC_HealthSciences_DiscoveryDays SP22

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
1	Program faculty will assess the effectiveness of changes to its curriculum PLO 2	The program made curriculum changes in the form of updating the credit hours for 4 courses where the required course content was heavier than the course credit hours supported.	The 2023–2024 cohort, in particular, demonstrated notable gaps in academic readiness and preparation. One of the courses being assessed allows for a student exemption from the final exam if they have an "A" average on all tests leading to the final exam. The number of exemptions can skew the results.	The 2023-2024 cohort scored lower in 3 of 4 courses and higher in 1 course. This cohort scored lower than pre-curriculum change students across almost every course in the program. The 2023-2024 cohort achieved 100% passage on the the multiple choice portion of the Certified Ophthalmic Technician exam. The VSCC Ophthalmic Program graduates achieve higher mean scores in each of the 22 content areas than the means scores achieved by students from all other Ophthalmic Programs in the US and Canada, which also demonstrates the success of the VSCC	Yes

				curriculum. Employer Surveys for the Class of 2023 reported a mean score of 4.56/5.00 on the knowledge base section of the survey demonstrating success with curriculum changes and PLO #1. Employer Surveys for the Class of 2023 reported a mean score of 4.63/5.00 on the clinical proficiency section of the survey which demonstrates success with curriculum changes as well as PLO #4.	
2	Program faculty will assess the contact lens section of the certification exam for improvement in contact lens scores. PLO 1	Program faculty ensured every student had clinical experience with contact lens concepts and students continued to complete clinical activities designed to ensure student engagement with the contact lens concepts they learned.	The topic of contact lens remains an area of ophthalmology where students experience limited clinical engagement. Program faculty are constantly striving to create more educational opportunities for students in this area.	The Certified Ophthalmic Technician Exam Performance Report for 2021-2022, 2022-2023, and 2023-2024 have shown higher mean scores for VSCC students in the area of contact lens as compared to students from all other ophthalmic training programs.	Yes
3	The program will increase enrollment and retention.	The program retained 100% of its students throughout the 3 semesters of the program.	Lack of marketing. The Ophthalmic Program is the only program of its kind in TN, which leads to under exposure if not marketed. In addition, the	2021-2022: Retention: 78%, Enrollment: 9 students 2022-2023: Retention: 100%, Enrollment 10 students 2023-2024: Retention: The program lost 1 student due to insufficient academic	Yes-retention No-enrollment

		program struggles with understanding of the profession. Full time nature of the program and student financial or personal challenges.	performance. Enrollment: 7 students. The number of Introduction to Ophthalmic Technology students has tripled over the last year, which is expected to lead to an enrollment increase.	
4				

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis

	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1	Program faculty will assess the effectiveness of changes to its curriculum	This initiative has allowed students to increase their skill level and competency in OPHT 2326/2326L and 2327/2327L. This initiative has created better alignment between required content and credit hours for OPHT 2221 and 2223.	None	This initiative will support faculty in making needed curriculum changes in the future and will provide a framework for an assessment tool to determine the effects of changes.

2	Program faculty will assess the contact lens section of the certification exam for improvement in contact lens scores.	This initiative has ensured that students apply didactic contact lens knowledge in the clinical setting. Data on the Certified Ophthalmic Technician for the past 3 years shows students scoring higher on this section of the exam as compared to students from all other ophthalmic programs in the US and Canada.	No other formal action will be implemented on this initiative.	This initiative will continue to an indicator of program success. Program faculty will continue to assess the outcomes in this content area to strengthen its initiatives and to increase student success.
3	The program will increase enrollment and retention.	This initiative allowed the program director to explore and implement actions within the program that would increase enrollment and retention. Changes were made to the program prerequisite requirements and entering GPA. In addition, several model courses were developed to allow course delivery methods that can aid non-traditional students, students with demanding work schedules, and students with families that need flexibility in their schedules.	Yes. The program will continue to explore opportunities to increase enrollment.	This initiative will aid the program in its course delivery and course scheduling and other enrollment and retention initiatives.
4				

Evidence:

- OPH Performance Report 2022-2023

Academic Program Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Sleep Diagnostics Technology CERT

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first Academic Program Review.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The program is designed to prepare the student for employment in a Sleep Disorder Center and to qualify students to sit for the international RPSGT credentialing examination. Link between Institutional Mission and Departmental Mission: 1. Satisfying the community workforce demand for qualified polysomnographic technologists. 2. Providing a pathway for students to enter into a stable, successful, and rewarding career. 3. This certificate program can be supplemented with a general education core to complete an A.A.S. degree and prepare students for the university level.

No mission statement revisions have been made.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

Link between Institutional Mission and Departmental Mission: 1. Satisfying the community workforce demand for qualified polysomnographic technologists. 2. Providing a pathway for students to enter into a stable, successful, and rewarding career. 3. This certificate program can be supplemented with a general education core to complete an A.A.S. degree and prepare students for the university level.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

DESCRIPTION OF THE PROFESSION

Polysomnographic technologists use sleep technology as part of a team, under the general supervision of a licensed physician, by applying a unique body of knowledge and methodological skills involving the education, evaluation, treatment, and follow-up of sleep disorders in patients of all ages. The polysomnographic technologist performs polysomnography and tests such as the Multiple Sleep Latency Test, Maintenance of Wakefulness Test, Actigraphy, and others used by a physician to diagnose and treat sleep disorders. These tests involve recording, monitoring, and analyzing EEG (electroencephalography), EOG (electrooculography), EMG (electromyography), ECG (electrocardiography), and multiple breathing variables including capnometry and oximetry during sleep and wakefulness. Testing procedures may involve application and adjustment of therapeutic modalities such as supplemental oxygen or positive airway pressure and include application of techniques, equipment, and procedures that are safe, aseptic, preventive, and restorative. Interpretive knowledge is required to recognize and respond to respiratory, cardiac or behavioral events that may occur during testing procedures. Technologists provide supportive services related to the ongoing treatment of sleep-related problems. The professional realm of this support includes patient instruction on the use of devices for the treatment of breathing problems during sleep and helping individuals develop sleeping habits that promote good sleep hygiene. (This description was copied directly from the CoaPSG's Standards and Guidelines for the Accreditation of Educational Programs in Polysomnographic Technology)

PROGRAM OUTCOMES

Program Outcome #1: Students will become competent polysomnographic technologists with training in the fundamentals of polysomnographic technology, laboratory fundamentals, and clinical skills as outlined in, but not limited to, the Association of Polysomnographic Technologists Curriculum Outline.

This outcome encompasses a large amount of both didactic knowledge and practical skills necessary to function on a professional level in a sleep laboratory as a polysomnographic technician. It is meant to include basic laboratory skills in regard to patient hook-up, equipment functionality and calibration, and the American Academy of Sleep Medicine (AASM) recommended protocol for initiating and running a polysomnogram, multiple sleep latency test, maintenance of wakefulness test, or home sleep apnea testing procedure. Students will receive instruction and guidance on patient interactions, quality control, and infection control. Students' basic laboratory knowledge and skills will be assessed after receiving instruction and guidance from their clinical instructor during the PSG 120C course in the campus sleep laboratory. East TN students will receive this instruction in a clinical affiliate sleep center in that region.

PSG 120C is a hands-on lab course that is designed to expose students to the equipment they will be utilizing on the job as a polysomnographic technologist. Students learn the international 10-20 system of head measurement, proper placement of all sensors to a patient the various devices and equipment used in a sleep lab, the functionality of each, basic equipment calibrations, and safety protocols. Students will also be assessed on their readiness for employment which will include professional dress, punctuality, and the completion of all required clinical documentation for the fall clinical rotations. There are certain skills that are considered essential to the field and some are life skills needed to secure and maintain employment. This course will assess those skills utilizing the attached rubric.

Program Outcome #2: Clinical Competencies

Students will have achieved both academic and clinical competency in cognitive, psychomotor, and affective learning domains using the following organizations as sources of standards: Association of Polysomnographic Technologists, Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists, and the American Academy of Sleep Medicine.

The accrediting body that oversees the structure, format, and success of the Sleep Diagnostics Technology Program at VSCC is the Committee on Accreditation for Polysomnographic Technologist Education (CoaPSG), a division of The Commission on Accreditation of Allied Health Education

Programs (CAAHEP). They set technical standards for any polysomnography education in the four above-mentioned categories, which can be viewed at the following address:

<https://www.caahep.org/CAAHEP/media/CAAHEP-Documents/StandardsandGuidelinesPSGMay2011rev71921.pdf>

. Since this is a healthcare program, and patient safety is a concern, there are also minimum student physical capabilities needed to function in a sleep lab. In addition to the practical knowledge to operate laboratory equipment, students would need the physical dexterity required to perform CPR, turn a patient on their side in the case of a seizure, visualize waveforms on screen, and hear a patient's distress call. A physical exam is part of the required clinical documentation, and students are required to be CPR certified in order to attend clinical rotations and qualify to sit for the registry exam after graduation.

Though VSCC does not require the following for entry into the program, many of our clinical affiliate sites will also require that students be vaccinated for certain illnesses and be able to pass a background check and drug screen. The TN polysomnography licensure law also requires the passage of a background check before students can obtain a state license to practice polysomnography.

The attached PSG 120C grading rubric will be utilized to assess this outcome.

Program Outcome #3: Entry Level Skills

Students' accomplishments of their academic and clinical objectives will prepare them with entry-level skills as polysomnographic technicians.

Some polysomnographic skillsets require experience to master well. However, employers have been increasing expectations of graduates in recent years. Part of this has occurred as a result of the passage of the TN Polysomnography Act which took final effect in the year 2010. It created our state licensure requirement. That state licensure mandated that all polysomnography techs working in TN labs be registered by the Board of Polysomnographic Technologists and be graduates of a CAAHEP accredited polysomnography educational program. Prior to that time, they were free to hire trainees and teach them on the job. This increase in standards has also increased the expectations of employers. Therefore, more attention has been given to tasks that were not previously expected of new graduates.

In addition to the skills mentioned in the first two outcomes, students are also expected to be able to satisfactorily analyze, or score patient data and compile that data into a report that the physician will use in diagnosing the patient. The scoring of patient data is an advanced task that incorporates a large portion of the knowledge students have gained throughout the program to carry out accurately.

Therefore, that task will be assessed individually using online scoring comparison exams from the American Academy of Sleep Medicine. It is referred to as inter-scorer reliability testing. The exams are purchased and utilized as a means of assessing how students are progressing. This online service sends individualized reports of student success/failure. Students will be compared with the AASM gold-standard scorer and must be within 85% accuracy to receive a passing score. It is worth mentioning that the AASM Gold-standard scorer has been criticized for his inaccuracy, but the AASM has hired four new gold-standard scorers to serve as scoring experts for comparison. It is also worth noting that these exams vary greatly in difficulty, depending on the patient data that is selected for each month. This service is provided online and the AASM forwards the report to VSCC. This service also complements the online format of the program well. Data scoring is also a task that graduates will be required to do as an ongoing quality assurance measure on the job. All scorers are required to pass an inter-scorer reliability exam periodically in order to continue scoring actual patient data.

In addition, students will be assessed on their data analysis skills by utilizing a critical thinking assignment in the PSG 132 Course. Students will be asked to analyze some patient data and narrate their reasoning as to how they arrived at the conclusions they did. The grading rubric for this activity is also attached. Students are graded on their completeness and how well they can support their conclusions with evidence. Feedback is given in the online grading environment, but we also go over this assignment together in our final class meeting.

Program Outcome #4: Board Preparation

Successful completion of the program will help prepare the graduate to take the Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists Registry Exam.

One of the primary goals of the program is to help students prepare students to pass their board exams after graduation. All program courses as well as their CPR certification are part of that preparation. Registry exam passage rates are also an accreditation standard and are included on the program's

annual accreditation report, which would also require an action plan if the passage rate ever fell too low.

Evidence:

- PSG 132 Data Interpretation Exercise Rubric Detail
- PSG120 Lab Rubric Rubric Detail 11-08-2021 125042 (1)

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

Summary and Analysis of Outcomes Assessments

- **Program Outcome #1: Students will become competent polysomnographic technologists with training in the fundamentals of polysomnographic technology, laboratory fundamentals, and clinical skills as outlined in, but not limited to, the Association of Polysomnographic Technologists Curriculum Outline.**
- **Program Outcome #2: Students will have achieved both academic and clinical competency in cognitive, psychomotor, and affective learning domains using the following organizations as sources of standards: Association of Polysomnographic Technologists, Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists, and the American Academy of Sleep Medicine.**
- **Program Outcome #3: Students' accomplishments of their academic and clinical objectives will prepare them with entry-level skills as polysomnographic technicians.**

Program Outcomes #1, #2, and #3 were measured with the course outcomes below. Measures were chosen because they are the best representations of the skills needed for success in the field after graduation. Therefore, successful results on these are representative of successful fulfillment of program outcomes 1-3.

1. Demonstrate critical thinking skills in the analysis of recorded sleep data. This goal is assessed via utilizing the data interpretation exercises section in the Registry Review Course-PSG132.

This goal has been consistently met. However, due to its importance and informative value, this is one that we will continue to monitor.

It is expected that a minimum of 80% of students in this course will average greater than 12 points on the rubric. The goal was achieved again by the 2021 cohort. The median score was 100% with a standard deviation of 6.98%. Since our goal was met. These results show a continued increase in consistency among students on the outcome. We will shoot for a goal of 80% or more of the class earning a minimum of 14/20 on the rubric which computes to a percentage score of 70% or better. No additional funds are needed.

2018: Average Score = 93.3% ; Median = 95%; Standard deviation = 7.59%

2019 Average Score = 87.45%; Median = 92.5%; Standard Deviation = 13.31

2020 Average Score = 88.28%; Median of 90%; Standard Deviation = 8.1%.

2021 Average Score = 96.53%; Median = 100%; Standard Deviation = 6.98%

2. Familiarity with Polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment. Students need to understand how each piece of equipment works as well as why and when to use it. Assessed during PSG 120C.

Familiarity with Polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment. Students need to understand how each piece of equipment works as well as why and when to use it. This will be assessed via student demonstration of understanding in the laboratory during PSG 120C. This outcome has historically been assessed via utilizing the clinical check-off sheets. Students are required to demonstrate proficiency in the VSCC campus laboratory before continuing on to clinical affiliate sites. 100% success was again achieved for the 2019 -2021 cohorts. We are committed to working with each student at their pace until they each achieve this goal. Any student not achieving a satisfactory result on an initial attempt will be retested after further instruction. Continue to accept nothing less than a satisfactory demonstration by 100% of the students in the cohort. No additional funds are needed. This goal has been consistently met, it will continue to be monitored. However, a new rubric will be utilized for the assessment of this outcome beginning with the 2022 cohort. That rubric is attached.

3. Students will demonstrate their knowledge of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine (AASM) scoring rules and ability to distinguish among sleep stages and recognize micro-arousals in EEG patterns, different types of scorable respiratory events, Limb movements and PLMs. PSG 131

This outcome is assessed during the PSG 131 Sleep Scoring course each fall semester. Students will be compared with the AASM gold-standard scorer and must be within 85% accuracy to receive a passing score. Experienced scorers are expected to achieve an 85% match or better when compared to the AASM Gold-standard scorer in order to continue at this task. If our students can achieve this before entering the workforce, it should be considered a great accomplishment. For that reason, we will consider 50% or more of the class scoring over 85% as a successful result. This service is funded via TAF revenue. No additional funds are needed at this time.

2018 - 100% passage - Goal well exceeded

2019 - 24/31 = 77.4% passage - Goal achieved

2020 - 92.3% passage of the exam - goal achieved

Although this goal has been consistently met, it is a job function that will continue to be monitored as an ongoing assessment.

These results are extraordinarily good considering that the national average on the exam among professionals is only an 82.6% agreement on sleep stages alone. That is below the 85% cut-off score needed to pass the test. This means that our students must score better than an average experienced professional to pass the exam. I could not find a value for what percentage score above 85% nationally for comparison. However, a research analysis conducted by Rosenberg & Van Hout (2013) on scoring consistency presented in the Journal of Clinical Sleep Medicine suggested a lower threshold. The conclusion was stated as follows:

"Returning to the issue that prompted the development of the AASM ISR program, center managers may wish to set a relatively low-cut point (such as 75%) that reflects basic stage scoring competence. A consistent score above this threshold could be used as a criterion for entrance to the pool of scorers. It is not recommended that a high threshold, such as 95%, be used as a criterion for promotion or bonuses. Such a criterion would be in excess of the agreement between expert scorers and is likely to occur only as a result of chance." (para. 24)

- **Program Outcome #4: Successful completion of the program will help prepare the graduate to take the Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists Registry Exam.**

Program outcome #4 is that the technical certificate will help to prepare students to take the RPSGT exam after graduation. Every course is designed with registry exam in mind. The RPSGT exam has a history of being notoriously difficult in comparison to other allied health fields. The average nationwide passage rate in 2010 was 62% which was a significant improvement over previous years. Therefore the threshold was set at a 65% passage rate. However, The VSCC program has always been above the threshold of results suggested by the CoAPSG. That being said, there is still some room for

improvement. The RPSGT Passage rates for VSCC graduates over the past three years are 78%, 82% and 55% respectively so far. Only about half of the 2020 class has taken the exam at this time. The 2020 year was affected by a pandemic-related temporary closing of RPSGT testing sites and some sleep centers. This number will continue to evolve for a while yet.

Reference

Rosenberg, R. S., & Van Hout, S. (2013). The American Academy of Sleep Medicine inter-scorer reliability program: sleep stage scoring. *Journal of clinical sleep medicine: JCSM: official publication of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine*, 9(1), 81–87. <https://doi.org/10.5664/jcsm.2350>

Evidence:

- PSG120 Lab Rubric Rubric Detail 11-08-2021 125042

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Historical Perspective

The Sleep Diagnostics Program at VSCC has grown in the number of graduates as well as the amount of geographic coverage area since its beginning. The first cohort in 2004 produced a total of seven graduates. Over the past several years, the cohort size has grown to around 30 students annually.

When our state license law was written, it stipulated that there had to be education coverage in all regions of the state in order to make education a requirement for licensure. At that time, A-step study modules combined with work internships were being used by some to qualify for the board exam. For those other pathways to be denied, the licensure bill said that there must be two CAAHEP accredited polysomnography programs in East TN, one in Middle TN, and one in West TN. ETSU and Roane State Community College had programs in East TN, VSCC covered Middle TN, but there were no polysomnography schools in West TN. The TN Sleep Society President approached our program director to ask if we could expand this program to West TN in order to satisfy the education coverage stipulation in that law. Because of the program's mostly online format, we did that by hiring an adjunct instructor to teach the two clinical courses out of a clinical affiliate lab in that area. The state board of health approved the expansion as the fourth program in TN, and the law took final effect in July of 2010.

Since then, Miller-Motte began a program in Clarksville TN, but it did not survive accreditation issues. ETSU's program also dissolved around the same time of reaccreditation. Then Concorde Technical College in Memphis started a program that is still in operation. Those changes left Roane State, VSCC, and Concord. We were also approached by the COO of the Ballad Health System about filling

the gap left by ETSU's program departure. Therefore, we did a similar expansion in the East TN region by teaching the two clinical courses out of a hospital there.

VSCC's expansion not only provided the necessary education coverage to satisfy our state license law, but it continues to provide employees to labs throughout TN and beyond. Since our inception, we have had students attend the Sleep Diagnostics Technology program from 13 different states.

These expansions do bring with them challenges, however. It has been challenging to market in those areas and to grow those sections. The registry exam for the field is also challenging for many. Therefore, the program has to walk a narrow line in regard to student selections. On one hand, we need to provide employee coverage, but on the other hand, we still must meet accreditation standards by only admitting students who show the aptitude for learning the material. Accreditation standards require annual reports of placement rates, graduation rates, registry exam passage rates, graduate and employer survey results, and resource survey results from students and program personnel. Program personnel includes teaching staff, the medical director, and our advisory board.

We are proud that our program has thrived and expanded while many of our competitors have closed due to an inability to maintain accreditation standards.

Discussion of Survey Data

The Sleep Diagnostics Technology Program has never received a bad overall rating on any survey measure. However, there are a few items that we have addressed over the past few cycles. One of those comments was that the East TN clinical instructor's technical knowledge needed improvement. That instructor became registered via a respiratory care add-on track rather than going through a school of polysomnography, so that was a weak spot in her education. Therefore the program director has been working with her to improve her theoretical knowledge. She was also given access to our summer PSG 110 instrumentation course that should also help her to understand some of the questions her lab students might ask her.

Another comment that has been suggested a few times is that we should move the sleep scoring course to the summer semester instead of waiting for the fall. That has been considered before, and it was determined that it is best to leave it in the fall. The reasoning was that students need to understand how the equipment and sensors function in generating the waveforms on screen before attempting to interpret the data produced. That being said, we have added more scoring training toward the end of the summer PSG 120C course to provide a bit of a head start to the fall scoring class. That was implemented when the summer semester was expanded to a 15-week schedule. The program director will continue to work with the East TN clinical instructor to ensure that this is being done in a uniform way for all clinical students.

One area of current concern is in the return ratio of some of the student questionnaires utilized for the annual accreditation report. Though the overall ratings have always been good, there is a minimum threshold percentage of students who are required to be surveyed. That has fallen a little short on a couple for the past two cohorts. Those two years are the only years since the program's origin that this has occurred. On the accreditation report, we suggested that the department work more closely with IERPA staff to ensure that enough surveys are returned and enough data is collected to satisfy the accrediting body. We explained that the IERPA department has a new V.P. and is undergoing many changes, but that we would continue to work on improving communication with them. Also, it is important to understand that all students who go through the program courses graduate with a certificate in Sleep Diagnostics Technology. That is regardless of whether they are certificate majors or A.A.S. in Health Sciences Degree majors. Sometimes the survey results separate the two majors. Therefore, when viewing cohort results, it may be necessary to combine the survey results of the certificate majors with the A.A.S. majors to reveal the true number of certificate students. The annual accreditation report includes data from certificate graduates only. All students must graduate with the technical certificate in Sleep Diagnostics Technology because the certificate is the only one of the two that is accredited through the CAAHEP. That is what qualifies students to sit for their registry exam after graduation. This should explain why our graduate numbers are higher than our enrollment numbers for the certificate majors.

Evidence:

- 2018 Cohort Employer Survey Results
- 2018 Cohort Graduate Survey Results
- 2019 Cohort Graduation Satisfaction Survey Results
- 2019 Employer Survey Results
- 2020 Graduate Survey Results
- Graduate Surveys Returned
- Program Resource Surveys by Student 2019

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment

Enrollment

Retention

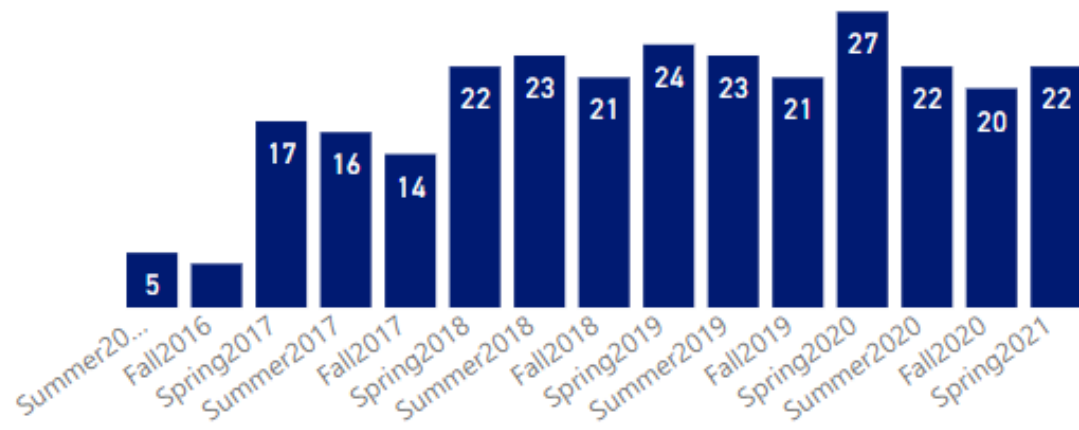
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

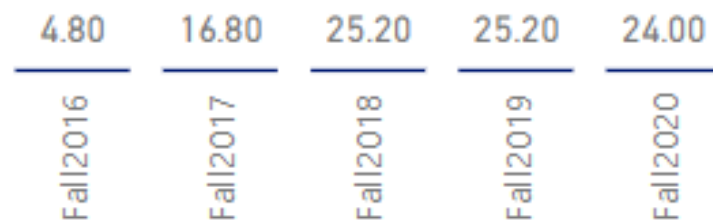
Narrative:

Charts like the first two below are misleading because they only show students with a major in the Sleep Diagnostics Technology Certificate. Again, all Sleep Diagnostics AAS in Health Sciences majors also received the certificate. Those two numbers should be added together for cohort information. For example, the fact book shows a total of 14 students attending in the fall of 2017. However, there were 32 who actually were in the fall 2017 cohort who graduated with a Sleep Diagnostics Technology Certificate. There were 37 enrolled for the spring of 2017. That combined information can be seen in the chart at the bottom of the screen, which is a more accurate representation of the cohort numbers. It is also worth noting that there is no single data chart that can be retrieved from the Fact Book data that includes all students in the cohort or that includes an accurate FTE count for the faculty teaching these program courses.

Headcount



Full Time Equivalent (FTE)



2016 - 2020 Retention Average

152	27	65%	82.24%	83.7%		
Total Students	Dropped Out	Threshold	Percentage Retention	3-Year Average		
Graduation Year		2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
# Initially Enrolled		31	34	27	37	23
# Added to Class		0	0	0	0	0
Attrition Due to General Education Courses		0	0	0	0	0
Attrition Due to Non-Academic Reasons		7	3	3	5	5
Attrition Due to Professional Courses		1	0	1	2	0
# Dropped Out		8	3	4	7	5
# In-Progress or Stopped Out		0	0	0	0	0
# Graduated		23	31	23	32	16
Retention Percentage		74.19%	91.18%	85.19%	81.08%	78.26%

Retention Detailed Analysis

Retention Action Plan

The Sleep Diagnostics Program has tripled in enrollment since its inception. This has been partly due to its expansions into other regions of TN and beyond. The online format has aided in our capability to do this. Last year, the Covid-19 pandemic seemed to have a significant impact on retention. We lost several students to illness and other related factors. We have backed away somewhat from the West TN area due to the existence of another program in Memphis. However, the East TN, and Chattanooga area, in particular, has made up for it and seems to be growing in interest. The number of applications submitted for the 2021 cohort was the highest ever, so there seems to be no decline in student interest regardless of the overall slow down in enrollment campus-wide.

The demographics of the program cohorts have shown lots of diversity, and a significant portion of our cohort is consistently made up of non-traditional students.

Sleep Graduate Demographics						
Grad Year	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015
# of Grads	23	30	23	32	16	23
Male	3	3	3	7	2	8
Female	20	27	20	25	14	15
Age less than 25 years	10	9	7	9	5	8
25 to 35 years	10	7	7	13	6	6
36 to 45 years	1	7	5	5	3	4
46 or more years	2	7	4	5	2	5
Unknown	0	1	0	0	0	0
African American	3	4	6	6	4	5
American Indian	0	0	0	0	0	0
Asian	1	0	0	1	0	0
Caucasian	18	25	16	24	12	15
Hispanic	1	0	1	0	0	1
Other	0	0	0	1	0	2

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

It is important that reviewers of this academic program review understand the nature of the program format. In particular, our summer clinical practice I course is taught as a laboratory course with an instructor. Our campus sleep lab was not designed to hold the entire cohort at once. This was intentional on the part of the program director as a way to limit waste. Most of the program courses are offered via an online format. Because students would not be on campus all year round, it was decided that it would be more efficient to utilize less space. Therefore, due to the small capacity of our campus lab and a desire to provide better service to our students, the cohort is divided into smaller groups for lab training. There are generally three to four separate middle TN groups and an additional East TN group that is taught by an adjunct in the Bristol TN area. In recent years, there has been an increase in enrollment from the Chattanooga and southern part of TN. Although most of those students are technically East TN residents, they generally come to Gallatin for their lab training since it is a shorter commute. The point is that the same instructor may be teaching several groups per week but only getting credit for one because they are registered for the same course.

Secondly, any increase in enrollment numbers compounds the work of clinical instructors exponentially and not only because of having to split them into more groups. More students means much more clinical documentation, more time in locating and scheduling clinical sites, more late night phone calls, and more information to gather for accreditation reports. The sleep diagnostics technology students do clinical rotations on third shift. Local sleep labs are not always open every day of the week, so matching the students' schedules with lab schedules while only sending one student to each lab at a time is an incredible challenge. Most sleep lab control rooms are not large enough to accommodate more than one student at a time. So far, the program has had students from 13 different states. When students register from regions we haven't served before, it also requires much more effort to locate new clinical affiliates in those locations.

Lastly, it is important to understand that the entire cohort's information cannot be retrieved in a single report from the Fact Book data. Our certificate majors are always separated from the A.A.S. in Health Sciences majors even though they are in the same cohort. Those reports are pulled based on student majors. Therefore it can be very misleading to pull a report for Sleep Diagnostics Technology certificate majors. The A.A.S. majors also complete the certificate even though it may not be listed as their current major. That is why our cohort graduate numbers for the certificate will always be larger than the number of certificate majors that can be viewed in any one report. Therefore, cohort information is best gathered from graduate numbers rather than majors.

It is also critical to understand the significance of our East TN and West TN expansions. Those expansions were necessary to satisfy the state polysomnography act that established our state licensure requirements. Without our presence in East TN, the law's requirement of graduation from a CAAHEP accredited program like this one would go away. That would be a huge blow to our enrollment because it would allow applicants for a state license to practice polysomnography to qualify through alternative pathways. Therefore, the East TN presence is crucial. Even though the East TN clinical group is sometimes small in numbers, those students also take the rest of the online courses in the same course sections as the rest of the cohort.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

Narrative:

The Sleep Diagnostics Technology Program is a cohort based program, which accepts a new cohort of students each spring semester. All program courses are required to be taken in succession. Below is a brief summary of the professional program courses included within the Certificate in Sleep Diagnostics Technology. Selection preference is granted to applicants who have completed a medical terminology course. Coursework in Human anatomy and Physiology is also highly encouraged but not required for entry.

Courses/Semester-by-Semester Sequence

Spring Semester: Physical Aspects of Polysomnography

PSG 101* Anatomy and Physiology of Sleep Disorders (3) A study of the Anatomy and Physiology that is specific to sleep disorders medicine. The areas to be covered will include; structure of the nervous system, macro-and micro-anatomy including the upper and lower airway, the respiratory and cardiac system, circadian rhythm biology, sleep architecture and the physiology of REM.

PSG 102* Classification of Sleep Disorders (3) A study of the 84 sleep disorders with emphasis on disorders evaluated during a Polysomnographic study. Upon completing the course, a student will have an understanding of the importance of documentation in the sleep center setting by interpretation of patient history and physical assessment.

Summer Semester: Technical Application of Polysomnography

PSG 110* Sleep Polysomnography Instrumentation (3) A course of study covering three major items: basic electronics, Analog PSG's and Digital PSG's. Emphasis placed on computer systems, equipment calibration, signal pathways, relationships between analog and digital equipment and troubleshooting. PREREQUISITES: PSG 101*, PSG 102* or permission of Program Director.

PSG 120C Clinical Practice I (4) Students will receive instruction and clinical supervision on clinical application of electrode placement utilizing the 1020 method, proper patient preparation, montages, protocols, impedance checks, calibrations, troubleshooting, vital sign assessment, proper documentation and note taking. PREREQUISITES: PSG 101*, PSG 102* or permission of Program Director.

*Upon completion of the Summer semester, the student should be able to set-up and run a sleep study with minimal amount of guidance.

Fall Semester: Data Analysis of Polysomnography

PSG 130* Data Management in Polysomnography (4) A study of the mathematical equations used in a sleep report with focus on sleep report review, sleep documentation and editing and reviewing physician's final report. Also covered is the proper flow of patients into an accredited sleep disorders center. Sleep center management covered; time permitting. PREREQUISITES: PSG 110* and PSG 120C* or permission of Program Director.

PSG 131* Sleep Scoring (4) A study of the sleep staging of adults and pediatrics, respiratory scoring, scoring of PLMS, scoring of REM density, scoring of EKG arrhythmias and recognition of atypical EEG patterns. PREREQUISITES: PSG 110* and PSG 120C* or permission of Program Director.

PSG 132* Sleep Registry Review (4) This course is designed to prepare the student for the NBRPT examination. It includes test preparation and review. PREREQUISITES: PSG 110* and PSG 120C* or permission of Program Director.

PSG 133C* Clinical Practice II (6) Supervised clinical application of electrode placement utilizing the 1020 method, proper patient preparation, montages, protocols, impedance checks, calibrations, trouble-shooting, vital sign assessment, proper documentation and note-taking. PREREQUISITES: PSG 110* and PSG 120C* or permission of program director. 120 clinical hours per term.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from creditable industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The results of all three course outcome measures have exceeded the goals set so far.

1. Demonstrate critical thinking skills in the analysis of recorded sleep data.

This goal has been consistently met. These results show increased consistency among students on the outcome. We will shoot for a goal of 80% or more of the class earning a minimum of 14/20 on the rubric which computes to a percentage score of 70% or better. No additional funds are needed.

2. Familiarity with Polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment. Students need to understand how each piece of equipment works as well as why and when to use it.

This goal has been consistently met, but it will continue to be monitored. However, a new rubric will be utilized for a more quantitative assessment of this outcome beginning with the 2022 cohort.

3. Students will demonstrate their knowledge of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine (AASM) scoring rules and ability to distinguish among sleep stages and recognize micro-arousals in EEG patterns, different types of scorable respiratory events, Limb movements, and PLMs.

So far, the results for this outcome measure have exceeded expectations. Our results have been comparable to those of experienced technologists in the field. Although this goal has been consistently met, it is a job function that will continue to be monitored as an ongoing assessment. This is partly due to the fact that these scoring rules continue to be updated annually. It is also an essential job function that requires critical thinking and the application of a culmination of program knowledge learned. The sleep diagnostics faculty will monitor current guidelines and parameters, and keep courses updated accordingly. No other changes are needed at this time.

Overall Program Summary Analysis:

The past three years have been challenging for the Sleep Diagnostics Technology Program. The pandemic caused some sleep clinics to close their doors temporarily. There was also a CPAP machine recall by the largest manufacturer, Philips/Respironics which also caused temporary halting of lab

titrations in some areas. Through it all, students received reasonably normal instruction and were able to complete all clinical rotation requirements. The design of our program was better suited for navigating the challenges presented by the Covid-19 pandemic than most others. However, we did have to get a little creative in performing lab instruction via the Zoom app for the first 6 weeks of the 2020 summer PSG 120 Clinical Lab course that is normally taught in person in our campus sleep lab. Though all three years produced good graduate cohorts, some effects of the pandemic were not immediately apparent. One of those effects was a slight decrease in retention. This was not due to academics but was more related to life circumstances and illnesses. It was also challenging to find clinical affiliates willing to accept students during the pandemic. However, through lots of scheduling creativity and cooperation of clinical affiliates, we were able to accomplish a relatively normal clinical rotation schedule. This was complicated further for the recent 2021 cohort due to some students choosing not to receive the Covid-19 vaccine. However, we were able to find enough clinical affiliate sites willing to take them, and those students were able to complete their rotations as well. During a time when the overall enrollment numbers for the college are down, the Sleep Diagnostics Technology Program has not experienced a similar effect. In fact, the number of applicants for our 2022 cohort was higher than ever before. We also continue to add new service locations. While this has been challenging for the program director to manage, regarding clinical affiliates, it is a positive trend for the college. The most significant limitation to this growth is the way our out-of-state tuition rates and e-rates are calculated. Currently, the rules are such that an out-of-state student can qualify for the e-rate only if they take all online courses for a semester. If they take one course that requires them to meet somewhere in person (even if it is at one of our clinical affiliate sites), they are charged the out-of-state rate for the entire semester, even if most of those courses are online. The program has reached out to TBR officials regarding this and has received positive comments of support for altering this rule, but it is yet to happen. Those students are taught by the same faculty, so it is just an unnecessary loss of opportunity and revenue for VSCC.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Current and Future Course Learning Assessments

The following learning outcomes will continue to be assessed. They are representative of a large amount of knowledge needed to complete each activity. Together, they represent a skill set needed to function as a professional polysomnographic technologist.

- 1. Instruments and Ancillary Equipment** - Students learn the international 10-20 system of head measurement, proper placement of all sensors to a patient the various devices and equipment used in a sleep lab, the functionality of each, basic equipment calibrations, and safety protocols. Students will also be assessed on their readiness for employment which will include professional dress, punctuality, and the completion of all required clinical documentation for the fall clinical rotations. This outcome will be assessed near the end of the PSG 120C course, which is a hands-on laboratory course that is designed to pair well with the didactic learning in PSG 110. Students will be assessed via the attached rubric.

2. **Problem-solving/ critical thinking improvement** - Students will use critical thinking/problem-solving skills to analyze patient data. Students will be assessed on their data analysis skills by utilizing a critical thinking assignment in the PSG 132 Course. Students will be asked to analyze some patient data and narrate their reasoning as to how they arrived at the conclusions they did. The grading rubric for this activity is also attached. Students are graded on their completeness and how well they can support their conclusions with evidence. Feedback is given in the online grading environment, but we also go over this assignment together in our final class meeting.
3. **Sleep Data Scoring** - Students will apply and demonstrate their knowledge of AASM scoring rules and ability to distinguish among sleep stages and recognize micro-arousals in EEG patterns, different types of scorable respiratory events, Limb movements and PLMs. This task will be assessed individually using online scoring comparison exams from the American Academy of Sleep Medicine as part of the PSG 131 Sleep Scoring course in the fall semester. It is referred to as inter-scorer reliability testing. The exams are purchased and utilized as a means of assessing how students are progressing. This online service sends individualized reports of student success/failure. Students will be compared with the AASM gold-standard scorer and must be within 85% accuracy to receive a passing score. It is worth mentioning that the AASM Gold-standard scorer has been criticized for his inaccuracy, but the AASM has hired four new gold-standard scorers to serve as scoring experts for comparison. It is also worth noting that these exams vary greatly in difficulty, depending on the patient data that is selected for each month. This service is provided online and the AASM forwards the report to VSCC. This service also complements the online format of the program well. Data scoring is also a task that graduates will be required to do as an ongoing quality assurance measure on the job. All scorers are required to pass an inter-scorer reliability exam periodically in order to continue scoring actual patient data.

Although this goal has been consistently met, it is a job function that will continue to be monitored as an ongoing assessment. These results are extraordinarily good considering that the national average on the exam among professionals is only an 82.6% agreement on sleep stages alone. That is below the 85% cut-off score needed to pass the test. This means that our students must score better than an average experienced professional to pass the exam. I could not find a value for what percentage score above 85% nationally for comparison. However, a research analysis conducted by Rosenberg and Van Hout, S. (2013) on scoring consistency presented in the Journal of Clinical Sleep Medicine suggested a lower threshold. The conclusion was stated as follows:

"Returning to the issue that prompted the development of the AASM ISR program, center managers may wish to set a relatively low cut point (such as 75%) that reflects basic stage scoring competence. A consistent score above this threshold could be used as a criterion for entrance to the pool of scorers. It is not recommended that a high threshold, such as 95%, be used as a criterion for promotion or bonuses. Such a criterion would be in excess of the agreement between expert scorers and is likely to occur only as a result of chance." (para. 24)

Although outcomes #2 and #3 above have been assessed with very good results prior to this action plan, they will continue to be monitored because of the fluid nature of the registry exam and to ensure that we are staying up to date on the AASM guidelines and parameters. Outcome #1 above will utilize a new rubric that does not yet have a baseline set. We will monitor it over the next few years to establish trends for improvement.

Student Success Planning for Future Cohorts

1. The Registry exam has added more content on home sleep apnea testing, and that is a task that has become a larger part of the daily testing routine in a sleep clinic. Therefore, we want to add more hands-on practice of that task. To do this, we are purchasing some HSAT testing devices so that students can practice the actual procedure either on themselves or their lab partners. If the supply chain issues allow, this will be added to the curriculum of the summer 120C course for the 2022 cohort. This is recommended by our accrediting body and our program advisory board. It is our hope that more hands-on practice will not only make graduates more proficient at these procedures after starting their new careers, but it could also help to improve their registry exam scores. Existing funds accumulated from the collection of the health sciences fee will be utilized to purchase the necessary equipment.
2. Work with IERPA to create a dashboard that can more easily review program statistics by cohort rather than designated degree, or major. The way the data tables are set up in the Fact Book, it is currently impossible to pull a report summary regarding our entire cohort at the same time. Therefore,

it is especially difficult to convey information to others who might view this data. It gives the impression that our cohort sizes are smaller than they really are.

Reference

Rosenberg, R. S., & Van Hout, S. (2013). The American Academy of Sleep Medicine inter-scorer reliability program: sleep stage scoring. *Journal of clinical sleep medicine: JCSM: official publication of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine*, 9(1), 81–87. <https://doi.org/10.5664/jcsm.2350>

Evidence:

- Email from CoAPSG

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Increase student performance on SLR #1	Increasing the number of examples	The 2022 cohort was a strong group	The goal was achieved among those	The 2022 cohort class average was

(Demonstrate critical thinking skills in the analysis of recorded sleep data) by spending more time on data interpretation during the summer clinical course. Goal was increased to 80% or more of the class earning a minimum of 14/20 on the rubric which computes to a percentage score of 70% or better. PLO 1	appeared to have limited effect between the 2022 and 2023 cohorts. However, the goal was well achieved.	with 100% participation and a high scoring average. However, the 2023 cohort included a few students who did not complete the assignment. The ones who completed it did well, however. The main challenge in achieving 100% participation is that students are doing 3rd shift clinical rotations during this time and many are exhausted and have gotten into a routine by the time this assignment is released. This assignment is part of an online course.	completing the assignment. Still, 100% participation is desired. Students were prompted and reminded several times during the semester regarding this assignment. Making the assignment should factor more into the students' overall grade may be worth considering. However, no changes to the timeline are needed at this time.	91.6% with a SD of 10.11, and the 2023 cohort average was 88.5% with a SD of 10.01. All scores for both cohorts (2022 & 2023) were at or above the set threshold level of three on the rubric. It is worth noting that the 2022 cohort was an exceptionally strong group academically.
2 Increase Student familiarity with polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment. Students need to understand how each piece of equipment works as well as why and when to use it. Assessed during PSG 120C. PLO 2	A list of knowledge concepts related to boost the electrical concepts and ancillary equipment and a new rubric to measure understanding of students in the PSG 120C course more on a more quantifiable scale were developed.	Challenges in completing this goal are largely based on the fact that there is only one instructor, and the plan was to quiz students orally. This increases the necessary	No changes in teaching methodology needed at this time. However, we need to transition to using the online rubric tool in VIA instead of recording these grades	The 2022 and 2023 cohorts did well on this activity. All students scored at an adequate level on the rubric.

		Familiarity with Polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment.	testing time greatly. Individual attention in the lab to correct or retrain a student is also time-consuming.	on hard copies.	
3	Students will demonstrate their knowledge of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine (AASM) scoring rules and ability to distinguish among sleep stages and recognize micro-arousals in EEG patterns, different types of scorable respiratory events, Limb movements, and PLMs. PSG 131 PLO 2	The outcome goal of this assessment has continued to rise due to our students' success. Students have achieved each new milestone. Much effort has been directed at increasing student participation as well as in boosting their performance on the samples.	One area that can be challenging is getting students to begin participation early enough that they can gain the benefit of seeing multiple patients' data. Some seem apprehensive for fear of not doing well. They are also very busy during this semester.	No changes are planned for the upcoming year. However, we plan to continue applying pressure on students to participate early and consistently throughout the second half of the semester.	The students in the 2022 and 2023 cohorts have done very well on this assessment. For 2022, all but two students scored high enough to pass this exam at the professional level. One missed by two points, and the other just failed to participate. For the 2023 cohort, 13 out of 16 participated with 11 of those scoring above the professional threshold. This meets expectations, but 100% participation is desired.
4	Successful completion of the program will help prepare the graduate to take the Board of Registered	More focus on AASM guidelines and parameters seems to have boosted graduate performance on the exam. Also,	Primary challenges are attracting high caliber students to the program and	RPSGT exam content must be continually monitored and course content	The 2022 cohort currently has a passage rate of 100% from those attempting the

Polysomnographic Technologists Registry Exam. PLO 4	library of prep resources has been purchased.	developing the work ethic in students that is required to succeed on the exam. It is also a challenge to keep up with the exam content because it changes every four years. Lastly, there were several very strong students in the 2022 cohort that never attempted the exam. Some chose to either continue their educations or pursue another career.	adjusted in coordination.	exam. The results for the 2023 cohort are not complete at the time of this assessment. However, 4 out of 5, or 80% of those attempting have passed so far. The one who did not pass is expected to retake it shortly. These results are within our expectations and well above the national average.
---	---	--	---------------------------	--

-
-

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
1	Increase student performance on SLR #1 (Demonstrate critical thinking	Increasing the number of examples appeared to have limited effect between the	The 2022 cohort was a strong group with 100% participation	Only one student out of the 3-year assessment period scored	Yes

	skills in the analysis of recorded sleep data) by spending more time on data interpretation during the summer clinical course. Goal was increased to 80% or more of the class earning a minimum of 14/20 on the rubric which computes to a percentage score of 70% or better.	2022 and 2023 cohorts. However, the goal was well achieved for all three cohorts.	and a high scoring average. However, the 2023 cohort included a few students who did not complete the assignment. The ones who completed it did well, however. The main challenge in achieving 100% participation is that students are doing 3 rd shift clinical rotations during this time and many are exhausted and have gotten into a routine by the time this assignment is released. This assignment is part of an online course.	lower than the goal.	
2	Increase Student familiarity with polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment. Students need to understand how each piece of equipment works as well as why and when to use it. Assessed during PSG 120C. PLO 2	A list of knowledge concepts related to boost the electrical concepts and ancillary equipment and a new rubric to measure understanding of students in the PSG 120C course more on a more quantifiable scale were developed. Familiarity with Polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment.	Challenges in completing this goal are largely based on the fact that there is only one instructor, and the plan was to quiz students orally. This increases the necessary testing time greatly. Individual attention in the lab to correct or retrain a student is also	This initiative has worked well. Students have demonstrated more retention of important concepts. However, due to time constraints as well as the value of group preparation, this will become a group grade for future cohorts.	Yes

			time-consuming.		
3	Students will demonstrate their knowledge of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine (AASM) scoring rules and ability to distinguish among sleep stages and recognize micro-arousals in EEG patterns, different types of scorable respiratory events, Limb movements, and PLMs. PSG 131	The outcome goal of this assessment has continued to rise due to our students' success. Students have achieved each new milestone. Much effort has been directed at increasing student participation as well as in boosting their performance on the samples.	One area that can be challenging is getting students to begin participation early enough that they can gain the benefit of seeing multiple patients' data. Some seem apprehensive for fear of not doing well. They are also very busy during this semester.	All three year cohorts exceeded the threshold set by the AASM for professional RPSGT's to be able to maintain scoring privileges on the job. 89% of the three combined cohorts passed the ISR on the professional threshold level. The final year, only one student did not participate.	Yes
4	Successful completion of the program will help prepare the graduate to take the Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists Registry Exam.	More focus on AASM guidelines and parameters seems to have boosted graduate performance on the exam. Also, library of prep resources has been purchased.	Primary challenges are attracting high caliber students to the program and developing the work ethic in students that is required to succeed on the exam. It is also a challenge to keep up with the exam content because it changes every four years. Lastly, there were several very strong students in the 2022 cohort that never attempted the	So far, all three cohorts have a passage rate of well over 80%, which is much higher than the accreditation threshold set by the CoAPSG of 65%. In addition, the cohort size has increased for 2025 which should also increase the competitive level for entry into the program.	Yes

		exam. Some chose to either continue their educations or pursue another career.		
--	--	--	--	--

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis

Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
1 Increase student performance on SLR #1 (Demonstrate critical thinking skills in the analysis of recorded sleep data) by spending more time on data interpretation during the summer clinical course. Goal was increased to 80% or more of the class earning a minimum of 14/20 on the rubric which computes to a percentage score of 70% or better.	It has pushed students to look at patient data more critically, consider how the data was collected, and recognize when it may be flawed to gain a more accurate picture of what can be drawn from it. We have a classwide discussion of the data afterwards. I think it has been one of the most valuable assignments asked of our students.	This has worked very well. However, the sleep data used for this activity may need to be changed periodically to discourage cheating. More examples could be used as well.	We will continue to encourage students to think critically of the data they are analyzing. It appears that the more patient data students are exposed to, the better they become at interpreting it.
2 Increase Student familiarity with polysomnographic instruments and ancillary equipment. Students need to understand how each piece of equipment works as well as why and when to use it. Assessed during PSG 120C.	It has forced students to retain more of how and why lab equipment is used. This will make them better technologists by improving their troubleshooting skills and help them to explain procedures to their patients.	It is anticipated that this will be converted to a group activity. Each lab group will be tested as a group instead of individually. We have seen the benefit for groups as a whole who study together. It is expected that the group pressure will encourage students to be better prepared	Knowing the equipment well is a large part of their job, so we will continue to test students skill level and retention, making adjustments as necessary to achieve a high level of cohort. We will closely monitor the success of the group testing format as well.

			so not to negatively affect the grades of their peers. The program continues to grow in size and attendance. The group testing will also help make the process more efficient.	
3	Students will demonstrate their knowledge of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine (AASM) scoring rules and ability to distinguish among sleep stages and recognize micro-arousals in EEG patterns, different types of scorable respiratory events, Limb movements, and PLMs. PSG 131	Participating in ISR testing, students are prepared and ready to perform this duty on the job after graduation. It also provides students with proof of their scoring ability that they can provide to potential employers. In addition, the results of this assignment provided valuable feedback to our instructors and to each individual student.	This is a graded activity in which we will continue to participate and a service we will continue to provide for our students.	This initiative provides ongoing feedback to our instructors on how to adjust our scoring training in the PSG 131 course.
4	Successful completion of the program will help prepare the graduate to take the Board of Registered Polysomnographic Technologists Registry Exam.	Our student's ultimate goals are to become registered polysomnographic technologists (RPSGTs). Therefore, the pressure to maintain a high passage encourages instructors to constantly evaluate the content of our program and find innovative ways to convey the information needed bolster students' chances of passing this exam. The exam feedback is informing of which areas need more attention.	We will continue to monitor our students success and scourer the feedback data for ways to improve this ultimate outcome for each cohort.	Much has been done over the past three years to bolster students' chances of passing the RPSGT exam. A library of resources and a complete study-prep website have been developed by our program Director. This information serves as a constant source of program feedback. The program cohort size has increased for 2025, which also means that more quality

			students are choosing this profession. However, the RPSGT exam content is updated every four years requiring an ongoing monitoring effort.
--	--	--	--

Academic Program Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Dental Assisting CERT

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first year for the Academic Program Review. Therefore, no previous data is available for comparison.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The mission of the Dental Assisting Program at Volunteer State Community College is to produce entry-level graduates that are competent assistants, registry eligible and demonstrate professional concern for their patient. The mission reflects the industry need for qualified dental assistants in the communities in the service area of the Collège.

Evidence:

- Dental Assisting Program Information Packet with Mission Statement 2021

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

The Dental Assisting Program aligns with the Institution's mission statement by preparing student for successful careers in field of dental assisting.

Evidence:

- DAST Program Mission Alignment with VSCC Mission

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Evidence:

- Dental Assisting Technical Certificate Curriculum Mapping_
- Fall 2021 DAST1510 001 Activity Assessments Aggregated Result 11-15-21 color aggregate
- Fall 2021 DAST1530 451 Activity Assessments Aggregated Result 11-30-2021 132105

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The program utilizes the Employer Satisfaction Surveys to assess the effectiveness of Program Goals.

1. Basic skills to be a competent dental assistant
2. Ability to recognize terminology unique to dental assisting
3. Ability to illustrate comprehension of professional ethical standards for dental assisting]
4. Ability to apply and demonstrate critical thinking problem solving and decision making skills within the parameters of dental assisting.

In addition, assessing student learning assessment was conducted in two courses DAST 151o Dental Radiology and DAST 1530 General Chairside I. Each of the courses utilized the learning outcomes for hands-on exams that also incorporated Program Goals. (see evidence)

Program Response:

- **Program Outcome 1.** Students will demonstrate the basic skills to be a competent dental assistant. This assessed by using the employer satisfaction survey. It accurately demonstrates skills learned and applied while in the program and utilized in employment. The target on the Employer Satisfaction Survey is a 3.8 out of 5-point liker score. The Program meets this target of 3.8 as shown below. See DA Table A, B and C. in evidence for the survey results.

Assessment Tools	2018	2019	2020	2021
Employer Survey Results				
#3 Competency in the skills required in position	4.11	4.33	4.00	Data not available

- **Program Outcome 2.** Students will recognize terminology unique to dental assisting. The target level of performance was a 3.9 out of a 5.0 Likert scale on the Employer Satisfaction Survey. See DA Table A, B, and C in the evidence for the survey results. the . The program also used the Supervised Clinical Progress Report to evaluate dental terminology. The target level of performance for the Supervised Clinical Progress is 85% of students would score competent (a 2) or higher. The program meets both of the targets. See DA Supervised Clinical Progress Report in the evidence.

Assessment tools	2018	2019	2020	2021
Employer Survey Results				

# 12 Ability to understand technical information	3.89	4.0	4.0	No data at this time
#13 Ability to use technical information	3.89	4.33	4.0	No data at this time
Supervised Clinical Progress Report	100% scored 2 (competent)	100% scored a 2 (competent)	100% scored a 2 (competent)	100% scored a 2 (competent)

- **Program Outcome 3.** Students will illustrate comprehension of professional ethical standards for dental assisting. The target level of performance is scoring a 3.5 on the Employer Survey Satisfaction survey and on the SCPR a score of 80% or higher would score a 3 were met. The program meets this target as shown in the table below. See DA Table A, B, and C and DA Supervised Clinical Progress in the evidence.

Assessment tools	2018	2019	2020	2021
Employer Survey Results				
# 6 Appropriate work ethics	4.56	4.67	5.0	No data
Supervised Clinical Progress Report	90% scored 3	89% scored 3	92% scored 3	100% scored a 3 (Commendable)

- **Program outcome 4.** Students will apply and demonstrate critical thinking, problem solving and decision-making skills within the parameters of dental assisting. The target level of performance is scoring a 4.3 or higher on the Employer Satisfaction Survey and a score of competent a 2 or higher a 3 which is commendable on the SCPR. The program did not meet the target score of 4.3 on the Employer Survey averages. See DA Table A, B, and C and DA Supervised Clinical Progress in the evidence.

• Assessment tools	2018	2019	2020	2021
Employer Survey Results				
# 10 Problem solving skills	4.33	4.33	4.0	No data
Supervised Clinical Progress Report	91% scored 3	90% scored 3	89% scored 3	91% scored a 3

Analysis of Trends

The VSCC Dental Assisting program continues to meet the benchmarks set by the program outcome goals as demonstrated by the Employer Satisfaction Surveys. The student learning outcomes for 2020 varied slightly and 2020 academic year was challenging due to the pandemic and rapid changes in how the program was offered. The faculty continued to seek opportunities to engage the students.

Student Learning Improvements

To address the lowered scores in problem solving skills, the program has implemented an evaluation assessment tool that includes problem solving in DAST 1510 Dental Radiology. See evidence.

Evidence:

- DA Program Outcome 1. Table A, B, and C
- DA Supervised Clinical Progress
- DAST 1510 Dental Radiology Assessment

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

The Graduate and Alumni Surveys for the dental assisting program were rated a 4.7 out of a 5.0 for the 2020-2021 academic year. The Program faculty overcame and successfully delivered the curriculum during the pandemic so that students received as much hands- on experiences as were allowed.

Positive comments:

1. I am so happy to be in that program.
2. I believe the primary goal of the program is to give students a basic knowledge of the dental assisting career. I felt prepared as much as I could be.
3. My instructors were always one step ahead of the game when it came to things we needed to know for our clinical rotations.

Comments for program improvement:

1. More chairside assisting
2. I wish they (the instructors) could have prepared us on resume, cover letter and interview questions.

The faculty have reviewed recommendations made by graduates in the area of job seeking skills. Resume building, cover letters and interview skills were added to the curriculum in the Fundamentals of Dental Assisting Course in order to thoroughly cover the important job seeking needs.

Evidence:

- Fundamentals of Dental Assisting syllabus
- Section 4- Student, Graduate and Alumni Satisfaction

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

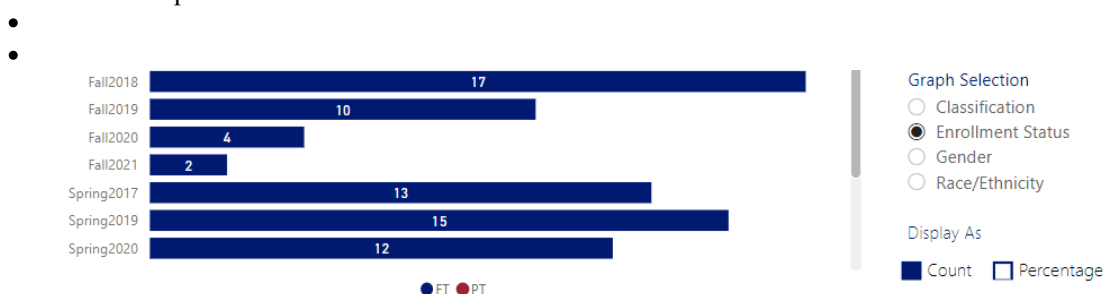
Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention

Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

- Recruitment- Direct recruitment comes from the college. In addition, the program participates in hosting service area high school students as well as the Discovery Days launched during 2021 fall semester. Discovery Days was created by the Health Science faculty to reach out to current VSCC students and introduce them to health science careers that are not as widely publicized or known. Each program allots for time to share program information and guided tours of their faculties and to allow students to ask questions about the industry of interest.
- Enrollment- The program declined by 50%. Discrepancies could be attributed to the Program name change mandated by TBR to reflect the common curricular requirements by all Commission on Dental Accreditation (CODA) approved Programs as well as the pandemic of 2020. The former program certificate name/degree was AAS in Dental Assistant. Now the degree name is Dental Assisting. See charts below regarding the decline in numbers. There are still two separate degree names, Dental Assistant and Dental Assisting. Dental Assistant is specific to the certificate, while Dental Assisting is specific to the AAS degree. If a student chooses the degree, the number of students for the certificate drops. The faculty also felt that the pandemic may have been an additional factor in the lower enrollment numbers for the program. Although the college and the surrounding service areas have returned to a semi-normal lifestyle, students were reluctant to pursue a career in the dental field because of the close proximity of a dental assistant to the patient as well as other dental team members and the fear of the spread of the virus.

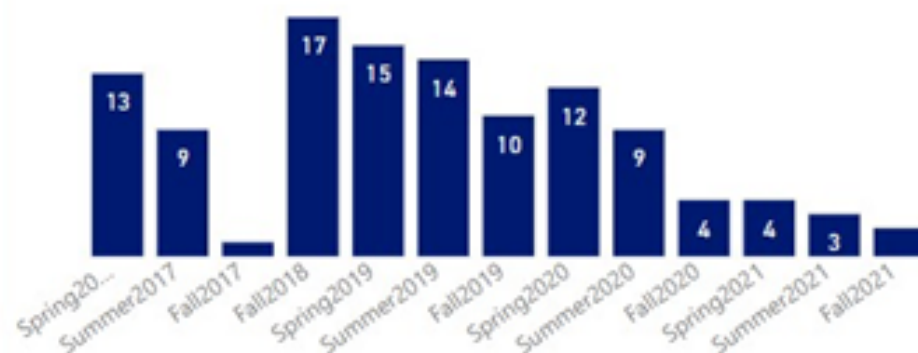


a career in dental assiting beacuse of the nature of the job skills.

- Retention- 88.4 from 2016- 2020 excluding fall 2017 and spring 2018 -no data was available.
- Graduation- 100% graduates for 2018 and 2021 graduates; 93% for 2019 graduates and 87% for 2020 graduates. A mean average of 95% graduation rate for 2018-2021.

Although a decline in student enrollment was significant, the program faculty believe the lowered number of students enrolled in dental assisting was attributed to the pandemic. From the data provided by IEARPA, the Program maintains an 88.4 percent retainment of those students that choose dental assisting as a profession. In addition, the program has a mean average of 95% for students who stay in the program and graduate. The demographics for the program are mainly located in the VSCC service areas. Average age of students is about 22 and mostly those who identify as female are enrolled in the program.

Headcount



State/County	Fall2017	Fall2018	Fall2019	Fall2020	Fall2021
Sumner County	1	9	5	1	2
Macon County		2	1	1	
Robertson County		1	2	1	
Davidson County		2	1		
Wilson County		1	1	1	
Bedford County		1			
Cheatham County		1			

Fall to Spring Persistence

92.9%

Fall 2016 to Spring 2017

0.0%

Fall 2017 to Spring 2018

82.4%

Fall 2018 to Spring 2019

90.0%

Fall 2019 to Spring 2020

100.0%

Fall 2020 to Spring 2021

Concentrations	16-17	17-18	18-19	19-20	20-21
Art (Studio)	7	13	14	13	13
Biology	3	4	3	2	7
Business Administration	38	33	32	23	33
Chemistry		4		2	1
Civil Engineering	2	1	2	3	1
Computer Info Sys Tech	2				
Computer Science		1	5	3	4
Criminal Justice	37	34	35	41	36
Criminal Justice (TSU)	3	1			
Criminal Justice Law Enfrcemnt		1			
Cyber Defense	6	11	18	21	35
Dental Assistant	14	10	6	5	2

Evidence:

- Section 5 Recruitment, Enrollment Retention and Graduation

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

Clinical experiences play a significant role in student learning. The students participate in clinical rotations in working dental offices during the fall, spring, and summer. The clinical rotations are valuable in that the foundations being taught in the classroom and laboratories are developing and increasing student competencies. Each rotation and semester, the expectations for students to participate in dental procedures are increased. Feedback from the clinical team is helpful in identifying the students' areas of weakness as well as comments about their strengths. The assessment tool used in assessing student learning for clinical experiences is via the Supervised Clinical Progress Report.

Evidence:

- 2018-2021 Supervised Clinical Progress Report

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

When the common core curriculum was mandated for all accredited dental assisting programs in Tennessee, the program faculty saw an opportunity to enhance the summer curriculum by adding lectures in coronal polishing, dental sealants and monitoring nitrous oxide in DAST 1650, offered in the summer semester. The addition of the coursework was a result of requests from the dental community and the TBR common curriculum mandate. In addition to following curriculum changes, in order for the Program to offer the certifications, approval by the Tennessee Board of Dentistry was sought and approved. Also because the Tennessee Board of Dentistry statutes state that the certification course must be taught by a dentist in good standing with the TBD, the faculty reached out to affiliate's seeking instructors for the courses. The faculty have been able to retain two local dentists to teach the courses and the students are not only adding certification courses to their licensure, but they are also receiving life experiences from seasoned dentists.

Evidence:

- DAST 1650 Special topics 2021

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The Program is doing well in:

- Developing a foundational knowledge base in which a graduate is able to build on once in the dental assisting field. Based on Employer feedback and ratings, graduates have successfully met the goals implemented for basic skills in dental assisting.
- The students are understanding the importance of ethical decision making as it pertains to the field of dentistry as noted by the employer surveys scores. The ability to make decision based

upon the students' personal ethics that mirrors the ethical standards held by the profession of dentistry is expected and met.

- The additional certification courses were a positive improvement for students in their ability to obtain employment faster and with better retention in staying in the position. It increased the graduate's confidence in obtaining employment as well as confidence in their level of foundational skills learned.

Areas the Program will improve:

- The faculty will add components in dental software (Eaglesoft) use in Clinical Chairside I and II as well as Dental Office Management. Remarks from alumni and graduates were that there should have been more opportunities to use the software to build confidence and comfortability in navigating the icons and areas in the software.
- Also, the faculty will spend more time on employment seeking skills such as resume building, developing a cover letter and soft interviewing skills as noted in a comment results for 2019 graduates.
- The faculty will work with IERPA in collecting data for student resource surveys and program personnel resource surveys.
- The faculty will look for opportunities to increase program enrollment by attending high schools and interacting with guidance counselors to make the program more visible. The faculty will also recruit on campus by setting up information booths during the spring in order to showcase the program. The dental assisting advisory board members gave feedback on recruitment by recommending by creating a video showcasing the activities of dental assisting and to invite admissions recruiters to sit down with program faculty for ways to recruit students for the program.

Evidence:

- Technology and Software use graphs

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

The two-year plan of action will include:

- **Student Learning Recommendation: Increase outcome achievement for Program Outcome #1** Students will demonstrate the basic skills to be a competent dental assistant.
 - The faculty will look at evaluate the clinical assessment documents from Spring 2022.
 - **2022-2023 Actions: Review and take action accordingly, Clinical Chairside I (fall) skills assessment document**
 - **2023-2024 Actions: Review and take action accordingly, Clinical Chairside I (fall) skills assessment document**
- **Student Success Recommendation: Improve Student Feedback**

- Working closely with IERPA to create and distribute a Student Resources Survey and a Program Personnel Resource Survey. Both surveys will provide the program with data to make sure that students are utilizing and receiving resources necessary for their successes as well as revealing areas lacking in each
 - **2022-2023 Actions: Create and distribute survey (collect data to evaluate and assess**
 - **2023-2024 Actions: Evaluate survey results, examine effectiveness**
- **Student Success Recommendation: Improve recruiting efforts**
 - Attend high school visits to speak with health science students, participate in the Health Science Discovery days, Participate in the Health Sciences high school visits to VSCC Campus, Develop a Program specific video to showcase the program and the facilities
 - **2022-2023 Actions: High School visits, participate in the Health Sciences Discovery days in the fall and spring**
 - **2023-2024 Actions: High School visits, participate in the Health Sciences Discovery days in the fall and spring**
- **Student Learning Recommendation: Increase outcome achievement for Program Outcome #4 Students will apply and demonstrate critical thinking, problem solving and decision-making skills within the parameters of dental assisting**
 - To address the lowered scores in problem solving skills, the program has implemented an evaluation assessment tool that includes problem solving in [DAST 1510 Dental Radiology](#). See evidence:
 - **2022-2023 Actions: Implement new assessment,**
 - **2023-2024 Actions: evaluate effectiveness and implement new assessment if necessary for lowered scores**
- **Student Learning Recommendation: Increase outcome achievement for Program Outcome #2 Students will recognize terminology unique to dental assisting.**
 - **2022-2023 Actions: The faculty will add components in dental software (Eaglesoft) use in Clinical Chairside I and II as well as Dental Office Management. Remarks from alumni and graduates were that there should have been more opportunities to use the software to build confidence and comfortability in navigating the icons and areas in the software.**
 - **2023-2024 Actions:**

Evidence:

- DAST 1510 DENTAL RADIOLOGY Assessment 2021
- DAST 1530 GOALS AND ASSESSMENT 2021

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

The program faculty have done an effective job in producing graduates who are meeting the needs of business and industry. The addition of certification courses increased their marketability in a new profession. Introducing dental software into the program will be of great benefit to all stakeholders by increasing familiarization with technology and building confidence in maintaining adequate medical records. The College will collaborate with the program director to increase visibility with the overall goal of increasing enrollment and completion.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment has reviewed this report and will begin supporting the report champion in preparing for the presentation of this review to the Institutional Effectiveness Committee.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Increase outcome achievement for Program Outcome #1 Students will demonstrate the basic skills to be a competent dental assistant.	PLO # 1- 80% of the students will receive a score a 2.5 or higher on the overall competency in Clinical Chairside I competency evaluation. On SLO DAST 1530 there were 50 skills evaluated. 80% of the students scored a 2.5 or higher.	No challenges in the evaluation of students' basic skills were noted.	No changes needed	On PLO # 1, 80% of the students received a 2.5 or higher on the evaluations in DAST 1530.

2	Improve Student Feedback	The faculty failed to work on an assessment tool in order to develop a Student Resources Survey and a Program Personnel Resources Survey.	The faculty failed to develop the survey necessary to retrieve data for the action plan.	The faculty will work with IERPA to develop a new resource survey or use the current survey with minor changes to satisfy the needs for the Program.	No data available
3	Improve recruiting efforts.	Hendersonville High School, Sumner County Middle School and Career Exploration Fair 2023 and 2024	No challenges in recruitment	No changes	Although no students were gleaned from the high school visits who chose the dental assisting program, the faculty will continue to reach out to the high schools and will participate in the on-campus activities for recruitment.
4	Increase outcome achievement for Program Outcome #4 Students will apply and demonstrate critical thinking, problem solving and decision-making skills within the parameters of dental assisting.	PLO # 4- 80% of students will score a 2.5 or higher on problem solving activity located in DAST 1510 Dental Radiology evaluation tool # 48. Outcome- a 2.18 was the overall score, which is less than the set baseline.	Developing a more comprehensive evaluation tool to assess the students' problem-solving skills in the evaluation of quality dental x-rays.	The faculty will develop an additional and separate evaluation tool for assessing diagnostically acceptable x-rays.	The score of a 2.5 or higher was not achieved. Therefore, the faculty will work on a separate assessment tool that will demonstrate the students' skill sin critical thinking and problem solving. In addition, the faculty will incorporate Clinical Practicum I and II Supervised Clinical Progress Report for the spring and summer Which addressed the evaluation of the students' ability to problem solve.
5	Increase outcome achievement for Program Outcome #2 Students will recognize terminology unique to dental assisting.	PLO # 2- 86% of the students received a 75% or higher on the EagleSoft assignment final in Dental Office Management Course. 92% of the students received a 75% or higher on the terminology final in Clinical Chairside I 83% of the students received a 75% or higher in the	The faculty will be involved in the distribution of the Employer Surveys in order to receive adequate data to analyze for student success	Contacting Employers for survey completion Add the Clinical Practicum I and I to the evaluation tools in order to adequately measure the students' understanding and knowledge of dental terminology.	The faculty will continue to embed the terminology final sin both Clinical Chairside I and II as well as incorporating Eaglesoft exercise in Clinical Chairside I and Dental Office Management. The Program will add the Clinical Practicum Supervised Clinical Progress Report for spring and summer. Part I of the said reports # 9-

	terminology final in Clinic Chairside II. No data from the 2023 Employer Survey results have been retrieved in regard to understanding terminology.		Demonstrates Knowledge of dental terminology, 80% of the students will score a 2 (competent) or higher.
--	---	--	---

Evidence:

- VSCC_HealthSciences_DiscoveryDays SP22

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress

Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved?
PLO #1 - Basic Clinical Skills	Continued use of DAST 1530 Clinical Chairside I competency evaluation (50 skills).	None	80% scored 2.5 or higher; consistent with Year 2.	YES
Improve Student Feedback	Reviewed survey tools with IERPA.	Survey implementation in progress.	No data available.	NO
Improve Recruiting	Continued high school outreach and career fairs.	None	No immediate enrollment impact.	YES
PLO #4 - Critical Thinking	Added Clinical Practicum I & II progress reports.	New tool still under development.	Below 2.5 benchmark; steady vs Year 2.	NO
PLO #2 - Terminology	Continued terminology assessments and Eaglesoft activities.	Low employer survey response.	80-90% met competency benchmarks.	YES

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis

Initiative	Support of Student Learning	Further Action	Future Program Decisions
PLO #1 - Clinical Skills	Reinforced consistent measurement of core competencies.	No	Maintain current assessment approach.
Student Feedback	Identified need for improved data collection.	Yes	Guide future resource planning.
Recruiting	Increased program visibility.	Yes	Refine outreach strategy.
PLO #4 - Critical Thinking	Expanded assessment perspective.	Yes	Improve assessment tools.
PLO #2 - Terminology	Confirmed strong terminology mastery.	Yes	Seek employer validation.

Summary

During Year 3, the Dental Assisting Program continued its initiatives with student performance remaining steady and consistent with Year 2 results. PLO #1 met the established benchmark, with 80% of students achieving a score of 2.5 or higher on the Clinical Chairside I competency evaluation, indicating continued effectiveness of current instructional practices.

Efforts to improve student feedback and recruitment remained in progress. Faculty reviewed survey tools with IERPA but did not collect new data during Year 3. Recruitment activities continued through high school outreach and career events to support long-term enrollment goals.

For PLO #4, critical thinking and problem-solving results remained below the benchmark, similar to Year 2. In response, faculty expanded assessment methods by incorporating Clinical Practicum I and II Supervised Clinical Progress Reports while continuing development of a more targeted evaluation tool. PLO #2 terminology outcomes remained strong, with approximately 80-90% of students meeting competency benchmarks across courses. Overall, Year 3 reflects sustained performance, ongoing assessment refinement, and continued focus on improvement.

General Education Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Humanities and Fine Arts GE

Reflection and Mission

Previous General Education Review

Reflect on the past GER (if any) and responds to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is our first round completing the general education review.

Program Mission Statement

Have any changes been made to the general education mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The goal of the Humanities and/or Fine Arts requirement is to enhance the understanding of students who, as citizens and educated members of their communities, need to know and appreciate their own human cultural heritage and its development in a historical and global context. Also, through study of Humanities and/or Fine Arts, students will develop an understanding, which they otherwise would not have, of the present as informed by the past.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the general education mission align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Our program mission is consistent with our institution's mission; we prepare our students for successful careers in a variety of courses, including English Composition and Communications. We foster meaningful civic participation and promote cultural awareness and diversity in all of our course offerings.

Student Learning Outcomes Assessment and Curriculum

Curriculum Map

Curriculum mapping ensures the alignment of TBR GenEd outcomes and student learning outcomes; which affords an opportunity to ensure course coverage and sequencing of outcomes in courses.

The reviewer should review the current mapping to ensure there is pathways to meeting the TBR GenEd outcomes for all general education students.

Narrative:

The current TBR General Education outcomes are not consistently written in a way to lend themselves to being mapped to unique course-level outcomes. Rather, the TBR General Education Outcomes are broad and often map to multiple course learning outcomes, especially given how the course learning outcomes are currently written. Assessments are mapped to specific TBR General Education Outcomes, but they may also be connected to multiple course learning outcomes, depending on how the course learning outcomes are structured.

Literature and Film: a review of course learning outcomes and mapping will take place over the next year, so these mappings may be adjusted during this cycle.

Philosophy:

Art:

Music: Faculty who teach MUS 1030 will meet during the spring of 2022 to review course learning outcomes and ensure course mapping aligns with TBR GenEd outcomes. If necessary, we will modify course mapping for future semesters.

Theater:

Evidence:

- GenEd Humanities Course Outcomes

Evidence of Student Learning

Evidence of Student Learning

Provide evidence of student learning, and the program's effectiveness in reaching both TBR GenEd outcomes and student learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of assessment most recent results.
2. Analysis of trends.
3. Ideas of how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

For all courses in humanities & fine arts: This is the first cycle with the new general education review. We do not have enough consistent data to make analyses on specific outcomes as they related to specific years, but we can draw general conclusions based on limited data.

English:

(Film | 2860): We discovered an oversight; we have not assessed our film course in recent years. This will change beginning in spring 2022.

(literature course offerings): We only have one year of data -- 2018-2019. The next two years were disrupted due to COVID and changes in our general education review process. As for the year we do have, we were able to assess 22 sections of our literature offerings. We examined three areas of student learning using an excel sheet: analysis of theme, assessment of relationships and culture, and comparative analysis. All literature courses require one essay; this was the assignment used for all faculty to assess all three areas on the rubric. Students had the highest numbers (3.32/5) on analyzing relationships and culture. Analysis of theme was close, with a score of 3.29/5. Students had the most trouble with comparative analysis, which had a mean score of 3.32. Anecdotally, our faculty agree that students tend to struggle with comparative analysis. Our off-campus sites (dual enrollment) had higher scores in all categories. The higher score in analysis of culture and relationships makes sense, as students tend to do engage with theme for every assignment in literature. Many have already analyzed theme in previous English courses as well. It is not surprising that our off-campus sites had higher scores; dual enrollment students tend to be better prepared than our traditional students and outperform our main campus students with grades as well. During the assessment process, we discovered we did not assess ENGL 2045 (introduction to literature). This is unfortunate, because 2045 is our most commonly offered course. We will plan to assess it starting in spring 2022.

Philosophy:

Art:

Comparing our scores from the writing rubrics to those of Music and Theater, it seems we may be grading a bit easier than we should, particularly in the writing. We will discuss this as a department and decide the best way to proceed, perhaps by including more short writing assignments and/or emphasizing writing skills more.

Looking at our pre- and post-quiz scores, the increases between the two fluctuate a bit from semester to semester, but are consistently fairly strong with an average increase of nearly 15% (ranging from a low of 8.44% to a high of 19.3%).

Music:

Our pre- and post-test scores frequently show improvement for most students. However, not all students take the pre- and/or post-tests, and since we are unable to treat these quizzes as graded items, students will perhaps need more incentive to complete them (extra-credit, allowing one late assignment, etc).

The concert reports consistently demonstrate what students have learned in class and how well they incorporate that knowledge into narrative form. There are two concert report per semester, approximately two pages each. More emphasis can be placed on rigorous grading to help students improve. Overall, students have received 3.97 on the grading rubric, with "Writing Skills" receiving the lowest score of 3.83 and 1/3 of the students receiving "Adequate".

Theater:

Overall, Theatre final course grades are significantly correlated with Post-test scores for students completing the assessment. However, overall, correlation strength is low to moderate, suggesting that Post-test score alone is not a strong predictor of student course outcome. The data tells us that theatre students understand the assignment but need help completing tasks on time. There is a need to improve how we explain how humanistic and artistic expression throughout the ages expresses the culture and values of its time and place. Likewise, the need to improve how theatre is has influenced our society.

Evidence:

- ART 1819 Rubric report tables
- ART Pre-Post VPA 2020
- ART VPA Rubric Writing Assessment Results Spring 2018
- Literature tables 18-19

Faculty and Courses

Faculty Usage and Development (optional)

May review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and/or any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

English (literature):

Based on the most recent data for literature courses, it is clear that our faculty assign very different numbers when assessing students; some faculty have scored categories with a mean as high as 4.8, while others have numbers as low as 2.5. While assessing is very different from grading, the numbers suggest faculty teaching literature may benefit from some grade norming sessions. Our department has

done this in the past three years for our composition courses, but it has been a while since we have had sessions geared toward literature.

Philosophy:

Music:

Art:

Theater:

Class Offerings (optional)

May address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and/or discuss the impact relative to faculty and student's success.

Narrative:

English (Film): For the immediate future, ENGL 2860 will be assessed using the _____ for spring 2022. Faculty teaching 2860 are currently revising the model course. It will be piloted in Fall 2022, and faculty teaching the course will include an assessment of the course outcomes as indicated in the attached mapping.

English (Literature): It appears ENGL 2045 has not been assessed in recent years, which is a problem since it is one of our most popular literature courses. It is also evident we have not assessed 2310, though only 3-4 sections are usually offered each year. We plan to continue to assess 2045 sections in addition to 2055, 2110, 2120, and 2320 using our current course mapping. Our department plans to re-examine course outcomes beginning in Fall 2022, so we may re-map or wait for the new TBR outcomes.

Philosophy:

Music:

Art:

Theater:

Recommendations and Next Actions

Analysis and Summary

Analyze and summarize the proceeding sections. The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

English (literature and film)

This review highlighted the need to assess our film course and to ensure all literature courses (including ENGL 2045) are assessed. For ENGL 2860, we will assess the genre analysis assignment. We will continue to assess each literature course's respective essay using the same rubric categories (analysis of theme, assessment of relationships and culture, and comparative analysis) for the time being. We will discuss ways to incorporate more comparative analysis earlier in the semester with lower-stakes assignments (such as discussion board posts) so students have more practice before writing their major essay; hopefully, this will improve assessment results. The English department has an academic audit starting in fall 2022, so we may find we need to revise the assignment we use for the general education assessment.

Philosophy:

Art:

Our writing rubrics include scores generally higher than those using the same rubric in Music and Theater courses, so we will discuss to determine if we think this is an indication that our students are performing better on the paper in question or rather we are grading too easy. Pre- and post-quiz scores are generally good and will continue to be monitored as a means of identifying any problems that develop.

Music:

MUS 1030 instructors need to improve student participation in pre- and post-tests, particularly the latter. It may be advisable to tie these in to student participation or other graded items. The post-tests, when submitted, show student improvement.

We require two 500-word Concert Reports, and these remain excellent assessment instruments in showing students' writing skills and application of material learned in class. However, even though we have a set rubric, faculty have often vastly different methods to grading these reports, so we can better align our grading approach. Our students tend to have adequate writing skills at best.

Theater:

Students need a better understanding of how theatre classes can assist them with other courses.

Students need to discover how theatre can positively affect life outside of the classroom.

Next Actions

The reviewer should discuss the next steps for the general education for the following two academic years. A plan of action and timeline should be included in the narrative or document library.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the GER timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

English (literature and film):

Film: faculty teaching 2860 are currently revising the model course. Starting in spring 2022, we will assess the genre analysis assignment.

Literature: It appears ENGL 2045 has not been assessed in recent years, which is a problem since it is one of our most popular literature courses. It is also evident we have not assessed 2310, though only 3-4 sections are usually offered each year. We plan to continue to assess 2045 sections in addition to 2055, 2110, 2120, and 2320 using our current course mapping.

Our department plans to re-examine course outcomes beginning in Fall 2022, so we may re-map or wait for the new TBR outcomes. Our 2022-2023 academic audit may give us more direction.

Philosophy:

Art:

The Art Department will meet in early spring 2022 to discuss the way we are using the writing rubrics and in particular whether we should be expecting more of our students in their writing. We are beginning the process of pushing students more toward the Learning Commons for help with their writing, which will potentially counter the likely outcome of this meeting of increasing our expectations in this area. This should all be in place before anyone is grading these assignments in spring of 2022.

Music:

Music faculty will meet in spring 2022 to discuss a more consistent approach to grading the Concert Reports, and also to determine better methods to improve student participation in pre- and post-tests. The Art Department's suggestion of encouraging more students to use the Learning Commons for tutoring in writing is an approach that we will also use, since most of our students would benefit from more instruction in writing.

Theater:

- To work closely with criminal justice faculty providing them with student actors to role-play situations that law enforcement face daily. One of the benefits of having students role-play is that it will aid in training students who want to become police officers.
- Show how theater relates to other disciplines.
- To have two to three one-on-one meetings with students to discuss their Theatre Project
- Students will do a group PowerPoint presentation on theatre and social media.

Evidence:

- ART1030 _THEA1030 TBR General Education Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085734
- Art History Fall 2020 Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 084001
- ENGL2045 SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085741
- ENGL2055 SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085748
- ENGL2110 SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085811
- ENGL2120 SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085817
- ENGL2310 SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085825
- ENGL2320 SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085835
- PHIL 1030 Gen Ed Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085847
- PHIL 1040 Gen Ed Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085901
- PHIL 2430 Gen Ed Rubric Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 085907

Feedback and Review

Feedback (General Education Committee)

Presentation by faculty to the General Education Committee of the Program Review. The General Education Committee will provide feedback on the completed review and action plan. The feedback will be included and summarized.

Dean(s) Approval and Feedback

The Dean(s) of the general education discipline(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

VPAA and AVPAA

The VPAA & AVPAA will provide feedback on the completed review and action plan.

Action Plan Reports

Year 2 Action Plan Review

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or document library.

Narrative:

ENGLISH:

Film (ENGL 2860)

Between spring 2022 and spring 2023, we began assessing the Genre Analysis assignment in ENGL 2860. This marked an important step in aligning our teaching and assessment practices with course outcomes. The initial assessment helped faculty pinpoint strengths in student engagement with genre conventions and revealed areas where students needed more support in critical analysis and writing. Building on this work, a newly revised OER-based model course was launched in spring 2023. The updated course features refreshed materials, streamlined assignment scaffolding, and more intentional connections between outcomes and major assessments. Faculty who piloted the new course have provided valuable feedback, and we plan to continue refining the materials based on those insights.

Literature offerings

We made steady progress in addressing gaps in literature course assessment. ENGL 2045, one of our most popular offerings, had not been assessed in recent years, so we prioritized it for inclusion in our assessment cycle. We also began assessment efforts in ENGL 2310, which, while offered less frequently, remains a key part of our literature offerings. Alongside these efforts, we continued assessing ENGL 2055, 2110, 2120, and 2320, maintaining consistency with our current course mapping.

At the same time, faculty initiated broader conversations about our course outcomes. These discussions have focused on whether our current outcomes still serve the needs of students and whether updates might be needed in light of forthcoming TBR general education revisions. By the end of spring 2023, the department was weighing whether to re-map outcomes now or wait for guidance from the new statewide framework.

Year 3 Action Plan Review

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

ENGLISH:

Film (ENGL 2860)

During the 2023–2024 academic year, we continued to build on our assessment work in ENGL 2860, our film course. The recently launched OER-based model course has made a positive impact by reducing costs and improving access to course materials. Faculty have observed that this change has helped students engage more deeply with the content, and early feedback has been encouraging. That said, the pass rate for film (71.3%) remains lower than in our literature courses. We believe this may be partly due to the higher number of students in learning support who enroll in ENGL 2860. As the English department revises ENGL 0810 (Learning Support Writing), we expect that changes to that curriculum may support stronger outcomes in film in future semesters.

Literature Offerings

In our literature courses, we've maintained a consistent approach to assessment while also working to update course outcomes across the board. ENGL 2045 continues to be our most popular literature course, with a strong pass rate of 86.6% and a low withdrawal rate of 1.8%. We also continued assessment efforts in ENGL 2310, which saw an 82.6% pass rate this spring. Both courses have been part of a broader push to refresh outcomes across our literature offerings, and those revised outcomes will officially go into effect in fall 2025.

Meanwhile, our other literature courses showed solid performance:

- ENGL 2055 had a 72% pass rate
- ENGL 2110 reached 76.8%
- ENGL 2120 stood out with a 93% pass rate
- ENGL 2320 had an 87.8% pass rate

Each of these courses continues to be mapped and assessed according to departmental plans. The literature faculty also spent time this year discussing whether our current outcomes still align with the skills and knowledge we want students to take away from these courses. These conversations have helped us prepare for the upcoming TBR general education revisions, ensuring we're ready to adapt when the new framework is finalized.

General Education Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Natural Science GE

Reflection and Mission

Previous General Education Review

Reflect on the past GER (if any) and responds to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

No prior GERs have been conducted. Science faculty have developed, administered, and evaluated outcomes assessments over the past several years. This review evaluates data from academic years 2018/2019, 2019/2020, and 2020/2021. We will define our departmental mission, examine the current IE assessment data, discuss the impacts of the Covid-19 pandemic, explore multiple faculty- and course-related topics, and present a plan to improve student learning and success.

Evidence:

- Academic Audit Science 2007
- Academic Audit Science 2013
- Academic Audit Science 2018

Program Mission Statement

Have any changes been made to the general education mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

The mission of Natural Sciences General Education is to provide innovative courses and encourage active learning, communication, and decision-making skills by providing immersive and hands-on educational opportunities to help students meet degree and certificate requirements, prepare for university transfer, and meet their personal goals.

The science department created a new mission statement during Fall 2021 to align with the college's updated format. We collected faculty comments via email and Jamboard, a collaborative, online whiteboard where faculty can post comments and share ideas. Science faculty then met to review the comments and identify themes to create the new statement.

Previous Mission Statement

The department provides coursework and supporting services and facilities which allow students to meet the degree and certificate requirements in programs of the college or to build a foundation of skills and knowledge for pursuit of advanced degrees, a lifetime of learning, and enhanced career performance.

Evidence:

- Natural Sciences Mission Jamboard

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the general education mission align with the mission of the institution?

These educational opportunities contribute to the college mission by fostering lifelong learning and meaningful participation in a global society.

Student Learning Outcomes Assessment and Curriculum

Curriculum Map

Curriculum mapping ensures the alignment of TBR GenEd outcomes and student learning outcomes; which affords an opportunity to ensure course coverage and sequencing of outcomes in courses.

The reviewer should review the current mapping to ensure there is pathways to meeting the TBR GenEd outcomes for all general education students.

The Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR) states that the goals of the Natural Science curriculum are to “guide students toward becoming scientifically literate. This scientific understanding gained in these courses enhances students’ ability to define and solve problems, reason with an open mind, thinking critically and creatively, suspend judgment, and make decisions that may have local or global significance.” ([TBR Proposal for the Establishment of a Lower Division General Education Core](#), November 2002).

TBR General Education Outcomes

TBR has identified five Natural Science General Education Outcomes. Students will demonstrate the ability to:

- **Outcome 1:** Conduct an experiment, collect and analyze data, and interpret results in a laboratory setting.
- **Outcome 2:** Analyze, evaluate and test a scientific hypothesis
- **Outcome 3:** Use basic scientific language and processes and be able to distinguish between scientific and non-scientific explanations.
- **Outcome 4:** Identify unifying principles and repeatable patterns in nature, the values of natural diversity, and apply them to problems or issues of a scientific nature.
- **Outcome 5:** Analyze and discuss the impact of scientific discovery on human thought and behavior.

Vol State Science Department Outcomes

Our faculty created the following four outcomes by modifying the TBR General Education Outcomes to better align with the needs of the department.

Students will demonstrate the ability to:

- **Outcome 1:** Apply established scientific methods to the interpretation of experimental results. (TBR 1 and 2)
- **Outcome 2:** Use scientific principles to solve problems of a scientific nature. (TBR 1 and 2)
- **Outcome 3:** Demonstrate knowledge of scientific principles, processes and terminology. (TBR 3 and 4)
- **Outcome 4:** Discuss the impact of scientific discovery on human thought and behavior. (TBR 5)

Course-level Learning Outcomes

Each general education natural science course has developed a set of course learning outcomes that can be linked to the above departmental outcomes. The attached curriculum map links course-level learning outcomes to our four departmental Learning Outcomes, which are then linked to the five TBR Learning Outcomes.

Course Learning Objectives

Several courses have also developed a more detailed list of course topics, called Learning Objectives (LOs). The list of LOs for BIOL 2010 are attached as an example.

TBR General Education Program Revisioning

TBR is conducting a comprehensive review of the General Education Core. The mission is to create a core “framework that best meets the needs of all student populations, disciplines, and pathways including a clear structure of general education global learning outcomes” ([TBR General Education Core](#), 2021). TBR has asked schools to provide input on the highest level, global outcomes called Very Important Learning Outcomes (VILOs).

The figure below outlines the Gen Ed Revisioning process, with the goal to launch the new Learning Outcomes in 2025.

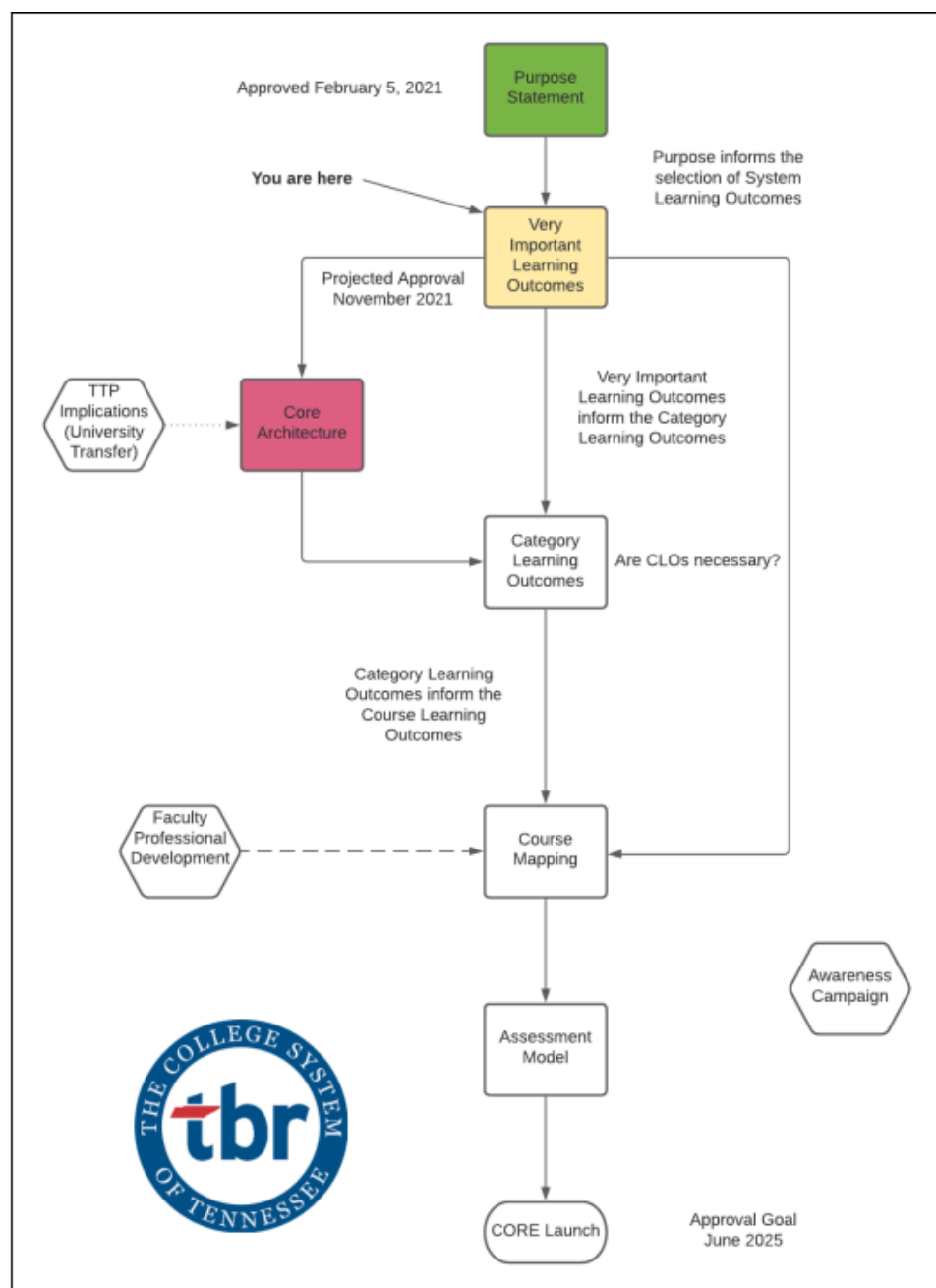


Figure 1. TBR General Education Core Revisioning Process overview.

Evidence:

- BIOL 2010 Learning Objectives
- Gen Ed Natural Science Course Outcome
- TBR General Education Outcomes

Evidence of Student Learning

Evidence of Student Learning

Provide evidence of student learning, and the program's effectiveness in reaching both TBR GenEd outcomes and student learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of assessment most recent results.
2. Analysis of trends.
3. Ideas of how those results could be used to improve student learning.

General Education science faculty created outcome assessment tools for their courses and have been using them for several years. Course coordinators collect and analyze the data and post the results in a common folder on the T drive. In the past, each course was not required to assess every outcome. Additionally, the years under review were impacted by Covid-19, so the data in this review cycle is incomplete. We have identified this as an area for improvement and dedicated our first Student Learning Goal to collecting assessment data for all four learning outcomes in each section of every general education science course.

Covid-19

The last two years under review were affected by the Covid-19 pandemic. The college announced that all classes were moving online during spring break in 2020, and faculty were given one additional week to prepare their classes before they resumed in an online or virtual format. Science faculty placed emphasis on maintaining our high quality of classes and academic rigor. We wanted to ensure that students would receive the specific skill sets they would learn through traditional on-ground teaching methods.

Laboratories were a challenge for science faculty to move online, especially in classes that teach hands-on skills and STEM classes. Instructors employed a variety of methods, including lab kits, online simulations, and videos demonstrating the lab activities. Some utilized “kitchen chemistry,” where students conduct experiments at home using common ingredients. For example, DNA extraction from fruit using dish soap and salt in a biology class. Chemistry faculty recorded videos performing laboratory experiments. Students then used the data from the video and pictures for calculations as if they had performed the experiment. These videos were highlighted on the local news to demonstrate creative methods our faculty utilized to adapt their courses during the pandemic. (“[Chemistry classes continue virtually.](#)” WSMV News. Sept 2020.) Our BIOL 1050 and 1060 did virtual field trips and invited guests to speak over Zoom. This includes doing Citizen Science Projects virtually and remotely in place of in person.

Faculty collaborated with many other departments, including Distributed Education, Media Services, and Information Technology to prepare their classes for online and virtual delivery. Distributed Education created an Online/Virtual faculty mentor position and a “faculty fellows” position to support faculty during this time.

Testing was a concern for many science faculty. Honorlock and the testing center were available for proctoring, but the capacity of the testing center is limited, and many faculty were skeptical about online proctoring services. Most faculty pivoted to giving exams on eLearn. The loss of the use of Honorlock during Spring 2022 is a significant concern for many faculty.

Access to the internet was a challenge for many students and faculty, especially at our satellite locations where internet service is not available in some areas. Information Technology provided faculty and students with laptops, Wi-Fi hot spots, video cameras, and other items needed to participate in their online courses. Faculty could also request instructional tools such as document cameras and smartpens enabled for touchscreen 2-in-1 laptops.

Continuing effects of Covid-19

In a survey of more than 120,000 students across 273 colleges, greater than one-third of students described their financial situation as “worse than it was before the COVID-19 pandemic.” More students are struggling to pay for college, with Asian, Hispanic/Latino, American Indian/Alaskan Native, and Black/African American individuals most affected. (CCCSE. (2021). [The Continued Impact of COVID-19 on Community College Students.](#))

The financial stress of the pandemic may cause additional challenges for our students, with 29% of Vol State students reporting a lack of finances as “very likely” to cause them to withdraw. Approximately 36% reported working more than 30 hours per week. (CCSSE. (2021). Survey of Student Engagement, Volunteer State Community College).

Safety continues to be a significant concern for faculty and students. 59% percent of students reported trying to avoid situations on campus in which they are unable to stay 6 feet away from another person, with nontraditional-age students and women expressing the highest levels of concern. (CCCSE. (2021). [The Continued Impact of COVID-19 on Community College Students.](#)) Some faculty have utilized cohorts to reduce the number of students in the room at any given time, and adjustments were made to the schedule to maximize the time between classes for rooms to be cleaned. TBR recently changed the mask policy, and we will no longer be allowed to require students on campus to wear masks.

College enrollment has fallen since the pandemic, and we are making additional efforts to increase student success and retention. Student engagement is a factor that can increase success and retention. The graphs in Figure 2 represent Vol State’s highest and lowest aspects of student engagement relative to a CCSSE Cohort. The lowest aspects could be areas for improvement. Class presentations could be a good idea for some courses looking for capstone projects for their learning outcome assessments.

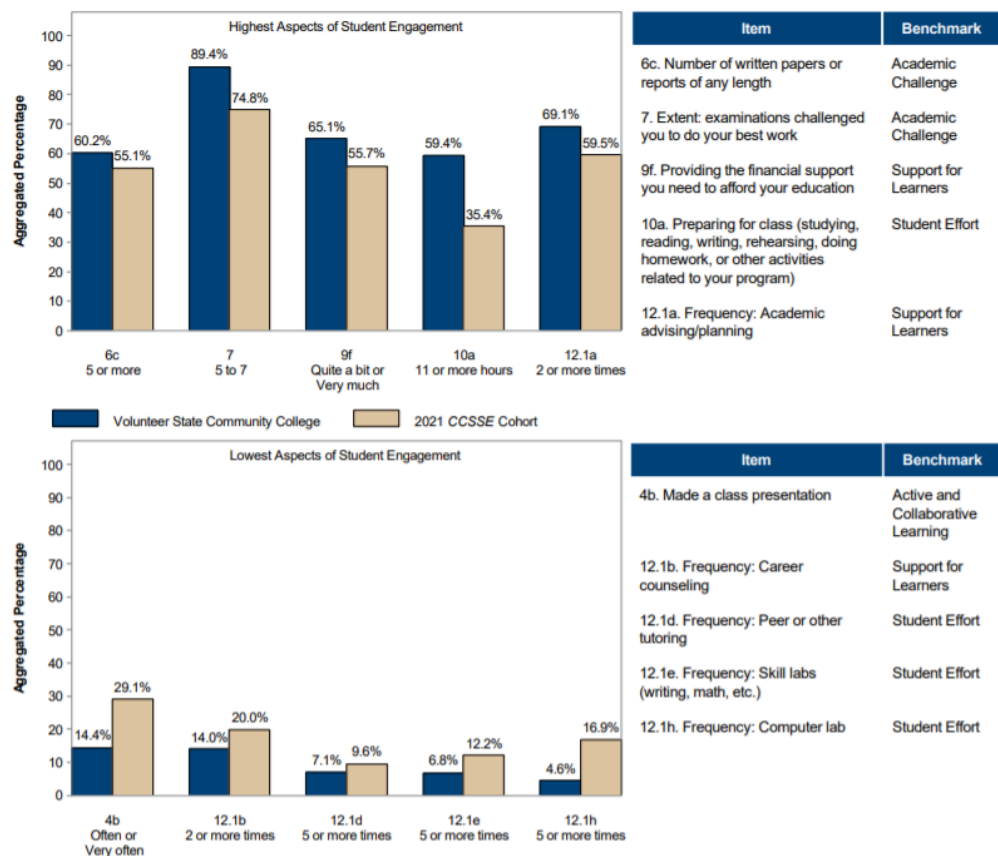


Figure 2. Vol State’s highest and lowest aspects of student engagement relative to a CCSSE Cohort. (CCSSE. (2021). Volunteer State Community College CCSSE Executive Summary of Results.)

Evidence:

- CCSSE 2021 Executive Summary
- CCSSE Student Engagement 2021 Vol State
- Implementation Plan 2013 vs now

Faculty and Courses

Faculty Usage and Development (optional)

May review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and/or any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

We have 25 full-time faculty and 10 adjunct instructors in the Science Department. We have several new additions to our faculty, with 16% our full-time instructors and 70% of our adjunct instructors hired during the review period. Full-time faculty members have an average of 15 TLE and 127 students. Adjunct instructors have an average of 7 TLE and 63 students. Figures 3 and 4 include the average class size, sections taught by instructor classification, and percent courses by instructor classification for General Education science courses.

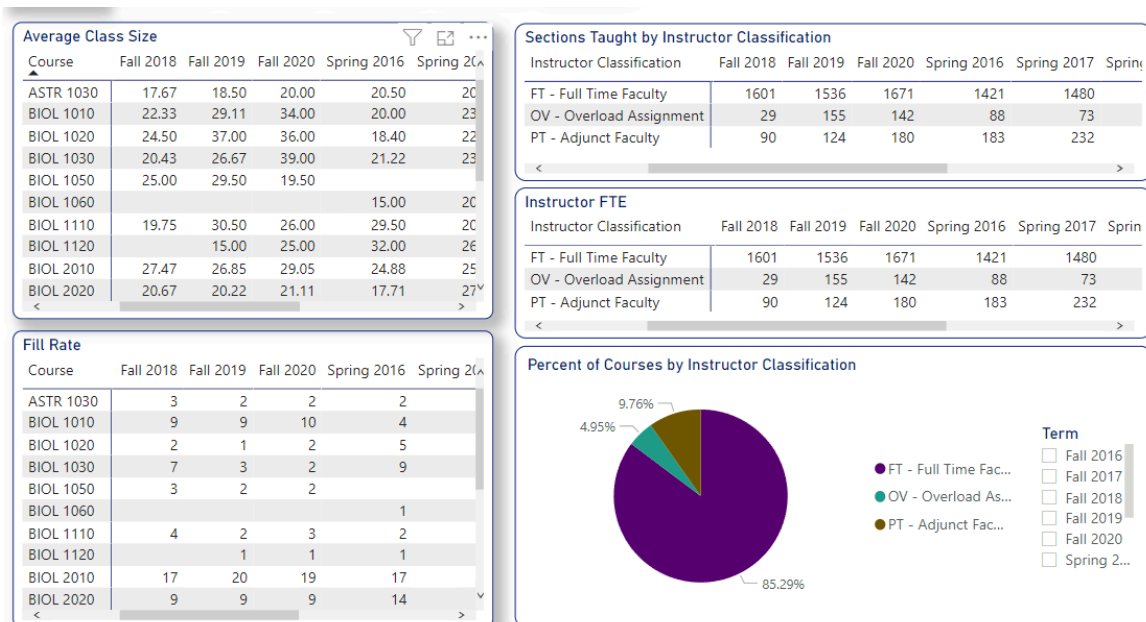


Figure 3. General education science course and faculty loads. All locations, fall semesters displayed.

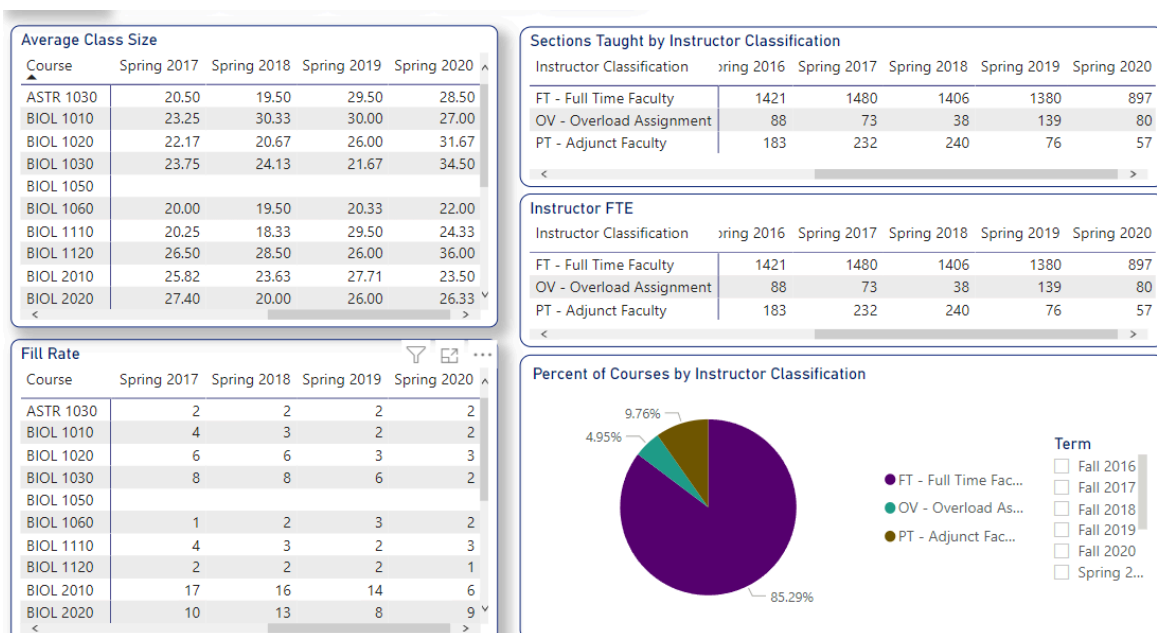


Figure 4. General education science course and faculty loads. All locations, spring semesters displayed.

Full-time instructors teach approximately 85% of general education science courses, compared to approximately 59% for the entire college, as indicated in figures 5 and 6. Adjunct instructors give our department flexibility to respond to changing enrollment demands. They bring an interesting perspective to our students, and the instructors grow both professionally and personally. We have developed great relationships with many dedicated adjunct instructors over the years who are a great asset to our students and our department.

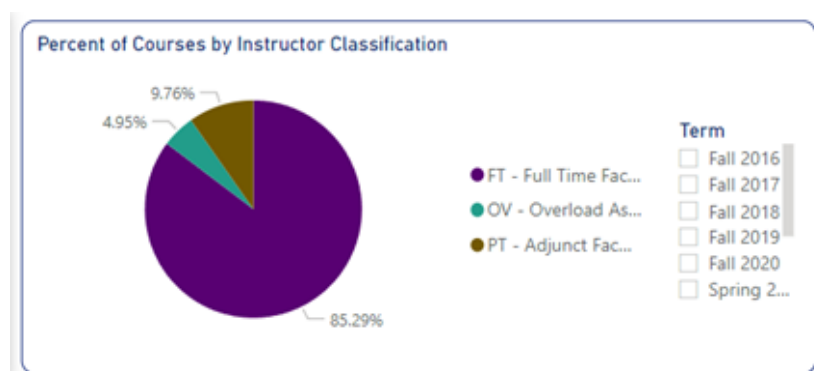


Figure 5. Distribution of classes by instructor classification. Science General Education.

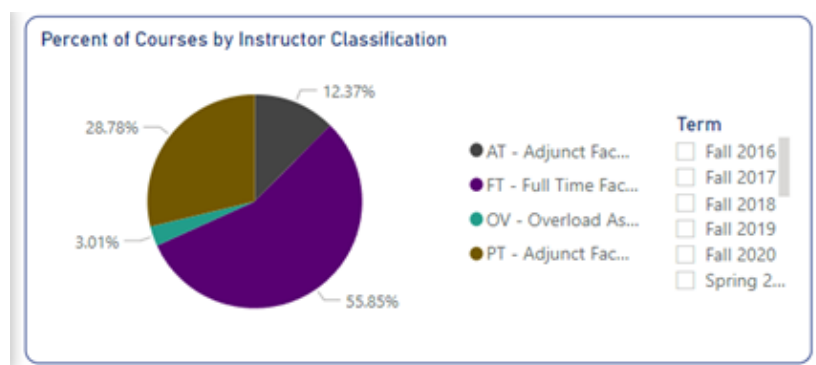


Figure 6. Distribution of classes by instructor classification. Entire college.

BIOL 1010 utilized the greatest number of adjunct instructors, with four online sections, and one conventional section at each of our Upper Cumberland locations, Cookeville and Livingston. Biology 2010 utilized two new adjunct instructors this semester to teach online, virtual, and conventional course formats. Figure 7 shows the number of adjunct instructors utilized in general education science courses during Fall 2021.

Course	Adjunct Instructors
ASTR 1030	1
BIOL 1010	3
BIOL 2010	2
CHEM 1030	1
GEOL 1030	1

Figure 7. General education science courses utilizing adjunct instructors. Fall 2021.

Course coordinators

All general education science courses have a faculty member assigned to perform and/or delegate tasks required for the maintenance of that course (Course coordinators job description, 2017). Course coordinators responsibilities include the following:

- Prepare and distribute an ADA-compliant syllabus with updated college statements and policies.
- Create a laboratory schedule and coordinate with the lab technician regarding the preparation and ordering of materials.
- Maintain eLearn model shells and course materials including, but not limited to, power points, laboratory guides, and comprehensive exams.
- Manage Institutional Effectiveness plans, assessments, and compilation of results from all faculty.
- Communicate with textbook publishers and the bookstore regarding course materials, textbook edition updates, and IncludEd, when applicable.
- In courses that utilize online materials such as Mastering, course coordinators are responsible for working with the publishers to ensure student and faculty access.
- Course coordinators may also be asked to create course guides, handbooks, or other materials.

Course coordinators are the primary support for new and adjunct instructors, and they were especially helpful during the pandemic, assisting faculty with the online transition by developing new course materials, eLearn shells, laboratories, and other resources.

The course coordinator position does not offer any release time or stipend. The department could consider providing benefits to course coordinators of highly demanding or high enrollment courses, such as A&P, or those who coordinate multiple courses. A reduced teaching load could provide the coordinators with the time needed to meet the various demands of the position. Additional job duties and goals of the BIOL 2010 and 2020 course coordinators are discussed below to demonstrate the need for release time:

During Fall 2021, Human Anatomy & Physiology had two course coordinators to manage more than 1500 students in 27 lecture and 40 laboratory sections. They work with 12 different instructors (10 full-time, 2 adjunct) and maintain eLearn models shells for online, hybrid, and traditional lecture and laboratory courses. During the pandemic, one of our A&P course coordinators requested CARES funding for two different online laboratory simulation programs. They built assignments using these programs and shared their resources with faculty. They also coordinated with the publishers to create faculty accounts and trained interested faculty on how to use these programs.

The A&P course coordinators are currently managing the creation of updated assessment tools to match the needs of our GER. They are also involved with the Gateway program and have identified student preparation as an indicator of student success in BIOL 2010. They are leading conversations regarding the addition of prerequisites, advisor training, and the addition of language in DegreeWorks to help students and advisors across campus determine if students are prepared for BIOL 2010.

Human Anatomy & Physiology needs a curriculum review. The laboratories should be updated with new activities and technologies. The faculty would like to communicate with our stakeholders to determine how well-prepared our students are for

health science and nursing programs and identify areas for improvement to help guide our curriculum updates.

During the Fall 2021 semester, our two Human Anatomy & Physiology coordinators had 16.5 and 19.5 TLE, with one being asked to take an overload due to the need for A&P coverage. In the first year under review, Human A&P had only one course coordinator for both BIOL 2010 and 2020. A reduced teaching load could provide the course leaders with the time needed to accomplish our goals.

Professional Development:

There are various professional development opportunities offered through the Teaching and Learning Center (along with co-sponsored programming with the Office of Diversity and Inclusion). In addition to traditional professional development opportunities offered by the TLC, science faculty are also encouraged to attend various conferences at the state and nationwide level, in an effort to broaden their expertise in their respective fields and their teaching. Faculty also have the opportunity to participate in learning communities to discuss various best practices regarding pedagogy in culturally responsive teaching (which is a part of our Gateway Course Academy Initiative through TBR). Along with all of that, we have several science faculty (5 to be exact – one being the Coordinator of the TLC) that serve on the TLC Advisory Board to develop and implement the various initiatives mentioned earlier (and some that will be listed later).

In regard to traditional professional development sessions, the sessions listed below are just a few of the opportunities our science faculty have participated in over the past 4 semesters. In the Fall of 2020, we had over 20 sessions attended by Math and Science Division faculty, and the same number was attended in the Spring of 2021. On average we have 3-5 science faculty in attendance at those sessions throughout the academic year. We also have some science faculty that present various professional development sessions through the TLC, which are also listed below.

In an effort to help faculty pivot to virtual and online teaching, the TLC hosted one professional development session almost every day in the Summer of 2020 (called the VSCC's 2020 Summer Series), ranging over a variety of topics – 15 science faculty participated. Along with that, we had 10 science faculty participate in VSCC's 2021 Summer Institute, which was a three-day intensive program covering topics on culturally responsive teaching, technology-enhanced learning, and "getting back to the basics".

Selection of PD Sessions Attended by Science Faculty

- Teaching Virtually and Online
- Safe Zone Training (all levels)
- Trauma-Informed Instruction
- Interactivity Tools and Project-Based Learning
- Student Success for Non-Traditional Students
- EdTech Workshops on Nearpod, Padlet, and Kahoot
- Learning Support Math Advising Session
- Faculty Advisors and Appreciative Advising
- Building Strong Brains
- Culturally Responsive Teaching in the Online Classroom
- Deconstructing Implicit Bias
- Identifying Microaggressions
- Successful Students Programming – Interdependence; Personal Responsibility; Connection and Belonging
- (and a ton more!)

Selection of PD Sessions Presented by Science Faculty

- Erin Bloom presented several sessions at the 2020 VSCC Summer Series
- Chrysa Malosh has presented various trainings on Teaching Virtually and Online since Spring 2020
- Shane Kelly offered a session on Calibrated Peer Review in Spring 2021
- Billy Dye presented a seminar on COVID 19 Vaccines in Spring 2021
- Erin Bloom presented several sessions and Girija Shinde presented one session at VSCC 2021 Virtual Summer Institute
- Erin Bloom has co-presented the Safe Zone: Basic training Spring 2021 and Fall 2021, and is slated to co-present again in Spring 2022
- Shane Talbott offered a session on Faculty Advisors and Appreciative Advising in Fall 2021
- Erin Bloom is slated to offer a session on Successful Students: Life-long Learning; an EdTech Workshop on Padlet; in Spring 2022
- Shane Talbott is also slated to offer a session on Student Services and Academic Affairs in Spring 2022

Conferences attended

- We All Rise in Fall 2020 – Erin Bloom and Maryam Farsian

- TBR Summer Institute in Summer 2021 – Erin Bloom (did present as well)
- IUPUI Assessment Institute in Fall 2020 and 2021 – Erin Bloom
- Transforming STEM Higher Education in Fall 2021 – Erin Bloom

Our goals are to increase participation in TLC-sponsored professional development throughout the year and to increase the number of science faculty that are hosting TLC-sponsored professional development sessions on our campus. Also increasing participation in VSCC's Summer Institute and Learning Communities. As the TLC has moved more/most PD virtually, we have been able to increase faculty participation from our other campuses. We have gotten great feedback and the TLC has really enjoyed being able to see faculty at these locations having the chance to participate. While we have seen a LARGE increase in participation across the college and within our Division and Department, we want to continue to gather momentum and provide support to our faculty, which includes getting them in the door at some of these programs.

As faculty continue to attend state and national conferences, plans are being made to host "lunch and learn" sessions to hear more about what our other science faculty have learned and what can they use at VSCC. The Coordinator of the TLC, the Science Department Chair, and the Assistant Chair are working on a program to coach science faculty to reflect on how culturally responsive their courses are and provide support to help faculty develop and eventually implement changes they would like to make.

Also in Spring 2022, our Gateway Course (Chem 1030 and Biol 2010) Coordinators will begin piloting small changes in those courses in the effort to close equity gaps, as well as continue to analyze data for future course changes. This is being done with the support of the TLC and the Gateway Course Academy Task Force.

Learning Commons

The science department began offering free tutoring through the Learning Commons in Fall 2019. Prior to Covid, all tutoring was done on campus, leaving students at the satellite locations with limited opportunities for tutoring. On the Gallatin campus, Human Anatomy & Physiology held "open lab" study sessions for students. Some attempts were made with chemistry, but there was very little student participation.

In response to the pandemic, we followed the Math department's model of a virtual learning commons to increase the number of tutoring sessions we could offer and the number of students we could reach. Figure 8 indicates the number of students who visited the learning commons for each course. Future goals include marketing improvements to reach more students and to appear more welcoming for all students who need help.

Course	Fall 2020	Spring 2021
BIOL 1010	4	0
BIOL 1020	1	0
BIOL 1120	8	0
BIOL 2010	52	65
BIOL 2020	2	50
CHEM 1030	23	26
CHEM 1110	30	13
CHEM 1120	0	22
GEOL 1030	4	1
PHYS 1030	10	6
Total	134	183

Figure 8. Learning Commons student use data, Fall 2020 and Spring 2021.

Evidence:

- Science Dept Course Coordinator Job Description

Class Offerings (optional)

May address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and/or discuss the impact relative to faculty and student's success.

General education science classes currently have approximately 3500 students enrolled in 148 lecture and laboratory sections during Fall 2021. Biology is the highest-enrollment subject, with more than 4x the number of students than chemistry, the next highest subject. Human Anatomy & Physiology and Introduction to Biology are the highest enrollment courses.

Subject	Lecture Students	Lecture Sections
Astronomy	26	1

Biology	1273	49
Chemistry	285	14
Geology	87	4
Integrated Science	15	1
Physics	50	4
Physical Science	27	1

Figure 9. The number of students and sections per subject. Lecture courses only, general education, Fall 2021.

The average class size for most general education science course sections is between 20-30 students per class. The college average is 21 students per class. Class sizes vary according to the subject and teaching facility, but the science department consistently offers the largest class sizes at the college. The faculty handbook states that web-based (online) courses should have a generic maximum of 25 students, but online science courses have a maximum capacity of 40. ([Vol State Faculty Handbook](#), 2021). The college could consider smaller class sizes to align with the other departments and so faculty can provide science students with more individualized support.

Online and Virtual education

The number and variety of non-traditional course offerings increased during the pandemic, with demands for online, virtual, and hybrid courses remaining high. Figure 10 shows the number of sections offered by format in Fall 2018 and 2021.

Semester	Conventional	Virtual	Online
Fall 2021	29	26	22
Fall 2018	81	0	0

Figure 10. The number of lecture sections offered with conventional, virtual, online, and hybrid formats. General education science.

Starting in Spring 2022, all online classes must go through review by Distributed Education. The process is described on our [Distributed Education New Course Development](#) page. Several of our general education classes have already gone through review.

One of our online course developers had the following feedback regarding Distributed Education and the use of open educational resources (OER):

"The development of the open educational resource based BIOL 1050 Master Course was productive. The Distributed Education Instructional Designer did an outstanding job working with both course developers via Zoom meetings over the summer 2021 semester. The Instructional Designer was able to pull the strengths from all involved to help create a course that offers the richness of current issues in the field of environmental science and maintain the academic rigor requirements using open educational resources. The Instructional Designer was especially helpful with various technical issues such as building HTML files from OER material, imbedding videos, and providing congruency among the lessons."

Scheduling

Scheduling was especially challenging during the pandemic. We monitored the schedule closely and made changes as needed to respond to enrollment demands, administrative requests, and faculty needs. This meant that schedules were changed frequently, and classes were sometimes changed after students had already registered. Faculty and students were flexible and accommodating as we attempted to balance the schedule, but schedule changes will increase confusion and should be reserved for rare and special circumstances.

Suggestions to improve scheduling include more involvement of course coordinators and an improved STEM schedule that allows students to take each course recommended by their program of study within each semester. New AdAstra software was implemented in Fall 2021 to project and track enrollment across the college. This may eliminate the need for a STEM schedule, and it should help us meet student needs regarding the schedule.

Satellite campus locations

We currently offer science classes at three satellite locations – Cookeville (CHEC), Livingston (LIV), and Springfield (SPR). We have full-time faculty who teach permanently at these locations and those who split their time between locations. Livingston and CHEC regularly utilize adjunct instructors, but the Springfield campus rarely does, as indicated in the figures below.

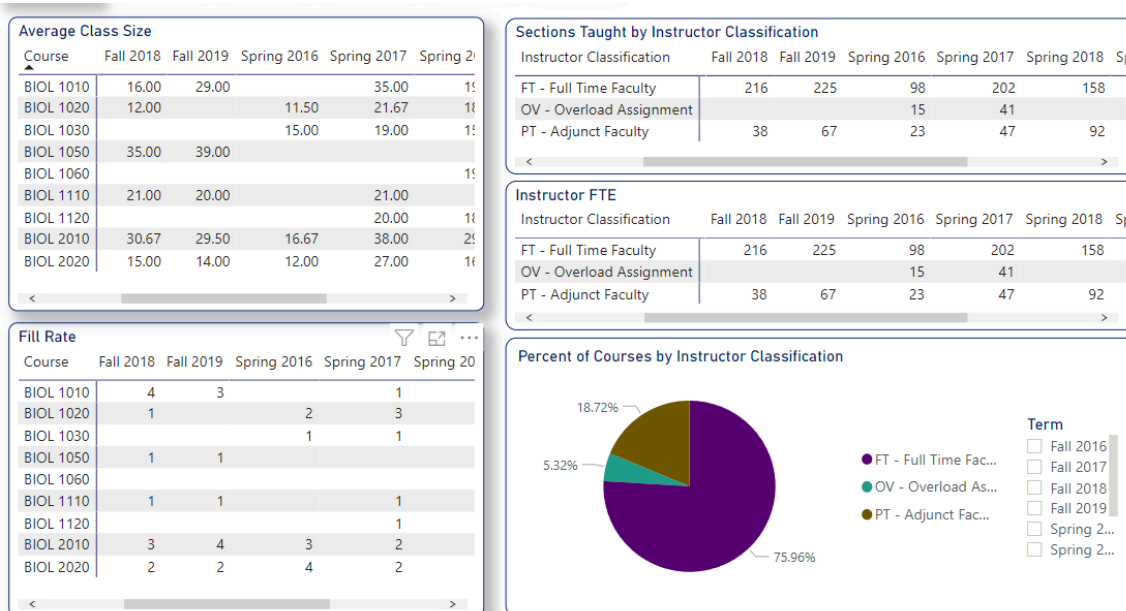


Figure 11: Course and faculty loads, CHEC and Livingston locations. Fall displayed.

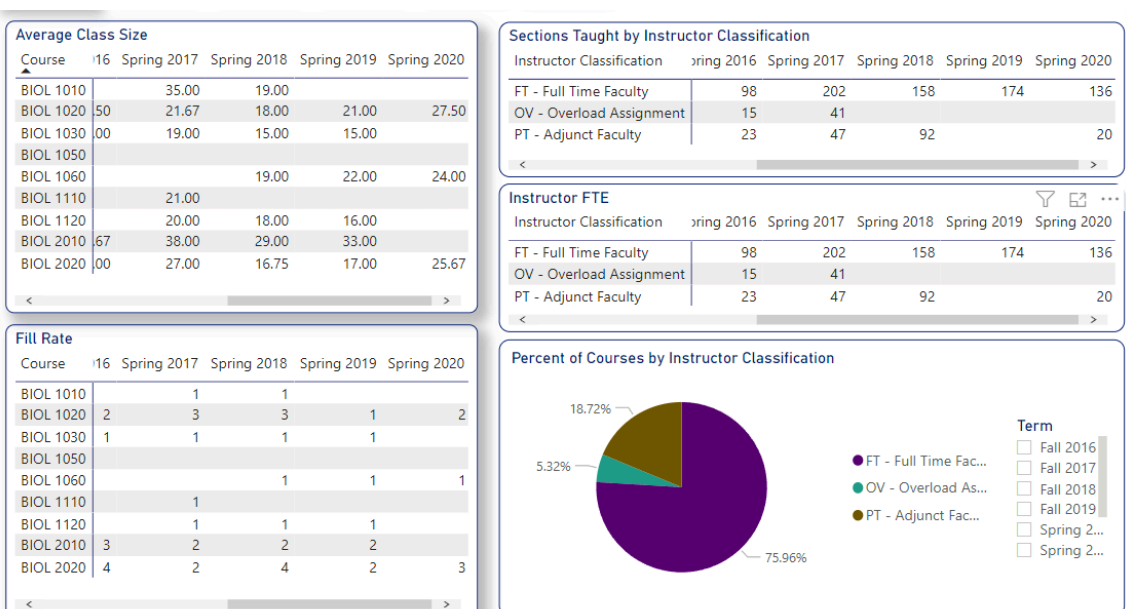


Figure 12: Course and faculty loads, CHEC and Livingston locations. Spring displayed.

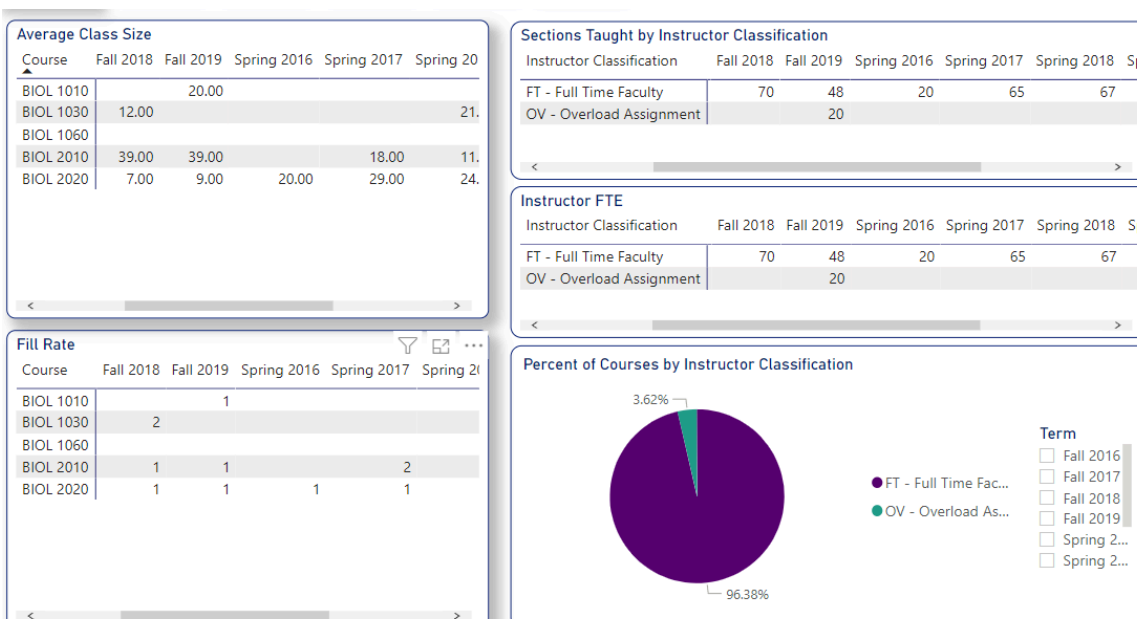


Figure 13: Course and faculty loads, Springfield location.

Facilities

The Warf building on the Gallatin campus was recently renovated. The renovations improve laboratory spaces, as well as provide more space for instruction, research, and storage. The renovations improve some but not all scheduling challenges, as we still have a limited number of rooms, and we must share some of our lecture space with the Mathematics Department. The renovations also provide a maximum class size of 35 in the Warf building, but science lecture courses usually have a maximum of 40, further limiting our use of these rooms.

Faculty report that the satellite location facilities meet the basic needs of students and faculty, but each location has areas for improvement. The diversity of course offerings is limited because each location is not equipped to offer all science courses. For example, the Livingston lab is not properly equipped for chemistry classes, so they can only be offered from CHEC. The CHEC lab is deficient in many areas, not only for chemistry but also biology courses. For example, there is no electricity at the lab tables, therefore microscopes can only be used on the counterspace around the perimeter of the room, requiring students to face the wall while instructors talk to their back. Microbiology cannot be offered at CHEC, but it is a regular offering at LIV. We are offering our first microbiology course at Springfield during Spring 2022.

Office space is limited at the satellite campuses. Many LIV and CHEC faculty teach at both locations but only have office space at one location. Most Springfield faculty share a common office space, so they may not always have access to a quiet workspace and a computer. Prior to the pandemic, faculty at our satellite locations were able to access their offices after hours, but now they lose access whenever the site is closed. This includes weekends and any weekday after 4:30 pm if there are no on-campus classes scheduled that night. Faculty cannot access their offices after 4:30 pm Friday until Monday morning. This creates a significant challenge for faculty at these locations, especially during the pandemic when classes are taught primarily online, and some faculty live in areas with limited access to the internet.

LIV and CHEC faculty do not have reliable copier/printer access. These devices malfunction frequently, and there are no backup options (other copiers that can be used). If a copier has an issue at Livingston, for example, then faculty may not be able to print or make copies for that day, or in some cases, a full work week. There is only one fully functional copier on the Livingston campus. This is the same for CHEC. If each campus had at least two fully functional copiers/printers, this would help resolve the issue.

As we return to on-campus instruction, not only are printers and copiers utilized more often, but we also rely on a scantron machine to grade some objective assessments. However, there is only a scantron machine at the Livingston campus and it is not fully functional. It will grade 50 questions at a time. If more than 50 questions are to be graded, any questions over 50 will be graded alone and not incorporated in the first 50. This results in two scores for the test instead of one. Instructors must implement manual grading to justify this issue. If both CHEC and Livingston could be furnished with new scantron machines, this would be an area of improvement. Currently, if our chemistry professor who is stationed at CHEC uses scantron for testing, they must drive to Livingston to grade the tests.

Additionally, the front door at the Livingston campus is labeled as accessible, yet it does not consistently open when the automatic button is pushed and must be opened manually. This is the only entrance for student use at the campus. If someone using a wheelchair needs to enter through that door, it may or may not work.

Scheduling and room availability at our satellite locations

The addition of the CHEC facility to the Upper Cumberland created a need for the assistant chair position to coordinate schedules between the two Upper Cumberland campuses. This has resulted in an increased ability to offer more science courses and optimal schedules for both faculty and students.

Classroom availability does not currently seem to be an issue at the Livingston and Springfield locations, but their ability to grow will be limited by the constraint of having only one laboratory room at each site. For example, one lab room is used for BIOL 1010, 1020, 1030, 2010, 2020, and 2230 at both sites. Adding an additional lab space would allow for increased science offerings at each location.

Room availability is an issue at CHEC, as TCAT and TTU continue to progressively acquire rooms at the facility each semester, reducing Vol State's options for room use.

Adjunct instructors at the satellite locations

It can be difficult to acquire and retain adjunct instructors at our satellite locations. The Upper Cumberland lost all except one adjunct during the onset of the pandemic. This one adjunct is versatile and willing to teach day or night. As some low enrollment courses are attempted to be placed back on campus, this adjunct has been assigned to them. However, we are concerned if these courses are canceled, we may lose our last, experienced adjunct. One way to prevent this may be to consider assigning this adjunct to a virtual synchronous course if possible. This could ensure that the adjunct instructor will continue to work through next semester and hopefully more often, as enrollment increases in the following semesters. The Upper Cumberland may also need a chemistry adjunct instructor in the future.

Accomplishments and improvements at the satellite locations

There are several areas where improvements have been made in the Upper Cumberland in the past years. During the last additions to the Livingston campus, each full-time faculty member received their own office. Previously, science faculty utilized the laboratory prep room as an office and shared this space. As well, science faculty at CHEC now each have their own office space. This is an improvement from the first few years CHEC was open, where all science faculty shared one office.

Another major improvement to the Upper Cumberland locations was the hiring of our laboratory technician, Patrick Kent. He manages all lab supplies and preps most labs. Prior to the addition of his position, science faculty had to prepare each lab, which was very difficult for faculty teaching multiple different courses and/or at multiple locations. For example, a faculty member may teach BIOL 1030, 2010, and 2230 in the same semester and at multiple campus locations within the same day. The addition of a lab tech to serve the LIV and CHEC locations has been a great benefit to the faculty and students. Springfield currently does not have a laboratory technician, and faculty must prepare all their labs.

Upper Cumberland Science faculty say they feel more included in discussions that affect the department within the past few years. They have made a "wish list" to summarize their needs regarding facilities and course offerings:

LIV/CHEC faculty wish list:

1. Two fully functional copiers on each campus
2. Fully functional scantron machines on each campus
3. Afterhours access to offices on each campus
4. The front door at Livingston is not accessible for someone in a wheelchair, most of the time. The door doesn't work consistently.
5. Chemistry lab at Livingston campus
6. One more Biology lab at Livingston campus
7. Fully functional chemistry and Biology labs at Cookeville campus

International Education

We have offered a variety of opportunities for international education with general education courses. We have a BIOL 1060 course planned for Japan during summer 2022, and we have a section of BIOL 1030 at the Livingston location that will be tied to a special topics course where the students will travel to Ecuador and the Galapagos Islands during spring break.

Travel was not possible during the pandemic, and it remains limited, but our faculty were still able to provide students with international connections through virtual exchange programs. Students from Vol State worked with students from Wuxi Health School and Hangzhou Normal University in China to solve problems for their classes as described below:

Santino Ladogana's CHEM 1030, 1110, and ISCI 1030 students participated in a Green Chemistry Project in which they wrote a 3-4 page paper and gave a poster presentation on a selected topic. The students from Vol State experienced global exposure and an international perspective on the future of sustainable living. They acquired skills on how to communicate with different cultures. For example, they had to adjust to the time difference and to speak clearly so a non-native speaker can understand them. The new environment was daunting at first, but most came out of the exchange program with a new feeling of confidence in interacting with people from different cultures.

Girija Shinde's BIOL 2020 students worked with 70 health-science students from the Chinese schools. Dr. Shinde provided the following comments about the Chinese exchange program and her teaching abroad experiences.

"The purpose of this exchange was to interact and learn several aspects (culture, health care, diseases, education, nursing profession, Covid 19 response, holistic medicine) with Chinese students, to explore the health issues in China, and to collaborate and develop friendships with the Chinese students. The objectives of this exchange were to identify the major health issues in the USA and compare the same with China, recognize the similarities and differences of the same health issue in different countries, learn the methods of treatment in both countries, explore any holistic methods of cure /prevention of the diseases, and expose students to solving problems on health issues at the international level. This exchange program gave a broader perspective about the same health issue in a different country. They learned how the same health issue is treated differently in another culture. In addition, some of my rural students also had email conversations about the lifestyle and challenges with resources in rural America. The students also shared each other's hobbies and schooling experiences. Some students also exchanged recipes like they requested kimchi recipes from their Chinese counterparts! Overall, it was an amazing experience for my students, but there were some challenges like time differences, technology issues, and language barriers, but the students gained innovative ways to communicate."

"Though I have offered the same course in each of my study abroad trips, I have always tailored it to match the environmental issues in that country. All the assignments, field trips, field reports were different for each place. So, it was exciting to be innovative and resourceful with all the available opportunities in each country. It has enriched my teaching and life experience which I share with all students at home."

“I am directing the study abroad trip to The Galapagos Islands during the spring break of 2022. I will be teaching a one-credit Special Topics in Biology course which deals with topics carefully selected to meet the needs of this specific group. The program site which is The Galapagos Islands will be a perfect place as a living laboratory for the students of Biology to study selected topics that are relevant to this specific program site. The students will study topics that will include the study of native and invasive flora and fauna, survival of the native species, factors responsible for thriving of invasive species, and the study of endangered and endemic species. This course will enable the students to gain firsthand knowledge about all the selected topics at one location. This would be a perfect location for the discussion of less genetically diverse species, the effect of the environment on the survival of the flora and fauna of the Islands. Finally, the students will also be able to study Darwin's theory of evolution firsthand. The Galapagos Islands is one of the dream destinations of biologists to study the invasive and indigenous flora and fauna in real-time. That is why it is called the “Mecca” of Biologists.”

Recommendations and Next Actions

Analysis and Summary

Analyze and summarize the proceeding sections. The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

The science department has a robust plan for assessing our general education learning outcomes. We utilize established assessment tools and have been collecting data for many years. The college has a new plan for learning outcome assessments, with an increased focus on individual student scores and reporting through the Watermark/Via system. All general education courses must also assess each student learning outcome, which was not a requirement in the past. These changes in reporting and the GER self-study have provided us with a valuable opportunity to re-evaluate our strategies and identify areas for improvement. Several courses chose to make significant changes to their assessment tools, and we look forward to seeing the results of their efforts and how individualized student reporting can be used to improve success and retention.

Science GER Committee members:

Maryam Farsian, Department Chair, Associate Professor of Biology

Erin Bloom, Associate Professor of Biology

Robert Carter, Professor of Biology

Clark Cropper, Professor of Geology

Santino Ladogana, Assistant Professor of Chemistry

Chrysa Malosh, Instructor of Chemistry

The GER committee consisted of faculty volunteers who met weekly from October 6 to December 7. We worked with course coordinators in October and November to introduce them to the new reporting system and learning outcome assessment requirements. The Science Department met to review the results of our self-study and discuss our GER plans on December 3rd ([Meeting recording](#)). Faculty submitted assessment rubrics to the IE Officer during the last weeks of Fall 2021 and the first weeks of Spring 2022. Our first assessments will be reported in Spring 2022.

Thank you to the following faculty contributors to this self-study:

- Erin Bloom - mission statement, professional development, and editing
- Linda Cathey - satellite campus locations (CHEC, LIV)
- Rufus Darden - Assistant Chair of the Science Department, satellite campus locations (CHEC/LIV)
- Mark Green - online course development
- Santino Laodgana - virtual travel abroad
- Chrysa Malosh - learning commons and editing
- Jonathan Martin - satellite campus locations (SPR)
- Girija Shinde - virtual travel abroad, international education, and satellite campus locations (CHEC/LIV)
- Brenda Wolff - course coordinators and online course development

Thank you to our Institutional Effectiveness and Assessments Officer, Jonna Alexander. She guided us through the GER process, attending meetings with our department, the GER committee, course coordinators, and individual faculty. We appreciate all her efforts to help the science department conduct our self-analysis and develop a sustainable plan.

Next Actions

The reviewer should discuss the next steps for the general education for the following two academic years. A plan of action and timeline should be included in the narrative or document library.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the GER timeline for approval deadlines.

Two Year Recommendation Action Plan

Student Learning Goal 1: Every general education science course will assess all four TBR learning outcomes. Currently, 76% of our general education courses are assessing some of the outcomes. 38% are assessing all four outcomes. We are setting a goal of 100% compliance in science courses, and 80% compliance in course sections.

Strategy 1: Course coordinators will develop assessment activities.

Strategy 2: Faculty will receive training pertinent to assessment tools.

Strategy 3: Course coordinators will work with course faculty to evaluate the data and decide if changes to the course should be implemented.

Student Learning Goal 2: Science department will implement a sustainable process to utilize assessment data. Departmental faculty will meet to discuss assessment results and determine what steps should be taken to improve student learning and to close the assessment loop. The strategic plan should include efforts to improve communication and collaboration between faculty members, which will improve the alignment between courses, subjects, and within the entire department.

Strategy 1: A survey will be administered to faculty to assess their feelings regarding collaboration and identify areas for improvement. We will compare the results to the past faculty surveys in 2007 and 2012 (results attached).

Strategy 2: Based upon our survey results, we may initiate efforts to improve collaboration among faculty to make the department and division work more cohesively.

Strategy 3: Department/Division leadership will work with faculty and course coordinators to ensure the assessments are meeting our needs and to guide discussions regarding improving student learning.

Student Success Goal 1: Analyze factors that bear upon student success and identify potential curriculum changes.

Strategy 1: Evaluate data from IERPA related to student success factors and consider if changes should be made to prerequisites, catalog descriptions, advising, etc. to ensure students are fully prepared to succeed in our class at the time of registration. This effort will be tied to our Gateway Course Initiative.

Student Success Goal 2: Science department will ensure campus facilities meet the curriculum requirements and student needs at all campus locations. Special attention will go to the satellite locations that have the greatest need.

Additional efforts to improve the Science Department and our Gen Ed courses:

- Deployment of AdAstra scheduling software, improvement of our STEM schedule, and efforts to maximize enrollment and space utilization while remaining sensitive to student and faculty comfort levels, as well as compliant with any mask or social distancing guidelines.
- Offer a variety of course formats and times to meet student needs.
- Improve support and consider possible release time for course coordinators of highly demanding courses or those who coordinate multiple courses.
- Support online education with the Distributed Education course development process.
- Continue to offer excellent professional development opportunities. The science department will make specific efforts to increase inclusion, accessibility, and cultural sensitivity within our course materials.
- Continue to support our satellite locations and find solutions to problems including enrollment challenges, limited office space and facilities, and access to campus and instructional resources.
- Continue to support international education opportunities and find new ways to expand the worldview and cultural knowledge and skills of our students.

Feedback and Review

Feedback (General Education Committee)

Presentation by faculty to the General Education Committee of the Program Review. The General Education Committee will provide feedback on the completed review and action plan. The feedback will be included and summarized.

Dean(s) Approval and Feedback

The Dean(s) of the general education discipline(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

VPAA and AVPAA

The VPAA & AVPAA will provide feedback on the completed review and action plan.

Action Plan Reports

Year 2 Action Plan Review

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should

be included in the narrative or document library.

Year 3 Action Plan Review

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

Two Year Recommendation Action Plan

Student Learning Goal 1: Every general education science course will assess all four TBR learning outcomes. Currently, 76% of our general education courses are assessing some of the outcomes. 38% are assessing all four outcomes. We are setting a goal of 100% compliance in science courses, and 80% compliance in course sections.

Strategy 1: Course coordinators will develop assessment activities.

Strategy 2: Faculty will receive training pertinent to assessment tools.

Strategy 3: Course coordinators will work with course faculty to evaluate the data and decide if changes to the course should be implemented.

Student Learning Goal 2: Science department will implement a sustainable process to utilize assessment data. Departmental faculty will meet to discuss assessment results and determine what steps should be taken to improve student learning and to close the assessment loop. The strategic plan should include efforts to improve communication and collaboration between faculty members, which will improve the alignment between courses, subjects, and within the entire department.

Strategy 1: A survey will be administered to faculty to assess their feelings regarding collaboration and identify areas for improvement. We will compare the results to the past faculty surveys in 2007 and 2012 (results attached).

Strategy 2: Based upon our survey results, we may initiate efforts to improve collaboration among faculty to make the department and division work more cohesively.

Strategy 3: Department/Division leadership will work with faculty and course coordinators to ensure the assessments are meeting our needs and to guide discussions regarding improving student learning.

Student Success Goal 1: Analyze factors that bear upon student success and identify potential curriculum changes.

Strategy 1: Evaluate data from IERPA related to student success factors and consider if changes should be made to prerequisites, catalog descriptions, advising, etc. to ensure students are fully prepared to succeed in our class at the time of registration. This effort will be tied to our Gateway Course Initiative.

Student Success Goal 2: Science department will ensure campus facilities meet the curriculum requirements and student needs at all campus locations. Special attention will go to the satellite locations that have the greatest need.

Additional efforts to improve the Science Department and our Gen Ed courses:

- Deployment of AdAstra scheduling software, improvement of our STEM schedule, and efforts to maximize enrollment and space utilization while remaining sensitive to student and faculty comfort levels, as well as compliant with any mask or social distancing guidelines.
- Offer a variety of course formats and times to meet student needs.
- Improve support and consider possible release time for course coordinators of highly demanding courses or those who coordinate multiple courses.
- Support online education with the Distributed Education course development process.
- Continue to offer excellent professional development opportunities. The science department will make specific efforts to increase inclusion, accessibility, and cultural sensitivity within our course materials.
- Continue to support our satellite locations and find solutions to problems including enrollment challenges, limited office space and facilities, and access to campus and instructional resources.
- Continue to support international education opportunities and find new ways to expand the worldview and cultural knowledge and skills of our students.

REVIEW OF ACTION PLAN:

The overall strategies of the science department were to reach a place where not only assessment was being done, but that the assessment was also meaningful and impactful for the faculty to improve the learning outcomes of their courses. The science department made great strides but will use the findings of this action plan to move forward into our next General Education Review (GER). The course coordinators worked with their faculty to develop assessment tools. The faculty identified test questions and course activities that measured the four learning outcomes to "close the loop" on the data collected. What the faculty found was that while the assessments were good that the assessments may need to be further revisited.

One course sequence to highlight during this GER was the Anatomy and Physiology courses. Over the years our student success data had shown that students were not prepared for the course. As we reviewed the data, we began to see a pattern where students

with an ACT composite of 19 or higher improved success as well as completing CHEM 1030 or a biology course improved success. Using this data, the science department changed the pre-requisite for the course to include either an ACT of 19 or higher or completion of CHEM 1030 or BIOL 1030 with a C or higher. The goal is to review this course over time to determine if the new pre-requisites do improve the success rates for students. This process really connects back to Student Learning Goals 1 and 2 and Student Success Goal 2. The work here connects to Student Success Goal 1 because anatomy tied to the previous Gateway Course Initiative as well as CHEM 1030 tied to that initiative.

While we were not able to implement Strategies 1 and 2 under Student Learning Goal 2, we have worked together as a science department and as a division to determine how we can connect student learning goals across the departments in our division.

While no survey was conducted, informally improved connections happened organically as assessment data began to be utilized more intentionally. For instance, the Anatomy and Physiology faculty consulted with the chemistry and other biology faculty to arrive at the courses added to the Anatomy and Physiology I pre-requisite. While the science department sees the need to further improve collaboration, efforts have been made to improve collaboration. Furthermore, the science department has collaborated with the math department to improve course offerings related to the STEM schedule to diminish the number of scheduling conflicts to improve degree completion for students.

Moreover, the area where the science department felt they closed the looped was under the "**Additional efforts to improve the Science Department and our Gen Ed courses**". The science department chair, the dean, and the assistant dean began utilizing AdAstra to impact some improvements in scheduling. We also have made great strides in not only returning to more on-ground from the pandemic, but we have worked with Star Boe and her team to improve or develop model courses to teach asynchronous options and hybrid options of our courses. While we have seen success in improving student needs related to scheduling, we hope to monitor success in both the improved asynchronous and hybrid courses to improve further to positively impact student success. These novel course offering strategies have allowed us to offer courses for our regional campus needs as those enrollments grow after the pandemic.

We have begun a remodeling effort to improve the chemistry lab at the Cookeville campus beginning our plans to improve facilities at the regional campuses. Moreover, the Maddox Building remodel on the Gallatin campus will create a multi-use laboratory for mostly geology use but could be useful for general education biology courses.

While we were not able to add information in our Year 2 review due to some changes in personnel, changes in IERPA, and movement of academic assessment to academic affairs which impacted some of our work on the project. However, the science department has demonstrated some successes with our action plan in several areas. Moreover, this GER cycle has allowed the department to make significant strides to improvement of student success, modalities of courses, collaboration between faculty, and changes in some course pre-requisites by following the data. The science department plans to close the loop further as we develop our next GER in our improved data culture.

General Education Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Social Behavioral Sciences GE

Reflection and Mission

Previous General Education Review

Reflect on the past GER (if any) and responds to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

The information for this report is based on a compilation of input from three different departments within the Social Science and Education Division; the Social Sciences Department the Behavioral Sciences Department, and the Physical and Health Education Department. The Social Sciences Department reported on Geography, Economics, and Political Science courses. The Behavioral Sciences Department reported on Psychology and Sociology courses, The Physical and Health Education Department reported on Wellness courses.

The Social and Behavioral Science courses at Vol State have not undergone a general education review. The departments underwent an academic audit in the 2015-2016 school year. Between 2017-2019 the departments conducted institutional effectiveness reports. This is the first General Education review cycle. This resulted in reworking some course alignments and dropping some courses from the catalog. The previous self-study produced data on learning outcomes, but since so much time has passed, it is believed this data is of little use to us now. See Section 3 for a discussion of recent assessments of student learning.

Program Mission Statement

Have any changes been made to the general education mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

Our mission is to foster the development of critical thinking in students. To encourage them to seek an understanding of the relationship between the individual and society as it affects personal behavior, social development, and the quality of life of individuals, the family, and the community; to examine the impact of behavioral and social scientific research on major contemporary issues in behavioral sciences.

Evidence:

- Mission Statement SSE 2024

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the general education mission align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

VSCC Mission:

Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering associate degrees, certificates, continuing education, and service to our constituencies. The College is committed to providing quality innovative educational programs; strengthening

community and workforce partnerships; promoting diversity, and cultural awareness, and economic development; inspiring lifelong learning; and preparing students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

The Social and Behavioral Science mission statement aligns with the college's mission by promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and meaningful participation in a global society. Furthermore, the department's and college's mission statements are both focused on preparing students to be critical thinkers and lifelong learners.

Student Learning Outcomes Assessment and Curriculum

Curriculum Map

Curriculum mapping ensures the alignment of TBR GenEd outcomes and student learning outcomes; which affords an opportunity to ensure course coverage and sequencing of outcomes in courses.

The reviewer should review the current mapping to ensure there is pathways to meeting the TBR GenEd outcomes for all general education students.

Narrative:

Program outcomes are derived from the Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR) list of Social and Behavioral Sciences learning outcomes. The Volunteer State's learning outcomes are mapped to align with the TBR outcomes. TBR provides 7 Learning Outcomes but only 4 are required per course.

Evidence:

- GenEd Social Behavioral Sciences Course Outcome

Evidence of Student Learning

Evidence of Student Learning

Provide evidence of student learning, and the program's effectiveness in reaching both TBR GenEd outcomes and student learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of assessment most recent results.
2. Analysis of trends.
3. Ideas of how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The assessments made between 2018-2020 demonstrated that the department was successful in meeting its goals for 70% proficiency for a majority of the outcomes. Outcome #1 was met by all assessed sections. Due to the switch to fully online classes during the COVID-19 outbreak, the proficiency average did drop across all courses, but the department was still able to meet the goal of 70% proficiency. With this in mind, and the return to more face-to-face classes, we expect the next round of assessment testing will result in a higher success rate.

After reviewing the data for this round of measurements, it has been decided that the next set of assessments will use more similar writing assignments across all courses to measure the proficiency of students.

The scores from the assessments for psychology, sociology, political science, and wellness were all at or above 70% for all outcomes.

Economics 2100, did not meet 70% proficiency for outcomes #1 & 2. The averages were 69 and 68 respectively. In an effort to improve students' proficiency scores, the instructors reviewed the material and spent additional time covering the material. Upon a follow-up assessment, the ECON students improved their scores to 76%.

Geography 1015 was the other course that failed to meet proficiency for outcomes #1 (68%), #6 (68%), & #7 (67%). As with the ECON classes, after the assessments scores were recorded, the instructor recorded a video that reviewed the information associated with the outcomes not met. An assignment given later in the term produced higher average scores (81%) using the same rubric.

Comparing the results from such different courses as geography, economics, psychology, wellness, political science, and sociology, has shown us that our next assessment tool needs to focus on the similarities among the courses.

Not every course was assessed during this period. However, the department did assess 11 of 15 courses and did assess 4 outcomes within 11 of the courses.

Upon a further review, the results indicate that the social and behavioral sciences have been effective in assuring students are meeting the course learning outcomes. The use of six different assessments tools was not the best plan. For the next assessment period, the department will use writing assignments and an improved rubric. The intention is to align our assessments to provide valid and reliable measurements.

Evidence:

- SS data template (3)

Faculty and Courses

Faculty Usage and Development (optional)

May review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and/or any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

We have 15 full-time faculty and 12 adjunct instructors in the Social and Behavioral Sciences Departments teaching the involved courses. Full time faculty carry a load of five courses and adjunct instructors are limited to four courses per term.

Approximately 55% of the involved general education Social and Behavioral Science courses were taught by full time faculty.

The use of social science adjunct instructors increased during the years under review. This was due to additional online sections during COVID. Adjunct instructors help our department in being more responsive to students' needs and to changing enrollment demands. Adjunct instructors bring a different perspective to our students. These dedicated professionals benefit from their service to the college as well as see personal growth in their fields. We continually work to strengthen the relationships with our adjunct instructors.

The Social and Behavioral Science Departments used the last two years to develop new courses and professional development opportunities for the college's faculty. Open Education Resources (OER)

courses are classes designed using fully digital textbooks. These courses provide no-cost textbooks to the students. Psychology 1010, 2130, Sociology 1010 and 1040 have all adopted an OER platform.

It is worth mentioning, Dr. Krista Mazza-Carter's work with the Learning center (TLC) has impacted faculty within our department and across the college. Dr. Mazza-Carter was able to develop, and conduct trainings on topics including: *Culturally Responsive Teaching and the Brain* and *Wellness at Work*.

Class Offerings (optional)

May address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and/or discuss the impact relative to faculty and student's success.

Recommendations and Next Actions

Analysis and Summary

Analyze and summarize the proceeding sections. The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The Social and Behavioral Sciences Departments completed their last academic audit in 2018. The reviewers made recommendations that align well with the GER and the two-year action plan.

1. Faculty should be more collaborative when designing assessment tools.
2. More focus should be given to connecting the results from the assessment tools to improve teaching and learning.

The reviewers approved of the assessment instruments used, but they had suggestions on how the faculty could collaborate more effectively. The reviewers suggested that the departments develop the next strategic plan to better align with the assessment tool and learning outcomes. They also want to see the documentation used to develop and design the instrument for measuring proficiency of content.

The auditors were complimentary to the faculty, but did note that some courses were more aligned with learning outcomes than others. This has become one of the priorities for the next cycle; collaborate on developing assessments so we can work together in planning which skills might focus on which courses for the term.

During this review period, we (as with the rest of the college) dealt with COVID-19 and the consequences of a lockdown, isolation, and the complete switch to online courses from March 2020, through August 2021. Faculty and students alike were pushed into learning, adapting, and becoming proficient with a 100% virtual environment.

Many instructors had experience with online education, so there were plenty of faculty to assist those moving into this platform for the first time. Faculty began using Zoom, Microsoft Teams, and created numerous pathways to success for our students.

For Fall 2020 and Spring 2021, several courses started using a synchronous approach. The choice of asynchronous or synchronous online learning was a good option and was well received by students.

A review of student grades did not reveal any significant difference in grade distribution between synchronous and asynchronous sections.

Next Actions

The reviewer should discuss the next steps for the general education for the following two academic years. A plan of action and timeline should be included in the narrative or document library.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the GER timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

The next steps for the Social and Behavioral Sciences departments is the Spring 2022 implementation of a newly developed set of writing assignments. These assignments have been designed to measure the mastery of both course and general education learning outcomes. Collaboration among the faculty has led to the creation of rubrics strongly linked to Learning Outcomes that align with departmental recommendations and professional organizations such as American Psychology Association (APA), American Sociological Association (AS), American Geographical Society (AGS), American Political Science Association (APSA), American Economic Association (AEA), American Alliance for Health, Physical Education, Recreation, and Dance (AAHPERD), and American Association of Colleges and Universities (AAC&U).

1. The new assessment will be assigned during the middle third of each course.
2. Overall goals for improvement include: higher proficiency averages for Geography courses.
3. Increase Geography course proficiency to 70% for all sections and all outcomes
4. Future improvements include: assessing all general education courses within the department and improving the effectiveness of assessments made. We will also review assessment data to become more aware of trends and patterns to improve curriculum.
5. Our expectations also include providing feedback on students progress to increase retention. This would be accomplished through increasing faculty usage of the ALERTS system and increasing the number of faculty that use the ALERTS system.

For academic year 2022-2023:

1. Improve Geography courses: the plan to achieve this mark is through increasing class assignments and discussions.
2. Increase the number of courses assessed to 100% of the departments. This will be accomplished by monitoring progress in VIA.
3. Increase the number of faculty using the ALERTS system. This will be accomplished by monitoring faculty use of the ALERTS system and communicating with those who do not use the system.

For academic year 2023-2024:

1. Provide opportunities for faculty to discuss assessments and assessment data.
2. Increase number of ALERTS faculty submit. This will be done by tracking the number of ALERTS each faculty member sends for each recording period.

Evidence:

- ECON2100 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083132
- ECON2200 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083139
- GEOG1012 Student Learning Outcomes Assessment Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083152
- GEOG1015 Student Learning Outcome Assessment Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083158
- GEOG2010 Student Learning Outcomes Assessment Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083205
- HED120 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083211
- PSYC1030 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083553
- PSYC2010 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083225
- PSYC2130 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083233
- SOC11010 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083256
- SOC11040 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 12-17-2021 083302

Feedback and Review

Feedback (General Education Committee)

Presentation by faculty to the General Education Committee of the Program Review. The General Education Committee will provide feedback on the completed review and action plan. The feedback will be included and summarized.

Dean(s) Approval and Feedback

The Dean(s) of the general education discipline(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

I have reviewed this General Education Review (GER) report for Cohort B (Geography, Economics, Political Science, Psychology, Sociology, and Wellness) and have the following comments and suggestions:

- Philip Williams has done an excellent job with a challenging task. His report was complete and thorough. It did require some minor editing, but this was because of the potential confusion related to his having to report on multiple programs; some of them not in his department.
- The Social Science and Education Division has six departments. Three of those departments have general education courses. They are the Social Sciences Department, the Behavioral Sciences Department, and the Physical and Health Education Department.
 - The Social Sciences Department includes the following general education courses:
 - History
 - Economics
 - Geography
 - Political Science
 - The Behavioral Sciences Department includes the following general education courses:
 - Psychology
 - Sociology
 - The Physical and Health Education Department includes the following general education course:
 - Wellness
- The Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR) prescribes two different sets of student learning outcomes (SLOs); one for History and one for the other general education courses mentioned above.
- Logically, it made sense to have one GER report for History and have it address the related TBR SLOs and have a second GER report for the remaining courses and have it address the related TBR SLOs.
 - It was this division of the work that caused some of the confusion in the current report.

At some point in the future, it might be advisable to consider a different approach to who prepares these reports. I would suggest the following:

- Continue to have the Social Sciences Chair complete the History GER report and address the related TBR SLOs.
- Because the Economics, Geography, and Political Science courses are in the Social Sciences Department, have the Chair complete that GER report and address the related TBR SLOs.
 - This would have the GER report being completed by the Chair who best knows the courses and the faculty who teach them.
 - Since the TBR SLOs are the same, this report should be completed collaboratively with the involved faculty of both departments and the Behavioral Sciences Chair.
- Have the Behavioral Sciences Chair complete the GER report for Psychology, Sociology, and Wellness and address the related TBR SLOs.

Overall, I was very pleased with this report. The above observations and suggestions are offered in the spirit of making the next report(s) even better.

VPAA and AVPAA

The VPAA & AVPAA will provide feedback on the completed review and action plan.

Action Plan Reports

Year 2 Action Plan Review

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or document library.

Narrative:

Year 2 (2022-2023) was not have updated since there was a transition in the research office and reminders did not go out. See Year 3 Action Plan Review for final review and results.

Year 3 Action Plan Review

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

The Social and Behavioral Sciences (SBS) departments introduced, in the Spring 2022, implementation of a newly developed set of writing assignments. These assignments had been designed to measure the mastery of both course and general education learning outcomes. Collaboration among the faculty had led to the creation of rubrics strongly linked to Learning Outcomes that aligned with departmental recommendations and professional organizations such as the American Psychology Association (APA), American Sociological Association (ASA), American Geographical Society (AGS), American Political Science Association (APSA), American Economic Association (AEA), American Alliance for Health, Physical Education, Recreation, and Dance (AAHPERD), and American Association of Colleges and Universities (AAC&U).

The new assessment was assigned during the middle third of each course. Overall goals for improvement included higher proficiency averages for Geography courses and a goal of course proficiency to 70% for all sections and all outcomes.

Future improvements included assessing all general education courses within the SBS area and enhancing the effectiveness of the assessments made. Another step was to review assessment data to become more aware of trends and patterns to improve curriculum. Lastly, a goal was to increase faculty usage of the ALERTS system. These expectations included providing feedback on students' progress to increase retention.

For academic year 2023-2024:

1. Improve Geography courses: the plan to achieve this mark is through increasing high-impact class assignments and discussions.

Results: The geography courses aimed to improve proficiency through a strategy of increasing high-impact class assignments and discussions. By implementing more interactive and engaging activities, the courses sought to enhance student understanding and retention of geographical concepts. The success of this approach was evaluated by measuring student performance and proficiency, with the goal of reaching 70% mastery rate for all sections and outcomes on the assessment. Increased assignments and discussions were intended to provide more opportunities for students to apply their knowledge, receive feedback, and engage deeply with the material, ultimately leading to improved educational outcomes. Faculty reported some improvement in classroom engagement and an overall increase in students' preparedness. However, the goal of 70% mastery was not achieved.

2. Increase the number of gen ed SBS courses assessed to 100%. This will be accomplished by monitoring progress in VIA.

Results: There were increases in total number of courses monitored, however Political Science/Government classes were not assessed in 2023-2024. The data collected has indicated the rubrics used by each course's assessment tool need to be reviewed and updated to reflect a concise and comprehensive analysis.

3. Increase the number of faculty using the ALERTS system. This will be accomplished by monitoring faculty use of the ALERTS system and communicating with those who do not use the system.

Results: Between 2020-2023 AY, the total number of Alerts sent by faculty decreased. The total number of faculty using the Alerts system also decreased. Analysis does show that some faculty did show a consistence use of the Alert system. Also noted are the lack of Alerts from specific faculty members. Follow-up to this report will involve debriefings with faculty to discuss the results and to make plans for improvement.

Evidence:

- GEOG 1015 SLO Report AY21-22-23
- GEOG 2010 SLO Report AY21-22-23
- alerts 22-24

Academic Program Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Associate of Science in Teaching- All Concentrations

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

Our Associate of Science of Teaching Institutional Effectiveness outcomes have changed, and no Academic Program Review has been conducted. Tennessee Board of Regents Associate of Science Teaching Academic audit completed in 2017. The Academic Audit fulfills reporting requirements for the Tennessee Education Commission's Quality Assurance Funding Standard 3.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The Associate of Science Teaching program prepares a diverse student population to transfer to a Tennessee Board of Regents four-year institution. For students pursuing the associate degree, the program is designed to prepare the students with substantial knowledge about children ages five through twelve, an overview of theoretical orientations that have shaped the education discipline, and a base knowledge of empirical teaching and learning strategies. Co-curriculum courses in the general education requirements develop the student's baseline of knowledge to prepare the student for employment in the field of teaching.

The Associate of Science Teaching program is an important part of Volunteer State Community College's mission to provide quality innovative education programs, to strengthen community and workforce partnerships, to promote diversity, and to address cultural and economic development.

Also, another part of the mission is to inspire lifelong learning and to prepare students for successful careers, university transfers, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

The Associate of Science Teaching program links to the university mission addressing community engagement, promoting diversity, economic development to prepare students for successful careers in teaching.

A change will be made after reviewing the old mission statement, and the new institutional mission statement. A revision to clearly align with the institutional mission will be made by adding cultural awareness in the Associate of Science Teaching program mission statement.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The Associate of Science Teaching program is an important part of Volunteer State Community College's mission to provide quality innovative education programs, to strengthen community and workforce partnerships, to promote diversity, and to address cultural and economic development.

Also, another part of the mission is to inspire lifelong learning and to prepare students for successful careers, university transfers, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.

The Associate of Science Teaching program links to the university mission addressing community engagement, promoting diversity, economic development to prepare students for successful careers in teaching.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

This curriculum map was implemented in fall 2021

Curriculum Chart: Sample learning opportunities and rubric assessments for each outcome			
Education Outcomes	Learning Opportunities (activity, course number)	Rubric assessments of performance	Achievement Target
The students will be able to explain historical, political, social, economic factors, diverse cultures, special education and integrating technology currently affect American education.	EDU 101: - Collaborate through authentic problem based learning activities. - Demonstrate and apply technology as an integrated tool in the teaching and learning process. - Create a multicultural lesson, and align to culturally responsive teaching. - Collaborate to develop a historical timeline. - Discuss and debate political, social, special education and economic factors in American education. - Explore the role of the K-12 teacher and decide whether or not to pursue a career in education.	EDU 101: Portfolio Presentation- Personal Teaching Philosophy and Narrative Reflection of Observation 1 & 2. Students will create an education portfolio in power point demonstrating the value the learning has provided that aligns to their teaching career. Portfolio Rubric embedded in eLearn Evaluation and Oral Presentation Rubric (face-to-face modality)	90% of the students will meet this outcome. Scoring- “Meets Expectations” on all levels of the rubric.
The students will be able to create his/her own philosophy of teaching including current issues, trends, legal liabilities/responsibilities and reform in public education.	EDU 101: Design his/her own philosophy of teaching and learning in a project- based learning group. (Examining peers philosophy and providing constructive feedback. Receive constructive feedback	EDU 101: Philosophy Paper- Relevant Aspects, Evident of Reflection and Examples (section of rubric) Students will formulate their philosophy in relation to the role of	90% of the students will meet this outcome. Scoring: “Meets Expectations” on a three level rubric.

	to make improvements). • Examine and explore the role of the students, teacher, classroom and curriculum. • Debate and compare legal liabilities and responsibilities in the teaching profession. • Discuss current issues, trends, and reform in public education.	students, teachers, and environment, and instruction that support them. Philosophy Paper Rubric embedded in eLearn in Evaluation	
The students will be able to write a lesson plan including the alignment of curriculum standards, educational outcomes, and adaptations for disabilities, predominant theorists and assessment.	EDUC 2210: • Explore Tennessee curriculum standards and the use of these in lesson planning. • Collaborative objective writing utilizing Bloom's taxonomy verbs. • Create a chart to Identify predominant theorist and apply their various learning theories within educational modalities. • Describe alternative learning assessments to measure predetermined outcomes, explain procedures for interpretation, and evaluating various tools of assessment. • Develop adaptations to differentiate learning due to the complexities of diversity.	EDUC 2210: Lesson Plan-Objectives, Standard, Alignment to Activity, Adaptations for Children with Special Needs and Assessment (section of rubric) Create a lesson plan including; objectives, standards, adaptations for special needs and assessment- scores. Lesson Plan Rubric-embedded in eLearn in Evaluation	90% of the students will meet this outcome. Scoring: "Meets Expectations" on a three level rubric.
The students will be able to compare and contrast a variety of K-12 classroom settings (including special education) by observing and conferring to pursue a career in education	EDU-264: • Compare and contrast a K-12 regular education setting to a special education setting. • Identify the accommodations and modifications for all exceptionalities, including assistive technology observed in the classrooms. • Examine and explore the role of the students,	EDU 264: Field Observation-Description of Classroom, Description of Classroom Management and Teach-Student Relationships, Description of Teacher Qualities Observed and Student Reflection (sections of rubric)	90% of the students will meet this outcome. Scoring: "Meets Expectations" on a three level rubric.

	teacher, classroom and curriculum. • Describe the teaching strategies to meet the needs of all students observed in the classrooms. • Apply information from observations; relate the classroom field experience to expectations and outlook for a career in education. • Identify classroom management strategies and examples of teacher-student relationship techniques observed in the classrooms.	Students will observe classrooms and write a description of the environment, behavior management, teacher-student relationships, and teacher qualities. Field Observation Rubric-embedded in eLearn	
--	---	--	--

The students will identify characteristics of exceptional children, multi-disciplinary teaming, special education laws and legislation, accommodations and modifications to address classroom	EDU 264: • Define the importance of the process of working effectively with a multi-disciplinary team to coordinate appropriate related services. • Analyze the laws and legislation with regards to exceptionalities, basic terms, concepts of special needs including confidentiality, appropriate assessment, documentation, service delivery, and ethical conduct. • Identify the causes, categories, characteristics of exceptionalities addressed in special education teacher interview. • Describe the accommodations and modifications for all exceptionalities, including assistive technology from the special education teacher interview.	EDU 264: Special Education Teacher Interview-Focused Topic, Content (sections of rubric) Students will interview a special education teacher and write a narrative paper. Special Education Teacher Rubric embedded in eLearn	90% of the students will meet this outcome. Scoring: “Meets Expectations” on a three level rubric.

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness is indicated in the continuous improvement of the student Core for Educators Math Praxis exam scores demonstrated a rise from 156.5 to 176.3. The analysis to these trends indicate the learning opportunities are helping the students to improve their scores and be

successful. The program will add strategies to improve this outcome and change learning opportunities to increase success rate. The philosophy paper outcome will be continued based on the new outcome assessment method, instructional opportunities will be changed to increase student success. The other outcomes listed in the chart will not be continued.

Data Chart: 2018- summer 2021			
Education Outcomes	Learning Opportunities	Achievement Target	Three years of trend data
The students will pass the Praxis Core for Educators Exam in Reading/Writing/Math. PLO 3	- Assign a grade for completion of the Praxis Core for Educators Math practice test 1-at the beginning of the semester. - Provide the Praxis Core for Educators Reading/Writing and Math practice tests on eLearn. - Students who score low, will be directed to the Learning Commons to get assistance to improve the score. - Provide students handouts and general information about the Praxis Exam, share these materials with Social Science and Education completion coach and the advising office.	Improve the Math mean score to 160.	2018-2019: 156.5 mean on Math 2019-2020: 162.67 mean on Math 2020-2021: 176.3 mean on Math Continue these learning opportunities to increase student success rate. Add strategies to improve in two year action plan.
The students will be able to create his/her own	Examine and explore the role	90% of the students will meet this outcome.	2018-2019:

philosophy of teaching including current issues, trends, legal liabilities/responsibilities and reform in public education. PLO 2	of the students, teacher, classroom and curriculum. • Lecture and discussion related to examining and comparing philosophies of education (essentialism, perennialism, progressivism, social reconstructivism, existentialism) • Instructor will demonstrate how students will incorporate the teaching philosophy in their teacher portfolio		89% of students met this outcome 2019-2020: 84% of students met this outcome 2020-2021: 87% of the students met this outcome This outcome will be continued based on new assessment plan to increase student learning outcome achievement.
Provide opportunities for students with multiple partner universities.	• Faculty contact universities to meet and share course information required for AST • Discuss advising options with universities to align a seamless transfer for students • Share materials with students to help with transfer • Contact and invite local private universities to visit education classes, communicate	Contact 4-5 universities to discuss a teacher preparation program transfer agreement so that students have multiple opportunities/choices to transfer.	2017-2018: 3 universities visited Vol State campus. 2018-2019: 3 universities visited Vol State campus Outcome was not continued. Collaboration with the universities continue to improve transfer opportunities for students.

	their Bachelors Teaching Education program, and scholarship opportunities.		
Develop embedded assessment items to track education data related to curriculum effectiveness. PLO 1	• Embed questions in fall and spring midterm and/or final exams • Contact Institutional Effectiveness to get assistance with tracking the data • Submit data from assessments to Institutional Effectiveness office each semester	90% average or higher on the 20 embedded questions from each education course	2018-2019: There is no student data at this time. Faculty made curriculum changes required by the State of Tennessee and online courses were fully redeveloped. Given the curriculum changes and update to the online sections, the embedded assessments were not developed and added to course assessment. 2019-2020: 76% of students met this outcome. Online courses significantly lower. This outcome is changed based on new
Embedded question: The students will identify major historical, political, social, economic, and psychological trends		85% of the students will meet this outcome.	

that currently affect the field of education.			assessment plan to increase student learning outcome achievement.

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Schools within our community partnership participated in our 2020 Employer Survey of Results of education graduates (managed evidence). All of the schools indicated that they would hire another education graduate from the education program. The employer survey indicates a overall 66.7% satisfaction with education graduates, with a mean of 4.33. The employers indicate that students/teachers strengths include that they work very hard to find fun activities and prepared well for students. Additional comments that would help to better prepare future graduates include; more skills and adaptation to working with children with individualized needs. This comment clarifies a need for implementing more strategies to help teachers be better equipped to work with students with disabilities. educational activities in the classroom.

According to the Teaching placement report (managed evidence), there were 31 graduates with 18 placement indicates a 58% of students completed the program and reported placement. Tracking of student placement within community partnerships is a need to improve the success of the program and was identified as a need for improvement. Community College Survey of Student Engagement (managed evidence) results share the highest and lowest aspects of student engagement. The highest benchmark for Volunteer State Community College was in Academic Challenge 89%, with a standardize score of 52.5- students reported examinations challenged them to do their best work. This report aligns well with education employers indicating that students work very hard to develop fun and educational activities with their students. This benchmark data and employer data demonstrates effective quality programming and students are successfully prepared for the workforce.

Education faculty completed a survey developed by the chair for fall 2021, 100% of faculty report effective collaboration with education faculty members, sharing of education resources and campus student services activities. 4/5 indicate that liability insurance would benefit students, and 60%

reported that background checks haven't been reported necessary by students in schools districts. The Middle Tennessee Associate of Science in Teaching taskforce (AST Taskforce) group have discussed these requirements for several years. Some Community Colleges do require and some do not, Vol State teacher education program has been partnering with local districts for many years. This has not been a problem, however, when reviewing the program it is necessary to collaborate, discuss requirements, and make changes if necessary. Education adjuncts indicated the Vol State Teaching and Learning center professional development opportunities, current teaching strategies, current trends, and virtual learning engagement tools are beneficial for training. In addition, training was reported as needed on current changes in the education courses to help improve communication with students. An eLearn education page to improve the communication of current course changes by semester and updated regularly.

Spring student course evaluations indicate education faculty scored a 4.6 out of 5.0 possible score on all courses. "The content of the course challenged me to think" (4.88) was the highest score reported by students. Moreover, "the instructor provided feedback on my progress in the course" was reportedly higher (4.78) than the overall Social Science and Education division mean. The lowest was "the instructor's use of technology helped me to understand and use the material in this course" (4.43). The comments include; " I enjoyed the videos for this course, they were very thought provoking" and "this instructor was amazing and kind- very helpful and patient throughout my injury and made this class as stress-free as possible- very quick to answer emails and phone calls as well"- each of these align with the scores reflective of the data. The online content of each course is on a current redevelopment cycle for approval every 3 years, and updated every semester. 10 hours of field observations are a requirement for licensing purposes. Continuous training improvement for education adjunct faculty to address use of eLearn materials.

Evidence:

- CCSSE_2021_5D858BF002_ExecSum
- Teach Grads and Progress Update
- VSCC AST Faculty Survey
- VSCC Alumni Survey 2021 (2019 Graduates)
- VSCC Continuing Student Satisfaction Survey
- VSCC Teaching A.S.T 2020 Employer Survey Results

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and

local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

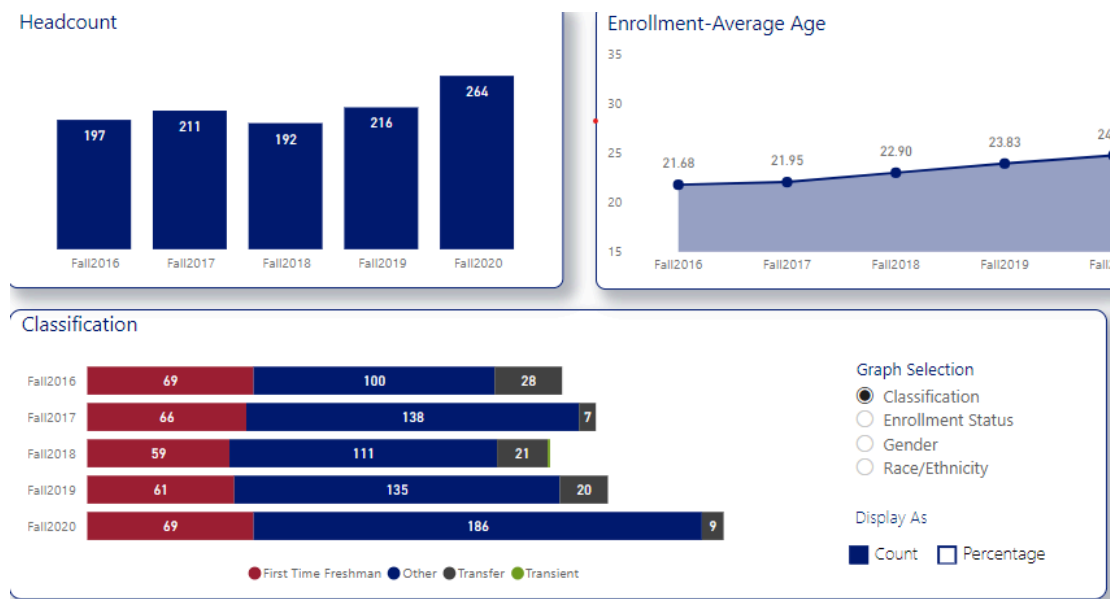
Narrative:

Despite the pandemic, the Vol State teacher education enrollment data indicates an increase in the last five years. However, lower enrollment trends in Community Colleges and teacher retention throughout Tennessee and across the nation is a concern.

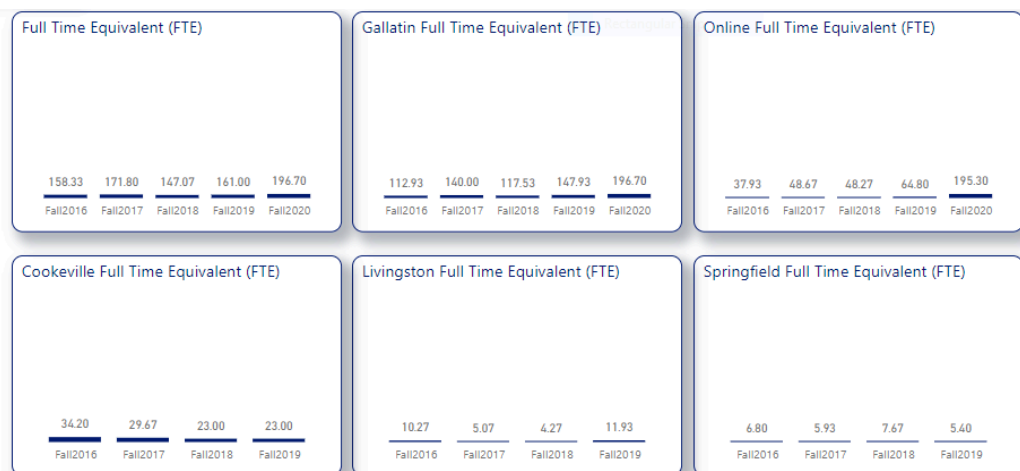
<https://files.eric.ed.gov/fulltext/ED608848.pdf> Recent data indicates enrollment in Tennessee Community College is down 19% overall. One of Governor Lee's Tennessee teacher education preparation initiative to address this concern is called the "Grow Your Own" partnership. This State of Tennessee grant, supports partnerships between educator preparation programs (EPP) and local Education Agencies (LEAs) to provide innovative, no-cost pathways to the teaching profession by increasing educator preparation programs enrollment and growing the supply of qualified teachers.

Vol State teacher education program is currently running a cohort of students through a partnership with Austin Peay State University and Robertson County Schools. Vol State education program faculty are continuously pursuing partnerships with schools to recruit and improve enrollment.

Headcount increased data demonstrates a 45 student increase from Fall 2019 to Fall 2020. The enrollment-average age has increased over the past 3 years, this could be related to Tennessee Reconnect state program, which began in the fall semester of 2018, which allows eligible adult student to earn a college degree tuition-free. The age increased from 22.90 in fall 2018 to 24.67 by fall 2020. Faculty share fliers and information at community events to recruit non-traditional students. Incoming freshman data indicates a increase over the last five years. The teacher education program faculty shares degree information with high schools to recruit more incoming freshman to declare the AST as their intended major. The program recruitment strengths include; recruitment materials that are shared periodically with area high school guidance counselors participating in high schools who hold annual job fairs. The education website is updated regularly, with degree options and programs discussed in a video- created by faculty. Over 2,500 8th grade students from Sumner County attended virtually the P16 Council Career Exploration Fair hosted by Volunteer State Community College last spring 2021. Industry representatives shared their future career opportunities through live, virtual meetings. The Career Exploration Fair promotes an avenue for eighth graders preparing to enter local high schools to explore a breadth of career areas and make an informed decision when choosing their courses. After meeting with career and education college representatives, students are better equipped to identify potential career pathways in teaching. Pre-COVID, Social Science and Education faculty set-up a table to promote career pathways in education and distribute degree information pamphlets. In addition, education faculty set-up a table to recruit new students during the 3rd Annual Hometown Hero's Festival honoring the local school teachers and staff. Education faculty presented program information to perspective high schoolers interested in teaching during Tennessee Department of Education Commissioners Teach Today tour. The education department is working closely with the Associate of Science (AST) taskforce group of Middle Tennessee Community Colleges to collect new ideas to form new opportunities to improve recruitment and enrollment.

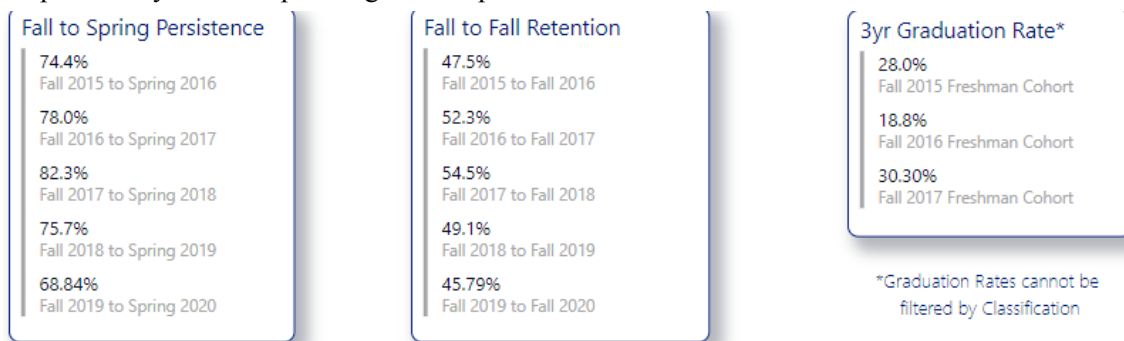


The Associate of Science in Teaching program's FTE enrollment improved significantly for fulltime students attending the Gallatin campus. There was a drastic increase on online enrollment- FTE of 147.93 in 2019 to 196.70 in 2020. This increase is pandemic related- due to most all course offering methods going online. Our Livingston satellite campus increased in FTE from 4.7 in 2018 to 11.93 2019. This enrollment increase could be related to a new education partnership program started on this campus. Our education "Grow Your Own" partnership program with Montgomery County Schools and Austin Peay State University started in Fall 2019. A cohort of 10 teacher assistants from Montgomery County Schools began in Fall 2019 and are scheduled to graduate in Spring 2022. Vol State Vice-President Dr. Brezina, Austin Peay State University, Social Science and Education Dean, and education faculty started collaboration on the new program in spring 2019. A five semester schedule was created, including method of delivery- designed for the newly cohort of assistant teachers.



The Retention rates decline to 69% from fall to spring, 46% from fall to fall, and 30% 3 year graduation rate. Student persistence/retention rates are an overall concern for the college at this time. Strengths to help AST students include; offering the Praxis Core for Educators math workshops, utilizing Vol State campus alert system, and sharing Vol State Learning Commons resources. Education faculty meet with the division completion coach and collaborate on ways to help prevent dropout and increase completion rates. Education faculty collaborate regularly with adjuncts to share advising tools and pamphlets suggesting adjuncts add the resources to eLearn announcement pages for every education course. Education faculty offered advising zoom sessions for education students, and

advising times during class. The education department program chair is working with Vol State campus faculty to develop strategies to improve the success of students.



The Associate of Science Teaching degree graduation rate data indicates growth in graduation rates from 14 students in 2018 to 21 students in 2019 (7 more students) and 18 in 2020. University representatives visit every semester to speak to the students face-to-face courses and share transfer offerings and assistance. In addition, the Universities offered zoom links and meeting opportunities were posted in eLearn online courses. University representative include; Tennessee Tech, Tennessee State University, Welch College, Austin Peay University, and Middle Tennessee State University.

Education faculty have a 2+2 articulation agreement with Tennessee State University. It is offered on the Gallatin campus and students report that they love the convenience and instructors. The partnerships and visits with the universities removes the uncertainty of graduation and transfer confusion for students. These opportunities are provided to help students graduate, complete transfer paperwork to be admitted to a teacher education program and transfer smoothly. In addition, the State of Tennessee has added a variety of licensure requirement changes and EPP program options for students. The data is a reflection of the continued trend in fallen community college enrollment and persistence/retention nationwide.

Degree	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020
Associate of Teaching	19	27	14	21	18
Total	19	27	14	21	18

Major	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020
Web Designer Level I	1	2			
Web App Developer Level II	23	19	1		
Video Production		1			
Veterinary Technology	23	21	17	21	18
Veterinary Assistant	10	10	9	16	15
University Parallel	461	458	508	552	560
Tennessee Transfer Path	191	232	282	268	310
Teaching	19	27	14	21	18
Sleep Diagnostic Technology	23	18	30	23	31
Respiratory Care Technology	14	30	17	14	11
Radiologic Technology	28	31	24	28	25
Professional Studies	1	2			
Professional Music					2
Physical Therapist Assistant	32	31	34	32	32
Paramedic		44	33	44	48

Core Praxis for Educators Scores 2020-2021



	Reading	Writing	Math	Mean
Mean Score	181	172	176	176.3
Passing Score	156	150	150	
Prepared by: Office of Institutional Effectiveness, Research, Planning and Assessment Oct 22, 2021				

Vol State educating students scored higher on the Praxis Core Academic Skills for Educators (Core) Reading, Writing, and Math test in 2020-2021- 176.3 mean average in all three require tests. In the recent data indicates students scored; 2018-2019- 166.3 and 2019-2020- 162.67 (mean average). Math and Writing are the lowest shows 150- with a required passing score of 150. A passing score is required for graduation of the AST program and entering into a universities teaching education preparation (EPP) program or an ACT score of 21 or higher.

Plans to improve recruitment include; attending Gallatin High School's Career Technical Education instructor's education advisory meetings, a currently new advisory board created by the CTE instructor. Moreover, the high school students enrolled their "Teaching as a Profession I, II, and III program will participate in a field trip to Vol State and TSU in the spring. Vol State Student Services and Social Sciences and Education division will conduct the tour, and speak to the students about the AST program options. Dual enrollment courses will be offered at the local high schools, the EDU 101 course is scheduled to start fall 2022 at Gallatin high school. FTE data indicated a rise in

the Livingston campus AST data, could be related to the pilot of our "Grow Your Own" partnership program with Montgomery County Schools and APSU. Teacher assistants/students will complete spring 2022. Vol State Springfield site director is recruiting students with Montgomery County Schools for the fall 2022. The education faculty are collaborating with the partners to create a new schedule, troubleshooting solutions for Learning Support requirements and delivery methods. Continuous improvements will be made to towards the new "cohort" selection and requirements and the program is working with another university (TTU) to begin the process to secure another partnership. Plans for improve the persistence/retention rates include collaboration with the Vol State math instructor who teaches MATH 1410 and 1420 (Math for Elementary Teachers) to improve success and plan a fall math and spring workshop to prepare for the Praxis Core Academic Skills for Educators exam. In addition, to better equip students in writing, education faculty will post <https://www.tutor.com/> in Learn and suggest students visit the Vol State Learning commons online or via zoom.

A passing score is required for graduation of the AST program and entering into a universities teaching education preparation (EPP) program. In addition, the AST program department chair has a partnership with a local high school to establish an education student mentoring program paired with Teaching as a Profession III students. Students who have completed EDU 101 and are enrolled in EDUC 22210 will participate in the mentorship program to help with persistence/retainment of the high school future educators.

Evidence:

- APSU K-5 2+2 Final
- Copy of Praxis Scores for AST 2020-21 Graduates
- EducationPrograms-Brochure
- Grow Your Own Grants in Tennessee
- Praxis Core Academic Skills for Educators (Core) Qualifying Scores
- Praxis Scores for AST 2018-19 Graduates
- Praxis Scores for AST 2019-20 Graduates
- Teacher Retention in Tennessee
- Tutoring for Praxis Core Academic Skills for Educators (Core) Tests

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

The education teaching faculty continually seek ways to set students up for success and impactful, high-engagement teaching faculty has been identified as one of these ways. A model course map was created to secure consistency between program outcomes, course objectives, delivery content and textbooks. Course manuals are updated adding the new course objectives determined by the AST Taskforce group. Course rubrics were redeveloped to align with new course outcomes to track key assessment data that lead to continuous improvements in the program. The course map, rubrics and data is shared regularly with education faculty.

Faculty teaching loads include; 2 fulltime education (one with doctorate degree and with a Master's degree- working on a doctorate) and 4 education (2 with a doctorate degree) adjuncts. The satellite Cookeville program, employs 2 of the adjuncts and 2 are located at the Gallatin campus. As education enrollment continues to grow, another education adjunct will be hired to assist with face-to-face and online course education courses. In the spring, a education adjunct's hiring paperwork will be processed to teach a new dual enrollment course offered at Gallatin High School. This opportunity had fostered through the community partnership developed with the Career Technical Education (CTE) teacher . Vol State education faculty has met with various local high school career coaches to discuss an education dual enrollment offering for the past, and plans to contact again for fall 2022.

Full-time faculty professional development include the bi-annually Tennessee Association of Colleges for Teacher Education conference and Higher Education Institute conference. These are each held every fall and spring semester, bring Tennessee teacher education program faculty together to update on licensure, state requirements, initiatives and trends in the field. In addition, the "High Impact Practices" conference is regularly attended by education faculty. The faculty share new information with the Vice President of Academic Affairs, Dean of Social Science and Education and education faculty. Education faculty attend professional development offered through the Teaching and Learning Center at Vol State and presented several trainings. These include; Adverse Childhood Experiences in Higher Education" 'Alternative Assessments, "Self-Motivation" and "Thinking Outside the Box". In addition, a presentation at the 2021 Virtual Tennessee Conference on Volunteerism and Service Learning on "Improving Community Literacy through Collaboration and Service". Education faculty member partnered with Vol State distance learning to present on "Digital Student Engagement" at the Tennessee Early Childhood Training Alliance conference. Faculty department chair served on Columbia State Community College's Tennessee Board of Regents academic audit team in 2021. Being an auditor for another school's academic audit was a great way to learn more about the process and what is expected when it is Vol State's turn. This faculty service will benefit the education program because the department chair is familiar with the self-study report process and the underlying quality principles as foundations of good educational practice. The education program will be up for review in 2022 and have experience with the Quality Assurance Funding Academic Audit Rubric.

The Teaching and Learning Center is a faculty-led center, designed to support and provide professional development and build community with other teaching colleagues. Several notable speakers such as; author, Rich Milner (These Kids are Out of Control) author, Flower Darby (Small Teaching Online) and author, James Lang (Small Teaching) and book studies, "Cultural Responsive Teaching and the Brain" and "Over-Come Bias" were attended by education faculty to improve teaching practices and self-awareness of these topics.

All full time faculty go through a peer evaluation by 2 assigned peers, complete classroom observations and required documents to division secretary. In addition, all adjuncts are evaluated by fulltime faculty, including a classroom observation and required documents signed and completed and sent to the division secretary. All evaluations are considered constructive feedback to adjust and improve teaching modalities, schedule, classroom climate and to benefit the teacher and student.

Evidence:

- AST Degree Curriculum Map
- EDU 101 Course Manual
- EDU 264 Course Manual
- EDUC 2210 Course Manual
- Fall_2021_AST_Faculty_Survey

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

Narrative:

The teacher education program offers a variety of course scheduling and modality to meet the needs of students at every campus. In the fall of 2020, online courses included synchronous offerings at an average of 21 students and asynchronous courses showing an average of 25 students. Spring 2021 data reflected an average of 20 students in all asynchronous offerings. Student course evaluation comments and education faculty input suggested only offering the asynchronous offerings for the spring. Students and faculty reflections indicated difficulty and adding more stress and pressure of COVID- thus, required to sit in a number of synchronous classes. Faculty and future teacher educators reported this format of learning was not the best use of time or align with pedagogy/best practice to meet student learning styles. Summer asynchronous course average was 17, typically, every summer 1 education

course is offered. Fall 2021 data indicated an average of 15 students in face-to-face courses and 21 in asynchronous. All of the education courses are offered every semester either online or face-to-face. Cookeville satellite campus offerings include daytime and night face-to-face, and Gallatin campus offerings are offered various days, morning, and late afternoon time frames. The scheduling and modality are considered and assessed each semester based on student course evaluations and faculty collaboration. These will continue to be improved to reflect options that best meet the needs of students to ensure completion. Often, a student might have missed a course or have a transfer that needs another hour of course work. The faculty will offer an independent study to ensure the student graduates and/or offer substitutions upon credibility of transferring college and approval from the dean of Social Science and Education.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

Faculty work collaboratively to provide quality, expansive workforce experience and incorporating best practices in instruction. Teaching and learning opportunities are rich. Service Learning, the use of problem solving strategies as a teaching method, the use of technology, and the availability to learn through international programs are components of our program.

The program is driven by the Department of Education teacher licensing requirements, which require 30 hours of field observations (10 in each education course). Vol State has a network of community partnerships who allow students to complete these field observations. A list of schools partnering is provided to the students, as a resource if needed. Through this network of school partnerships Vol State faculty have initiated guest speakers, service learning and work based learning opportunities. Collaborating across departments and divisions to support student success has been addressed through an on-going evolving service-learning project to promote early literacy called "Read Across America" changed to "The project this year included the library, english, education, foreign language and communication faculty, Over 500 new books were donated and delivered to 5 childcares in Sumner County. An event was hosted by the library and various social-distancing activities were arranged throughout the library, and the public was invited. In the past, Vol State students have held a used book drive on campus, and distributed the books as they visit early childhood centers and read to classes of students. It was certainly a modified version of this project, but was a great success! This project was selected to present at "2021 Tennessee Conference on Volunteerism and Service-Learning." Education faculty. Guest speakers include; Open Arms Care facility director, Sumner County Schools behavioral analyst, and Metro Schools special education teacher. Students are required to write questions for the speakers and reflect and apply the experience to their teaching career.

A "Future Educators" student group was started in 2018. A few of the projects include; collected books for the "Read Across America" project, read books to students and donated items to Vol State "The Feed". In addition, decorating of the teacher education boards in the Noble Hall Caudill building. International education students collaborated with Ireland students on several study abroad trips. A partnership with "The Presentation School" in Thurles, Ireland led to students from Ireland visiting on campus and meeting with new education students. International Education offers students a global perspective and offers an opportunity of education students to compare and contrast various education programs and schools to broaden and add to pedagogy of teaching.

In the past, education faculty have partnered with various schools to arrange opportunities for students designed to enhance student experience in classrooms. Two special education programs: Harris-Hillman (Nashville) and R. T. Fisher Alternative (Gallatin) both offer students a tour and presentation on each facility and the offering to students who have disabilities.

Evidence:

- Dr Seuss Flier
- Future Educators Student Group flier
- Literacy, Service-learning and HIPS...OH My! video
- Read Across America 2021
- SL Conf Pres 2021

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

The labor market for kindergarten and elementary school teachers are expected to grow 7 percent from 2020 to 2030, about as fast as the average for all occupations. About 124,300 opening for kindergarten and elementary school teachers each year, on average, over the decade.

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/education-training-and-library/kindergarten-and-elementary-school-teachers.htm> (visited October 28, 2021)

The United States Department of Education indicates a teacher shortage in most areas of secondary education; math, science, social studies, and all areas of special education and English language learners. [TSA \(ed.gov\)](https://www.ed.gov)

Emerging trends include a framework of primary partnerships with high schools to help more high school graduates prepare for, attend and complete college. The goals for this joint venture are to expand college access, to boost college persistence and completion. A particular focus on closing all achievement, equity and opportunity gaps to expand student opportunities and to build our education workforce. Gallatin high school and Vol State are working together to enroll education students in dual enrollment education courses. This early college experience helps illustrate college to help increase enrollment, retention and builds post secondary success- persistence in this degree. Vol State faculty and education students complete a presentation on how to to prepare for college and share personal experiences. High school students come on campus- a field trip to Vol State in the spring. In addition, education faculty visit and share degree programs to the Teaching as a Profession (TAP) courses that are offered through the Tennessee Department of Education's Career and Technical Clusters. In hopes of motivating more young people to pursue teaching as a profession. Another trend, as mentioned before- is the "Grow Your Own" program, as a means to increase workforce diversity. The grant is granted to public school systems and colleges to encourage more aspiring educators to pursue the profession and develop a local pipeline of well-qualified teachers who are ready for the classroom. Vol State currently partners with Montgomery County Schools, through matching scholarship funds with Austin Peay State University. This has fully funded 8-9 teaching assistants to become a licensed teacher. Vol State is excited to be a part of an initiative that we believe will help remove barriers and transform the important profession of teaching.

motivate more young people to pursue teaching as a profession.

Education Commissioner Penny Schwinn's strategic plan for Tennessee educator prioritizes three key areas of providing quality academic programs, serving the whole child, and developing and supporting teachers and leaders. The outlook for the field at Vol State aligns with this plan, in the next 5 years faculty will recruit partnerships for the "Grow Your Own" program with various prospective educators in our service area. In addition, Vol State plans to ensure our students are prepared to be successful in the classroom upon completion of their educator preparation programs- attending every Tennessee Association of Colleges for Teacher Education higher education conferences bi-annually and Community Colleges Program Directors (job alike) sessions. Staying current on current licensure, state policy changes, and new state education initiatives in the field and assess the implications for change and continuous improvement in the education program.

Evidence:

- Department of Education-Teacher Shortages
- U.S Bureau of Labor Statistics- Elementary Teaching

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Narrative:

The education degree is designed to create a smooth transition to all public universities offering a Baccalaureate degree in this major by guaranteeing the transferability of all courses. There are no course substitutions for the program.

The education program has a 2+2 partnership program with Tennessee State University offered on the Gallatin Vol State campus- with some online and hybrid method options for students. This degree leads to a Bachelor of Science Degree in Arts and Science; Child Development and Learning K-5 from Tennessee State University with clinical placements in Sumner County. Education faculty collaborate with local university representatives where students go after graduation to assist students in reaching their goals and enhance the likelihood of success.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

In the last 3 years, here are some trends we found; effective faculty collaboration, positive and high scores from students on our course evaluations and improved enrollment. Education faculty at Vol State collaboration and faculty involvement in the AST Taskforce has made continuous improvement and changes to the program. Student evaluations indicated that faculty build strong student-teacher relationships, quick to communicate feedback, and course content was challenging. The feedback from students aligned with the employer survey results. The positive implications of this data indicate a program strength in faculty usage and development. Although, Community College and teacher retention through Tennessee is a concern. The enrollment has increased in the education program in the last 3 years. Recruiting efforts, The Grow Your Own Program, and partnering with local community organizations and schools efforts are some of the positive efforts for possible implications of the program increase.

Retention rates have declined to 69% in the last 3 years indicating that student success rate is a weakness of the program. Strategies to improve student persistence and retention will be addressed in the 2 year plan. Efforts include; Praxis Core for Educators workshops, collaboration with division completion coach, utilizing alert system and Learning Common resources are positive- yet, just not working. One of our student outcomes addressed the Praxis Core for Educators Test and the need for improvement on the Math scores and successful passing of this exam for completion. The scores increased from 162.67 in fall 2019-2020 to 176.3 in 2020-2021. Identifying specific program course

student success rates such as; Math 1410 and Math 1420 will be a new plan of action to help students complete the program. Implications of the teacher placement report indicate 58% of students completed and reported placement. Tracking of student placement is an area weakness in the program and identified as a need for improvement. Building strong community partners in local schools and emphasizing the benefits of reporting/completing student placement surveys to demonstrate student success rates and placement data results.

A new assessment plan to increase student learning outcome achievement has been developed. The embedded tests placed in the education courses were removed and changed to alternative assessments in each course to improve student success and make continuous improvements in the program.

Evidence:

- AST Data Chart 2018-2021

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

2 Year Recommendation Action Plan

Student Success Recommendation

1. Increase Job Placement rates for education majors.
 - Faculty monitor first of each month
 - Communicate to future educators the purpose of completing the Graduated Satisfaction and 6 months later the Job Placement survey (contacted 3 times within 6 months)
 - Share a copy of the Job Placement survey to showcase to the classroom

Timeline: October 31, 2021 - October 31, 2022

- Is the number of Job Placement survey completions improved implementing these action steps? If not, what steps can be determined to improve?

Timeline: October 31, 2021 - October 31, 2023

- Steps necessary to make continuous improvement in tracking student success

Student Success Recommendation

2. Increase Praxis for Educators exam support for education majors
 - Schedule Math Praxis Core for Educators workshops every mid-semester
 - Share information with division completion coach, faculty and the advising center
 - Offer ZOOM for satellite campus students

Timeline: November 1, 2021 - July 1, 2022

- Track attendance in the workshops and gather student feedback from education faculty. Make changes necessary for continuous improvement

Timeline: July 1, 2022 - July 1, 2023

- Steps necessary to make continuous improvement in student success

Student Success Recommendation

3. Increase success in MATH 1410 and MATH 1420 for education majors

- Obtain data each semester from IERPA office to review- to track success
- Contact math faculty teaching to brainstorm improving student success
- Increase usage of the Learning Center for these courses

Timeline: July 1, 2021 - July 1, 2022

- Can the student success rates improved as a result of these action step? If not, what steps can be determined to improve?

Timeline: July 1, 2022 - July 1, 2023

- Steps necessary for improve student success in these courses

Student Learning Recommendation

1. Increase Grow Your Own partnerships, and improve the Springfield satellite campus current program

- Explore partnerships with Tennessee Tech University
- Collaborate with Springfield director and faculty to make accommodations for students, alter schedule and methods of delivery

Timelines: August 2021 - July 1, 2022

- Meet with TTU to discuss grant partnership and plan
- Make changes necessary to recruit and improve Springfield satellite new cohort

Timelines: July 1, 2022 - July 1, 2023

- Develop a Grow Your Own program with TTU, Putnam County Schools and Vol State
- Continuous improvements to Grow Your Own program located on Springfield satellite campus

Student Learning Recommendation

2. Increase Student Learning Outcome achievement based on the new assessment plan

- Collaborate with faculty to change or alter assessments to improve student scores
- Analyze student course evaluations to make improvements to course assessments
- Develop new assessment when students master student learning outcomes

Timelines: August 2021 - August 2022

- Meet with education faculty bi-annually to discuss assessment results
- Analyze data to make continuous improvements

Timelines: August 2022 - August 2023

- Steps necessary to make continuous improvements on the Student Learning Outcomes for the education courses and/or develop new ones to monitor

Evidence:

- 2021 Job Placement Survey
- 2021 Graduate Job Placement Survey
- APSU K-5 2+2 Final
- Praxis Math Workshop

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

I have reviewed the information and documentation provided for the AST APR. Not only do I approve, I commend the Education Department's faculty for providing such a thorough, accurate, and comprehensive analysis of their AST programs. This no doubt took a significant commitment of time and energy. It is an example of a job done well..

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment has reviewed this report and will begin supporting the report champion in preparing for the presentation of this review to the Institutional Effectiveness Committee.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed, and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Increase the job placement rates for education majors	Communicated with current students the teacher shortage and job placement is in high demands	The fact book has been in the process of being reconstructed and improved- data was not provided.	Faculty results are monitored and shared with current students in March.	Due to a national teacher shortage, the field of teaching is in high demand. The PL1 has been met. The job placement rates were 100%.
2	Increase Praxis Core for Educators Math score.	A Math Praxis Core workshop held in February by Math department (Shelly Fenton) to practice/study.	There were 2-3 students who participated and indicated that it was very helpful- scheduling is a challenge.	Due to lack of attendance would change the ground workshop to providing online resources and study guides for students. In addition, Learning Commons resources. Develop a handout with the Praxis steps to study and prepare resources.	Math scores for spring and fall 2023 indicate a mean score of 162- above the passing score requirement of 150. Writing scores for spring and fall 2023 indicate a mean score of 168.5- above the passing score requirement of 156. Reading scores for spring and fall 2023 indicate a mean score of 175- above the passing score of 162. Continue PL2
3	Increase Math 1410 and 1420 grades for education students	Worked with Math & Science chairs and arranged the AST schedule and methods of offerings. In addition, collaborated with Learning Commons director to assign students to take the EdReady to prepare them for Math.	Students need to take face-to-face Math classes and seek the learning commons resources to improve grades.	Continue to work with the math chair and learning commons.	Math 1010: 60% pass Math 1410: 72% pass Continue the PL3
4	Increase Grow Your Own partnerships, and improve the Springfield satellite campus current program	Held an interest meeting with Robertson County Schools and Putnam County Schools. Developed a MOU with both school districts. Completed an Appendix A form with Tennessee Grow Your Own center to	Advising the cohort is time consuming. I have scheduled ZOOM meetings on a regular semester schedule to schedule at one time. The admittance process was difficult- created a handout of	Schedule and meet with students in a group on ZOOM more often, and additional help advising. Collaborate with department chairs to develop the	19 students are currently enrolled in the Robertson County AST cohort, with 5 more additions. 10 students are currently admitted into the Putnam County cohort to start in the Fall. An interest meeting will be

	become a registered apprenticeship college.	steps, MOU and contacted the business office and bookstore.	schedule for each semester.	scheduled for Overton County in April or May. Continue to expand and develop the GYO cohort partnerships in PLO4.
--	---	---	-----------------------------	---

Evidence:

- 2021 Job Placement Survey
- 2021_Graduate_Job_Placement_Survey
- Praxis Math Workshop

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
1	Increase the job placement rates for education majors	Communicated with current students the teacher shortage and job placement is in high demands	There was a RASI change the data was not provided.	Faculty results are monitored and shared with current students in March	No There was no job placement data. A principal survey was created with RASI to be sent to school districts Continue PL!
2	Increase Praxis Core for Educators Math score.	Department Chair shared Praxis Core ZOOM links and information for workshop held at Chattanooga State by STEA to practice/study. ETS Praxis Study Materials provided to advising and faculty to share with AST students	There were a few students who participated and indicated that it was very helpful- scheduling is a challenge. Grow YOUR OWN students indicated a need to more study materials and in person tutoring.	VSCC Learning Commons offered a new resource "Peterson's Test and Career Prep Praxis" In addition, shared ZOOM and ground one-on-one tutoring schedule. Developed an additional handout and	Math scores for spring and fall 2023 indicate a mean score of 162- above the passing score requirement of 150. Writing scores for spring and fall 2023 indicate a mean score of 168.5- above the passing score requirement of 168.5 Reading scores for spring and fall

				shared with advising and education faculty.	2023 indicate a mean score of 175- above the passing score of 162. Continue PL2
3	Increase Math 1410 and 1420 grades/success for education students	Worked with Math & Science chairs and arranged the AST schedule and methods of offerings. In addition, collaborated with Learning Commons director to assign students to take the EdReady to prepare them for Math.	Students need to take face-to-face Math classes and seek the learning commons resources to improve grades	Continue to work with the math chair and learning commons.	Collaborated with the Math Instructor to methods and instruction to help education students be successful. Align with Tennessee Academic Learning Standards. Continue PL3
4	Increase Grow Your Own partnerships, and improve all satellite campus current program	Held an interest meeting with Robertson County Schools and Putnam County Schools. Developed a MOU with both school districts. Completed an Appendix A form with Tennessee Grow Your Own center to become a registered apprenticeship college.	Advising the cohort is time consuming. I have scheduled ZOOM meetings on a regular semester schedule to schedule at one time. The admittance process was difficult- created a handout of steps, MOU and contacted the business office and bookstore.	Schedule and meet with students in a group on ZOOM more often, and additional help advising. Collaborate with department chairs to develop the schedule for each semester. Collaborate with Workforce Development, Marketing and Learning Commons	19 students are graduating in the Robertson County first AST cohort, with 8 more additions. 8 students are currently admitted into the first Putnam County cohort. GYO Interest meeting was held in January 2025 to add 10 more students in cohort 2. Overton County has 5 in cohort 1. April or May. Continue to expand and develop the GYO cohort partnerships in PLO4.
4					

Academic Program Review Cohort B- Cycle 1

Early Childhood Education CERT

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

Our Associate of Science of Teaching Institutional Effectiveness outcomes have changed, and no Academic Program Review has been conducted. Tennessee Board of Regents Associate of Science Teaching Academic audit completed in 2017.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

This career program is designed to prepare students for entry and advancement in the early childhood education profession. Students can work for an associate of applied science degree or a technical certificate in early childhood education. Graduates of this degree program may also be able to transfer to a four year university and complete the baccalaureate degree in early childhood education.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The Early Childhood Education technical certificate is an important part of Volunteer State Community College's mission to provide quality innovative education programs, to strengthen community and workforce partnerships, to promote diversity, and to address cultural and economic development. Also, another part of the mission is to inspire lifelong learning and to prepare students for successful careers, university transfers, and meaningful civic participation in a global society. The Associate of Science Teaching program links to the university mission addressing community engagement, promoting diversity, economic development to prepare students for successful careers in teaching.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

This curriculum map was implemented in Fall of 2021 Early Childhood Technical Certificate

Education Outcomes	Learning Opportunities	Achievement Target	Three years of data trend
The students will describe the historical, philosophical, and social aspects of early childhood education.	• Students in ECED 1310 will examine various components of early childhood education (history, philosophies, etc.) • Instructor will facilitate lectures and activities directly related to these topics. • Students will complete discussions and journal activities. • Report on websites related to multiple influences on development and learning. (NAEYC, Zero to Three). • Develop a narrative of the historical, philosophical, and social aspects of the early childhood site observ	85% of students meet expectations	
The students will define the basic components of setting up an early childhood education environment.	• Students in ECED 1310 will complete an early childhood learning environment. • Instructor will lecture and provide activities that support an understanding of setting up an early childhood environment. • Lecture and modeling of creating an early childhood activity plan.	90% of students meet expectations	

	• Define basic components of the site set-up, play activities, schedule, and early childhood stages.		
The students will examine and compare different types of early childhood programs and align with various theoretical curriculum models.	• Students in ECED 2315 will complete an observation and write a narrative of an early childhood program of their choice. • Instructor will lecture and provide learning activities on the various early childhood curriculums. • Students will complete discussions and journal activities. • Examine and compare the different types of early childhood programs (Head Start, Montessori, Public, Private).	95% of students meet expectations	

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

Due to this being the first Academic Program Review plan of study a summary of most recent assessment results is not available.

At this time students enrolled in ECED 1310 will complete an assessment (Site Observation Assignment) that is linked to the outcomes for the course. Students will be introduced to the outcomes in this course. The knowledge learned in all other courses will build upon this information.

Once the results of the assessment are made available, the information can be used to determine if the information should be shared in various ways. All data will have input to how student learning can be improved.

2019-2020 IE Plan Results and Future Planning					
Outcome #	Outcome Statement	Outcome Final Status	List of Evidence (Provide in Email Attachments)	Results of the Institutional Effectiveness Effort What does the evidence show regarding the Outcome? To what extent was the Outcome met? As a result of the success of the Outcome, what Continuous Improvement need will have been met? Provide all supporting evidence.	Future Planning How will this outcome inform future planning? Will the results of this Outcome lead to completing the same or a similar Strategic Plan item at a higher level?
1	Phase out the Early Childhood Education AAS degree program.		1. Letter of instruction Plan approved by college. 2. Letter of instruction Plan approved by college.	1. Received approval from college curriculum committee. 2. Received approval from IEPA to implement Teach Out Plan. 3. Received approval from TBR to phase out program.	This is the last year this outcome will be used.
2	Increase the number of Early Childhood Education Technical Certificate graduates.	Complete - Met	Evidence from IEPA	The evidence indicates that there was an enrollment increase in the early technical Certificate program. The enrollment goal was 15 students, and there were 17 total students for fall 2019 and spring 2020. Continuous improvement will be made to visit	This is the last year this outcome will be used.

Data Chart: 2018- summer 2021

Education Outcomes	Learning Opportunities	Achievement Target	Three years of trend data
Increase graduation of students with Technical Certificate.	N/A	Increase program by 15 students	2018-2019 3 graduates 2019-2020 Graduate information not available in Factbook Dashboard.
Knowing about and upholding ethical standards and other early childhood professional guidelines.	The rubric score results will indicate instructional changes such as: Instruction provided (lectures, videos) on the NAEYC Code of Ethics. A copy given to the students. Instruction provided (textbook readings, lectures, panel discussions, video demonstrations) on how to apply these ethical standards and other early childhood professional guidelines to young children and families.	Students will earn a score 90% on the science study and the ethics case study assignments	2017-2018 62.7% of students scored 90% 2018-2019 44% of students earned a 90% 2019-2020 This outcome was not continued.
Students will engage in continuous collaborative learning to inform practice; using technology effectively with young children.	The rubric score results will indicate instructional changes such as: Lesson plan writing and ways to create a science study. Examples provided to incorporate technology in the classroom.	Students will score a 90% or above on the Science Study rubric and the Ethics Case Study rubric.	2017-2018 62.7% of students scored 90% 2018-2019 44% of students earned a 90% 2019-2020 This outcome was not continued.

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Schools within our community partnership participated in our 2020 Employer Survey of education graduates (managed evidence). All of the schools indicated that they would hire another education graduate from the education program. The employer survey indicates a overall 66.7% satisfaction with education graduates, with a mean of 4.33. The employers indicate that students/teachers strengths include that they work very hard to find fun and educational activities in the classroom. Additional comments that would help to better prepare future graduates include; more skills and adaptation to working with children with individualized needs. This comment clarifies a need for implementing more strategies to help teachers be better equipped to work with students with disabilities. Spring student course evaluations indicate early childhood faculty scored a 4.5 out of 5.0 possible score on all courses. Students comments include; "engagement throughout the course, and "let us know- if we had questions- she was available". Each of these align with the positive reflective data scores.

The academic year 2019-2020 graduate satisfaction survey results indicated that an 86% job placement rate with seven of the eight graduates being placed in a position in early childhood education. This is a 61% increase from the previous year. However, the employer satisfaction rate is at 50%.

The increase in job placement is an interesting trend that needs to be watched. If the job placement increases over the next year for students earning a technical certificate it should be examined.

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

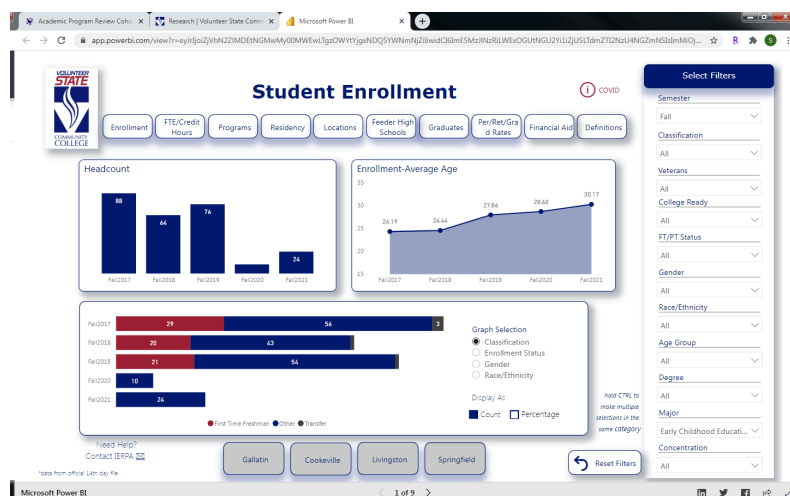
Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss

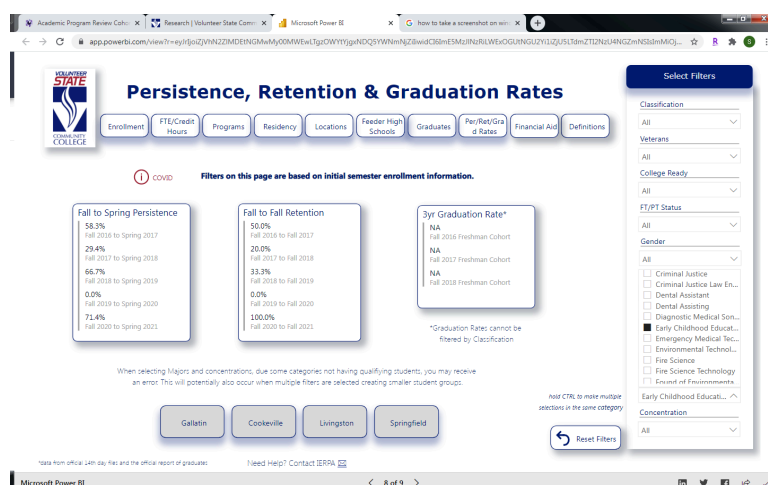
potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

The Early Childhood Technical Certificate (ECTC) has seen a slight increase in enrollment of students on the Gallatin campus despite the pandemic changing the modality of course offerings. The enrollment in the ECTC has increased from 7 students in fall of 2019 to 16 students in fall of 2021. This increase is related to the states new early childhood program licensure requirements for early childhood educators.



The retention rates for the ECTC is listed as 0% for both fall 2019 to spring 2020 and fall 2019 to spring 2020. This is due to a lack of reported data for this year. However, the fall 2019 to spring 2020 persistence rate for the technical certificate is reported at 71.4% and a 100% retention rate for fall to fall. While persistence and retention rates are a concern for the college the rates reported are not a concern for the technical certificate and show a steady increase over the past five years. The Tennessee Early Childhood Training Alliance (TECTA) funds ECED courses for eligible ECED students. Vol State faculty partners with this agency to help students be successful and complete degrees. This funding opportunity removes a financial burden and faculty assist with advising, retention and completion.



Graduation rates for the Early Childhood Technical Certificate illustrate a slight increase of 56% from the academic year 2019-2020 with 25 graduates to 39 graduates for the 2020-2021 academic year. This increase in certificate recipients suggests more early childhood programs are aligning to the state program licensing rules and having staff pursue academic coursework. Recruitment includes

The early childhood program shares degree information with high schools to recruit more incoming freshman to declare the ECED technical certificate as their intended major. The program recruitment strengths include: recruitment materials shared periodically with high school guidance counselors, presenting to high school classrooms, and participating in high school job fairs. In addition, attending the local Sumner County directors meeting, sending a bi-annual Vol State newsletter to local childcare agencies and directors, and holding annual Vol State ECED advisory meetings with community partners.

Evidence:

- Advisory Board Members
- ECED Advisory Board Agenda 2020

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

The early childhood education teaching faculty (1 full time and 2 adjunct instructors at the Gallatin location and 2 adjuncts at the Cookeville satellite location) continually seek ways to set students up for success and high-engagement teaching faculty has been identified as one. A model course map was created to secure consistency between program outcomes, course objectives, delivery content and textbooks.

All full-time faculty participate in a peer evaluation completed by two assigned peers, complete classroom observations and required documents to division secretary. In addition, all adjuncts are evaluated by full-time faculty, including a classroom observation and required documents signed and complete and sent to the division secretary. All evaluations are considered constructive feedback to adjust and improve teaching modalities, schedule, classroom climate and to benefit the teacher and student.

Course rubrics were redeveloped to align with new course outcomes to track key assessment data that lead to continuous improvements in the program. The course map, rubrics and data is shared regularly between early childhood education faculty and adjuncts.

Faculty teaching loads include; one full-time early childhood education faculty (working on a doctoral degree) and two early childhood education (one with a doctorate degree) adjuncts. The two adjuncts are located at the Gallatin campus.

Evidence:

- ECED 1310 Course Manual
- ECED 2310 Course Manual
- ECED 2315 Course Manual
- ECED 2320 Course Manual
- ECED 2335 Course Manual
- ECED 2340 Course Manual
- ECED 2365 Course Manual

- ECED 2370 Course Manual (002)
- ECED 2380 Course Manual
- ECED 2385 Course Manual
- Technical Certificate Data Chart 2018-2021[87]

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

Narrative:

The early childhood education technical certificate offers a variety of course scheduling and modality to meet the needs of students at every campus. In the fall of 2019, it was determined that to best meet student needs the program will convert to a fully online program. This allows students to take the 24 credit credential in an online modality. The course conversion was completed in the summer of 2020.

In the past, the courses were offered in fast track hybrid format. The courses would meet once a week for seven weeks. The students were able to take four courses in the fall and four courses in the spring to complete the technical certificate. However, with the pandemic causing courses to move to an online format. This allowed for the early childhood technical certificate to progress to the online modality. In the fall of 2019 there were 13 students taking courses fully online. That dropped in the fall of 2021 by 2 students. The online content of each course is on a current redevelopment cycle for approval every 3 years, and updated every semester. Each course has a required minimum of 2 or more clinical field hours, students completed assigned projects. The ECED faculty have childcare community partners who allow students to complete this requirement. In addition, the Initial Practicum ECED 2335 has 45 clock hours of required clinical field work. Students may choose to complete half of these hours in the childcare they are employed with.

In Cookeville, the course offerings are determined by enrollment and student needs in this area. One of the locations of the TECTA office is at the Cookeville satellite campus. This agency is convenient for students to complete the eligibility requirements and seek advising from Vol State faculty.

While discussing the spring 2022 course offerings, it was determined to try a different hybrid format for the early childhood education courses. The courses are required for the technical certificate and for the early childhood AST (TTP). In order to provide face to face courses a new hybrid format is to be offered. The two courses will meet once a week for the full semester. One course being held on Monday and the other on Wednesday in the same time slot. This will allow for students to have a full semester rather than the compressed version of the past "fast track" modality. Students will be surveyed to determine if this is a popular offering.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

Faculty work collaboratively to provide quality, expansive workforce experience and incorporating best practices in instruction. Teaching and learning opportunities are rich. Service Learning, the use of

problem solving strategies as a teaching method, the use of technology, and the availability to learn through international programs are components of our program.

The program coursework is driven by a workforce development mentality. Students have an average of eight hours of hands-on, fieldwork assignments for all courses in the technical certificate. The students also have two practicum courses with total of 135 hours of fieldwork.

Collaborating across departments and divisions to support student success has been addressed through an on-going evolving service-learning project to promote early literacy called "Read Across America" changed to "The project this year included the library, english, education, foreign language and communication faculty, Over 500 new books were donated and delivered to 5 childcares in Sumner County. An event was hosted by the library and various social-distancing activities were arranged throughout the library, and the public was invited. In the past, Vol State students have held a used book drive on campus, and distributed the books as they visit early childhood centers and read to classes of students. It was certainly a modified version of this project, but was a great success! This project was selected to present at "2021 Tennessee Conference on Volunteerism and Service-Learning." Education faculty. Guest speakers include; Open Arms Care facility director, Sumner County Schools behavioral analyst, and Metro Schools special education teacher. Students are required to write questions for the speakers and reflect and apply the experience to their teaching career.

A "Future Educators" student group was started in 2018. A few of the projects include; collected books for the "Read Across America" project, read books to students and donated items to Vol State "The Feed". In addition, decorating of the teacher education boards in the Noble Hall Caudill building.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

The field of early childhood is a dynamic field with trends and innovations evolving with the times.

In the state of Tennessee, early childhood educators are a part of the ever changing the landscape of child care. One program that stands out as an innovative program is the Child Care Wage\$ Tennessee. This program rewards Early Childhood Educators with financial incentives based on their education and continuity of employment. By increasing teacher retention, this program provides the children of Tennessee with stable relationships with caregivers. Also, research indicates the teachers with more academic training and course work provide a higher level of care.

The National Association for the Education of Young Children (NAEYC) is at the forefront of early childhood trends and innovation. This is evident in their initiative "Power to the Profession". This national collaboration defines the early childhood education profession. It has established a Unifying Framework of recommendations of educator roles and responsibilities, aligned preparation and pathways, profession compensation, and a supportive infrastructure with shared accountability. The goal of the initiative is to create equitable learning opportunities for young children.

Another trend in Early Childhood Education is a focus on expanding the Voluntary Pre-K program in the state. Voluntary Pre-K promotes a high-quality learning environment for children. The program

fosters a the joy of learning and promotes school readiness through developmentally appropriate practices.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

In the last 3 years, here are some trends we found; effective faculty collaboration, positive and high scores from students on our course evaluations and improved enrollment. Student evaluations indicated that faculty build strong student-teacher relationships, quick to communicate feedback, and course content was challenging.

The positive implications of this data indicate a program strength in faculty usage and development.

The enrollment has increased in the early childhood technical certificate has had a steady increase over the last three years. The largest increase was 6 students (fall 2020 enrollment was 10 students and fall of 2021 enrollment was 16 students). The TN Wages program is having a positive impact on enrollment and retention.

The academic year 2019-2020 graduate satisfaction survey results indicated that an 86% job placement rate with seven of the eight graduates being placed in a position in early childhood education. This is a 61% increase from the previous year. However, the employer satisfaction rate is at 50%. The high placement rate along with the low employer satisfaction rate are trends to watch.

The increase in job placement is an interesting trend that needs to be watched. If the job placement increases over the next year for students earning a technical certificate it should be examined.

Retention rates for the early childhood technical certificate have increased from 20% the fall of 2018 to 100% in the fall of 2021. The data illustrates an 80% increase. Strategies to improve student persistence and retention will be addressed in the 2 year plan. Persistence rates (fall to spring) have shown an increase of 41% over the last three years.

The program advisory committee meetings will continue going into the next program year. This allows for participates to learn more about the technical certificate program at Volunteer State Community College. It also allows for the department chair and program faculty to hear about the needs of early childhood education learning programs.

A new assessment plan to increase student learning outcome achievement has been developed. The embedded tests placed in the early childhood education courses were removed and changed to alternative assessments in each course to improve success student and make continuous improvements in the program.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Narrative:

The two-year plan of action will include:

-

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

I have reviewed the information provided for the Early Childhood Education CERT APR and approve it. Again, I found this to be a thorough report about an important program. Kudos to the Education faculty for doing such fine work.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment has reviewed this report and will begin supporting the report champion in preparing for the presentation of this review to the Institutional Effectiveness Committee.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
	Increase the number of students enrolled in the technical certificate.	Increase the program by 15 students.	Pandemic reduced the number of students enrolling in the program.		Fall 2020- 10 students Fall 2021- 10 students Fall 2022- 12 students *Some students enroll as "Adult Special" but are actively pursuing the Technical Certificate. The number of students enrolled is higher.
2	Strengthen student understanding and application of ethical standards and professional guidelines in early childhood education. PLO 2	Students will earn a score of 90% on the science study and ethics case study.		The ethics case study was in ECED 2365 which is no longer required.	90% of students met expectation or exceeded expectation on the science study 2021-2022, 2022-2023.
3	Apply technology-based tools to inform instructional practice with young children. PLO 2	Students will score a 90% or above on the: Science study and ethics case study		The ethics case study was in ECED 2365 which is no longer required.	90% of students earned met or exceeded expectations. Students who earned below did not complete the assignment.

4					
---	--	--	--	--	--

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1	Increase the number of students enrolled in the technical certificate.	Increase the number by 15 students.	The TECTA students from TTU are not enrolling as technical certificate students at the start of the program. These students enroll as adult special lowering the number of students enrolled.		Yes. The 2023-24 academic year there were 55 students enrolled. The fall of 2024 there were 28 enrolled and another 34 enrolled as "adult special".
2	Strengthen student	Students will earn a score of	Not all students completed the	In Spring 2024, 9 of the 15 students	Yes, but not all students

	understanding and application of ethical standards and professional guidelines in early childhood education. PLO 2	90% on the science study.	assignment.	completed the assignment with all of them earning a 90% or more. In Fall of 2024 the program added zoom seminars to help students with the transition to asynchronous online courses. Spring of 2025 the assignment is due on May 2, 2025.	completed the assignment.
3	Apply technology-based tools to inform instructional practice with young children. PLO 2	Students will earn a 90% or above on the science study.	Not all students submitted the assignment.	In the spring of 2024, 9 of the 15 students completed the assignment with a 90% or above. In Fall of 2024 the program added zoom seminars to help students with the transition to asynchronous online courses. science study is due on May 2, 2025.	Yes, but not all students completed the assignment.
4					

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections

	implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234			was 86%
1	Increase the number of students enrolled in the technical certificate.	An increase in students this year will increase the number of CRT2 graduates.	Yes, we want to continue to increase the number of students enrolled.	The increased number of students enrolled could allow for the ECE AAS to be reinstated.
2	Knowing about and upholding ethical standards and other early childhood professional guidelines.	This initiative will increase the employment satisfaction survey results. Students have more insight on how to handle ethical dilemmas in the classroom or program.	None.	- We added zoom seminars to all online ECED courses. This has helped students connect with the instructor and peers. The instructors use this meeting to guide students through project instructions. It also provided students a place to ask questions about projects. - Going forward, the program is adding key assessments to all courses in the technical certificate. This will allow for more detailed assessment of PLOs and CLOs for the next few program years.
3	Learning to inform practice; using technology effectively with young children.	Informed practices and using technology will prepare students for success in their classrooms.	None.	We added zoom seminars to all online ECED courses. This has helped students connect with the instructor and peers. The instructors use this meeting to guide students through project instructions. It also provided students a place to ask questions about projects.

				• Going forward, the program is adding key assessments to all courses in the technical certificate. This will allow for more detailed assessment of PLOs and CLOs for the next few program years.
4				

Cohort C

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Transportation, Distribution, Warehousing and Procurement, CERT

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

No changes to previous APR recommendations.

This is the program's first APR. This program started in 2019. As a result, there are no recommendations, actions needed, and no implications or challenges at this point.

Learning outcomes were started in 2016 and 2015 for the courses that were offered at that time. It appears that at the time learning outcomes were not assessed for the classes. There was an exit assessment used at the time to assess learning outcomes.

There is very little to no data from the exit exam that was used at the time to assess students. The course numbers were changed in 2019 as the logistics technical certificate was started. Learning outcomes were officially assigned to classes in 2020.

An academic audit was completed in 2018 prior to the change in LO and course numbers.

Evidence:

- LGM & SCM_Academic Audit_Self Study_021218
- VSCC Logistics Academic Auditor Report 2018

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

There are no changes or updates to the mission statement.

The Logistics Management Technical Certificate is still in its infant stage. Program was started in 2019 and is designed to prepare students for the growing need for logistic expertise. Additionally, the program allows certificate credits to be applied toward AAS in Business Administration, and Logistics and Supply Chain Management Concentration. There are no plans to change the curriculum and program offerings. Oct 2022 there were proposed changes to the Logistics certificate name.

Mission Statement

"This technical certificate program offers the opportunity for formal study in the growing field of Logistics, Transportation and Distribution Center/Warehouse Management, Sourcing &

Procurement, and Supply Chain Management. Study in the program is designed to provide career growth. Students completing the Certificate Program may apply the coursework toward the Associate of Applied Science, General Business Administration Option, and Logistics and Supply Chain Management Concentration. "

Evidence:

- Logistics and Supply Chain Management Technical Certificate 10-27-22
- TBR Side by Side Comparison

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The program mission statement is still in line with the college mission statement.

The program helps to answer the communities growing need for workers with a logistics background. Answering the need for workers in logistics builds on our community partnerships and provides labor resources for local and national economy. Our students graduate understanding the role of logistics in a global society.

Industry experts and local companies are concerned that the labor market lack trained and experienced working in logistics to support growing supply chain management concerns. The concern is that there is a lack of understanding for warehouse, distribution, transportation and supply chain. The courses offer students an indebt understanding of all aspect of logistics. Real world case studies in all classes give students the opportunity to analyze and discuss the problems. Students can address these issues by applying learned content and personal experience to resolving supply chain issues.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

Case studies are still being used to assess program learning outcomes in each course as a part of the certificate.

PLO 1 and 2 are assessed in LOGI 1010 using a case study. A rubric is used to assess students' ability to demonstrate understanding of Content, writing mechanics (organization, spelling, grammar), use of references, citations, and sources. Score range from 3.5 to 5 on each section of the rubric.

PLO 3 is assessed in LOGI 1030 using a case study.

A rubric is used to assess students' ability to demonstrate understanding of Content, writing mechanics (organization, spelling, grammar), use of references, citations, and sources. Score range from 3.5 to 5 on each section of the rubric.

PLO 4 is assessed in LOGI 2040 using a case study.

A rubric is used to assess students' ability to demonstrate understanding of Content, writing mechanics (organization, spelling, grammar), use of references, citations, and sources. Score range from 3.5 to 5 on each section of the rubric.

All courses are not offered each semester since 2019. Therefore all PLO have not been assessed due to course offerings .

Evidence:

- LOGI TC Curriculum Map 2022
- Optional Action Plan Matrix[1]

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

Data still being collected for the Technical Certificate

1. Summary of most recent assessment results

Key assessment courses for the Logistics Certification are:

- LOGI1000 Supply Chain Management with learning outcomes.
- LOGI1010 Transportation
- LOGI1030 Distribution and Warehouse Management
- LOGI2040 Sourcing and Procurement

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

1. There is very little to no data or past review of institutional effectiveness for the Logistics Certification. Assessments and learning outcomes for the courses were finalized Spring of 2021. Assessments and learning outcomes were not officially applied to courses until 2022. Therefore, all learning outcomes have not been assessed. Additionally, the lack of data has been impacted by the course offering schedule as well as the application of the learning outcomes.
2. Analysis of trends are also affected by the lack of data and the infancy of the program. Assessments and learning outcomes were not officially applied to courses until 2022. Therefore, all learning outcomes have not been assessed. Additionally, the lack of data has been impacted by the course offering schedule as well as the application of the learning outcomes.
3. In the future as more assessments are applied to the logistics courses, the results should be used to tailor course models and make corrections to courses based on data from the assessments and learning outcomes.

Evidence:

- AY2021-2022 LOGI TC Assessment Results

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

2021 Surveys LOGI 1000, 1010

Student surveys were completed by 57 to 74% of the students with an overall average that met VSCC and division survey averages.

Fall 2021 64% of students completed surveys with an average rating at or above VSCC and division.

Spring 2021 70% of students completed surveys with an average at or above VSCC and division

Spring 2022 50% of students completed surveys with an average at or above VSCC and Division average.

summer 2020 50% of students complete surveys with an average at or above the VSCC and division average.

I had out administrative associate pull Logistics TC graduates and enrollment on Nov 14 after I submitted the report for peer review. Here are numbers.

Semester	Logistics TC # graduates	Logistics TC # enrolled
201880	4	3
201910	2	4
201950	5	1
201980	6	9
202010	8	5
202050	2	1
202080	4	8
202110	5	5
202150	2	1
202180	12	1
202210	5	2
202250	1	1
202280	3*	7

Evidence:

- 18145.202210LOGI-1000-C01-IntrotoLogisticsManagementBinghamTyrone_TyroneBingham
- 18148.202210LOGI-1010-C01-TransportationBinghamTyrone_TyroneBingham
- 87769.202180LOGI-1000-C01-IntrotoLogisticsManagementBinghamTyrone_TyroneBingham
- 88441.202180LOGI-1000-H01-IntrotoLogisticsManagementBinghamTyrone_TyroneBingham
- 88442.202180LOGI-1010-C01-TransportationBinghamTyrone_TyroneBingham
- Fall_2017
- Fall_21
- MergedReport
- MergedReport (1)
- MergedReport (2)
- MergedReport (3)
- Spring_22
- Summer 21
- Summer 22

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

3.5 The Logistics Technical Certificate continues to have steady enrollment with a very good graduation rate [\[DE1\]](#) [DE1].

	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Fall Enrollment	15	14	34	22	8	1
Graduates	15	17	28	18	32	33

Here is the data for Fall 2017 & Spring 2018 graduation.

Fall 2017 graduates; 2- AAS degrees; 3 certificates

V00640761	Jill	Curtis	B & T Logistics Mgt C1	CRT1	201750
V00587056	Dianna	Harrison	B & T Logistics Mgt C1	CRT1	201750
V00224084	Phillip	Stafford	B & T Logistics Mgt C1	CRT1	201780
V00640032	Angel	Figuroa	B & T Logistics Management AAS	AAS	201750

V00218306	Teresa	Rumble	B & T	Logistics Management AAS	AAS	201750
-----------	--------	--------	-------	--------------------------	-----	--------

Spring 2018 graduates; 4- AAS degrees; 1 certificate

V00646059	Adam	Mamula	B&T	Logistics Management AAS	AAS
V00613434	Kelly	Dean	B&T	Logistics Management AAS	AAS
V00649526	Joshua	Green	B&T	Logistics Management AAS	AAS
V00198918	Rhonda	Mitchell	B&T	Logistics Management AAS	AAS
V00219949	Marcus	Townsend	B&T	Logistics Mgt C1 (certificate)	CRT1

In 2022 new brochures were completed. A grant was received to complete student, faculty, and classroom commercials. Commercials were completed Fall of 2022 in conjunction with public affairs. Placement % has decreased since 2019 from 57% to 33% this was at the heart of the pandemic and in the coming years placement numbers should increase. Graduate numbers have increased since 2019. Retention rate for 2019 was 33%, and there is no data for any other years.

Evidence:

- 2022 Logistics Fact Sheet
- Number of LGM grads Fall17 and Sprg18

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

There is nothing to provide on faculty usage and development as this section is optional.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

Narrative:

This section is optional and there is no evidence to report for class and course offerings.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

Guest speakers provide real-world logistics knowledge and challenges for the LOGI 1000 in-person classes. Don Ellis has been the logistics community resource for guest speakers used for the on ground LOGI 1000 class starting Fall 2022. Chariot Logistics visited the LOGI 1000 course Fall of 2022. Joe Delio is the president and graduate of UT Knoxville with a degree in Logistics. Joe runs a Million Dollar company in the Nashville and provided lots of insight for students taking the class and those working on the certification. The goal is to offer students in the in person classes an opportunity to take field trips to the near by Gap distribution center to talk with those currently working in warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from creditable industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

There is no industry data and information to provide for this APR. This section of the APR is optional.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Narrative:

There is no data available from the start of the program addressing employment and transfer forecast. This section is optional.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

Progress has been made on the 2022 plans. Faculty advisors are assigned to help streamline the advising process and decrease response time. Faculty advisors are no longer forced to advise students. This maintains faculty advisors in the advising role that want to advise students. Faculty advisors are better trained at advising which improves the experience for students. Training sessions are held multiple times each semester for faculty advisors. The advising send emails to students throughout the semester as a way to maintain a connection between faculty advisors and students.

Plans for improvement 2022

Improve teamwork and process discipline between Completion Advisers and Business Department faculty members. Improve the frequency and substance of communication between advisers and

students by providing faculty members with additional training and through regular review and attention from the director, chair and dean. Improve response times and the quality of support and follow up provided by faculty advisers when the alert system notifies them of student performance issues. Improve student enthusiasm for the field by increasing significantly the number and quality of work-based learning experiences in every CIT class and creating assignments and other learning experiences to enhance student understanding of the career and income opportunities provided by their course of study. Restructure degree requirements and suggested course sequencing to encourage students to earn a certificate enroute to their degrees, establishing stackable credentials to reward progress and encourage retention and completion. Systematically review the syllabus for each course to add assignments and instruction that increases student awareness of college resources available for their support and to increase student engagement with one another and with division and campus personnel. The director, chair and dean will work with IERPA to review student success trends in Logistics and Supply Chain courses. They will identify any bottlenecks and barriers and develop and lead any response plans that may be needed.

To inspire student performance, faculty members will revise their courses to increase work-based learning in all LOG courses and to increase student understanding of career and income opportunities associated with CIT credentials and the importance of pursuing career-relevant work opportunities and internships while in college. Faculty members will review the syllabus of their programs to develop assignments and learning experiences that teach and strengthen student skills in the eight NACE competencies.

Continue to advocate and push for the requirement for more Full-Time faculty members to teach in person Logistics and Supply Chain courses and manage the Logistics and Supply Chain programs. Successfully execute initiatives to increase the number of business students earning the Logistics certificate to demonstrate the focus and productivity of the department. Build and leverage strong partnerships with supported employers. Systematically expand work-based learning experiences in logistics. In 2022 work was completed via a grant to Publicize logistics opportunities. Work was done in 2022 to work with the VSCC Office of Public Relations to improve and expand marketing and promotion of logistics programs. Include content promoting partnerships with career and technical education (CTE) programs of area school systems. Team with colleagues to develop a multi-year plan for strategic engagement and partnerships with school districts and employers across the service area. Students and faculty were involved in a campaign and commercial for the department and the logistics TC. Commercials included interviews with students and faculty. Students were highlighted in the classroom environment showcasing student and faculty engagement.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

No changes to program recommendations.

Recommendation based on student learning

1. LOGI 1000 is the only course that has been offered in person all other courses in the program are only offered online. I recommend advocating for more classes within the certificate be offered in-person. More faculty will be needed in order to offer other logistics courses in person. It is recommended that more in person logistics classes are offered in the next two years based on the ability to hire new faculty.

2. Review all current textbooks within the logistics program and update materials as necessary to stay in line with industry changes over the last five years. Courses should be reviewed in the next year with time to work with publishers to implement new course materials.

Student success recommendation

1. Incorporate more guest speakers from the industry to offer insight on the career field for in person courses. Local field trips and tours of companies to expose students to warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

Evidence:

- Optional Action Plan Matrix[1]

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

I have analyzed the program review and agree with the evidence provided and am supportive of the action plan moving forward.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the lead faculty member as well as the rest of the department in completing this review and designing thoughtful initiatives for continuous improvement. The action plan is appropriate and will help improve student learning as well having the potential to increase retention and job placement. In addition to these actions, I encourage the department to think more about how recruitment efforts could be expanded, particularly through the use of dual enrollment pathways and other partnerships. Many of the students who receive the certificate are enrolled in the AAS program, and providing this certificate as a stackable credential is a great feature of the program. At the same time, there may be opportunity to recruit potential students to the certificate program specifically - either students who do not plan to pursue a degree at this time or students who already have a degree but are looking to increase their skills in this specific area.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

APR Cohort C conducted a Peer Review rather than a presentation.

The Logistic APR was reviewed by an Assessment Fellow.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Recommendation based on student learning

1. LOGI 1000 is the only course that has been offered in person all other courses in the program are only offered online. I recommend advocating for more classes within the certificate be offered in-person. More faculty will be needed in order to offer other logistics courses in person. It is recommended that more in person logistics classes are offered in the next two years based on the ability to hire new faculty.
2. Review all current textbooks within the logistics program and update materials as necessary to stay in line with industry changes over the last five years. Courses should be reviewed in the next year with time to work with publishers to implement new course materials.

Student success recommendation

1. Incorporate more guest speakers from the industry to offer insight on the career field for in person courses. Local field trips and tours of companies to expose students to warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

YEAR 2

	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1					
2					
3					
4					

1. Additional Business full-time faculty have been added to the staff that can instruct more in-person logistics courses. There are now two full-time and two part-time faculty teaching logistics courses. The logistics certificate name change was approved by TBR and is now "Supply Chain Management" this is more in line with local and national industry standards. Logistics courses and textbooks are continuously being updated each year. The most recent update was for the LOGI 2030 and 1000 courses update Fall of 2023.

2. Industry guest speakers have been incorporated into the Curriculum. Part-time faculty are able to serve as industry speakers as well as instructors for the logistics program. Chariot Logistics from Gallatin are used as a guest speaker to offer industry insight and logistics challenges.

Evidence:

- Action Plan Matrix[1]

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on

student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Recommendation based on student learning

1. LOGI 1000 is the only course that has been offered in person all other courses in the program are only offered online. I recommend advocating for more classes within the certificate be offered in-person. More faculty will be needed in order to offer other logistics courses in person. It is recommended that more in person logistics classes are offered in the next two years based on the ability to hire new faculty.

2. Review all current textbooks within the logistics program and update materials as necessary to stay in line with industry changes over the last five years. Courses should be reviewed in the next year with time to work with publishers to implement new course materials.

Student success recommendation

1. Incorporate more guest speakers from the industry to offer insight on the career field for in person courses. Local field trips and tours of companies to expose students to warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1					
2					
3					
4					

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Health Information Management AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first cycle of the APR. Previous program reviews were executed by IE report.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information management technicians with the knowledge, technical skills and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that would afford our graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

No changes have been made to the VSCC HIM Program mission statement, and no revisions are planned.

Revisions may be made once the CAHIIM HIM 2026 Standards, Competence Assessment Statements, and Performance Indicators (PIs) have been fully implemented.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The Health Information Management Program is highly central to the VSCC mission, vision, and core values. The Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information technicians with the knowledge, technical skills, and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that afford graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

HIM, A.A.S. Program Learning Outcomes

1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance.
2. Apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security.
3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use.
4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management.
5. Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance.
6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.
7. Apply knowledge of pathophysiology, pharmacology, anatomy and physiology, medical terminology, computer concepts and computer applications as they relate to health information management.

Assessment Method and Target Level of Outcome

PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping.

In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements. Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #2 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #2. Identify and apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security, is assessed utilizing EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure.

This assignment provides an introduction to the issues surrounding the release of information (ROI) and a patient's right to an accounting of disclosures of their protected health information (PHI). Students must apply privacy and security strategies to health information, identify compliance requirements, manage data within a database system, apply legal processes impacting health information, and demonstrate compliance with external forces by answering questions regarding the ROI scenario given and the items on file in the EHR.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use, is assessed utilizing EHR Go

Query Basic Orientation.

In this assignment, students create and run queries to gather needed data, apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information, utilize technologies for health information management, and manage data within a database system.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient's hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #5 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #5 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine the present on admission (POA) status indicator for each.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #6 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA's Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

Additional Information

The HIM PLOs were assessed during the spring 2022 semester however, as noted above, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. The best history we currently have is the results of the Registered Health Information Management (RHIT) certification exam. The Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) certification exam also assesses the PLOs which are based on the required 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies. On our Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) to our accrediting body, the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM), our Student and Graduate goal is:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies.

One of the measured target outcomes for meeting this goal is:

The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduate will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.

Results of the RHIT School Score Report for the academic years from August 1st, 2020, to July 31st, 2021 were reviewed and students who tested early and graduated had an RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 76.92% which exceeds our measured target outcome.

Evidence:

- APAR with Results 8.1.2020 to 7.31.2021
- HIMT AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- HIMT, AAS Assessment Tool

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The VSCC Associate of Applied Science in Health Information Management program is designed to teach students the 38 entry-level 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies, including the Data Management (DM) and Revenue Management (RM) specialty tracks, developed by the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) and the Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) and approved by the Commission on Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). These 38 competencies can be aggregated into the broad HIM PLOs assessed in Via.

The HIM PLOs listed below were assessed during the spring 2022 semester using Via however, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. An analysis of the spring 2022 results was conducted.

Notations and summary of most recent assessments, AY21-22 Assessment Results:

HIM Program Students and MCTC Students are assessed in the HIMT 2305 and HIMT 2303 classes. In AY21-22 we also had students from the MPM major in the HIMT 2305 class, in spring 2022. The MPM major is no longer offered at VSCC so in the future, we will not have MPM students in this class. MCTC students will continue to be in both classes. Assessing the data based on the students' majors will be necessary for analyzing accurate statistical data in the HIM APR and the MCTC APR. The attached AY21-22 Assessment Results only include assessments of HIM students.

Analysis of trends for HIM PLOs assessed:

- PLO #1 HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping 86% met; 14% not met
- *PLO #2 EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure 91% met; 9% not met
- PLO #3 EHR Go Query Basic Orientation 85% met; 15% not met
- PLO #4 HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission 100% met; 0% not met

- PLO #5 HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis 98% met; 2% not met
- PLO #6 HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making 80% met; 20% not met

Ideas to improve student learning:

- To increase the HIM student learning and scores we believe two of the assignments should be moved to courses that better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with these PLOs. We will move the following PLOs for AY23-24:

1. Move PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, from HIMT 2305 to HIMT 1305 Computer Applications in HI, and ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment.
2. Move PLO #3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use from HIMT 2303 to HIMT 2309 Data Analysis and Statistics, and ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment.
3. Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for PLO #6 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.

*We will also move PLO #2. Apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security from HIMT 2305 to HIMT 1202 HIM Legal Aspects better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with this PLO. This PLO was 91% met, 9% not met.

HIM PLOs:

- PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping. In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements.

Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

- PLO #2 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #2. Identify and apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security, is assessed utilizing EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure.

This assignment provides an introduction to the issues surrounding the release of information (ROI) and a patient's right to an accounting of disclosures of their protected health information (PHI). Students must apply privacy and security strategies to health information, identify compliance requirements, manage data within a database system, apply legal processes impacting health information, and demonstrate compliance with external forces by answering questions regarding the ROI scenario given and the items on file in the EHR.

- PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use, is assessed utilizing EHR Go Query Basic Orientation.

In this assignment, students create and run queries to gather needed data, apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information, utilize technologies for health information management, and manage data within a database system.

- PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient's hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

- PLO #5 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #5 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine what the Present on Admission (POA) status is for each scenario.

- PLO #6 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA's Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

Historical Assessments, Analysis, Summary of Results, and Trends

Historically we can look at the Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) to our accrediting body, the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) as evidence of student learning and the HIM Program's effectiveness in reaching both PLOs and the learning outcomes/curriculum competencies in the HIM courses.

8/1/2020 - 7/31/2021 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR)

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2020 - 7/31/2021 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies.

The measured target outcomes for meeting this goal were:

1. The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduate will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.
2. 100 percent of students will receive "Satisfactory" or above ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Manager/Supervisor on their Professional Practice Experience (clinical) Student Performance Evaluation.

The steps to achieve this goal were:

1. Using results of the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduates will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%
2. Using results of the PPE Student Performance Evaluation, 100% of students will receive "Satisfactory" or above ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Site Manager/Supervisor.

Results/Analysis/Trends/Actions:

1. Results of the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year from August 1st, 2020, to July 31st, 2021 were reviewed and students who tested early and graduates had an RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 76.92%
2. Results of the PPE Student Performance Evaluations were reviewed and 100% of students received above Satisfactory ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Site Manager.

8/1/2019 - 7/31/2020 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR)

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2019 - 7/31/2020 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies

The measured target outcomes for meeting this goal were:

1. Students will recognize basic Health Information concepts and practices. Using results from the RHIT National Exam, graduates will meet or exceed the national average score for Domains 1-6 on the first attempt.
2. Graduates will demonstrate entry-level competency in the skill required in the position- students will apply and demonstrate critical, problem-solving, and decision-making skills within the parameters of Health Information Management Technology.
3. Students will apply and demonstrate knowledge of health record principles, management principles, classification systems, design principles, and legal and statistical information as acquired over the course of the Health Information Management Technology program as a whole.

The steps to achieve this goal were:

1. Due to the changes in the RHIT School Score Reports provided by AHIMA we were not able to assess this target outcome from August 1st, 2019, to July 31st, 2020. The national average score for Domains 1-6 was no longer provided in the RHIT School Score Reports. We developed a new target outcome for our action plan: The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students will have an RHIT exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.
2. Using returned Employer Satisfaction Surveys, 75% or more of employers will answer "yes" that the VSCC HIM graduates they hired had the HIM skills and knowledge they expected.
3. 80% of the HIM students will pass the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM.

Results/Analysis/Trends/Actions:

1. There were no results for this time period due to the changes in the RHIT School Score Reports that no longer provided the national average score for Domains 1-6. Due to this change in the reports, we developed a new target outcome for our action plan:
 1. The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students will have an RHIT exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.
2. Results of the PPE Student Performance Evaluations were reviewed for the academic year August 1st, 2019, to July 31st, 2020, and 100% of students received above Satisfactory ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Site Manager.

3. 100% of employees rated the VSCC HIM graduates they hired as having the skills and knowledge they expected.
4. 100% of the HIM students passed the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM.

8/1/2018 - 7/31/2019 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR)

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2018 - 7/31/2019 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies

The measured target outcomes for meeting this goal were:

1. Students will recognize basic Health Information concepts and practices. Using results from the RHIT National Exam, graduates will meet or exceed the national average score for Domains 1-6 on the first attempt.
2. Graduates will demonstrate entry-level competency in the skill required in the position – students will apply and demonstrate critical, problem-solving, and decision-making skills within the parameters of Health Information Management Technology.
3. Students will apply and demonstrate knowledge of health record principles, management principles, classification systems, design principles, and legal and statistical information as acquired over the course of the Health Information Management Technology program as a whole.

The steps to achieve this goal were:

1. Using results of the RHIT National Exam, graduates will meet or exceed the national average score for Domains 1- 6 on the first attempt. Domains 1-6:
 1. Data, Content, Structure, and Information Governance
 2. Access, Disclosure, Privacy, and Security
 3. Data Analytics and Use
 4. Revenue Cycle Management
 5. Compliance
 6. Leadership
2. Using returned Employer Satisfaction Surveys, 75% or more of employers will answer "yes" that the VSCC HIM graduates they hired had the HIM skills and knowledge they expected.
3. 80% of the HIM students will pass the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM

Results/Analysis/Trends/Actions:

1. Scores from August 1, 2018, through July 31, 2019, Domains 1- 6 for the first attempt:
 - Domain 1 – 18.30 below Nat'l score of 19.47
 - Domain 2 – 11.60 below Nat'l score of 11.74
 - Domain 3 – 12.80 below Nat'l score of 12.89
 - Domain 4 – 11.80 below Nat'l score of 13.36
 - Domain 5 – 9.80 below Nat'l score of 10.47
 - Domain 6 – 10.20 below Nat'l score of 11.15

The results were reviewed and the scores that fell below the national average were not considered significant. We continued to monitor, and we did the following for improvements:

- Provided students with the following detailed information on basic Health Information concepts and practices/ Domains 1-6:
 - PowerPoint presentations
 - Lecture notes
 - Terms to know and understand

- Information from the Annual THIMA meeting and we encouraged student attendance at the Annual THIMA meeting
 - Used Discussion boards
- We also did the following:
 - Added exams for each domain in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM.
 - Provided students with a fundamental and comprehensive review of program content.
 - Provided students with materials for further study.
 - Students were required to register and sit for the RHIT Exam during their last semester, prior to graduation.
 - Added additional assignments and discussion boards from the AHIMA Case Studies in HIM textbook to the Seminar in HIM, Introduction to HIM, and Revenue Cycle Management courses; added additional assignments to meet AHIMA Curriculum Competencies for Data Analysis & Statistics, Quality Improvement, and HIM Management Principles courses.

2. 100% of employees rated the VSCC HIM graduates they hired as having the skills and knowledge they expected.

3. 100% of the HIM students passed the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212

Ideas to improve student success:

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2020 - 7/31/2021 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies.

One of the measured target outcomes for meeting this goal was:

The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduate will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%

To improve student success we will increase the RHIT first-time exam pass rate from 72% to 75%. The following steps will be initiated to improve the RHIT first-time exam pass rates:

- Extend the study time by 1 week by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation.
- Allow students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as many times as they need to make a 75%.

Evidence of Student Learning:

Based on the assessment results in Via and the Annual Program Assessment results the HIM Program is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the HIM student learning and scores we believe two of the assignments should be moved to courses that better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with these PLOs; we will also ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing these two assignments. We will also provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for another assignment. To improve student success we will increase the RHIT first-time exam pass rate from 72% to 75%.

Evidence:

- AY21-22 HIM, AAS Assessment Results 11.8.22
- HIMT Scores 18-19
- HIMT Scores 19-20
- HIMT Scores 19-20 Amended received 2022
- HIMT Scores 20-21

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Advisory Board and Alumni

52% of the VSCC HIM Advisory Board are VSCC Alumni. The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback each year in the following areas:

- HIM curriculum
- Graduate placement data
- Employer satisfaction survey results
- Graduate licensure/certification results
- Student PPE (clinical) results

The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities.

Perceptions of the HIM Program, students, and graduates are positive.

HIM Employer Surveys

100% of Employer Surveys rate the overall quality of graduates they have hired from the VSCC HIM Program as excellent or good.

HIM Graduate Surveys

99% of the HIM Graduates agreed that the VSCC HIM Program helped them acquire the knowledge necessary for a job in the Health Information Management field, and trained them to use sound judgment in the Health Information Management work setting. 1% of the Graduates were neutral on these survey questions.

Summary/Trends/Identified Strengths

To increase the number of Employer Surveys and Graduate Surveys received, CAHIIM suggested the following ideas regarding surveys in their review of the 08/01/2018 - 07/31/2019 APAR:

- As an option to graduate surveys and employer surveys, some programs have graduating students fill out a survey in class near the end of their last term, with the protocol that results will not be given to HIM faculty until after the term ends.
- Also, some programs send employer surveys to all of the PPE supervisors while the students are still engaged in PPE, and use these responses to assess the student's performance levels as potential employees.

We inquired about the possibility of implementing both of these and were told by IERPA we could not implement these to use as survey results.

The perception of the VSCC HIM Program is favorable as noted by the Advisory Board Members, Alumni, Graduates, and Employers. We will continue to monitor the results.

Evidence:

- 2019 HIM Employer Survey
- 2019 HIM Graduate Survey
- 2020 HIM Employer Survey
- 2020 HIM Graduate Survey
- 2021 HIM Employer Survey
- 2021 HIM Graduate Survey
- APAR with Results 8.1.2018 to 7.31.2019

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:**Recruitment/Enrollment**

The attached VSCC HIM Program Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) submitted to the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) show the HIM Program enrollment, retention, and graduation results for the last three years. There was an increase in enrollment for AY20-21 with fifteen full-time students and seven part-time students. We would like to see an increase in enrollment to full capacity, 25 students. We are listed as a CAHIIM accredited Associate Level HIM Program on the CAHIIM website as well as the Tennessee Health Information Management Association website, allowing our program to be recognized nationally, and on a state level. We will continue to participate in the Health Science Discovery Days, and host area high school students to share information about the HIM Program and professional field. We are also working with an Entertainment Media Production student to create a promotional video of the HIM Program for use on our VSCC webpage and possibly on social media platforms to increase awareness of the HIM Program and field.

Evidence:

- 2022 HIM Fact Sheet
- APAR with Results 8.1.2018 to 7.31.2019
- APAR with Results 8.1.2019 to 7.31.2020
- APAR with Results 8.1.2020 to 7.31.2021

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

CAHIIM requires the following faculty development goal which is assessed annually on the Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR):

Faculty Development Goal: The program will provide a plan for faculty that establishes or assesses the knowledge, skills, qualifications, and experience pertinent to the professional curriculum content that they are assigned to teach.

This includes efforts to keep current in health information management and/or other relevant professional content and practice, as well as other components of advanced formal education.

Measured target outcome: All HIM faculty will obtain CEUs annually to improve faculty knowledge and expertise, and keep current in the health information management areas in which they teach. All HIM faculty will turn in proof of their AHIMA membership and continued certification annually

Steps to achieve: Faculty will attend CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, and professional development meetings to stay current in the topics they teach. One faculty member will attend AOE.

Results/Analysis/Actions: 100% of the HIM faculty are in compliance. Both faculty members attended the CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, the THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, professional development meetings, and AOE for AY20-21. We will continue to monitor.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

Narrative:

The VSCC HIM Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019.

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all courses by September 1, 2021 All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

The HIM Students are Student AHIMA Members, <https://www.ahima.org/ahima-membership/membership-types-and-benefits/>

Professional Practicum Experience (PPE) is an essential part of the HIM curriculum. According to the Commission on the Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management (CAHIIM), the professional practice experiences must be designed and supervised to reinforce didactic instruction and must include program-coordinated experience at professional practice sites. The VSCC HIM Program students complete 45 hours of PPE during their fall semester.

We encourage the HIM students to attend the Annual THIMA Meeting and local Middle Tennessee Health Information Management Association (MTHIMA) Meetings.

The HIM students are encouraged to sign up for the THIMA Mentor Program, <https://www.thima.org/members/mentor-program/>

The HIM Students attend the AHIMA Student Open House during the fall semester. This complimentary virtual event offers the following:

- AHIMA Foundation scholarship opportunities
- How to transition from health information student to health information professional
- The top five emerging issues impacting health information management
- Building their personal brand on LinkedIn
- AHIMA credentials— options and where to get started
- Optimizing AHIMA student membership

Students also get a virtual tour of the new AHIMA Student Resources portal, with content and tools to help navigate their professional journey.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

The VSCC HIM Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019.

The Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) strives to provide the public with effective and consistent quality monitoring of health informatics and health information management programs through maintenance of accreditation processes. CAHIIM is recognized by the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA).

Additional information about the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) including its mission, vision, core values, and strategic goals may be found on its website, CAHIIM.org

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all

courses by September 1, 2021 All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

Evidence:

- 2-27-19 Certificate of Accreditation

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Narrative:

HIM professionals serve the healthcare industry wherever health information is collected, organized, and analyzed. HIM professionals work in a variety of healthcare settings, education, payer organizations, research and policy agencies, consulting, and legal firms.

According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) employment of medical records and health information technicians (those with a certificate and/or associate degree) is expected to increase by 9% from 2020-2030, much faster than the national average. The demand exceeds the number of qualified professionals.

The VSCC Associate of Applied Science in Health Information Management program is designed to teach students the 38 entry-level 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies developed by the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) and the Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) and approved by the Commission on Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). Our curriculum includes both of AHIMA's specialty tracks: revenue management (RM) and data management (DM), as recommended by our HIM Advisory Board. Our curriculum prepares the student to sit for and pass the RHIT and begin their HIM professional careers.

The 2021 HIM graduates have found employment as:

- Medical Coders
- ROI Specialists
- Registrars
- HIM Specialist
- Record Content Specialist
- QA Specialist
- ROI Quality Analyst

They have been employed by the following organizations:

- Parallon Shared Service Center
- Xtend Healthcare
- Mayo Clinic, HIMS Department
- QTC (Quality, Timeliness, Customer Service)
- MediCopy
- Davita

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

What went right

- **Advisory Board**

The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback regarding the HIM curriculum, graduate placement data, employer satisfaction survey results, and graduate licensure/certification results. The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities. The HIM Advisory Board also provides feedback about the VSCC HIM students they may have hosted at their facilities for their PPEs (clinical). Their feedback is always positive with examples of how well-prepared our students are.

- **HIM Employee Surveys and Trends**

The general response rate for the HIM Employer Surveys has been low for the past three years as noted in the evidence. In order to increase the number of HIM Employer Survey results received we will send email reminders the first week after the survey has been sent, that include the importance of their feedback and the value we place in the information they share with us as well as how we use their feedback to improve the HIM Program.

- **HIM Graduate Surveys and Trends**

The HIM Graduate Survey results had a low response rate for AY18-19 and AY19-20, with improvement seen in AY20-21. We began reminding the HIM Program Students of the importance of returning these surveys and explaining how we use the survey results to improve the HIM Program during the spring semester Orientation, via email towards the end of the spring semester, and again via email after Graduation. We will continue to provide this information to the HIM Program students.

The attached VSCC HIM Program Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) submitted to the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) show the HIM Program enrollment, retention, and graduation results for the last three years. There was an increase in enrollment for AY20-21 with fifteen full-time students and seven part-time students. We will continue to participate in the Health Science Discovery Days, and host area high school students to share information about the HIM Program and professional field. We are also working with an Entertainment Media Production student to create a promotional video of the HIM Program for use on our VSCC webpage and possibly on social media platforms to increase awareness of the HIM Program and field.

- **Recruitment/Enrollment**

The attached VSCC HIM Program Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) submitted to the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) show the HIM Program enrollment, retention, and graduation results for the last three years. There was an increase in enrollment for AY20-21 with fifteen full-time students and seven part-time students. We would like to see an increase in enrollment to full capacity, 25 students. We are listed as a CAHIIM accredited Associate Level HIM Program on the CAHIIM website as well as the Tennessee Health Information Management Association website, allowing our program to be recognized nationally, and on a state level. We will continue to participate in the Health Science Discovery Days, and host area high school students to share information about the HIM Program and professional field. We are also working with an Entertainment Media Production student to create a promotional video of the HIM Program for use on our VSCC webpage and possibly on social media platforms to increase awareness of the HIM Program and field.

What went wrong and plans to improve

- **Assessments**

Based on the assessment results in Via and the Annual Program Assessment results the HIM Program is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the HIM student learning and scores we believe two of the assignments should be moved to courses that better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with these PLOs; we will also ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing these two assignments. We will provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for another assignment. To improve student success we will increase the RHIT first-time exam pass rate from 72% to 75%.

We will continue to analyze the assessments and results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the HIM curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the RHIT certification exam and become HIM professionals with a comprehensive entry-level HIM knowledge base. The HIM field changes rapidly due to changes in EHRs, technology, software, government quality initiatives, laws, regulations, and incentive programs, as well as other industry changes; we will continue to update and change the HIM curriculum as needed and required by CAHIIM, and the rapid changes in the HIM field.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline**</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement	To provide students with	Program Director	(1) Increase of XYZ	AY2023-2024	(1) 76% pass

	of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	and VSCC1234 faculty	assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	- Develop tutorial - Faculty review of the tutorial. - Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 - Launch video in the model shell	rate. (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1.	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1	• Move SLO #1 to the HIMT 1305 course which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO • Ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment	HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty	Increase the percentage met to 90%	AY22-23	86% met AY21-22
2.	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3	• Move SLO #3 to the HIMT 2309 course which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO	HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty	Increase the percentage met to 89%	AY22-23	85% met AY21-22

		• Ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment				
3.	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #6	• Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge	HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty	Increase the percentage met to 84%	AY22-23	80% met AY21-22
4.	Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75%	• Extend the study time by 1 week by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation. • Allow students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as many times as they need to make a 75%.	HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty	Increase RHIT first-time pass rate to 75%	AY22-23	72% first-time pass rate

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

It is evident that a detailed evaluation of the Health Information Management program was conducted. Program faculty provided detailed plans for learning outcomes and student success. Some of the initiatives consist of curriculum revisions that should yield positive outcomes for students. I am most interested in Initiative #4: Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75% and look forward to seeing the results.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and the program faculty on this analysis and action plan. The program has shown marked improvement in persistence and retention rates in recent years, which is all the more impressive given the challenges of the pandemic. I agree with the dean that the plans to revise curriculum are thoughtful and thorough, and I also look forward to seeing the results for initiative #4. Another area the program may want to monitor and consider for future initiatives is placement. It may be that the dip in 2020 was due to the pandemic and will recover back to 2019 levels soon, but this could be a potential area for focus in years 2 or 3 if it does not.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

Action Plan Status Reports**YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the	Delays in development	No changes	The assignment

	PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	to the timeline.	success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1	• Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO • Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7: ◦ AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52. ◦ AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52. ◦ HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35) ◦ Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1). ◦ Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for	No challenges.	N/A	The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 100% met: • 14 of 16 students made a final grade of A, scoring 97-100%: • 2 of 16 students made a B, scoring 91%. Continue to monitor.

		SAS and CSV Datasets.			
2	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3	- Requested that SLO #3 be moved to the HIMT 2309 course for Fall 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO, - The following resource was added: - AHIMA Informatics Toolkit	There were no challenges.	N/A	The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 100% with all students scoring 100%. Continue to monitor.
3	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #6	- Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for SLO #6 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership. The following resource articles were added: <i>What are AHIMA Standards of Ethical Coding?</i> <i>AHIMA Ethical Coding Guidelines</i> <i>AHIMA Body of Knowledge Code of Ethics</i> <i>Is Medical Coding a Risky Job?</i> <i>Making Ethical Decisions: Process</i> <i>Steps of the Ethical Decision-Making Process</i>	There were no challenges.	N/A	The assignment for SLO #6 success rate was 100% met: 15 of 17 students made a final grade of A, scoring 97-100%: 2 of 17 students made a C, scoring 83%. Continue to monitor.
4	Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75%	- Extended the study time by 1 week by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation. - Allowed students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as	Students appreciated the additional study time, but still felt the added stress of taking the RHIT Exam 1 week after graduation, and hoped we would		RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 94%. Results of the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year

		many times as they need to make a 75%.	increase that time for the next cohort. We will discuss and possibly increase study time for the 2023 - 2024 Cohort.		from August 1st, 2022, to July 31st, 2023 were reviewed and students who test early and graduates had an RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 94%. We will continue to monitor The HIM Program is effective in meeting student learning outcomes and curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results. Continue to monitor.

Evidence:

- AHIMA APAR Q4 RHIT School Score Report for August 1 2022 through July 31 2023
- Annual Program Assessment Report with Results August 1 2021 through July 31 2022

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time	None	The assignment success rate	YES

	developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1. The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 100% met in Year 2; we continued to monitor.	- Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course, and continued to provide additional resources for completing the assignment. - Reminded students of the additional resources for completing this assignment to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7: - AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52. - AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52. - HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf . (data element "patient race" is on page 35) - Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019.	Requested that SLO #1 be moved to HIMT 1305 class in Via, but found it had not been moved. Will request again for Summer 2024 semester HIM 1305 course, for 2024-2025 HIM Cohort.	The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 72% met: 8 of 11 students passed this activity. 3 of 11 students failed this activity.	No.

		Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1). Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets.			
2	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3. The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 100% with all students scoring 100%; we continued to monitor.	- Requested that SLO #3 be moved to the HIMT 2309 course for Fall 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO - Provided the AHIMA Informatics Toolkit as an additional resource. - Reminded students of the resource within the activity that provides the Structured Query Language (SQL), terms and concepts used to create queries.	Requested that SLO #3 be moved to HIMT 2309 class in Via, but found it had not been moved. Will request again for Fall 2024 semester HIM 2309 course, for 2024-2025 HIM Cohort.	The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 90% met: 8 of 9 students made an A scoring 100% 1 of 9 students made an F scoring 75% Continue to monitor	No
3	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #6	Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for SLO #6 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership. The	None.	The assignment for SLO #6 success rate was 100% met: 7 of 9 students made an A scoring 100%	Yes

		following resource articles were added: ◦ <i>What are AHIMA Standards of Ethical Coding?</i> ◦ <i>AHIMA Ethical Coding Guidelines</i> ◦ <i>AHIMA Body of Knowledge Code of Ethics</i> ◦ <i>Is Medical Coding a Risky Job?</i> ◦ <i>Making Ethical Decisions: Process</i> ◦ <i>Steps of the Ethical Decision-Making Process</i>		• 2 of 9 students made a C scoring 83% Continue to monitor.	
4	Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75%	• Extended the study time by 2 weeks by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation. • Allowed students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as many times as they need to make a 75%.	• We will not receive the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year from August 1st, 2023, to July 31st, 2024 for review, until October 2024 at the earliest. • We have only received the APAR Q2 RHIT School Score Report: ◦ None of our students had sat for the RHIT Exam as evident on the APAR Q2 RHIT School	5 of 9 students have sat for the RHIT and sent us copies of their RHIT results: • 3 passed on first attempt • 1 passed on second attempt • 1 failed on first attempt	• We will not receive the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year from August 1st, 2023, to July 31st, 2024 for review, until October 2024 at the earliest. • Final analysis of this initiative will be conducted at that time.

			Score Report		
--	--	--	--------------	--	--

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1.	The 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies align HIM education with the skills and knowledge required to meet long-term future HIM workforce needs. This initiative supports the required 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competency I.6DM Evaluate data dictionaries and data sets for compliance with governance standards: • This assignment assist the students in Identifying and applying privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security, is assessed utilizing EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure. • This assignment provides an introduction to the issues surrounding the release of information (ROI) and a patient's right to an accounting of disclosures of	Yes, requested that SLO #1 be moved in Via to Summer Semester 2023 HIMT 1305 class which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency, associated with this SLO, however it has not been moved.	The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 72% met: • 8 of 11 students passed this activity. • 3 of 11 students failed this activity. Continue to monitor and follow-up on moving to the Summer Semester 2025 HIMT 1305 class within Via.

		their protected health information (PHI). Students must apply privacy and security strategies to health information, identify compliance requirements, manage data within a database system, apply legal processes impacting health information, and demonstrate compliance with external forces by answering questions regarding the ROI scenario given and the items on file in the EHR.		
2	Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3	The 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies align HIM education with the skills and knowledge required to meet long-term future HIM workforce needs. This initiative supports the following required 2018 AHIMA HIM Curriculum Competencies: • III.1 Apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information. • III.2 Utilize technologies for health information management. • III.6 DM Manage data within a database system. This assignment assists students in Managing standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use, is assessed utilizing EHR Go Query Basic Orientation. In this assignment, students create and run queries to gather needed data, apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information, utilize technologies for health information management, and manage data within a database system.	Yes, requested that SLO #3 be moved in Via to Fall Semester 2023 HIMT 2309 class which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency, associated with this SLO, however it has not been moved.	The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 90% met: • 8 of 9 students made an A scoring 100% • 1 of 9 students made an F scoring 75% Continue to monitor and follow-up on moving to the Fall Semester 2025 HIMT 2309 class.
3	Increase RHIT first-time pass	We increased the study time for the students by allowing them to	Yes, we will require the Academic Year	The results of the RHIT Exam assist

	rates to 75%	register and sit for the RHIT certification exam 2 weeks after graduation, reducing their stress.	2025-26 Cohort of HIM students to register and sit for the RHIT certification exam before Graduation, as studies show that students that sit for the RHIT Exam early, before Graduation, do better on the exam.	in ensuring the HIM program provides the educational needs of students and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies. Continue to monitor.
4				

Evidence:

- AHIMA APAR Q4 RHIT School Score Report for August 1 2022 through July 31 2023
- Annual Program Assessment Report with Results August 1 2021 through July 31 2022

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Medical Coding CERT

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first cycle of the APR. There have been no previous reviews or data collected for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate.

Add start date of tracking the data for historical purposes such as:

AY 2022-23 was the first cycle of the MCTC APR. There have been no previous reviews or data collected for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management

The Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information management technicians with the knowledge, technical skills, and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that would afford our graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

No changes have been made to the VSCC HIM Program mission statement and no revisions are planned.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management for those students who wish to continue their studies. Students obtaining the HIM degree after completing the Medical

Coding Technical Certificate must update their coding knowledge prior to sitting for the national Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) Exam. All courses in the Medical Coding Certificate apply toward the HIM degree requirements. The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate students sit for the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) Certified Coding Associate (CCA) exam during their last semester in school.

The Health Information Management Program is highly central to the VSCC mission, vision, and core values. The Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information technicians with the knowledge, technical skills, and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that afford graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification. A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management for those students who wish to continue their studies. Students obtaining the Health Information Management degree after completing the Medical Coding Technical Certificate must update their coding knowledge prior to sitting for the national Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) Exam. All courses in the Medical Coding Certificate apply toward the Health Information Management degree requirements. This is a three-semester certificate that only begins in the summer semester of each year. Courses must be taken in sequence.

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate students sit for the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) Certified Coding Associate (CCA) exam, during their last semester, just before graduation. Coding professionals who hold the CCA credential have demonstrated coding competency across all settings, including hospitals and physician practices. Since 2002, the CCA designation has been a nationally recognized standard of achievement in the health information management (HIM) field.

CCAs:

- Exhibit a level of commitment, competency, and professional capability that is valued by employers.
- Demonstrate a commitment to the coding profession.
- Distinguish themselves from others as having passed AHIMA's rigorous CCA exam.

Medical Coding Technical Certificate Program Learning Outcomes

1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance.
2. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management.
3. Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance.
4. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.
5. Apply knowledge of pathophysiology, pharmacology, anatomy and physiology, medical terminology, computer concepts and computer applications as they relate to health information management.

Assessment Method and Target Level of Outcome

PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping.

In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements. Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #2 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #2. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient’s hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #3 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine the present on admission (POA) status indicator for each.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA’s Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

Additional Information

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate PLOs were assessed during the spring 2022 semester however, as noted above, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. There is no historical data to review for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate .

We require the Medical Coding Technical Certificate students to register and pay for the CCA exam during their last semester of school. We also book a week with the VSCC Pearson Vue Testing Center for the VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate and Health Information Management students to test for their CCA and RHIT certification exams.

AHIMA does not provide a CCA School Score Report so data is not readily available. For AY 22-23 we will ask the Medical Coding Technical Certificate students to email us with their test date and their CCA certification results, and explain the importance of sharing that information with us.

Evidence:

- MC, CERT Assessment Tool

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification. A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management for those students who wish to continue their studies. Students obtaining the HIM degree after completing the Medical Coding Technical Certificate must update their coding knowledge prior to sitting for the national Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) Exam. All courses in the Medical Coding Certificate apply toward the HIM degree requirements. This is a three-semester certificate that only begins in the summer semester of each year. Courses must be taken in sequence.

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) students sit for the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) Certified Coding Associate (CCA) exam, during their last semester, before graduation. Coding professionals who hold the CCA credential have demonstrated coding competency across all settings, including hospitals and physician practices. Since 2002, the CCA designation has been a nationally recognized standard of achievement in the health information management (HIM) field.

CCAs:

- Exhibit a level of commitment, competency, and professional capability that is valued by employers.
- Demonstrate a commitment to the coding profession.
- Distinguish themselves from others as having passed AHIMA's rigorous CCA exam.

The MCTC PLOs listed below were assessed during the spring 2022 semester using Via however, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. An analysis of the spring 2022 results was conducted.

Notations and summary of most recent assessments, AY21-22 Assessment Results:

HIM Program Students and MCTC Students are assessed in the HIMT 2305 and HIMT 2303 classes. In AY21-22 we also had students from the MPM major in the HIMT 2305 class, in spring 2022. The MPM major is no longer offered at VSCC so in the future, we will not have MPM students in this class. HIM students will continue to be in both classes. Assessing the data based on the students' majors will be necessary for analyzing accurate statistical data in the MCTC APR and the HIM APR. The attached AY21-22 Assessment Results for MCTC only reflect the results of the MCTC students.

Analysis of trends for Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) PLOs assessed:

- PLO #1 HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping 95% met; 5% not met
- PLO #2 HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission 100% met; 0% not met

- PLO #3 HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis 92% met; 8% not met
- PLO #4 HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making 78% met; 22% not met

Ideas to improve student learning:

- To increase the MCTC students learning and scores we will do the following:
 1. Delete PLO #1 Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, from HIMT 2305. This assignment will be moved to HIMT 1305 Computer Applications in HI, which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO, 1.6 DM (Data Management). This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies.
 2. Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for PLO #4 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.

Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) PLOs

- PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping. In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements.

Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

- PLO #2 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient’s hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

- PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #5 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine what the Present on Admission (POA) status is for each scenario.

- PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA’s Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

Historical Assessments, Analysis, Summary of Results, and Trends

There is no historical data for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate. We require the CCA students to register and pay for the CCA exam during their last semester of school. We also book a week with the VSCC Pearson Vue Testing Center for the VSCC MCTC students to test for their CCA certification exams.

AHIMA does not provide a CCA School Score Report so results data is not readily available. For AY 22-23 we will ask the MCTC students to email us with their test date and their CCA certification results, and explain the importance of sharing that information with us for improving the MCTC.

We created the following Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24:

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.

We created the following measured target outcome for meeting this goal:

The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.

Evidence of Student Learning:

Based on the assessment results in Via the MCTC is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the MCTC student learning we will delete PLO #1 from the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet the Data Management Specialty Track competency associated with this PLO. We will also provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for the assignment associated with PLO #4. We have also created an MCTC Student and Graduate Goal to assess for AY23-24.

Evidence:

- AY21-22 Medical Coding Assessment Results

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Graduate Numbers

- AY18-19 1 MCTC Graduate
- AY 19-20 8 MCTC Graduates
- AY 20-21 5 MCTC Graduates
- AY 21-22 1 MCTC Graduate

Advisory Board and Alumni

There is not an Advisory Board for the MCTC, however, we share any updates about the coding classes as well as the number of graduates. AHIMA does not provide a School Score Report for the CCA Exam so we

do not have pass rates. We ask the MCTC students to email and let us know when they sit for the CCA and to email us their results, but this method is not very effective.

52% of the VSCC HIM Advisory Board are VSCC Alumni. The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback each year on the HIM curriculum, which includes the MCTC curriculum.

The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM, including medical coding, and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities.

Perceptions of the Medical Coding Technical Certificate, students, and graduates are positive.

Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Graduate Surveys and Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Employer Surveys

Survey data is inconclusive of evidence because these surveys aggregate the HIM and MCTC students.

Summary/Trends/Identified Strengths

We will discuss with RASI the possibility of separating MCTC Employer Surveys and MCTC Graduate Surveys from HIM for future analysis.

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Retention

- **AY18-19 50%**
 - 4 students began the MCTC summer 2018
 - 1 graduated spring 2019
 - 1 graduated spring 2020 (also obtained MPM)
 - 1 never took all the required MCTC courses. This student did graduate with an MPM degree spring 2019.
 - 1 never returned after her summer MCTC courses
- **AY 19-20 71%**

- 14 MCTC students began summer 2019
 - 7 graduated spring 2020
 - 2 graduated spring 2021 (also obtained MPM)
 - 1 graduated spring 2022 (also obtained MPM)
 - 1 failed summer 2019 classes
 - 3 withdrew fall 2019
- **AY 20-21 63%**
 - 8 MCTC students began summer 2020
 - 5 graduated spring 2021
 - 1 student never returned after summer 2020
 - 2 withdrew fall 2020
- **AY 21-22 33%**
 - 3 MCTC students began summer 2021
 - 1 graduated spring 2022
 - 1 failed summer 2021 courses
 - 1 never returned fall 2021

Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Graduation

- AY18-19 1 MCTC Graduate
- AY 19-20 8 MCTC Graduates
- AY 20-21 5 MCTC Graduates
- AY 21-22 1 MCTC Graduate

Retention and Graduation Trends

The MCTC retention rates have varied for the last three years from 77% to 33%.

The MCTC graduation results for the last four years have also varied. There was an increase in graduation for AY19-20 with eight MCTC graduates and a decrease in graduation for AY 20-21 and AY 21-22.

Plans for improvement:

- Ensure all potential students have met with an HIM advisor prior to registration to ensure the student understands the following:
 - The MCTC is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification.
 - A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The curriculum will be difficult for any student who does not have this knowledge and understanding.
 - The MCTC curriculum is rigorous and students should expect to spend time working on course material and activities each day.
 - Most hospitals require medical coders to have at a minimum a two-year degree in Health Information Management (HIM) and pass the Registered Health Information Technician (RHIT) exam, and then obtain the Certified Coding Specialist (CCS) credential.
 - Graduates who successfully sit for the CCA may find employment as a medical coder at a physician's office, or working as a billing specialist.
 - MCTC graduates rarely are afforded an opportunity to work from home.

Evidence:

- 2022 Medical Coding Fact Sheet

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

Narrative:

Faculty Development Goal: The program will provide a plan for faculty that establishes or assesses the knowledge, skills, qualifications, and experience pertinent to the professional curriculum content that they are assigned to teach.

This includes efforts to keep current in health information management, including medical coding and reimbursement, and/or other relevant professional content and practice, as well as other components of advanced formal education.

Measured target outcome: All HIM faculty will obtain CEUs annually to improve faculty knowledge and expertise, and keep current in the health information management areas in which they teach. All HIM faculty will turn in proof of their AHIMA membership and continued certification annually

Steps to achieve: Faculty will attend CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, and professional development meetings to stay current in the topics they teach. One faculty member will attend AOE.

Results/Analysis/Actions: 100% of the HIM faculty are in compliance. Both faculty members attended the CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, the THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, professional development meetings, and AOE for AY20-21. We will continue to monitor.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

Narrative:

The VSCC Health Information Management (HIM) Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management.

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all courses by September 1, 2021 All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

Narrative:

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Students are Student AHIMA Members, <https://www.ahima.org/ahima-membership/membership-types-and-benefits/>

We encourage the MCTC students to attend the Annual THIMA Meeting and local Middle Tennessee Health Information Management Association (MTHIMA) Meetings.

The MCTC students are encouraged to sign up for the THIMA Mentor Program, <https://www.thima.org/members/mentor-program/>

The MCTC Students are encouraged to attend the AHIMA Student Open House during the fall semester. This complimentary virtual event offers the following:

- AHIMA Foundation scholarship opportunities
- How to transition from health information student to health information professional
- The top five emerging issues impacting health information management
- Building their personal brand on LinkedIn
- AHIMA credentials— options and where to get started
- Optimizing AHIMA student membership

Students also get a virtual tour of the new AHIMA Student Resources portal, with content and tools to help navigate their professional journey.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Narrative:

The VSCC Health Information Management (HIM) Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management.

The Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) strives to provide the public with effective and consistent quality monitoring of health informatics and health information management programs through maintenance of accreditation processes. CAHIIM is recognized by the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA).

Additional information about the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) including its mission, vision, core values, and strategic goals may be found on its website, [CAHIIM.org](https://www.cahiim.org)

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The

AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all courses by September 1, 2021. All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Narrative:

Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) graduates that obtain their CCA are considered Health Information Management (HIM) professionals, as entry-level coders. HIM professionals serve the healthcare industry wherever health information is collected, organized, and analyzed. HIM professionals work in a variety of healthcare settings, education, payer organizations, research and policy agencies, consulting, and legal firms.

According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) employment of medical records and health information technicians (those with a certificate and/or associate degree) is expected to increase by 9% from 2020-2030, much faster than the national average. The demand exceeds the number of qualified professionals.

The VSCC Associate of Applied Science in Health Information Management program is designed to teach students the 38 entry-level 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies developed by the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) and the Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) and approved by the Commission on Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). Our curriculum includes both of AHIMA's specialty tracks: revenue management (RM) and data management (DM), as recommended by our HIM Advisory Board. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management. Our MCTC curriculum prepares the MCTC student to sit for and pass the CCA and begin their HIM professional careers as entry-level medical coders.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

Results

Advisory Board

There is not a separate Advisory Board for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC), however, we share any updates and information about the coding classes as well as the number of graduates with the VSCC Health Information Management (HIM) Advisory Board. AHIMA does not provide a School Score Report for the CCA Exam so we do not have pass rates. We ask the MCTC students to email and let us know when they sit for the CCA and to email us their results, but this method is not very effective.

52% of the VSCC HIM Advisory Board are VSCC Alumni. The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback each year on the HIM curriculum, which includes the MCTC curriculum.

The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM, including medical coding, and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities.

Perceptions of the Medical Coding Technical Certificate, students, and graduates are positive.

MCTC Graduate Surveys and MCTC Employer Surveys

Survey data is inconclusive of evidence because these surveys aggregate the HIM and MCTC students.

Summary/Trends/Identified Strengths

We will discuss with RASI the possibility of separating MCTC Employer Surveys and MCTC Graduate Surveys from HIM for future analysis.

Retention/Graduation

The MCTC retention rates have varied for the last three years from 77% to 33%.

The MCTC graduation results for the last four years have also varied. There was an increase in graduation for AY19-20 with eight MCTC graduates and a decrease in graduation for AY 20-21 and AY 21-22.

Plans for improvement:

- Ensure all potential students have met with an HIM advisor prior to registration to ensure the student understands the following:
 - The MCTC is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification.
 - A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The curriculum will be difficult for any student who does not have this knowledge and understanding.
 - The MCTC curriculum is rigorous and students should expect to spend time working on course material and activities each day.
 - Most hospitals require medical coders to have at a minimum a two-year degree in Health Information Management (HIM) and pass the Registered Health Information Technician (RHIT) exam, and then obtain the Certified Coding Specialist (CCS) credential.
 - Graduates who successfully sit for the CCA may find employment as a medical coder at a physician's office, or working as a billing specialist.
 - MCTC graduates rarely are afforded an opportunity to work from home.

Assessments

Based on the assessment results in Via the MCTC is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the MCTC student learning we will delete PLO #1 from the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet the Data Management Specialty Track competency associated with this PLO. We will also provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for the assignments associated with PLO #3 and PLO #4. We have also created an MCTC Student and Graduate Goal to assess for AY23-24.

We will continue to analyze the assessments and results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the MCTC curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the CCA certification exam and become Certified Coding Associates with a comprehensive entry-level medical coding knowledge base. The HIM field, including medical coding and reimbursement, changes rapidly due to changes in EHRs, technology, software, government quality initiatives, laws, regulations, and incentive programs, as well as other industry changes; we will continue to update and change the MCTC and HIM curriculum as needed and required by CAHIIM, and the rapid changes in the HIM field.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 - Develop tutorial - Faculty review of the tutorial. - Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 - Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate. (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1.	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1	- Delete this PLO and move PLO #1 to the HIMT 1305 course which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO - This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies	HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty	N/A	AY22-23	95% met AY21-22
2.	Increase the percentage of	Provide additional	HIM Program	Increase the percentage	AY 22-23	92% met AY21-22

	MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #3	resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge	Director and HIM Faculty	met to 96%		
3.	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #4	Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge	HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty	Increase the percentage met to 82%	AY22-23	78% met AY21-22
4.	Created Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24: The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.	Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.	HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty	Baseline data not established for PI.	AY23-24	72% first-time pass rate

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

Program faculty provided a detailed 2-year recommendation plan for Medical Coding technical certificate program. Program learning outcomes will be reassigned into appropriate courses, along with removing outcomes that are not required for the program. The curricular changes in addition to additional resources, may have positive impacts on the student access goal of increasing first-time passage rates to at least 72%

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. The curricular changes proposed here make sense and should improve the quality of the program. I encourage the program to consider adding additional actions related to recruitment and retention given the low number of students participating in and completing the program.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1	Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum	No challenges.	This is no longer an outcome for the MCTC.	N/A

Competency associated with this SLO

- Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7:
 - AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48-52.
 - AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46-52.
 - HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35)
 - Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1).
 - Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets.

This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies

2	PLO #2 - Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.	Student was successful in meeting this.	Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #2 Case Study 4.17.	No changes to timeline.	The assignment for PLO #2 success rate was 100% with the one MCTC student scoring 100%. Continue to monitor.
3	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #3	Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.	Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #3 Case Study 5.4	No changes to timeline.	The assignment for PLO #3 success rate was 94% with the one MCTC student scoring 94%. Continue to monitor.
4	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #4	Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.	Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #4 Case Study 6.6	Previously we Increased the percentage met to 82%. No changes to timeline.	The assignment for PLO #4 success rate was 92% with the one MCTC student scoring 92%. Continue to monitor.
5	Created Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24: The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met	Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.	The student works for Spheris Health and they wanted her to obtain the AAPC CPC Exam instead of the AHIMA CCA Exam for promotion.	No changes to timeline.	The MCTC student did not sit for the AHIMA CCA Exam as employer wanted her to sit for the AAPC CPC Exam for promotion; Student passed the AAPC CPC

and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.				Exam on first attempt. Continue to monitor.
--	--	--	--	--

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1	- Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO - Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint	None.	This is no longer an outcome for the MCTC.	N/A

		Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7: - o AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52. - o AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52. - o HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35) - o Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1). - o Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets. This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies.			
2	PLO #2 - Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.	Students were successful in meeting this.	None.	The assignment for PLO #2 success rate was 100% with the two MCTC students scoring 100%. Continue to monitor.	Yes.

3	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #3	Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.	None.	The assignment for PLO #3 success rate was 72% with the one MCTC student scoring 63% and one MCTC student scoring 81%. Continue to monitor.	Yes.
4	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #4	Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.	None.	The assignment for PLO #4 success rate was 83% with each of the MCTC students scoring 83%. Continue to monitor.	Yes.
5	Created Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24: The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.	Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.	None.	Both of the MCTC students sat for and passed their CCA Exams.	Yes.

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis			
Initiative	How has this initiative supported student	Will there be any further action taken on this	How will this initiative inform

		learning or student success?	initiative? If yes, explain.	program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
	Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1	• Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO • Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7: ◦ AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52. ◦ AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52. ◦ HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35) ◦ Joint Commission on Accreditation of	The other PLOs will need to be renumbered.	This is no longer an outcome for the MCTC.

		Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1). Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets. This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies		
1	For Year 2, PLO #s 2-5 Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #s 2-5.	N/A	In the future, if students are in eLearn but not in Watermark, faculty will notify the VSCC Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment Officer so that those students may be added to Watermark. Investigated and found student registered for these classes in November, so further investigation by RASI Department may reveal the cause of this student not being in Watermark to help prevent this from happening again.	In the future, if students are in eLearn but not in Watermark, faculty will notify the VSCC Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment Officer so that those students may be added to Watermark.
2	PLO #2 - Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle	PLO #2 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they	This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #1 due to deleting previous PLO #1.	The assignment for SLO #2 success rate was 100% met.

	management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.	relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission. In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient's hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.		Continue to monitor.
3	PLO #3 - Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.	PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding. Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis. In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine what the Present on Admission (POA) status is for each scenario.	This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #2 due to deleting previous PLO #1. Provide the following additional resources for students to use with this assignment: • Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality, Healthcare Cost and Utilization Project (HICUP) Present on Admission (POA) Indicator Toolkit • Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services Hospital-Acquired Conditions Present on Admission Indicator	The assignment for PLO #3 success rate was 94% with the one MCTC student scoring 94%. Continue to monitor

			• DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Hospital-Acquired Conditions and Present on Admission Indicator Reporting Provision • US Department of Health and Human Services, Hospital-Acquired Conditions (Present on Admission Indicator): Coding. Guidance for identifying Present on Admission (POA) indicators for all diagnoses reported on claims involving inpatient admissions to general acute care hospitals.	
4	PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.	PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making. In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and,	This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #3 due to deleting previous PLO #1.	The assignment for SLO #4 success rate was 86% met. Continue to monitor.

		if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA's Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.		
5	PLO #5 - The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.	The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.	This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #4 due to deleting previous PLO #1.	One MCTC student did not sit for the AHIMA CCA Exam as employer wanted her to sit for the AAPC CPC Exam for promotion; Student passed the AAPC CPC Exam on first attempt. The other two MCTC graduates sat for and passed their AHIMA CCA certification exams. Continue to monitor.
	Based on the assessment results in Via and the Annual Program Assessment results the MCTC is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. We will continue to analyze the assessments and	N/A	N/A	continue to analyze the assessments and results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the

	results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the MCTC curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the CCA certification exam and become MCTC professionals with a comprehensive entry-level MCTC knowledge base. The MCTC field changes rapidly due to changes in EHRs, technology, software, government quality initiatives, laws, regulations, and incentive programs, as well as other industry changes; we will continue to update and change the MCTC curriculum as needed and required by CAHIIM, and the rapid changes in the HIM and MCTC fields.		MCTC curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the CCA certification exam and become MCTC professionals with a comprehensive entry-level MCTC knowledge base.
--	---	--	--

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Radiologic Technology AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

No previous APRs have been completed. Prior reporting was executed on IE reports.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

MISSION STATEMENT:

The mission of the Radiologic Technology Program at Volunteer State Community College is to produce entry-level graduates that are competent technologists, registry eligible, and demonstrate a professional concern for their patients.

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

The program did not make any changes to the mission statement over the course of this cycle. We review our mission statement annually with our Radiologic Technology Advisory Board. We will continue to present this to our advisory board and make changes as necessary.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Graduates from the radiologic technology program will support the college's mission by providing skilled radiographers to the imaging community. Graduates will utilize their education and skills in hospital settings, outpatient imaging centers, and various types of clinics and imaging centers throughout the country. The radiologic technology program enrolls both traditional and non-traditional students to achieve a degree in a medical imaging that will be in high demand for years to come. The radiologic technology program also prepares graduates to pursue credentials in many other imaging modalities as well as bridging their A.A.S. degree into a B.S.R.S. degree through East Tennessee State University.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

The Radiologic Technology Program has a comprehensive assessment process to ensure continuous improvement and accountability. The assessment plan identifies benchmarks for the measurement of outcomes in relation to its mission statement, philosophy, and goals.

Assessment plans are evaluated annually and adjustments are made according to technical changes or program advisement from the radiology advisory board, the Dean of Health Sciences, the Vice President of Academic Affairs.

Evidence:

- Assessment Plan 2020-2021
- RADT AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- RADT, AAS Assessment Tool

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The program faculty analyzes student learning outcomes and program effectiveness data twice a year during planned assessment review meetings. The team reviews the criteria used in projects and assessments which effect student learning outcomes. The results of student learning outcomes and program effectiveness data are shared at the fall advisory meeting. Advisory committee members are encouraged to provide input regarding student learning outcomes and their effectiveness. The program processes changes based on the findings of the analysis. Advisory board meetings are held annually.

The program uses analysis of employer and graduate exit surveys to highlight areas for program improvement. The information is used to determine if program updates are needed.

In support of the program's mission statement, the following have been developed.

Upon completion of the radiography program our students / graduates will have successfully completed a number of goals and student learning outcomes:

Program Goal-Clinical Competency.

Students will demonstrate competency in the skills required of entry level radiologic technologists.

Student Learning Outcome(s):

1. Students will demonstrate proper patient positioning.
2. Students will properly determine technical factors to be used for radiographic procedures.
3. Students will apply knowledge of anatomy to accurately demonstrate desired anatomical structures on a patient diagnostic procedure.

Program Goal-Problem Solving and Critical Thinking

Students will demonstrate effective problem solving and critical thinking skills.

Student Learning Outcome(s):

1. Students will be able to evaluate radiographic images.
2. Students will be able to exercise judgment in the technical performance of medical imaging procedures.
3. Students adapt appropriately to changing needs of patients.

Program Goal-Professionalism

Students will exhibit professionalism for the patients by delivering high quality care with concern and compassion.

Student Learning Outcome(s):

1. Students will demonstrate professionalism.
2. Students will practice desirable customer service skills.
3. Students will show compassion and concern towards the patient.
4. Students present a professional appearance in the clinical setting.

Program Goal-Communication Skills

Students will establish effective communication skills.

Student Learning Outcome(s):

1. Students will use acceptable communication with patients and other professionals.
2. Students will use effective oral and written communication.

Evidence:

- 2019 Test Scores
- 2020 Test Scores
- 2021 Test Scores
- AY2021-2022 RADT, AAS Assessment Results
- vscc_rad_program_data 2022

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Best practices:

- Preparing the next teaching activity before the current one finishes, therefore creating continuity
- Involving students in classroom activities, to improve their communication, interpersonal and collaboration skills

- Creating a teaching activity by first defining its end goal and then determining the steps to get there
- Using resources such as lesson plans to have a benchmark that can improve teaching techniques
- Motivating students in the radiologic technology program to have a demeanor, appearance and character that they can use as examples.

Graduate Surveys

Graduates surveys completed for students graduating in the spring of 2019, 2020, and 2021 yielded positive results. These surveys are the latest set of surveys available to the program. The average mean score on the overall quality of preparation as an entry-level radiologic technologist surveys for 2018, 2019, and 2020 revealed a mean score of 4.18 out of 5.00. The lowest section score on the survey was a 4.00 out of 5.00 on program quality.

The radiologic technology program has endured a lot of faculty turnover in the past 5 years. These changes required faculty teaching overload and teaching courses that they had not previously taught. These changes clearly had an impact on the quality of the program. The program has recently filled open positions and is fully staffed. The faculty will continue to implement and reinforce the learning methods and techniques used, and continue to improve on the quality of the courses.

Feedback received from students on graduate surveys reflected the students' desire to be have more experience in the operating room and the lab. Program faculty have incorporated lab exercises to acclimate students to the equipment and procedures in the operating room, as well as various other lab exercises to reinforce positioning skills.

Employer Surveys

Response rate for employers is low, with an average of 53.3% response rate over the three years of employer satisfaction surveys. The employer surveys analysis reveals that employers responded that come students to their facilities with more, or less, or the exact level of entry skills with a mean score of 2.53 out of 5.00. Faculty will work with clinical affiliates to communicate when students are lacking in skills. In addition, faculty will reinforce skills with additional lab exercises. These areas for improvement should increase over time with the graduates' years of professional clinical experience

Evidence:

- 2018 RADT AAS Employer Survey
- 2018 RADT AAS Graduate Survey
- 2019 RADT AAS Employer Survey
- 2019 RADT AAS Graduate Survey
- 2020 RADT AAS Employer Survey
- 2020 RADT AAS Graduate Survey

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

The program publishes program effectiveness data on the VSCC website at www.volstate.edu/radtech. Program effectiveness data is also included in the annual report to the Joint Review Committee on education in Radiologic Technology (JRCERT).

Radiology program faculty market the program to high school students in various ways. Faculty participate annually in between 5-10 high school visits per year. High school visits give faculty an opportunity to discuss the profession of radiologic technology. Program faculty have also visited several local high schools to make potential students aware of the radiology technology program at VSCC.

The radiology program accepts 30 students annually. The retention rate over the past 5 years totals 84%. Program job placement over the past 5 years is 95%. First time credentialing exam rate for the past 5 years is 89%.

The faculty will incorporate tutoring for students that need additional course remediation to help improve retention. The program has consistently seen improvement in first time credentialing exam pass rate over the past 5 years. The most recent cohort graduating and achieved 100% first time pass rate.

Evidence:

- 2022 RAD Fact Sheet
- vscc_rad_program_data 2022

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Evidence:

- JRCERT Accreditation Letter 09-25-19

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The Radiologic Technology Program will concentrate on enrollment, retention, AART licensure first-time pass rate over the next few years. Overall the program outcomes are very good but they could improve in the area retention. The retention rate averaged over three years (2020, 2021, 2022) is 84%.

The area that the program will concentrate on most heavily in the next few years is retention. Faculty will incorporate tutoring in courses and labs to help remediate students' grades in hopes of increasing retention.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Student Learning

1. Students will score 70% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the ARRT credentialing exam (PLO 12)
2. Students will attend a two-day, onsite Kettering seminar licensure exam review course prior to taking the ARRT exam (PLO 12, PLO 13)

Student Success

Students will attend and participate in mandatory course and lab remediation sessions during the two-year program to help improve course grades and remain in the program. This will ensure that we are working to improve retention in the Radiologic Technology Program.

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

In the face of several changes in faculty over the past three years, the program has successfully been able to yield graduates with a 100% pass rate on the credentialing examination and obtainment of gainful employment. Nevertheless, focusing on retention is warranted. Successful completion of the student learning and success outcomes could improve their knowledge base and support their ability to remain in the program. Another area of focus should be on graduate perception of program quality as approximately 11% of the Graduate Survey respondents rated it as fair. A deeper dive into comments from student evaluations and recent graduate surveys will assist in identifying concerns which could potentially have an impact on retention.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the

results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Students will score 70% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the ARRT credentialing exam (PLO 12)				
2	Students will attend a two-day, onsite Kettering seminar licensure exam review course prior to taking the ARRT exam (PLO 12, PLO 13)				
3	Students will attend and participate in mandatory course and lab remediation sessions during the two-year program to help improve course grades and remain in the program. This will ensure that we are working to improve retention in the Radiologic Technology Program.				
4					

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
1	Students will score 70% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the ARRT credentialing exam (PLO 12)				

2	Students will attend a two-day, onsite Kettering seminar licensure exam review course prior to taking the ARRT exam (PLO 12, PLO 13)			
3	Students will attend and participate in mandatory course and lab remediation sessions during the two-year program to help improve course grades and remain in the program. This will ensure that we are working to improve retention in the Radiologic Technology Program.			
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Respiratory Care Technology AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is Respiratory Care's first cycle participating in an Academic Program Review. There is not any previous data to review or report.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement

The Respiratory Care Technology program at Volunteer State Community College provides a transferable degree created within a diverse educational environment which promotes the practice of critical thinking and problem solving, the development of clinical competence, and the advancement of the respiratory care profession through life-long learning.

No revisions have been made to the program's mission statement.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Program Mission Statement

The Respiratory Care Technology program at Volunteer State Community College provides a transferable degree created within a diverse educational environment which promotes the practice of critical thinking and problem solving, the development of clinical competence, and the advancement of the respiratory care profession through life-long learning.

Respiratory Care Technology graduates will support the college's mission statement by providing expert skills to care and treat pulmonary diseases in the respiratory care community. The program prepares the graduates to care for patients in many healthcare settings, including hospitals with acute care areas, intensive care units, critical care units, emergency departments, inpatient and outpatient rehabilitation, post anesthesia care units, outpatient clinics and home care. Vol State's Respiratory Care Technology Program foster's close relationships with clinical affiliates that provide students with a variety of different patient care experiences. The close relationships with community partnerships allows the students of all backgrounds to shape and mold skill sets learned during the course work of the program. The community partnerships promote diversity and cultural awareness while providing an educational environment allowing students of all backgrounds to utilize skills learned from the respiratory care technology program.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

The program's learning outcomes for the Respiratory Care Technology Program will be assessed in RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation I and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. The Respiratory Care Technology Program has four Student Learning Objectives.

- Demonstrate the ability to comprehend, apply, and evaluate clinical information relevant to their role as a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).
- Demonstrate the technical proficiency in all skills necessary to fulfill the role as a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).
- Demonstrate personal behaviors consistent with professional and employer expectations as a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).
- Successfully meet employer expectations by competently performing skills required of a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).

The program designated the first and second semester out of four to assess the student learning outcomes. Assessing the outcomes is being completed to monitor the progression of knowledge and skills during the semesters that require laboratory check-offs. The learning outcomes will assess the knowledge and skills required to become a registered respiratory therapist to pass two national board examinations and to be considered competent employees by respiratory therapy departments that will employ the graduate.

The learning outcomes will be assessed through laboratory check-offs during the first and second semesters. The course instructor will perform check-offs on each student for the required laboratory skills. Each student must successfully pass each laboratory check-off within four attempts. The student is being evaluated on effectiveness of communication, knowledge of check-off being performed, performance and safety of check-off, and thorough documentation of the check-off completed. The student demonstrates the skill being evaluated for the check-off step-by-step for the course instructor. The student is evaluated by one of the four levels identifying whether the student passes or fails the check-off attempt. The levels of evaluation for check-offs are:

- Done Correctly
- Not Done Correctly
- Not Done
- Not Applicable

To successfully pass the laboratory check-off the student must complete each step of the check-off with "Done Correctly. Once the student successfully completes the laboratory check-off the student is then allowed to complete the check-off and skill clinically. Program faculty demonstrate, observe, and remediate the students while practicing each laboratory check-off prior to the scheduled laboratory check-off date. Program faculty ensure the students are meeting successful completion of check-off within four attempts and continue to practice and improve their skills in the clinical setting.

Respiratory Care Technology Program [Check-off Forms](#) for viewing.

Evidence:

- Laboratory and Clinical Check-off Forms
- Respiratory Care Technology AAS Curriculum Map

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The Respiratory Care Technology Program currently assesses student and program outcomes based on data from the Therapist Multiple Choice Examination (TMC) and the Clinical Simulation Examination (CSE) through the National Board for Respiratory Care (NBRC). Additionally, laboratory check-offs from the two key assessment courses (RESP 2440 and RESP 1420), course and graduate surveys are utilized for assessment. The data obtained from these items will be used to determine if the program's curriculum is effectively being taught.

The spring of 2022 is when respiratory care implemented two key assessment courses. The two courses the program has chosen is RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation (first semester) and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II (second semester). Currently, there is not enough data to report a trend or to implement any changes. The data from spring and summer 2022 show 100% of the assessment was met and 0% not met.

Key Assessment Courses

RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation this course studies the techniques of mechanical ventilation including initiation and modification of settings. The assessment for this course will be how many students successfully completed a ventilatory check check-off and to evaluate how many attempts it takes the student to complete the check-off correctly.

RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II this course continues to build on respiratory care procedures and monitoring. The assessment for this course will be looking at how many students successfully complete an arteriotomy check-off and how many attempts does it take the student to complete the check-off correctly.

National Board Examinations and Passage Rates

To become a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT) the graduates must pass both the Therapist Multiple Choice Examination (TMC) and the Clinical Simulation Examination (CSE). It is a requirement that the first examination will be the TMC. There are two scoring levels for this examination the high-cut score and the low-cut score. If the high-cut score is obtained the graduate is then eligible to take the CSE. If the graduates passed the CSE they are now an RRT. If the low-cut score is obtained on the TMC examination the graduate is not eligible to take the CSE, but the CRT credential is awarded becoming a Certified Respiratory Therapist (CRT). If the graduate desires to obtain the RRT credential. The graduate must retest starting with the TMC examination and must score at the high-cut score to be eligible for the CSE.

Passage Rates for Registered Respiratory Therapist

	Cohort Number	CSE
2019	13	12/13 – 92.31%
2020	11	11/11 – 100%
2021	10	5/9 – 55.56%

The program has strong passage rates on the national board examinations in the 2019 and 2020 cohort to award the RRT credential. The focus is the CSE for the program obtaining the registry credential. The 2021 cohort has a significant decline in passage rates due to COVID-19. This cohort of students began the program in January 2020. The program is set-up for the didactic courses and laboratory courses to be synchronous. In March 2020, the program went completely online from face-to-face and laboratory courses were put on hold. Throughout the remaining program courses were moved from

different semesters to accommodate online learning. This was until the students could return to campus for laboratory courses while continuing didactic courses online. Additionally, the students did not get to begin clinical rotations until fall 2020, one full semester of clinical rotations were missed. Additionally, the fall 2020 clinical semester was limited on hands-on patient care and clinical experiences due to clinical affiliate restrictions. During the fall 2020 semester respiratory care students were not allowed to treat COVID-19 patients. As publicized, COVID-19 is a respiratory related illness causing which should have been the students second semester of clinical rotations as almost completely hands-off on patient care. This cohort of students truly had a disadvantage on caring for patients, developing their critical thinking, problem solving, and troubleshooting skills. The time the students were able to participate in clinical rotations was less than half for a standard cohort. The combination of the program becoming online, laboratory courses were no longer synchronous with didactic, and one semester of clinical rotations were missed lead to a significant decrease in passage rates.

The official CSE School Summary Reports from the National Board for Respiratory Care have been uploaded for evidence. The Respiratory Care Technology Program at Vol State consistently has higher than national average passage rates excluding the 2021 cohort from COVID. The 2021 cohort, academic year 2020 – 2021 is 0.36% from the national average passage rates. Although the program is happy with the passage rates on the national board examinations. There are always areas for improvement.

The examination report from the National Board for Respiratory Care breaks down the content areas aligning with a detailed content outline showing the matrix of material tested. Each year the program director evaluates the score reports for both TMC and CSE examinations. Any area(s) from the score report for the cohort that has scored <85% of national mean the program director creates an action plan. In 2020, section 2B which is Ensure Infection Prevention had a subscore of 72% of national mean. This section includes adhering to infection prevention policies and procedures, adhering to disinfection policies and procedures, and proper handling of biohazardous materials. All remaining subscores are greater than 85% of national mean on the New Candidate Summary (in evidence). Program faculty implemented the action plan of reviewing isolation procedures, donning and doffing of personal protective equipment, implemented hand hygiene video, and created a separate presentation covering the different levels of infection control. The extra efforts of implementing the action plan successfully increased the subscore by 19%. In 2021, section 2B increased to 91% on national mean. Program faculty continue to monitor subscores for each and implement action plans for areas that have a score less than 85% for the 2022 – 2023 academic year.

Starting with the 2022 – 2023 academic year, the Respiratory Care Technology Program will assess the course and program learning outcomes in its key assessment courses, RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. The program chose those two courses for assessment to provide evidence from the first semester to the second semester that the students are being effectively taught and can demonstrate proficiency in their skills required in becoming a Registered Respiratory Therapist. Program faculty hope all students achieve “Done Correctly” on all laboratory check-offs within two attempts. If areas of weakness are identified by assessment data indicating greater than two attempts to complete a laboratory check-off, program faculty will concentrate on strengthening areas of weakness to improve assessment outcomes.

Evidence:

- 2018-2019 RESP Test Scores, Cohort 2019
- 2019 Annual Report
- 2019-2020 RESP Test Scores, Cohort 2020
- 2020 Annual Report
- 2020-2021 RESP Test Scores, Cohort 2021
- 2021 Annual Report
- AY2021-2022 RESP, AAS Assessment Results

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Graduate Surveys

[Graduate Surveys](#) completed for students graduating in spring of 2021 yielded positive scores. These survey results are the latest surveys available to the program. The three main categories on the survey average a mean score 4.88 out of 5.00. The score for Program Quality was 4.50 out of 5. The survey scores did not show any response less than 4.88. A comment was made on the area of the survey how to improve/strengthen the Respiratory Care Technology Program. The suggestion made was more hands-on care with neonatal patients in clinical rotations, especially deliveries of babies. The director of clinical education regularly schedules students for clinical rotations at two clinical affiliates that specialize in neonatal care each semester. The program director will continue to monitor survey results and comments to make adjustments where needed. The program director will ensure the students continue to have clinical rotations with neonatal experience. The Commission on Accreditation for Respiratory Care (CoARC) has a set threshold of 80% for Graduate Satisfaction. The 2021 graduate surveys met the threshold at 100%.

Employer Surveys

[Employer Surveys](#) were completed from employers that employee graduates from spring of 2021. Eight surveys were emailed out to the graduates current employers. This graduating class had 10 students. Two of the graduates were not employed. Seven out of the eight surveys sent out were returned. The overall response rating of the employer surveys were 3.71 out of 5.00. The Commission on Accreditation for Respiratory Care (CoARC) has set a threshold of 80% to be met for Employer Satisfaction. The 2021 survey results show the program's threshold was met with 86%.

Two areas scoring less than 4.00 on the surveys are the following:

- I. Knowledge Base: Initiate appropriate therapeutic interventions, monitor patient responses, and modify therapy to achieve goals.
 - Score indicated 3.86 out of 5.00.
- II. Clinical Proficiency: Apply problem-solving strategies in the patient care setting.
 - Score indicated 3.86 out of 5.00.

The first two sections Knowledge Base and Clinical Proficiency were significantly impacted due to the lack of clinical rotations during the pandemic of COVID-19. This cohort of students missed their first semester of clinical rotations. The students were able to participate in clinical rotations beginning in the fall 2020 semester. The clinical rotations were limited for hands-on patient care due to clinical affiliates limiting students to care for patients only that were not COVID-19 positive. During this cohort many patients across the state were COVID-19 positive. Also, with COVID-19 being heavily respiratory related students did not have adequate hands-on patient care experience to sharpen their critical thinking and problem solving skills. Additionally, some of the spring 2020 and summer 2020 laboratory check-offs were not complete for the fall 2020 clinical rotations limiting what the students could participate in clinically.

Student Resource Surveys

The student resource surveys were administered to the 16 students in the 2021 cohort with a 100% response rate. This cohort's data is for the 2021 - 2022 academic year. The overall response rate for the

resources of the program is a 4.69 out of 5.00. The resources include faculty, classroom, laboratory equipment, academic resources, and clinical resources. The surveys from this cohort do not reflect the clinical resources.

The lowest score on the student resource surveys were variety of equipment to perform required laboratory exercises. The pandemic affected students being able to participate in laboratory exercises and complete laboratory check-offs in a timely manner. Additionally, laboratory exercises were modified to accommodate The Centers of Disease Control guidelines for COVID-19. Program faculty modified how procedures were practiced and performed to reduce the spread of aerosol particles in hopes to maintain infection control which limited use of some equipment. These modifications restricted practicing laboratory check-offs with direct face to face, one-on-one, hands-on experiences. Program faculty worked with students to verbalize each step of the check-off to ensure understanding and demonstrate how the check-off is correctly performed. Additionally, to ensure proper technique and patient safety. If there were areas that the student verbalized or demonstrated incorrectly the students was remediated on the areas that were incorrect. Since these surveys were conducted the program has purchases five pieces of new equipment and laboratory practice is back to pre COVID-19 standards. The students are able to practice hands-on and participate one-on-one with each other to perfect their skills for their laboratory check-offs. Remediation is continued for students that do not pass their check-offs.

Program Resource Surveys

[Program Resource Surveys](#) were completed by advisory committee members, Vol State program faculty, and the program's adjunct clinical instructors for the 2021 - 2022 academic year. The overall score from the resource surveys combining all categories is a 4.71 out of 5.00. The score for facilities and laboratory is a 4.72 out of 5.00. Academic support and financial resources score was a 4.68 out of 5.00. The clinical resources available to students scored a 4.68 out of 5.00.

Feedback provided on the resource surveys included:

- Laboratory Equipment needs updating and serviced.
 - The program director has been in contact with the mechanical ventilator service department for two mechanical ventilators that need servicing and new updated software installed. The program director is in process of getting the two mechanical ventilators scheduled for maintenance.
- Adjunct Laboratory Instructor:
 - The advisory committee members expressed the need for additional program faculty by adding an adjunct laboratory instructor. The program director has been in communication with Human Resources at Vol State to post a Pool Adjunct Instructor Position to see if there is interest for a laboratory instructor. The need for an adjunct instructor is heavy in the spring semester. The spring semester of the program is when there are two cohorts of students with didactic, laboratory, and clinical components. Both the program director and director of clinical education have heavy teaching and administrative roles during the spring semester. The program director will continue to advertise and seek out interest for the adjunct position.

Evidence:

- 2018 RESP AAS Employer Survey
- 2018 RESP AAS Graduate Survey
- 2019 RESP AAS Employer Survey Results
- 2019 RESP AAS Graduate Survey
- 2020 RESP AAS Employer Survey
- 2020 RESP AAS Graduate Survey
- 2021 RESP AAS Employer Surveys
- 2021 RESP AAS Graduate Surveys
- 2021 RESP Program Resource Surveys

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

All statistic information for this section of the APR is based off of The Commission on Accreditation for Respiratory Care (CoARC) Annual Report. The data is the most accurate to the program's cohorts not academic years versus the Fact Book.

Enrollment, Retention, and Graduation

The Respiratory Care Technology Program has consistent years of high number of program applicants, but has seen a decline in program applicants since 2014. The program is able to accept/enroll 22 students maximum for each cohort. A brief history to lay out when the program started to see a decline in program applicants. Prior to the 2014 cohort the number of program applicants ranged between 65 to 105 applicants for each cohort. In 2014, the program was restructured to begin in the summer semester instead of the fall semester to produce graduates at different times of year from other respiratory programs in the state. This change was made in hopes for all graduates to obtain employment beginning each fall after graduation. In 2016, the program had to restructure the layout of when classes/cohort(s) would start the program to accommodate the requirements for Tennessee Promise. As posted on page six of the 2022 CoARC's Annual Report the number of applicants have decreased since 2014 - 2015 cohort. The now enrollment of the spring semester for each starting cohort has limited students to one semester to complete the program's pre-requisites. In some cases, this change causes students to have to wait one-full year to apply to the program depending on when the student begins to take pre-requisite courses. If a student begins taking pre-requisites in the summer semester and finishes the pre-requisites in the fall semester they are eligible to apply and interview for the next starting spring cohort. All program applications are due by October 1st each year. Program interviews take place one week in November. Typically, the week before Thanksgiving. Final selection to the program is made after all final grades are posted in December.

In the 2022 - 2023 cohort the program received a total of 60 program applications. 33 interviews were scheduled and out of the scheduled interviews thirteen applicants were no call no shows. The program director reached out to those thirteen applicants via email and telephone to see if another interview date or time could be rescheduled. Only one applicant responded to rescheduling an interview. Due to the significant drop in scheduling and attending a program interview. The program director reached out to all of the Anatomy and Physiology Professors and the Medical Terminology Coordinator to see if they would be willing to share information about the Respiratory Care Technology Program with

their students. In response to this additional outreach the program was able to schedule one additional interview and that applicant was accepted into the 2022 - 2023 cohort. The program offered eighteen students seats in the 2022 - 2023 cohort. There were eighteen applicants that were eligible for enrollment. The 2022 - 2023 cohort started with fourteen students. During the first semester the cohort lost four students. The reason the four students left the program was due to personal health reasons or decided the field of respiratory care was not for them. The 2022 - 2023 cohort has 10 students and are scheduled to graduate in spring 2023.

CoARC's Annual Report shows the following statistics for retention. CoARC's threshold for retention is 70%. The program's threshold is an 87% or greater for retention according to CoARC's standards. Over the last three years the program has exceeded the set threshold for retention. Additionally, CoARC does not count students that withdraw from the program for personal reasons as a decline in the retention percentage. A student failing out of the program from academics is when the program's retention is negatively impacted.

2019 - 2021 Retention and Graduate Data				
	Enrolled	Percent Retention	Graduates	Number of Students Dropped Due to Academics
2019	20	90%	11	2
2020	15	87%	10	2
2021	18	100%	16	0

As noted from the table above the 2019 and 2020 cohorts had two students that were dismissed from the program due to failing academics. The program's academic rigor is challenging and accelerated. It is difficult for students to work full-time and successfully complete this accelerated program. Many of the students that withdraw from the program it is due to needing to work full-time to support their family, the student(s) decide respiratory care is not the field for them, or a variety of personal reasons cause the student(s) to withdraw. Program faculty encourage students to develop study groups, practice laboratory check-offs outside of scheduled class times, apply for scholarships, apply for Workforce essentials to help financially with the program if one qualifies, and meet with their instructors for tutoring.

From CoARC's standards on retention the need is for the program director to continue to monitor the program's retention since the program exceeds the threshold. The program director plans to incorporate a remediation plan to the program's student policy and procedure manual. Currently, program faculty regularly provide remediation to students in need based on examination grades and/or laboratory check-offs. The program does not have an official benchmark set for remediation for the program faculty to utilize to determine set grades or standards when remediation should be initiated.

Recruitment

Respiratory Care faculty participate regularly in high school visits for health sciences programs to promote the field of respiratory care and Vol State's Respiratory Care Technology Program. The only exception has been during the pandemic when schools did not have students face to face. Many students do not know what a respiratory therapist does or what patient populations respiratory therapist care for. Additionally, the program director started hosting monthly program information sessions in the fall of 2021 to increase awareness for the program. The clinical director host an annual smoking cessation event beginning fall 2021 on the Gallatin Campus. This event attracts many students on campus to learn about smoking cessation and about the field of respiratory care. As mentioned previously, the program director has reached out to the Anatomy and Physiology Faculty and the Medical Terminology Coordinator to showcase the field of respiratory care and the program at Vol State. The program director also works with Vol State's marketing department to post respiratory care related events, information sessions, and program application deadline. Program faculty have attended career expos and middle and high school events to promote the Respiratory Care Technology Program at Vol State. Program faculty will continue in their efforts in recruiting.

Evidence:

- 2022 Annual Report

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from creditable industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Evidence:

- RPC Accreditation thru 2026

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The Respiratory Care Technology Program will concentrate on enrollment and retention over the next few years. The program will work to retain a greater number of students by implementing a remediation policy as mentioned in the academic program review. Additionally, the program will continue to work on increasing enrollment to the maximum amount. Program faculty will continue to work and dedicate on recruiting efforts through college and community involvement.

Program faculty will continue to use the most recent Therapist Multiple Choice Examination and Clinical Simulation Examination score reports to strengthen areas of the program curriculum. In addition, the program will utilize the assessment results of the program and student learning outcomes over the next two years to ensure program curriculum is effectively being taught.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 - Develop tutorial - Faculty review of the tutorial. - Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 - Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate. (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1.	Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO #1.	Improving the passage rates by the second attempt on these two laboratory check-offs Ventilator Check and Arteriotomy will help students gain competency quicker by tailoring their skills.	Program Director and Director of Clinical Education	1). Increase laboratory check-off passage rates by the second attempt. 2). Each student has four attempts to successfully complete their laboratory check-off.	- AY 2023-2024 - Faculty will review check-off criteria and review expectations with students prior to laboratory check-off performance during the spring and summer semesters.	1). 2022 - 2023 Cohort has a 100% on passage rate on the laboratory check-offs by the second attempt in RESP 2440 and a 80% passage rate in RESP 1420. 2). 100% of the students met the SLO #1 by the fourth attempt.

2.	Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.	Clinical Simulation Examination score reports continue to be monitored for areas with a score less than 85% of national mean.	Program Director	1). Develop action plans to aid in improvement of scored areas less than 85%.	-AY 2023 - 2024. The Program Director will implement needed changes on areas from the NBRC's Detailed Content Outline with a score of less than 85% of national means.	1). 2021 - 2022 cohort 15/16 students passed the Clinical Simulation Examination and obtained the RRT credential.
3.	Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than the current program average.	Increasing retention produces a higher number of graduates for employers to hire respiratory therapists and helps reduce the national shortage of RRTs.	Program Director and Director of Clinical Education	1). Maximum enrollment is 22 students per cohort. 2). Retain 10% or more of enrolled students per cohort.	-AY 2023-2024 - Implement program remediation plan.	1). Retention rate is 87% or greater.

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

The faculty of the Respiratory Care program submitted a thorough 1st-year APR. The two-year recommendation plan addresses learning outcomes, enrollment, and retention. I recommend unbundling enrollment and retention to focus on them as separate initiatives and assigning two performance indicators to each category. In addition to enrolling the maximum number of students in the next cohort, adding a recruiting effort that applies to the current population of general education students at the college could be helpful. It is mentioned that students who withdraw tend to do so due to personal issues such as work-life imbalances. Implementing a remediation plan is an excellent addition to aid in retention.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. I agree with the dean's suggestion to separate recruiting from retention in that initiative. Both are important, but they will require different strategies and so tracking them as separate initiatives would be better. I also agree that having earlier assessment will give the program more time to help assist students with remediation and should help improve passage rates.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

Action Plan Status Reports**YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Action Plan Number I: Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440	RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off the 2022-2023 cohort successfully completed the ventilator check-off in two attempts or less.	Arterial Blood Gas Analysis check-off is a challenging check-off to complete due to the complexity of the skill.	No changes needed for this check-off. The students are given two weeks to practice the Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off in lab prior to check-offs. If a student does not successfully pass their check-off	Achievement of each student successfully passing their check-offs by the fourth attempt meets the SLO# 1 with a 100% passage rate for check-off completion. The

	Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1.	The ten students in the cohort during this spring semester completed the ventilator check, check-off successfully on the first attempt. RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II, Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off for the 2022-2023 cohort shows eight of the ten students successfully passed their check-off by the second attempt. Two out of the ten successfully completed their check-off by the third or fourth attempt.		the student is remediated and has the opportunity to ask questions and to receive help.	SLO #1 states students will successfully complete their check-offs by the fourth attempt.
2	Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.	Ten students graduated in the 2022-2023 cohort. All ten students successfully completed the Clinical Simulation Examination on the first attempt.	The Clinical Simulation Examination has eighteen content and section type subscores. The 2022-2023 cohort had three sections below the required national mean of 85% of greater. Content and section type subscores 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention, 3D. Administer Medications and Specialty Gases, and 3 G. Provide Respiratory Care in High-Risk Situations were the challenge areas with the 2022-2023 Clinical Simulation Examination.	The Program Director and Clinical Director reviewed the course curriculum for the three section subscores that scored an 85% or less than the national mean for 2022-2023. Subscore 2B: Ensure Infection Prevention. Program faculty added additional material to presentations and infection prevention charts and isolation precautions from the Center of Disease Control and Prevention. Subscore 3D. Administer Medications and	The new content implemented was monitored for progress on the 2023-2024 cohort passage rates on the Clinical Simulation Examination.

				Specialty Gases. Program faculty added a cardiovascular drug unit with coordinating heart rhythms. Along with adding additional resources and material for administering specialty gases. Subscore 3G. Provide High-Risk situations. Program faculty have added more clinical experiences around student exposure to high-risk situations with physician contact in critical care areas.	
3	Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average.	Enrolled fifteen students with the 2022-2023 cohort. Eighteen spots were offered to selected applicants.	Out of the eighteen students accepted to the Respiratory Care Technology Program three of those students decided not to pursue Respiratory Care at the present time. The three students made this decision prior to courses January 2022. Out of the fifteen students that enrolled and completed the program equaled a 67% retention rate, 10/15 graduated. The five students that did not graduate from program all made the choice to withdraw from respiratory care. There were various reasons why the five students elected to withdraw from health concerns, family obligations, and chose a different career path. None of the withdrawals were due to academics.	Program faculty will continue to offer remediation for lecture and laboratory components when students need additional help.	Program faculty continued recruiting and remediation efforts in hopes of retaining 10% or more of the enrolled cohort.

4					
---	--	--	--	--	--

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Action Plan Number 1: Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1. Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates SLO #4.	RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off the 2022-2023 cohort successfully completed the ventilator check-off in two attempts or less. The ten students in the cohort during this spring semester completed the ventilator check, check-off successfully on the first attempt. RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II, Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off for the 2022-2023 cohort shows eight of the ten students successfully passed their check-off by the second attempt. Two out of the ten successfully	Arterial Blood Gas Analysis check-off is a challenging check-off to complete due to the complexity of the skill.	No changes needed for this check-off. The students are given two weeks to practice the Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off in lab prior to check-offs. If a student does not successfully pass their check-off the student is remediated and has the opportunity to ask questions and to receive help.	Achievement of each student successfully passing their check-offs by the fourth attempt meets the SLO# 1 with a 100% passage rate for check-off completion. The SLO #1 states students will successfully complete their check-offs by the fourth attempt.

		completed their check-off by the third or fourth attempt.			
2	Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.	Ten students graduated in the 2022-2023 cohort. All ten students successfully completed the Clinical Simulation Examination on the first attempt.	The Clinical Simulation Examination has eighteen content and section type subscores. The 2022-2023 cohort had three sections below the required national mean of 85% of greater. Content and section type subscores 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention, 3D. Administer Medications and Specialty Gases		
3	Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average.				
4					

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES

	complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections			
1	Action Plan Number I: Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1.	RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off for the 2023-2024 cohort had a 88% successful completion of the check-off by the second attempt. RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off for the 2023-2024 cohort had a 93% successful completion by the second attempt.	Yes. RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off two students did not pass their check-off until the third or fourth attempt. After remediation and mock check-off attempts the two students were successful in the check-off completion. RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II, Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off one student did not pass their check-off until the third attempt. With remediation and practice the student successfully completed the checkoff.	100% of the cohort met the SLO #1 by completing the Ventilator Check and Arterial Blood Gas Analysis check-off by the fourth attempt. Majority of the 2023-2024 cohort successfully met the goal of check-off completion within two attempts. The APR data for the 2022-2023 cohort in RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory II was an 80% check-off completion by the second attempt for Arterial Blood Gas Analysis. The 2023-2024 cohort increased by 13% for the goal of check-offs to be successfully completed by the second attempt.	No for a 100% completion of check-offs by the second attempt. The data does show an improvement in passage rates.
2	Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.	The 2023-2024 Cohort's Clinical Simulation Examination (CSE) score report shows all content and section subtypes are greater than the 85% of national mean.	None	Program faculty implemented four changes to course curriculum to improve the CSE scores. There were three categories that were < 85% of national mean and one category that was close to the 85% of national mean. The four subscore categories were: 1A. Evaluate Data in the Patient Record. 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention. 3D. Administer Medications	Yes

				and Specialty Gases. 3G. Provide Respiratory Care in High-Risk Situations.	
3	Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average.	The 2023-2024 Cohort started with the maximum acceptance of twenty-two students in January 2023.	Retaining 10% of more of enrolled students. 77% of the students that did not complete the program were reasons outside of the programs means to assist or control.	The 2023-2024 Cohort started with the maximum acceptance of twenty-two students in January 2023. The cohorts' retention rate was 59%. Thirteen students graduated in May 2024. Nine students from the twenty-two students did not complete the program. Two out of the nine students were not academically successful. Seven out of the nine students chose not to continue in the program due to various reasons: finances, health concerns, or decided the career choice of respiratory care was not for them. The two students that were not academically unsuccessful had multiple remediation meetings by both the Program Director and Director of Clinical Education. The remediation sessions were implemented to aid in student success. During the remediation sessions these students were worked with one-on-one reviewing course content, tutoring subject matter, practicing, and evaluating laboratory check-offs, and clinical related skills and issues. One student was academically unsuccessful in the first semester. One student was academically unsuccessful in the second semester. Both students had multiple absences and/or tardiness to class. The students that did not complete the program due to financial concerns were provided resources to the Foundation at Vol State to see if there was any additional financial	No

				assistance available. One student was awarded monies to help them through the program. Unfortunately, the monies awarded still did not allow the student to continue in the program.	
4					

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1	Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1.	The completion of check-offs by the second attempt allows for quicker competency by tailing their skills. The quicker a student demonstrates laboratory competency the quicker the student can perform those skills clinically. The more exposure and practice students have in clinical rotations helps improve the student confidence and skills proficiency. Leading into stronger patient care.	Yes. Program faculty will continue to monitor, review check-off criteria, and provide student remediation as needed.	Based on the data reported there is still room for growth to improve laboratory completion of check-offs by the second attempt. Program faculty will continue to offer students open laboratory practice time outside of class days. Faculty members will continue to provide feedback after an unsuccessful check-off attempt and provide constructive remediation of the needed skill.
2	Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.	The four content and section type subscores on the Clinical Simulation Examination that needed enhancing to ensure the subscores increased to 85% of national means or greater were successful. Subscore 1A: Evaluate	Yes, continue to monitor and implement changes to ensure content and section types by subscores remain 85% or greater than the national mean on the Clinical	The Program Director and Clinical Director will continue to monitor, review, and assess the content and section subtypes for the Clinical Simulation Examination. Improvement plans will be implemented on

		Data in the Patient Record. The Director of Clinical Education made sure to increase exposure to patient charts in the clinical setting. The students had the opportunity to read and study patient history, diagnosis, laboratory results, and diagnostic procedures. Subscore 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention. Throughout the course curriculum where infection control is taught. Program faculty have added additional material to presentations and infection prevention charts from the Center of Disease Control and Prevention. Subscore 3D. Administer Medications and Specialty Gases. Program faculty reviewed course material where medications and specialty gases are taught. Additional information about cardiovascular drugs and specialty gases administered have been incorporated in course material. Subscore 3G. Provide Respiratory Care in High-Risk Situations. Program Faculty have worked diligently to enhance clinical experiences to ensure student exposure to more high-risk situations. This exposure has been increased through more intensive care and emergency department scenarios.	Simulation Examination.	areas that score less than or close to 85% of the national mean.
3	Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average.	A remediation plan was implemented for students that did not successfully pass laboratory check-offs on the first attempt and did not have a 75% average on	Yes, program faculty will continue remediation efforts in hopes to aid in student success.	Program faculty will continue making efforts to improve program retention. The Program Director and Director of Clinical Education will

		all course examinations. The students were offered tutoring and additional help in lab with practicing check-offs of procedures.		review semester course evaluations and student feedback to see if there are areas of improvement that can be added to the remediation plan.
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Physical Therapist Assistant AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first Academic Program Review for this program.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The Physical Therapist Assistant Program offers an Associate Degree and seeks to graduate individuals who are competent and qualified to assume roles in the health care field as Physical Therapist Assistants. The program is committed to excellence in serving the ever-changing needs and interests of the Physical Therapy community of Middle Tennessee. The program supports the practice of Physical Therapy as a vocation to strengthen the healthcare workforce and economic development of Middle Tennessee.

No mission statement revisions have been made.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The mission and philosophy of the Program are congruent with the mission and philosophy of the institution. The Program has the mission of providing competent and qualified physical therapist assistants at the associate degree level in serving the needs of the physical therapy community of Middle Tennessee. The Program enables the College to achieve its mission by preparing PTA students for employment in the community through successful completion of the curriculum and attainment of an associate degree.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

The program learning outcomes for the Physical Therapist Assistant Program will be assessed in PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA and PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II. The Physical Therapist Assistant Program has three student learning outcomes.

1. Support the diverse physical therapy healthcare needs of Tennessee communities through employment as physical therapist assistants working under the supervision of physical therapists.
2. Demonstrate entry-level competence as physical therapist assistants as evidenced by successful completion of the National Physical Therapy Examination (NPTE) and qualification for state licensure.
3. Identify career development and lifelong learning opportunities as physical therapist assistants in contemporary physical therapy practice.

The program selected the student learning outcomes to be assessed in the first and third semester, Spring and Summer 2022. Assessing the outcomes is being completed to monitor the overall improvement of knowledge and the application of skills from the beginning of the program till the end of the terminal clinical education, prior to graduation. The learning outcomes will assess knowledge and skills required for a physical therapist assistant to pass the National Physical Therapy examination (NPTE) and to be considered for employment as an entry level physical therapist assistant.

The manner which the learning outcomes will be assessed, is through a comprehensive final practical examination at the end of PTAT 2460 and the clinical performance in PTAT 2494 with the mid-term and final assessment of PTAT 2494. The instructor of PTAT 2460 will evaluate the students on knowledge and skills applied with the emphasis of safe practice learned in PTAT 2460. All students must meet at least a satisfactory level score on all critical safety criteria and no more than 2 unsatisfactory marks in other performance criterion. The student's clinical instructor and Academic Coordinator of Clinical Education (ACCE) will evaluate the student in PTAT 2494 during mid-term and at the final assessment of the clinical externship. The student must be at entry level, at the final assessment capable of completing tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection for patients with simple or complex conditions. This course requires all students to be rated at entry level practice in order meet the standards of final externship. Program faculty ensure that all students are successful in meeting the required skills for safe practice in the first semester at a satisfactory level, and at entry level in the third semester.

Level of Evaluation for PTAT 2460

Exceeds Satisfactory

Meets Satisfactory

Below Satisfactory

To successfully pass the final practical examination in PTAT 2460, the student must meet a satisfactory level on all critical safety criteria and no more than 2 unsatisfactory marks in other performance criterion. Program faculty ensure the students are meeting the successful completion of the final practical and are able to continue to practice and improve their skills in a competent and safe manner.

Level of Evaluation for PTAT 2494

Beginning Level – At this level, performance of essential skills is inconsistent and clinical problem solving is performed in an inefficient manner. Performance reflects little or no experience in application of essential skills with patients.

Intermediate Level – the student is proficient with simple tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection and is developing the ability to consistently perform more complex tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collections.

Entry Level – the student is consistently proficient and skilled in simple and complex tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection.

The Clinical Performance Instrument (CPI) assessment score must be at entry level on all critical safety skills by the completion of the final assessment of PTAT 2494 in order to ensure the student is capable of completing tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection for patients with simple or complex conditions.

Evidence:

- CPI
- PTAT 2460 Lab Practical
- PTAT, AAS Assessment Tool

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The Physical Therapist Assistant Program currently assesses student and program outcomes based on data from the National Physical Therapy Examination (NPTE), graduate and employer surveys. Additionally, final practical examination for PTAT 2460 and entry level on CPI for PTAT 2494 are utilized for assessment.

The spring semester of 2022, is when the Physical Therapist Assistant Program implemented two key assessment courses. The two courses the program chose are PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA (first semester) and PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II (third and final semester). Currently, there is not enough data to report a trend or implement any changes. The data from spring and summer 2022 show 100% of the assessment was met for both PTAT 2460 and PTAT 2494.

Key Assessment Courses

PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA - This course includes all of the fundamental patient care skills, selected data collection and physical therapy interventions for the physical therapist assistant student. The assessment for this course will be how many students successfully complete the final practical examination with a satisfactory or above satisfactory score.

PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II - Terminal clinical education experiences consist of the student's supervised clinical practice of previously learned PTA duties and functions in a physical therapy practice setting under the direction of a licensed physical therapist or physical therapist assistant. The assessment for this course is how many students will meet the entry level performance by the final CPI assessment.

National Physical Therapy Examination (NPTE)

To become a licensed physical therapist assistant (PTA), graduates must pass the NPTE in order to practice as a PTA. The NPTE is designed to assess the graduate's basic entry-level competence after graduation from an accredited program. This ensures that only those individuals who have the requisite knowledge of physical therapy are licensed in the physical therapy field. The passing standard is a scale score of 600; therefore, any score of 600 or higher is a passing score, and any score below 600 is a failing score. The passing scores established for the National Physical Therapy Examinations (NPTE®) reflect the level of performance required to provide minimally safe and

competent physical therapy services by physical therapists and physical therapist assistants. Individuals scoring at or above the passing score have met the performance standard and are eligible for licensure, and individuals scoring below the passing score have not met the performance standard and are not yet eligible for licensure.

The program has overall strong passage rates that meet accreditation standards (85% ultimate pass rate over two years) and are above the mean scale score of the national pass rates. In 2020 and 2022, the program had a significant decline in the first-time pass rate but the ultimate pass rate was at or above 96.9%. In 2021, the program had a first time pass rate of 100%. The summary of most recent assessment results reveal the licensure (NPTE) ultimate pass rate has maintained consistency in the results, although first-time pass rates have decreased.

NPTE LICENSURE PASS RATES		
GRADUATION YEAR	FIRST-TIME PASS RATE	ULTIMATE PASS RATE
2022	80%	100%
2021	100%	100%
2020	87.5%	96.9%

The official NPTE pass rate report from the Federation of State Boards of Physical Therapy have been uploaded for evidence. The Physical Therapist Assistant Program at Vol State consistently has higher than the national average pass rates. The 2021 graduates NPTE mean scale score of 696.2 is well above the national mean scale score of 645.7 pass rate. Although, the program is very pleased with the ultimate pass rate scores, the program would like to see improvements in the first-time pass rate.

Each year the program director evaluates the NPTE pass rate report. The faculty also reviews the results of a mock practice exam on the same graduates who took the NPTE. Those graduates who did not pass the NPTE first-time, also did not meet the expected score of the mock practice exam. Program faculty have implemented an action plan of a mock practice exams earlier in the program (2nd semester) may be beneficial on the first-time pass rates. Typically, the program offers a practice mock examination during the last semester (3rd semester) of the program. Faculty have decided to introduce the practice mock examination earlier in the program to best direct the students preparation for passing the NPTE licensure exam on the first attempt.

Stating with the 2022 – 2023 academic year, the Physical Therapist Assistant Program will assess the course and program learning outcomes in its key assessment courses, PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA and PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II. The program chose those two courses for assessment to provide evidence from the first semester to the third semester that the students can demonstrate kinematic skills necessary for PTA practice and the requisite knowledge of physical therapy to pass the NPTE. The program faculty hope all students can achieve a satisfactory level on the final practical examination and ultimately pass the NPTE. If any areas of weakness are identify on the assessment data, program faculty will look at areas of weakness to improve assessment outcomes.

Evidence:
NPTE Licensure Pass Rate
Program Outcomes
CPI
PTAT 2460 Rubric

Evidence:

- 2019, 2020, 2021 MFT 2 PTA State Board Results
- CPI
- NPTE Licensure Pass Rate
- PTAT 2460 Rubric Comprehensive Final Lab Practical
- Program Outcomes

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Graduate Surveys

Graduates surveys completed for students graduating in the spring of 2019, 2020, and 2021 yielded positive results. These surveys are the latest set of surveys available to the program. The average mean score on the overall quality of preparation as an entry-level physical therapist assistant surveys for 2018, 2019, and 2020 revealed a mean score of 4.32 out of 5.00. The lowest section score on the survey was a 4.25 out of 5.00 on the collection of data from charts and patients. The collection of data from charts and patients occurs mostly while students are completing their clinical externships, although it is taught during their first semester while in the program. The faculty will continue to implement and reinforce the learning methods and techniques used.

Feedback received from students on graduate surveys reflected the students' desire to be taught more manual therapy techniques and experience in online documentation platform. Program faculty have incorporated guest speakers to address these two suggested specific topics during the last semester in the program.

Employer Surveys

Response rate for employers is low, with an average of 38.7% response rate over the three years of employer satisfaction surveys. The employer surveys analysis reveals their overall satisfaction of the graduate mean score is 4.68 out of 5.00. Faculty will work with Institutional Effectiveness, Research, Planning and Assessment to encourage employer's response rate.

Positive comments about the strengths of the program were written and the faculty will continue to implement and reinforce the learning methods and techniques.

Areas for improvement would be clinical reasoning skills, confidence, and time management. The program faculty will continue to address these areas throughout the program, and will continue to incorporate these areas for improvement in the laboratory setting. These areas for improvement should increase over time with the graduates' years of professional clinical experience.

Evidence:

- 2018 PTA Employer Satisfaction Survey
- 2018 PTA Graduate Satisfaction Survey
- 2019 PTA Employer Satisfaction Survey
- 2019 PTA Graduate Satisfaction Survey
- 2020 PTA Employer Satisfaction Survey
- 2020 PTA Graduate Satisfaction Survey

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

Enrollment for the Physical Therapist Assistant program has been set at 32 students each year up until the pandemic. The Physical Therapist Assistant program faced many challenges as the pandemic evolved. The program selected 18 students for the 2020 cohort, 19 students for the 2021 cohort and 24 students for the 2022 cohort. The reduction in enrollment was due to the inability to secure clinical placement for 32 students during the pandemic. Currently, clinical placement has improved to be successful in securing placement for 24 students, although the program is not able to meet the clinical placement of the previous years of enrollment of 32 students.

Retention has only been a challenge since the pandemic (Cohort 2021 and 2022). Beginning with cohort 2021, four students withdrew from the program for various reasons. Two students withdrew from the program due to the inability to successfully maintain academic standards of the program and the other two withdrew due to the clinical affiliates' requirements of the COVID-19 vaccine. Retention has been a challenge also for the 2022 cohort. Three students withdrew from the program due to the inability to successfully maintain academic standards of the program. Program faculty are concerned that some applicants are not prepared for the academic rigors of the physical therapist assistant program. This could be due to the changes of the delivery of courses to an online format during the pandemic. Prior to the pandemic, the Physical Therapist Assistant program has not had any enrollment and retention challenges. Overall, the mean average retention rate is 92.9% for the last three years (2019, 2020 and 2021). The Program Director will continue to monitor enrollment and retention rates.

Program marketing is extremely important for the Physical Therapist Assistant Program. From 2017 through 2021 the average number of applicants have been 56. In 2022, the number of applicants dropped to 32. The program contributes the drop in applications due to the COVID pandemic response. Health services utilization including physical therapy dropped precipitously as providers closed their doors to out-patient clinics and patients practicing social distance avoided health facilities. Faculty believe students are questioning their career choice in health care due to the effects of the pandemic. Students may not want to seek a career in health care because of the risks of exposure to COVID, mandating COVID vaccines and securing employment.

Program faculty spend a great deal of time with marketing and education. For many years, the program have hosted an Information Session, held once monthly for those seeking more information about the Physical Therapist Assistant Program. In addition to marketing to VSCC students, program faculty also market to high school students in various ways. Faculty participate annually in 5-10 area high school visits. High school visits give faculty an opportunity to discuss the profession of physical therapy while providing hands-on physical therapy learning activities, led by Physical Therapist Assistant students. The visits not only benefit the program as a marketing tool, but it allows the PTA students to demonstrate their knowledge and skills as they educate high school students. Program faculty have also visited several local high schools to educate on the field of physical therapy for those interested in a health care profession. Students and faculty from 2021 created an educational video about the program and the profession that would benefit a student who may have an interest in the program. These various activities assist program faculty create awareness of the program and profession.

Evidence:
PTA Success Data
2022 PTA Fact Sheet

Evidence:

- 2022 PTA Fact Sheet
- PTA Success Data

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could

also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

Evidence:

- 2019 PTA Accreditation summary & certificate

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The Physical Therapist Assistant Program will concentrate on enrollment, retention, NPTE licensure first-time pass rate over the next few years. Overall the program outcomes are very good but they could improve in the area of first-time pass rate. The first-time pass rate averaged over three years (2020, 2021, 2022) is 89.1%.

The area that the program will concentrate on most heavily in the next few years is first-time pass rate on licensure exam (NPTE). The program will require earlier testing on practice mock examination to best direct the students to ensure student success. The program will set a minimum score of the practice mock examinations in order to ensure the student is prepared to pass the NPTE.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Student Learning

Students will score 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE .
Students will complete a two day onsite licensure exam review course prior to taking the NPTE.

Student Success

Passage rates on the NPTE. Faculty will evaluate the 1st time pass rate on the licensure exam (NPTE) to ensure student success with regards to obtaining a 95% first-time test taker pass rate for 2023 and 2024.

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

The program faculty have maintained high standards for the Physical Therapist Assistant program. The overall APR was thorough. Achievement of the student learning outcomes will also have positive effects on student success. Securing additional clinical affiliate relationships should be considered in this APR because it will increase the number of clinical opportunities for students, thereby impacting student success.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. I think the planned initiatives are good, but I agree with the dean's feedback that recruitment of clinical sites is an important initiative for this program to add so that it can return to its previous enrollment levels. Additionally, I encourage the program to explore the recent drop in job and monitor to see if additional initiatives in that area would be helpful.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2

	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Students will score 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE PLO 2	Nine students out of 21, achieve a score of 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination.	Students need to improve study preparation for the practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE.	Increase the number of practice mock examinations prior to taking the NPTE and incorporating various forms of technology to assist with study prep.	With the increased number of practice exams, scores will improve to 600 or above
2	Students will complete a two day onsite licensure exam review course prior to taking the NPTE. PLO 2	All students completed a two day onsite licensure review course.	All students participated.	None	Continue to offer the onsite review course each year.
3					
4					

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
1	Students will score 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE PLO 2	Seven students out of 20, achieve a score of 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination.	Students need to improve study preparation for the practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE	Increase the number of practice mock examinations prior to taking the NPTE and incorporating various forms of technology to assist with study prep.	With the increased number of practice exams, scores will improve to 600 or above.
2	Students will complete a	All students completed a	All students participated.	None	Continue to offer the

	two- day onsite licensure exam review course prior to taking the NPTE. PLO 2	two- day onsite licensure review course.			onsite review course each year.
3					
4					

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1	Increase the achievement of PLO #2 by ensuring only those who score a 600 or 73% on a practice mock exam will be allowed to take the NPTE prior to graduation.	Eight students were successful in scoring at least a 600 or 73% on a mock practice exam.	Yes, incorporate a resource (Basecamp) as a required assignment to ensure students are preparing for the NPTE while completing their clinical.	The ultimate success rate for the NPTE is 85% for 2024 and 90.5% for 2023, therefore the PTA Program is in compliance with CAPTE.
2	Students were successful in completing a 2 day review course.	95% of students overall impression of the course was favorable and recommended the course be offered to the next year's class.	Even though the 2 day review course was favorable, the ultimate pass rate has declined since 2022.	Since the ultimate pass rate has declined over the last 2 years, I think incorporating an asynchronous course review for students to complete during their clinical.
3				
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Veterinary Assistant CERT

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

The last program assessment for the VTA program was in 2019, under the previous system. At that time the program had 3 outcomes.

1. Demonstrate knowledge of office/hospital procedures and communicate in a professional manner
 1. This outcome was assessed in VTA 130: B on Final Exam and B on Client Education paper.
 2. Spring 2019 72% of students achieved a B on the Final but only 50% were able to achieve a B on the Paper.
 3. The plan was to add written assignments to other classes – which happened. Also, to add interactive communication practice in VTA 130. Interactive practice did not happen because of COVID. This is beginning Fall 2022.
2. Recognize and demonstrate nursing procedures appropriate for a veterinary assistant
 1. This outcome was assessed in VTA 120: B on Final Exam and B on Animal Care Rotation rubric.
 2. Fall 2018 92% of students achieved a B on both assessments.
 3. There were no additional plans made for this outcome.
3. Recognize and demonstrate diagnostic procedures appropriate for a veterinary assistant, common to veterinary facilities
 1. This outcome was assessed in VTA 140: B on the Final Exam and B on the skills test rubric.
 2. Spring 2018 86% of students achieved a B on the Final Exam. Only 57% of students achieved a B on the skills test.
 3. The plan was to increase the number of visits to Animal Control in VTA 151 in the Fall of 2020. Also to repeat the VTA 140 skills in VTA 151 in the Fall. Neither happened because of COVID.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The program did not have its own mission statement. One will be drafted and approved Fall 2022. Approvals will take place Fall 2022 at the Advisory Committee Meeting.
Current Mission Statement Draft:

- The mission of the Veterinary Assistant Program is to enable students to attain gainful employment by providing high quality education and clinical experiences. These services contribute to the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Alignment to Institutional Mission

- The mission of the Veterinary Assistant Program is to enable students to attain gainful employment by providing high quality education and clinical experiences.
- These services contribute to the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

PLO#1 – Demonstrate interpersonal and interprofessional communication skills with the clients and veterinary team. Students must write a client education handout in VTA 151. Target achievement level is 90%. This is at least their second paper to write while in the program.

PLO#2 – Demonstrate knowledge of office and hospital procedures appropriate to the veterinary assistant. Students rotate through several jobs while at animal control as part of VTA 151. The Recorder job is used to assess this outcome. The recorder must use appropriate abbreviations and terminology as they transcribe the medical notes. Target achievement level is 90% or better for every outcome.

PLO#3 – Properly assess and evaluate needs of patients as they relate to animal care. The Assistant job in VTA 151 is used to assess this outcome. The assistant must gather data on the patients, perform grooming of nails and administer prescribed medication. Target achievement level is 90% or better for every outcome.

PLO#4 – Demonstrate ability to assist with common veterinary procedures involving companion animals. The Lab Tech job in VTA 151 is used to assess this outcome. The Lab tech must gather supplies and perform needed tests as directed by the Licensed Technician or Veterinarian. Target achievement level is 90% or better for every outcome.

Evidence:

- VTA Certificate AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- VTA, CERT Assessment Tool

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:**Summary of most recent assessment results**

1. PLO#1 was not assessed in AY21-22.
2. PLO#2 – 100% of students successfully demonstrated applied knowledge of Hospital Procedures.
3. PLO#3 – 90% of students successfully demonstrated applied knowledge of Animal Care.
4. PLO#4 - 100% of students successfully demonstrated applied knowledge of Assist with Procedures.

Analysis of trends

Students in this course must first pass VTA 140 Clinical Procedures. There is generally quite a bit of attrition between the 2 courses. This level of success is expected with this set of students.

Students may perform each of the skills / assessments multiple times during a semester. It is expected that 100% will meet expectations by the end of the semester. Moving the formal assessment to the end of the semester may improve outcomes.

There were no results for Communication because those assessments did not get put into VIA.

Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning

Looking at only these outcomes it would seem there is not much need to improve. That is not the case. Retention rates need to improve.

The Communication SLO must be evaluated after the Fall 2022 class is complete. This may give more information about the needs of this course and the program.

Evidence:

- AY2021-2022 VTA TC Assessment Results

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

There are no responses from graduates about the program.

There were only 2 responses to the 2020 Employer Satisfaction survey, none in 2019 and 4 responses in 2018. Looking at all the results, all employers said the students were prepared for the position and their overall satisfaction was satisfied or very satisfied. When evaluating the skills of the graduate, the graduate's ability to work with others was only fair according to half of the employers. This would indicate there is a need to work with our students in this area.

Course evaluations were collected from several of the courses. The majority of students really liked the hands-on portions of the curriculum. One of the few criticisms, students wanted more opportunities to perform those skills.

Evidence:

- 2018 VTA TC Employer Survey
- 2019 VTA TC Employer Survey
- 2020 VTA TC Employer Survey
- VTA 100 Student Evaluations 2022
- VTA 140 student evaluations 2022

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

Looking at headcount, recruitment and enrollment is near capacity, which is set at 24. Many students choose the Vet Assistant program because it fits into their schedule. Most of the classes are late afternoon or evening so that working students can attend the in-person classes. There is also a set of students that choose this program because they did not have the grades for or get accepted into the Vet Tech program.

Retention is poor, at anywhere from 57% to 77%. Part of the poor retention is from COVID and online coursework. That was difficult for this group. Student must pass VTA 140 with a C or better to take 2 of the Fall semester classes, VTA 151 – Veterinary Assistant Seminar and VTA 145 – Assistant Clinical Practicum. Almost all of the students that do pass VTA 140 graduate from the program.

Employment rates are very low according to graduate placement data. How accurate is this data is zero graduates completed the alumni survey? The program needs to survey students before they graduate about placement.

Evidence:

- 2022 VTA TC Fact Sheet

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

Since the last program review there have been some positive changes in the program learning outcomes and how they are assessed. There is clear evidence that 90% of students are meeting all of the outcomes that were measured.

The program did not measure PLO#1 last year, but that will be measured AY 22-23. There is very little feedback from graduates or employers. The lack of good feedback limits how the program is assessed. The other serious limitation is the low retention rates. The students completing the PLO assessments have already demonstrated competency in previous classes. Data needs to be gathered on why students

are not successfully passing VTA 140. The recommendations below are based on the findings from this review.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 - Develop tutorial - Faculty review of the tutorial. - Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 - Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate. (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1.	Improve student learning in the area of interpersonal and interprofessional communication. This is part of PLO #1	To provide students with relevant and consistent practice of interpersonal and interprofessional communication.	Program Director and VTA faculty	Increase PLO #1 achievement to 90% Increase in employer satisfaction survey for graduates' ability to work with others	AY2022 – 2023 Develop assignments that reflect contemporary practice interactions Develop a peer evaluation system for group projects AY2023-2024 Increase the number of group projects throughout the program	50% of employers rated the graduate's ability to work with others fair There is no other data reflecting working well with others.
2.	Improve students' skills in assisting with common veterinary	To provide students with relevant and consistent practice with common	Program Director and VTA faculty	Increase PLO #4 achievement to 100%	AY 2022-2023 Develop a list of assistant skills that are	90% success rate for restraint

	procedures. This is part of PLO #4.	veterinary procedures.		Increase in student clinical rotation evaluations in <i>appropriately handles animals</i> Increase passage rate of VTA 140	needed in practice Develop a standard and rubric for each skill AY 2023-2024 Add a lab to VTA 140, which will increase the amount of time students have to learn each skill Implement skills and rubric changes	Less than 60% pass rate of VTA 140
3.	Increase retention rate of students between Spring and Fall semester	To increase number of graduates	Program Director and VTA faculty	75% of students that start the program, complete it Increase passage rate of VTA 140 to 75%	See improvements to VTA 140 AY2023-2024 Develop support services for students in VTA 100 and 140. AY2024-2025 Implement those services	57% retention rate in 2021
4.						

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

With data provided by the Program Director, Dr. K. Hope Wright, I approve this report. The data presented shows a program poised to continue to make great strides and a program with very good supportive data showing good retention, persistence, and graduation data. I approve this review and action plan.

VPAA Feedback: The action plan is thoughtful and is aimed to help more students complete this high-quality program. I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. I think the focus on success in the gateway course will have an important effect on program retention and completion rates.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

Recommendation 1

PLO#1 – Communications: Improve student learning in the area of interpersonal and interprofessional communication.

Performance Indicators

- Increase PLO #1 achievement to 90%
- Increase in employer satisfaction survey for graduates' ability to work with others

Results

- 2023 evaluations for VTA 145 indicate 8 out of 11 students received an excellent on communication skills. The other 3 received a good.
- Fall 2023, 100% of students successfully completed a client communication handout and utilized medical terminology appropriately. There are no employer surveys for this time period.

Modified Timeline

2023-2024

- Add assignments to Economics that reflect contemporary practice interactions
- Add a peer evaluation system to the group projects in VTA 120
- Track professional communication in clinics for VTA 145
- Institute the peer evaluation system

Recommendation 2

PLO#4 – Assist with Procedures: Improve students' skills in assisting with common veterinary procedures. This is part of PLO #4.
Performance Indicators

- Increase PLO #4 achievement to 100%
- Increase in student clinical rotation evaluations in *appropriately handles animals*
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140

Results

- 2023 evaluations for VTA 145 indicate 8 out of 11 students received a good to excellent on animal handling skills.
- In 2023, 100% of students successfully restrained a dog or cat during VTA 151.

Modified Timeline

- Postpone and re-evaluate need next year: Add a lab to VTA 140, which will increase the amount of time students have to learn each skill

Recommendation 3

Student Success: Increase retention rate of students between Spring and Fall semester.
Performance Indicators

- 75% of students that start the program, complete it
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140 to 75%

Results

- 2022: 13 students VTA 140 to 8 students in VTA 151 = 61.5% retention
- 2023: 15 students VTA 140 to 7 students in VTA 151 = 46.6% retention
- 2024: 14 students VTA 140 to unknown at this time

There are a number of students every year that have accommodations from the access center. Often those students choose not to go to the access center for testing. The instructors have strongly encouraged those students to take tests there this year. That has helped their test scores. Instructors have also increased the number of hands on activities during this semester.

Evidence:

- VTA 151 CLO 22-23
- VTA PLO 22-23

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

Recommendation 1

PLO#1 - Communications: Improve student learning in the area of interpersonal and interprofessional communication.

Performance Indicators:

- Increase PLO #1 achievement to 90%
- Increase in employer satisfaction survey for graduates' ability to work with others

Results

- 2024 VTA 145: 88.88% of students (8 out of 9) received an excellent or good on communication skills from their clinical rotation site. This is a decrease from 100%.
- 2024 VTA 151: 88.88% of students (8 out of 9) received an A on their research paper as a demonstration of written communication skills. This is a decrease from 100%.
- 2024 VTA 151: 100% of students utilized medical terminology appropriately during the semester. This is from a new set of skills.

At such low numbers, the failure of one student to successfully complete a task radically decreases the overall success rate. 89% achievement in communication is a reasonable success rate.

Recommendation 2

PLO#4 - Assist with Procedures: Improve students' skills in assisting with common veterinary procedures. This is part of PLO #4.

Performance Indicators

- Increase PLO #4 achievement to 100%
- Increase in student clinical rotation evaluations in *appropriately handles animals*
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140

Results

- 2024 VTA 145: 77.77% of students received an excellent or good on their animal handling skills from their clinical rotation site. This is a increase from 72.7%.
- 2024 VTA 151: 95.65% of students successfully restrained a dog or cat during lab. This is a decrease from 100%
- 2024 passage rate of VTA 140 was 91.6%. That is an increase from 60%.

There has been a shift in hands on tasks given to the students during VTA 151. Instead of getting only a few opportunities at Animal Control to handle animals, students now spend most of lab time preparing animals for surgery. This has significantly increased their hands on opportunities, which increases their odd of success. This was a great semester with the group in Fall of 2024.

Recommendation 3

Student Success: Increase retention rate of students between Spring and Fall semester.

Performance Indicators

- 75% of students that start the program, complete it
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140 to 75%

Results

- 2023: passage rate of VTA 140 was 60% (9 out of 15 students passed with a C or better). Of those, 77% enrolled and successfully completed VTA 151 (7 out of 9). From the start of Fall 2023, 40% graduated December 2023.
- 2024: passage rate of VTA 140 was 91.6% (11 out of 12 students passed with a C or better). Of those, 81.1% enrolled and completed VTA 151 (9 out of 11). From the start of Fall 2024, 33% graduated December 2024.

The instructors have done a great job with increasing the success rate of VTA 140 without compromising quality of education. There is still a serious disconnect between Spring and Fall semesters. Of the 2024 group, 4 did not register for VTA 151 or dropped early on because of personal reasons. Of the ones that completed VTA 151, 1 could not graduate because their overall GPA was not at a 2.0 and 2 still had other classes to take due to failing previous coursework.

Evidence:

- 2023 VTA 140
- 2023 VTA 151
- 2024 VTA 140
- 2024 VTA 151
- VTA 151 CLO Report Fall 2024

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Mechatronics Technology AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Narrative:

This is the first APR for the Mechatronics Technology program. However, the program had an accreditation review in Spring 2022 by ATMAE. The program was recommended for accreditation having been found in full compliance with 17 accreditation standards and partial compliance with 2 standards.

The self-study and visiting team report are attached as evidence.

Evidence:

- ATMAE Self-Study 2022 Final Version
- VolState-Team Report 2022

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

No changes to the program mission have been made and none are planned.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

The Mechatronics Technology program aligns with the institutional mission by

- preparing students for successful careers by "provide the academic knowledge and practical experience necessary to prepare students for employment as highly skilled mechatronics technicians"
- employing innovative educational programs through "practical" (i.e. lab based) experiences.
- building partnerships with companies that hire Mechatronics graduates through
 - preparing students enter "the workforce quickly with the technical skills that employers demand"
 - having company representative serve on the advisory committees
 - providing WBL (work-based learning) opportunities through local companies
 - having guest speakers from local companies

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

The 7 outcomes are assessed in the following courses:

- MECH 1330
- MECH 2320
- MECH 2441
- MECH 2425

Assessments are attached as evidence.

Evidence:

- Control Wiring Assessment v2
- MECH 1330 - Outcomes Assessment
- MECH 2441 PLC Troubleshooting Assessment
- MECH AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- MECH, AASCERT Assessment Tool

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

The Mechatronics program has an exit exam that each student is required to take prior to graduation. This was reported on in the ATMAE self-study. This portion of the report is copied below.

<http://schemas.microsoft.com/office/2004/12/omml>" xmlns="http://www.w3.org/TR/REC-html40">

Mechatronics Exit Exam

Beginning in Fall semester of 2019, Mechatronics students were required to take an exit exam to measure competency levels for each of the program outcomes. Students were not required to pass the exam as this was to be a measure of their mastery of the program outcomes and provide feedback to the program. The exam is multiple choice and is patterned after the Siemens Mechatronics Systems Certification Program (SMSCP) Level 1 and Level 2 exams. The exam as well as exam analysis reports can be found in Appendix 5.3 – Mechatronics Exit Exam. Due to the COVID pandemic and the campuses being closed to students, Spring 2020 graduates were given an exemption from taking the exam.

Each question was mapped to one or more program outcomes. Some of the outcomes were broken down into subcategories for analysis.

Summary Report

Performance on Program Outcomes and sub-outcomes

Outcome	Performance
---------	-------------

1. The graduate will have demonstrated a thorough understanding of the electrical components, electric motors, and mechanical components in a mechatronics system.	43%
1a. Electrical components	48%
1b. Electric motors	22%
1c. Mechanical components	46%
1. The graduate will demonstrate a thorough understanding of basic pneumatic, electro pneumatic and hydraulic control circuits in a mechatronics system.	57%
1. The graduate will demonstrate a thorough understanding of basic digital logic and programmable logic controllers (PLCs) in a mechatronics system.	50%
3a. Digital Logic	38%
3b. PLC systems	58%
1. The graduate will have demonstrated the ability to use troubleshooting techniques, correct malfunctions, perform systematic preventive maintenance and apply safety rules with respect to electrical components, mechanical components, electric motors, pneumatic and hydraulic controls, and PLCs used in a mechatronics system.	44%
4a. Electrical troubleshooting	49%
4b. Mechanical troubleshooting	16%
4c. Motors troubleshooting	22%
4d. Pneumatic/hydraulic troubleshooting	55%
4e. PLC troubleshooting	52%
1. The graduate will have demonstrated the ability to install, implement and modify software tools used in mechatronic systems.	51%
Overall Performance	50%

Analysis of Exit Exam results

- Overall performance on the exam was low with low correlation between exam performance and student GPA. Correlation coefficient = 0.01
- Reasons for poor performance
 1. Exam is too difficult
 2. Students are not motivated to do well on the exam since there is no grade assigned or requirement to pass

Possible solutions

- Eliminate the exam as a requirement and rely on in-class graded assessments to measure program outcomes – see below (Vol State Outcomes Assessment Initiative)
- Modify the exam

Siemens Level 1 exam

- The Siemens Level 1 exam is given every Fall and Spring semester (except a few semesters due to COVID).
- The exam is optional for students and costs them \$150 to take.
- The exam covers all 4 first-year courses and the score report dis-aggregates the individual courses.
- Over 5 exams the weighted average for each of the first-year courses is (see attached spreadsheet)
 - MECH 1310 - 0.71

- MECH 1320 - 0.60
- MECH 1330 - 0.68
- MECH 1340 - 0.61
- The 2 courses with the lowest weighted averages will be the focus of the continuous improvement.

Evidence:

- MECH AAS AY 2022 - 2023 Standards_and_Outcomes Report 09-25-2024 144715
- MECH AAS AY 2023 - 20024 Standards_and_Outcomes Report 09-25-2024 144938
- Mech 19-20 Item Analysis
- Mech 20-21 Item Analysis
- Siemens Level 1 analysis

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Graduate surveys are attached as evidence.

Summary from 2019 and 2020 data

Total number of graduates: 43

- Survey responses: 26 (60%)
- Primary campus
 - 1. Gallatin – 16 (62%)
 - 2. Cookeville – 10 (38%)
- 20/26 rate program as excellent or very good
- 25/26 Strongly agree or generally agree that the program "Helped me acquire the knowledge necessary for a job in the mechatronics field"
- 23/26 Strongly agree or generally agree that the program "Prepared me to utilize technology/software necessary for a job in the mechatronics field"

Regarding program outcomes

1. 25/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Gave me a thorough understanding of electrical component, electrical motors, and mechanical components in a mechatronics system"
2. 25/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program " Gave me a thorough understanding of pneumatic and hydraulics in a mechatronics system."
3. 22/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Gave me a thorough understanding of PLCs in a mechatronics system"
4. 20/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Gave me the ability to install, implement, and modify software tools in a mechatronics system."

5. 24/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Prepared me to work safely around mechatronics systems."

Evidence:

- 2019 MECH AAS Employer Survey
- 2019 MECH AAS Graduate Survey
- 2019 MECH Certificate Graduate Survey
- 2020 MECH AAS Employer Survey
- 2020 MECH AAS Graduate Survey
- 2020 MECH Certificate Employer Survey
- 2020 MECH Certificate Graduate Survey

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

Enrollment is the biggest challenge to the Mechatronics program at this time. Since COVID (Spring 2020) enrollment has dropped. Enrollment at the Cookeville campus has particularly been affected. There are a few factors that are beyond the control of the program that has contributed to this:

1. In times of low unemployment, career programs tend to suffer as employers are often hiring regardless of credentials.
2. TCAT - Livingston's Industrial Maintenance program that is located in Cookeville and Livingston is pulling from the same pool of students as the Mechatronics program.

Efforts to improve enrollment:

1. A summer boot-camp for Mechatronics and IT was piloted in 2021 in Gallatin. The camp was for HS students. We will attempt to offer this boot-camp again in Gallatin and Cookeville for Summer 2022 pending funding.
2. We have a statewide articulation agreement with TCATs as of Spring 2021. We can promote this agreement to TCAT students so that they can continue their education past the TCAT certificates.

3. Collaborate with TCAT on company recruitments. Invite companies to recruit on campus in our Mechatronics classes. When this happens, we can invite the TCAT students in Cookeville to sit in on the recruitment sessions. This will help familiarize the students with the Vol State Mechatronics program.

Evidence:

- 2022 MECH AAS Fact Sheet
- Mechatronics FTE comparison
- Mechatronics Graduates
- Mechatronics enrollment trend

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

The biggest challenge for the Mechatronics program is enrollment. This is most critical at the Cookeville campus. A multi-faceted approach to increasing enrollment will be required. Some aspects of this approach will be high school visits, dual enrollment, summer "boot camps", and working with employers to train incumbent workers.

Assessing program learning outcomes also needs to be improved. The Mechatronics exit exam is not proving to be a useful tool in this assessment. The more individualized assessments in the classroom may prove to be more useful and effective. The ATMAE visiting team suggested requiring the Siemens Level 1 exam for all graduates. This would require a \$150 payment for each student. However, this may prove to be a better method of assessing the program learning outcomes.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

	<i>Initiative</i>	<i>Objective</i>	<i>Who</i>	<i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>	<i>Timeline **</i>	<i>Baseline Data</i>
Ex.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 - Develop tutorial - Faculty review of the tutorial. - Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 - Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate. (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1.	Increase the achievement	Provide students with	Program chair and	(1) Increase the score on	AY 2023-2024	(1) Current weighted

	of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning)	an online tutorial for the MECH 1320 portion of the Siemens level 1 exam.	faculty	the Mechanical components portion of the Siemens Level 1 exam to 0.65 (2) Obtain PLO #1 achievement of 85%	- Develop module - Faculty review - Pilot module in MECH 1320 AY 2024-2025 - Launch module in MECH 1320	average score for the Mechanical Components portion of the exam is 0.60 over 5 exams. (2) No baseline for PLO #2 achievement.
2.	Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs class. (Student learning)	Provide students with an online tutorial for the MECH 1340 portion of the Siemens level 1 exam.	Program chair and faculty	(1) Increase the score on the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs portion of the Siemens Level 1 exam to 0.65 (2) Obtain PLO #3 achievement of 85%.	AY 2023-2024 -Develop module - Pilot module in MECH 1340 AY 2024-2025 -Launch module in MECH 1340	(1) Current weighted average for the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs portion of the exam is 0.61 over 5 exams. (2) No baseline for PLO #3 achievement
3.	Increase enrollment in first-year classes at the Cookeville campus. (Student success)	Increase recruiting efforts at the Cookeville campus through high school visits, dual enrollment, boot camps, and employer contacts.	Program chair and faculty	(1) Enrollment in Fall and Spring 1st year classes in Cookeville averages 12 students per class	AY 2022 - 2024 - HS classroom visits - promote dual enrollment to HS students - explore employer contacts for potential incumbent worker training AY 2023-2024 - Pilot boot camp in	(1) Spring 2022 average enrollment in MECH 1320 and MECH 1330 - 6 (2) Fall 2022 average enrollment in MECH 1310 and MECH 1340 - 0 - classes cancelled.

					Summer 2023	
4.						

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

The Mechatronics Program has taken great initiatives in its short lifetime. The program received accreditation from The Associate of Technology, Management, and Applied Engineering (ATMAE) during the Spring 2022 Semester with final approval at their Annual Conference in November 2022. The work detailed in This initial Academic Program Review illustrates the work the program has done to increase its academic rigor, its academic integrity, and its reputation in the community. The program provides for a great pathway for students looking for careers in Applied Engineering and Advanced Manufacturing allowing for a career-ready student upon graduation. The evidence provided from the program shows a young program making great strides toward continuous improvement utilizing data to inform decisions. Moreover, the program recognizes work needed to improve enrollment at our Cookeville Campus. We have begun discussions to towards improving enrollment.

As the Dean of Mathematics and Science, I approve the completed review and action plan outlined by the program and its faculty.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Department Chair and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. The analysis of assessment results is thorough and the selected focus areas for improvement reflect thoughtful and strategic consideration of the results. I agree with the dean's comments applauding the program for its quality and use of data to inform decision for continuous improvement. I also agree that improving enrollment, particularly at Cookeville, is a critical initiative for the program this year. In addition to the increase in recruitment activities, the program may consider curricular changes to better align with regional workforce needs (increased emphasis on robotics?) and to more clearly define the role of our program relative to TCAT programs and 4-year university programs in applied engineering.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning)	eLearn module has not been developed.	Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens.	Vol State will likely drop the Siemens certification program in AY 25-26. We are looking into other external certifications applicable to Mechatronics.	Siemens Level 1 exam data is not useful since only a few students take the exam. The PLO#1 assessment gave an 88% rate of meeting the competency. PLO #1 is assessed in MECH 2320.
2	Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs class. (Student learning)	eLearn module has not been developed.	Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens.	Vol State will likely drop the Siemens certification program in AY 25-26. We are looking into other external certifications applicable to Mechatronics.	Siemens Level 1 exam data is not useful since only a few students take the exam. The PLO#3 assessment gave a 72% rate of meeting the competency. PLO #3 is assessed in MECH 2441
3	Increase enrollment in first-year classes	The inaugural Summer STEAM	Outside funding for STEAM	No changes anticipated. The	Fall 2023 enrollment in the

	at the Cookeville campus. (Student success)	camp was help in 2023. Several HS groups have toured the campus and visited the MECH lab. Cookeville campus recruiting is actively involving Mechatronics in recruiting activity.	camp is required. META funded the 2023 camp.	plan is to continue with the current efforts to grow recruiting and increase dual enrollment.	two 1st year MECH classes is at 12 and 11. This is compared to 2022 when the 1st year classes were cancelled due to low enrollment.
4					

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	YES
1	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning)	eLearn module was not developed.	Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens	PLO #1 achievement based on the MECH 2320 assessment was 100%.	No
2	Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and	eLearn module was not developed.	Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens	PLO #3 achievement based on the MECH 2441 assessment was 90%.	No

	PLCs class. (Student learning)				
3	Increase enrollment in first-year classes at the Cookeville campus. (Student success)	Summer STEAM camps were held in 2023 and 2024. Several HS groups have toured the campus and visited the MECH lab. Cookeville campus recruiting is actively involved in Mechatronics recruiting. The charter class of the Putnam County Middle College (PCMC) began Fall 2024 with 9 students enrolled and 2 students choosing Mechatronics as a major.	Continued funding for STEAM camp. Continued recruiting for PCMC.	Fall 2024 enrollment in the two 1st year classes is at 16 and 15.	Yes
4					

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning)	This initiative is designed to help show if students are achieving the standard of PLO #1.	We will continue to measure PLO#1 using the current method. We will continue to look for a standard or 3rd party method to verify PLO #1.	Assessments used to verify PLOs need to be required activities that are preferable integrated into a course.
2	Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs class. (Student learning)	This initiative is designed to help show if students are achieving the standard of PLO #3.	We will continue to measure PLO#3 using the current method. We will continue to look for a standard or 3rd party method to verify PLO #3.	Assessments used to verify PLOs need to be required activities that are preferable integrated into a course.
3	Increase enrollment in first-year classes at the Cookeville campus. (Student success)	Increasing enrollment in the Cookeville Mechatronics program increases the stability of the program as well as improves	Yes - best practices learned from this effort will continue to be used at the Gallatin and Cookeville campuses to increase student	The recruiting efforts for the STEAM camp and PCMC have yielded results inside and outside the targeted recruiting demographic.

		opportunity for program graduates.	enrollment in the Mechatronics program.	
4				

Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Nursing AAS

Reflection and Mission

PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

Narrative:

The nursing division's mission is to prepare graduates with a foundation for professional nursing through the philosophy of providing the knowledge, skills, and attitudes necessary for students to be eligible to apply to take the National Council Licensure Examination for the Registered Nurse (NCLEX-RN). Students will cover the core concepts that provide the basis for the knowledge, skills, and attitudes that are essential for providing safe nursing care.

Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Revised in 2016, Vol State's mission statement describes the philosophy and purpose of the college. Volunteer State Community College (VSCC) is a public, comprehensive community college offering associate degrees, certificates, continuing education, and service to our constituencies. The College is committed to providing quality innovative educational programs; strengthening community and workforce partnerships; promoting diversity, and cultural awareness, and economic development; inspiring lifelong learning; and preparing students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society. The VSCC Strategic Plan through 2025 was updated and adopted by the President's Cabinet on June 28th, 2021. It focuses on Open Access, Community and Workforce Development, and Completion.

The nursing program mission and philosophy supports the governing organization in fulfilling its core values, mission, and goals. The AASN program added an associate degree offering in nursing to the many programs already offered at Vol State. It has helped provide nursing education to area students to prepare them as successful nurses. It helped strengthen workforce partnerships and is helping the community with access to quality healthcare by delivering more registered nurses to the community. These students are career ready and are also ready to transfer to four-year universities as they choose to do so.

The values, mission, and goals of the Vol State also help support the nursing program. Vol State's commitment to providing quality education programs was a driving force in bringing a nursing program to Vol State. They have provided an accessible program to a community that was in need. Their community partnerships that were already in place due to other health science programs helped give nursing the contacts and clinicals necessary to provide quality education to nursing students.

Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

Narrative:

The VSCC AASN program has developed a systemic plan of evaluation. The systemic plan of evaluation is used to assess outcomes and help evaluate areas where improvement is needed. The results allow for faculty and the nurse administrator to determine the need for change. Faculty use evaluation to make curriculum changes geared towards improving outcomes. The systemic evaluation plan is attached in the evidence. The AASN program uses multiple methods to evaluate EPSLOs and PO's.

Evidence:

- Systematic Plan of Evaluation

EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Narrative:

Learning Activities and Instructional Methods

Learning activities are selected by the faculty to aid in delivering content while meeting SLOs and EPSLOs. Each activity is selected based their ability to help the student achieve outcomes. A detailed lesson plan is created by each ensure each activity relates and that all outcomes are covers.

Instructional methods vary based on the setting. Instructors use PowerPoint presentations, group activities, hands-on activities, case studies, videos, simulations, and group discussion. They select activities that will allow the students the opportunity to critically think.

Evaluation Methods

Evaluation methods are based on each individual activity. They help ensure the student has met the objectives of the assignment as related to the EPSLOs. Each assignment is intended to show the student had achieved the outcome in which the assignment relates.

Evaluation of EPSLOs

- ATI RN Comprehensive Predictor: Scores are analyzed in different content areas that relate to each EPSLO. The expected level of achievement (ELA) is a group average of 70% in the corresponding content area.
- Final Clinical Evaluation: The final clinical evaluation evaluates overall student performance in the clinical setting as it relates to the EPSLOs. The ELA is that 100% of students will achieve a satisfactory in all areas of their final clinical evaluation.

- **Final Care Plan:** The final care plan evaluates the student use of the nursing process in the clinical setting as it relates to several of the EPSLOs. The ELA is that 100% of students will achieve a satisfactory on their final care plan.

Evaluation of PO's

- **Exam Pass Rate for NCLEX Certifications:** The annual NCLEX-RN pass rate for the first-time test-takers will be at least 85%.
- **Program Completion Rate:** At least 60% of students will complete the program within 150% of the program length.
- **Program Completion Rate for ACEN:** At least 45% of students will complete the program on-time.
- **Job Placement Rate:** At least 85% percent will be employed as a registered nurse within twelve months post-graduation.

Each EPSLO is paired with an end of course student learning outcome. They are all the same concept, but advance in progression. They are professional behavior, communication, assessment, clinical decision making, caring interventions, teaching and learning, collaboration, and managing care.

AASN Evaluation Methods

AASN Formative Evaluation Methods		
Classroom	Skills lab	Clinical
Unit Exams	Skills Check-offs	Care Plans
Quizzes	Simulations	Weekly Clinical Evaluations
Prep U		
Math Competency Exams		
Discussion Boards		
Case Studies		
ATI Practice Assessments		
Learning System 3.0		
Professional Communication Assessment		
Board of Nursing Paper		
Weekly Journal Entries		
AASN Summative Evaluation Methods		
Classroom	Skills lab	Clinical
Final Exams	Final Simulations	Final Clinical Evaluations
ATI Proctored Assessments	Laboratory Evaluation	Final Care Plans
ATI Comprehensive Predictor		

Student Attainment of Competencies

Students complete a wide variety of activities to prove attainment of competence throughout the program. Students must submit all assignments, whether awarded points or not, to be awarded a passing grade for the course. Satisfactory performance in the clinical and lab setting are also required to pass a course. Students are required to receive a pass or satisfactory on any pass/fail or satisfactory/unsatisfactory assessments. For evaluation methods which are awarded points, the students must earn a minimum average of 78%.

Quizzes

Quizzes may be scheduled or unscheduled. They are an opportunity to obtain a baseline of how students are comprehending material.

Exams

Each course has four-unit exams and a final. Each exam increases in difficulty, increasing in application and analysis questions as students progress through each semester. Exam Soft is in the process of being purchased to administer exams. They are currently given electronically in eLearn. Instructors utilize exam blueprints when creating exams to be reflective of the NCLEX test plan and

ensure an increase in difficulty and application and analysis type questions. It also allows them to link each question to an SLO. At the end of each exam, students are broken into groups to take the exam as a small group. They are able to discuss rationales and it enhances the learning process. Students are also given ATI exams in each course, except for NRSNG 1720, and a comprehensive ATI exam at the end of the program. They also follow the NCLEX test plan guidelines.

Skills Evaluation

Skills check-offs are utilized in the lab to evaluate competence. Standardized check-off rubrics from a current skills book are used in order to be objective, consistent, and up to date with current practice.

Additionally, students receive a lab evaluation at the end of each lab which they must earn a satisfactory on.

Clinical Evaluation

Each student receives a clinical evaluation. If not satisfactory at the mid-term, they receive a written evaluation outlining the need to improve. If satisfactory performance is noted, they will receive the evaluation only at the end of the semester. The instructor provides feedback through counseling forms if a student is at risk for meeting outcomes week by week. This helps the student understand areas of opportunity in a timely manner, as well as address any issues that may need to be addressed before another clinical. The clinical evaluations are then shared with the course lead in order to make them aware of any deficiencies noted with an individual student or within the groups. Clinical evaluations are progressive in expectations as students advance in the classroom, learn more advanced skills in the lab, and gain independence in the clinical setting.

Lab Evaluation

Each student receives a lab evaluation at the end of the semester. Any deficiencies during the semester are noted with a counseling form. The lab evaluation ties to the SLO's. Students must earn a satisfactory to pass the course.

Case Studies

Case Studies are a way for students to build upon a clinical scenario. There are multiple avenues for them to show what they know, do not know, and where they may need to improve.

Evidence:

- 2020 NCLEX
- 2021 NCLEX
- SEP - Updated for Job Placement Collection of Data

Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

Narrative:

Survey results are from cohorts graduating in 2020 and 2021. These students entered the program the year it was brand new and lacked leadership for almost 10 months. They also attended during the peak of COVID, often times, when labs and clinicals were not available.

To improve, instructors were placed at both campuses so no students had to receive instruction via video.

More simulations have been added to the lab. Instructors are encouraged to bring more active learning into the classroom.

Additional faculty and lab coordinator positions have been a strength.

Evidence:

- 2020 Nursing Employer Survey
- 2020 Nursing Graduate Survey
- 2021 Nursing Graduate Survey

RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment
Enrollment
Retention
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

Narrative:

Nursing admission has increased on the Gallatin campus each year. The Livingston campus increased two years in a row, then had a decrease. The GPA requirement was researched and adjusted to help with this. Students are recruited through virtual information sessions, social media, and other methods.

Evidence:

- 2022 Nursing Fact Sheet

Supporting Program Information

FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other

evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

Narrative:

Many things have gone right for the AASN program. The program has had overall growth, has met all program outcomes each year, has received full approval from the TN Board of Nursing, and is on the path to accreditation by ACEN, expected in April/May 2023. The faculty have grown and continue to develop to help graduate successful nurses to enter the workforce upon successfully completing the NCLEX.

There is always room for improvement. The faculty will continue to evaluate each course each semester to find areas to improve in and make them better.

Overall, the AASN program has been very successful.

TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

Narrative:

Goal: Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus.

Rationale: This will help provide full-time support for nursing students on the Livingston campus. It will also provide more consistent faculty dedication to course coverage, specifically lecture. This should ultimately help improve student satisfaction and outcomes.

Timeline: Post job in 11/2022, hire faculty member to start position in 05/2023.

Goal: Implement ExamSoft for nursing exams in Spring 2023.

Rationale: This will help provide students an opportunity to experience Next Gen NCLEX testing styles that will go live for NCLEX in April 2023. They will be able to familiarize themselves with question types to be more successful with the Next Gen NCLEX.

Timeline: Implement ExamSoft by start of Spring semester 2023.

Goal: Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course.

Rationale: The course summary will be a place for faculty to document their course outcomes, evaluate them, and make suggestions for change. Changes will be analyzed to see if they were beneficial. The document will bring more accountability to the faculty member to find deficiencies in activities thought to meet outcomes and improve them.

Timeline: First implementation to be 12/2022. Reevaluation of changes will occur the next time each course is taught, one year later.

DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

Narrative:

I have reviewed this report for content, accuracy, and quality and it has my support in all areas.

VPAA feedback: I appreciate the work of the Dean and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. The program has had tremendous success in growth, retention, and quality (as shown by NCLEX scores and other measures), which is especially notable as a new program that navigated the pandemic in its first few years. I'd like to see the initiatives reframed to focus more on student learning (with the action/adoption being a strategy for reaching the

improvement in student learning). It would also be good for the faculty to find a specific area or two of student learning based to focus improvement initiatives on. While the overall level of achievement is very high, there may be relative areas of weakness that could be improved.

AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Narrative:

This position is no longer active. The APR author works directly with the Academic Assessment Officer throughout the process.

PRESENTATION FEEDBACK

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

Narrative:

APR Cohort C conducted a Peer Review rather than a presentation.

The Logistic APR was reviewed by the Mechatronic, A.A.S. APR author.

Action Plan Status Reports

YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
1	Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus.	A nursing lab coordinator was hired and began working exclusively for the Livingston campus in May of 2023.	There was not a large applicant pool, but the person who was hired was a quality candidate. She did not have her MSN, but did start a program prior to hire to	No changes	The goal was met. A lab coordinator was hired for the Livingston campus by the target date.

			meet the position requirement set forth by the TN nursing board.		
2	Implement ExamSoft for nursing exams in Spring 2023. PLO 4	Examsoft was contracted in December 2022 and went live for nursing exams in January of 2023.	Setup was challenging with the need being on numerous devices on two different campuses. Examsoft updates remain a challenge on some devices. While they get done, it is not an ideal process given the need for IT admins to update.	No changes	The goal was met. Students easily learned and utilized the software beginning in the Spring 2023 semester. Faculty are better able to administer exams in an NCLEX format and track their data.
3	Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course.	The course summary was developed in the fall of 2022 and presented in the December 2022 faculty meeting. It was then used the following spring 2023 semester.	There were no challenges to the process.	No changes	The goal was met. The course summary was initiated by the goal date and summarizes course outcomes, strengths, and weaknesses.
4					

YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and	The tutorial video was launched in the model shell.	None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%	YES

	implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1	Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus.	A nursing lab coordinator was hired and began working exclusively for the Livingston campus in May of 2023.	There was not a large applicant pool, but the person who was hired was a quality candidate. She did not have her MSN, but did start a program prior to hire to meet the position requirement set forth by the TN nursing board.	No changes	The goal was met. A lab coordinator was hired for the Livingston campus by the target date.
2	Implement ExamSoft for nursing exams in Spring 2023.	Examsoft was contracted in December 2022 and went live for nursing exams in January of 2023.	Setup was challenging with the need being on numerous devices on two different campuses. Examsoft updates remain a challenge on some devices. While they get done, it	No changes	The goal was met. Students easily learned and utilized the software beginning in the Spring 2023 semester. Faculty are better able to administer exams in an NCLEX format and track their data.

			is not an ideal process given the need for IT admins to update.		
3	Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course.	The course summary was developed in the fall of 2022 and presented in the December 2022 faculty meeting. It was then used the following spring 2023 semester.	There were no challenges to the process.	No changes	The goal was met. The course summary was initiated by the goal date and summarizes course outcomes, strengths, and weaknesses.
4					

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis

	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1	Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus.	This role has provided support for lab practice, tutoring, mentoring, more face to face instructor time, and more in comprehensive lab experiences. All of these things help students improve their knowledge and skills which align with the course outcomes.	No. The lab coordinator role should remain filled and continue the duties per the job description.	The lab coordinator offers feedback on a regular basis and changes for improvement will be made in the lab as necessary.
2	Implement ExamSoft for	The software has allowed students to experience Next	No. Examsoft is installed and	Data from exams can show the

	nursing exams in Spring 2023.	Gen NCLEX style questions which help them prepare for the licensure exam. These questions give them the experience they need to know how to answer the questions. Showign competence in exams helps cover the different learning outcomes set forth in the course.	the program will continue use.	program where we are meeting outcomes and where we are not. Decisions that are made are based on data.
3	Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course.	Course summaries allow the faculty to gave a summary of the class performance on learning outcomes, overall grades, what went well, what did not, what should stay the same and what needs to change. These changes are made with the students in mind to help achieve stuent learning outcomes.	No. The course summary is in place and will continue to be used as it currently is.	The course summaries allow faculty to reflect on hcnages that need to be made.
4				

University Parallel Cohort A

Academic Program Review Cohort A- University Parallel Cycle 2

University Parallel AA & AS

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Narrative:

Section 1. Mission Statement Alignment

PROGRAM AND INSTITUTION MISSION ALIGNMENT

Program Mission Statement	Institutional Mission Statement
"Be a great program"	Volunteer State Community College is a public, comprehensive community college offering quality, innovative educational programs, support, and services. Vol State is committed to building partnerships, strengthening internal and external community engagement, and promoting diversity, cultural awareness, and economic development to prepare students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society.
How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?	

Evidence:

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

Volunteer State Community College's University Parallel program offers Associates of Arts and Associate of Science degrees in sixty-seven areas of emphasis. The programs span five academic divisions: Business, Humanities, Math and Science, Social Science and Education, and Health Sciences. The mission of the University Parallel Program aligns with the mission of Volunteer State Community College.

All courses offered by the college correspond with the mandated student learning outcomes for each general education course by the Tennessee Board of Regents (TBR). The courses taught at Volunteer State Community College are offered through four different delivery methods: traditional face-to-face, online, hybrid, and TNeCampus. The faculty of Volunteer State Community College have developed programs designed to meet the educational needs of our service area. Consistency of instruction and preparation of appropriate course materials that meet the students' needs is a challenge, however, faculty implement several learning initiatives to address these challenges. For example, increase direct assessments of University Parallel student learning outcomes, the development of a vigorous Quality Assurance Process for online learning, and the development of the Teaching & Learning Center. Additionally, the academic freedom allowed to each faculty member illustrates the commitment of establishing attainable course outcomes and allows for the implementation of best practices throughout each program's curriculum.

The curriculum of each University Parallel program promotes the mission of the college by providing innovative educational programs in the context of preparing students for successful careers and community service.

Section 2. Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

2.A ASSESSMENT PLAN

The program's assessment plan is attached as evidence. Assessed A.S. and A.A. areas of emphasis assessment plans are also attached as evidence. Assessment plans detail the following.

1. Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcomes
2. Assessment Method
3. Achievement Targets
4. Assessment Schedule
5. Assessment Rubric

After reviewing the assessment plan and evaluating course sequencing, provide a rationale for the findings.

Narrative:

The Program Learning Outcomes and Course Learning Outcome for the A.A. & A.S. are evaluated in a variety of subjects annually. Each division identified faculty members who created standardized rubrics and faculty provided input regarding the creation of those rubrics. Additionally, faculty within each division have chosen an assignment or assessment to evaluate the learning outcomes. Faculty have also identified achievement targets as either "met" or "not met", respective to their content area. Assessments take place once an academic year, but each division has the liberty to choose which semester the outcomes are evaluated.

Evidence:

- ART1035 General Education SLO Assessment Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144759
- BIOL 1010 Student Learning Outcome Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145036
- CHEM1030 General Education Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145251
- ECON2100 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144442
- ECON2200 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144504
- GEOL1060 Assessment Rubric- Lab Activity Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 145115
- MATH 1530 Student Learning Outcomes Assessment Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144954
- MUS1030 General Education SLO Rubric Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144832
- SOCI1010 General Education SLO Rubric _VALUE_ Rubric Detail 02-12-2024 144548
- University Parallel A.A. & A.S. Assessment Plan

2.B EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Areas must analyze all program learning outcomes and at least 3 course learning outcomes from the program's area.

Utilizing the assessment matrix below please provide the following:

1. Analysis of trends.
2. Attach effectiveness documentation of each assessed area of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

Attach: Academic Program Review, University Parallel Area of Emphasis Assessment Reviews

Narrative:

OUTCOME	2020 Met	2020 Not Met	2021 Met	2021 Not Met	2022 Met	2022 Not Met	3 Year Outcome Result (Met/Not Met)	
PLO 1			87.54	12.46	83.81	16.19	93.64	6.36
PLO 2			74.59	25.41	64.87	35.13		
PLO 3			67.01	32.99	62.5	37.5		
PLO 4			77.94	22.06	70.37	29.63	96.36	3.64
PLO 5			81.82	18.18	75	25	92.73	7.27
PLO 6			79.10	20.9	94.2	5.8	78	22
Course Learning Outcome 1 HIST.2010.1 Sources Students will explain the difference between primary and secondary sources.			83.84	16.16	82.03	17.97		
Course Learning Outcome 2 HIST.2010.2 Causes/consequences Students will analyze the causes and consequences of major historical events in early US history			81.96	18.04	81.36	18.64		
Course Learning Outcome 3 HIST.2010.3 Changes Students will demonstrate an understanding of the various social, economic, and political events and changes of the early US period			84.05	15.95	23.82	17.86		

PLO 1: Students will use problem solving as an application of critical thought.

PLO 2: Students will understand and apply knowledge of the foundations and practice in the scientific method of inquiry.

PLO 3: Students will understand and apply knowledge to the foundation and practice in relevant mathematical skills.

PLO 4: Students will demonstrate effective oral communication skills.

PLO 5: Students will demonstrate effective effective written communication skills.

PLO 6: Students will identify and analyze national and global societal challenges.

PLO results dropped in all categories except PLO 7. The most significant drop was in PLO 2, followed by PLO4. The significant decrease in PLO2 is due to students are weaker in science skills coming into college. Additionally, during the transition from Covid to post-Covid, we were seeing students who took more of their science courses online. We know that success went down in the online science courses compared to in-person science courses. Since then we have switched back to modalities that have more in-person components. The significant decrease in PLO4 is most likely a result of the lack of oral communication activity in students due to isolation during the pandemic. The isolation from others increased the level of social anxiety, which decreased the level of effective oral communication skills. Once students were able to return to social activities, too much time had passed in not exercising said skills and at this point, electronic communication was more commonplace than before.

Evidence:

- History Course Learning Outcomes Report
- UPR AA AS PLO_s AY20-23

- UPR AA AS PLOs Gender AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Pell First Gen AY21-23
- UPR AA AS PLOs Race Ethnicity AY21-23
- University Parallel Learning Outcome - Courses Assessment Chart - UPR

Section 3. Quantitative and Qualitative Program Information

VITALITY RESPONSE

Utilizing the program's fact sheet, survey responses, and/or additional evidence, provide the following.

1. Analysis of the program's strengths and areas of opportunity.
2. Analysis of top and low-performing areas of emphasis.
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student success.

Narrative:

1. Assessment of Strengths

The program's biggest strength lies with the faculty at the college. Their ability to adapt and innovate seems to be the driving force behind the increase in graduation rates of students in the University Parallel programs by approximately 500 students from 2020 to 2022, even with the decline of student headcount of approximately 1500 students from Fall 2018 to Fall 2021. There are numerous examples across many departments within the University Parallel program, illustrating the faculty's ability to adapt not only the course modality, but also course content delivery to reach our students' ever-changing needs. Faculty are engaged in HIPs (High Impact Practices), rigorous course review, development and re-development of model courses, annual assessment and review of course learning outcomes, course textbook revisions, and supporting students through the Learning Commons. During the academic audit timeline, the data shows that there are fewer adjunct faculty compared to full-time faculty. This means there are more hours each semester where students have access to faculty during office hours, tutoring time in the Learning Commons, and other unplanned, random interactions with faculty. An increase in student graduation rate in the University Parallel Programs could be attributed to an increase in one-on-one student interactions both inside and outside of the classroom.

3. Areas of Opportunity

In addition to faculty attendance at regional conferences for subject area two-year colleges and similar groups, we find that this is also an area of opportunity. There are several departments within the University Parallel program that would benefit from more consistent interaction with other TBR and out-of-state community colleges and 4-year schools, which would serve both as opportunities to network as well as to gather information about what is being done. This can also lead to continued innovation within our department and program.

Another area of opportunity lies with interdepartmental and cross divisional collaborations and interaction within the program. Many departments have interesting and useful initiatives and other departments may not be aware of these. We find that working on the University Parallel Academic Audit and University Parallel Review makes this clear as we find out about a variety of such initiatives through these processes. This may also be true within each department regarding how classes are taught and different activities, methodologies, and best practices.

By increasing student retention, we would also be increasing graduation rates. Focusing on faculty support of students in the classroom in both content area and study skills and critical thinking abilities may continue to increase graduation rates. Gateway courses, FYEX, and a broader adoption of HIPs, best practices, and innovations that are occurring in some areas.

Another area of opportunity is leadership structure. One of the University Parallel Academic Audit's initiatives from Spring 2023 was to provide a leadership group for the University Parallel program. The goal date for this was Spring 2024. Thus far a leadership group has not been announced. A General Education committee was created and approved in Fall 2022, so the precedent has been set for such a committee for the University Parallel. A leadership organization would go a long way towards accomplishing the area of opportunity listed above.

Evidence:

- University Parallel Academic Audit 2022
- University Parallel- Fact Sheet FA23

Section 4. Improvement Initiatives

4.A Matrix of Improvement Initiatives

Complete the matrix of improvement initiatives below. The matrix must include at least two student learning and at least two student success initiatives. The matrix should not include more than 6 initiatives in total.

Narrative:

YEAR 1						
	Initiative	Objective	Who	Performance Indicator(s)*	Timeline **	Baseline Data
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements	Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty	(1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%. (2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88% (3) Reach 120 views	AY2023-2024 Develop Tutorial Faculty review of the tutorial. Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections. AY2024-2025 Launch video in the model shell	(1) 76% pass rate (2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.
1	To increase student success achievement of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during	To provide faculty with resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques to best meet the needs of the	VPAA, Deans, Department Chairs, and Faculty.	Increase of each PLO by 2.5%	Provide a round table discussion time during convocation days. Record minutes to share with	

	convocation to discuss best practices.	student population.			faculty not in attendance.	
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective oral communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #4 met outcome rate to 80% which is an increase of 9.63%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped from 77.94% in 2021 to 70.37% in 2022	Baseline of 77.94 in 2021 70.37% in 2022 of met outcome.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the development of course material in Gateway courses.	To provide all students in Gateway math courses additional resources of prerequisite material to ensure they are prepared to learn new and more complex concepts.	Dean Math and Sciences Division, Math Department Chair, and Math Faculty	Increase the PLO #3 met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (67%)	AY 2023-2024 -Build course material to make Learning Support materials available to all students -Provide material to students by Spring 2025	Baseline of 67.01% (2021) and 52.5% (2022) met the outcome.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	To provide students with the skills and techniques needed to develop effective written communication skills.	Deans, department chairs, and faculty	Increase the PLO #5 the met outcome rate to the rate from 2021 (81.2%) which is an increase of 6.2%	Develop the FYEX course by Fall of 2024. Pilot course Spring of 2025. Examine evidence to determine why the rate dropped in 2021 from 81.2% to 75% in 2022	Baseline of the met outcome of 81.2% (2021) and 75% (2022).

4.B Initiative Budget

Detail the budget needs and/or requests for applicable initiatives.

Section 5. Reviews and Feedback

5.A General Education Committee

Faculty will present the General Education Review (GER) to the General Education Committee. The Committee will conduct a review of the UPR and GER. The committee will provide feedback for the completed review and action plan as a supportive step.

5.B DEAN'S REVIEW

The Dean will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. Deans should consider division planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

5.C VPAA AND AVPAA REVIEW

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

Section 6. Improvement Initiative Progress Updates

6.A YEAR 2 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 2					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Changes if applicable	Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.	Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.	No changes to the timeline.	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%
1	To increase student success achievement		During the past academic year, the college experienced a significant leadership	As the new leadership continues to settle in,	Unable to compare because no progress has

	of all PLOs, faculty have a scheduled time slot during convocation to discuss best practices.		transition with the appointment of a new president. While this change brought fresh perspectives and long-term strategic vision, it also required a period of adjustment and realignment of priorities across departments. As the administration focused on assessing current practices and establishing new goals under new leadership, our effort to provide faculty with targeted resources, strategies, and classroom management techniques was temporarily paused or delayed. This transition period limited the availability of time and support needed to fully implement faculty development programs.	we anticipate renewed momentum for faculty support in the upcoming year.	been made in the initiative.
2	Increase student learning in PLO #4 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #4 79.66% met. This is 0.34% below the goal.
3	Increasing student learning in PLO #3 through the	The Math Gateway courses use a third-party learning platform	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #3 57.88% met. This is a

	development of course material in Gateway courses.	to deliver the majority of course content, including homework assignments, quizzes, and tests. The math department added the Learning Support Math material into these learning platforms in the model courses as optional assignments to ensure that the material is available to all students.			5.38% increase from 2022, but still below the goal.
4	Increase student learning in PLO #5 through a revamped FYEX course that is relevant to each division and program.	The campus-wide FYEX committee created a FYEX model that was shared with each division earlier this semester (2025). Divisions will revise the course, as needed, by the end of April 2025. FYEX courses will go live in Fall 2025.	No challenges were identified.	No changes to the timeline.	AY 23-24 PLO #5 84.05% met. This exceeds the goal of 81.2%.

6.B YEAR 3 PROGRESS MATRIX

Complete the progress matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Progress					
	Initiative	Achieved Milestones	Challenges	Performance Indicator Result	Initiative Achieved? Yes/No
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1	The tutorial video was launched in the model	None	The assignment success rate for pilot	YES

	by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234	shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections		sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%	
1					
2					
3					
4					

6.C YEAR 3 INITIATIVE ANALYSIS MATRIX

Complete the initiative analysis matrix below.

Narrative:

YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis				
	Initiative	How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?	Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.	How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?
EX.	Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234		None	The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%
1				
2				
3				
4				